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Leviticus 1:1–17

Leviticus

Leviticus 1:1–17

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 1:1–17 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 1:1–17 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 1:1–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the book of Leviticus, Yahweh gives the people of Israel more of the rules, laws, and instructions for their nation. At the beginning of the book, Yahweh focuses on telling Moses how the people of Israel and Yahweh's priests should offer the offerings, gifts, and sacrifices of animals and grain to Yahweh.

Before Yahweh explains this, though, a few important things have already happened.

For more information about what important things have happened, stop and listen to the introduction to the book of Leviticus. Pause this audio here.

So the book of Leviticus begins with Yahweh telling Moses to tell the people of Israel the instructions for how to bring different kinds of offerings to Yahweh. And Yahweh talks to Moses from the Tent of Meeting because that was the place on earth where Yahweh had put Yahweh's presence.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Where do people in your culture go to communicate with gods, ancestors, or spirits? Is there a specific location, or can people communicate with gods anywhere? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh gives the instructions to Moses because Moses is Yahweh's prophet and so Moses is Yahweh's messenger. Part of Moses' job as Yahweh's prophet is to listen to Yahweh and then tell the people of Israel what Yahweh said. In the book of Leviticus, this means that it is Moses' responsibility to listen to Yahweh's instructions about how to worship Yahweh and then explain those instructions to the people of Israel so that everyone would know how to worship Yahweh in the correct way.

The beginning of Leviticus focuses on how to offer the burnt offerings. The word that Yahweh uses for burnt offerings in the original language means "go up." Yahweh probably calls this sacrifice the "go-up" offering because every part of the animal except the hide burns up on the bronze altar and becomes smoke that goes up to the sky. The hide of an animal is its outside skin.

Stop here and look at a picture of the bronze altar. Pause this audio here.

Burnt offerings were not a new kind of offering. If you remember the story of Noah, after Noah left the ark, Noah offered a burnt offering to Yahweh. Later, when the people of Israel went through the ritual to officially become Yahweh's people, and for Yahweh to be the people's only God, the people offered burnt offerings as part of that ritual. The people of Israel were not the only people who sacrificed this kind of offering. People in other countries offered burnt offerings to their gods and goddesses as a gift or as a way to ask for a favor.

Leviticus 1:1–17

However, after the people of Israel officially promised to be Yahweh's people and that Yahweh would be their only God, Yahweh no longer allowed the Israelites to offer burnt offerings or any other kind of sacrifice to anyone or anything except Yahweh. Because of that, Yahweh gave Moses instructions for how the people of Israel were supposed to offer burnt offerings to Yahweh. There are three main sets of instructions that are different depending on which kind of animal the person offering the sacrifice gives to Yahweh. The instructions start by focusing on how to offer the most expensive animals, and the instructions end with how to offer the least expensive animals.

So the instructions start with how to sacrifice an animal from the herd. "From the herd" means a large herd animal like a bull or ox, or another large animal people kept for milk or meat.

Stop here and look at a picture of a bull and an ox. Pause this audio here.

So, when a person chooses one of these large herd animals to offer to Yahweh, the person who offers the sacrifice is supposed to choose a male animal that is perfect. That means that the animal has no physical defects. The animal must not be blind or deformed or have any bruises or injuries. The animal must not have any kind of skin disease or be missing any body part. The animal has to be physically perfect.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, when people want to offer something to a god, ancestor, or spirit, what kinds of offerings are acceptable? What kinds of offerings are unacceptable? Pause this audio here.

Once the offeror has chosen a perfect animal, the offeror should bring the animal to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. Then the offeror should place their hand on the animal's head. The Bible does not explain exactly why the offeror had to put their hand on the animal's head. Some people think the purpose was a ritual way to say, "This animal is mine and not the priest's." This would be similar to how some people use a signature or stamp when they send a letter or a package to someone as a way to identify themself as the sender. Other people think the purpose was to say, "This animal is me, and I should be dying here." Still other people think the purpose was to transfer uncleanness or ritual dirtiness to the animal, which would then cleanse the offeror. People at this time used words like "clean" and "dirty" to talk about the world and people's actions. For example, doing something wrong would make someone unclean or ritually dirty. For the people of Israel, it was important for the Israelites to be "clean." This was because Yahweh had dedicated the Israelites to Yahweh and made the Israelites holy. Anything that was holy also had to be "clean." So, one possible reason the person offering the animal for the burnt offering put their hand on the animal's head was to move whatever ritual dirt was on that person onto the animal. When people killed and burned the animal on the altar, the person offering the animal would be "clean" again.

Next, Yahweh tells Moses one of the purposes of offering a burnt offering. That purpose is to "make atonement," or make amends, for the offeror. The word for this in this original language focuses on cleansing and making things right.

So, for the ancient Israelites, when someone wronged another person or wronged Yahweh, three things would happen. The first thing was that there would be a separation between the two people. When one person wronged a second person, that second person might feel upset or angry. That person might avoid or attack the first person.

The second thing that would happen was that the wrong thing would make the person who did the wrong thing ritually "dirty." However, it would not only affect the person who did the wrong thing. That dirt would also affect that person's family, community, and environment.

The third thing is that the spiritual dirt that came on a person marked that person for punishment or judgment that would happen sometime in the future. People from other nations who were not the people of Israel believed that one of the many gods and goddesses that those people believed in would punish the person who did wrong. However, the Bible teaches that Yahweh is the only God. That means that Yahweh is the One who would judge and punish the person who did wrong. Yahweh might use a human, disease, wild animal, or anything else to judge and punish the person, but the ultimate judge is always Yahweh.

"Making atonement," or making amends, would resolve these three problems. The act of atoning, or making amends, would do three things. First, it would restore the relationship between the person who did the wrong and the person whom the first person wronged. Second, it would cleanse the person who did the wrong, as well

as their family and environment, from guilt and spiritual dirt. Third, because the person was now clean from the guilt of the wrong, that person did not have to worry about Yahweh judging and punishing that person. While there were other sacrifices that focused more specifically on atoning and making amends, one of the purposes of the burnt offering was to do this as well.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do people in your culture make amends when someone has wronged somebody else? Pause this audio here.

After the offeror puts their hand on the animal, the offeror is supposed to kill the animal in front of Yahweh. It is unclear exactly where the offeror is supposed to kill the animal, but it is probably somewhere in the courtyard area between the entrance of the Tent of Meeting and the bronze altar. It is possible that the offeror killed the animal right next to the bronze altar since people still considered the altar as part of the entrance, but no one knows for certain.

Stop here and look at a picture of the courtyard in the Tent of Meeting. Notice the possible locations for where the person should kill the animal. Pause this audio here.

After the offeror kills the animal, Aaron's descendants, who were the priests, are supposed to take the blood of the animal and splash it all around on the bronze altar. People thought blood contained the life of a person or animal, and so the people of Israel used the blood of animals to atone, or make amends, after the Israelites had wronged Yahweh or other people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do people in your culture think about blood? How is that similar or different from how the people of Israel thought about blood? Pause this audio here.

After a person splashes the blood around the bronze altar, someone is supposed to skin the animal and cut the meat into pieces. It is unclear whether the person doing this is the priest, the offeror, or someone else. Next, the priest is supposed to light a fire on the altar and arrange wood on the fire. Then the priest is supposed to arrange the animal meat, head, and fat on top of the wood that is on the altar. After that, someone is supposed to wash the animal's legs and the inside organs with water. Again, it is unclear whether the person doing this is the priest, the offeror, or someone else. Finally, the priest is then supposed to burn the animal's innards and legs up on the altar as well.

The end result is that everything except for the hide is supposed to burn up on the altar. The smoke from the animal is like incense that would make a good smell to please and honor Yahweh. People in other cultures at this time thought that offering sacrifices to their gods and goddesses was a way to give the gods food. Other people thought that the gods and goddesses would eat the animals, grain, and wine that people sacrificed to gods. But Yahweh is different. Yahweh does not need to eat food or drink wine. The sacrifices and offerings that the people of Israel gave to Yahweh were a way to honor Yahweh, not a way to give Yahweh something to eat.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are some other reasons that people might make an offering to a god, ancestor, or spirit? How is that similar or different to why the people of Israel are offering animals to Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

Part two focuses on what to do if the person offering the sacrifice sacrificed an animal from the flock. This refers to smaller animals like sheep or goats. Like with the bull or ox, the sheep or goat that the person sacrificed had to be a male that was physically perfect.

Stop here and look at a picture of sheep and goats. Pause this audio here.

A person is supposed to kill this animal on the north side of the bronze altar in front of Yahweh. After the person killed the animal, the priests were supposed to splash the blood around on the altar, and then someone was supposed to cut the animal into pieces. It is unclear whether the person doing this is the priest, the offeror, or someone else. Then the priest is supposed to arrange the pieces of meat along with the head and fat on the wood that is burning on the altar. Next, someone is supposed to wash the legs and innards with water. It is unclear whether the person doing this is the priest, the offeror, or someone else. Finally, the priest is supposed to burn the legs and innards on the altar as well. Once again, the smoke from the animal is like incense that would make a good smell to please and honor Yahweh.

Part three focuses on what to do if the person who sacrificed the animal sacrificed a bird. These specific birds are different kinds of pigeons and doves. These kinds of birds only eat plants and grains. Later, when Yahweh tells Moses what kinds of animals and birds are clean and which ones are not, Yahweh says these birds were "clean," which meant it is okay to eat and to sacrifice these birds to Yahweh.

Stop here and look at a picture of different kinds of pigeons and doves. Pause this audio here.

When someone sacrifices a bird as a burnt offering, the priest is supposed to bring the bird to the bronze altar. Then, the priest is supposed to wring off the bird's head and burn the head on the altar. After that, the priest is supposed to drain the blood on the side of the altar. Then, the priest is supposed to remove the digestive tract and feathers. The digestive tract refers to the part of the bird that digests food.

Stop here and look at a picture of a bird's digestive tract. Pause this audio here.

After the priest removes the digestive tract and feathers, the priest is supposed to throw both on the east side of the altar. This is the same place where the priest would put the ashes that were left behind after the fat from a sacrifice burned up. People called this place the place where the fat ashes went.

Stop here and look at a picture of the bronze altar. Note the east side where the fat ashes are. Pause this audio here.

After that, the priest is supposed to tear open the bird's wings without completely splitting the bird in half. Finally, the priest is supposed to burn the rest of the bird on the wood that is burning on the altar. Once again, the smoke from the bird would be like incense that would make a good smell to please and honor Yahweh.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 1:1–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: We hear an introduction to the passage and learn who is talking, to whom, where, and about what. Yahweh speaks to Moses in the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh tells Moses what the people of Israel need to do if they bring Yahweh an offering or a gift of animals to sacrifice as a burnt offering.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Moses what to tell the people of Israel to do if someone sacrifices a bull, ox, or other large animal from the herd. These are animals that people used for milk and meat.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells Moses what to tell the people of Israel to do if someone sacrifices a sheep or goat from the flock.

In the fourth scene: Yahweh tells Moses what to tell the people of Israel to do if someone sacrifices a small bird like a pigeon or dove.

The characters in this passage include:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The sons, or people, of Israel
- The person who offers an animal sacrifice
- And Aaron and his sons, who are the priests

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this scene, Yahweh talks about the entrance to the Tent of Meeting, the bronze altar, and the courtyard between the entrance and the bronze altar.

Stop here and look at a picture of the bronze altar. Pay special attention to the top and sides of the bronze altar. Also, pay special attention to the north side and the east side of the bronze altar. Pause the audio here.

In scene one, Yahweh speaks to Moses from the Tent of Meeting. This happens after the people of Israel made and set up the Tent of Meeting, the way Yahweh told Moses to do. In the previous book of Exodus, we hear that Yahweh told Moses how Yahweh wanted the people of Israel to make the Tent of Meeting and all of the parts, as well as how to set up the Tent of Meeting and where to put all of the parts. After the people of Israel set up everything in the middle of the Israelites' camp at Mount Sinai, Yahweh's presence and glory filled the Tent of Meeting.

Since Yahweh's presence was then living with the people of Israel, Yahweh began to give Moses further instructions about how the people of Israel needed to live. Yahweh begins by talking about what the people of Israel needed to do if a person wanted to bring Yahweh offerings, gifts, or sacrifices of animals.

Since Moses is acting as Yahweh's messenger, Yahweh tells Moses what to tell the people. Yahweh begins by focusing on what the people needed to do if they wanted to sacrifice an animal to Yahweh. Even though the storyteller does not use the word in the original language for a burnt offering, the entire passage focuses on that particular type of sacrifice.

Before going further, stop and describe a ritual ceremony that your community does. Pay attention to how the storyteller describes the process. What words does the storyteller use to explain who does what in what order? Pause this audio here.

Scene two begins the instructions about how to sacrifice an animal from the herd for a burnt offering. These kinds of animals include bulls, oxen, and other large animals that people kept for milk or meat.

Stop and discuss: What kinds of large herd animals do people in your culture keep for milk or meat? Would any of those animals be appropriate to sacrifice to a god, ancestor, or other spiritual being? Pause this audio here.

The instructions begin with what the person offering the sacrifice is supposed to do. The person should choose a male animal without any physical defect. Then the person should bring the animal to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. The person puts their hand on the head of the animal. Then the person kills the animal in front of Yahweh. This probably means in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting, somewhere between the entrance and the bronze altar.

When the Bible talks about killing the animal in front of Yahweh, it means that the person is killing the animal in Yahweh's presence. This does not mean that the person went into the tent itself to kill the animal in front of the ark of the covenant. Rather, it means that the person killed the animal in Yahweh's presence in the courtyard area. Make sure you find a way to translate this phrase that implies the person kills the animal in Yahweh's presence without implying that they went into the tent itself, but rather stayed in the courtyard.

The person offering the sacrifice is supposed to do these things so that Yahweh will accept the sacrifice as a way to atone, or make amends. Next, the priests take some of the blood from the animal and splash the blood around on the bronze altar.

Stop and do this activity: Grab some liquid, like water, and throw it onto a wall or similar structure. Discuss how you think the priests would have thrown the blood onto the sides of the altar, and try to do the same thing. Pause this audio here.

It is not clear who does the next step, but it is likely the offeror. The person should skin the animal and then cut the meat into pieces.

Then the priests should light the fire on the bronze altar and put wood on the fire. Next, the priests should arrange the meat, head, and fat on the wood on the bronze altar.

It is unclear who is doing the next step. It is likely that the offeror is the one doing it, but that is not certain. The step, however, is clear: wash the legs and inside organs with water. The inside organs were probably the animal's stomach and intestines.

Finally, a priest is supposed to burn everything on the altar.

Scene two ends by explaining that this burnt offering is a gift with fire to Yahweh, and it is like incense that is supposed to smell good and make Yahweh happy. Remember that the purpose of the offering is not to feed

Yahweh. Instead, the purpose is to atone, or make amends, for the person who did something wrong and to honor Yahweh with the gift.

Scene three focuses on the instructions about how to sacrifice an animal from the flock as a burnt offering. This kind of animal includes smaller herd animals like sheep and goats.

Stop and discuss: What kinds of smaller herd animals do people in your culture keep? Would any of those animals be appropriate to sacrifice to a god, ancestor, or other spiritual being? Pause this audio here.

The instructions begin with what the person who offers the sacrifice is supposed to do. Again, the person must choose a male animal without any physical defect. The person should kill the animal on the north side of the altar in front of Yahweh.

Stop here and look at a picture of the bronze altar as a group. Note where the north side is. Find a way to explain where that is. Pause this audio here.

Remember, when a person kills an animal "in Yahweh's presence," this probably means that the person kills the animal in the courtyard.

The priests splash some of the animal's blood around on the bronze altar. It is not clear who does the next step, but it is likely the offeror. The step, however, is clear. Someone cuts the meat into pieces.

Next, a priest arranges the meat, head, and fat on the wood on the bronze altar. It is not clear who does the next step, but it may be the priests. The step, however, is clear. Someone washes the legs and the inside organs with water. Finally, a priest should burn everything on the altar.

Like with the previous scene, scene three ends by explaining that this burnt offering is a gift with fire to Yahweh. This offering is like incense that is supposed to smell good and make Yahweh happy. Remember that the purpose of the offering is not to feed Yahweh. Instead, the purpose is to atone for the person who did something wrong and to honor Yahweh with the gift.

Scene four focuses on the instructions about how to sacrifice a bird, such as a turtledove or young pigeon, as a burnt offering. These pigeons ate only plants.

Stop and discuss: What kinds of birds are nearby that only eat plants? Would people consider any of those animals appropriate to sacrifice to a god, ancestor, or other spiritual being? Pause this audio here.

The instructions begin with what the person offering the sacrifice is supposed to do. The person should bring the birds to the Tent of Meeting. Then the priest wrings the bird's neck and burns the head on the bronze altar. Next, the priest drains the blood on the side of the bronze altar. Then the priest must remove the digestive tract and feathers and put them on the east side of the bronze altar, where the fat ashes go. Then the priest should tear the wings, but not fully split the bird. Finally, the priest should burn everything on the wood on the bronze altar.

The east side is where the sun comes up in the morning. For the people of Israel, the east side of the altar is where the priests would put the ashes from the fat that would burn up on the altar. Although the priests and the people of Israel were allowed to eat some of the other animal sacrifices, no one was ever allowed to eat the fat. The fat always burned up on the altar, so it needed a place for the ashes to go.

Stop here and look at a picture of the bronze altar as a group. Note where the east side is. That is the place where the fat ashes went. Discuss a way to describe where the "east side" is. Pause this audio here.

Like with the previous two scenes, scene four ends by explaining that this burnt offering is a gift with fire to Yahweh. This offering is like incense that is supposed to smell good and make Yahweh happy. Remember that the purpose of the offering is not to feed Yahweh. Instead, the purpose is to atone for the person who did something wrong and to honor Yahweh with the gift.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 1:1–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The sons, or people, of Israel
- The person who offers an animal sacrifice
- And Aaron and his sons, who are the priests

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In scene one, Yahweh starts talking to Moses from the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh tells Moses, "Tell the people of Israel: 'If any of you want to bring an animal to Yahweh as a gift from either the herd or the flock, you should bring it near.'" Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel happy to hear what Yahweh has to say; or
- I hope the Israelites listen and obey this time.

Continue the drama. In scene two, Yahweh continues to tell Moses what to tell the people of Israel. Yahweh says, "If the burnt offering is an animal from the herd, it needs to be a male that is physically perfect. Then the offeror needs to bring the animal to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting so that Yahweh will accept the sacrifice. The offeror needs to lay their hand on the head of the animal so that Yahweh will accept it to make atonement and amends for that person." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the person bringing the animal, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel sad that the animal has to die; or
- I feel happy that Yahweh has made a way to restore our relationship.

Continue the drama. Yahweh says, "Next, the offeror needs to kill the young bull in front of Yahweh. After that, Aaron's sons, who are the priests, will bring the blood and splash it around on the sides of the bronze altar. The altar is near the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. Then the offeror will skin the animal and cut the meat into pieces.

"After that, the priest will light the altar and put wood on the fire. Then the priest will arrange the pieces of meat along with the head and fat on the wood on the altar. Then, the offeror will wash the innards and legs with water. Finally, the priest will burn everything on top of the altar. This burnt offering is a gift with fire that will smell good to Yahweh and please Yahweh." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that the offeror cares enough about our relationship to bring an animal; or
- I am happy with the person offering the animal; or
- I am glad this person wants to honor me.

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Continue the drama. In scene three, Yahweh continues to tell Moses what to tell the people of Israel. Yahweh says, "If the burnt offering is a sheep or goat from the flock, it needs to be a male that is physically perfect. The person who offers the animal will kill it on the north side of the altar in front of Yahweh. After that, Aaron's sons, who are the priests, will bring the blood and splash it around on the sides of the bronze altar. Then the offeror will cut the meat into pieces.

"After that, the priest will arrange the pieces of meat along with the head and fat on the wood on the altar. Then, someone will wash the innards and legs with water. Finally, the priest will burn everything on top of the altar. This burnt offering is a gift with fire that will smell good to Yahweh and please Yahweh." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy to help the offeror restore their relationship with Yahweh; or
- My clothes have a lot of blood on them; or
- I am glad to be able to honor Yahweh this way.

Continue the drama. In scene four, Yahweh continues to tell Moses what to tell the people of Israel. Yahweh says, "If the burnt offering for Yahweh is a bird, it should be a turtledove or young pigeon. The priest will bring the bird to the altar. Then the priest will wring off the bird's head and burn the head on the altar. Next, the priest will drain the bird's blood on the side of the altar. After that, the priest will remove the digestive tract and the feathers and throw both on the east side of the altar, where the fat ashes are. Then, the priest will tear open the wings but not split the bird completely in half. Finally, the priest will burn the rest of the bird on the wood that is on the altar. This burnt offering is a gift with fire that will smell good to Yahweh and please Yahweh."

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 1:1–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

This passage begins with **Yahweh** talking to Moses. "Yahweh" was the personal name that the one true God told Moses at the beginning of the book of Exodus. When Yahweh told Moses to bring Yahweh's people out of slavery in Egypt, Moses asked Yahweh what name to tell the people of Israel so that the Israelites would know who sent Moses. So Yahweh told Moses that Yahweh's name was "Yahweh" and that is what Moses should tell the people. When the people of Israel heard this name for God, the name would remind the Israelites of the covenant and promise that Yahweh made with the Israelites' ancestors to take care of the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Yahweh**. Look up Yahweh in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh talks with Moses at the **Tent of Meeting**, which in other places Moses calls the tabernacle. The Tent of Meeting referred to the tent and courtyard that Yahweh chose and set aside as Yahweh's personal space. The Tent of Meeting was sacred to Yahweh, and so everyone needed to treat it with extra respect and care. Only the priests and Moses were allowed to go into the tent itself.

Stop here and look at a picture of the Tent of Meeting as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **Tent of Meeting**. Look up tabernacle in the Master Glossary for more information. Remember that although the Tent of Meeting and tabernacle are the same thing in Leviticus, Moses calls it the Tent of Meeting here. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells Moses what to tell the people of Israel. In the original language, the phrase literally means "Israel's sons," but it refers to everyone—both men and women—who were descended from a man named Israel and his 12 sons. Israel was Abraham's grandson, and his original name was Jacob. When Jacob first left his dad's home to travel to get married, Jacob made a promise to Yahweh that Yahweh would be Jacob's only God if Yahweh would keep Jacob safe until Jacob came back home to Jacob's dad. While Jacob was away, Jacob married two wives and two concubines and had twelve sons and one daughter. After being away from home for many years, Jacob and Jacob's family traveled back to Jacob's dad's home. On the way, Jacob wrestled with one of Yahweh's angels, and so Yahweh changed Jacob's name to "Israel." This new name meant "he wrestles with God." Not long after that,

Jacob realized that Yahweh had kept Jacob safe throughout all of Jacob's travels, so Jacob told Jacob's family to get rid of all household idols in order to worship Yahweh only. The "people of Israel" referred to the descendants of Israel's 12 sons who got rid of their idols and whom their patriarch Israel commanded to worship only Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **people of Israel**. Look up **Israelites** and **Israel** in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

In this chapter, Yahweh tells Moses to tell the people of Israel how to offer their offerings. Yahweh specifically talks about how to offer a burnt offering. The word in the original language literally means "go up." This is probably because people would burn the entire animal except the hide for a burnt offering. All of the meat and fat became smoke that would "go up" to the sky. There were many different reasons why someone might sacrifice a burnt offering. Sometimes it was to thank or honor Yahweh. Sometimes it was to restore their relationship with Yahweh and to cleanse themselves from the contamination of doing something wrong. Burnt offerings were also part of the daily morning and evening sacrifices that the people of Israel offered Yahweh to honor Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the general word for **offering** and for the **burnt offering**. Look up offering and burnt offering in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

In these instructions, Yahweh tells Moses what the person who brings the offering should do, as well as what the priests should do. The word "priest" referred to Moses's brother Aaron and Aaron's male descendants. The priests were responsible for offering the sacrifices. The priests were also the only ones who could go into Yahweh's tent itself, which was the most sacred area in the Tent of Meeting. And the priests were the only ones who could touch the most sacred things. It was dangerous for everyday people to be in the sacred space of Yahweh's courtyard and to be near Yahweh's most sacred things. If the everyday people touched the most sacred things or went into the tent itself, then the people could die. To protect the people, Yahweh gave the priests the responsibility to go into the tent itself, offer the sacrifices, perform the religious rituals, and make sure everyone did everything correctly. The priests also had the responsibility to teach the people of Israel how to love and honor Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **priests**. Look up **priest** in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh gives Moses three different sets of instructions based on the type of animal that the people offered. Yahweh starts with instructions for the animals from the herd. These animals were large animals that the people of Israel kept for milk or meat. One specific type of herd animal in this chapter is a young bull.

Stop here and look at a picture of bulls again as a group, as needed. Pause this audio here.

The second set of instructions is for animals from the flock. Flock animals were smaller herd animals that the people of Israel kept for milk or meat. Two specific types of flock animals that we hear about in this chapter are goats and sheep.

Stop here and look at a picture of goats and sheep again as a group, as needed. Pause this audio here.

The third set of instructions is for birds. These were small birds that only ate plants. These birds did not hunt for meat or scavenge from dead animals. Yahweh talks about pigeons and turtledoves or doves.

Stop here and look at a picture of pigeons and turtledoves as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for the **herd**, **bull**, **flock, goat**, **sheep**, **pigeon**, and **turtledove**. For more information, look at dove in the Master Glossary. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

When Yahweh tells Moses what kinds of herd and flock animals to sacrifice, Yahweh says that the animals have to be physically perfect. The word here for "physically perfect" refers to something that is complete, whole, and without fault. For sacrifices, this meant that the animal could not have any physical defects or skin diseases. Some translations use the word "spotless" for this word. However, this word does not mean that the animal could not have different colors or spots of color. Instead, it meant that the animal could not be blind or lame.

The animal could not have any injuries, deformities, bruises, or any kind of skin disease. What the animal looked like was not important. What was important was that the animal was physically perfect.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **physically perfect**. Look up **perfect** in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, decide if it is appropriate to use the same word here. Use the same word throughout the book of Leviticus. Pause this audio here.

Once the person offering the animal brought the animal to the Tent of Meeting, that person would lay their hand on the head of the animal so that it would be accepted to make atonement for the person. This word focuses on cleansing and making things right.

In the ancient Israelite worldview, when someone wronged another person or wronged Yahweh, three things would happen. The first thing was that there would be a separation between the two people. When one person wronged a second person, that second person might feel upset or angry. That person might avoid or attack the first person.

The second thing was that the wrong thing would make the person who did the wrong thing ritually and spiritually "dirty." However, it would not only affect the person who did the wrong thing. That dirt would also affect that person's family, community, and environment.

The third thing is that because the person was ritually and spiritually dirty, that person would receive punishment or judgment sometime in the future. People from other nations who were not the people of Israel believed that one of the many gods and goddesses that those people believed in would punish the person who did wrong. However, the Bible teaches that Yahweh is the only God. That means that Yahweh is the One who would judge and punish the person who did wrong. Yahweh might use a human, disease, wild animal, or anything else to judge and punish the person, but the ultimate judge is always Yahweh.

"Making atonement," or making amends, would resolve these three problems. The act of atoning, or making amends, would do three things. First, it would restore the relationship between the person who did the wrong and the person whom the first person wronged. Second, it would cleanse the person who did the wrong, as well as their family and environment, from being guilty and ritually dirty. Third, because the person was now clean from the guilt of the wrong, that person did not have to worry about Yahweh judging and punishing that person.

Most of the time, people made atonement, or made amends, by offering a gift to apologize and then doing whatever the victim wanted as a way to make amends. In Leviticus, we hear that when people wronged Yahweh, those people offered Yahweh a gift of an animal sacrifice as a way to apologize and make amends.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **atonement**. Look up atonement in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, decide if it is appropriate to use the same word here. Use the same word throughout the book of Leviticus. Pause this audio here.

The person would slaughter, or kill, the animal. Moses uses a special word for kill here to mean to cut through an animal, especially for a sacrifice.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **slaughtering** an animal. Pause this audio here.

Then the priests would splash or throw some of the blood around on the sides of the bronze altar. Bronze was a metal that people made when they combined copper and tin. The altar was near the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. People considered the altar extra sacred, so only the priests were allowed to touch the altar. This altar was where people sacrificed all of the animals.

Stop here and look at a picture of the bronze altar as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **bronze altar**. Look up **bronze** and **altar** in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about the priest **splashing** or **throwing** the blood on the side of the altar. Pause this audio here.

For animals from the herd or from the flock, different things happened to different parts of the animal. The priest arranged the meat, fat, and head on the bronze altar and burned them up. But someone washed the legs and organs with water before the priest burned the pieces on the altar.

Stop here and look at a diagram of a cut-up animal as a group. Notice the different parts of the animal. Also, notice what the **inside organs** are. Decide how to translate these different parts of the animal. Use the same words throughout the book of Leviticus. Pause this audio here.

For birds, the priest wrung off the head and burned it on the bronze altar. Then the priest removed the digestive tract and feathers. The "digestive tract" probably refers to the part of the bird where the excrement is. Since that was dirty, the priest removed the whole digestive tract, along with the feathers. Then the priest would tear open the wings without splitting the bird completely in half, and then burn the bird on the altar.

Stop here and look at a diagram of a bird as a group. Notice where the **digestive tract** and **feathers** are. Decide how to refer to the different parts of the bird. Use the same words throughout the book of Leviticus. Pause this audio here.

The priest is supposed to throw the bird's digestive tract and feathers on **the east side of the altar, where the fat ashes go**. The east side is where the sun comes up in the morning. The east side of the altar was where the priests would put the ashes from the fat that burned up on the bronze altar.

Stop here and look at a picture of the bronze altar as a group. Note where the east side is, where the fat ashes went. Find a way to communicate about where the fat ashes went. Use that same word or phrase throughout the book of Leviticus. Pause this audio here.

Each section ends by noting that the burnt offering was one of the kinds of offerings that people called a gift with fire. This word in the original language likely referred to a gift of food that people gave to a god that would burn up on an altar. These sacrifices were not food for Yahweh, but instead a way to honor Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for a **gift with fire**. For more information on gift with fire, refer to **fire offering** in the Master Glossary. Be sure to choose a word or phrase that does not mean that Yahweh eats the sacrifices. Use the same word or phrase throughout the book of Leviticus. Pause this audio here.

This animal sacrifice would burn up as incense before Yahweh and be a sweet smell for Yahweh. Incense is a mixture of natural materials like spices and gums that smells good when people burn it. People would burn incense on an altar or in a censer as a way to worship a god or goddess. People at that time burnt incense as a way to honor and worship the gods, and so different communities in the Bible would worship their own gods and goddesses by burning incense. Burning incense smells good. People also thought of the smoke and smell of sacrifices as this same kind of good smell. In this chapter, Yahweh says the smoke and smell of the sacrifices are like incense. That means that the sacrifice was a way to honor and worship Yahweh, and that it would smell good to Yahweh, and that good smell would make Yahweh happy.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **incense** and **sweet smell**. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, decide if it is appropriate to use the same words here. Use the same words or phrases throughout the book of Leviticus.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 1:1–17

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (609 KB)
- Setting the Stage (8.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (9.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (913 KB)

Leviticus 2:1–16

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 2:1–16 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 2:1–16 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 2:1–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The second chapter on Leviticus focuses on offerings of grain and different kinds of bread and crackers. People often translate this kind of offering as the “grain offering.” In the original language, people often used this word to talk about the kind of tribute someone might give to a king or ruler. People also used this word to talk about the kinds of gifts someone would give to someone else in order to ask for a favor. After Yahweh rescued the people of Israel out of slavery in Egypt, Yahweh used Moses to bring the Israelites to the Sinai Mountain. Then, Yahweh and the people of Israel made a covenant, or a binding agreement, with each other that the people of

Israel would be special to Yahweh and that Yahweh would be the Israelites' only God. As part of that covenant, Yahweh became the king and ruler of the Israelite nation. This grain offering was one of the ways that the people of Israel could honor Yahweh as the Israelites' king and ruler, and ask Yahweh for favors.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What kind of gifts do people in your culture bring to honor or ask rulers, chiefs, and government officials for a favor? If Yahweh were in charge of your community, what kind of gifts would you bring to Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

This passage focuses on three different kinds of grain offerings that the people gave to Yahweh. The first kind of grain offering was an offering of uncooked flour. This particular kind of flour was probably semolina flour and was of very high quality. People often used this kind of flour to make meals for kings and other royals.

To prepare this offering, the person offering it would pour oil on the flour. People probably made this oil by pressing olives. After that, the person would put frankincense on top of the oil and flour. Frankincense was a kind of tree sap, or resin, that was both valuable and expensive. Frankincense smelled good when people burned it. People would have also added salt to the offering, but the storyteller does not mention that yet.

After the person prepared the offering, that person would bring the offering to the priests. The priests were Aaron's descendants. In order to bring the offering to the priest, the person presenting the offering probably carried it in a dish or some other sort of vessel. The person would bring this offering to the Tent of Meeting so that the priests could offer it on the bronze altar. This is the same altar that the priests offered the burnt offering and all of the other sacrifices and offerings on.

Once the priest received the offering, the priest would take a full handful of the fine flour and oil, as well as all of the frankincense, and then burn all of this on the altar as incense. The people called the part of the flour and oil that burned up "the memorial portion." Some people think that this portion was supposed to help the people of Israel remember the covenant between Yahweh and his people. Other people think it was supposed to call Yahweh's attention to the reason the person was offering the gift, whether that was to honor, thank, or ask Yahweh for a favor, or for another reason. This memorial portion was a gift with fire that would smell good to Yahweh.

After the memorial portion burned up along with all of the frankincense, the priests would keep the rest of the flour and oil. As Yahweh's close servants and representatives, the priests could share in the gifts that the people gave to King Yahweh. This was also a way for Yahweh to provide for the priests since Yahweh did not give the priests a portion of the promised land to farm. Instead, Yahweh was their portion, so Yahweh took care of the priests through the sacrifices and offerings of animals and grain that the people of Israel brought to Yahweh.

So the priests could eat everything left over after the memorial portion burned up on the bronze altar. However, because the grain offering was extra holy, Yahweh said that no one except the priests could eat that offering. We hear later that the priests needed to eat that offering in the holy place around the Tent of Meeting.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When people in your culture give a food offering to a god, an ancestor, or a spirit, can anyone else eat that offering? If someone else may eat the food, why can that person eat that food? Pause this audio here.

People cooked the second kind of grain offering. There were three different ways to cook it, with instructions about each way. The first way was to cook the offering in an oven. There were two different kinds of ovens. People made both kinds of ovens from clay.

Stop here and look at a picture of both kinds of ovens as a group. Pause this audio here.

There were two kinds of bread that people made in these ovens. One bread was a ring shape. The other bread was a flat, round bread. People made both kinds of bread with the same high-quality flour that the storyteller mentioned earlier. People mixed olive oil with the flour to make the ring-shaped bread. People anointed or smeared the flat, round loaf with olive oil. It was important that people did not add any leavening or yeast to this bread when people cooked it. The two kinds of bread were high-quality, soft, flat bread.

Stop here and look at a picture of both kinds of bread as a group. Pause this audio here.

The second way was to cook the offering on a griddle. People probably made this griddle from iron or clay and made it so that the griddle was slightly curved in shape. People would put the griddle on the fire with the curved side facing up, and then put the dough on top of the curved side.

Stop here and look at a picture of this kind of griddle as a group. Pause this audio here.

Once again, people needed to make this offering with olive oil and the same high-quality flour. Like before, this offering could not have any leavening or yeast in it. This kind of dough made a hard and thin cracker that people needed to break into pieces and then pour oil on the pieces. This would make it easier for the priest to grab some of the cracker as a memorial portion.

The third way was to cook the offering in a pan. This type of pan was probably similar to a frying pan or bowl that might have had a lid with it.

Stop here and look at a picture of this kind of pan as a group. Pause this audio here.

Once again, people needed to make this offering with olive oil and the same high-quality flour. This kind of bread was softer and thicker.

Once someone made the cooked kind of grain offering in one of these three ways, that person would bring the bread or cracker to the priest at the Tent of Meeting. The priest would then approach the bronze altar and lift up a part of the offering as a memorial portion. Then the priest would burn that memorial portion on the bronze altar as a kind of incense to Yahweh. This memorial portion was a gift with fire that would smell good to Yahweh.

Like before, Yahweh gave the priests the rest of the offering to eat. Because this offering was very holy, the priests had to eat it in the holy space of the Tent of Meeting. It is possible that priests ate this meal in the holy space of the courtyard surrounding Yahweh's tent, just like trusted servants sharing a meal with their ruler and king, King Yahweh.

Before Yahweh gave instructions about the third kind of grain offering, Yahweh gave Moses general instructions and rules that applied to all three kinds of grain offerings.

The first rule was that people could not add yeast or honey to any of the grain offerings. The people of Israel often added leavening, or yeast, to other breads to make the bread fluffier. If someone added leaven and honey or sugar to dough, the leaven would eat the honey or the sugar, which would result in gas, which would cause the bread to rise.

However, when offering a gift of bread to Yahweh, the people of Israel were not allowed to use leavening, yeast, or honey. There are a few possible reasons for this rule. One possible reason is that the leavening process resulted in a kind of decay and death. Yahweh values life so much that Yahweh considered any death aside from the ritual animal sacrifices "unclean." If Yahweh called something "unclean," then that meant it was ritually dirty. Yahweh did not allow anything unclean in Yahweh's holy space. Grain offerings were unique because part of their purpose was to be a gift of tribute to honor Yahweh as king. Since death would contaminate Yahweh's space, a gift of tribute that had death as a part of its creation process would not be an appropriate gift to King Yahweh. Another possible reason was that people thought of leavening as alive, and the people could not burn anything that was alive on the altar.

A third possible reason is that the leavening process was chaotic in the way it "changed" the bread. Yahweh values order. When Yahweh created everything, Yahweh turned chaos into order, made everything stable, and assigned everything its roles and responsibilities. Since Yahweh values order, a gift of tribute that had a chaotic creation process would be an inappropriate gift to King Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about what you know about who Yahweh is and what Yahweh values. Why do you think that Yahweh did not allow people to add leavening, yeast, and honey to this kind of offering? Pause this audio here.

So leavening, yeast, and honey could not burn up on the altar as a gift with fire to Yahweh, but people could bring those foods to Yahweh as a separate gift. This separate gift would have been part of the gift of "firstfruits." People brought "firstfruits" at the beginning of the harvest season as a gift to thank Yahweh for providing a harvest. When people brought leavening, yeast, and honey, this provided more food for the priests without dishonoring Yahweh by burning up an offering of leavening, yeast, and honey on the altar.

Leviticus 2:1–16

The final rule the storyteller talks about in this section was that the person who presented the grain had to add salt to every offering of grain given to Yahweh as a gift or to honor Yahweh as king. This salt is the "salt of the covenant of your God." A covenant is a binding agreement or promise between two people or groups. In a covenant, these two people or groups promise to be loyal to each other. Yahweh and the people of Israel made a covenant, or a binding agreement, to be loyal to each other—Yahweh would take care of the people of Israel, and the people of Israel would rely on and worship Yahweh as their only God. Adding salt to this kind of offering was a way to remember that covenant and promise of loyalty.

For the people of Israel and the other people groups at this time, eating a meal together was a normal part of making a covenant with each other. Food with salt was a common part of this meal, and so sometimes people at this time talked about "eating salt" or "tasting salt" as a way to talk about the loyalty relationship that existed between the two people, or groups of people, who made a covenant with each other. For the people of Israel, to add salt to the grain offering would have been a constant reminder of the covenant and loyal relationship between the Israelites and Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When people in your culture make covenants, binding agreements, or promises of loyalty to each other, what do people do to show that those people have promised to be loyal to each other? Pause this audio here.

After talking about the rules and guidelines that applied to all of the grain offerings, Yahweh gave Moses the instructions for the third kind of grain offering. This third kind is specifically a gift or tribute of "firstfruits." The gift of "firstfruits" means the gift that people gave to Yahweh at the beginning of the harvest to thank Yahweh for taking care of the people by providing the harvest. For the people of Israel, this gift was grain that someone roasted over the fire and then crushed or rubbed out through a sieve. The result was a kind of coarse, roasted grain that was a normal, everyday food for the people of Israel. When giving it as a gift of firstfruits, the people were supposed to put oil on the grain and then add frankincense on top.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do people in your culture give thanks for a good harvest? Who do people thank? Pause this audio here.

The person would bring the grain to the priests at the Tent of Meeting. The priest would then take a portion of the roasted grain and oil, as well as all of the frankincense that was resting on top of the mixture, and burn all of this on the altar as incense. The priests burned this portion on the altar as the memorial portion. It was a gift with fire for Yahweh.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 2:1–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh gives instructions about what to do if someone is offering a gift of uncooked grains.

In the second scene: Yahweh gives instructions about what to do if someone is offering a gift of cooked grains.

In the third scene: Yahweh gives rules for all kinds of grain offerings that the people gave to honor Yahweh as king or to give Yahweh a gift.

In the fourth scene: Yahweh gives instructions about what someone should do when they offer a gift of the firstfruits at the beginning of the harvest.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron's descendants, who are the priests
- And the person who will one day bring an offering

Leviticus 2:1–16

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

A lot of this passage happens near or on the bronze altar. This bronze altar was in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting near the entrance of the tent. This was the altar where the priests burned all of the sacrifices.

Scene one focuses on how to offer Yahweh uncooked grain as a gift to honor Yahweh as king or ask Yahweh for a favor. Yahweh begins these instructions by stating that people have to use high-quality flour to make the grain offering.

Next, the person who offers the uncooked grain needs to pour olive oil on high-quality flour. Then, the person has to put frankincense on top of the oil and flour mixture. Finally, the person needs to bring the oil and flour mixture with the frankincense on top of it to the priests.

Then the priest needs to take a full handful of the oil and flour mixture, along with all of the frankincense, as a memorial portion. The priest needs to burn up this memorial portion on the bronze altar as incense and a gift with fire to smell good to Yahweh. The remainder of the flour and oil mixture that the priest did not burn became food for the priests, who were Aaron's descendants. This offering was very sacred.

Stop here and, as an activity, give instructions to someone about how to do a simple task that involves two people doing different things. How does the person who gives the instructions make it clear who does what? How does the person who gives the instructions make the order of instructions clear? Pause this audio here.

Scene two focuses on how people give Yahweh cooked grain as a gift to honor Yahweh as king or ask Yahweh for a favor. People made this grain into flour. There were three different ways to cook the flour.

The first way was to bake the offering in an oven. There were two kinds of bread that people baked in these ovens. One bread was a ring shape. The other bread was a flat, round bread. People needed to make both kinds of bread with the same high-quality flour as before. For the ring-shaped bread, the person needed to mix olive oil with the high-quality flour to make the bread. For the flat round bread, the person needed to anoint the bread. The word "anoint" could just mean that people smeared olive oil on top of the bread. However, Yahweh probably used this word to remind the people of Israel that people specially dedicated the grain offering to Yahweh. It was important that none of this bread had yeast or leaven in it.

The second way was to cook the offering on a griddle. Like before, people needed to make this offering with olive oil and the same high-quality flour. Like before, this offering could not have any leaven or yeast in it. In this way, the person would prepare the offering by first cooking the dough on a griddle. This made a hard, brittle cracker. Then, the person needed to break the cracker into pieces. Finally, the person needed to pour olive oil on top of the broken pieces.

The third way was to cook the offering in a pan. Once again, people needed to make this offering with olive oil and the same high-quality flour.

Once someone made the cooked kind of grain offering in one of these three ways, the person would bring the bread or cracker to the priest at the Tent of Meeting. After that, the priest first approached the bronze altar with the offering. Then, the priest would lift up part of the offering as a memorial portion. Finally, the priest would burn the memorial portion on the bronze altar as a kind of incense and gift with fire that would smell good to Yahweh.

Stop here and, as an activity, give instructions to someone about how to do a simple task that involves three different ways to do the same thing. How does the person who gives the instructions make it clear that there are three different ways to do the same thing? Pause this audio here.

The remainder of the flour and oil mixture that the priest did not burn became food for the priests, who were Aaron's descendants. This offering was very sacred, or very holy.

Scene three explains the general rules for all grain offerings that people gave to Yahweh to honor Yahweh as king or ask Yahweh for a favor. There are two main rules in this section. After Yahweh explains the first rule, Yahweh explains one situation that is a little different from the first rule. For the first rule, Yahweh says that people cannot ever include any kind of leaven, yeast, or any kind of honey with the grain offering. If the grain offering has leaven, yeast, or honey, people cannot burn it on the bronze altar as a kind of incense. The one situation that is a little different is at the beginning of the harvest. At that time, people could bring something

with leaven, yeast, or honey as a gift to Yahweh at the beginning of the harvest. However, people could not burn it on the altar. This means that people would give the offering to the priests as Yahweh's representatives, but the priests would not burn any memorial portion on the bronze altar. For the second rule, Yahweh said that people always had to add salt to the grain offering. The salt represented the covenant and binding agreement between Yahweh and Yahweh's people. And this rule did not only apply to the grain offering. Every kind of offering that anyone gave to Yahweh had to include salt.

Stop here and, as an activity, give instructions to someone about how to do a simple task that has some important rules about how to do it. How does the person emphasize how important the rules are? Pause this audio here.

Scene four focuses on how to offer Yahweh a gift of the first produce from the harvest. People often translate this first produce as the "firstfruits" of the harvest. This kind of offering is one kind of grain offering that people only offered at specific times during the year.

Stop here and, as an activity, give instructions to someone about how to do a task differently from how people normally do it. For example, give instructions for how to cook a meal for a special holiday instead of how to cook a meal on normal days. How does the person who gives the instructions make sure the listener knows that this is a special task that only happens at certain times? Pause this audio here.

People made the gift of firstfruits that Yahweh talked about in this section from grain that people roasted over the fire and then crushed or rubbed out through a sieve. The person then needed to put oil on the grain and then add frankincense on top of the mixture.

After the person finished preparing the gift, the person would bring the gift to the priests at the Tent of Meeting. Next, the priest would do his part. First, the priest would take a portion of the roasted grain and oil, as well as all of the frankincense that was resting on top of the mixture, as a memorial portion. Then the priest would burn the memorial portion on the altar as incense and a gift with fire for Yahweh.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 2:1–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron's descendants, who are the priests
- And the person who will one day bring an offering

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Leviticus 2:1–16

In scene one, Yahweh continues to tell Moses what to tell the people of Israel. This time, the focus is on uncooked grain. Yahweh says, "If someone wants to offer a gift to Yahweh or tribute to honor Yahweh as king, that person needs to make the gift with high-quality flour. The person will pour olive oil on the gift and then put frankincense on top. Then, that person will bring that gift to the priests. These priests are Aaron's descendants. The priest will take a full handful of the oil and flour mixture, along with all of the frankincense, and burn it all on the bronze altar as incense. This is a gift with fire that smells good to Yahweh." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the person who brings the offering, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want to thank Yahweh for what Yahweh has done for me; or
- I want to ask Yahweh for a favor; or
- I hope Yahweh likes this gift; or
- I am so glad Yahweh is our king.

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh says, "The rest of the gift of grain belongs to Aaron's descendants, the priests, to eat. This leftover oil and flour mixture is very holy compared to the other gifts with fire that people give to Yahweh." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that the person who offers the grain wants to honor Yahweh; or
- I hope Yahweh gives the person what the person asks for; or
- The bread and crackers look good to eat; or
- I am glad Yahweh allows me and the other priests to enjoy this gift with Yahweh.

Continue the drama. In scene two, Yahweh continues to tell Moses what to tell the people of Israel. This time, the focus is on cooked grain. Yahweh says, "If someone wants to offer a gift that the person baked in an oven, that person needs to make the bread with high-quality flour. This bread cannot have leaven or yeast. The person should mix the flour with olive oil. If the person bakes the dough as a flat round bread, the bread also cannot have leaven or yeast in it. The person should smear oil on this bread to dedicate it to Yahweh.

"And if someone wants to offer a gift that the person cooked on a griddle, the person needs to make the dough with high-quality flour. The person needs to mix the flour with olive oil. The dough must not have leaven or yeast in it. Once the person cooks the dough, that person needs to break the bread into pieces and pour oil on top of it. This is a gift to Yahweh or tribute to honor Yahweh as king.

"And if someone wants to offer a gift that the person cooked on a pan, the person needs to make the dough with high-quality flour and olive oil.

"Once that person has cooked the gift, that person will need to bring it to Yahweh at the Tent of Meeting and give it to the priest. Then, the priest will bring the gift to the bronze altar. The priest will lift up a portion of the grain offering as a memorial portion. Next, the priest will burn the memorial portion on the bronze altar as incense. This offering is a gift with fire that smells good to Yahweh." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that my people want to honor me as their king; or
- I am glad my people are coming to me to ask for help instead of going to other gods and goddesses.

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh says, "The rest of the gift of bread or crackers belongs to Aaron's descendants to eat. This leftover portion of the bread or crackers is very holy compared to the other gifts with fire that people give to Yahweh."

In scene three, Yahweh continues to tell Moses what to tell the people of Israel. This time, the focus is on general rules for all kinds of grain offerings that people give to honor Yahweh as king or to give Yahweh a gift. Yahweh says, "There cannot be any leaven or yeast or honey in the grain offerings that people give to honor Yahweh as king or to give Yahweh a gift. You cannot burn anything that you made with leaven, yeast, or honey on the altar. Honey, yeast, and leaven cannot be in any of the gifts with fire that you burn to smell good to Yahweh.

"Now, the offerings that people give at the beginning of the harvest can have leaven or yeast or honey, and people can give these gifts to Yahweh. But people cannot burn these gifts on the altar to smell good to Yahweh.

Leviticus 2:1–16

"Also, every grain offering that you bring to Yahweh to honor Yahweh as king or give Yahweh as a gift has to have salt in the offering. This salt represents the covenant between your God, Yahweh, and his people, and so you cannot offer a gift of grain to honor Yahweh as king or to ask Yahweh for a favor without including that salt. In fact, all of your offerings and sacrifices need to have salt." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the person who brings the offering, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want to be careful not to include leaven or yeast or honey when I bring Yahweh this gift; or
- I am so glad Yahweh gave us specific instructions so that I know what to do; or
- I am so glad Yahweh cares about our relationship enough to remember our covenant.

Continue the drama. In scene four, Yahweh continues to tell Moses what to tell the people of Israel. This time, the focus is on the specific kind of grain offering called the "firstfruits." Yahweh says, "If you offer a grain offering as the first produce from the harvest to honor Yahweh as king or to give Yahweh a gift, you need to give heads of grain that you have roasted on the fire and then beaten or crushed to separate the kernels.

"Then you will put olive oil on it and set some frankincense on top. This is a gift of grain to honor Yahweh as king or to give Yahweh a gift. Then, the priest will burn a memorial portion of the grain and oil mixture on the altar, along with all of the frankincense. The priest will burn it as incense, a gift with fire to Yahweh." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that my people want to honor me as their king; or
- I am glad that my people are trusting me to give them a good harvest; or
- This gift smells good. It reminds me of how special these people are to me.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 2:1–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this chapter, **Yahweh** gives Moses instructions about the grain offering. The word in the original language that people commonly translate as "grain offering" is actually a word that refers to gifts people gave to honor a king or to ask someone in a higher position for a favor. There were a few different reasons why someone might give Yahweh this kind of offering. Sometimes, a person might want to honor Yahweh as the king of their nation. Other times, a person might want to ask Yahweh for a favor or give Yahweh a gift to thank Yahweh for what Yahweh already did for that person. This kind of offering was also part of the daily morning and evening sacrifices that the people of Israel offered Yahweh to honor Yahweh. Use the same word for Yahweh that you used previously. For more information about Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **grain offering**. Look up grain offering in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

In these instructions, Yahweh says that this gift must be of high-quality flour. This specific kind of flour was probably semolina flour. However, the important part is that the flour was high-quality. It was appropriate to use this flour to make food to serve a king at a royal feast.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the fine or **high-quality flour**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The person offering the gift will pour oil on it. People made this particular kind of oil from pressed olives. If you do not have olive oil in your area, consider using a general term for oil or a different oil that people make from plants. If your language has more than one way to refer to oil, make sure to use the word that means oil from plants and not animals.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **oil**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 2:1–16

Next, the person offering the gift needs to put frankincense on top. Frankincense is a kind of tree sap that has hardened into resin. Frankincense was valuable and expensive. People burned frankincense because it smelled good.

Stop here and look at a picture of frankincense as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **frankincense**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Then, the person will bring their gift of grain to the **priests**. These priests are Aaron's descendants. Use the same term as you did in the first chapter of Leviticus. Look up priest in the Master Glossary for more information.

The priest will take a full handful of the oil and flour mixture, along with all of the frankincense, and burn it all on the bronze **altar** as incense. Use the same term that you did in the first chapter of Leviticus to refer to burning things on the altar as incense. For more information about the bronze altar, refer to altar in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for the bronze altar as you used in the previous passage.

People often translate the part of the grain offering that the priests burn on the altar as the memorial portion. In the original language, people connect this word to the idea of remembering. Some people think that the memorial portion was a physical way for people to remember the covenant between Yahweh and Yahweh's people. Other people think it was supposed to call Yahweh's attention to the reason the person was offering the gift, whether that was to honor, thank, or ask Yahweh for a favor, or for another reason.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **memorial portion**. For more information, refer to "memorial portion" in the Master Glossary. If you have already translated this idea in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

This is a gift with fire that smells good to Yahweh. Use the same phrase to describe a fire gift as you used in the first chapter. For more information on gift with fire, refer to **fire offering** in the Master Glossary.

The rest of the gift of grain will be for Aaron's descendants, the priests, to eat. This leftover oil and flour mixture is extra holy or more holy than the other gifts with fire that people gave to Yahweh. People often translate this phrase "extra sacred" as "most holy." The three sacrifices that Yahweh said were "most holy" were the sin or purification offering, the guilt offering, and the grain offering. If something or someone touches one of the "most holy" things, then that thing or person becomes holy and sacred themselves. However, if someone other than a priest touched something that was "most holy," that person would die. Yahweh only allowed the priests to touch what was "most holy."

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **most holy**. Look up **holy** in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh then explains the instructions for what to do if someone wanted to offer a gift that the person had baked in an oven.

Stop here and look at a picture of the ovens as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **oven**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

People needed to make bread that those people baked in an oven as a grain offering with the same high-quality flour and olive oil as before. There were two different kinds of bread that people baked this way. One bread was a ring shape. The other bread was a flat, round bread. Both kinds of bread would have been soft and high-quality.

Stop here and look at a picture of both kinds of bread as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for the ring-shaped **bread** and the flat, round bread. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

When offering the flat round bread, the person needed to anoint the bread with olive oil to specially dedicate it to Yahweh. To anoint something means to put oil on something to choose that thing for a specific purpose. People often anointed something or someone to dedicate that thing or person to Yahweh. Here, “anoint” could just mean that someone smeared the olive oil on top of the bread. However, Yahweh probably also used the word “anoint” to remind the people of Israel that the grain offering specially belonged to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **anoint**. Look up anoint in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

It was important that none of this bread had yeast or leaven in it. Yeast and leaven are two different ways to describe something that people add to dough to help the dough become fluffier after baking. When people mix yeast or leaven with a mixture of flour, water, and sugar, the yeast and leaven will eat the sugar. The leaven creates tiny pockets of air that become trapped in the dough. These pockets of air help the bread “rise” and become fluffier. Yahweh said that no one could burn anything on the altar that the person had made with yeast or leaven.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **yeast** or **leaven**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Now, if someone offered a gift that the person had cooked on a griddle, that person also needed to make the offering with high-quality flour and olive oil. This griddle was likely iron or clay and slightly curved in shape. People would put the griddle on the fire with the curved side facing up, and then put the dough on top of the curved side.

Stop here and look at a picture of a griddle as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **griddle**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, decide if it is appropriate to use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

This kind of offering also could not have leaven or yeast in it. After cooking the offering, the person offering the gift needed to break it into pieces and pour oil on top of it.

Now, if someone offered a gift that the person had cooked on a pan, that person needed to make the offering with high-quality flour and olive oil. This type of pan was probably similar to a frying pan or bowl that might have had a lid with it.

Stop here and look at a picture of a pan as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **pan**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, decide if it is appropriate to use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Once the person had baked the offering, the person needed to bring the offering to Yahweh at the Tent of Meeting and give the offering to the priest. Then, the priest brought the offering to the bronze altar. The priest lifted up a portion of the grain offering as a memorial portion and then burned the memorial portion on the bronze altar as **incense**. This offering was a **fire offering**, or a gift with fire that **smelled good** to Yahweh. Use the same phrases to describe burning something as incense, and something smelling good to Yahweh, as you used in the first chapter. Translate “fire offering” in the same way you did previously in this passage.

Yahweh gave the rest of the gift of bread or crackers to Aaron’s descendants to eat. This leftover portion of the bread or crackers was extra sacred compared to the other gifts with fire that people gave to Yahweh.

Before Yahweh gave instructions about the third kind of grain offering, Yahweh gave Moses general instructions and rules that applied to all three kinds of grain offerings.

The first rule was that people could not make any of the grain offerings with leaven, yeast, or honey. Honey is a kind of natural sugar that small insects called bees make. Bees probably made this kind of honey from the blossoms of fruit trees.

Stop here and look at a picture of honey as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **honey**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Nothing that the priests burned on the altar could have yeast, leaven, or honey in it. Also, none of the gifts with fire that the priests burned as incense to Yahweh could have yeast, leaven, or honey in it. However, the offerings that people gave to Yahweh at the beginning of the harvest could have leaven, yeast, or honey. But people could not burn these gifts on the altar to smell good to Yahweh.

We do not know if the word that people typically translate here as "offerings that people give at the beginning of the harvest" refers to the "firstfruits" that Yahweh talks about later. This word could either refer to the first produce from the harvest or to food that people made from the first produce of the harvest. Discuss with your team whether you want to translate it the same or differently.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**offerings that people give at the beginning of the harvest**." For more information about **firstfruits**, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

The second rule was that people had to add salt to every grain offering that people gave to Yahweh. Salt is a kind of seasoning that people used to preserve food and help prevent the food from rotting. People also added salt to every offering and sacrifice of either grain or animals that people gave to Yahweh.

Stop here and look at a picture of salt as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **salt**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh calls this salt the "salt of the covenant of your God." A covenant is a binding agreement or promise between two people or groups. In a covenant, these two people or groups promise to be loyal to each other. These two promise to be at peace with each other and to help each other. If one person is in danger, the other person promises to help the other person.

Yahweh and the people of Israel made a covenant, or a binding agreement, to be loyal to each other, too. In this covenant, the people of Israel promised that Yahweh would be their only God. The people of Israel promised to only worship and serve Yahweh and to do whatever Yahweh said. Yahweh promised to protect and take care of the people of Israel. Yahweh promised that the Israelites would be special to Yahweh and that Yahweh would provide for and live with the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **covenant**. Look up covenant in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, decide if it is appropriate to use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

In the final section, Yahweh gives Moses instructions for a specific kind of grain offering, which is the "firstfruits." The word in the original language refers to the "first" "fruits" of anything. For example, in this culture, a woman's oldest son is the first fruit of the woman's womb. The first animal born to a mother animal is the first fruit of that animal's womb. The initial harvest of grain from a grain field was the first fruit from the land. The initial harvest of fruit was the first fruit of the vine or trees. All of these different kinds of "first" "fruits" are related in the original language. In this section, the specific kind of firstfruits that Yahweh is talking about is the initial harvest of grain, fruit, and other plant crops.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **firstfruits**. Again, look up firstfruits in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, decide if it is appropriate to use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

If someone wanted to offer firstfruits to Yahweh as a grain offering to give Yahweh a gift or to honor Yahweh as king, that person needed to roast heads of grain over a fire and then beat or crush the roasted grain.

Stop here and look at a picture of roasted grain as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **roasted grain**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, decide if it is appropriate to use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Next, the person needed to put olive oil on top of the roasted grain and then set some frankincense on top of the mixture. This was a gift of grain to honor Yahweh as king or to give Yahweh a gift. Then, the priest would burn a memorial portion of the grain and oil mixture on the bronze altar, along with all of the frankincense, as incense, a fire offering, or gift with fire, to Yahweh.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 2:1–16

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (598 KB)
- Setting the Stage (8.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (10.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (911 KB)

Leviticus 3:1–17

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 3:1–17 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 3:1–17 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.

2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 3:1–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Before this passage, Yahweh gave laws about how to offer burnt offerings and grain offerings. Now, Yahweh gives laws about how to offer a peace or fellowship offering. Later, Yahweh will explain that the people do not need to make these fellowship offerings at a specific time each day or when people sin. Instead, a fellowship offering was an offering that people offered to make their relationship with Yahweh stronger or better. People also offered a fellowship offering to have fellowship with Yahweh and with the people in their community.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you make your relationship with God or other people better? How do you talk about things that help relationships get better? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh gives instructions about how to offer three different animals as fellowship offerings. The fellowship offering was a sacrifice where the priest only burned part of the animal on the altar. The person needed to kill the animal in a specific way, and then the priest would burn specific parts of the animal as a sacrifice to Yahweh. Yahweh also forbids the Israelites from eating fat or blood.

In the first section, Yahweh gives instructions for how to offer something from the herd as a fellowship offering. A herd was a group of cattle. A herd included male and female cows.

Stop here and look at a picture of a cow as a group. Pause this audio here.

Here, Yahweh says that the sacrifice could be one of the male or female cattle. Yahweh also says that the animal needs to be physically perfect. You will remember that a perfect animal had no physical defects. The animal must not be blind or deformed or have any bruises or injuries. This animal must not have any kind of skin disease or be missing any body part. The animal had to be physically perfect. The person who offers the sacrifice needs to bring the animal to Yahweh. You will remember that Yahweh told the Israelites that Yahweh's presence is at the Tent of Meeting, or the tabernacle. The person who is offering the sacrifice needs to put their hand on the head of the animal. Then the person needs to kill the animal in front of the Tent of Meeting. The person would kill the animal the same way a person kills a bull for the burnt offering in Leviticus 1. Then the priests need to throw the blood on the altar. The priests would not touch the altar, but just throw the blood onto the sides of the altar. Yahweh also calls the priests "Aaron's sons," because Yahweh told the Israelites that the priests would be the men who descended from Aaron. Then the priest needs to put specific parts of the animal on the altar. Yahweh says the priest needs to put those parts of the burnt offering on the altar. Every morning, the priests put a burnt offering on the altar, so the fellowship offering would go on top of it. On the altar, the priest should put the fat from around the internal organs, or the stomach and intestines; the kidneys and the fat that is around them; and the fatty part of the liver.

Stop here and look at pictures of a cow's kidney and liver as a group. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about who deals with animals' organs in your culture. What do people do with the animals' organs? Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are the best parts of an animal to eat in your culture? Do people in your culture eat kidneys or liver? How does your culture divide the parts of the liver? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh tells Moses that the burned pieces of the animal will be a special gift that smells good to Yahweh and honors Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss a time when you smelled something that made you happy. Why did that smell make you happy? Why do you think this smell made Yahweh happy? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh gives instructions for how to offer something from the flock as a fellowship offering. A flock was a group of sheep or goats that included male and female sheep or goats. Here, Yahweh says that the sacrifice could be a male or female. First, Yahweh gives the instructions for offering sheep.

Stop here and look at a picture of a sheep as a group. Pause this audio here.

You will notice that the laws for animals from the herd and the laws for animals from the flock are similar, but there are some small differences. Yahweh says that the sheep needs to be physically perfect. The person who offers the sacrifice needs to put their hand on the head of the sheep. Then the person needs to kill the sheep in front of the Tent of Meeting. The person would kill the sheep the same way a person kills a sheep for the burnt offering in Leviticus 1. Then Aaron's sons, the priests, need to put some of the blood on the altar the same way people do when the fellowship offering is a cow. Then the priest needs to put specific parts of the sheep on the altar. Yahweh says the priest needs to put the sheep on top of the burnt offering on the altar. When the fellowship offering is a sheep, the parts of the fellowship offering that go on the altar are slightly different. First, the sheep's tail goes on the altar. Yahweh says that the person needs to cut the tail off the sheep right where the tail touches the sheep's spine.

Stop here and look at a picture of a sheep's tail as a group. Pause this audio here.

The priests also need to burn all the fat around the sheep's stomach and intestines; the kidneys and the fat that is around them; and a specific lobe, or part, of the liver.

Stop here and look at pictures of a sheep's kidney and liver as a group. Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh tells Moses that the burned pieces of the sheep will be a special gift of food to Yahweh. Though people give this food to Yahweh, this is not food for Yahweh to eat. Yahweh does not say the parts of the bull that people burn as part of the fellowship offering will be food. But the bull is probably also the same kind of food offering for Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: Is there any way people in your culture give food to gods or spirits? How do people do this? Why do people give food to gods or spirits? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh tells Moses how to offer a goat, another animal from the herd, as a fellowship offering.

Stop here and look at a picture of a goat as a group. Pause this audio here.

You will notice that the rules for offering sheep and the laws for offering goats are similar. Yahweh says that the goat needs to be physically perfect. The person who offers the sacrifice needs to put their hand on the head of the sheep. Then the person needs to kill the goat in front of the Tent of Meeting. The person would kill this goat the same way a person kills a goat for the burnt offering in Leviticus 1. Then Aaron's sons, the priests, need to put some of the blood on the altar the same way the priests do when the fellowship offering is a cow. Then the priest needs to put specific parts of the animal on the altar. Yahweh says the priest needs to put the pieces on top of the burnt offering on the altar. When someone offers a goat as a fellowship offering, the parts that go on the altar are the same as when someone offers a cow as a fellowship offering. The priests need to burn all the fat around the stomach and intestines, the kidneys and the fat that is around them, and a specific lobe, or part, of the liver.

Stop here and look at pictures of a goat's kidney and liver as a group. Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh tells Moses that the burned pieces of the goat will be a special gift that smells good to Yahweh.

Finally, Yahweh tells Moses that all fat from animals belongs to Yahweh. Yahweh tells Moses a statute that the Israelites need to follow forever, no matter where the Israelites live. The law is that the Israelites cannot eat animal blood or fat. Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to eat the animal fat because the fat belongs to Yahweh. Yahweh does not explain why the Israelites must not eat blood here, but in Genesis, Yahweh explains that the blood of an animal is its life, and that is why the Israelites must not eat blood.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Are there any parts of an animal that no one in your culture may eat? Why must people not eat it? Why do you think that Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to eat blood or fat?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 3:1–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh gives specific instructions about how to offer cattle as a peace or fellowship offering.

In the second scene: Yahweh gives specific instructions about how to offer a sheep as a fellowship offering.

In the third scene: Yahweh gives specific instructions about how to offer a goat as a fellowship offering.

In the fourth scene: Yahweh tells Moses that Yahweh will never allow the Israelites to eat fat or blood.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- A person who offers a fellowship offering
- The priests
- And the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this passage, remember that Yahweh is still giving Moses instructions for how the Israelites are supposed to live now that the Israelites have a covenant with Yahweh. In the first part of the book of Leviticus, Yahweh gives Moses the laws the Israelites need to follow when someone offers a sacrifice to Yahweh. Remember, before this passage, Yahweh explained the laws for how to offer a burnt offering and a grain offering.

It was common in Moses' time that people who gave laws, such as kings and other leaders, would repeat a lot of information and instructions as the leader explained the ritual laws. This made these laws easier to remember and showed how the laws were important. Also, remember that the structure of these laws is, "If this is what you are doing, then this is how you need to do it." Yahweh expected people to make these offerings a lot, so you can also say, "When you do this, this is how you need to do it."

In the first scene, remember that when a person offers a bull or cow from the herd, there are several actions that the person needs to do. The animal needs to be "spotless," or physically perfect. The person needs to bring the animal to Yahweh. This means that the person needs to bring the animal to the front of the Tent of Meeting because God's presence is in the Tent of Meeting.

Stop here and look at a diagram of the layout of the tabernacle, or Tent of Meeting, again. Pause this audio here.

The person puts their hand on the animal's head, and then the person kills the animal. Then the priests take the blood and throw the blood on the sides of the altar. This is the same action that Yahweh described in earlier passages.

The person cuts the animal open and removes the fat around its stomach and intestines. The person also removes the kidneys and the fat around them, and removes a certain lobe, or part, of the liver. The priest burns all those pieces on the altar, and Yahweh enjoys the smell.

In the second and third scenes, Yahweh gives the laws for how to offer an animal from a flock as a fellowship offering. In the second scene, Yahweh specifically explains the laws for offering a sheep as a fellowship offering. These are the same laws for offering a cow as a fellowship offering, except that the person needs to cut off the tail of the sheep where it connects to the spine, and the priest burns that on the altar too.

Stop here and look at pictures of a sheep again as a group if needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and answer this question as a group: How will you explain the rules for sheep? Is there a way in your language to repeat information naturally? What is the best way to communicate these laws together? Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: When you repeat information in a story, do you ever repeat the same information slightly differently? Are there ever differences in the repeated information that do not mean there is new information? Why are there differences that do not mean there is new information? Why do you think there are differences here if they do not mean there is different information? Pause this audio here.

The sheep needs to be physically perfect. The person who is offering the sheep as a fellowship offering needs to be in front of the tabernacle, which is the Tent of Meeting. The person puts their hand on the sheep's head, and that person kills the sheep. Then the priests take the blood and throw the blood on the side of the altar. The person cuts the sheep open and removes the fat around its stomach and intestines. The person also removes the kidneys and the fat around the kidneys, and the person removes only the best part of the liver. The person also cuts off the tail at the point it connects to the spine. The priest burns all those pieces on the altar as a food offering to Yahweh.

In the third scene, Yahweh gives the laws for how to offer a goat as a fellowship offering.

Stop here and look at pictures of a goat again as a group, if needed. Pause this audio here.

These are the same laws for offering a cow as a fellowship offering. The goat needs to be physically perfect. The person who is offering the goat as a fellowship offering needs to be in front of the Tent of Meeting. The person puts their hand on the goat's head, and the person kills the goat. Then the priest takes the blood and throws the blood on the side of the altar. The person cuts the goat open and removes the fat around the stomach and intestines. The person also removes the kidneys and the fat around them, and removes only the best part of the liver. The priest burns all those pieces on the altar as a food offering to Yahweh, and Yahweh enjoys the smell.

In the fourth scene, Yahweh tells Moses that all fat belongs to Yahweh. Yahweh tells Moses that it will be a statute for the Israelites forever that the Israelites cannot eat fat or blood, no matter where the Israelites are. A statute is a rule that usually explains how to do something that involves the tabernacle or temple. A statute may also refer to a special requirement for living in a specific society.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 3:1–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- A person who offers a fellowship offering
- The priests
- And the Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Yahweh tells Moses the laws for how to offer different animals as a fellowship offering. Yahweh tells Moses that if someone offers an animal from the herd, it can be a bull or a cow, but the animal must be perfect. The person puts their hand on the animal's head, and then that person cuts the animal's throat with a knife to kill the animal. Then the priests throw some of the blood onto the sides of the altar. Then the person cuts the animal open and removes the fat around the internal organs, the kidneys and the fat around them, and the best part of the liver. The priest burns those parts on the altar, and Yahweh likes the smell. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the person who offers a fellowship offering, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so happy that Yahweh allows me to give Yahweh this offering. I really want to know Yahweh better; or
- I really love Yahweh, and I am glad I got to show Yahweh appreciation with this cow; or
- I think this cow was really expensive.

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh tells Moses that if someone offers an animal from the flock, it can be a male or female, but it must be perfect. If someone offers a sheep, the person puts their hand on the sheep's head while that person is in front of the Tent of Meeting. Then the person cuts the sheep's throat with a knife to kill the sheep. Then the priests throw some of the blood onto the sides of the altar. Then the person cuts off the tail at the spine, cuts the sheep open, and removes the fat around the internal organs, the kidneys and the fat around them, and the best part of the liver. The priest burns those parts on the altar as a gift of food to Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy with the person who made this offering; or
- I really like the smell of this sheep; it makes me happy; or
- It is good that this person wants to have a closer relationship with me and that the priest is helping that person do it.

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh tells Moses that if someone offers a goat, the person puts their hand on the goat's head while the person is in front of the tabernacle. Then the person cuts the goat's throat with a knife to kill the goat. Then the priests throw some of the blood onto the side of the altar. Then the person cuts the sheep open and removes the fat around the internal organs, the kidneys and the fat around them, and the best part of the liver. The priest burns those parts on the altar as a gift of food to Yahweh, and Yahweh likes the smell. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad I get to help this person have a better relationship with Yahweh; or
- All this blood from killing the animal is disgusting; or
- I am very used to this because this is my job.

Continue the drama. Yahweh tells Moses that all fat belongs to Yahweh. Yahweh also tells Moses that Yahweh will never allow the Israelites to eat blood or fat, no matter where the Israelites are.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 3:1–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh gives instructions for when a person offers a bull or a cow as a peace or fellowship offering. A fellowship offering is a sacrifice someone makes to have a better relationship, or "fellowship," with Yahweh and the person's community. A person makes a sacrifice when they give a gift to God. The person will eat part of the sacrifice with other people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **sacrifice** and **peace or fellowship offering**. Look up sacrifice and peace or fellowship offering in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The animal must be **perfect** or **spotless**. The person takes the animal to **Yahweh**. Yahweh's presence is in the **Tent of Meeting**, so the person takes the animal to the front of the Tent of Meeting and puts their hand on the animal's head. Use the same words or phrases for perfect, Yahweh, and Tent of Meeting as you have used in previous passages. Look up perfect, Yahweh, and tabernacle in the Master Glossary for more information.

Then that person kills the animal. The **priest** will **throw the blood** onto the sides of the **altar**. Use the same words or phrases for throwing the blood on the sides of the altar as previously. Use the same words for altar and priest that you used in previous passages. For more information on altar and priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

Then the person will cut out certain parts of the animal's organs. The first is the fat on the internal organs, which may be the animal's stomach and intestines. Then the person removes the **lobe of the liver**. This is the best part of the animal's liver, and you may simply say "the best part of the liver" in your translation. These, along with the two **kidneys**, would be good portions of the animal. If you have already translated the book of Exodus, use the same words or phrases for kidneys and lobe of the liver as you used in Exodus 29:13. Use the same words or phrases for kidneys and lobe of the liver throughout the book of Leviticus.

This is a **gift with fire** that smells good to Yahweh. Use the same phrase to describe this fire offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on fire offering, refer to **fire offering** in the Master Glossary.

The smell will be a sweet smell or **pleasing aroma** to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for pleasing aroma as you used in previous passages.

There are also the rules for if someone wants to offer a **sheep**, and Yahweh also requires the priest to burn the sheep's tail. There are rules for if someone wants to offer a **goat**. Use the same words for sheep and goat that you have used in previous passages.

Then Yahweh tells Moses that all the fat is Yahweh's. That means that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to eat the fat in animals because the fat belongs to Yahweh. Yahweh also tells Moses this is a statute forever. No Israelite can eat fat or blood no matter where the Israelites are. A statute is a rule that focused specifically on the religious rules about how to celebrate festivals, perform religious rituals, and offer sacrifices of animals and grain. Yahweh also used this word to talk about the rules for what the priests needed to do.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **statute**. Look up statute in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

This statute will last through all the generations of the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **generations**. Look up generations in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 3:1–17

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (576 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (904 KB)

Leviticus 4:1–12

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 4:1–12 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 4:1–12 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 4:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

At the end of the book of Exodus, the storyteller told us that the Israelite people finished building the Tent of Meeting. At the beginning of the book of Leviticus, Yahweh meets with Moses in the Tent of Meeting to tell Moses the laws and instructions for the people of Israel. Yahweh wants to teach the Israelites how to live and how to be close to Yahweh. Yahweh's rules also show the Israelites what is important to Yahweh. So far in Leviticus, Yahweh gave laws and instructions on whole burnt offerings, grain offerings, and peace or fellowship offerings. Yahweh's instructions for the Israelites often teach the people how to be ritually clean and how not to get ritually dirty. Israelites need to be "clean" ritually and spiritually to worship Yahweh.

In Leviticus 4, Yahweh gives Moses instructions about sin or purification offerings. If an Israelite person was ritually dirty, that person needed to give a sin offering to become ritually clean again. Yahweh says that this offering is for Israelites who sinned accidentally, through a mistake or error. This mistake could happen in two different ways. An Israelite person might become ritually dirty because they touched or ate something that they did not know was ritually dirty. For example, Yahweh told the Israelite people what kinds of animal meat the people should eat. An Israelite person might become ritually dirty if they ate some cooked food, and later found out that the meat in the food was forbidden or ritually dirty. In other circumstances, an Israelite person might accidentally touch something that was ritually dirty. Then the Israelite person would become dirty too. For

example, an Israelite man would know that he should not touch a dead body. But if a person died unexpectedly next to the Israelite man, the man might accidentally touch the dead body. In this case, the Israelite man did not want to become ritually dirty, but the man still became ritually dirty.

If an Israelite person did not know that what he did was wrong when he did it, then that person could give a sin or purification offering to become clean again. If an Israelite person knew inside himself, in his thoughts, that he was doing something wrong, then that person needed to give a guilt offering. A guilt offering was a bigger offering than a sin offering. We will hear about the guilt offering later. In this passage, Yahweh gave the Israelite people instructions for the sin or purification offering so that the people could become ritually clean, or pure, again. Because of this, we will call this offering the sin or purification offering.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Describe a time in your life when you only had good intentions, but you accidentally did something wrong anyway. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh has told Moses in the first chapters of Leviticus that some offerings are mandatory, which means the Israelite people must give these offerings. Yahweh also gave instructions about other offerings, such as the fellowship or peace offerings. An Israelite person could choose when they wanted to give a fellowship or peace offering. However, Yahweh commanded that the Israelite people must give the sin or purification offering. Yahweh commanded that the Israelite people give the sin or purification offering every time they became ritually dirty. To give a sin offering was the only way for an Israelite person to become ritually clean again.

Yahweh gives instructions on how a high priest should offer a sin or purification offering if he unintentionally sins. The high priest must give a young male bull for his offering. This is a big offering! In the next passage, we find that this offering is the same as the offering for the whole group of Israelites if they all sinned together. The offering for the high priest was the same as the one for the people of Israel because the high priest was a representative of the people to Yahweh. The young male bull was physically mature and old enough to reproduce, but still young. The high priest had to bring the young male bull to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting, which was on the east side.

Stop here and look at a picture of the Tent of Meeting as a group. Discuss a process in your own culture where people have to follow special instructions in a specific order. Pause this audio here.

When the high priest needed to offer a sacrifice, the high priest had to bring the young male bull to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. There, the high priest would lay his hands on the head of the young male bull. We are not sure exactly why Yahweh commanded this, but it probably connected the high priest to the offering in a special way. The high priest would kill the young male bull and collect its blood. The high priest would take some of the blood in a bowl or pot and carry it into the Tent of Meeting.

Stop here and look at a picture of the Tent of Meeting as a group. Find the curtain of the sanctuary and the altar of fragrant incense. Pause this audio here.

The curtain of the sanctuary was a thick curtain. Yahweh commanded certain Israelite people to make the curtain of the sanctuary out of special woven threads. This curtain separated the area where the priests worked in the Tent of Meeting from the Holy of Holies, where Yahweh's presence lived on top of the ark of the covenant. The high priest would take the blood to the curtain of the sanctuary. The high priest would dip his finger into the blood and sprinkle or throw the blood in front of the curtain of the sanctuary seven times. The high priest would also smear the blood on the altar of incense. When a priest sprinkled the blood during a sin or purification offering, the blood symbolized that the dirty person was now clean and able to worship Yahweh again. Yahweh wanted the people of Israel to understand that sin makes humans ritually dirty and unable to worship Yahweh, even when people sin accidentally. But Yahweh gave the Israelite people the instructions for the sin offering so that they could become clean again and again. But Yahweh also wanted the Israelite people to know that in order to be ritually clean, they needed the blood of a sacrifice.

After putting the blood on the altar of fragrant incense, the high priest would go back outside. The high priest would pour out the rest of the bull's blood at the bottom of the bronze altar of burnt offering. Next, the high priest had to take certain body parts from the dead body of the young male bull. The high priest had to remove these body parts from the bull's dead body: the fat that covers the internal organs; the two kidneys, and the fat on the kidneys; the best part of the liver that is attached to the kidneys.

Stop here and look at pictures of the fat and the organs of the bull, the kidneys of the bull, and the liver of the bull as a group. Pause this audio here.

The high priest took all these parts of the bull's dead body and burned them on the altar of burnt offering. Then there is another list of all the rest of the bull's body that the high priest had to carry away: the hide or skin of the bull, the flesh or meat parts of the bull, the head of the bull, the legs of the bull, the internal organs of the bull, and the dung of the bull.

The high priest took all these parts of the bull's dead body that were not part of the offering on the altar and carried them away. The high priest took the bull's dead body to a ritually clean place where the priests would dump the ashes from sacrifices. There, the priest burned the bull's dead body on a wood fire. This place was outside the camp, away from the Tent of Meeting and the places where the Israelite people lived.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 4:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh is talking to Moses in the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh gives more instructions to Moses about how the Israelites should live. Yahweh tells Moses to tell the Israelites what Yahweh says. Yahweh tells Moses that an Israelite person who accidentally sins or becomes ritually dirty must offer a sin or purification offering.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a high priest accidentally sins. The high priest must lay his hands on a young bull. Then the high priest must kill the young bull and sprinkle the bull's blood in a special way. The high priest also must take certain pieces of the animal's dead body and burn them with fire on the altar.

In the third scene: The high priest must carry the rest of the dead bull's body to a clean place outside the camp and burn the body.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- And the Israelite high priest

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

When the Israelite high priest offers a purification offering, the high priest will do different actions at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting, the altar of burnt offering, the Tent of Meeting, the curtain of the sanctuary, and the altar of fragrant incense.

Stop here and look at a map of the Tent of Meeting. Trace the path that the high priest would walk while doing the offering. Point to the locations in this order: the entrance of the Tent of Meeting, the altar of the burnt offering, the Tent of Meeting, the curtain of the sanctuary, the altar of fragrant incense, and again the altar of the burnt offering. Describe how the priest walks from the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting inside to the Tent of Meeting and then walks back outside again. Pause the audio here.

In scene one, Yahweh speaks to Moses in the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh is still telling Moses the rules, laws, and instructions that the Israelites need to obey. This is the second time the storyteller uses this special phrase: "And Yahweh spoke to Moses and said, 'Speak to the sons of Israel and say….'" When a listener hears this phrase, the listener knows that everything that follows is what Yahweh told Moses and also what Moses told the Israelite people. The narrator uses this phrase over and over in Leviticus, so it may be helpful to have a special phrase in your language that introduces these instructions.

Stop here and, as an activity, have one person in the group tell another person in the group something important. After that, the second person should tell a new person the same words. What words would you use to re-tell someone else's words? Pause the audio here.

Yahweh gives Moses instructions about how to give purification offerings. Remember, an Israelite person gave a purification offering when that person accidentally became ritually dirty. Try to translate the term "purification offering" in a way so that listeners will understand that this offering was for accidental sin, error, or when a person became ritually dirty. You may want to use a phrase like "purity offering," or "cleaning offering," or another phrase that means that these offerings made people spiritually clean again.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate "purification offering" in your language? Pause the audio here.

In scene two, Yahweh talks about the anointed priest. The high priest was the leading priest whom Yahweh specially anointed for the role, so sometimes the narrator calls the high priest the anointed priest. Yahweh explains what a high priest should do if the high priest accidentally disobeys one of Yahweh's rules, makes a mistake, or accidentally becomes ritually "dirty." Yahweh explains what the high priest must do to become ritually clean. The high priest needed to do this every time that the high priest accidentally sinned or became ritually "dirty."

Stop here and discuss: Think of a ritual, ceremony, or process that people in your culture do in a special way and in a certain order. Talk about those actions as if you were explaining them to someone who has never seen the ceremony before. Pause the audio here.

First, the high priest must select a young bull that is perfect, healthy, and strong. The high priest must lead this young male bull through the entrance of the courtyard to the altar of the burnt offering. When a person presents their offering in the place of worship, that person comes close, or comes near to, the place of worship. The person who offered the animal had to come close to Yahweh to offer the sacrifice. Yahweh's law said that the right place to give Yahweh an offering was at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting.

Stop and find the entrance of the Tent of Meeting and the altar of the burnt offering on the map. Pause the audio here.

There, the high priest must lay his hand on the head of the young male bull and kill it. The high priest also must then collect the blood from the dead animal's body in some sort of bowl or pot.

The high priest must carry the bowl with some of the blood into the Tent of Meeting. In the Tent of Meeting, the high priest will then walk to the curtain of the sanctuary.

Stop and find the Tent of Meeting, the curtain of the sanctuary, and the altar of fragrant incense on the map. Pause the audio here.

There, the high priest must dip his finger in the blood and splash or sprinkle the blood seven times in front of the curtain of the sanctuary. The high priest must also put some of the blood onto the horns of the altar of fragrant incense. Then the high priest should go back outside to the altar of the burnt offering.

Stop here and find the altar of the burnt offering on the map again. Pause audio here.

The high priest must pour out the rest of the young bull's blood at the bottom of the altar of the burnt offering. Then the high priest has to remove certain parts of the animal carcass. The high priest must remove all of the fat that covers and surrounds the internal organs of the bull, the two kidneys and the fat on them near the back part of the animal, and the best part of the liver.

The high priest must take all of these special pieces of the bull's dead body and burn them with fire on the altar of the burnt offering.

In scene three, the high priest should take the rest of the dead bull's body, including the bull's skin, the flesh, head, legs, the rest of the bull's internal organs, and the bull's dung. The high priest must carry all of the remaining dead body parts outside the camp to a special place that was ritually clean. There, the high priest must burn the dead body on a wood fire.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 4:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- And the Israelite high priest

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language. Act out the high priest's actions as if he was following Yahweh's instructions.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In scene one, Yahweh tells Moses to do offerings when someone sins accidentally. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy and relieved that Yahweh made a plan for when we become unclean or ritually dirty; or
- I realize that even when humans try to do good, we still make mistakes that make Yahweh unhappy.

Continue the drama. In scene two, Yahweh gives special instructions about what a high priest must do if the high priest accidentally sins. The high priest must take a young bull and lay his hand on the head of the young bull. The high priest must kill the young bull. Then the high priest must gather the blood into a special bowl and take the blood into the Tent of Meeting. Inside, the high priest must dip his finger in the blood and splash it seven times in front of the curtain of the sanctuary. The high priest also must put some blood on the horns of the altar of fragrant incense. Then the high priest must go outside and pour out the rest of the blood at the bottom of the altar of the burnt offering. Then the high priest has to cut out certain special parts of the insides of the bull carcass and burn them on the altar of the burnt offering. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the high priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel embarrassed to have to admit in front of everyone that I did something wrong; or
- I am the spiritual leader of my people. If I make a mistake, it impacts all my people, too. That is a big responsibility!

Continue the drama. In scene three, the high priest has to carry the rest of the bull's dead body through the camp to an area outside the camp. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing one of the people of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking when you see the high priest carrying the bull's dead body out of the camp?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel bad when I see the dead animal. When people sin, things have to die, like these animals! or
- I am glad my spiritual leader is clean again; or
- It is very serious when a person sins! or
- Every sin, even accidental sin, makes us ritually dirty and keeps us from Yahweh.

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Continue the drama. The high priest must take the bull's body to a ceremonially clean place and burn it on a wood fire.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 4:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh speaks to Moses. Use the same word for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh commands Moses to repeat these instructions to the **people of Israel**. Use the same word or phrase for people of Israel, or Israelite people, as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israelite, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh's laws tell a difference between when a person chooses to sin against Yahweh and when a person sins against Yahweh and does not know that they sinned. The offering in this passage was for a high priest who did an accidental sin. The high priest still sinned, but it was a lesser kind of sin since the high priest did not know that he had sinned and became ritually "dirty."

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **accidental sin**. Look up **sin** in the Master Glossary for more information. Discuss how you might show the difference in your language between when a person purposefully sins and accidentally sins. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh gives some of his special rules for the Israelite people to follow. These are Yahweh's commandments.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **commandment**. Look up commandment in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

This passage talks specifically about what the high priest should do if he accidentally sins. The storyteller calls the high priest the "anointed priest," because this is the priest that Yahweh anoints, or chooses, to be the leader of all the priests and to make special sacrifices for the Israelite people. You may also simply call this priest the "high priest."

Stop here and discuss as a group: What word or phrase will you use for **anointed priest** or **high priest**? For more information on anoint, priest, and high priest, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

When the anointed priest or high priest sins, the high priest brings guilt on the people. Remember that when someone sins against Yahweh or disobeys Yahweh, that person becomes guilty. In other words, that person is no longer in a right relationship with Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **guilt**. See the Master Glossary for more information about guilt. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The high priest must offer a young **bull**. This word refers to a male animal that is physically mature and able to reproduce. Use the same word for bull as you used in previous passages.

The high priest offers the bull as a sin or purification offering. This offering makes someone pure after they have become ritually dirty or unfit for service to God. In previous passages, you have words like "burnt offering" and "fellowship or peace offering." Remember that this is the "accidental sin offering," so you might want to use your word for "accidental sin" in this passage rather than your regular word for "sin." Or you may want to use a phrase like purification offering or purity offering that reminds listeners that the Israelite people made this offering to become ritually clean.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **sin or purification offering**. Look up "sin or purification offering" in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The high priest presents his offering at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. Use the same word or phrase to describe the person coming close to the Tent of Meeting as you have used in previous passages.

The high priest takes the blood into the **Tent of Meeting** to the Holy Place or the sanctuary. Yahweh only allowed priests to go inside the Tent of Meeting. Use the same word or phrase for the Tent of Meeting as you used in previous passages. For more information on the Tent of Meeting, refer to "tabernacle" in the Master Glossary.

The high priest uses a bowl or pot, a special **container**, to carry the blood into the Tent of Meeting. The narrator does not mention this bowl in the passage, so we do not know what kind of bowl this is. But you can include this bowl if it is helpful in your language to describe how the high priest carried the blood.

Stop here and look at a picture of a bowl as a group. Pause this audio here.

The high priest has to put his finger into the blood so the high priest can **sprinkle** or **throw** the blood of the sacrifice in certain places. The high priest carefully uses his fingers to make the blood fall on certain places.

Stop here and get a bowl of water. Have someone put their finger or hand in the water and then hold their wet finger over an object so the water falls from their finger onto the object. Talk about what words you would use to explain the actions of when the priest dips or puts his finger in the blood, and when the high priest sprinkles the blood. You may use the same word you used in Leviticus 1 for throwing the blood. Pause the audio here.

The high priest sprinkles the blood in front of the curtain of the sanctuary. The word sanctuary means a holy place. The curtain of the sanctuary was a thick piece of woven fabric that hung in the Tent of the Meeting, between the Holy Place and the Holy of Holies, where Yahweh's covenant ark was. The curtain protected the priests from Yahweh's power and glory.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **curtain of the sanctuary**. See the Master Glossary for more information about **sanctuary**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The high priest smears some blood on the horns of the **altar** of fragrant or sweet incense. The high priest would pour the rest of the blood at the base of the altar of burnt offerings. Use the same phrase for the altar of burnt offerings as you used in previous passages. For more information on altar and burnt offerings, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **horns of the altar of fragrant incense**. You may look at the picture of the altar of fragrant incense again. This altar is in the first room of the tabernacle. This altar is the place where the priests burn incense for Yahweh. Pause this audio here.

The high priest removes the **fat** from the **internal organs**, the **kidney** and its fat, and the best part of the **liver**. Use the same words and phrases for these parts of the bull as you have used in previous passages. The high priest removes this fat just like he does from the **sacrifice** of the **peace or fellowship offering**. Use the same words or phrases for sacrifice and peace or fellowship offering as you have used previously, and refer to the Master Glossary for more information about these words.

The high priest burns parts of the bull's body, then takes the rest of the bull's body to the place "where people throw the ashes out." Earlier, in Leviticus 1, Yahweh talks about a place "where the fat ashes go" beside the altar. These two places are not the same. The place in Leviticus 1 was near the altar. In this passage, Yahweh mentions a place "where people throw the ashes out" that was not in the Israelite camp. It was in a ritually clean place. In the Bible, a clean place means a place that is fit for service to God. But this place was not close to the Tent of Meeting, and it was not close to places where the Israelite people lived.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **the place where people throw out ashes**. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **clean** or ritually clean. See the Master Glossary for more information about clean. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 4:1–12

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (583 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (5.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (904 KB)

Leviticus 4:13–26

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 4:13–26 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 4:13–26 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 4:13–26 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 4:13–26

In Leviticus chapter 4, Yahweh gives Moses instructions for offerings for accidental sins or ways people accidentally become ritually dirty. The Israelites could learn about Yahweh and about sin by understanding what Yahweh wanted and what was important to Yahweh. Rules about accidental sins remind us that even when people want to do good things, people still disappoint Yahweh sometimes. Yahweh said that the Israelites had to be ritually clean to be close to Yahweh and have a relationship with Yahweh. But Yahweh chose not to punish the Israelites for their sin and ritual dirtiness. Instead, Yahweh made a way for the Israelite people to become clean again. When the Israelite people did not have a good relationship with Yahweh, Yahweh made a way for the Israelite people to come close to Yahweh again.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Describe a time when you felt like you did not have a good relationship with a close relative. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh required that all the animals for the offering were perfect. The animals must be healthy and strong, not missing body parts or hurt badly. Yahweh did not want the Israelite people to give Yahweh the animals that no one wanted. The Israelite people showed Yahweh that the Israelites were really sorry when they gave Yahweh their best animals.

In Leviticus 4, Yahweh required that an Israelite person give a sin or purification offering after the person realized that they had sinned. In this passage, Yahweh gives instructions for how to do a purification offering to clean all the Israelite people as a whole group. The instructions for the purification offering for all the people of Israel are almost the same as the instructions for the purification offering for the high priest. Why was this the case? The high priest represented all of Israel to Yahweh. So these two purification offerings were the biggest purification offerings. For these offerings, Yahweh required a young bull that was healthy, strong, and whole.

In this passage, the elders or leaders of the Israelites are the ones who must give the purification offering for all of Israel. The elders are the men whom people respected because these men were wise, experienced, and older. These men made important decisions for the whole community and represented different families. Because these men were often older men, people called these leaders the elders.

Stop here and discuss: Who are the spiritual leaders in your community? Describe the responsibilities these people have for the whole community. How is your spiritual leaders' work similar to the Israelite elders' work? How is their work different? Pause the audio here.

The elders or leaders of Israel would lead the young bull to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting in front of the altar of burnt offering. There, the leaders would lay their hands on the head of the young bull. Then a person would kill the bull. We do not know exactly who killed the bull, but it was probably one of the Israelite elders.

The high priest would carry some of the blood in a bowl from the bull into the Tent of Meeting. There, the high priest would sprinkle or throw the blood in front of the curtain of the sanctuary seven times. The high priest would also put some blood on the horns of the altar of fragrant incense. The altars for the Tent of Meeting had points on their corners, which people called horns.

Stop here and look at a picture of the altar of fragrant incense. Find the horns on the altar. Pause this audio here.

After the high priest put the blood on the altar of fragrant incense, the high priest would go back outside. The high priest would pour out the rest of the bull's blood at the bottom of the altar of burnt offering. Next, the high priest had to take the fat from the bull and follow the same process that the high priest would do for his own purification offering. So the high priest must take the fat that covers the internal organs, the two kidneys, the fat on the kidneys, and the best part of the liver.

The high priest took all these parts of the bull's dead body and burned them on the altar of burnt offering. In this way, the high priest made atonement for the people. Remember that atonement makes people clean and restores their relationship with Yahweh. Then Yahweh would forgive the people who had accidentally sinned.

Then the high priest would take all the parts of the bull's dead body that the high priest did not burn on the altar and carry those parts away. The high priest took the rest of the bull's dead body to a ritually clean place where the priests could dump the ashes of the Tent of Meeting. There, the high priest burned the rest of the bull's dead body on a wood fire.

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Next, Yahweh gives instructions for the purification offering for a tribal leader of Israel who accidentally sins or becomes ritually dirty. The Israelite tribal leader who accidentally sins must bring a young male goat for his purification offering. This goat must also be perfect, healthy, and strong.

Stop here and look at a picture of a young male goat as a group. Pause this audio here.

The Israelite tribal leader must bring the young male goat to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. The Israelite leader had to lay his hand on the head of the goat in front of the altar of burnt offering. Then the leader had to kill the goat.

The priest who was helping with the offering would take the goat's blood and put it on the horns of the altar of burnt offering. The priest would then pour the rest of the goat's blood out at the bottom of the altar of burnt offering.

Stop here and look at a picture of the altar of burnt offering. Find the horns on the altar. Talk about where the priest would pour the goat's blood. Pause this audio here.

The priest had to take the fat from the goat and follow the same process that the priest would do for a fellowship offering. So the priest had to take the fat that covers the internal organs, the two kidneys, the fat on the kidneys, and the best part of the liver. The priest would burn all of these parts of the goat on the altar of burnt offering in order to make atonement for the tribal leader. Then Yahweh would forgive the leader who had accidentally sinned.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 4:13–26 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh gives Moses instructions for how to do a sin or purification offering for all the people of Israel if the whole community accidentally sins.

In the second scene: Yahweh gives Moses instructions for how to do a purification offering if a leader of the Israelite people accidentally sins.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- All of the Israelite people, which is the whole community
- The Israelite elders
- The Israelite high priest
- The Israelite tribal leaders
- And an Israelite priest

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The people should follow Yahweh's instructions at the same places as in the last few passages: at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting, the altar of the burnt offering, the Tent of Meeting, the curtain of the sanctuary, the altar of fragrant incense, and a ceremonially clean place outside the camp where the priests dump ashes.

Stop here and look at a map of the Tent of Meeting. Pick locations in your space to represent the different locations. For example, if someone is representing Yahweh, that person may stand in the Holy of Holies. Pause the audio here.

In this passage, you might hear the narrator mention two different words: "congregation" and "assembly." The narrator uses the word congregation, or community, to refer to the whole group of Israelite people. Sometimes this word refers to the representatives or leaders of the whole group of Israelites who act on behalf of the Israelite people and make decisions for the Israelite people. The word assembly refers to a smaller group of

people who performed religious duties for the Israelite people. The assembly was likely the elders of the Israelite people and prominent religious leaders.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, what words do you use to refer to whole groups of people? Do you have any way to refer to a group of people who are representatives who make decisions for the whole group? Pause the audio here.

Scene one answers an important question: What happens if all the people of Israel accidentally become ritually "dirty" by sinning or making a mistake? How can the whole group of Israelites become clean again? This passage explains what the Israelite people must do to become clean again as a whole group.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, what happens when your entire community sins against God or your gods? What kinds of things do your people do all together against God? What happens to the people when they sin like that? Pause the audio here.

When the Israelite community realizes that the community has sinned, the Israelite elders must offer a purification offering on behalf of all the Israelite people. These leaders must bring a young bull to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting and lay their hands on the bull's head.

Then someone, probably one of the Israelite elders, would kill the young bull. The high priest would collect the bull's blood, probably in a bowl or a pot, and carry the blood into the Tent of Meeting. The narrator calls the high priest the "anointed priest" here because this is the special priest that Yahweh has chosen to lead the Israelite people.

The high priest stands before the curtain of the sanctuary, dips his finger in the blood, and sprinkles it seven times before the curtain of the sanctuary. The high priest also takes some blood and puts it on the horns of the altar of fragrant incense. Then the high priest goes back outside.

The high priest pours the rest of the bull's blood at the bottom of the altar of burnt offering. Then Yahweh says that the high priest must remove all the fat from the bull and burn it on the altar, and follow the same process that the high priest would do for his own purification offering. This means that the high priest would first remove all that fat that covers and surrounds the internal organs of the bull. These internal organs were probably the stomach and the intestines. Then the high priest would also remove the two kidneys, the fat on the kidneys, and the best part of the liver. The high priest would then burn all these pieces on the altar of the burnt offering.

To do this, the priest would arrange these pieces of the bull's body on top of the wood that was on the altar. Finally, the priest was supposed to burn these parts of the bull on the altar with fire. In this way, the priest makes atonement for the people. Then Yahweh forgives the people of Israel for their accidental sin.

Then the high priest takes the rest of the bull's dead body, including the bull's skin, flesh, head, legs, the rest of the bull's internal organs, and the bull's dung outside the camp. Then the high priest would burn these pieces of the bull just like the high priest burned the bull for the high priest's purification offering. That means the high priest would burn those pieces on a wood fire in a ritually clean place where the priests put the ashes.

Scene two answers an important question: What if a leader of the Israelites sins accidentally? The leader of the Israelites who sins accidentally must bring a male goat as a purification offering. The narrator says the Israelite leader should lay his hand on the goat's head and kill it at the place where people kill animals for the burnt offering. This is at the same place as for the purification offering for the Israelites. So the Israelite leader brings the male goat to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting by the altar of the burnt offering. There, the leader puts his hand on the goat's head and then kills the goat. Then an Israelite priest dips his own finger into the goat's blood and puts the blood on the horns of the altar of the burnt offering. The priest pours out the rest of the goat's blood at the bottom of the altar of burnt offering.

Yahweh says that the priest must burn all of the goat's fat on the altar and follow the same process that the priest would do for a fellowship offering. This means that the priest would first remove all the fat that covers and surrounds the internal organs of the goat. These internal organs were probably the stomach and the intestines. Then the priest would also remove the two kidneys, the fat on the kidneys, and the best part of the liver. The priest would then burn all these pieces on the altar of the burnt offering.

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To do this, the priest would arrange these animal body parts or inside organs on top of the wood that was on the altar. Finally, the priest was then supposed to burn these animal body parts on the altar with fire. In this way, the priest makes atonement for the leader. Then Yahweh forgives the Israelite leader for his accidental sin.

Stop here and discuss: Talk about the purification offering for all the people of Israel and the purification offering for an Israelite leader. How are the two offerings the same? How are the two offerings different? Pause the audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it. Pay special attention to which person does each action.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 4:13–26 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- All of the Israelite people, which is the whole community
- The Israelite elders
- The Israelite high priest
- The Israelite tribal leaders
- And an Israelite priest

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh gives instructions for what to do when the whole community of Israelites accidentally sins or becomes ritually dirty. When the people of Israel realize that the community has sinned, the leaders of the Israelites must offer a purification offering of a young bull. Pause the drama. Ask all the people playing Israelite people, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am glad I am not the one who has to offer the sacrifice; or
- I am sad that we did something that makes Yahweh angry; or
- Those other people did the bad thing, not me! or
- I realize that even when humans try to do good, we still make mistakes that make Yahweh unhappy.

Continue the drama. The leaders of the Israelites bring a young bull to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. The leaders of the Israelites put their hands on the head of the young bull. Then one of the leaders of the Israelites kills the young bull. The high priest takes some of the bull’s blood into the Tent of Meeting. The high priest dips his finger in the blood and sprinkles it seven times in front of the curtain of the sanctuary. The high priest also puts some of the blood onto the horns on the altar of fragrant incense. Then the high priest goes back outside.

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The high priest pours the rest of the bull's blood at the bottom of the altar of burnt offering. Then the high priest has to remove and burn the fat from the bull on the altar in the same way that the high priest would do for the high priest's purification offering. This is how the high priest makes atonement for the Israelites, and Yahweh forgives the Israelites for their accidental sin. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that my people are ritually clean again; or
- I was sad that my people were not in close relationship with me, but now I am happy that my people have a good relationship with me again.

Continue the drama. Then the high priest would take the rest of the bull's dead body outside the camp and burn it just like the high priest burned the bull for the high priest's purification offering. This is how the high priest offers a purification offering for the community.

In scene two, Yahweh gives instructions on what to do if a leader of the Israelites accidentally sins. When the Israelite leader realizes he has sinned, that leader must bring a male goat as a purification offering. The male goat must be perfect. The leader brings the male goat through the entrance of the Tent of Meeting to the altar of the burnt offering. There, the leader puts his hand on the goat's head and then kills the goat as a purification offering. Then an Israelite priest dips his own finger into the goat's blood and puts the blood on the horns of the altar of the burnt offering. The priest pours out the rest of the goat's blood at the bottom of the altar of burnt offering.

Then the priest has to remove and burn the fat from the goat on the altar in the same way that the priest would do for a fellowship offering. This is how the priest makes atonement for the Israelite leader, and Yahweh forgives the Israelite leader for his accidental sin.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 4:13–26 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, the whole **Israelite** community may accidentally **sin** and need to give an offering to become clean again. The Israelites realize that the Israelites are **guilty**. The narrator uses two words, "**congregation**" and "**assembly**," to refer to all the people of Israel as a whole. The word "congregation" refers to the Israelite people as a whole, but could also refer to a smaller group of Israelite people whose actions impacted the whole community. The word "assembly" often refers to a smaller group of Israelite people, most likely the elders and important religious people. These leaders did religious ceremonies and made important decisions on behalf of all of the Israelites. For more information on Israelite, guilt, and sin, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for Israelite, guilt, and accidental sin as you have used before.

Stop here and discuss as a group different ways to refer to "**the people of Israel**" in this passage. Discuss how to refer to them in a way that emphasizes them as a group. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh talks about what the Israelites should do if the Israelites do not obey Yahweh's **commandments**. Use the same word for Yahweh and commandment as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and commandment, refer to the Master Glossary.

In this passage, the elders or leaders of the Israelites must give the purification offering for all of Israel. These are the men whom people deeply respected because of those men's age and experience. These leaders made important decisions for the whole community and represented different families. People often called these leaders elders because these men were usually old men.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **elder**. Look up elder in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The elders give the **purification offering** for all of Israel. Use the same phrase for sin or purification offering as you used in previous passages. Remember that this is the "accidental sin offering," so use your word for

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"accidental sin" in this passage rather than your regular word for "sin." For more information, refer to sin or purification offering in the Master Glossary.

The elders bring a bull to the **Tent of Meeting**. Use the same words for bull and for Tent of Meeting as you used in previous passages. For more information on the Tent of Meeting, refer to **tabernacle** in the Master Glossary.

Remember the way you have talked about the people coming close to the place of worship when people present the animal to Yahweh to kill it. Talk about that in the same way here as you did in previous passages. Also, talk about killing an animal in the same way you have in previous passages.

During the purification offering for the whole community of Israel, the **high priest** takes the blood of the dead bull into the Tent of Meeting. The narrator calls the high priest the "**anointed** priest," because this is the priest that Yahweh specially anoints, or chooses, to be the leader of all the priests and to make special sacrifices for the Israelite people. Use the same words or phrases for anoint and high priest as you have previously, and remember that anoint and high priest are in the Master Glossary.

The high priest uses a bowl or pot, a special **container**, to carry the blood into the Tent of Meeting. The narrator does not mention this bowl in the passage, but you can include it if it is helpful in your language to describe how the priest carried the blood. Use the same word for bowl or pot as you used in previous passages.

The high priest has to **dip** or put his finger into the blood so the high priest can sprinkle it. Use the same word or phrase for dip as you used in previous passages.

The high priest would **sprinkle** the blood of the sacrificed animal in front of the **curtain of the sanctuary**. Use the same word or phrase for sprinkle and "curtain of the sanctuary" as you used in previous passages. Look at **sanctuary** in the Master Glossary for more information.

The high priest would put some blood on **the altar of fragrant incense**. The high priest would pour the rest of the blood at the base of **the altar of burnt offerings**. Use the same phrases for the altar of fragrant incense and the altar of burnt offerings as you used in previous passages. For more information on altar and burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

The high priest makes **atonement** for the sins of the people when the high priest burns the bull's body on the altar. In this way, the people become ritually clean from their sin because Yahweh forgives the people for their sin. When you forgive someone who has done something bad to you, you stop being angry with that person. You no longer want to take revenge or to give punishment. So people's relationship with Yahweh is right again. See the Master Glossary for more information about atonement, and translate this in the same way as you have previously.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **forgive**. Look up forgive in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

If an Israelite leader sinned, the leader must bring a **male goat** for a purification offering. This male goat must be physically **perfect**. That meant that the animal had no physical defects. The animal must not be blind or deformed or have any bruises or injuries. The animal must not have any kind of skin disease or be missing any body part. Use the same words for male goat and perfect that you used in previous passages. For more information on perfect, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says a **priest** will help the Israelite leader with the purification offering. This would not be the high priest, but one of the other priests. Use the same word for priest that you used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

For the Israelite leader's purification offering, the priest removes and burns the goat's fat, just like the priest did for the **sacrifice** of the **fellowship offerings**. Use the same words for sacrifice and fellowship or peace offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on sacrifice and fellowship offerings, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 4:13–26

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (601 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (910 KB)

Leviticus 4:27–35

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 4:27–35 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 4:27–35 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 4:27–35 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 4:27–35

In Leviticus 4, Yahweh is giving Moses instructions about the different kinds of accidental sin or purification offerings. This passage gives instructions for purification offerings for all the rest of the Israelite people. Any person who was not a priest or a leader would follow these instructions to become ritually clean again.

In this passage, an Israelite can bring a young female goat or a young female sheep for a purification offering. The instructions for both offerings are almost the same, just with a different kind of animal.

Stop here and look at a picture of a young female goat and a young female sheep as a group. Pause this audio here.

When an Israelite person picks an animal to sacrifice, that animal needs to be a healthy animal that has no physical defects. The animal must not be blind or deformed or have any bruises or injuries. The animal must not have any kind of skin disease or be missing any body part. The animal has to be physically perfect. This is true for all the sin offerings. Yahweh requires the best animals and crops for the offerings. This is one of the ways that the Israelite people honored Yahweh.

One difference between offering a young female goat and offering a young female sheep is that the special parts that the priest would burn as a fat offering are slightly different. The priest would burn the same parts of sheep that the priest would burn for the fellowship offering. We know from Leviticus 3:9 that when someone offered a sheep for a fellowship offering, the priest had to include the fatty tail. So the priest would have to include the tail for the purification offering also.

This is what Yahweh says an Israelite must do for a purification offering. The Israelite person who accidentally sinned must bring a healthy young female goat or a young female sheep through the courtyard entrance from the east into the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. The Israelite person must put their hand on the head of the animal, then kill the animal at the altar of burnt offering. An Israelite priest must put some of the animal's blood on the horns of the altar of burnt offering and then pour out the rest of the blood at the bottom of the altar of burnt offering.

Then the priest must remove certain body parts from the dead animal's body, just like the priest does for a fellowship offering. If the Israelite was offering a sheep, the priest would need to also remove the tail. The priest burns those body parts on the altar of burnt offering. When the offering is burning, it is a pleasing smell to Yahweh. This is how the priest makes atonement for the Israelite person's sin. Remember that atonement makes people clean and restores their relationship with Yahweh. And Yahweh forgives the Israelite person for the accidental sin.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is different about the purification offerings in this passage compared to the other purification offerings? What is the same?

Yahweh gave the Israelites rules for the purification offerings to help the Israelites become ritually clean from sin. Yahweh wanted the Israelites to understand that sin makes people ritually or spiritually dirty. When people are ritually dirty, those people are not fit to worship Yahweh. When a person sinned, that person could not hide the sin from Yahweh. A person could only become ritually clean again if the person made the right offering. The priest would put the blood of the offering on the horns of the altar to atone, or to cover, the person's sin. When the priest put the blood on the horns of the altar, an Israelite person might remember the story in Exodus, when Yahweh passed over the houses that had blood on the doorposts. Yahweh was teaching the Israelites a pattern and a truth. This is the truth: something must die in order for the person to have a good relationship with Yahweh again.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 4:27–35 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

Leviticus 4:27–35

In the first scene: Yahweh gives instructions to Moses about how an Israelite person could bring a young female goat as an accidental sin or purification offering.

In the second scene: Yahweh gives instructions to Moses about how an Israelite person could bring a young female sheep as a purification offering.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- An Israelite person who accidentally sinned
- And an Israelite priest

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The people should follow Yahweh's instructions at the same places as in the last few passages: at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting and the altar of the burnt offering.

Stop here and look at a diagram of the Tent of Meeting. Pause the audio here.

This passage answers an important question: What happens if one person accidentally becomes ritually "dirty" by sinning or making a mistake? How can the person be clean again? Yahweh explains in this passage what the Israelite person must do to become ritually clean again. The Israelite person can offer a young female goat or a young female lamb as a purification offering.

In scene one, an Israelite person has learned that they have accidentally sinned or become ritually "dirty." So the Israelite person must bring a young female goat to the Tent of Meeting. The storyteller says the Israelite person should lay their hand on the goat's head and kill it at the place where people kill animals for the burnt offering. This is at the same place as for the other purification offering for the Israelites. So the Israelite person should bring the female goat to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting by the altar of the burnt offering. There, the Israelite person must put their hand on the head of the young female goat. Then the Israelite person must kill the young female goat.

An Israelite priest must then dip his own finger into the young female goat's blood and put the blood on the horns of the altar of the burnt offering. The priest pours out the rest of the goat's blood at the bottom of the altar of burnt offering.

Then the storyteller says that the priest will remove all of the goat's fat in the same way that a priest would for a fellowship offering. This means the priest would first remove all the fat that covers and surrounds the goat's internal organs. These internal organs were probably the stomach and the intestines. Then the priest would also remove the two kidneys, the fat on the kidneys, and the best part of the liver.

The priest takes all of these special pieces of the goat's dead body and burns the special pieces with fire on the altar of the burnt offering. This smell pleases Yahweh. This is how the priest makes atonement for the Israelite person's accidental sin. Yahweh forgives the Israelite person, and the person becomes ritually clean again.

In scene two, the process is the same, but this time the Israelite person brings a young female sheep for the sin offering.

Stop here and discuss: When someone tells a story in your language, how do you repeat information? If you are describing a process that is the same as a process you recently described, do you repeat all the details of the process, or do you have a special way to talk about repeated processes? What information do you choose not to repeat? Are there any special phrases that will help your listeners understand? Pause the audio here.

In scene two, an Israelite person has learned that they have accidentally sinned or become ritually "dirty." Again, the Israelite person brings the animal to the same place as for a fellowship offering, so the Israelite takes the young female sheep to the altar of burnt offering. The Israelite person puts their hand on the head of the young female sheep. Then the Israelite kills the young female sheep.

An Israelite priest dips his own finger into the young female sheep's blood and puts the blood on the horns of the altar of the burnt offering. The priest pours out the rest of the sheep's blood at the bottom of the altar of burnt offering.

Leviticus 4:27–35

Again, the priest has to remove the same parts of the sheep's dead body as a priest would for a fellowship offering. This is the sheep's tail, the fat that covers and surrounds the internal organs of the sheep, the two kidneys and the fat on them, and the best part of the liver.

The priest takes all of these special pieces and burns the special pieces with fire on the altar of the burnt offering. Yahweh says the priest needs to put those parts on the other fire offerings on the altar. This is how the priest makes atonement for the Israelite person's accidental sin. Yahweh forgives the Israelite person's accidental sin, so that person becomes ritually clean again.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 4:27–35 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- An Israelite person who accidentally sinned
- And an Israelite priest

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In scene one, Yahweh tells Moses what an Israelite person should do when the Israelite person has accidentally sinned and become ritually dirty. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad because I know that that person did not want to become dirty; or
- I want the person to be clean again so they can have a good relationship with me again.

Ask the person playing the Israelite person who sinned, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel shame about what people will think of me; or
- I am worried because my sin keeps me from Yahweh; or
- I want to be ritually clean again!

Continue the drama. The Israelite should bring a young female goat to the altar of the burnt offering. The Israelite should lay their hand on the goat and then kill the goat. The priest should take some of the dead goat's blood and should put the blood on the horns of the altar of burnt offering.

The priest must remove the fat in the same way that the priest would for a fellowship offering.

Leviticus 4:27–35

The priest takes all of these special pieces of the goat's dead body and burns the special pieces with fire on the altar of the burnt offering. Yahweh considered the smoke from this fire to be a pleasing aroma. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite who accidentally sinned, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- There is so much blood; or
- I do not understand why this is what Yahweh wants; or
- I know I need to do this to be clean again, but I wish there was something else I could do.

Continue the drama. This is how the priest makes atonement for the Israelite person's accidental sin. Yahweh will forgive the Israelite person's unintentional sin, and the ritually dirty Israelite will be clean again.

In scene two, Yahweh gives instructions for an Israelite person when they offer a young female sheep as a purification offering. The Israelite person should get a young female sheep and bring the sheep to the altar of the burnt offering. The Israelite person should lay their hand on the sheep and then kill the sheep. A priest should take some of the dead sheep's blood and put the blood on the horns of the altar of burnt offering.

The priest must remove the fat in the same way that the priest would for a fellowship offering.

The priest should take all of these special pieces of the sheep's dead body and burn the special pieces with fire on the altar of the burnt offering on the other fire offerings. This is how the priest will make atonement for the Israelite person's accidental sin. Yahweh will forgive the Israelite person's unintentional sin, and the ritually dirty Israelite person will be clean again.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 4:27–35 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, a member of the Israelite people may accidentally **sin** and need to give an offering to become clean again. The Israelite realizes that the Israelite is **guilty**. Use the same words for accidental sin and for guilt as you used in previous passages. Remember that this is about the "accidental sin offering," so if you have a word for "accidental sin," use that word in this passage rather than your regular word for "sin." For more information about sin and guilt, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh talks about what the Israelites should do if the Israelites do not obey Yahweh's **commandments**. Use the same word for Yahweh and commandment as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and commandment, refer to the Master Glossary.

Remember the way you have talked about the people coming close to the place of worship when people present the animal to Yahweh to kill the animal. Talk about that and about killing an animal in the same way here as you did in previous passages.

In this passage, the Israelite person has the option to bring a young female goat for a sin offering. Think of the word you used for goat in previous passages. But notice that the word you used before was for a male goat. If possible, use a word for goat here that means a female goat.

Stop here and discuss as a group the best way to say "**female goat**" in your language. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh gives instructions for **sin or purification offerings**, which are offerings for Israelite people to offer when a person accidentally sins or becomes ritually dirty. Use the same phrase for purification offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on purification offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

The priest would sacrifice animals for the purification offering on the **altar** of **burnt offering**. Use the same word for "altar of burnt offering" as you used in previous passages. For more information on "altar" and "burnt offering," refer to the Master Glossary.

Leviticus 4:27–35

The **priest** would put the blood from the dead animal on the horns of the altar. Use the same word for horn, as in "the horn of the altar," as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

When the priest burns the parts of the goat on the altar of burnt offering, it will be a pleasing smell to Yahweh. Use the same phrase for "a pleasing smell to Yahweh" as you have used previously.

The priest will make **atonement** for the people, and Yahweh will **forgive** the people. Use the same words or phrases for atonement and for forgive as you used in previous passages. For more information about atonement and forgiveness, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh compares the process for making a purification offering to making a **sacrifice** for the **peace or fellowship offering**. Use the same word for sacrifice and fellowship offering as you used in previous passages. Refer to peace or fellowship offering in the Master Glossary for more information.

In this passage, the Israelite person has the option to bring a young **female lamb** for a sin offering. Think of the word you used for lamb in previous passages. But notice that the word you used before was for a male lamb. If possible, use a word for lamb here that means a female lamb.

Stop here and discuss as a group the best way to say "female lamb" in your language.

The priest will burn the parts of the lamb on top of the other **fire offerings**. Use the same word or phrase for fire offerings as you have used previously. For more information, refer to fire offerings in the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 4:27–35

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (683 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.3 MB)

- Speaking the Word (938 KB)

Leviticus 5:1–13

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 5:1–13 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 5:1–13 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 5:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, Yahweh gave Moses laws for how people need to make a sin or purification offering. Yahweh now talks about the circumstances that require a purification offering. In this passage, Yahweh gives examples of circumstances in which someone becomes unclean or ritually dirty because that person has not done something that person needs to do. Therefore, that person needs to make a purification offering. Yahweh does not describe everything that makes a person ritually dirty.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Describe times when someone in your community has not done something they are supposed to do. How do other people feel about that person? What does that person need to do to make things right again? Pause this audio here.

The first example is when a leader or someone with authority commands people to talk about something that people saw or learned about. If a person does not talk about what that person saw or learned about, that person makes themselves guilty. Yahweh is probably talking about when the leaders in a community would ask for people to give the leaders information about a person who disobeyed a community law. People who do not give information to the leaders are guilty.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you investigate crimes in your community? What do you call the people who have information about crimes? What do you do if someone knows important information about a crime but will not share it? Pause this audio here.

The second example is when someone touches something that is unclean or ritually dirty. This makes that person become ritually dirty too and guilty. Unclean did not just mean physically dirty. Yahweh was talking about being ritually clean or dirty. Because Yahweh deserves a lot of respect as the creator of the universe and as the one who ruled over the Israelites, Yahweh used this system of clean and dirty to help the Israelites understand how to respect Yahweh. Yahweh did not want anything ritually dirty to touch anything holy, so Yahweh had various rules to keep literally dirty people, animals, and objects from touching holy objects or people. If a person touched a ritually dirty animal's dead body, that person became ritually dirty too. Ritually dirty animals were animals that Yahweh did not allow the Israelites to eat. Those animals also made the things the animals touched ritually dirty.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: What are your culture's rules about how to interact with the dead bodies of animals? What does someone who touches a dead animal have to do? Pause this audio here.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: Are there any animals that people in your culture must not eat? Why? What do you call animals that you must not eat? Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 5:1–13

When Yahweh talks about the ritually dirty animals, Yahweh talks about three different types of animals. Yahweh talks about animals that are livestock, which people also call domesticated animals. These were animals that people have tamed and used for food or work. Yahweh talks about wild animals, which people also call beasts. These were all the other animals that people have not tamed. Yahweh also talks about swarming creatures, or things that move on the earth. These were small creatures like rodents or insects. Yahweh talks about these categories of animals because these were the major categories of animals for the Israelites. When someone talked about wild animals and domesticated animals, that person was talking about all animals.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: How do people in your culture talk about different types of animals? How do people put different types of animals in groups that are similar? How do people in your culture talk about all the different kinds of animals at once? Pause this audio here.

Sometimes a person might accidentally touch the dead body of a ritually dirty animal, but does not realize that they have touched a ritually dirty animal. Then that person goes to the Tent of Meeting or participates in a religious ritual before that person has made themselves ritually clean again. That person is guilty. When that person realizes what they have done, that person must make a purification offering to Yahweh.

Another example is when someone touches another human's dirtiness. It does not matter that the person does not know that the other person is ritually dirty. That first person is now ritually dirty and guilty, too. A human's dirtiness is a way to refer to something that the human body produces, like excrement, blood, or semen, that makes people ritually dirty if those people touch it. It also refers to diseases, like specific types of rashes or skin diseases, that make a person ritually dirty. Yahweh will explain later what things specifically will make people ritually dirty if someone touches those things.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: How do people in your community treat things the human body produces? Do you treat different things, like spit or blood, differently? Talk about a time when someone could not be around other people because of something that person's body was producing. Pause this audio here.

A person who touches a human's dirtiness but does not make themselves ritually clean again is guilty for the same reason that a person who touches the dead body of a ritually dirty animal is guilty.

The fourth example is when a person swears an oath without thinking seriously about the oath. That person is also guilty. This is true whether the oath was good or bad. An oath was good if it was helpful and bad if it was harmful to someone. Yahweh cares a lot about making oaths, so if someone makes an oath, Yahweh's law says that person needs to do what that person said they would do. Yahweh cared because when a person swore an oath, that person said that their god would punish that person if the person did not do what that person said. Since Yahweh is the Israelite's God, Yahweh will punish that person if that person does not do what that person swore to do.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time someone in your culture swore an oath or made a strong promise that that person would do something, and then that person did not do it. What happened to that person? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that if someone did any of the things Yahweh just talked about, then that person needs to confess that they are guilty. That person needs to bring a purification offering to Yahweh at the Tent of Meeting, and the priest will make atonement for the person's sin. This means that the priest will offer the animal as a purification offering, and then Yahweh will restore Yahweh's relationship with that person. Yahweh will forgive that person, and Yahweh will not punish the person for what that person did wrong.

The next section explains what someone needs to do for a purification offering if that person cannot afford a sheep. This rule is also for someone who cannot afford a goat. Yahweh is giving this rule because Yahweh wants to help the poor Israelites.

Stop and discuss this question as a group: How does your society help poor people, or people who need extra help, to worship your God or gods? How do poor people worship God in different ways than wealthy people do? Pause this audio here.

If someone cannot afford a sheep or a goat, that person needs to bring two doves or two pigeons. It is unclear what the difference is between a dove and a pigeon in this passage. People sacrificed these birds because these birds represented purity and innocence.

Stop here and look at a picture of doves and pigeons as a group. Pause this audio here.

The person offers one of the birds as a purification offering and one bird as a burnt offering. The person brings the birds to the priest, and the priest offers the first bird as a purification offering. The priest twists the bird's neck until the bird dies and pulls until the head starts to come off the body. The priest needs to make sure the head is still partially attached to the bird's dead body. As the blood pours out of where the bird's neck has ripped open, the priest needs to take some of the blood and sprinkle the blood onto the side of the altar. The priest will drain the rest of the blood from the bird at the base of the altar of burnt offering.

Stop here and look at a picture of the altar of burnt offering as a group. Pause this audio here.

Then the priest offers the second bird as a burnt offering by following the laws Yahweh explained earlier in Leviticus. Yahweh explains that this is how the priest will make atonement for the person's sin, and Yahweh will forgive the person.

Yahweh continues to help poor people by explaining what someone can do if someone cannot afford two doves or two pigeons for a purification offering. Yahweh says that the person needs to bring one-tenth of an ephah of good-quality flour to offer as a purification offering. An ephah was probably a large basket that people used to carry and measure flour. One tenth of an ephah was about 2.25 liters. In weight, it was about 1 to 2 kilograms. People crush the grain as small as they can to make good-quality flour.

Stop here and look at a picture of good-quality flour as a group. Pause this audio here.

The person must not add any oil or frankincense of any kind to the flour because this is a purification offering.

Stop here and look at a picture of oil and of frankincense as a group. Pause this audio here.

The person takes the flour to the priest, and the priest takes a handful of the flour and puts it on the altar to burn. This is a memorial portion. You will remember that some people think a memorial portion helps the Israelites remember Yahweh's covenant, or perhaps call Yahweh's attention to the reason the person was offering the flour. Yahweh explains that the flour will go with the other offerings that are already in the fire. This process will be how the priest will make atonement for the person's sin, and Yahweh will forgive the person. The person who brought the flour will give the rest of the flour to the priest, as a person does for a grain offering.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 5:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh explains what sort of sins require someone to offer a sin or purification offering.

In the second scene: Yahweh explains how to offer two doves or two pigeons as a purification offering if someone cannot afford to offer a sheep.

In the third scene: Yahweh explains how to offer flour for a purification offering if someone cannot afford to offer doves or pigeons.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The leaders who tell people to testify if people have seen something bad happen
- The person who offers a purification offering because they have accidentally sinned
- And a priest

Leviticus 5:1–13

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the passage, remember that Yahweh is still giving Moses these laws from the Tent of Meeting. These laws are about how and when the Israelites are supposed to bring offerings. Remember that in the previous passage, Yahweh gave Moses laws for what different types of people must do for purification offerings. In this passage, Yahweh is giving Moses examples of what types of sins require a purification offering, and what people can bring if people cannot afford to bring the certain animals. Also, remember that in this passage, Yahweh says, "If someone does this thing, another thing will happen." In each of these examples, Yahweh is talking about when someone does something that makes that person guilty or ritually dirty. Yahweh is talking about events that have not actually happened yet.

In the first scene, Yahweh describes things a person could do that would make that person guilty or ritually dirty. The first is if someone does not tell leaders what that person knows about a crime when the leaders ask about it. The second is if someone touches the dead body of an unclean animal, but that person does not realize it and does not make themselves clean. The third is if someone touches some human dirtiness that makes the person unclean, but that person does not realize it and does not make themselves clean. The fourth is if someone makes an oath to do something without thinking about the oath seriously.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: Talk about a list of potential actions someone might do, such as ways a person could get across a river or ways a person could start a story. Listen for words that you use to show these are all examples and potential things someone could do. Pause this audio here.

When someone realizes that they are guilty, that person needs to bring a purification offering to the priest and confess what that person has done. The purification offering needs to be a sheep or a goat. The priest will make atonement for the person with the offering, which will make the ritually dirty person clean again, so Yahweh will not punish that person. Here, Yahweh does not say Yahweh will forgive the person. That does not mean that Yahweh will not forgive the person. Yahweh probably does not say Yahweh will forgive the person because Yahweh already said he would forgive the person in the last passage, when Yahweh explained how to offer a purification offering.

In the second scene, Yahweh explains how to offer two doves or pigeons as a purification offering if the person cannot afford a sheep. Yahweh means a sheep or a goat here. Yahweh is giving another way for people who cannot afford a sheep or a goat for a purification offering.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: How do you give different options for ways people can do a certain task? As an activity, give someone multiple options, such as different ways they could get to a certain location or different ways to clean a house. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh explains that one dove or pigeon will be a purification offering, and one dove or pigeon will be for a burnt offering. Yahweh gives the details for how to offer a bird as a sin offering. First, the priest twists the bird's head partly off and sprinkles some of the blood onto the side of the altar. That means that the priest makes sure a few drops of blood drip from the priest's hand onto the side of the altar without touching the altar. Then the priest drains the rest of the blood at the bottom of the altar. Yahweh says again that this is a purification offering. Yahweh says that because the purification offering is the only offering in which the priests will pour the blood onto the base of the altar.

Stop here and, as a group, act out how the priest will sprinkle or throw some of the bird's blood on the side of the altar. Then act out how the priest will drain the rest of the bird's blood onto the base of the altar. How will you describe this in your translation? Remember how you have described these actions in previous passages. Pause this audio here.

Then the priest offers the second bird as a burnt offering. This entire process is how the priest makes atonement for the person, and Yahweh will forgive that person.

In the third scene, Yahweh explains how to use one tenth of an ephah of well-milled flour as a purification offering if a person cannot afford two doves or two pigeons. Yahweh explains how the flour cannot have any oil or frankincense in it. The priest burns a handful of the flour on the altar to show that the person remembers Yahweh and Yahweh's laws. The priest will put this flour on top of the other fire offerings, or the animal offerings,

that are already on the altar. This process is how the priest makes atonement for the person, and Yahweh will forgive that person. Then the person who brings the flour is supposed to give the rest of the flour to the priest.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 5:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The leaders who tell people to testify if people have seen something bad happen
- The person who offers a purification offering because they have accidentally sinned
- And a priest

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

You may choose to have the characters act out each possible situation as Yahweh gives these instructions through Moses.

Yahweh tells Moses to say to the Israelites: "If you are a witness to a crime but you do not tell your leaders when your leaders ask you to say what you know, then you are guilty." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the leaders, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The person might answer things like:

- I really want to know who committed this crime; or
- I hope people tell us about what happened; or
- No one told us about what happened, and now I am sad and frustrated.

Continue the drama. Yahweh says, "If you touch the dead body of any kind of unclean animal, even if you do not realize it, then you are guilty. If you touch something that humans make that is unclean, even if you do not realize it, then you are guilty. If you make an oath to do something without thinking seriously about it, you are guilty. When you realize you are guilty, you need to take a sheep or a goat to the priest to make a purification offering." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the person who is bringing a purification offering, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so embarrassed that I forgot one of these things! or
- I feel guilty because I did something wrong; or
- I do not understand why I have to make a sacrifice since this was just an accident.

Continue the drama. Yahweh then tells Moses to say to the Israelites, "If you cannot afford to use a sheep for the purification offering, then you need to take two doves or two pigeons to the priest. One of the birds will be a purification offering, and one will be a burnt offering. The priest will twist the bird's head until it comes mostly off the body but is still a little attached. Then the priest will get a little of the bird's blood on the priest's hand and sprinkle the blood onto the side of the altar. The priest will make sure the rest of the blood falls onto the

ground at the base of the altar. The priest will use the second bird as a burnt offering, and the priest needs to follow the rules Yahweh said earlier about how to offer a dove or pigeon as a burnt offering. When the priest sacrifices the birds, the priest will make atonement for the person, which makes the person ritually clean from the thing that person did wrong so that Yahweh will not punish that person." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The person might answer things like:

- I forgive this person because this person did what I asked the Israelites to do; or
- I love this person so much. I am glad I gave people a way to restore their relationship with me, even though this person can not afford a sheep.

Continue the drama. Yahweh then tells Moses to say to the Israelites: "If you cannot afford two doves or two pigeons, then you need to bring one tenth of an ephah of flour. The flour needs to be very small pieces of grain, and it cannot have any oil or frankincense in it. The priest will take a small amount of the flour and put it on the altar with the other food sacrifices. This shows that the person who brings the flour remembers Yahweh and the laws Yahweh told the Israelites to follow. When this happens, the priest makes atonement for the person. Yahweh will forgive the person and restore Yahweh's relationship with that person so that Yahweh does not punish that person. Then the person who brought the flour gives the rest of the flour to the priest, just like people give the flour from the grain offering to the priest." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the person who is bringing the purification offering, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so glad that I can restore my relationship with God, even though I do not have a lot of money; or
- I hope Yahweh forgives me, even though this sacrifice is not as valuable as sheep.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 5:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this section of Leviticus, Yahweh gives Moses more laws for the Israelites about how to make offerings to Yahweh. The laws in this passage are about when and how to offer a **sin or purification offerin**g. Use the same word or phrase for purification offering that you used in the previous passage. Purification offering is in the Master Glossary.

The first example is when a leader commands people to testify, or talk about something people saw or learned about. If someone does not talk about that thing, that person is **guilty**. Use the same word or phrase for guilty that you used in the previous passage, and remember that guilt is in the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **testify**, or talk about something that you have seen in a court where people are judging if someone is guilty. Translate the idea of testify in the same way you have in other books of the Bible, and refer to the Master Glossary for more information about testify. Pause this audio here.

The second example is when someone touches something that is unclean or ritually dirty. That person becomes ritually dirty and guilty. Unclean does not just mean physically dirty. Yahweh also used the words clean and unclean to talk about being spiritually clean or unclean. In the Bible, a clean person means a person who is fit for service to God—someone who is acceptable to participate in worship to God. A person who is unclean is unfit for service to God. Animals and even objects can also be clean or unclean. In this passage, Yahweh is talking about people who are ritually unclean because they have accidentally sinned.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **unclean** when it refers to animals. Look up **clean and unclean** in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

A person can become ritually dirty if a person touches a ritually dirty animal's carcass. A carcass is the dead body of an animal.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for a **carcass**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 5:1–13

Yahweh talks about three different types of animals: domesticated animals, wild animals, and swarming creatures. These three different types of animals included all the animals that existed. Domesticated animals are animals that people have taught to do what people want the animals to do. Domesticated animals generally live with people, and people use these animals for food or work. Wild animals are animals that do not obey people and that are not used to people. Wild animals generally stay away from people, though these animals might occasionally go near people and cause problems for people. People might hunt wild animals, but people do not stay near wild animals. Finally, swarming creatures are all the small creatures, like insects or really small animals. The Israelites used these three categories of animals to talk about every different kind of animal.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **domesticated animals**, **wild animals**, and **swarming creatures**. If you have already translated these phrases in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The third example is when someone touches a human's uncleanness. Even if the person is unaware of what they have done, that person is guilty. A person's uncleanness is a way to refer to something that the human body produces, like poop, blood, or semen, that makes people ritually dirty if someone touches it. It is also a way to refer to a disease a person has, like a skin disease, that makes people ritually dirty when someone touches it or has it. Yahweh will explain later what things specifically will make people ritually dirty if someone touches those things.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate the idea of a human's uncleanness. Pause this audio here.

The fourth example law is when a person swears an oath or serious promise without thinking seriously about the oath. When someone swears an oath, that person says, "I will absolutely keep my promise. If I do not, God may punish me."

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **oath**. Look up oath in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh says that if someone is guilty because that person did any of the four things Yahweh just talked about, then that person needs to confess that they are guilty. When Yahweh says to confess, Yahweh means that the person needs to say out loud what that person did wrong. Here, the person probably says it to the priest, though Yahweh might mean that the person says it to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **confess**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

A person needs to bring a purification offering to **Yahweh** because that person is guilty. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. Look up Yahweh in the Master Glossary for more information.

The purification offering needs to be something from the flock; it can be either a **sheep** or a **goat**. Use the same words or phrases for sheep and goat that you used in previous passages.

When the person brings the purification offering to the **priest**, the priest gives the offering for the person. Use the same word or phrase for priest as you used in previous passages. Look up priest in the Master Glossary for more information.

This is how the priest will make **atonement** for the person's **sin**. Use the same words or phrases for atonement and for accidental sin that you used in previous passages. Look up atonement and sin in the Master Glossary for more information.

Then Yahweh explains what someone needs to do if that person cannot afford a sheep for the purification offering. That person needs to bring two **doves** or two **pigeons**. Some translations say two turtledoves or two pigeons. Doves and pigeons are two different types of birds. Use the same words or phrases for pigeons and doves that you used in the first passage of Leviticus. For more information on dove, look in the Master Glossary.

Stop here and look at a picture of doves and pigeons again as a group. Pause this audio here.

The priest will sacrifice one of the birds as a purification offering, and then the priest will sacrifice one bird as a **burnt offering**. Use the same word for burnt offering that you used in previous passages, and refer to burnt offering in the Master Glossary if needed.

When the priest offers the first bird as a purification offering, the priest wrings the bird's neck until the bird dies and the head becomes partially detached from the body. Then the priest **sprinkles** some of the blood onto the **altar**. Use the same word or phrase for sprinkling blood, and for altar, that you used in previous passages. Look up altar in the Master Glossary for more information. The priest drains the rest of the bird's blood out at the base, or bottom, of the altar.

Then the priest offers the second bird as a burnt offering by following the laws Yahweh gave earlier in Leviticus. Yahweh explains that this process will be how the priest will make atonement for the person's sin. This means that the priest will offer the animal as a purification offering, and then Yahweh will not punish the person for what they did wrong. Yahweh specifically says here that Yahweh will **forgive** the person. Use the same word or phrase for forgive as you used in previous passages. Look up forgiveness in the Master Glossary for more information.

Then Yahweh explains what someone needs to do if that person cannot afford two doves or two pigeons for a purification offering. Yahweh says the person needs to bring one-tenth of an ephah of good-quality flour to offer as a purification offering. Use the same word or phrase for good-quality flour that you used in previous passages.

An ephah was probably a large basket that people used to carry and measure flour. One tenth of an ephah was about 2.25 liters, and a tenth of an ephah of flour weighed between 1 and 2 kilograms. You may use the actual weight or volume of the flour in your translation, rather than saying "ephah," if you would like.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for one-tenth of an **ephah**, or for this measurement. Look up ephah in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The person should not add any **oil** or any **frankincense** of any kind to the flour. Use the same word or phrase for oil that you used in previous passages. Also, use the same word or phrase for frankincense that you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of oil and of frankincense as a group. Pause this audio here.

The person takes the flour to the priest, and the priest takes a handful of the flour and puts it on the altar on top of the other **fire offerings** to burn. This is the **memorial portion**. That means it is how the person shows that they remember Yahweh and what Yahweh has told them to do. Use the same words or phrases for fire offerings and memorial portion that you used in previous passages. Fire offerings and memorial portion are in the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that the person who brought the flour will give the rest of it to the priest, just like people give the flour from the **grain offerings** to the priests. Use the same word or phrase for grain offering that you used in previous passages. Look up grain offering in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 5:1–13

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (652 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (6.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (919 KB)

Leviticus 5:14–6:7

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 5:14–6:7 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 5:14–6:7 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 5:14–6:7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh has been giving Moses laws to give to the Israelites that explain when and how the people are supposed to give offerings to Yahweh, so that they can live in good relationship with Yahweh. Yahweh has explained how to offer burnt offerings, grain offerings, peace or fellowship offerings, and sin or purification offerings. Now Yahweh explains the last main type of offering, which most translations call a guilt or reparation offering. It is a guilt offering because a person is guilty when that person does something wrong, and this offering is how Yahweh forgives that person. Reparation is a word that means payment for what someone owes. Since this offering is a way that people pay Yahweh or other people what that person owes, people sometimes call this offering a reparation offering. [This offering is different from the purification offering because a person sacrificed a guilt offering when that person did something that caused]{.mark} Yahweh or other people to lose something valuable. This offering repaid the value to other people or to Yahweh. The sacrifice allowed the priest to make atonement

for the person so that Yahweh would forgive the person. Then Yahweh restored Yahweh's relationship with that person and cleansed that person from their guilt.

This passage involves three different situations that would cause someone to need to make a guilt offering, and what that guilt offering must be.

In the first situation, Yahweh tells Moses what the Israelites need to do when someone sins accidentally against any of Yahweh's holy things. Yahweh also says that when a person sins against Yahweh's holy things, that person is being unfaithful to Yahweh. Yahweh's holy things probably mean any of the items in the Tent of Meeting or the Tent of Meeting itself. The holy things are also things that people are supposed to give to Yahweh, such as firstborn animals or money. This probably included things that the priests and the Levites were supposed to get and things that people promised to give to Yahweh. These holy items have a value that people can measure. Yahweh is probably talking about when someone promises to give Yahweh something, but does not give it to Yahweh. Yahweh says that when that person sins, that person needs to bring a ram that is physically perfect from the flock as a guilt offering. A ram was an adult male sheep. Rams were the most valuable type of sheep.

Stop here and look at a picture of a ram as a group. Pause this audio here.

The person must choose a ram they own that has a certain value. The Israelites did not have a set of coins at this time, but used various weights of precious metal for money. A shekel was a weight measurement of about 11 grams. There were different standards for weight measurement at this time, so Yahweh specifies which measurement to use. The person should use the shekel measurement that weighed as much as priests in the holy place decided a shekel should weigh.

Stop here and look at a picture of a shekel as a group. Pause this audio here.

The holy place or sanctuary was another name for the Tent of Meeting, and people used the term later as a name for the temple as well. It is not clear from this passage how many shekels the ram needed to be worth. It is possible that the price of a ram would change over time, so the priests were in charge of determining how expensive the ram should be.

The person who brought the guilt offering also had to pay money to make peace or make up for the holy thing that that person had sinned against. This is probably because the holy thing needed to go through a special ritual for people to be able to use it again. It is also possible that people needed to make a new holy thing to replace the one that someone had sinned against. The person had to pay for the full value of the holy thing. The person also had to pay an additional one-fifth, or 20 percent, of the cost. This person paid that money to the priest.

Then the priest makes atonement with the ram to ask Yahweh to forgive that person and restore the relationship between Yahweh and the person. When the priest makes atonement, Yahweh also cleans the person from the guilt of what that person did wrong and forgives that person. Yahweh does not explain here how the priest is supposed to sacrifice the ram.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Do you have any holy or special things in your culture? What do you do if someone misuses those things or ruins them? How does someone make peace or pay back the value of what that person ruined? Pause this audio here.

In the next situation, Yahweh says that when someone sins by doing anything that Yahweh told the Israelites not to do, that person is guilty. Yahweh specifies that even if the person does not realize they have sinned until later, that person is still guilty. If that person is guilty, Yahweh says that person needs to bring a ram that was physically perfect from the flock, just like in the first situation. This ram also needs to be worth a certain amount of shekels, that weigh the amount the priests in the holy place decided a shekel should weigh. The priest then makes atonement for the wrong thing the person did, and Yahweh will forgive the person. Yahweh wants people to know that even when people do not know that they break Yahweh's laws, those people are still guilty of breaking one of Yahweh's laws.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you do in your culture when someone breaks the law accidentally, or without realizing that the person has broken the law? How do people in your culture punish that person, and how do you bring that person back into your community? Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 5:14–6:7

In the last situation, Yahweh describes several ways someone might take something valuable from their neighbors illegally. Yahweh says that people who do this are being unfaithful to Yahweh. When Yahweh says neighbor, Yahweh means the people who are part of the Israelites' community.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What people do you consider to be part of your community? What are some things you are supposed to do or not do for people in your community? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that anyone who does one of these things is betraying Yahweh. The first thing a person might do is lie about something a neighbor gave the person as a deposit or as a pledge. A deposit is something someone gives to you to keep safe. A pledge is something someone gives you as a sign of a promise that the person will do something. When Yahweh says that someone might lie about it, Yahweh means a person might lie and say their neighbor did not give anything, or the person might lie and say that their neighbor gave the person less than the neighbor actually gave. Another way to translate "deposit or pledge" would be "something a person is supposed to take care of."

Stop here and discuss this as a group: How do people in your culture keep things safe? Do people ever ask neighbors to take care of something for them? What happens if the neighbor steals the thing instead of taking care of the thing? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also says that a person might just steal something from their neighbor. A person might also extort their neighbor, or force their neighbor to give something that the neighbor does not want to give. The last thing a person might do is find something that belongs to someone else and then lie and say they do not have that thing. In these situations, the person has sworn a false oath that they did not have something or did not do something wrong.

Yahweh ends these examples by saying that Yahweh is talking about any kinds of sins that involve taking something valuable from a person and lying about it, since a guilt or reparation sacrifice is about repaying things.

Yahweh says that if someone does any of those things, when that person realizes their guilt, that person needs to make peace, or give back the thing that the person should not have. That means the person needs to give back whatever that person lied about or stole. That would also include whatever someone gave to the person that the person lied about, or the lost thing the person found and swore they did not have. The person needs to give that thing back and pay the other person an extra one-fifth, or 20 percent, of the value of the thing. The person needs to do this on the same day the person gives Yahweh a guilt offering. The person needs to bring a ram from the flock that is physically perfect. This ram also needs to be worth a certain amount of shekels, that weigh the amount the priests in the holy place decided a shekel should weigh. The priest then makes atonement for the wrong thing the person did, and Yahweh will forgive the person for whatever the person did that was a sin.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: What do people in your culture do when someone steals from another member of the community?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 5:14–6:7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh explains how to offer a guilt offering when a person sins against one of Yahweh's holy things.

In the second scene: Yahweh explains how to offer a guilt offering when a person does something Yahweh commanded the Israelites not to do.

In the third scene: Yahweh explains the situations where a person might steal something from someone in their community. Yahweh then explains how to offer a guilt offering when the person admits their guilt.

Leviticus 5:14–6:7

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- The person who offers the guilt offering because they have sinned
- The priest
- And the neighbor whose things someone else stole

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh has been speaking to Moses and has been giving Moses laws that the Israelites need to obey for offerings. Although we do not know where Moses is when Yahweh gives him the laws in this passage, it is possible that Moses is still on Mount Sinai and that Yahweh gives Moses these laws there. In any case, now Yahweh gives laws for the last type of offering in this part of Leviticus.

In the first scene, Yahweh gives the laws for how someone gives a guilt offering when that person sins against one of Yahweh's holy things without meaning to. This person is unfaithful to Yahweh. In other words, this person betrays Yahweh and shows that he is not loyal to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will say that someone has sinned against Yahweh and is unfaithful to Yahweh. Pause this audio here.

The person must bring a ram that is perfect and worth a certain number of shekels based on the weight of shekels the priests in the holy place used. This person gives the ram to the priest at the Tent of Meeting.

That person needs to make restitution, or peace, with whoever they have wronged. That means that this person also gives the priest money that is equal to the value of the holy thing the person sinned against. The person also gives additional money equal to 20 percent of the value of the holy thing. Then the priest will make atonement for that person, and Yahweh will forgive that person. Yahweh will explain how the priest offers the ram in Leviticus 7.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you say that the person who wronged someone else must make restitution, or peace, with whoever they wronged? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and do this activity as a group. Talk about what 20 percent means. Find a group of 10 items. Twenty percent of these 10 items is 2. Therefore, add 2 things to the 10 things. You will have 12 things. If someone takes 10 things away from someone else, that person would have to give back 12 things—the 10 they took and 2 more. Then, come up with things in your society that people all know the value of, such as fish, bread, or houses. What would it be to pay back the value of those things and an additional 20 percent as well? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh gives the laws for when someone accidentally does something Yahweh commanded the Israelites not to do, and then the person realizes they sinned. Yahweh says that in these situations, a person is still guilty and deserves punishment. Yahweh says that the person needs to bring a ram that is perfect and worth a certain number of shekels based on the weight of shekels that people use in the holy place. The person gives the ram to the priest. Then the priest will make atonement for that person, and Yahweh will forgive that person. Yahweh repeats that it is a guilt offering for the sin the person did against Yahweh that made the person guilty. Yahweh wants to emphasize that even though the person did not know they did something Yahweh told the Israelites not to do, that person is still guilty of breaking one of Yahweh's laws.

In the third scene, Yahweh gives several examples of how someone might be unfaithful to Yahweh by stealing. First, a person might lie about something the neighbor gave as a pledge or a deposit. A pledge is something someone gives you as a sign of a promise that the person will do something. You are supposed to return a pledge to the person when the person does what they say they will. However, someone could lie and say their neighbor did not give a pledge or that the person has not yet done what they promised. A deposit was something that someone gave someone else to take care of. If a person were going on a trip, the person could protect something valuable if they gave it to someone to keep safe. People often gave valuable things to their neighbors to protect while a person was away. But someone could lie and pretend to have lost the valuable thing or say that the thing had always belonged to that person. Yahweh is saying that that is a sin. Second, a person steals from someone in their community. That means a person would attack and take something from their neighbor. Third, a person might extort their neighbor, or force their neighbor to give something. That usually means a person threatens to do something to the neighbor if the neighbor does not give the thing the person asks for. Or a person might trick

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their neighbor so the neighbor gives the thing without realizing it. Finally, a person might find something that belongs to someone else and lie about it. If anyone swears a false oath about any of these things, that person sins. Yahweh says that any of these things is something someone might do that is a sin.

Yahweh specifically lists again all the ways someone might be unfaithful to Yahweh by stealing and repeats that people sin when they do these things. You might list these things all again, or you might summarize the things.

As soon as someone realizes that the person has sinned by doing something like this, that person needs to give back what the person stole. The person also gives additional money worth 20 percent of the thing's value. Then that person needs to bring a ram that is perfect and worth a certain number of shekels based on the weight of shekels the priests in the holy place used. The person must give the ram to the priest. Then the priest will make atonement for them. Yahweh will forgive that person for anything that person has done that made the person guilty.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 5:14–6:7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- The person who offers the guilt offering because they have sinned
- The priest
- And the neighbor whose things someone else stole

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Yahweh tells Moses to tell the Israelites: "If you accidentally sin against any of Yahweh's holy things, then bring a guilt offering to Yahweh. It needs to be a ram that has no problems with it and is worth a certain number of shekels. The priests at the holy place will weigh the shekels according to the sanctuary standard. The person also needs to pay for the holy thing that the person sinned against, plus an additional 20 percent of its value. Then the priest will sacrifice the ram to ask Yahweh to forgive the person, and Yahweh will forgive the person." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the person who sinned against one of Yahweh's holy things, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel guilty or ashamed because I sinned against one of Yahweh's holy things; or
- I am glad Yahweh forgave me when I brought the guilt sacrifice; or
- I did not do it on purpose, so why am I in trouble?

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh told Moses to tell the Israelites: "If you accidentally disobey any of the laws that I am giving you, even just one of them, when you realize that you are guilty, you need to make it up to me. Bring a guilt offering to Yahweh. It needs to be a ram that has no problems with it and is worth a certain number

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of shekels. The priests at the holy place will weigh the shekels according to the sanctuary standard. Then the priest will sacrifice the ram to ask Yahweh to forgive that person for what the person unintentionally did, and Yahweh will forgive that person. The person gave a guilt offering because even though that person did not mean to break one of Yahweh's laws, that person was still guilty." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The person might answer things like:

- I forgive this person because I love the person so much; or
- Even though the person did not realize that they disobeyed my laws, my laws are really important, so I am glad the person realized they were guilty.

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh told Moses to tell the Israelites: "If you lie about something a neighbor gave you to take care of, or if you rob their neighbor, you are guilty. If you force your neighbor to give you something your neighbor does not want to give you, you are guilty. Also, if you find something that does not belong to you and then swear you do not have it, you are guilty." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the person whose things someone stole, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The person might answer things like:

- I am upset because someone stole something from me; or
- I thought I could trust my neighbor, but now my neighbor lies about what I gave.

Continue the drama. Yahweh says, "Any of these things is something someone might do that is a sin. As soon as someone admits that they sinned in something like this, the person needs to give back what the person stole and then also give money worth 20 percent of the thing's value. Then the person needs to bring a ram that is perfect and worth a certain number of shekels. The priests at the holy place will weigh the shekels according to the sanctuary standard. The person must give the ram to the priest. Then the priest will make atonement for that person, and Yahweh will forgive that person for anything the person has done that made the person guilty." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priest, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad I can help someone ask Yahweh for forgiveness; or
- This person did something really bad. I do not like that the person did not get a worse punishment.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 5:14–6:7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh continues to speak to Moses. Use the same word for Yahweh that you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh tells Moses what to do when an Israelite is unfaithful to Yahweh and **sins** accidentally against any of Yahweh's holy things. Use the same phrases for sins accidentally as you have used previously, and refer to sin in the Master Glossary for more information.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about being **unfaithful** to Yahweh. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh's holy things probably refer to any of the things that a person promises to give to Yahweh, and the things that Yahweh told the Israelites to give to Yahweh. That includes firstborn animals, the first crops in a harvest, and the money that the priests and the Levites are supposed to get. It probably also refers to the things in the Tent of Meeting and, later, in the temple. These things are holy because Yahweh said that these items belonged to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **holy things**. Look up **holy** in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

This person who sins needs to bring a **ram** that was **physically perfect** from the flock to the **priest**. A ram was an adult male sheep. Rams were the most valuable type of sheep. Use the same words for priest, ram, and physically perfect that you used in previous passages. For more information on priest and perfect, refer to the Master Glossary.

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The Israelites used the ram for a guilt offering. People also sometimes translate this offering as a reparation or repayment offering. People gave the guilt offering when someone did something wrong that took value from someone else, either from Yahweh or from another person. People also gave a guilt offering when someone broke any of Yahweh's laws without meaning to. That is probably because people at that time thought that when you broke a law against a god, you owed the god money or something else valuable to make up for disobeying the god.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **guilt offering**. Look up guilt offering in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The ram needs to be worth a certain amount of shekels of silver. A shekel is a unit of measurement for weight. A shekel is about 11 grams.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **shekel**. Look up shekel in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

People used different standards for weights, so Yahweh says to use a certain standard—the holy or sanctuary standard. This was a shekel that weighed as much as what the priests in the holy place decided a shekel should weigh. The holy place, or **sanctuary**, was another name for the Tent of Meeting, and people used it later as a name for the temple as well. Use the same term for sanctuary, or holy place, that you used in previous passages. Sanctuary is in the Master Glossary.

The person who sinned against one of Yahweh's holy things or against someone else had to make restitution, or peace, with the person that they sinned against. The person had to make it right again with Yahweh and with the person that they stole from or harmed.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will say that the person had to make **restitution**, or **peace**. For more information about peace, refer to the Master Glossary. In this situation, peace refers to the good relationship between two people or groups when one has harmed the other. Pause this audio here.

The person who brought the guilt offering also had to pay money to make up for the holy thing that the person had sinned against. The person had to pay for the full value of the holy thing, then the person also had to pay an additional one-fifth, or 20 percent, of the cost. The person paid that money to the priest. Then the priest makes **atonement**. That means that the priest offers the ram as a sacrifice to ask Yahweh to forgive that person and restore the relationship between Yahweh and the person. With atonement, Yahweh also cleans the person from the guilt of what the person did wrong. Use the same word for atonement that you used in previous passages, and remember that atonement is in the Master Glossary.

Yahweh does not explain here how the priest is supposed to sacrifice the ram. Yahweh says Yahweh will **forgive** this person when the priest makes atonement. Use the same word for forgive that you used in previous passages. For more information on forgiveness, refer to the Master Glossary.

In the next situation, Yahweh talks about when someone accidentally sins and disobeys Yahweh's **commandments**. Use the same word or phrase for commandment that you used in previous passages. For more information on commandment, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that even if someone does something wrong without meaning to, that person is **guilty**. That means that the person is supposed to receive the consequences for what the person did. That person has a debt to Yahweh that the person needs to repay. Use the same word or phrase for guilty that you used in previous passages, and remember that guilt is in the Master Glossary.

In the last situation, Yahweh describes several ways someone might take something valuable from their neighbors illegally. When Yahweh says neighbor, Yahweh means the people who are part of the Israelite community. Sometimes this word just means people in the village, and sometimes it means the people in the country.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **neighbor**. Look up neighbor in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that anyone who does one of these things is betraying Yahweh. The first thing the person might do is lie about something a neighbor gave them as a deposit or as a pledge. A deposit is something someone gives to you to keep safe. A pledge is something someone gives you as a sign of a promise that the person will do something. A person may lie and say the neighbor did not give anything, or the person might lie and say that the neighbor gave less than the neighbor actually gave. Another way to translate “deposit or pledge” would be “something a person is supposed to take care of.”

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **deposit** and **pledge**. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also specifies that a person might just steal something from their neighbor. A person also might oppress or extort their neighbor. This means that a person might force their neighbor to give the person something that the neighbor does not want to give.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **oppress** or **extort**.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 5:14–6:7

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (688 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (937 KB)

Leviticus 6:8–18

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 6:8–18 and put it in your hearts.

Leviticus 6:8–18

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 6:8–18 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 6:8–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this next part of Leviticus, Yahweh gives Moses more instructions about the offerings so that Moses can tell his brother Aaron and Aaron's sons exactly what to do. Aaron and Aaron's sons, as well as all of Aaron's male descendants, were Yahweh's priests. The priests were in charge of giving the offerings of animals and grain to Yahweh. So that is why the priests needed more specific instructions about what to do.

In this section, Yahweh gives Moses instructions about two of the five offerings. These two offerings are the burnt offering and the grain offering. Remember that, for the burnt offering, every part of the animal except for the hide burned up. Remember that the purpose of the grain offering was to honor Yahweh as king or to ask Yahweh for a favor. Yahweh probably talks about these two offerings together because the priests were supposed to offer both a burnt offering and a grain offering, along with a wine offering, every day in the morning and at the time when the sun went down. For the people of Israel, a new day started at night, so every time the sun went down, a new day began. The priests gave these two offerings on behalf of all the Israelites at the beginning of every new day when the sun went down, as well as when the people of Israel woke up in the morning to begin their work.

Yahweh starts by telling Moses to tell Aaron and Aaron's descendants the command for the burnt offering. Yahweh's first instruction is that the priests should burn the burnt offering on the bronze altar every night until the morning. We know from other parts of the Bible that the type of animal that they offered for the daily burnt offering was a year-old lamb. So, these instructions mean that a priest would kill a year-old lamb at the time when the sun went down and place parts of the lamb on the bronze altar. The lamb would burn on the altar all night. The parts of the animal needed to stay on the altar until morning, and the fire on the bronze altar could not go out. The fire had to continually burn from evening until morning.

After the animal had burned up so that all that was left were ashes, the priest needed to put on linen clothes. Linen was a kind of fabric that people made from the flax plant. Linen was lightweight and expensive, so in many countries at this time, usually only kings and wealthy people wore linen. Since the priests were servants of Yahweh, who was both God and king over the people of Israel, people made the priest's uniform out of linen fabric for the priest to wear when the priest did Yahweh's work.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kind of fabric do different people wear? What kind of fabric do kings, chiefs, and government officials wear? What do people think when people see different kinds of fabric? Pause this audio here.

There were two parts to the linen clothes that the priest needed to wear. First were linen undergarments, and second was a linen tunic that went over the undergarments. No one knows exactly what this clothing looked like, but the tunic was probably long enough to reach the priest's ankles.

Stop here and look at pictures of what the priest's tunic and undergarments might have looked like as a group. Pause this audio here.

When the priest got dressed in the linen clothes, the priest probably put the clothes on in a way so that the priest was never fully without clothes, since Yahweh told the people of Israel that no one could be without clothing

near Yahweh's altar. This rule was probably because many other people groups at this time worshiped their gods and goddesses by having sex in the holy area. But Yahweh repeatedly told the people of Israel and the priests not to worship Yahweh that way. So, to avoid being naked near the bronze altar, the priest probably put the linen clothes on in a way that avoided doing that.

After the priest dressed in the linen clothes, the priest was supposed to gather together the ashes from the burnt offering that had been burning all night, and move the ashes from the top of the altar to the side of the altar. The side of the altar was the east side, which is the direction the sun rises in the morning.

Stop here and look at a picture of the bronze altar as a group. Notice where the priest would have put the ashes. Pause this audio here.

After that, the priest needed to take off the linen clothes and put on other clothes. Then, the priest needed to carry the ashes to a ceremonially clean place outside the area where the people of Israel were camping. Nobody knows if there was one clean place that people brought the ashes to, or if people just brought the ashes to any ritually clean place outside of the Israelites' camp.

Stop here and discuss as a group where people in your community might take ashes or other leftovers from a fire outside of people's living spaces. Pause this audio here.

The priests must also keep the fire on the altar burning all day. So, the priest needed to put wood on the fire on the bronze altar every morning. Then the priest would offer another burnt offering on the altar. And the priest would also burn up the fat from the fellowship, or peace, offering as incense. The people of Israel thought that the smell from sacrifices smelled good like incense and that it was one way to honor Yahweh and make Yahweh happy.

Once again, Yahweh made sure to tell Moses to tell the priests that the fire on the altar had to always be burning.

After Yahweh gave Moses the instructions for the daily burnt offering, Yahweh gave Moses the instructions for the grain offering. In general, the purpose of the grain offering was probably to honor Yahweh as king or to ask Yahweh for a favor. In this part, Yahweh focuses on the instructions for eating the grain offering.

The priests were supposed to bring the offering of grain before Yahweh to the bronze altar. Then the priest needed to take a handful of the good-quality flour and oil, along with all of the frankincense that was on top of the mixture of flour and oil. That is the memorial portion. The priest would then burn the memorial portion on the bronze altar, and it would smell good to Yahweh.

Whatever flour and oil were left belonged to any of Aaron's male descendants. Not all of Aaron's descendants could be priests. For example, if one of Aaron's descendants was lame, that man could not be a priest. But that man could still eat the grain offering as long as the man obeyed the requirements for eating it.

Any of Aaron's descendants who ate the grain offering needed to eat it without adding leaven or yeast. Even if the descendants baked the flour, the descendants had to bake the flour without leaven or yeast. And the descendants also needed to eat the grain offering in the holy place of the courtyard that surrounded the Tent of Meeting. This food was a gift from Yahweh to Yahweh's priests. The grain offering was most holy, like the other fire offerings, which were the purification offerings and guilt offerings.

This grain offering was Aaron's descendants' portion of Yahweh's fire gifts, or offerings, throughout every generation forever. And, like in the purification and guilt offerings, anyone and anything that touched these offerings would become holy. If someone or something was holy, then that meant that the person or thing belonged to Yahweh. For people, that meant that there were more strict rules for what that person did. It also meant that only Yahweh could punish that person, so everyone else needed to treat that person with respect and care because that person belonged to Yahweh. For things, that meant that people could not use the things for everyday use since those things belonged to Yahweh. So people needed to treat Yahweh's things with more respect and care than they would treat other things. It is not always a good thing for everything that touches the offering to become holy because it is dangerous when something dirty or common touches something that is holy. The only people who should touch these offerings are the people Yahweh says should touch the offerings.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your culture, what happens to a person if the person touches something that they should not touch because it is very special or dedicated to a divine being?

Leviticus 6:8–18

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 6:8–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses the instructions for the burnt offering that the priests were supposed to offer every morning and every evening on behalf of the people of Israel.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Moses the instructions for the grain offering that the priests were supposed to offer to honor Yahweh as king and to ask Yahweh for favors. This scene specifically focuses on who is allowed to eat the grain offering and all of the requirements for eating it.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron and Aaron's descendants, who are the priests
- Any of Aaron's male descendants, including the ones who are not priests
- And a person who touches the grain offering

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh talks about the offerings priests will burn on the bronze altar in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting, which is the sacred place. The priests will also take ashes to a clean place outside of the Israelites' camp.

The first scene begins when Yahweh tells Moses to give Aaron and Aaron's descendants the command to obey the instructions. The instructions in the first scene are about the burnt offerings that the priests burn every day. The instructions start and say that the burnt offering has to burn on the altar all night. This means that the parts of the animal needed to stay on the altar until morning and that the fire itself had to keep burning.

Stop here and, as an activity, give instructions for how to do something that needs to happen every day. How does the storyteller make it clear that this needs to happen every day? How does the storyteller make it clear what time of day things happened? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh focuses on what the priest needed to do in the morning. First, the priest needed to put on a linen tunic and linen undergarments. Next, the priest needed to take the ashes that were on the bronze altar and put the ashes next to the altar on the side of the altar where the sun rises in the morning. After that, the priest needed to take the linen clothes off and put other clothes on. Finally, the priest needed to take the ashes outside the area where everyone was camping and put the ashes in a clean place.

Then Yahweh reminds the priests that the fire on the bronze altar must not go out. This means that the fire has to stay burning all night and all day.

So, every morning after the priest cleans the ashes off the bronze altar, a priest needs to add wood to the bronze altar. The priest needs to add this wood every morning. After the priest puts the wood on the bronze altar, the priest needs to put the morning burnt offering on the wood, as well as the fat from the peace, or fellowship, offerings.

Once again, Yahweh reminds the priests that the fire on the bronze altar must not go out. The fire has to stay burning on the bronze altar, all day and all night. Yahweh gives these instructions about the fire not going out three times during this scene. This shows how important these instructions are.

Stop here and, as an activity, give instructions about how to do something important. How does the storyteller emphasize the important part of the instructions? Pause this audio here.

The instructions in the second scene are about the grain offering. The focus of this scene is on what priests needed to burn on the bronze altar and what Yahweh allowed the priests to eat. In this scene, the narrator gives more instructions about eating part of the grain offering.

To begin, the priests were supposed to bring the offering of grain before Yahweh to the bronze altar. Then a priest needed to take a handful of good-quality flour and oil, along with all of the frankincense that was on top of the mixture of grain and oil. That was the memorial portion. The priest would then burn the memorial portion on the bronze altar, and the memorial portion would smell good to Yahweh.

Any of Aaron's male descendants were allowed to eat whatever was left over from the good quality flour and oil. The male descendants would probably use the flour and oil to make bread. However, there were two main instructions for how the descendants could eat it. No one may add yeast or leaven. And the male descendants needed to eat the food in the sacred place of the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh says twice that no one may add yeast to the flour.

The grain offering was a gift from Yahweh to Yahweh's priests and was most holy. Like the purification offerings and guilt offerings, the grain offering was very holy. Again, Yahweh says that any male descendant of Aaron could eat the grain offering. The offering was Aaron's male descendants' portion of Yahweh's fire gifts throughout every generation forever.

The instructions end when they say that anyone and anything that touched these offerings would become holy. Remember that in this case, the idea of holy means that the person or thing now belongs to Yahweh, and people cannot use it for anything ordinary.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 6:8–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron and Aaron's descendants, who are the priests
- Any of Aaron's male descendants, including the ones who are not priests
- And a person who touches the grain offering

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In scene one, Yahweh tells Moses to give Aaron and his descendants the command to obey these instructions. The instructions in the first scene are about the burnt offerings that the priests were supposed to offer every day. The instructions start by saying that the burnt offering had to burn on the altar all night. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I need to make sure there is enough wood on the altar so that the fire does not go out; or
- I will take turns with the other priests so that someone is always awake to keep the fire going; or
- I want to honor Yahweh by making sure the fire does not go out.

Continue the drama. In the morning, the priest needed to put on a linen tunic and linen undergarments. Then, the priest needed to take the ashes that were on the bronze altar and put the ashes next to the altar on the side of the altar that faces where the sun rises in the morning. After that, the priest needed to take the linen clothes off and put other clothes on. Finally, the priest needed to take the ashes outside the area where everyone was camping and put the ashes in a clean place.

Yahweh then reminds the priests that the fire on the bronze altar must not go out. The fire has to stay burning all night and all day.

Every morning, after the priest cleaned the ashes off the bronze altar, the priest needed to add wood to the bronze altar. Then the priest needed to put the burnt offering on the wood, as well as the fat from the peace offerings. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad I get to be the one to offer the burnt offering to Yahweh today; or
- I need to make sure to add enough wood so that the fire keeps burning all day.

Continue the drama. Once again, Yahweh reminds the priests that the fire on the bronze altar must not go out. The fire has to stay burning on the bronze altar, all day and all night.

In scene two, Yahweh gives the instructions for the grain offering. The priests needed to bring the offering of grain before Yahweh to the bronze altar. Then the priest needed to take a handful of good-quality flour and oil, along with all of the frankincense that was on top of the mixture of grain and oil. That is the memorial portion. The priest would then burn the memorial portion on the bronze altar, and it would smell good to Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so glad my people want to honor me as their king; or
- I love my people; or
- This smells good.

Continue the drama. Yahweh allowed any of Aaron's male descendants to eat whatever was left over from the good quality flour and oil. However, the descendants must not add yeast or leaven, even if the men baked it. Also, the descendants needed to eat what was left over from the grain offering in the sacred place of the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting.

The grain offering was a gift from Yahweh to Yahweh's priests and was very holy, like the purification offering and the guilt offering. The grain offering was Aaron's descendants' portion of Yahweh's fire offerings throughout every generation forever.

The instructions end when they say that anyone and anything that touched these offerings would become holy.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 6:8–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

This section starts when **Yahweh** tells Moses to command Aaron and Aaron's descendants. This word refers to the way someone with authority tells someone else what to do. Pick a word that emphasizes that Yahweh has authority to tell Aaron and Aaron's descendants what to do. Also, look up the name Yahweh in the Master Glossary. Translate this name the same way as you translated it previously.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **command**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, decide if the same word is appropriate to use here. Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 6:8–18

Yahweh tells Moses to give Aaron and Aaron's descendants the command to follow the instructions, or law, for the burnt offering. This word for "instructions" refers to wisdom, teaching, or instructions that someone who is older and wiser tells someone who is younger. Parents give instructions to their children, elders give instructions to people who are younger, and Yahweh gives instructions to Yahweh's people. Pick a word that gives the idea of teaching and wisdom that people have to listen to and obey.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **law**, or instructions. Refer to law in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, decide if the same word is appropriate to use here. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh's first instruction is that the **burnt offering** has to burn on the altar all night. Use the same word or phrase for burnt offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

In the morning, the priest needs to put on linen clothes. Linen is a kind of fabric that people make from a flax plant. Linen was lightweight and expensive, so in many countries at this time, only kings, wealthy people, and special people like priests would usually wear this kind of linen. Since the priests were servants of Yahweh, who was both God and king over the people of Israel, Yahweh said to make the priest's uniform out of linen fabric for the priest to wear when the priest did Yahweh's work.

Stop here and look at a picture of linen fabric as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **linen**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The two parts are a linen tunic and linen undergarments. The linen tunic would cover the priest's chest, shoulders, stomach, and legs, probably down to the ankles. The priest would wear the undergarments underneath the tunic around his waist.

Stop here and look at a possible picture of the tunic and undergarments as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **tunic** and **undergarments**. Refer to tunic in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

After the priest dressed in the linen clothes, the priest needed to take the ashes that were on the bronze **altar** and put the ashes next to the altar on the east side of the altar. The east side was the side that faces where the sun rises in the morning. Use the same word or phrase for east as you used in previous passages. Look up altar in the Master Glossary for more information. Translate altar the same way that you did in previous passages.

After that, the **priest** needed to take the linen clothes off and put other clothes on. Finally, the priest needed to take the ashes outside the area where everyone was camping to a ritually **clean** place. Use the same word or phrase for priest and clean as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest or clean, refer to the Master Glossary.

The instructions then remind the priests that the fire on the bronze altar must not go out. The fire had to stay burning all night and all day.

After the priest cleaned the ashes off the bronze altar, the priest needed to add wood to the bronze altar. This needed to happen every morning. After the priest put the wood on the bronze altar, the priest needed to put the burnt offering on it, as well as the fat from the **peace or fellowship offerings**. Use the same word or phrase for peace or fellowship offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on fellowship offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Once again, the instructions remind the priests that the fire on the bronze altar must not go out. The fire had to stay burning on the bronze altar, all day and all night.

Once Yahweh finished giving the instructions for the burnt offering, Yahweh gave the instructions, or law, for the **grain offering** to honor Yahweh as king or to ask Yahweh for a favor. Use the same word or phrase for grain offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on grain offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Leviticus 6:8–18

The priest needed to bring the offering of grain before Yahweh to the bronze altar. Then the priest needed to take a handful of **good-quality flour** and **oil**, along with all of the **frankincense** that was on top of the mixture of grain and oil. Use the same words or phrases for good-quality flour, oil, and frankincense as you used in previous passages.

That was called the **memorial portion**. Use the same word or phrase for memorial portion as you used in previous passages, and refer to memorial portion in the Master Glossary for more information.

The priest would then burn the memorial portion on the bronze altar as **incense** that would **smell good** to Yahweh. Use the same words or phrases for incense and for a good smell as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh allowed any of Aaron's male descendants to eat whatever was left over from the fine flour and oil. However, the men must not add **yeast** or **leaven**, even if the men baked it. Yeast and leaven are two different ways to describe something that people add to dough to help the dough become fluffier after people bake the dough. Use the same word or phrase for yeast or leaven as you used in previous passages.

Also, the men needed to eat what was left over from the grain offering in the sacred, or holy, place of the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. The word "sacred," or "holy," refers to things that belong to a god. Since the people of Israel agreed that Yahweh would be their only God, the word "holy" here refers to the place that was given to Yahweh. In particular, this section is talking about the tent and courtyard that belonged to Yahweh. When something was holy, people needed to be careful and treat it with extra respect because it belonged to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **sacred**. Look up **holy** in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The grain offering was a gift from Yahweh to Yahweh's priests and was **most holy**. This means that people completely dedicated it to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for most holy as you used in previous passages.

The grain offering, the purification offering, and the guilt offering were all more holy than the other fire gifts. Use the same words or phrases for **purification offering** and **guilt offering** as you used in previous passages. For more information on sin or purification offering and guilt offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh gave all three of those offerings to Aaron's male sons, or descendants, to eat. This is a **statute** for **generations** to come. Use the same words or phrases for statute and generations as you have used previously, and refer to statute and generation in the Master Glossary for more information. A statute is an instruction especially for the place of worship. A person's descendants are his children, grandchildren, and all future generations from the same family line. Sometimes, storytellers will use the word for "son" or a person's male child to talk about a descendant.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **descendant**. If you have translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word here. Refer to descendant in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

This was their **portion** of Yahweh's **fire offerings** throughout every generation. Use the same word or phrase for fire offerings as you have used previously, and refer to fire offerings in the Master Glossary for more information.

In the original language, this word for "portion" refers to a boundary. It can refer to a boundary line between one person's land and another person's land. It can refer to the boundaries, or rules, of what people are allowed to do and not allowed to do. It can also refer to the boundary that marks what one person's portion is. In this section, you need to decide if the phrase "this boundary for all generations forever" means "this is the rule that priests get to eat this part of the offering" or "this part of the offering is the priests' portion." Then, translate accordingly.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **portion**. If you have already translated this idea in another book of the Bible, decide if the same word is appropriate to use here. Pause this audio here.

The instructions end when they say that anyone and anything that touched these offerings would become holy. In this situation, it is not a good thing for everything that touches the offering to become holy because it is dangerous when something dirty or common touches something that is holy.

Stop here and discuss as a group whether the word or phrase you use for **holy** or sacred can work for a situation that is not good. If not, discuss how you can communicate that these things become sacred, but that this is a dangerous situation.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 6:8–18

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (668 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (5.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (866 KB)

Leviticus 6:19–23

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 6:19–23 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 6:19–23 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 6:19–23

6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 6:19–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller describes more of the laws that Yahweh gave the Israelites through Moses so that the Israelites could live in good relationship with Yahweh. In the group of laws we heard previously, Yahweh told the priests how the priests should eat or deal with the offerings Yahweh described in the first part of the book of Leviticus after the priests sacrificed the offerings. Earlier, Yahweh told Moses to instruct Aaron and the other priests about how to clean up after the burnt offering and how to eat the grain offering. In this passage, Yahweh tells Moses to instruct Aaron and Aaron's descendants how to offer grain when Yahweh anoints, or chooses, someone to be the next high priest.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What kinds of ceremonies or rituals do people in your culture do when someone becomes a leader? This may be a religious leader, a community leader, or some other kind of leader. Pause this audio here.

Each time a priest became the new high priest, a leader anointed the new high priest with oil. This represented how Yahweh set the priest apart as dedicated to Yahweh and how Yahweh chose this priest as the religious leader of Israel. Exodus 29 and Leviticus 8 both describe this process with more details. When a priest became the high priest, the leader representing Yahweh poured special sacred oil on the new high priest's head.

Stop here and listen to a recording of your translation of Exodus 29, if you have already translated it. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh has just given instructions for how the priests should eat their share of the grain offering. However, the new high priest must also bring a grain offering to Yahweh on the day that Yahweh anoints the new high priest, and the new high priest may not eat any of this special grain offering. In this passage, Yahweh tells Moses what must happen on the day that Yahweh chooses a new high priest. Aaron or any of Aaron's descendants who becomes the high priest should bring flour. Most likely, this flour would have been the ground-up grain or seed of the wheat or barley plant.

Stop here and look at a picture of wheat as a group. Then look at a picture of barley as a group. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh instructed the new high priest to bring one-tenth of an ephah of the flour and to split it in half. An ephah is a unit of measurement that the ancient Israelites used to measure the volume of dry things like grain or flour. An ephah was about 2 liters.

Stop here and find something that is around 2 liters. It can be dry or liquid. Pause this audio here.

The priest would offer one-half of this amount of flour to Yahweh in the morning, and the priest would offer the other half of this amount of flour to Yahweh in the evening. To prepare the flour, the priest would mix the flour with olive oil and use a griddle to cook the dough over a fire. A griddle is a large, flat piece of pottery or metal that people prop up on stones over a fire underneath it. The priest would cook the dough on top of the griddle to make bread.

Stop here and look at a picture of olives and olive oil as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: If people in your culture cook bread, what is the process people use to make bread? If people in your culture do not make bread, what is the process people use to make any food that involves mixing ingredients together to make a dough or paste and then cooking the dough? Pause this audio here.

The new high priest would then bring the bread and offer it to Yahweh in several pieces. It is possible that the priest had baked the bread in multiple pieces and soaked the baked bread in oil. Or the priest had thoroughly mixed the flour and oil together, baked the dough, and then broken the bread into pieces. Either way, the priest would offer the bread to Yahweh by burning it completely on Yahweh's altar. The smoke from the burning bread would make a good smell to please and honor Yahweh.

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Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When someone in your culture becomes a religious leader, does the leader bring offerings to a deity or spirit? If yes, what kinds of offerings does the leader bring? How is that similar to or different from the Israelite high priest who offers bread to please and honor Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells Moses that this offering must happen every time a priest, who must be one of Aaron's descendants, becomes the new high priest. Each time this happens, the priest must completely burn up the bread. Normally, Aaron's male descendants can eat the rest of a grain offering. But no one can eat this first grain offering that the new high priest gives. The new high priest must completely burn this grain offering to represent that this offering belongs completely to Yahweh.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 6:19–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses how Aaron should prepare bread from flour and oil and offer it to Yahweh on the day when Aaron becomes the high priest.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Moses that each of Aaron's descendants who becomes the high priest after Aaron must offer the same special grain offering Aaron did. Yahweh also tells Moses that the priests cannot eat this offering.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron, the first high priest at the time Yahweh gave these instructions to Moses
- And Aaron's descendants who will become the high priest after Aaron dies

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this passage, Yahweh is still giving Moses instructions while Moses and the Israelites are camped at Mount Sinai. You will remember that in the previous passage, Yahweh gave Moses instructions for what the priests should do for the normal grain offering. In scene one of this passage, Yahweh gives Moses instructions for what Aaron and each of Aaron's descendants who become the high priest after Aaron must do when Yahweh anoints that person as the new high priest. These instructions are talking about things that have not actually happened yet, but that will happen in the future every time the Israelites get a new high priest.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: Talk about what someone must do to have a wedding or get married in your culture. Listen for words that show that this is what anyone who wants to have a wedding or get married in the future must do. Pause this audio here.

When a leader anoints Aaron or one of Aaron's descendants, which represents that Yahweh chooses that man as the new high priest, Aaron or that descendant must bring an offering to Yahweh. The new high priest will measure out the right amount of flour and divide it in half. On that day, once in the morning and once in the evening, when the other priests give the regular daily offerings, the new high priest will make bread with that flour. To make the bread, the new high priest will mix the flour with olive oil and cook the dough on a griddle over a fire. The new high priest will then break the bread into pieces and offer it to Yahweh by burning it completely on the bronze altar in front of the Tent of Meeting.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: If people in your culture give offerings to gods or spirits, what do people do when they offer things to the gods or spirits? Pause this audio here.

In scene two of this passage, Yahweh tells Moses that each descendant of Aaron who becomes the high priest in the future must offer the same bread offering, because this is a permanent statute, or rule. The Israelite priests

Leviticus 6:19–23

must follow this statute forever, so each new high priest must follow these instructions when they become the high priest. Yahweh also reminds Moses that because the new high priest offers all of the bread in this offering to Yahweh by burning the bread, the priests must not eat any of the offering. The new high priest is supposed to burn up all of the offering to please and honor Yahweh.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 6:19–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron, the first high priest at the time Yahweh gave these instructions to Moses
- And Aaron's descendants who will become the high priest after Aaron dies

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Yahweh gives Moses instructions for what Aaron and Aaron's descendants should do when Aaron or Aaron's descendant becomes the high priest. Have a person playing Aaron act out that Aaron follows Yahweh's instructions.

Yahweh says that the new high priest, Aaron, should get one-tenth of an ephah of flour and divide the flour in half. Aaron should then mix the flour with oil and use a griddle to bake the dough over a fire to make bread. Aaron should then break the bread into pieces and offer the pieces to Yahweh by burning all of the bread at the Tent of Meeting. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am excited to give this offering to Yahweh and become the high priest; or
- I am nervous to make this offering to Yahweh since I have dishonored Yahweh before; or
- I am honored that Yahweh has chosen me as the new high priest to help the Israelites worship Yahweh correctly.

Continue the drama. Now, pretend that Aaron has died, and one of Aaron's descendants will become the new high priest. This descendant must follow the same instructions Yahweh gave Moses for Aaron. Have a person who plays Aaron's descendant act out how that descendant follows Yahweh's instructions.

Yahweh says that the new high priest, Aaron's descendant, should get one-tenth of an ephah of flour and divide it in half. This descendant should then mix the flour with oil and use a griddle to bake the dough over a fire to make bread. This descendant should then break the bread into pieces and offer the pieces to Yahweh by burning all of the bread on the altar in front of the Tent of Meeting. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron's descendant, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

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- I am excited to start my new role as high priest; or
- I am nervous about whether I will perform this ritual offering correctly; or
- I am honored that Yahweh chose me for the role of high priest, just like Yahweh chose so many of my ancestors.

Continue the drama. Now Yahweh tells Moses that the high priest must completely burn up this offering. The priests must not eat any part of this offering.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 6:19–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this section, **Yahweh** gives Moses instructions for the special **offering**, called a grain offering, that each new high priest was supposed to make on the day someone anointed the new high priest. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and offering as you used in previous passages, and refer to Yahweh and offering in the Master Glossary for more information.

In the original language, people use the same word for the grain offering in Leviticus 2 and for this special grain offering for the new high priest in this passage. However, the way the priest must make the offering in this passage is a little different.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for this special **grain offering**. For more information on grain offering, refer to the Master Glossary. Discuss whether you should use the same word or phrase in your language for the grain offering in Leviticus 2 and the offering in this passage. Pause this audio here.

Aaron and each one of Aaron's **sons**, or **descendants**, who become the high priest later, make this grain offering on the day that Yahweh sets apart, or **anoints** each one to be the new high priest. Remember that Aaron's sons or descendants here are all of Aaron's male children, grandchildren, and future generations. Use the same words for sons or descendants and anoint that you used previously. For more information on descendants and anointing with oil, refer to the Master Glossary.

Each time Yahweh anoints a new high priest, that high priest must bring one-tenth of an **ephah** of flour and divide it in half. Flour is the ground-up seeds of a grass plant. The Israelites would have probably ground up the seeds of a wheat or barley plant, specifically. Use the same word or phrase for flour as you used in previous passages. Remember that an ephah is an amount of flour that would take up around the same amount of space as about 2 liters or 3 pints. Use the same word or phrase for one-tenth of an ephah as you used in previous passages, such as Leviticus 5:11. For more information on ephah, see the Master Glossary.

In the morning of the day Yahweh anoints the new high priest, and again in the evening of that day, the new high priest must take half of the flour and mix it with **olive oil** to make a dough. Use the same word or phrase for olive oil as you used in previous passages. Then the new high priest must cook the dough on a **griddle**, which is a large flat piece of pottery or metal that people propped up on stones over a fire. Use the same word or phrase for griddle as you used in previous passages, such as Leviticus 2:5.

Stop here and look at a picture of olive oil as a group. Pause this audio here.

The new high priest must then break this bread into pieces and offer the bread to Yahweh by burning the bread on Yahweh's altar. The smoke from the burning bread would make a **good smell** to honor and please Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase to talk about this good smell to Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh then tells Moses that each one of Aaron's descendants who becomes the high priest in the future must make the same special grain offering on the day that Yahweh anoints that man as the new high priest, because this is a permanent **statute** that must happen forever. Use the same word or phrase for "permanent statute" that you used in previous passages. For more information on statute, see the Master Glossary.

In this passage, Yahweh calls the new high **priest** the anointed priest, because Yahweh chose this priest and set the priest apart from the rest of the priests as the high priest. This offering belongs completely to Yahweh, so the high priest must burn up the offering entirely. The priests cannot eat the offering. Use the same word for

priest, or anointed priest, as you have used previously. For more information about priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 6:19–23

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (600 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (870 KB)

Leviticus 6:24–30

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 6:24–30 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 6:24–30 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 6:24–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the first few passages in Leviticus, Yahweh gave instructions to Moses about how to offer different types of offerings so that the Israelite people could live in good relationship with Yahweh. In the next section of Leviticus, which includes this passage, Yahweh tells the priests how people should eat or deal with those offerings after the priests sacrifice the offerings.

In the last passage, Yahweh told Moses to instruct Aaron and Aaron's descendants how to offer grain when Yahweh anoints, or chooses, someone to be the next high priest. Now, in this passage, Yahweh is no longer talking about the grain offering. Yahweh gives more instructions to Moses about what the priests are supposed to do after they offer the sin or purification offering. Yahweh previously told Moses about the purification offering in Leviticus 4.

Stop here and listen to your translation of Leviticus 4:1–35 as needed. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells Moses to give Aaron and Aaron's descendants, who will eventually become priests, more instructions, or further rules to follow to do the purification offering properly. Yahweh calls this the "law" about the purification offering. In the Old Testament, a law usually refers to a set of several rules or instructions to follow, so all the instructions in this passage are included in the law about the purification offering.

The first instruction is a reminder that the priests must kill the animal for the purification offering at the same place a priest kills the animal for the burnt offering. In this passage, Yahweh only talks about purification offerings that the priests make when leaders and individual members of the community accidentally sin against Yahweh and become ritually dirty. The priests only kill goats and sheep for these types of purification offerings, so the priests would kill these animals in the same place where the priests would kill the goats and sheep for the burnt offering.

Stop here and look at a picture of goats and sheep as a group. Pause this audio here.

The priests would kill these goats and sheep on the north side of the bronze altar, in Yahweh's presence. The priests did these sacrifices near the Tent of Meeting, where Yahweh lived among Yahweh's people. The bronze altar was right inside the entrance of the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. Since the entrance of the courtyard for the Tent of Meeting was on the east side of the courtyard, someone would see the north side of the altar on their right when they entered the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting.

Stop here and look at a diagram of the Tent of Meeting as a group. Find where the bronze altar is. Then find where the north side of the altar is. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also tells Moses that this offering is most holy or most sacred. Yahweh next tells Moses that the priest who offers the sheep or goat to Yahweh may eat the sheep or goat. When a priest offers a purification offering for a leader or for an individual person who is not a priest, the priest only pours out the animal's blood and burns the animal's fat on the altar to honor Yahweh. The priest does not burn the meat, so the meat is available for someone to eat. Yahweh allows the priests to eat that meat, but Yahweh tells Moses that the priests must eat the meat in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. The priests cannot eat the meat in the priests' homes or elsewhere because only the Tent of Meeting is holy and set apart to be a special place where Yahweh is.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When people in your culture give a sacrifice or offering to a god or spirit, what happens to the things the people have given after the people finish making the sacrifice or giving the offering? Pause this audio here.

This purification offering is so sacred, or holy, that anything and anyone the meat and blood touch will become holy, or special to Yahweh. However, it is bad and dangerous for things that are dirty to come into contact with things that are holy. This is because holy things are things connected with Yahweh, who is very powerful. Only clean things and people could interact with the most sacred things. If the meat and blood touched something or someone that was not clean or holy, it meant that no one could use that thing or person for ordinary things again. That thing or person now belonged completely to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what is holy? What are the rules for when people interact with what is holy? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh then tells Moses to instruct Aaron and the priests on what to do about things that have touched the holy sacrifice, so that dirty things do not keep touching holy things. The priests must wash any clothes that blood from the sacrifice has splashed on or stained. The priests must wash these clothes in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. The priests cannot wash these dirty clothes away from the Tent of Meeting because the priest cannot take the dangerous combination of sacred, or holy, things and dirty things away from the holy place and near the rest of the people.

A priest also has to do something about the pot that the priest cooks the sacrifice in, since the pot has touched the sacred, or holy, meat. If the priest cooks the meat in a bronze pot, which is a mixture of copper and tin metals, the priest must clean the metal pot. The priest does this by scouring the pot, which means scrubbing the pot with something rough like sand or ash, and then washing the pot with water. This was what the priest would normally do, since the pots that the priests were supposed to use in the sacrifices were bronze metal pots. However, if the priest cooks the meat in a clay pot, the priest cannot clean the pot and use the pot again; the priest must break the pot to destroy it. This is because once something has stopped being an everyday object and has become a sacred object, it is dangerous to use the object for everyday activities.

Stop here and look at a picture of a bronze pot and a clay pot. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Can people in your culture take things that people have used to worship deities or spirits and then use those things for everyday activities? Why or why not? Pause this audio here.

Remember that the priest who killed the animal for the purification offering can eat the meat from the offering. But now, Yahweh explains that this priest is not the only one who can eat that meat. Any priest, and any man or boy who is descended from a priest, may eat the meat. However, the meat from the purification offering is most holy, so these men and boys can only eat the meat in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting, which is a holy space.

So far, Yahweh has only told Moses what the priests should do about purification offerings that the priests make for the leaders and individual members of the community. Yahweh gives Moses rules for how the priests have to eat the meat and deal with the pots they cooked the meat in, because meat is leftover after these purification offerings.

The rules were different when the priests made the purification offering for the whole community of Israel or the high priest who sinned. You will remember that as part of those purification offerings, the high priest brought some of the blood into the Tent of Meeting to make atonement, or make amends with Yahweh for what the high priest or the whole community had done.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: If someone in your culture betrays or offends a deity or spirit, how can that person make amends? How is this different from, or similar to, the ways Yahweh told Moses the high priest could make amends to Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

To make atonement, or make amends, the high priest would go into the Tent of Meeting, which was more holy than anywhere else. The high priest would go to the curtain that separated the part of the tent where the ark of the covenant was, where Yahweh's presence was, from the rest of the tent. The high priest would then sprinkle the blood from the purification offering in front of the curtain that separated the high priest from the place where Yahweh was present. The priests could not eat the meat from these types of purification offerings because the high priest had to take the rest of the offering outside the camp and completely burn it up.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 6:24–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh gives Moses instructions for how Aaron and Aaron's descendants should sacrifice and eat the sin or purification offering.

In the second scene: Yahweh gives Moses instructions about what the priests should do if the blood from the purification offering touches something.

In the third scene: Yahweh gives Moses instructions about who may eat the purification offering and which purification offerings those people may eat.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- Aaron's descendants who become priests
- And Aaron's male descendants, including those who are not priests

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this passage, Yahweh continues to give Moses instructions while Moses and the Israelites are camped at Mount Sinai. We do not know where Moses is, but Moses may be in the Tent of Meeting, or on Mount Sinai, while Yahweh gives Moses these instructions. You will remember that in the previous passage, Yahweh gave Moses instructions for what Aaron and each of Aaron's descendants who become the high priest after Aaron must do when Yahweh anoints that person as the new high priest. You will also remember that earlier in the book of Leviticus, in chapter 4, Yahweh gave Moses many instructions about how the priests should offer the purification offering.

In scene one of this passage, Yahweh now gives Moses further instructions or laws to follow for what Aaron and Aaron's descendants who become priests must do when the priests sacrifice the purification offering. First, the priest must sacrifice the sin or purification offering in the same place that the priests sacrifice the burnt offering. This is on the north side of the bronze altar in the Tent of Meeting. Second, the priest who sacrifices the animal for the purification offering may eat the meat from the offering, but that priest must eat the meat in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. This is because the purification offering is very holy, so the priests must eat the offering in a very holy place.

Stop here and discuss these questions as a group: What kinds of places are holy, or sacred, in your culture? What things should people do in a holy place? What kinds of things should people not do in a holy place? Pay attention to the words and phrases you use to describe this holy place. Pause this audio here.

The sin or purification offering is so holy that ritually or spiritually dirty things should not touch it. This is why in scene two of this passage, Yahweh gives Moses instructions for what the priests should do if blood from the purification offering touches things. If the blood from the animal gets on clothing, the priests have to wash the clothing in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. The priest also has to clean the pot that the priest uses to cook the meat from the purification offering, because blood has touched the pot. If the pot is a bronze metal pot, the priest must scrub the pot with something rough and then wash the pot with water to clean the pot. The priest must do this in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. If the pot is a clay pot, the priest must not clean the pot and then use the pot for non-holy purposes. Instead, the priest must destroy the clay pot.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do people in your culture do to wash cooking pots? Are there any differences from how the priests wash the bronze pots in this passage? Pause this audio here.

In scene three of this passage, Yahweh explains to Moses who may eat the meat from the purification offering, and what kind of purification offering those people may eat. First, Yahweh explains that it is not just the priest who sacrificed the animal for the purification offering who may eat the meat from the purification offering. Any male person in a priest's family may eat the meat. So all of Aaron's male descendants may eat meat from purification offerings, even if those descendants are not priests themselves. Second, Yahweh explains that no one may eat meat from a purification offering where the high priest brings the blood into the Tent of Meeting. Before, in Leviticus 4, when Yahweh first explained how the priests should sacrifice the purification offering, Yahweh explained when the high priest should bring the blood into the Tent of Meeting. When the high priest

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has sinned or when the whole community has sinned, the high priest brings the blood into the tent. The priests must not eat the meat from this kind of purification offering. However, when anyone else has sinned, the priest does not bring the blood into the tent, and any male descendant of Aaron may eat the offering.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In scene one, Yahweh told Moses that the priest who sacrificed the animal for the purification offering could eat the meat from the offering. In this scene, Yahweh explains to Moses that any male person in a priest's family can eat the offering. What are some things in your culture that only leaders can do? Can family members of those leaders do any of those things because those people are related to the leader? How do you talk about those family members? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 6:24–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- Aaron's descendants who become priests
- And Aaron's male descendants, including those who are not priests

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Yahweh gives Moses instructions for what Aaron and Aaron's descendants should do when the priests sacrifice the animal for the sin or purification offering. Have a person who plays Aaron act out how Aaron follows Yahweh's instructions.

Yahweh says that Aaron should sacrifice the animal for the purification offering at the same place that Aaron would sacrifice the animal for the burnt offering. Aaron may then eat the meat leftover from the purification offering. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am honored that I am able to eat the meat from this sacred offering; or
- I am nervous about eating this meat because this meat is very sacred; or
- I am relieved that this purification offering has made amends to Yahweh for someone's sin, so I am glad to eat the meat from this offering.

Continue the drama. Now, pretend that Aaron has died and one of Aaron's descendants is a priest. This priest must follow the same instructions Yahweh gave Moses. Have a person who plays Aaron's descendant act out how that descendant follows Yahweh's instructions.

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Next, Yahweh gives Moses instructions about what the priest should do if the blood from the purification offering touches something. Have the people who play Aaron and Aaron's descendants act out the priest's role. First, blood from the purification offering gets on some clothes. Have the priest characters act out washing the clothes in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. Then, Yahweh gives Moses instructions about what the priest should do with the pot the priest used to cook the meat from the purification offering. Have one of the priests act out cooking the meat in a bronze pot. Have one of the priests act out cooking the meat in a clay pot. The priest who cooks the meat in the bronze pot must clean the pot by rubbing the pot with sand or something else rough and then washing the pot with water. The priest who cooks the meat in the clay pot must break the clay pot. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priest with the bronze pot, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am tired because cleaning the bronze pot was a lot of work; or
- I am proud that I followed Yahweh's instructions to clean the bronze pot; or
- I am relieved that the pot is clean so that nothing dirty touches what is sacred.

Ask the person playing the priest with the clay pot, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am disappointed that I had to destroy the pot; or
- I am proud that I followed Yahweh's instructions to break the clay pot; or
- I am relieved that I destroyed the pot so that nothing dirty touches what is sacred.

Continue the drama. Finally, Yahweh tells Moses that any male member of a priest's family can eat the meat from the purification offering. Have the people playing Aaron, Aaron's descendants who become priests, and Aaron's male descendants who are not priests, act out that they all eat the meat together in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. However, no one can eat the meat from the purification offering for the high priest's sin or the whole community's sin. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad to share the meat that people offered to me to make amends with the priests who serve me; or
- I want to make sure that no one eats meat from an offering for the high priest's sin or the whole community's sin because that meat is so holy that it would be dangerous; or
- I am glad that the priests are following my instructions well.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 6:24–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, **Yahweh** gives Moses more instructions for Aaron and Aaron's sons, or **descendants**, about what the priests are supposed to do when the priests sacrifice the **sin or purification offering**. For more information on Yahweh, descendants, and the purification offering, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh, descendants, and purification offering as you used in previous passages, like Leviticus 4.

Yahweh calls these instructions the **law** of the purification offering. For more information on the law, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for law as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh tells Moses that the **priests** must kill the animal for the purification offering in the same place the priests kill the animal for the **burnt offering**. Use the same word for killing an animal that you have used in previous passages. For more information about priests and the burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for priest and for burnt offering as you used in previous passages. The sin offering that the priest is offering now is most **sacred**, or most **holy**. For more information about holy, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for holy or sacred that you used in previous passages.

The priest may eat the meat from the purification offering, but because the offering is so sacred, the priest must eat this meat in a **sanctuary** or holy place. For more information about sanctuary, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for sanctuary that you used in previous passages. The holy place where the priest may eat the meat is the courtyard of the **tabernacle**, which people also call the Tent of Meeting. For

more information about the tabernacle, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Tent of Meeting that you used in previous passages.

Everything that touches the meat from the offering becomes sacred or **holy**. In this situation, it is not a good thing for everything that touches the meat from the offering to become holy because it is dangerous when something dirty or common touches something that is holy. Use the same word or phrase for holy in this case as you used in Leviticus 6:18.

When any of the blood from the purification offering touches clothing, a priest has to wash that clothing in a holy place. This means the priest must wash the clothing in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. When the priest uses a clay pot to cook the meat, the priest must break the clay pot. When the priest uses a **bronze** pot, the priest has to scour the pot with something rough and then wash the pot with water. For more information about bronze, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for bronze that you used in previous passages.

Every male descendant of Aaron can eat the meat from the purification offering. The meat from the offering is sacred. However, no one can eat the meat from certain kinds of purification offerings where the high priest brings the blood into the Tent of Meeting to **atone** for the sin, or make amends to Yahweh. For more information about atonement, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for atone that you used in previous passages.

Here, Yahweh again calls the Tent of Meeting “the sanctuary,” because it is a holy place. The kinds of purification offerings where the priest does this are those that make amends for the high priest’s sin and those that make amends for the whole community’s sin. The priest must completely burn up these kinds of purification offerings.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (636 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.3 MB)

- Embodying the Text (3.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (853 KB)

Leviticus 7:1–10

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 7:1–10 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:1–10 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:1–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passages, Yahweh has been giving Moses and Aaron instructions on how the Israelite people were supposed to live in good relationship with Yahweh. At this time, the Israelite people were still camping at Mount Sinai. Here in this passage, Yahweh repeats the instructions to Moses for how the priests are to offer guilt offerings. Yahweh also tells the priests what the priests can take from each kind of offering.

For the guilt offering, the priests would normally sacrifice an adult male sheep. Although the storyteller does not mention this animal here, Yahweh said several times in previous passages that people should give an adult male sheep as the “guilt offering.” Therefore, we know that the “guilt offering” that the storyteller mentions here is the adult male sheep.

Stop here and look at a picture of an adult male sheep. Pause this audio here.

For the guilt offering, the priest would kill the adult male sheep on the north side of the altar of burnt offering.

Stop here and look at a map of the Tent of Meeting and a picture of the altar of burnt offering as a group. Pause this audio here.

Although the narrator does not mention it here, we know from previous passages that the priest would also use a container to collect some of the sheep’s blood.

Stop here and look at a picture of tabernacle pots and utensils as a group. Pause this audio here.

After the priest sprinkles or splashes the sheep’s blood on the sides of the altar, the priest has to remove certain parts of the sheep’s dead body. The priest removes all the fat that covers and surrounds the internal organs of the sheep, the sheep’s tail, the two kidneys and the fat on them, and the fatty, or best, part of the liver.

Stop here and look at a picture of a sheep’s internal organs as a group. Pause this audio here.

The priest takes all of these special pieces of the sheep’s dead body and burns the special pieces with fire on the altar of burnt offering. This is how the priest makes atonement for the Israelite person’s sin or makes things right between the person and Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Why was it important for the priest to make atonement for the Israelite people’s sin? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also gives rules about who can eat the cooked meat from guilt offerings and where those people can eat the meat. The priest and any of the priest's male relatives can eat the guilt offering. However, the priest and the priest's male relatives must eat the offering in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting because the offering is most holy. The priest and his male relatives must follow the same rules for eating the sin or purification offerings.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, is it common for people to eat offerings that people make to a god or idol? Why or why not? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh tells Moses that a priest who makes a burnt offering can keep the animal hide or skin from the sacrifice. This is a special instruction. Why did Yahweh allow the priests to keep the animal skins or hides from the burnt offering? The rule says the priest should burn the whole offering, but this means only the food parts of the offering. The reason why the priest could keep the animal skin of the burnt offerings was that people did not eat the skin. Instead, a person could stretch the animal skin or hide and make something like clothes or a bag out of the skin. It is possible that the priest did burn the animal skin burnt offerings when he offered the burnt offering for the whole community, but kept the animal skin if an Israelite person offered a burnt offering individually. But we do not know.

Then Yahweh says that the priest who offers a cooked grain offering for a person gets to keep the offering. An Israelite person could prepare a cooked grain offering in an oven, a pan, or a griddle. The Israelite people had ovens that they usually made from clay bricks. These kinds of ovens could be shaped like a cup or shaped like a dome. People would use these kinds of ovens to bake flatbreads. You may be familiar with a tabun, tanur, or tandoor, which are different kinds of ovens that people use today and are similar to these ovens. Yahweh does say exactly what kind of pan and griddle to use. The Israelites may cook bread in a covered pan or on an uncovered pan. People probably made these pans and griddles out of clay or from a type of metal. Since the Israelite people were preparing these cooked grain offerings for Yahweh, it is possible that the people used the bronze utensils from the Tent of Meeting to cook or fry the bread.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people typically cook grains? What utensils do people use? What method of cooking, such as baking or frying, do people use? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at pictures of what an oven, a pan, and a griddle might have looked like as a group. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh instructs the priests to share the uncooked grain offerings equally among all of Aaron's male descendants.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:1–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh repeats the instructions to Moses for how the priests are to offer guilt offerings. Yahweh also mentions the rules about who can eat guilt offerings and where those people can eat the offerings. The priest and any of the male relatives of the priest can eat the guilt offering, but those men must eat the offering in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. This is because this meat is very special.

In the second scene: Yahweh says the same rules apply for who can eat sin or purification offerings. Then Yahweh tells Moses that a priest who makes a burnt offering can keep the animal hide or skin from the sacrifice. Then Yahweh says that the priest who offers a cooked grain offering gets to keep the offering. But the priests must share the uncooked grain offerings equally among all of Aaron's male descendants.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- An Israelite priest

- And male relatives of the priest

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In previous passages, Yahweh was giving Moses instructions on how the Israelite people can live in good relationship with Yahweh. At this time, the Israelite people were still camping at Mount Sinai. Note that the narrator does not mention Moses in this passage, but the narrator does mention Moses in the beginning of Leviticus 6, where the narrator says that Yahweh gave these instructions to Moses.

In the first scene, Yahweh repeats the law or instructions to Moses for how the priests are to offer guilt offerings. Israelite people would bring guilt offerings to the Tent of Meeting. A person would do this when a person accidentally sinned or when a person sinned in certain ways, like if the person stole or lied about property. Yahweh says that the guilt offering is most holy. The words "most holy" mean ritually special. Usually, when a person or thing was "most holy" to Yahweh, it meant the Israelite people had to treat that person or thing in a very special or particular way.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, how would you describe something extremely sacred or holy? Do you have any words you would use to talk about the most important spiritual things? Pause this audio here.

For a guilt offering, an Israelite person usually brings an adult male sheep. We know this from chapter 5. Even though this passage does not mention adult male sheep, you might need to remember this if it is important in your language to say what the sacrifice was. For the guilt offering, the priest kills the adult male sheep on the north side of the altar of burnt offering.

Stop here and, as a group, again look at a map of the Tent of Meeting and a picture of the altar of burnt offering as needed. Pause this audio here.

Although the storyteller does not mention it in this passage, we know from a previous passage that the priest also uses a container to catch some of the sheep's blood. Then the priest sprinkles or throws the sheep's blood on the sides of the altar.

Then the priest removes certain parts of the sheep's dead body. The priest removes all the fat that covers and surrounds the internal organs of the sheep, the sheep's tail, the two kidneys and the fat on them, and the best part of the liver.

Stop here and look at a picture of these internal organs as a group again as needed. Remind each other what you called these organs in Leviticus 3 and 4. Pause this audio here.

The priest takes all of these special pieces of the sheep's dead body and burns the special pieces with fire on the altar of burnt offering. Here, Yahweh calls this the food offering.

This is how the priest makes atonement for the Israelite person's sin. To make atonement means that Yahweh forgives the Israelite person's sin, and the ritually "dirty" person will be clean again and is able to worship Yahweh again.

Yahweh also talks about the rules about who can eat the cooked meat from guilt offerings and where those people can eat the cooked meat. Because the guilt offering is most holy, there is a very strict rule about who can eat the sacrificed and cooked meat and where those people can eat the meat. The priest and any of the male relatives of the priest can eat the guilt offering. But those men must eat this offering in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. It is important to translate this in a way that makes it clear that there were no women who could eat this meat from the most holy offerings.

In the second scene, Yahweh gives the same rule for who can eat sin or purification offerings. Then Yahweh tells Moses that a priest who makes a burnt offering for a person can keep the animal hide or skin from the sacrifice.

Then Yahweh says that the priest who offers a cooked grain offering gets to keep and eat the grain offering. An Israelite person who gives a cooked grain offering could cook the offering in an oven, on a pan, or on a griddle. The pans might have been bronze, like the other utensils in the Tent of Meeting.

Stop here and, as a group, look again at pictures of what an oven, a pan, and a griddle might have looked like as needed. Pause this audio here.

For the uncooked grain offerings, the priests must share the offering equally among all of Aaron's male descendants.

Stop here and discuss: Talk about sharing something equally in a large group, where every person gets the same amount. Talk about sharing a staple food, such as wheat, corn, or rice, in this way. How would you explain to someone that everyone gets the same amount of uncooked food? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:1–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- An Israelite priest
- And male relatives of the priest

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Note that the storyteller does not mention Moses in this passage, but the storyteller did mention Moses at the beginning of Leviticus 6, where the storyteller said that Yahweh gave these instructions to Moses.

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh repeats the instructions to Moses for how the priests are to offer guilt offerings. Yahweh also mentions the rules about who can eat guilt offerings and where those people can eat the offerings. The priest and any of the male relatives of the priest can eat the guilt offering, but those men must eat the offering in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. This is because this meat is very special. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that people will get to eat the meat and that it will not go to waste; or
- Why is it that only the priests can eat the meat?

Ask the person playing the priests, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that Yahweh has provided food for us. Because we work at the Tent of Meeting, we may not have time to grow or buy food from somewhere else. or
- I wonder why my daughters and wife cannot eat this meat. I trust Yahweh, though, and will follow Yahweh's instructions; or
- These rules about the holy meat remind me how carefully we must treat other holy things. The rules also remind me that I must deeply respect Yahweh, who is very holy!

Leviticus 7:1–10

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh gives the same rule for who can eat purification offerings. Then Yahweh tells Moses that a priest who makes a burnt offering can keep the animal hide or skin from the sacrifice. Then Yahweh says that the priest who offers a cooked grain offering gets to keep the offering. But for the uncooked grain offerings, the priests must share the offering equally among all of Aaron's male descendants. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want the Israelite people to know that I will provide for them; or
- I do not want people to be afraid that they will not have enough to make the sacrifices; or
- The Israelite people need to be careful with the most holy things.

Ask the person playing the male relatives of the priests, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am thankful that I may eat some of the food that Yahweh shares with the priests, even though I did not prepare this offering; or
- I am happy that our God is kind and provides food for us; or
- When I eat the food from the offerings, I think about Yahweh, and I remember that Yahweh is the one who keeps us alive.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:1–10 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh gives more **laws** or rules about how the priests should offer **guilt offerings**. Yahweh tells Moses what parts of the offerings the priests may keep for themselves. Use the same word for law as you used in previous passages. Use the same word for guilt offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on law and guilt offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that the guilt offering is most **holy**. Use the same word or phrase for most holy as you used in previous passages when you talked about an offering being most holy. For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary.

The priest sacrifices, or kills, the guilt offering on the same altar where the priest sacrifices **burnt offerings**. Use the same word for killing an animal and for burnt offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Use the same words and phrases you used previously for the **fat** that covers the **internal organs**, the **kidneys** and fat near the backside of the sheep, and the best part of the **liver**.

After the priest kills the animal for the guilt offering, the priest **sprinkles** or **throws** the blood onto the sides of the altar. Use the same word for sprinkle or throw as you used in previous passages.

The priest sacrifices the guilt offering on the **altar** of burnt offering. But in this passage, the storyteller just calls it the altar. Use the same word for altar as you used in previous passages. For more information on altar, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and, as a group, look again at a picture of the altar of burnt offering as needed. Pause this audio here.

The priest burns the guilt offering as a **fire offering** to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for fire offering as you have used previously. Fire offering is in the Master Glossary.

Use the same words for **Yahweh** and **priest** as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh also mentions that this law or rule is the same for **sin or purification offerings**. Use the same word for purification offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on purification offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

The priests would eat the offerings in the holy place or **sanctuary**. Use the same word for sanctuary as you have used in previous passages. For more information on sanctuary, refer to the Master Glossary.

The purification offering and the guilt offering belong to the priest who makes atonement with those offerings. Use the same word for **atonement** as you used in previous passages. For more information on atonement, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh allows the priests to keep the **grain offerings**. Use the same word for grain offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on grain offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

The storyteller mentions three ways that a person can cook or prepare a grain offering. The person can bake the offering in an **oven**, cook the offering in a **pan**, or cook the offering on a **griddle**. In Leviticus 2, when Yahweh gave instructions for the grain offering, Yahweh mentioned all three of these ways of cooking. Use the same words for oven, pan, and griddle as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and, as a group, look again at pictures of an oven, a pan, and a griddle as needed. Pause this audio here.

The dry grain offering belongs equally to all of Aaron's sons, or male **descendants**. Use the same word or phrase for descendants as you have used previously, and refer to descendants in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 7:1–10

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (606 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (849 KB)

Leviticus 7:11–21

Leviticus 7:11–21

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 7:11–21 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:11–21 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:11–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

After Yahweh tells Moses how the priests need to eat the meat of the guilt offering, Yahweh gives Moses more instructions about the peace or fellowship offering. This time, Yahweh does not give instructions about how to kill the animal or make the fellowship offering. Instead, Yahweh tells Moses new information about what the Israelites need to bring when the Israelites make the fellowship offering and when the Israelites can eat the meat. Yahweh starts this story by telling Moses specific rules and regulations that people need to follow when someone gives a fellowship offering to Yahweh. These rules are like laws and have serious consequences when people disobey the rules.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when you told someone specific instructions that the person needed to follow carefully, or there would be serious consequences. Tell a story about a time when someone else told you specific instructions that you needed to follow carefully. What happened? Pause this audio here.

The offerings that Yahweh talks about in this story are the fellowship offerings. It is important to remember that Yahweh gave instructions about how to kill the animal for the fellowship offering in Leviticus 3. In this story, Yahweh explains what other food the Israelites should bring when someone brings an animal as a fellowship offering and also how people should eat the meat of that animal.

One of the reasons an Israelite might give a fellowship offering is because the person wants everyone to know how amazing Yahweh is. Yahweh calls this kind of fellowship offering “a praise or thank offering.” A person would give a praise offering if Yahweh saved the person from their enemies or healed the person. A person might also give a praise offering to Yahweh to thank Yahweh for forgiving that person when that person sinned.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time someone did something amazing to help you. What did you do to thank that person? Pause this audio here.

When the Israelite brings the animal to sacrifice for the praise offering, the Israelite also needs to bring four different kinds of bread. The Israelites made the first kind of bread when the Israelites mixed flour and olive oil together and baked the dough into a thick loaf that did not have any yeast in it. The Israelites made the second kind of bread with flour without yeast, baked it into a thin loaf, and then poured olive oil on top. The Israelites made the third kind of bread with even nicer flour that the Israelites mixed carefully with the oil and baked into a thick loaf without yeast. The fourth and last kind of bread was the only one that had yeast in it. The priest would give some of the bread to Yahweh, and then the priest would eat the rest of the bread with the priest’s family.

Stop here and look at pictures of the different kinds of bread as a group. Pause this audio here.

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An Israelite may also bring an animal to sacrifice and bread for other kinds of fellowship offerings. Sometimes a person would promise Yahweh that the person would bring a fellowship offering if Yahweh answered a prayer. Yahweh calls this kind of fellowship offering "a vow offering." People bring these sacrifices to show Yahweh how thankful those people are that Yahweh answered their prayer.

Stop here and tell a story about a time you promised to give someone a gift if that person helped you. Pause this audio here.

There is one more reason why an Israelite would bring a fellowship offering to Yahweh. Sometimes the Israelites would want to give Yahweh a gift just because the Israelites loved Yahweh. An Israelite would decide that the Israelite wants to show Yahweh how much the Israelite loves Yahweh, and so the Israelite would bring all the bread and the animal to give to Yahweh. This kind of offering is a freewill offering.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time you gave someone a gift because you love that person so much. What did you do? Tell a story about a time you did something for someone because you appreciated that person. What did you do? Pause this audio here.

After the priests sacrifice the animal, the Israelite family that brought the sacrifice would eat the meat that the priests did not burn up on the altar. The fellowship offering was the only kind of offering that any clean Israelite could eat the meat of, so this offering was like a party for the Israelite family and their community. The Israelite family and maybe even their friends and neighbors would eat the meat together and could tell each other how amazing Yahweh is. The Israelites must finish the meat in a certain amount of time, or the meat would not be good to eat anymore, and Yahweh would punish the Israelites. The Israelite had to eat the meat of the praise offering in one day, but the Israelite could take two days to eat the meat for the vow and the freewill offering. If a person ate any of the meat from the vow or freewill offering on the third day, then Yahweh would punish the person.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What rules does your culture have about when people can eat certain foods? What are the punishments if someone breaks those rules? Pause this audio here.

Remember, Leviticus 5:1–13 talked about what people would need to do if someone touched a person or animal that was not ritually clean. If someone touched an animal or a person that was not ritually clean, then the person would not be ritually clean anymore. If someone who is not ritually clean eats any of the meat from the fellowship offering, then Yahweh says the Israelites need to punish that person. The punishment is very strong. The Israelites would make the person leave the community and never return, and the Israelites might even kill the person.

Yahweh punishes a ritually dirty person strongly for eating the fellowship offering because the fellowship offering is special to Yahweh. Only ritually clean people should touch or eat important offerings.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the worst punishment in your culture? What does someone need to do in order to get that punishment? Tell a story about someone who had to leave the community and never return. Why did that person have to leave the community? How did the community feel about it? How did you feel about it?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:11–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses that Yahweh is going to explain the laws the Israelites need to follow if the Israelites bring different kinds of fellowship offerings to Yahweh.

In the second scene: Yahweh explains what the Israelites should do when the Israelites want to give Yahweh a praise offering, which the Israelites give Yahweh when the Israelites want to praise or thank Yahweh. Yahweh

explains what kind of bread the Israelites should bring when the Israelites bring a praise offering and how the Israelites should eat the meat.

In the third scene: Yahweh explains how the Israelites should eat the meat from the fellowship offerings that are vow or freewill offerings. Yahweh also explains what the consequences are if the Israelites disobey.

In the fourth scene: Yahweh describes the consequences if the meat of the peace offering becomes ritually dirty or if a ritually dirty person eats the meat.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The priest who makes the offering
- The Israelite who brings the offering and their family
- A disobedient Israelite

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In scene one, Yahweh explains to Moses that Yahweh is about to tell Moses the laws for the fellowship offerings. It is important to remember that Yahweh introduced Yahweh's instructions about the guilt offering in the same way.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss how you introduced the information about the instructions for the guilt offering and whether you could use that same language here. Pause the audio here.

In scene two, Yahweh explains that the person who brings the praise offering, which is a kind of fellowship offering, must also bring different kinds of bread. The Israelite must make three loaves of bread without any yeast and one kind of bread with yeast. The Israelite brings these four kinds of bread to the Tent of Meeting when the Israelite brings the animal that the Israelite is going to sacrifice.

Stop here and look at a picture of the Tent of Meeting as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and talk about how you will describe the four types of bread in your translation. Remember that the Israelites made the first kind of bread when they mixed flour and olive oil together and baked the dough into a thick loaf that did not have any yeast in it. The Israelites made the second kind of bread with flour without yeast, baked it into a thin loaf, and then poured olive oil on top. The Israelites made the third kind of bread with even nicer flour that the Israelites mixed carefully with the oil and baked into a thick loaf without yeast. The fourth and last kind of bread was the only bread that had yeast in it. Pause this audio here.

The priest who sacrifices the animal may eat some of each kind of bread. The story describes this priest as the priest who sprinkles or throws the blood of the fellowship offering against the altar. It is important to remember that earlier, Yahweh told the priest to use a bowl to throw the blood of the fellowship offering against the altar when the priest killed the animal for the fellowship offering. Here, the storyteller describes how the priest throws the blood to show clearly that the priest who killed the animal is the priest who gets to eat the bread that the Israelite brought.

The Israelites who brought the fellowship offering have to eat the meat the same day that the priest kills the animal. The Israelites cannot leave any of the meat to eat the next day. The Israelites have to eat everything on the day the Israelites bring the sacrifice.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you tell someone that the person has to do something on the same day you are giving the instructions? Pause this audio here.

In scene three, Yahweh explains how the Israelites should eat the meat for the vow and freewill offerings. The Israelites can eat the meat of the vow and freewill offerings on the day the priest sacrifices the animal and the day after the priest sacrifices the animal. If the Israelites eat the meat on any other day, then Yahweh will not accept the offering.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use to explain what day the Israelites must not eat the meat anymore. Pause this audio here.

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If the Israelites eat the meat on the third day after the sacrifice instead of burning the meat like Yahweh says to, then Yahweh will not accept those Israelites. This could mean that Yahweh will reject the Israelite who brought the offering. This could also mean that Yahweh will not accept the Israelite's gift and will ignore the gift, so it will be like the Israelite never gave a gift at all.

The story says that the person who ignores the rules and eats the meat on that third day will receive a punishment, or "take on his own iniquity." In other words, the person has done wrong things against Yahweh and is guilty. The storyteller does not say who will punish the person, but normally the phrase here describes the way Yahweh punishes people and the way people punish other people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time that God or a spirit punished someone in your culture. Tell a story about a time the community punished a person. Discuss whether you use the same words to talk about both kinds of punishment. Pause this audio here.

In scene four, Yahweh explains what will happen if the meat from the fellowship offering is no longer ritually clean or if someone who is not ritually clean eats the meat. It is important to notice that Yahweh uses the general term "fellowship offering" here instead of any of the names for the specific kinds of fellowship offerings. The rules in scene four apply to all of the fellowship offerings that Yahweh has talked about so far.

If the meat touches anything that is unclean or ritually dirty, then someone must burn up the meat. It is important to remember that if something is ritually dirty, then that thing cannot come close to God. The meat for the offering is a gift to God, so the meat can not touch anything that would make the meat ritually dirty.

If a person touches a ritually dirty animal or something that prevents the person from participating in ritual activities, then the person is ritually dirty and cannot eat the meat. If that person eats the meat, the person's punishment is to not be part of Yahweh's people anymore. Yahweh repeats these instructions twice to show how important the instructions are. First, Yahweh says that if anyone who is ritually dirty eats the meat, then the Israelites will cut that person off from the rest of the people. This could mean that the people kill the ritually dirty person, but it probably means that the Israelites force the ritually dirty person to leave the community and never return. This is one of the strongest punishments that the Israelites had because the ritually dirty person could never become part of the community again.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "cut off from their people." Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh talks about what happens to the person who touches something ritually dirty and gives a list of ritually dirty things. The list includes things that come from people who are ritually dirty, ritually dirty animals, or any other living thing that is not ritually clean. If the person touches any of those ritually dirty things and eats the meat, then the Israelites must cut the person off from the rest of the people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What was a time when you wanted someone to understand how serious your instructions were or how bad the consequences would be if the person did not listen to you? What did you say? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:11–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The priest who makes the offering
- The Israelite who brings the offering and their family

Leviticus 7:11–21

- A disobedient Israelite

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The story begins with Yahweh talking to Moses and telling Moses that these are the rules that the Israelites need to follow when they bring peace or fellowship offerings to Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I know I need to take this seriously; or
- I should write this down so that everyone else knows what they need to do.

Continue the drama. The Israelite family that has the kinds of bread and the animal to sacrifice for the praise offering walks over to the priest to bring the sacrifice to Yahweh. The family gives the priest the three kinds of bread that do not have yeast, and then the bread that does have yeast. The priest sacrifices the animal and splashes its blood on the altar, gives the meat to the family, and then takes one of each kind of bread. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Israelite family, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people may answer things like:

- God healed me when I was sick, and I am so thankful! I want everyone to know how amazing God is! or
- I sinned, and God forgave me. I want to thank God and tell everyone how kind God is; or
- We have to make sure we eat all this meat today. Maybe we should get our friends to come and eat the meat with us.

Ask the person playing the priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person may answer things like:

- I am so thankful to God for this food for my family! or
- I am excited to eat this bread!

Continue the drama. The Israelite family brings the same kinds of bread and animal as they did for the praise offering, but this time the family tells the priest that they are bringing it for a vow offering or a freewill offering. The family members eat some of the meat, sleep, eat some of the meat, and sleep again. If there is any meat left after the family has slept a second time, they burn most of it. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the family, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people may answer things like:

- God answered my prayer, so I am bringing this sacrifice to show God how thankful I am; or
- I wanted to give God this gift, so I am bringing God this sacrifice; or
- Now that it is the third day, we need to burn all this up so that God does not punish anyone who eats it. I do not want to be punished!

Continue the drama. The Israelite who disobeys comes and eats some of the meat on the third day. Yahweh shows that he does not accept any of the sacrifice anymore and punishes this Israelite. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the disobedient Israelite, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Why is Yahweh so mad at me? I only ate some of the meat; or
- I am so sad that my actions mean that Yahweh will not accept any of my family's sacrifice.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person may answer things like:

- I am so disappointed that one Israelite disobeyed me and ate the meat; or

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- I am sad I cannot accept this sacrifice anymore; or
- The meat of the sacrifice is special to me, and I am angry that the disobedient Israelite was so disrespectful and disobedient.

Continue the drama. One of the Israelites touches the meat to an object that is unclean or drops the meat on the ground. The meat is now unclean, so the Israelite burns it. Pause the drama. Ask the actor who burned the meat, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I really wanted to eat this meat, but now that it has touched the ground. This meat is not clean anymore, so I need to burn it; or
- I do not want to eat something that is unclean! I do not want Yahweh to punish me.

Continue the drama. The Israelite family eats the clean meat together. The disobedient Israelite says that he is unclean and then eats the meat. The other Israelites chase the disobedient Israelite away. Then another disobedient Israelite touches unclean animals or unclean things and then eats the meat. The other Israelites chase the disobedient Israelite away so that he cannot come back. Pause the drama. Ask the disobedient Israelite, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I should not have eaten the meat. Now I cannot return home and be with my family. I am upset that I disobeyed God; or
- I did not think that it would be a problem if I was not clean and ate the meat. I should have listened to God.

Ask the other Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- God's rules are important! The disobedient Israelite should not have eaten the meat. The disobedient Israelite deserved to be punished; or
- I am sad that we will not see that person again. I wish that person had obeyed Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:11–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh tells Moses about the **laws** the Israelites need to obey when the Israelites give fellowship offerings. The word law is the same word Yahweh used in the last story to talk about very important rules that people need to obey. Use the same word or phrase here that you used in previous passages to talk about laws. For more information on law, refer to the Master Glossary.

These laws that Yahweh tells Moses are about **sacrifices** for the **peace or fellowship offering**. Use the same word or phrase for sacrifice and fellowship offering that you did in chapter three to talk about this kind of offering. For more information on this offering, refer to the Master Glossary for sacrifice and for "peace or fellowship offering."

The word **offering** talks about gifts that people would give to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase here that you used in previous passages. For more information on offerings, refer to the Master Glossary.

In this story, the storyteller uses God's name, **Yahweh**. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh that you have in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

The first kind of sacrifice is a praise or thanksgiving offering. This is the offering that people give Yahweh when Yahweh has done something amazing for those people or forgiven those people for something those people did wrong. The Israelites would give this offering to thank Yahweh and to tell everyone else what Yahweh did to help the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **praise or thanksgiving offering**. Pause this audio here.

There are four kinds of bread that the Israelites are supposed to give to Yahweh. Three of the kinds of bread do not have yeast in them. Yeast is what makes bread fluffy instead of flat.

Leviticus 7:11–21

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of the kinds of bread without yeast. Pause this audio here.

People also put olive oil in the bread without yeast. Olive oil is a normal cooking oil that the Israelites used to make food.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of olive oil. Pause this audio here.

One kind of bread uses yeast to make it fluffy.

Stop here and look at pictures of bread with yeast in it. Pause this audio here.

Use the same words or phrases to describe **yeast** and **olive oil** that you have used in previous passages.

Stop here and decide as a group how you will describe these four kinds of bread. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites have to eat the meat from the praise offering on the same day that the Israelites offer the animal. The Israelites can not eat any of the meat the next day.

Stop here and discuss how you will describe when the Israelites must not eat the meat anymore. Pause this audio here.

Another kind of fellowship offering is the vow offering. A vow offering is an offering that an Israelite gave Yahweh after Yahweh had answered a prayer. An Israelite would pray and ask Yahweh for something and would promise to give a vow offering if Yahweh answered the prayer.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **vow offering**. Look up **offering** and **vow** in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated the word vow in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The last kind of praise offering is the freewill offering. A freewill offering is an offering that an Israelite gave Yahweh just because the Israelite wanted to give Yahweh something.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **freewill offering**. For more information about the freewill offering, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

If a person eats the meat on the wrong day, Yahweh will not accept it. This might mean that Yahweh does not accept the person who gave the offering, or it might mean that Yahweh will not accept the person's offering, and it will be like the person never brought an offering.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use to explain how Yahweh does not accept the person or offering if the Israelite eats the meat on the wrong day. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will punish anyone who eats the meat on the wrong day. Yahweh explains that the person who eats the offering on the wrong day will "carry his own iniquity." This phrase describes a punishment, but Yahweh does not say who is punishing the person. Probably, this describes a punishment that only Yahweh gives people who disobey Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss the ways your culture talks about punishment from God. Discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use to translate the phrase "bear his own **iniquity**, or take the punishment." For more information, refer to iniquity in the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

If the meat touches anything that is **unclean** or **ritually dirty**, then the Israelites cannot eat it anymore. It is important to remember that something being ritually dirty does not mean that the thing was physically dirty. If something was ritually dirty, then the Israelites could not use it to worship Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase here that you used in previous passages to talk about people, animals, or objects that are ritually dirty. For more information on clean and unclean, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 7:11–21

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (610 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (842 KB)

Leviticus 7:22–27

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 7:22–27 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:22–27 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:22–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh has been telling Moses to give all these instructions to Aaron and Aaron's sons. Now, Yahweh tells Moses to give specific instructions to all of the Israelites. Moses is supposed to tell the Israelites that Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to eat any of the fat from certain animals.

Leviticus 7:22–27

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of animal fat with and without meat. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to eat sheep fat, cattle fat, or goat fat. You will remember that the Israelites sacrificed sheep, cattle, and goats to Yahweh, and that those animals' fat belonged to Yahweh. You will remember that cattle is a general word that can include female cows, bulls, and oxen.

Stop here and look at pictures of sheep, cattle, and goats. Then discuss this question as a group: What parts of an animal does your community eat? Are there parts of the animal that you are not allowed to eat? Why? Pause this audio here.

If the sheep, cattle, or goat dies by itself or if another animal kills one of those animals, then that dead animal's fat does not belong to Yahweh anymore.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What does your community do with animals that die because the animals are old or sick, or because another animal has killed the animals? Pause this audio here.

The Israelites could only sacrifice perfect animals, and animals that died by themselves were not perfect anymore. If another animal killed a sheep, cow, or goat, then the sheep, cow, or goat was not perfect anymore, and the Israelites could not sacrifice the animal either. Instead, the Israelites could use the fat of that animal to make things, but the Israelites still could not eat the animal's fat.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you use animal fat in your culture? What kinds of things do you make with animal fat? What rules do you have about what kind of fat people must use for specific purposes? Pause this audio here.

If anyone eats the fat of any of these three kinds of animals, the Israelites will cut that person off from the community. It is important to remember that when the community cuts someone off, the community is severely punishing that person, and that person is no longer a part of the community. Yahweh also says that the Israelites are not supposed to eat the blood of any bird or any animal. It does not matter where the Israelites lived, what kind of house the Israelites had, or how important the Israelites were; Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to eat the blood.

Stop here and discuss this question: What kinds of homes do you have in your community? What rules do you have about what you can eat in certain places? Pause this audio here.

If an Israelite eats any of the blood of any bird or any other animal, then the community would cut that person off. When Yahweh talks about eating the blood, Yahweh is talking about eating meat that still has blood in it. The Israelites have to drain all the blood out of an animal before the Israelites can eat the meat. The Israelites have to make sure the Israelites do not eat any of the animal's blood when the Israelites eat the animal's meat.

Stop here and look at a picture of people draining an animal's blood. Discuss this question: How does your community kill animals for meat? Pause this audio here.

After Yahweh flooded the earth in the book of Genesis, Yahweh told Noah that people must not eat an animal's blood because the animal's blood is where the animal's life is. The animal's blood belongs to Yahweh because Yahweh is the one who creates life.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What rules does your community have about how people should treat blood? Where do you think an animal's life is in its body?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:22–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses to talk to the Israelites and tell the Israelites what to do.

In the second scene: Yahweh gives instructions about what Israelites are supposed to do with animal fat.

Leviticus 7:22–27

In the third scene: Yahweh warns the Israelites not to eat any blood.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- And the Israelites, including the disobedient Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In scene one, Yahweh gives Moses instructions to tell the Israelites. The instructions about the offerings were instructions that Yahweh told Moses to tell to Aaron and Aaron's sons. But now Yahweh is telling Moses the instructions that all of the Israelites need to hear and understand. It is important to remember that Moses is still just listening to Yahweh's instructions. Moses has not told the Israelites these instructions yet. It is important to remember that the instructions that Yahweh is giving Moses are serious instructions.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you tell your entire community about instructions that people need to follow? How will you tell this story so that it is clear that Yahweh is giving instructions to Moses to tell all of the Israelites and not only Aaron and Aaron's sons? Pause this audio here.

In scene two, Yahweh tells Moses the instructions the Israelites need to follow when the Israelites eat cattle, sheep, or goats as food. When the Israelites eat those animals, the Israelites need to be careful not to eat any of the fat. It is important to remember that the priests burn the fat from cattle, sheep, and goats on the altar as part of an offering to Yahweh. If a person eats that fat, the person is stealing what belongs to Yahweh.

If an animal is already dead or if another animal attacks the animal and kills it, then the Israelites could not offer the animal to Yahweh, so the Israelites could use the fat for other things. Yahweh says again that the Israelites cannot eat the fat, even if the animal died because the animal was old or sick or because another animal had killed it.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when a wild animal attacked one of the animals in your community. What did the dead animal look like? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says again that the Israelites can never eat the fat of any animal that the Israelites can offer to Yahweh. This is a summary that explains that Yahweh is still talking about the cattle, sheep, and goats that Yahweh talked about at the beginning of the story. Since the priest burns the fat of cattle, sheep, and goats on the altar, everyone knew that the Israelites could sacrifice cattle, sheep, and goats as a fire offering. If a person eats the fat of one of these animals, the community will cut off that person.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will show that in this story, Yahweh is talking about the animals that people can offer to Yahweh in one of the fire offerings, or offerings that priests burn. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and remind each other of how you will say that the community will cut off that person, or remove that person from the Israelite community. Pause this audio here.

In scene three, Yahweh warns the Israelites about what will happen if the Israelites eat any of the blood. It is important to remember that the animal's blood also belonged to Yahweh, so if a person ate the blood, it was like stealing from Yahweh. No matter where an Israelite lives, Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to eat the blood of any bird or other animal. This rule is very serious and important. It is so serious that the community will cut off anyone who breaks the rule, just like the community will cut off anyone who eats the fat of the animals that people sacrificed to Yahweh.

Stop here and look again, as needed, at the picture of the animals hanging so that the blood drains from the animal. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:22–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 7:22–27

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- And the Israelites, including the disobedient Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

It is important to remember that Yahweh is telling Moses to give these instructions to the Israelites, so the Israelites were not actually eating these animals while Yahweh was talking to Moses. You may still act out the Israelites eating or not eating the animals in order to remember the story well.

The story begins as Yahweh tells Moses to tell the Israelites more instructions. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want Moses to understand how important these instructions are; or
- I want to make sure all of the Israelites follow these rules.

Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I need to make sure that all of the Israelites follow these instructions; or
- Why are these instructions for all of the Israelites and not just for Aaron and Aaron's descendants?

Continue the drama. Yahweh instructs the Israelites not to eat the fat of cattle, sheep, or goats. Show how some of the animals die from sickness or old age, or because a wild animal attacked the animal. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people may answer things like:

- I was planning on sacrificing that animal to Yahweh, but now I cannot; or
- I am excited that I can use this fat to make things we need in our house.

Continue the drama. A disobedient Israelite goes to eat some of the fat from the animals, and the rest of the Israelites force the disobedient Israelite to leave the group and not come back. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people may answer things like:

- I am so angry that person stole from Yahweh! That person deserves this punishment; or
- I am sad that the person has to leave the community now, but that person disobeyed Yahweh's rules.

Continue the drama. The Israelites act out draining the blood from birds and other animals, so the Israelites do not eat any blood. A disobedient Israelite eats some of the blood, and the rest of the Israelites force the disobedient Israelite to leave. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people may answer things like:

- The animal's blood belongs to Yahweh! I am so angry that the disobedient Israelite took what belongs to Yahweh! or
- We are never supposed to eat an animal's blood. Why did the disobedient Israelite think this was a good idea? Now we need to punish that Israelite.

Leviticus 7:22–27

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:22–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this story, the narrator uses the name **Yahweh**. It is important to remember that Yahweh is God's name. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

The word **Israelites** means all of the people who descended from a man whose name was Israel. The Israelites were God's people, and the rules in the Book of Leviticus are about how the Israelites were supposed to live. For more information about the Israelites, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for the Israelites as you used in previous passages.

An animal's **fat** is the thick white substance on animal meat. Use the same word or phrase for fat as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at the pictures of animal fat again as a group as needed. Pause this audio here.

The animals in this story are **sheep**, **goats**, and **cattle**. It is important to remember that these are the animals that people would sacrifice to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase to describe these animals as you used in previous passages. Remember that cattle is a general word that includes female cows, bulls, and oxen.

The phrase "found dead" talks about animals that people and other animals did not kill. The animals might die because the animals are old or because the animals are sick.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **found dead**. Pause this audio here.

The phrase wild animals talks about animals that do not work with people. Wild animals do not provide milk, meat, transportation, or any other kind of help. Wild animals attack the animals that belong to people. Wild animals are dangerous.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **wild animals**. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites are not supposed to eat the fat of any animal that people can offer as a **fire offering**. It is important to remember that people can sacrifice cattle, sheep, goats, and birds as fire offerings. Here, this term is not talking about a specific kind of offering, but it is instead talking about every kind of offering that the priests would burn on the altar. The meat would cook on the altar just like how people cook meat on fire for their own food, so sometimes people call this offering an "offering by fire." Use the same word or phrase for fire offering as you used in previous passages.

The phrase **cut off from their people** either means that the community killed the disobedient person or forced the disobedient person to leave and never come back. This was one of the most severe punishments that the Israelites had. Use the same word or phrase for cut off from their people that you used in previous passages.

The phrase wherever you live is a way to say that this rule applies to every Israelite in every place. It does not matter where the Israelites live or what the Israelites do. Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to eat the blood.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **wherever you live**. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 7:22–27

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (624 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (850 KB)

Leviticus 7:28–28

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 7:28–38 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:28–38 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:28–38 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this story, Yahweh tells Moses to tell all the Israelites more instructions about the peace or fellowship offering. Just like people sometimes eat together to show their good relationship with one another, the Israelites are supposed to eat most of the fellowship offering to show the Israelites' good relationship with Yahweh. However, there are parts of the animal that the Israelites do not eat. Those are the parts that Yahweh is talking about in this story.

When the Israelites bring a fellowship offering, the Israelites need to bring the offering with their own hands. This means that an Israelite cannot send someone else to give the animal instead of the Israelite. It is important that an Israelite personally bring the offering that the Israelite wants to give to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When you need to do something important, do you do it yourself or do you send someone else to do it? Why do you do it like that? Pause this audio here.

The Israelites are supposed to give the fat and the meat from the animal's breast to Yahweh.

Stop here and look at a picture of an animal's breast meat and a picture of an animal with the breast area circled. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites give the meat to Yahweh with a wave offering. A wave offering was a specific way to give an offering to Yahweh, just like burning up the meat on the altar was a specific way to give an offering to Yahweh. For a wave offering, the priest would wave the meat back and forth in the air in front of Yahweh to show that the meat belonged to Yahweh now.

Stop here and look at a picture of a priest making a wave offering. Pause this audio here.

After the priest finishes with the wave offering, the priest would burn up the fat on the altar. Aaron and Aaron's sons would get to cook and eat the animal's breast meat. It is important to remember that Aaron and Aaron's sons are supposed to be Israel's priests, so all of the priests can eat the animal's breast meat.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What jobs does your community have that belong to specific families forever? Pause this audio here.

The other piece of meat that belongs to the priests is the animal's right thigh. The thigh is the top half of the animal's leg. The Israelites thought that the right side of the body was better than the left side of the body, so the right thigh was a more important piece of meat.

Stop here and look at a picture of thigh meat and a picture of an animal with a right thigh circled. Pause this audio here.

The Israelite who makes the offering should give the right thigh to the priest who kills the animal, burns the animal fat on the altar, and sprinkles the animal's blood on the altar. It is a specific gift for the priest who helps offer the fellowship offering. All the priests may eat the breast meat, but only the priest who sacrifices the animal can eat the right thigh meat. The Israelites thought that the breast meat and thigh meat were the tastiest meat of the animal.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What meat does your community think is the tastiest meat? Who is allowed to eat that meat in your community? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that Yahweh is giving the breast meat that the offeror gave to Yahweh with a wave offering and the thigh meat to the priests. The Israelites give the fellowship offering to Yahweh, and Yahweh gives the right thigh and the breast meat to the priests. Aaron, Aaron's sons, and the sons' descendants can eat that meat every time an Israelite gives Yahweh a fellowship offering forever.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Who in your community gets special gifts or honor? Are these people whole families or individuals? Why do those people get those gifts or honor? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh made this rule about what meat the Israelites need to give Aaron and Aaron's descendants on the same day that Yahweh made Aaron and Aaron's descendants into Yahweh's priests. When Yahweh officially made Aaron and Aaron's descendants into priests, Yahweh also told the Israelites to give the priests the right thigh and the breast of the animal every time the Israelites make a fellowship offering. This rule is supposed to last forever.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are some rules in your community that it is important for everyone to follow forever? Pause this audio here.

The story ends with a summary. The story says that all these laws tell what the Israelites and the priests must do when the Israelites offer a burnt offering, a grain offering, a purification offering, a guilt offering, an ordination offering, or a fellowship offering. The Israelites made ordination offerings when Yahweh appointed new priests.

Leviticus 7:28–28

Yahweh gave all the rules for all of these offerings to Moses at Mount Sinai in the Wilderness of Sinai. Yahweh told Moses all these rules on the same day that Yahweh told the Israelites to bring offerings to Yahweh.

Stop here and look at a picture of Mount Sinai and the Wilderness of Sinai as a group.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:28–38 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh gives Moses more instructions about the peace or fellowship offering. Yahweh explains how the Israelites are supposed to give the priests the meat that the priests may eat.

In the second scene: The story explains that Yahweh gave the instructions that the priests should receive specific kinds of meat on the same day that Aaron and Aaron's sons officially became Yahweh's priests.

In the third scene: The storyteller summarizes all the kinds of offerings that Yahweh told Moses about on Mount Sinai.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller
- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelites
- Aaron
- Aaron's sons
- All of Aaron's descendants
- And the specific priest who sacrifices the fellowship offering

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Yahweh gives Moses more instructions to tell all the Israelites. Yahweh is not speaking directly to all the Israelites, but Yahweh is telling Moses what to do so that Moses can tell the other Israelites. These instructions are different from the last instructions. It is important to remember that the last instructions were about the food that Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to eat. This time, Yahweh is giving the Israelites more instructions about the fellowship offering.

It is important to remember that the Israelites eat most of the fellowship offering. When Yahweh starts giving the instructions about the fellowship offering, Yahweh reminds Moses that the Israelites are still supposed to sacrifice part of the meat to Yahweh. When the Israelites bring the fellowship offering to sacrifice, the Israelites need to make sure to bring the right parts of the animal to give to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will show that Yahweh is talking about the parts of the fellowship offering that the Israelites will give to Yahweh. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites are supposed to bring the fat and the animal's breast to God with their own hands. Yahweh repeats over and over again that the Israelite who is making the offering needs to bring the special parts of the animal to Yahweh. The Israelite cannot send someone else to bring the offering.

Stop here and talk about a rule in your community that is very important for everyone to follow. How do you show how important that rule is when you talk about the rule? Pause this audio here.

When an Israelite brings the fat and the animal's breast, the Israelite must wave the breast in the air as a way to give those things to Yahweh. We do not know exactly how the Israelite waves the breast.

Stop here to do this activity as a group: Find an object that you can use to wave in the air. If you can use actual meat, use actual meat. How would you wave the object to show that you are giving it to Yahweh? How will you describe how the Israelite waves the breast? Pause this audio here.

The priest takes the fat from the Israelite and burns the fat on the altar. Then the priest takes the breast meat and shares the breast meat with the other priests. Then the Israelite gives the priest who burned the fat the right thigh of the animal. Yahweh explains that this is the special gift that the Israelites are supposed to give the priest who helped the Israelite make the sacrifice. The priest who burned the fat on the altar and threw the blood on the altar gets to eat the right thigh. Yahweh explains that the Israelites are giving the fellowship offering to Yahweh, and then Yahweh gives the breast meat and the right thigh to Yahweh's priests.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time where someone gave you something and then you gave part of that gift to someone else. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the storyteller talks about the specific day when Yahweh gave these instructions. In some translations, the storyteller is the only person who talks in this scene, and the scene is a summary of what Yahweh said. In other translations, Yahweh is still the person talking here. It is not clear in the original languages which option is correct, so choose the option that works best for your language or is the most like other translations in your area.

Stop here and discuss as a group whether Yahweh will tell this part of the story in your translation or whether the storyteller will tell the story. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller explains again that the Israelites gave the fellowship offering to Yahweh and then Yahweh gave specific meat from the fellowship offering to Yahweh's priests. Yahweh made this rule about what meat the priests could eat on the same day that Yahweh officially made Aaron and Aaron's sons the priests of the Israelites. Yahweh makes Aaron and Aaron's sons priests when Yahweh anoints Aaron and Aaron's sons. A person anoints another person when they pour or smear oil on that person to show that the person has a new job and things to do. Then the storyteller repeats the same information again. On the same day that Aaron and Aaron's sons became the priests of the Israelites, Yahweh said that all the Israelites need to give the priests these kinds of meat every time the Israelites make a fellowship offering. The rules will last forever. Every time an Israelite gives a fellowship offering to Yahweh, Aaron and Aaron's sons get to eat the animal's breast meat and the right thigh as their special portion of the sacrifice.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you act out that the storyteller repeats the rules for the fellowship offering when you act the story in the next step? How will you show that Yahweh gave these rules on the same day that Aaron and Aaron's sons became priests? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, the storyteller summarizes everything that has happened since Yahweh gave Moses instructions about the purification offering.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a long, complicated story as a group. Where do you summarize information when you tell stories? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller explains that all these instructions, since Yahweh gave the instructions about the purification offerings, are how the Israelites are supposed to offer the burnt offerings, grain offerings, purification offerings, guilt offerings, ordination offerings for appointing the priests, and fellowship offerings. These are the different kinds of offerings that the Israelites regularly make to Yahweh. Each offering gives the Israelites a different way to interact with Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Make a list of different activities your community does regularly. What words, phrases, or other features do you use to make it clear that the activities in the list are things your community does regularly? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller explains that Yahweh gave all these instructions to Moses while Moses was on Mount Sinai. It is important to remember that the first story in Leviticus talks about Yahweh giving instructions to Moses in the Tent of Meeting. Now the storyteller says that Yahweh gave Moses these instructions when Moses was on Mount Sinai. As you will remember, Leviticus has two groups of instructions. Yahweh may have given instructions to Moses about how to make the burnt offering, the grain offering, the fellowship offering, and the purification

offerings when Moses was in the Tent of Meeting, after Moses came down from Mount Sinai. Yahweh may have given instructions to Moses about how to make guilt offerings, what to do with the daily offerings, how to prepare someone to be a new priest, and what parts of the offerings the Israelites and priests can eat when Moses was still on Mount Sinai. Then Moses came down and had the people build the Tent of Meeting. This might mean that Yahweh gave the instructions in Leviticus chapters 6 and 7 before Yahweh gave the instructions in Leviticus chapters 1 to 5.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you show the new location and time when you act this out? Tell a story about a thing that happened in the past. How do you show that you have changed time or location in the story? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller also says that Yahweh gave the instructions to Moses on the same day that Yahweh commanded the Israelites to bring the Israelites' offerings to Yahweh while all the Israelites were living in the Wilderness of Sinai. The day the storyteller is describing is the first day the Israelites brought offerings to Yahweh. After this day, the Israelites could bring offerings to Yahweh on any day.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about an important event or tradition in your community. How did the event start? How do you talk about the event today? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:28–38 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The storyteller
- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelites
- Aaron
- Aaron's sons
- All of Aaron's descendants
- And the specific priest who sacrifices the peace offering

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

It is important to remember that Yahweh is telling Moses to give these instructions to the Israelites, so the Israelites are not actually making these sacrifices while Yahweh is talking to Moses. You may still act out the Israelites making the sacrifices in order to remember the story well.

The story starts when Yahweh tells Moses to give these instructions to the Israelites about the fellowship offering. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- Why are we talking about the fellowship offering again? or
- I did not know Yahweh would give more instructions about the fellowship offering. I need to make sure I write these instructions down.

Continue the drama. Yahweh explains that an Israelite who brings the fellowship offering needs to bring part of the offering specifically to Yahweh. The Israelite needs to bring the animal’s fat and the animal’s breast meat to Yahweh and give it to Yahweh as a wave offering. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I want to make sure Yahweh knows that this gift is from me; or
- I am excited to give this gift to Yahweh! or
- I wonder why it is so important that I bring this fat and meat with my own hands?

Continue the drama. The priest burns up the fat on the altar and gives the breast meat to Aaron, Aaron’s sons, and Aaron’s descendants. Then the Israelite gives the right thigh meat to the priest who made the sacrifice. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the priest, Aaron, Aaron’s sons, and Aaron’s descendants, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people may answer things like:

- I am so thankful that Yahweh gave us this meat to eat! or
- Now I do not have to worry about what to feed my family; or
- This meat is the best meat!

Ask the people playing the Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people may answer things like:

- Yahweh is giving the priests the best meat. Yahweh must really want us to respect the priests; or
- Yahweh must really love Yahweh’s priests. Yahweh wants to give the priests the best meat.

Continue the drama. Yahweh explains that Yahweh is giving the animal’s breast meat and right thigh meat to the priests forever. Aaron and Aaron’s descendants will always eat the animal’s breast meat, and the specific priest who offered the sacrifice will always eat the animal’s right thigh. This rule will last forever. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person may answer things like:

- I love my priests, and I want to make sure to always take care of the priests; or
- I want to make sure the Israelites know that the priests are important to me, so the Israelites will take care of the priests.

Continue the drama. Either the storyteller or Yahweh explains again that this meat is the meat that the priests get to eat from the sacrifices that the Israelites give to Yahweh. Yahweh gave these instructions on the same day that the priests officially became Yahweh’s priests.

Finally, the storyteller explains that Yahweh gave all of the instructions about the burnt offerings, grain offerings, purification offerings, guilt offerings, ordination offerings, and fellowship offerings to Moses when Moses was on Mount Sinai. The storyteller also explains that Yahweh gave all these instructions on the same day Yahweh told the Israelites to start bringing offerings to Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 7:28–38 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this story, the storyteller always refers to God as **Yahweh**. Yahweh tells Moses to give instructions to the **Israelites** about their **offerings**. It is important to remember that Yahweh is God’s name. For more information on Yahweh, Israelites, and the general word for offerings, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh, offerings, and Israelites as you used in previous passages.

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The instructions that Yahweh gives Moses are about **sacrifices** for the **peace or fellowship offering**. It is important to remember that Yahweh talked about the fellowship offering in chapter three and in the previous passage. The fellowship offering is the sacrifice the Israelites make whenever the Israelites want to give Yahweh a gift or praise Yahweh for something Yahweh has done. Use the same word or phrase for sacrifice and fellowship offering as you used in previous passages. Look up sacrifice and fellowship offering in the Master Glossary for more information.

The Israelites are supposed to bring the animal's **fat** to sacrifice to Yahweh. An animal's fat is the thick white substance on animal meat. Use the same word or phrase for fat as you used in previous passages. The Israelites are also supposed to bring the animal's breast meat.

Stop here and look at a picture of a cut of breast meat and a picture of an animal with the breast area circled as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the animal's **breast meat**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites are supposed to give the breast meat and the fat to Yahweh with a **wave offering**. A wave offering was a way for the Israelites to show that the Israelites were giving something to Yahweh without burning the item on the altar. An Israelite would probably hold the meat in the air and move it up and down and side to side to show that the meat belonged to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **wave offering**. Look up wave offering in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The breast meat of the animal belongs to Aaron and Aaron's sons. It is important to remember that Aaron and Aaron's sons were the people that Yahweh chose to be priests. Only members of Aaron's family could be priests in Israel. When Yahweh talks about Aaron and his sons here, Yahweh is also talking about all of Aaron's **descendants**. Use the same word or phrase for descendants as you have previously. Descendants is in the Master Glossary.

The Israelites are also supposed to give the priest who helped with the sacrifice the right thigh meat of the animal.

Stop here and look at a picture of a cut of thigh meat and a picture of an animal with the right thigh circled as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **right thigh**. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The right thigh is a gift or **portion** from Yahweh to Yahweh's priests. Use the same word or phrase for special portion or gift for the priests as you used in previous passages.

The story talks about the **fire offerings** to Yahweh. It is important to remember that these sacrifices included all the different kinds of offerings that the priests burned up on the altar. Use the same word or phrase for fire offerings as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh **anointed** Aaron and Aaron's **sons** as priests. This means that Yahweh specifically chose the priests and had Moses put oil on the priests to show that the priests would serve Yahweh. In this case, Yahweh is talking about Aaron's actual sons on the day Yahweh appointed them as priests. Use the same word or phrase for sons and anoint as you used in previous passages. For more information on sons and anoint, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh gives the Israelites a **statute**, or special rule, to give this portion of meat to the priests for **generations**. Generations are the groups of people who are living at the same time. Here, it means that the Israelites are supposed to keep giving this meat to the priests forever. Use the same words and phrases for statute and generations as you have used in previous passages, and refer to statutes and generations in the Master Glossary for more information.

The story ends with a list of six kinds of offerings. The first offering is the **burnt offering**. The second kind of offering is the **grain offering**. The third kind of offering is the **sin or purification offering**. The fourth kind of offering is the **guilt offering**. The fifth kind of offering is the **ordination offering**. The sixth kind of offering is the **fellowship offering**. Use the same words or phrases for burnt offering, grain offering, purification offering, guilt offering, and fellowship offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on these offerings, refer to the Master Glossary.

We will hear more about the ordination offering in Leviticus chapter 8. In that chapter, Yahweh will anoint Aaron and Aaron's sons as priests. Moses will fill Aaron's hands with meat, fat, and bread for a wave offering to Yahweh to show that Aaron is now a priest. The word the Israelites used for ordination offering reminds the people that Moses filled Aaron's hands with an offering to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **ordination offering**, or the offering that priests gave to Yahweh when Yahweh appointed new priests. This should be a special phrase that shows that someone is appointing someone else for a special job. Use the same word for ordination that you used in Exodus 29:22. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh gave Moses all these instructions on **Mount Sinai**. Use the same word or phrase for Mount Sinai as you used in previous passages.

While Yahweh gave Moses these instructions, the Israelites were camped in the **Wilderness** of Sinai. Use the same word or phrase for the Wilderness of Sinai as you used in previous passages. Look up wilderness in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 7:28–28

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (616 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.7 MB)

- Filling the Gaps (3.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (804 KB)

Leviticus 8:1–13

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 8:1–13 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:1–13 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, Yahweh told Moses what meat from the sacrifices the Israelites should give to the priests to eat. Now, the storyteller tells the story about how Yahweh appoints Aaron and Aaron's sons to officially begin their work as Yahweh's priests. In the book of Exodus, chapter 29, Yahweh gave Moses specific instructions about how Moses was supposed to make Aaron and Aaron's sons into Yahweh's priests. If you have already translated Exodus 29, listen to your translation here to remember what Yahweh said.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh told Moses to bring Aaron and Aaron's sons to the Tent of Meeting. Moses was also supposed to bring all of the other things that Moses would need to officially make Aaron and Aaron's sons Yahweh's priests. Moses needed to bring the special clothing that Aaron and Aaron's sons would wear, special oil, a bull to sacrifice for a purification offering, two male sheep, and a basket of bread without yeast. Moses would use all of these items to make Aaron and Aaron's sons Yahweh's official priests. Yahweh also told Moses to make sure that all the people of Israel gather at the Tent of Meeting to watch what was going to happen.

Stop here and discuss this question: Tell a story about a time when your community gave someone an important role or position in the community. What ceremonies or rituals did your community do to honor that person? What objects or items did you use? Who came to the ceremony? Pause this audio here.

When Moses finished bringing everything to the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting, and the special assembly of Israelites were at the tent too, Moses told the Israelites that Moses was about to do what Yahweh had told Moses to do.

Stop here and look at a picture of the Tent of Meeting and the courtyard outside of it to see where everyone stood to watch the ceremony. Pause this audio here.

First, Moses had Aaron and Aaron's sons wash themselves in water. The storyteller does not say whether Aaron and Aaron's sons washed their entire bodies or whether Aaron and Aaron's sons only washed their hands and their feet. In other parts of the Bible, we know that priests washed their hands and feet every time the priests entered the Tent of Meeting, so some people think that Aaron and Aaron's sons only washed their hands and feet here. Other people think that Aaron and Aaron's sons washed their entire bodies. On one of the most holy days of the year, the Day of Atonement, the high priest had to wash his entire body to show that the high priest was ritually clean and could offer the sacrifices to Yahweh. Since Aaron and Aaron's sons were becoming Yahweh's holy priests, Aaron and Aaron's sons might have washed their entire bodies to show that Aaron and Aaron's sons

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were ready to devote their whole bodies to follow Yahweh. It is important to know that Aaron and Aaron's sons were probably still wearing some sort of thin clothing if Aaron and Aaron's sons washed their entire bodies, so Aaron and Aaron's sons were not naked in front of everyone.

Stop here and discuss this question: Tell a story about a holy time or day for your community. What do different members of your community do to prepare themselves for that day? Pause this audio here.

After Aaron and Aaron's sons had washed themselves, Moses put special clothing on Aaron to show that Aaron had a special position as the most important priest out of all the priests.

Stop here and discuss this question: Think about the most important people in your community. What do those people wear? How do people in your community know that those people are the most important people? Pause this audio here.

The first piece of special clothing that Moses put on Aaron was a tunic. People wore tunics next to the body under all the other clothing. A tunic had long sleeves and sometimes had embroidery as well.

Stop here and look at a picture of a man wearing a tunic. Pause this audio here.

Next, Moses wrapped a sash around Aaron's waist. A sash is a long piece of cloth that people wrap around themselves to help keep their clothing on their bodies.

Stop here and look at a picture of a man wearing a tunic and a sash. Pause this audio here.

After the sash, Moses put a robe on Aaron. People would make a robe out of one long piece of fabric. A robe had a hole for the head and two holes for the arms. Aaron's robe covered Aaron from his neck to down below his knees.

Stop here and look at a picture of a man wearing a robe. Pause this audio here.

Once Moses put the robe on Aaron, Moses tied an ephod on Aaron. The Bible does not give detailed descriptions of an ephod, so it is hard to know exactly what an ephod was. We do know that Aaron did not put the ephod on over Aaron's head like a shirt. Moses tied the ephod onto Aaron using a special, beautiful sash. Some people think the ephod looked like a vest, and some people think it looked like an apron that Moses tied around Aaron's neck and waist. People made the ephod of high-quality materials like gold, different colors of wool fabric, and fine linen.

Stop here and look at a picture of a man wearing an ephod over the robe. Pause this audio here.

Then Moses tied a breastpiece onto Aaron's ephod. People made the breastpiece of the same high-quality materials as the ephod, and Moses used fine gold chains to attach the breastpiece to the ephod. The breastpiece had 12 precious stones as decoration. Each stone had the name of a different tribe of Israel on it.

Stop here and look at a picture of a man wearing a breastpiece over the ephod and robe. Pause this audio here.

Moses put two items, the Urim and Thummim, in special pockets in the breastpiece. The Bible does not tell us exactly what the Urim and Thummim looked like. The priests were supposed to use Urim and Thummim to understand what God wanted the priests to do, but the Bible does not tell us how God used Urim and Thummim to communicate with the Israelites.

Once Urim and Thummim were safely in the special pockets in the breastpiece, Moses placed a turban on Aaron's head. The turban could have been a long piece of fabric that Moses wound around the top of Aaron's head. Or a turban could have been a special kind of hat that Aaron could take on and off without unwinding it.

Next, Moses set a special gold decoration on Aaron's turban. On the gold decoration were the words "Holy to Yahweh," and Moses attached the decoration to the turban. The decoration might have been a rectangle shape, or it might have been a flower shape. Yahweh called the decoration a holy crown that only the high priest could wear. The crown showed that Yahweh specifically chose Aaron to be the high priest.

Stop here and look at a picture of a man wearing all the priestly clothing that Moses has put on Aaron so far, including a turb
Pause this audio here.

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After Moses put all the special clothing on Aaron, Moses took the special oil that Moses had brought and used the oil to anoint the Tent of Meeting. The Israelites made the oil using special herbs and spices that Yahweh told the Israelites to use. When Moses poured or sprinkled the oil onto something, Moses was anointing that thing as a sign that the thing belonged to Yahweh. People had to treat the thing differently. People had to be careful not to disrespect the thing or to touch the thing when people were ritually unclean because the thing was one of Yahweh's special objects.

Moses sprinkled this special oil on the Tent of Meeting and on everything inside the Tent of Meeting to show that it all belonged to Yahweh. Moses also showed that people could only use the Tent of Meeting and all the things inside the tent to worship Yahweh. When it was time for Moses to anoint the altar, Moses sprinkled the oil on the bronze altar in the courtyard seven times. Moses also put oil on all the other things that the priests would need to use when the priests sacrificed animals on the altar. Once Moses finished sprinkling the oil on the altar and all the other tools, those items belonged to Yahweh, and the priests could use those items to worship Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when your community wanted to give something to Yahweh or to someone important. What did you do to show that the gift belonged to that person? Pause this audio here.

Now that the Tent of Meeting and everything in it officially belonged to Yahweh, Moses poured oil on Aaron's head. This showed everyone that Yahweh had chosen Aaron to be Yahweh's priest. Aaron belonged to Yahweh now and could serve Yahweh as Yahweh's priest.

After Moses poured the oil on Aaron's head, Moses put special clothing on Aaron's sons. Moses put tunics and sashes on Aaron's sons just like Moses had put on Aaron. Then Moses put special hats on Aaron's sons' heads. These hats were different from Aaron's hat, but the Bible does not tell us exactly what these hats looked like. The hats could be skullcaps that covered the top and back of a person's head but did not have a brim. Or the hats could be tall hats that Moses tied onto Aaron's sons' heads.

Stop here and look at a picture of a man wearing a skullcap and a picture of a man wearing a tall hat.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses what Moses needs to bring to make Aaron and Aaron's sons official priests.

In the second scene: Moses puts special clothing on Aaron.

In the third scene: Moses uses the special anointing oil to show that the Tent of Meeting and Aaron belong to Yahweh.

In the fourth scene: Moses puts special clothing on Aaron's sons.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The assembly of the people of Israel
- And Aaron's sons

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, the storyteller interrupts the long list of laws that Yahweh gives to Moses so that the Israelites can live in good relationship with Yahweh. The storyteller now tells the story about when Yahweh appoints Aaron

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and Aaron's sons to be priests for Yahweh. Yahweh tells Moses to bring Aaron and Aaron's sons to the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh also tells Moses to bring the other things that Moses will need for the ceremony to consecrate Aaron and Aaron's sons as Yahweh's official priests. Yahweh tells Moses to bring all the priests' clothing, the special oil, the bull for the sin or purification offering, two rams or male sheep, and a basket with bread that people made without yeast. Yahweh also tells Moses to bring all the people of Israel—the assembly—to the courtyard in front of the door of the Tent of Meeting. The assembly of people would not have been the entire population of Israelites, but it would have been a large number of people who represented the entire group of Israelites. The entrance to the Tent of Meeting probably referred to the entire courtyard around the Tent of Meeting.

Moses does everything Yahweh told Moses to. It is important to know that Yahweh did not tell Moses to bring everything by himself, so other people probably help Moses bring all the objects and animals to the Tent of Meeting. It is also important to know that the assembly of Israelites filled the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting to watch the ceremony.

In scene two, Moses tells the people that the ceremony Moses is about to do is the ceremony that Yahweh wants Moses to do. Moses is telling the people that everything Moses is going to do to make Aaron and Aaron's sons Yahweh's priests is exactly how Yahweh wants the Israelites to consecrate, or make holy, priests in the future.

Stop and discuss as a group: What is something that you do that you need to do in a specific way? Explain how to do that task to the group. What do you say to show the rest of the group how important that task is and why people have to do that task in that specific way? Pause this audio here.

Moses has Aaron and Aaron's sons step away from the rest of the Israelites and has Aaron and Aaron's sons wash themselves with water. Then Moses puts special clothing on Aaron. First, Moses puts a tunic on Aaron. Then Moses wraps a sash around Aaron's waist. Then Moses puts a robe over Aaron's head and ties the ephod onto Aaron with the special sash. After Moses ties the ephod onto Aaron, Moses attaches the breastpiece to the ephod and puts the Urim and Thummim in special pockets in the breastpiece. Finally, Moses puts the turban on Aaron's head and sets the gold plate, or the holy crown, on top.

Stop here and find different kinds of clothing and fabric that you can use to represent the different kinds of clothing that Moses put on Aaron. Choose one person to play Aaron and one person to play Moses. Have the person who is playing Moses put the different kinds of clothing on the person who is playing Aaron. Once the person playing Moses finishes, choose different people to play Moses or Aaron. Keep taking turns until everyone has a chance to be Moses and everyone has a chance to be Aaron. Pause this audio here.

When Moses puts the special clothing on Aaron, Moses does exactly what Yahweh had told Moses to do in the book of Exodus when Yahweh told Moses how to do this specific ceremony.

If you have already translated the book of Exodus, listen to Exodus 29 to remember how you translated Yahweh's instructions about the priests' clothing. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Moses uses the special anointing oil to anoint the Tent of Meeting, all the special tools and objects that the priests would use to worship Yahweh, and Aaron himself. Moses sprinkles the oil seven times on the altar and all the tools that the priests need when the priests sacrifice an animal on the altar. When Moses sprinkles the oil, Moses uses his fingers to flick small drops of oil onto the altar and the tools.

Stop here and find a bowl of oil. If you cannot use oil, then find a bowl of water instead. Practice sprinkling the oil or water on different objects. Choose one object to represent the altar and sprinkle the oil or water on it seven times. How do you describe this action? Pause this audio here.

Moses pours the anointing oil over Aaron's head to show that Yahweh had chosen Aaron to be Yahweh's special high priest. This also shows that Yahweh allows Aaron to touch things in the Tent of Meeting and do things to worship Yahweh that no one else could do.

Stop here and pour some of the water or oil in the bowl from the last activity onto the head of someone in the group who is willing to play Aaron. If no one in the group wants to play Aaron, find a large rock or other round object and pour the water or oil onto that instead. How would you talk about that action? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, Moses puts special clothing on Aaron's sons. First, Moses puts a tunic on Aaron's sons. Then Moses ties sashes around Aaron's sons' waists. Finally, Moses puts their special hats on Aaron's sons' heads.

Stop here and find clothing or fabric that represents or is similar to the kinds of clothing that Moses puts on Aaron's sons. Choose one person to play Moses and one person to play one of Aaron's sons. Have the person who is playing Moses practice putting the clothing on the person playing Aaron's son. Take turns playing Moses and Aaron's son until everyone has had a chance to play both parts. Pause this audio here.

When Moses puts this special clothing on Aaron's sons, Moses is following Yahweh's instructions from the book of Exodus.

If you have already translated the book of Exodus, listen again, if needed, to how you translated Yahweh's instructions about the priests' clothing in Exodus 29. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The assembly of the people of Israel
- And Aaron's sons

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

At the beginning of the story, Yahweh tells Moses to bring Aaron and Aaron's sons, the special clothing Aaron and Aaron's sons will wear as priests, the bull for the purification offering, two male goats, and a basket of bread without yeast. Yahweh also tells Moses to make sure all the people of Israel come to the front of the Tent of Meeting. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- It is finally time for Aaron and Aaron's sons to become my priests. I am very excited; or
- I want all the Israelites to see how important it is to be one of my priests; or
- These are important instructions. I want Moses to follow my instructions very carefully.

Continue the drama. Moses does exactly what Yahweh tells Moses to do, and all of the Israelites gather in front of the Tent of Meeting. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- There are so many instructions! I hope I do all of the instructions correctly! or

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- This is an important day for my brother, Aaron, and for all of the people of Israel. I am so excited!

Ask the people playing the Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- I am so curious about what is going to happen! or
- This must be very important if we all need to be here to watch; or
- I am so excited that Aaron and Aaron’s sons are becoming our priests! Now we can offer sacrifices to Yahweh.

Continue the drama. Moses tells everyone that the ceremony Moses is about to do is the ceremony that Yahweh said Moses needs to do. Then Moses tells Aaron and Aaron’s sons to come away from the other Israelites and join Moses in front of everyone. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Aaron and Aaron’s sons, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- I am so nervous. I do not know what will happen or what to expect! or
- I am so honored that Yahweh chose me to be Yahweh’s priest. I will do my best to follow Yahweh.

Continue the drama. Moses has Aaron and Aaron’s sons wash themselves, and then Moses puts all of the special clothing on Aaron. First, Moses puts the tunic over Aaron’s head. Then Moses ties the sash around Aaron’s waist. Then Moses puts the robe over Aaron’s head and ties the ephod onto Aaron with the special waistband. Then Moses ties the breastpiece onto Aaron and places the Urim and Thummim in their special pockets on the breastpiece. Finally, Moses places the turban on Aaron’s head and attaches the gold plate, or the holy crown, to the front of it. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person may answer things like:

- This clothing shows that I have an important role to serve Yahweh. I need to make sure I do the right thing; or
- This is a lot of different kinds of clothing. I will need to be careful about how I put the clothing on to make sure I follow all of Yahweh’s instructions.

Ask the people playing the Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- Yahweh wanted Aaron to wear such fancy clothing. Aaron must have a very important role; or
- I wonder if Aaron’s sons will have clothing that is just as special as Aaron’s clothing.

Continue the drama. Once Aaron is wearing all of Aaron’s special clothing, Moses takes the anointing oil and sprinkles the oil on the tabernacle and all the things inside the tabernacle. Then Moes sprinkles the oil on the altar seven times and on all the other tools that the priests would use to sacrifice an animal on the altar. Pause the drama. and ask the person playing Moses, “What are you thinking or feeling?” The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that this all belongs to Yahweh now, and we can use these things to worship Yahweh and follow all of Yahweh’s instructions;
- I hope all the Israelites treat these objects carefully and respectfully because these items belong to Yahweh now.

[!end] Continue the drama.

Moses pours the oil over Aaron’s head. Pause the drama. and ask the person playing Moses, “What are you thinking or feeling?” The person might answer things like:

- I am so proud of my brother. I cannot believe Aaron is Yahweh’s first high priest; or
- I hope Aaron does a good job as Aaron serves Yahweh as Yahweh’s high priest.

Ask the person playing Aaron, “What are you thinking or feeling?” The person might answer things like:

- I cannot believe that I am becoming Yahweh’s high priest now; or
- I need to be even more careful to follow all of Yahweh’s instructions now that I am becoming Yahweh’s high priest.

Continue the drama. Finally, Moses puts the special clothing on Aaron's sons. Moses puts a tunic over Aaron's sons' heads, ties a sash around their waists, and puts special hats on their heads. Pause the drama. and ask the people playing Aaron's sons, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The people might answer things like:

- I cannot believe that I am becoming a priest of Yahweh. This is the most important moment in my life; or
- I will do everything I can to worship and obey Yahweh and help the Israelites follow all of Yahweh's instructions.

Ask the people playing the Israelites, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The people might answer things like:

- Aaron must be a more important priest since Aaron is wearing different clothing than Aaron's sons; or
- Aaron's sons are wearing such special clothing. When I see that clothing, I will know that I need to listen to Aaron's sons because Aaron's sons are Yahweh's priests; or
- I am excited to be able to make sacrifices to Yahweh now that Aaron's sons are becoming priests.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:1–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The story starts with **Yahweh** giving Moses instructions. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh that you used for previous passages. Look up Yahweh in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh tells Moses to bring Aaron, Aaron's **sons**, and many other things to the **Tent of Meeting**. In this case, Aaron's sons are Aaron's male children. Use the same word for sons as you have used in previous passages, and refer to sons in the Master Glossary for more information. Use the same word or phrase for the Tent of Meeting that you used for previous passages. Look up the tabernacle in the Master Glossary for more information.

Moses must bring the **bull** for the **sin or purification offering**, two **male sheep** or rams, and a basket with **bread** that people made **without yeast**. Use the same words or phrases for bull, male sheep, bread without yeast, and sin or purification offering as you have used in previous passages. For more information about the purification offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

People use a basket to carry or store things, and in this case, the people carried bread in the basket. People make baskets by weaving together thin sticks, stems of plants, or reeds. A reed is a plant that grows in the water.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for a **basket**. Look at a picture of a basket. We do not know how big this basket was. For more information, refer to basket in the Master Glossary.

One of the things that Yahweh tells Moses to bring to the Tent of Meeting is the clothing that Aaron and Aaron's sons will wear once they become priests. This is a general word that describes any kind of clothing.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **clothing**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also tells Moses to bring anointing oil to the Tent of Meeting. In the Bible, people would **anoint** other people or things by pouring, sprinkling, or smearing oil on the person or thing to show that God had chosen that person or thing for a special purpose. Use the same word or phrase for anoint that you used for previous passages. Look up anoint in the Master Glossary for more information.

Moses obeys Yahweh and gathers the assembly at the Tent of Meeting. The assembly is a general word that describes the people of Israel, and often specifically a special group of representatives from Israel. It shows that representatives, or leaders, throughout all of Israel are gathering together for a specific purpose. In this story, the specific purpose is to watch Moses do the ritual that will make Aaron and Aaron's sons into Yahweh's priests.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **assembly**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

When everyone is standing in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting, Moses puts a tunic on Aaron. A tunic is a long-sleeved piece of clothing that covers a person's torso and goes under all a person's other clothing. It is important to remember that Yahweh described all of the different kinds of clothing that Yahweh wanted the

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priests to wear in the book of Exodus. If you have already translated the book of Exodus, you can listen to the story about the priests' clothing there to learn more.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a man wearing a **tunic**. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for tunic. Look up tunic in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

After Moses puts the tunic on Aaron, Moses ties a sash around Aaron's waist. A sash is a long piece of cloth that people wrap around their waists to help hold their clothing on their bodies.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a man wearing a tunic and **sash**. Decide as a group what word or phrase you will use for sash. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Next, Moses puts a robe on Aaron. People would make a robe from a single piece of fabric, and a robe had holes for a person's head and arms. The robe covered people from their neck down to below their knees, and people wore a robe on top of other clothing, like tunics.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a man wearing a **robe**. Decide what word or phrase you will use for robe. Look up robe in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word here that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Moses puts an ephod on Aaron over the robe. The ephod was a kind of clothing that covered the body from the shoulders to the thighs. Moses ties the ephod onto Aaron using a special sash.

Stop here and look at a picture of a man wearing an **ephod**. Decide as a group what word or phrase you will use for ephod. Look up ephod in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word here that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

After the ephod, Moses puts a breastpiece on Aaron. This is a special piece of fabric that Moses tied onto Aaron's ephod. The Israelites attached 12 precious stones to the fabric and wrote the name of a different tribe of Israel on each stone. The breastpiece also had special pockets in it for the Urim and Thummim.

Stop here and look at a picture of a man wearing a **breastpiece**. Decide as a group what word or phrase you will use for breastpiece. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word here that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Moses places the Urim and Thummim into the special pockets in the breastpiece. The Urim and Thummim were objects that Yahweh used to tell the Israelites what Yahweh wanted the Israelites to do. The Bible never describes what the Urim and Thummim looked like or exactly what the Israelites did to use the Urim and Thummim.

Stop here and decide as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Urim** and **Thummim**. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the bible, use the same word or words here that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Moses puts a turban on Aaron's head. A turban is a kind of hat that people wear. People make a turban out of a single long piece of fabric and wind it around their head to make a hat. Moses might have wound the fabric around Aaron's head, or people may have sewn together the fabric so that Moses could set the turban on Aaron's head like other kinds of hats.

Stop here and look at a picture of a **turban** as a group. Decide what word or phrase you will use to translate turban. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you used there. Pause this audio here.

Moses puts one more piece of clothing on Aaron. Moses puts a special golden plate on Aaron's turban. The Israelites might have made the golden plate in the shape of a flower, or the Israelites might have made the golden plate in the shape of a rectangle. Moses attached the plate to the most important priest's turban, and the Israelites carved the words "Holy to Yahweh" onto the plate.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of the **golden plate**. Decide what word or phrase you will use to translate the golden plate. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller describes the golden plate as a **holy** crown. The word holy describes things that belong to Yahweh. People cannot use holy things to do ordinary tasks. Holy things belong completely to Yahweh, and people must only use these holy items to serve Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for holy as you used in previous passages. Look up holy in the Master Glossary for more information.

Moses **sprinkles** some of the oil on the tabernacle and everything in the tabernacle, the bronze **altar** in the courtyard, the water basin or large bowl, and all the utensils that people used for work at the altar. Use the same words for sprinkle as you have used previously when priests sprinkle blood on an object with their fingers. Use the same word for altar as you have used previously. For more information about altar, refer to the Master Glossary.

The basin is a very large bowl that priests put water in. The utensils are all the forks, knives, and small bowls that priests used for work at the altar.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **tabernacle**. This is the first time in Leviticus that the storyteller uses a specific word for Yahweh's living place rather than calling it a tent. For more information about tabernacle, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **basin** and **utensils**. Use the same words for basin and utensils as you used in Exodus 35:16. Pause this audio here.

Moses pours the anointing oil on Aaron's head to consecrate Aaron. When someone consecrates someone else, the person who is doing the consecration is saying that the other person has a special job now. In other words, the priests are now holy—they belong to Yahweh. Moses consecrated Aaron, so now Aaron has the special job of being Israel's high priest.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **consecrate**. Look up consecrate in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Finally, Moses puts tunics on Aaron's sons, ties sashes around their waists, and places caps on their heads. These caps were different kinds of hats from Aaron's turban. The Israelites probably made Aaron's turban by winding a long piece of fabric around Aaron's head, but the Israelites made these caps out of a smaller piece of fabric. The Israelites probably made the caps into the shape of a circle, and the caps sat on the top of Aaron's sons' heads. Another word for this kind of hat is a skullcap. Another option is that the caps were tall hats that Moses tied onto the priests' heads.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of a cap and a hat. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **caps**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 8:1–13

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (590 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (6.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (823 KB)

Leviticus 8:14–21

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 8:14–21 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:14–21 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:14–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Once Moses finished putting the special priestly clothing on Aaron and Aaron's sons, it was time for Moses to offer the sacrifices so that Aaron and Aaron's sons could officially start serving Yahweh as Yahweh's priests. It is important to remember that Yahweh gave Moses the specific instructions about how to make the sacrifices that would make Aaron and Aaron's sons into Yahweh's priests in the book of Exodus in chapter 29. If you have already translated Exodus 29, you can listen to your translation here to remember what Yahweh said.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, Moses brought a bull and two male sheep to the Tent of Meeting along with the special clothing. In this story, Moses sacrificed the bull on behalf of Aaron and Aaron's sons. The bull is a sin or purification offering. It is important to remember that Yahweh gave instructions to Moses in Leviticus 4 about how to sacrifice an animal for a purification offering. When Yahweh gave those instructions, Yahweh said that the high priest needed to sacrifice a bull if the high priest ever sinned. The sacrifice would atone for the high priest. The sacrifice would pay for the high priest's sins so that the high priest did not need to die. The story does not say that Aaron and Aaron's sons have done any specific sins, but Aaron and Aaron's sons were about to become the most holy people in the community. Aaron and Aaron's sons were going to serve Yahweh in the Tent of Meeting. Aaron and

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Aaron's sons needed to be ritually clean from any sin so that they could offer the sacrifices that would pay for all of the Israelites' sins.

Stop here and tell a story about a ritual that a holy person in your community needs to do in order to keep serving the community in their position. Pause this audio here.

Aaron and Aaron's sons placed their hands on the bull's head, and then Moses killed the bull. Moses took some of the bull's blood and put the blood on the four horns of the altar.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of the altar with the four horns circled. Pause this audio here.

Moses put the blood on the horns of the altar to purify the altar. The Israelites were going to use the altar to give sacrifices to Yahweh, so the altar needed to be ritually clean. The blood from the sin offering ritually cleaned the altar so that the priests could offer sacrifices on it.

After Moses put the blood on the horns of the altar, Moses poured the rest of the blood at the base of the altar. The words in the original language here are confusing, so scholars have two main ways to understand what this part means.

The first option is that Moses poured the blood at the base of the altar to make atonement for the altar to purify the altar from sin. Once Moses purified the altar from sin, Moses consecrated the altar and gave the altar a special purpose to serve Yahweh. Humans made the altar, so the altar might have human sin on it simply because people made the altar. When Moses poured the blood on the altar, Moses cleaned away that sin and made the altar special so people could use the altar to serve Yahweh.

The second option is that Moses made the altar special to Yahweh so that people could use the altar to make atonement for people's sins. The altar did not have any sin on it, but priests were going to use the altar to make sacrifices that would atone for the Israelites' sins. If the priests were going to use the altar to pay for the Israelites' sins, then the priests needed to consecrate the altar. Moses had to set apart the altar to serve Yahweh in a specific way. When Moses poured the blood on the altar, Moses was consecrating the altar so that the priests could use the altar to atone for Israel's sins.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when you or someone in your community prepared a space or an object so that the community could use it to worship Yahweh, an ancestor, a spirit, or a god. Pause this audio here.

After Moses poured the blood on the altar, Moses took the bull's fat, the best part of the liver, the kidneys and all the fat that was on the kidneys, and Moses burned those pieces up on the altar.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of a cow's fat, liver, kidneys, and the fat that is on the cow's kidneys. Pause this audio here.

After the bull's fat, liver, kidneys, and the fat that was on the bull's kidneys finished burning, Moses took the rest of the bull outside the camp. Moses took the bull's skin, meat, and all the other organs that were inside the bull, and Moses burned up those parts outside the camp, away from where the Israelites lived. All these things that Moses did were exactly what Yahweh had told Moses to do earlier in the book of Exodus.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of a bull's skin, meat, and other organs. Pause this audio here.

After Moses finished sacrificing the bull, Moses brought one of the male sheep, which people also call rams, to Aaron and Aaron's sons. This ram was the ram that Moses was going to sacrifice as a burnt offering for Aaron and Aaron's sons. It is important to remember that a burnt offering was like a gift that the Israelites gave Yahweh. The priests burned the whole animal on the altar so that the offering would be a gift that smelled good to Yahweh.

Stop here and listen to how you translated Yahweh's instructions on how to sacrifice a burnt offering in Leviticus 1. Pause this audio here.

Aaron and Aaron's sons placed their hands on the ram's head, and then Moses killed the ram and threw the ram's blood on the sides of the altar. Moses cut the ram into pieces and burned the head, the pieces, and the fat on the altar.

Stop here and look at a picture of a ram's head, fat, and meat. Pause this audio here.

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Then Moses washed the ram's internal organs and the ram's legs with water, and Moses burned the whole ram on the altar.

Stop here and look at pictures of a ram's internal organs and legs. Pause this audio here.

When Moses sacrificed the ram, Moses did everything exactly as Yahweh told Moses to do. The ram was a burnt offering that made a good smell for Yahweh to smell. It was a gift that Moses gave Yahweh with fire.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:14–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Moses sacrifices the bull for the sin or purification offering for the priests.

In the second scene: Moses sacrifices the ram for the burnt offering for the priests.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Aaron
- Aaron's sons
- The assembly of Israelites
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

It is important to remember that the assembly of Israelites was still watching Moses in this passage, even though the storyteller does not mention the assembly.

In the previous story, Moses brought a bull and two rams to the Tent of Meeting. The bull that Moses sacrificed in the first scene in this story is the bull that Moses brought in the previous story.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will act out that this bull is the same bull from the previous story. Pause this audio here.

The bull was a purification offering for Aaron and Aaron's sons.

First, Aaron and Aaron's sons placed their hands on the bull's head. Then Moses killed the bull and put his own finger in the blood. Moses used his finger to spread the blood on the four horns of the altar.

Stop here and find a rock or piece of wood that is similar in shape to the horn of the altar. Fill a bowl with water. Take turns dipping your finger in the water and smearing the water on the rock or piece of wood. Remember how you described this action in previous passages. Pause this audio here.

Moses poured the rest of the blood at the base of the altar. The base is the bottom of the altar where the altar touches the ground.

Stop here and look at a picture of the altar together and point to where the base of the altar is. Then find a large rock or tree. Take turns pouring water from the bowl at the base of the rock or tree. Remember how you described this action in previous passages. Pause this audio here.

After Moses finished putting the blood on the altar, Moses removed the bull's fat, the best part of the liver, the kidneys, and the fat from both kidneys, and Moses burned these pieces on the altar. Then Moses took the rest of the bull outside the camp and burned the rest of the bull there just like Yahweh had told Moses to.

Next, Moses brought one of the two rams from the last story. Moses would sacrifice this ram as the burnt offering for Aaron and Aaron's sons.

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Stop here and discuss how you are going to show that the ram for this burnt offering is one of the rams that Moses brought to the tent in the last story. Pause this audio here.

Moses brought the ram to Aaron and Aaron's sons, who put their hands on the ram's head. Then Moses killed the ram and threw the ram's blood against the sides of the altar.

Stop here and fill a bowl with water. Take turns splashing the water against a rock or tree. Remember how you described this action in previous passages. Pause this audio here.

Then Moses cut the ram into pieces and burned the ram's head, meat, and fat on the altar. Next, Moses washed the ram's internal organs and legs with water and burned the rest of the ram on the altar. The ram was a burnt offering that smelled good to Yahweh, and it was a gift the priests burned with fire to give to Yahweh. The story ends when it says that Moses offered the ram to Yahweh exactly as Yahweh told Moses to.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:14–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Aaron
- The assembly of Israelites
- Aaron's sons
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Moses brings the bull for the sin offering to Aaron and Aaron's sons. Aaron and Aaron's sons lay their hands on the bull's head. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Aaron and Aaron's sons, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people may answer things like:

- This is a serious moment. This bull needs to die because of my sins, so that I do not have to die; or
- I cannot believe this is actually happening. I am going to officially be one of Yahweh's priests.

Continue the drama. Moses kills the bull and sticks his finger in the blood. Moses uses his finger to smear blood on the altar's four horns. Then Moses pours the rest of the blood at the altar's base. In this way, Moses purifies the altar and makes atonement for it. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person may answer things like:

- Now the altar is clean from sin, and the altar officially belongs to Yahweh; or
- Now this altar officially belongs to Yahweh, and the priests can use the altar to make sacrifices to Yahweh to atone for all the Israelites' sins.

Leviticus 8:14–21

Continue the drama. Then Moses takes the fat from the inside of the bull, the liver, the kidneys, and the fat that is on the bull's kidneys and burns all of these on the altar. Then Moses takes the rest of the bull outside the camp and burns the rest of the bull with fire, just as Yahweh told Moses to do it. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am very happy with Moses because Moses listened to my instructions and did exactly what I told Moses to do; or
- I am happy that Aaron, Aaron's sons, and the altar are almost ready to serve me.

Continue the drama. Next, Moses brings one of the rams to Aaron and Aaron's sons. Aaron and Aaron's sons lay their hands on the ram's head. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Aaron and Aaron's sons, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people may answer things like:

- This is a very serious moment. This animal is going to need to die to give this gift to Yahweh; or
- I am excited to give this gift to Yahweh.

Continue the drama. Moses kills the ram and throws the ram's blood on the sides of the altar. Then Moses cuts the ram into pieces, and puts the ram's head, the pieces of the meat, and the fat on the altar. Moses burns those parts of the ram. Then Moses washes the ram's legs and internal organs with water and burns all the rest of the ram's parts on the altar as a burnt offering that smells good to Yahweh. This is a fire offering to Yahweh. Moses offers this fire offering in the way that Yahweh told Moses to offer it. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am very happy with Moses because Moses listened to my instructions and did exactly what I told Moses to do; or
- I am happy that Aaron, Aaron's sons, and the altar are almost ready to serve me.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:14–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Moses first brings a **bull** to Aaron and Aaron's **sons**. It is important to remember that bulls are male cattle. Use the same words or phrases for bull and sons as you used in previous passages. Sons is in the Master Glossary.

Moses is going to kill the bull as a **sin or purification offering**. It is important to remember that Yahweh gave Moses the instructions for how to sacrifice a bull for a purification offering in Leviticus 4. Use the same words or phrases for killing an animal and for purification offering here as you used in previous passages. Look up "sin or purification offering" in the Master Glossary for more information.

After Moses kills the bull, Moses uses his finger to put some of the blood on the horns of the **altar**. Use the same word or phrase for the horns of the altar as you used in previous passages. Look in the Master Glossary for more information on the altar.

Moses puts the blood on the horns of the altar to purify the altar. When you purify something, you ritually clean the thing so that it can become special to Yahweh, and so people can use that thing to worship Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **purify**. Look up purify in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Moses pours the rest of the bull's blood on the altar to **consecrate** the altar, or make it holy, so the priests can use the altar for Yahweh. It is important to remember that to consecrate an object meant that the object officially belonged to Yahweh. Priests could only use objects that the priests had consecrated to worship Yahweh. Look up consecrate in the Master Glossary for more information. Use the same word or phrase for consecrate as you used in previous passages.

The priests will use the altar to **atone** for the Israelites' sins. It is important to remember that atonement is what happens when a person offers the correct offerings to Yahweh so that they can have a good relationship with

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Yahweh again. Look up atonement in the Master Glossary for more information. Use the same word or phrase for atone as you used in previous passages.

It is important to remember that there are two main ways to understand what Moses does with the altar. The first option is that Moses atones for the altar, cleans any sin off the altar, and consecrates the altar. The second option is that Moses consecrates the altar so that the priests can use the altar to offer the sacrifices to atone for Israel's sin.

Stop here and discuss as a group which option you will use in your translation. Look at other translations in majority languages or related languages and see which option they choose. Pause this audio here.

Moses burns the bull's **fat** on the altar. Use the same word for fat as you used in previous passages. Moses also burns the bull's **liver**, **kidneys**, and the **fat** that is on the bull's kidneys. Use the same words or phrases for liver, kidneys, and the fat that is on the bull's kidneys as you used in previous passages.

Then Moses takes the bull's **skin**, **meat**, and **inside organs** outside the camp. Use the same words for the bull's skin, meat, and inside organs as you used in previous passages.

Moses takes all these things outside the **camp** to burn these things. It is important to remember that the camp is where the Israelites lived. Moses is taking the bull's skin, meat, and inside organs away from where the Israelites lived. Use the same word for camp as you used in previous passages.

Moses follows all of **Yahweh's** instructions exactly as Yahweh said. In this passage, the narrator calls God "Yahweh." Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. Look up Yahweh in the Master Glossary for more information.

Then, Moses brings the **ram** to Aaron and Aaron's sons. It is important to remember that a ram is a male sheep. Use the same word or phrase for ram as you used in previous passages.

Moses kills the ram as a **burnt offering** to Yahweh and throws the ram's blood on the side of the altar. It is important to remember that Yahweh gave Moses the instructions on how to sacrifice a burnt offering in Leviticus 1. Use the same word or phrase for burnt offering and throwing the blood on the side of the altar as you used in previous passages.

After Aaron and Aaron's sons lay their hands on the ram's head, Moses kills the ram and throws the blood on the sides of the altar. Then Moses cuts the ram into pieces and burns the **ram's head**, **pieces of the ram**, and the **ram's fat** on the altar. Use the same words or phrases for the ram's head, pieces of the ram, and the ram's fat as you used in previous passages.

Moses washes the ram's **internal organs** and **legs** with water. Use the same words or phrases for internal organs and rams' legs as you used in previous passages.

Moses burns all that is left of the ram on the altar. The offering is a **fire offering** that smells good to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for fire offering as you used in previous passages, and refer to fire offering in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 8:14–21

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (567 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (762 KB)

Leviticus 8:22–29

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 8:22–29 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:22–29 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:22–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, Moses sacrificed a bull and a male sheep to make the Tent of Meeting, the altar, Aaron, and Aaron's sons ritually clean and ready to serve God. In this story, Moses continues the rituals to make Aaron and Aaron's sons ready to serve Yahweh as priests. Before the ceremony started, Moses brought two male sheep to the Tent of Meeting. Now, Moses sacrifices the second male sheep, or ram. Moses calls this sheep the "ram of ordination." It is important to remember that an ordination is a ceremony that officially appoints someone to a new role in the community.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when someone in your community gained a new role or position within the community. What did your community do to show that the person had new responsibilities now? Pause this audio here.

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Moses brings the ram of ordination to Aaron and Aaron's sons, then Aaron and Aaron's sons place their hands on the ram's head. Then Moses kills the ram. Moses smears some of the ram's blood on Aaron's right earlobe, Aaron's right thumb, and the big toe on Aaron's right foot.

Stop here and look at a picture of a person with the right earlobe, hand, and foot circled. Then look at specific pictures of the right earlobe, right thumb, and the big toe on a person's right foot. Pause this audio here.

After Moses puts the blood on Aaron's right earlobe, thumb, and big toe, Moses has Aaron's sons step in front of everyone. Then Moses smears some of the ram's blood on each of Aaron's sons' right earlobe, thumb, and big toe. The story does not explain specifically why Yahweh told Moses to smear the ram's blood on Aaron and Aaron's sons. However, Yahweh probably told Moses to smear the blood on Aaron and Aaron's sons to make those men ritually clean so that Aaron and Aaron's sons could serve Yahweh as priests. The Israelites thought that the right side of a person's body was more honorable or important than the left side and that the ear, hands, and feet were the most distant parts of a person's body. When Moses put the blood on those parts of Aaron and Aaron's sons' bodies, Moses showed the Israelites that Aaron and Aaron's sons were totally and completely clean and could do honorable work as priests.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What parts of your body does your culture think are the most honorable or important parts? What do you say when you want to talk about a person's whole body? Pause this audio here.

Then Moses throws the rest of the ram's blood against the sides of the altar.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of the altar. Pause this audio here.

Then Moses cuts off the ram's fatty tail, all the fat on all of the ram's internal organs, the best part of the ram's liver, both of the ram's kidneys along with their fat, and the ram's right thigh.

Stop here and look at these pictures as a group: Look at a picture of sheep fat. Look at a picture of a sheep with its fatty tail circled. Look at a picture of a sheep's internal organs covered in fat. Look at a picture of the best part of a sheep's liver. Look at a picture of a sheep's kidneys. Look at a picture of a sheep with the right thigh circled. And look at a picture of the cut of meat that is a sheep's right thigh. Pause this audio here.

After Moses cuts apart the ram, Moses takes some bread from a basket. You may remember that Moses brought a basket full of bread to the Tent of Meeting before this ceremony started. There were three different kinds of bread that the Israelites had made without any yeast in the dough. The Israelites had already dedicated the bread to Yahweh, so that the bread belonged to Yahweh. This is why some translations say that the bread was "before Yahweh."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when your community dedicated something to God, a spiritual being, or an ancestor. What did you call the thing you dedicated after you finished the ceremony? Pause this audio here.

The first kind of bread that Moses takes out of the basket is a thick loaf of bread.

Stop here and look at a picture of a thick loaf of bread without any yeast in it. Pause this audio here.

The second kind of bread is another thick loaf of bread, but the Israelites had used olive oil to make this second thick loaf.

Stop here and look at a picture of a thick loaf of bread without yeast that also has olive oil in it, and a picture of olive oil. Pause this audio here.

The third kind of bread is a thin loaf of bread.

Stop here and look at a picture of a thin loaf of bread without yeast. Pause this audio here.

Moses gives all the bread and all the different kinds of fat and meat that Moses had cut off the ram to Aaron and Aaron's sons. Aaron and Aaron's sons wave the bread, the fat, and the meat in the air to show Yahweh that they are giving the bread, fat, and meat to Yahweh. Then Moses takes all the bread, fat, and meat from Aaron and Aaron's sons and completely burns up the bread, fat, and meat on top of the burnt offering. The bread, fat,

Leviticus 8:22–29

and meat are an ordination sacrifice. This sacrifice officially makes Aaron and Aaron's sons into Yahweh's priests. The smoke from the bread, fat, and meat burning up smells good to Yahweh. It is important to remember that when the storyteller says that something smells good to Yahweh, the storyteller is saying that Yahweh accepts and appreciates the offering that the people made.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time you gave a gift to God, a spiritual power, or an ancestor. How did you know that God, the spiritual power, or the ancestor appreciated the gift? Pause this audio here.

After the bread, fat, and meat finish burning, Moses takes the ram's breast meat and waves it before Yahweh to show that Moses is giving the meat to Yahweh.

Stop here and look at a picture of a ram's breast meat and a picture of a ram with the breast circled. Pause this audio here.

Moses keeps the ram's breast meat to eat it himself because that is what Yahweh told Moses to do.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:22–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Moses kills the ram of ordination and smears blood on Aaron and Aaron's sons.

In the second scene: Moses places the bread, fat, and meat in the hands of Aaron and Aaron's sons, who wave the bread, fat, and meat in front of the Tent of Meeting. Then Moses burns the bread, fat, and meat on the altar.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Aaron
- Aaron's sons
- The assembly of Israelites
- And Yahweh

The story does not specifically mention the assembly of Israelites, but the Israelites are still watching Moses prepare Aaron and Aaron's sons to be priests.

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Moses is probably in the courtyard near the altar of burnt offering. Moses brings the ram of ordination close to Aaron and Aaron's sons. Remember that Moses had brought two rams to the Tent of Meeting, and this ram of ordination is the second ram. Aaron and Aaron's sons place their hands on the ram's head, and then Moses kills the ram. Moses smears some of the ram's blood on Aaron's right earlobe, the thumb on Aaron's right hand, and the big toe on Aaron's right foot. Then, Moses has Aaron's sons stand in front of everyone, and Moses smears the ram's blood on the same places on each of Aaron's sons.

Stop here and get a small bowl filled with water. Have one person pretend to be Moses and one or more people pretend to be Aaron and Aaron's sons. Have the person who is pretending to be Moses smear the water on the right earlobe, right thumb, and big toe of the right foot of the person or people pretending to be Aaron and Aaron's sons. Pause this audio here.

After Moses finishes smearing the blood on Aaron and Aaron's sons, Moses throws the rest of the blood onto the sides of the altar of burnt offering.

Stop here and find a large rock or tree to use as an altar for this activity. Take the bowl of water from the previous activity and move the bowl quickly through the air toward the rock or tree so that the water flies out of the bowl

and lands on the sides of the rock or tree. Remember how you described this action in previous passages. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Moses cuts up the ram. Moses cuts out the ram's fat, the ram's fatty tail, the fat that was on the ram's internal organs, the long part, or best part, of the ram's liver, the ram's kidneys and their fat, and the ram's right thigh. Then Moses takes the three kinds of bread from the basket of bread that belonged to Yahweh. Moses hands all the bread, fat, and meat to Aaron and Aaron's sons. Then Aaron and Aaron's sons wave the fat, bread, and meat in the air before Yahweh. When someone does something before Yahweh, it means the person does it in the presence of Yahweh, which is at the Tent of Meeting. Moses, Aaron, and Aaron's sons may be standing near the altar of burnt offering in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting, facing the tent. We are not sure exactly how a person would wave a wave offering. It is likely that the person holds the offering, then raises and lowers their arms one or more times.

Stop here and find objects that you will use to represent the different kinds of bread, fat, and meat. If you have bread, fat, and meat that you can use for this exercise, use those instead of other objects. Have one person pretend to be Moses, and have other people pretend to be Aaron and Aaron's sons. Practice having the person playing Moses hand the objects that represent the bread, fat, and meat to Aaron and Aaron's sons, and then have the people playing Aaron and Aaron's sons wave those objects up and down in the air. Pause this audio here.

After Aaron and Aaron's sons wave the fat, bread, and meat in the air, Moses takes the bread, fat, and meat from Aaron and Aaron's sons and burns the bread, fat, and meat on the altar. The story says that the meat from the first ram that Moses killed for the burnt offering is still burning on the altar when Moses adds the bread, fat, and meat from the second ram. This means that the bread, fat, and meat burn up in the fire at the same time as the meat from the burnt offering that Moses sacrificed to Yahweh in the previous story.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will show that Moses places the bread, fat, and meat from the ordination offering on top of the meat from the burnt offering when you act out this story in the next script. Pause this audio here.

The bread, fat, and meat are an ordination offering that makes Yahweh happy with Moses, Aaron, Aaron's sons, and the Israelites. It is an offering by fire because it burns up on the altar.

After Moses puts the bread, fat, and meat on the altar, Moses takes the ram's breast meat and waves it as a wave offering while Moses faces the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh told Moses to do this because Yahweh wanted to give the ram's breast meat to Moses.

Stop here and find something to use for the ram's breast meat. Take turns practicing waving the meat up and down in the air. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:22–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Aaron
- Aaron's sons
- The assembly of Israelites
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Moses brings the second ram over to Aaron and Aaron's sons. Aaron and Aaron's sons place their hands on the ram's head. Then Moses kills the ram and takes some of the ram's blood. Moses smears the blood on Aaron's right earlobe, right thumb, and right big toe. Then Moses tells Aaron's sons to stand in front of everyone, and Moses smears the blood on the right earlobes, right thumbs, and right big toes of Aaron's sons. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Aaron and his sons, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- Now every part of me is ritually clean, and I can serve Yahweh as Yahweh's priest; or
- Yahweh has honored me so much. I cannot believe I am finally able to serve Yahweh as a priest.

Continue the drama. Then Moses throws the rest of the blood on the sides of the altar. Once Moses is done throwing the blood, Moses cuts the ram apart so that Moses has the ram's fat and fatty tail as well as the fat that was on the ram's internal organs, the best part of the ram's liver, the ram's kidneys, the fat that was on the ram's kidneys, and the ram's right thigh. Then Moses turns to the basket of bread that belongs to Yahweh. Moses takes out three kinds of bread, which have no yeast. The first kind is a thick loaf, the second kind is a thick loaf that the Israelites baked with olive oil, and the third kind is a thin loaf. Moses puts all the bread, fat, and meat into Aaron's and Aaron's sons' hands. Aaron and Aaron's sons wave the bread, fat, and meat while facing the Tent of Meeting. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Aaron and Aaron's sons, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I am so thankful I can give this gift to Yahweh; or
- I am so excited to be a priest!

Continue the drama. Moses takes the bread, fat, and meat back from Aaron and Aaron's sons and puts the bread, fat, and meat in the fire on the altar where the meat from the burnt offering is. Yahweh sees the ordination offering and accepts it. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so glad that Aaron and Aaron's sons gave this offering to me; or
- It is almost time for Aaron and Aaron's sons to be my priests; or
- I am glad I chose Aaron and Aaron's sons to be my priests.

Continue the drama. Then Moses waves the ram's breast meat while Moses faces the Tent of Meeting to give the meat to Yahweh. Yahweh gives the ram's breast meat to Moses for Moses to eat. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so thankful to Yahweh for this meat; or
- I am giving this meat to Yahweh as a gift, and then Yahweh is giving the meat back to me.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:22–29 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Moses brought the second **ram** to Aaron and Aaron's **sons**. A ram is a male sheep. Use the same word or phrase for **ram** and for **sons** as you used in previous passages. Sons is in the Master Glossary.

Leviticus 8:22–29

The ram was a ram of **ordination**. It is important to remember that ordination is a ceremony that gives someone a new role or position within the community. You will remember that the original name for the ordination offering reminds the priests of the way that Moses filled Aaron's hands with the bread, fat, and meat for the wave offering. Use the same word or phrase for ordination as you used in previous passages.

Moses killed the ram and smeared the ram's blood on Aaron's right earlobe. Use the same word or phrase for killing an animal that you have used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of a person with the **right earlobe**, right thumb, and right big toe circled. Then look at a picture of a right earlobe. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the right earlobe. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Then Moses smeared the ram's blood on Aaron's right thumb.

Stop here and look at a picture of a right thumb. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the right thumb. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Finally, Moses smeared the ram's blood on Aaron's right big toe.

Stop here and look at a picture of a right big toe. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the right big toe. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Then Moses told Aaron's sons to stand in front of everyone, and Moses smeared the blood on Aaron's sons' right earlobes, right thumbs, and right big toes. Then Moses threw the rest of the blood around the **altar**. Talk about throwing the blood on the sides of the altar in the same way you have in previous passages. Use the same word or phrase for altar as you used in previous passages. For more information about altar, refer to the Master Glossary.

Then Moses cut up the ram. Moses took out the ram's **fat**, **fatty tail**, **internal organs**, the **best part of the ram's liver**, **kidneys**, the **fat around the kidneys**, and the **right thigh**. Use the same words or phrases for these parts of the ram as you used in previous passages.

After Moses finished cutting up the ram, Moses took the bread out of its basket. The bread in the basket belonged to **Yahweh**. Yahweh is God's personal name. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. Look up Yahweh in the Master Glossary for more information.

The Israelites made all the bread without any **yeast**. Use the same word or phrase to talk about bread without yeast as you used in previous passages.

Moses took three different kinds of bread out of the basket. People made all of these types of bread without yeast. The first kind of bread was a thick loaf. The second kind of bread was a thick loaf of bread that the Israelites made with olive oil. The third kind of bread was a thin loaf of bread.

Stop here and discuss what phrases you will use for these three kinds of bread. Pause this audio here.

Moses placed the kinds of bread on the fat and the meat and handed it all to Aaron and Aaron's sons. Aaron and Aaron's sons gave the bread, fat, and meat to Yahweh by waving these things in the air while Aaron and Aaron's sons faced the Tent of Meeting. This was a **wave offering**. Use the same word or phrase for wave offering as you have used in previous passages. For more information about wave offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Then Moses took the bread, fat, and meat from Aaron and Aaron's sons and burned the bread, fat, and meat on the altar. The ram that was the **burnt offerin**g was still burning on the altar when Moses added the bread, fat, and meat. Use the same word or phrase for burnt offering as you used in previous passages. Look up burnt offerings in the Master Glossary for more information.

The bread, fat, and meat were **ordination offerings** that made a good smell for Yahweh. It was a **fire offering** for Yahweh. An ordination offering appointed Aaron and Aaron's sons to officially become Yahweh's priests. Use the same words or phrases for ordination offering and fire offering as you used in previous passages. Fire offering is in the Master Glossary.

Last, Moses gave the ram's **breast meat** to Yahweh as a wave offering. Use the same word or phrase to talk about the ram's breast meat as you used in previous passages. The ram's breast meat was Yahweh's gift, or portion, to Moses for Moses to eat. Use the same word or phrase for portion of an offering as you have used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 8:22–29

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (705 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (937 KB)

Leviticus 8:30–36

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 8:30–36 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:30–36 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.

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5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:30–36 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, Moses killed the ram of ordination for Aaron and Aaron's sons. Now Moses starts the last steps of the ceremony that officially makes Aaron and Aaron's sons into Yahweh's priests. Moses takes some of the blood that is on the altar and some anointing oil, and sprinkles both liquids onto Aaron, Aaron's sons, and the clothing that Aaron and Aaron's sons are wearing. Moses might have sprinkled the blood and oil one at a time. Or Moses might have mixed the blood and oil together into a new mixture and then sprinkled the mixture on Aaron, Aaron's sons, and then onto Aaron's and Aaron's sons' clothing. Either way, the sprinkling ceremony shows all the Israelites that Aaron and Aaron's sons now have a special relationship with Yahweh and with the Tent of Meeting. Aaron and Aaron's sons are the only Israelites whom Yahweh allows to make sacrifices on Yahweh's altar. Aaron and Aaron's sons can only make the sacrifices when they wear their special priest clothing.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Who can use religious things or do religious rituals in your community? Tell a story about a time that person interacted with religious things or rituals. What kinds of clothing did the person need to wear? How did the community know that the person was using religious things or doing a religious ritual? Pause this audio here.

In the last story, Moses killed the ram of ordination, but Moses did not burn the entire ram on the altar. Moses only burnt the ram's fat and some of the ram's meat. Now, Moses tells Aaron and Aaron's sons to cook the rest of the meat. The word in the original language for cooking here does not tell us how people cooked the meat. Sometimes the word seems to refer to boiling food in water, but it can mean other kinds of cooking as well.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about the last time you cooked meat. How did you cook the meat? Pause this audio here.

Moses tells Aaron and Aaron's sons to cook the meat at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. This means that Aaron and Aaron's sons are not supposed to go outside the courtyard that surrounds the Tent of Meeting. Because Aaron and Aaron's sons are becoming Yahweh's priests, the ram's meat is even more holy than normal sacrifices. This means that Aaron and Aaron's sons cannot eat the meat outside of the Tent of Meeting, as the Israelites would normally eat the meat of the fellowship or peace offering.

Stop here and look at a picture of the Tent of Meeting and the area in the courtyard outside of it. Pause this audio here.

In the last story, Moses burnt some bread on the altar from a special basket as a sacrifice to Yahweh. In this story, Moses tells Aaron and Aaron's sons to eat the rest of the bread that is in the basket. Moses repeats how important this is and says that Aaron and Aaron's sons should eat this meat just as Moses says to. Then Moses tells Aaron and Aaron's sons to burn any of the meat or bread that Aaron and Aaron's sons do not eat. Aaron and Aaron's sons cannot save any of the leftover meat or bread to eat at another time.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about an important meal in your community. Where do you eat the meal? What rules do you follow about what you need to eat and when you need to eat the food? Pause this audio here.

Next, Moses tells Aaron and Aaron's sons to live in the Tent of Meeting for the next seven days. Aaron and Aaron's sons cannot go and walk around the rest of the camp with the other Israelites. Aaron and Aaron's sons need to stay close to Yahweh's Tent of Meeting until the very last day of the official ordination process. That process will take seven full days to finish. The Israelites believed that the number seven meant that something was complete or perfect, so that is why it took seven days for Aaron and Aaron's sons to complete the process to become Yahweh's priests.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when someone in your community got married, became an adult, or became someone who could interact with spirits, ancestors, or gods. How long did the ceremonies take? Why do the rituals take that amount of time? Pause this audio here.

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After Moses tells Aaron and Aaron's sons how long it will take to become Yahweh's priests, Moses says that everything Moses did from when Moses first brought everything to the Tent of Meeting to start the ceremony until now was exactly what Yahweh told Moses to do. Moses explains that Moses needed to do all these things to atone for Aaron and Aaron's sons so that Aaron and Aaron's sons could be holy and serve Yahweh. Then Moses reminds Aaron and Aaron's sons to live in the Tent of Meeting for seven days and do everything Yahweh says to do so that Yahweh does not kill Aaron and Aaron's sons. Because Aaron and Aaron's sons are Yahweh's priests, Aaron and Aaron's sons are set apart for special service to Yahweh in a way that other Israelites are not. Anything the priests do that disobeys Yahweh makes Yahweh's holy things ritually dirty, and that is a very serious problem.

Stop here and discuss this question as a community: Who are the most important people in your community? Tell a story about the kinds of rules or behaviors those people need to follow that are different from the rules that other people in the community need to follow. Pause this audio here.

Moses finishes when Moses says again that everything Moses told Aaron and Aaron's sons is what Yahweh told Moses to tell Aaron and Aaron's sons. Then Aaron and Aaron's sons obey Yahweh and do everything Moses said to do.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:30–36 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Moses sprinkles anointing oil and blood on Aaron, Aaron's sons, and their clothing.

In the second scene: Moses gives Aaron and Aaron's sons instructions about what to do for the next seven days.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Aaron
- Aaron's sons
- The assembly of Israelites
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

It is important to remember that the assembly of Israelites is still watching Moses, Aaron, and Aaron's sons, even though the storyteller does not specifically talk about the Israelites.

In the first scene, Moses takes some of the anointing oil to sprinkle on Aaron and Aaron's sons. Moses also takes some of the blood off of the altar to sprinkle on Aaron and Aaron's sons. Moses sprinkles both the oil and the blood on Aaron, Aaron's sons, and the clothing that Aaron and Aaron's sons are wearing. Moses probably mixed the blood and oil together, but Moses might have sprinkled the blood and oil on Aaron and Aaron's sons one at a time. Either way, Moses sprinkles the oil and the blood on Aaron and Aaron's clothing and on Aaron's sons and Aaron's sons' clothing to dedicate Aaron, Aaron's sons, and their clothing to serve Yahweh. We do not know exactly how Moses sprinkled the oil and blood. Moses may have used his fingers to dip in the bowl and then flick the oil and blood on the people and their clothing.

Stop here and get two bowls of water. Have one or two people pretend to be Aaron and Aaron's sons. One of the bowls of water represents the anointing oil. Practice sprinkling, or putting, the water from that bowl on the people who are pretending to be Aaron and Aaron's sons. Make sure you sprinkle the water on those people and their clothing. Then, pour one bowl of water on a smooth rock or tree trunk to represent the blood that is on the altar. Practice wiping the water off the rock and tree trunk and sprinkling it on the person or people who are pretending to be Aaron and Aaron's sons. How do you describe these actions? How will you describe these actions in your translation? Pause this audio here.

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In the second scene, Moses gives Aaron and Aaron's sons more instructions. Moses repeats himself a lot in these instructions to show how important and serious the instructions are.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when you gave very important instructions to someone else. How did you make sure that the other person knew how important those instructions were? Tell a story about a time when someone gave you very important instructions. How did you know how important those instructions were? Pause this audio here.

Moses tells Aaron and Aaron's sons to cook the meat from the ram of ordination that Moses did not burn on the altar. Aaron and Aaron's sons need to cook the meat without leaving the courtyard around the Tent of Meeting. Aaron and Aaron's sons need to eat the ram's meat as well as the bread that Moses did not sacrifice on the altar. Aaron and Aaron's sons need to eat both the meat and the bread while they are still in the Tent of Meeting courtyard. Moses explains that this is just what Moses said to do when Moses said that Aaron and Aaron's sons needed to eat the meat and the bread.

Next, Moses explains that Aaron and Aaron's sons need to stay at the Tent of Meeting for seven days. Aaron and Aaron's sons cannot leave the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting for any reason until the ordination ceremonies are completely finished. Moses explains that it will take seven full days for Aaron and Aaron's sons to finish the ordination ceremonies. Moses explains that Yahweh told Moses to do all these ceremonies to make atonement for Aaron and Aaron's sons, so that they can have a good relationship with Yahweh. Now Aaron and Aaron's sons need to stay at the Tent of Meeting all day and all night for seven days to serve Yahweh as Yahweh said to. If Aaron and Aaron's sons do not obey these instructions, then Yahweh will kill Aaron and Aaron's sons. Moses explains that Yahweh told Moses to tell Aaron and Aaron's sons all of these instructions.

The story ends when it explains that Aaron and Aaron's sons listen to Yahweh and do everything that Moses said to do.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:30–36 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Aaron
- Aaron's sons
- The assembly of Israelites
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Leviticus 8:30–36

It is important to remember that the Israelites are still watching Moses, Aaron, and Aaron's sons, even though the story does not specifically talk about the Israelites.

In the first scene, Moses takes some of the anointing oil and then takes some of the blood that Moses had thrown on the altar. Moses sprinkles both the blood and the oil on Aaron and Aaron's clothing and on Aaron's sons and their clothing. Pause the drama. and ask the people playing Aaron and his sons, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I am going to have to be very careful about how I act now since Yahweh has given me such an important role in the community; or
- I cannot believe that I get to serve Yahweh by making sacrifices to Yahweh now; or
- I feel so honored.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Moses tells Aaron and Aaron's sons to cook the meat by the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. Moses says to also take the bread that was still in the basket from the ordination offering and eat the bread with the meat there at the entrance. Moses explains that Aaron and Aaron's sons need to eat the meat and the bread just like Moses said to do when Moses first said that Aaron and Aaron's sons needed to eat the meat and bread. Then Moses warns Aaron and Aaron's sons that they must burn any meat or bread that they do not eat. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing Moses might say things like:

- I really want Aaron and Aaron's sons to realize how serious and important this is; or
- I am excited that my brother is almost Yahweh's priest; or
- I really want to make sure that Aaron and Aaron's sons obey Yahweh's instructions.

Continue the drama. Then Moses explains that Aaron and Aaron's sons need to stay at the Tent of Meeting for seven days and cannot leave until after all the ordination ceremonies. Moses explains that it will take seven days to finish the ordination ceremonies. Moses explains that Moses did all the different rituals and sacrifices to atone for Aaron and Aaron's sons so that Aaron and Aaron's sons can serve Yahweh as Yahweh's priests. Now, Aaron and Aaron's sons need to stay at the Tent of Meeting all day and all night for seven full days and do everything that Yahweh says to do so that Yahweh does not kill Aaron and Aaron's sons. Moses ends his speech and says that Yahweh told Moses to give Aaron and Aaron's sons all of these instructions. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing Moses might say things like:

- I do not want Aaron and Aaron's sons to die! I want Aaron and Aaron's sons to know how important it is to follow these instructions; or
- I want to make sure that Aaron and Aaron's sons remember all of these instructions so they know what to do; or
- I am worried Aaron and Aaron's sons will forget, and then Yahweh will have to kill Aaron and Aaron's sons.

Ask the people playing Aaron and Aaron's sons, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might say things like:

- These rules must be very important and serious because Moses keeps repeating them. We need to pay attention and do everything Moses says; or
- I do not want to die! I need to listen to what Moses is saying; or
- Yahweh has given me so much honor by making me Yahweh's priest. I need to make sure I do not do something that would make Yahweh's holy things ritually dirty.

Continue the drama. Aaron and Aaron's sons follow all of Yahweh's instructions and do everything that Moses said to do.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 8:30–36 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

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First, Moses took some of the **anointing** oil to sprinkle on Aaron and Aaron's **sons** and the clothing these men were wearing. It is important to remember that anointing oil was oil that someone would pour onto someone else to show that God chose the person for a special task or role. Use the same words or phrases for anointing oil and sons as you used in previous passages. Look up anoint and sons in the Master Glossary for more information.

Then Moses took some of the blood from the **altar** to sprinkle on Aaron and Aaron's sons and their clothing. Use the same word or phrase for altar as you used in previous passages. Look up altar in the Master Glossary for more information.

Moses sprinkled the oil and blood on Aaron, Aaron's sons, and the clothing that Aaron and Aaron's sons were wearing to **consecrate** them. This means that Moses was showing everyone that Yahweh had chosen Aaron and Aaron's sons to be Yahweh's. Aaron and Aaron's sons were going to be Yahweh's priests and serve Yahweh in a way no one else could. Aaron and Aaron's sons were holy. Use the same word or phrase for consecrate as you used in previous passages. Look up consecrate in the Master Glossary for more information.

Then Moses told Aaron and Aaron's sons to cook the meat from the ram of ordination at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting.

Stop here and look at a picture of the Tent of Meeting and the entrance area. Then, as a group, discuss what word or phrase you will use for the **entrance to the Tent of Meeting**. Look up the **tabernacle** in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

Moses told Aaron and Aaron's sons how to eat the meat and bread from the **basket** for the **ordination offering**. Then Moses said not to leave the Tent of Meeting until the last day of their **ordination**. An ordination is a ceremony that gives someone a new role or responsibility within the community. Use the same words for basket, ordination, and ordination offering as you used in previous passages. Basket is in the Master Glossary.

Moses explains that Moses did everything for the ordination ceremony because **Yahweh** told Moses to do it that specific way. Yahweh is God's personal name. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. Look up Yahweh in the Master Glossary for more information. Moses did all the ceremonies to **atone** for Aaron and Aaron's sons. Use the same word for atone as you have used in previous passages. Look up atone in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (993 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 9:1–7

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 9:1–7 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 9:1–7 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 9:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In Leviticus, Yahweh has been giving Moses and Aaron instructions on how the Israelite people were supposed to live in good relationship with Yahweh. During this time, the Israelite people were still camping at Mount Sinai. The Israelites recently built the Tent of Meeting according to Yahweh's instructions. In the previous passages, Moses has been doing the ceremony that officially makes Aaron and Aaron's sons into Yahweh's priests. Once Moses finished this ordination ceremony, the priests could start doing their priestly duties and do religious tasks. This passage starts on the eighth day, one week after the start of the ordination ceremony. Here, Moses gives Aaron and the Israelite elders instructions from Yahweh for what sacrifices the priests must offer to complete the ordination ceremony. This is the first time that Aaron actually does the sacrifices that Yahweh had commanded in the previous chapters.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do you do to officially recognize someone who will do a special task or hold a certain role? Describe the process. Pause this audio here.

In this story, Moses asks Aaron to bring a young male bull for a sin, or purification, offering. A young male bull is an animal that is old enough to become a father, but still young. Some scholars think that this bull would be one year old, like some of the other animals in the passage. Others think that the bull was a three-year-old bull. We do not know, but it is probably a physically mature bull that was still fairly young.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a young male bull. If you have not done so yet, stop and discuss what word you could use for a bull that is between one and three years old. Pause this audio here.

The purification offering is usually for someone who accidentally sins or does something to make themselves ritually unclean. In this case, Yahweh considers the whole assembly or all the Israelite people as ritually dirty. This ceremony is to make all the Israelite people ritually clean so that the Israelites can begin to have a relationship

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with Yahweh. Yahweh had told Moses that Yahweh would appear to the Israelites on that day, and the sin or purification offering helped the Israelites be prepared for Yahweh to appear to them.

Aaron must also bring a ram, which is an adult male sheep, for a burnt offering. Even though Moses has already purified Aaron and Aaron's sons to be priests, Yahweh still requires Aaron to offer a purification offering and a burnt offering for Aaron. Aaron must make these offerings before Yahweh will allow Aaron to offer sacrifices for the entire Israelite community. When Aaron makes the sacrifices for the Israelite people, Aaron makes atonement for the Israelites, which means Aaron does what is necessary to bring the Israelites back to Yahweh. Aaron makes the purification offering to make sure that Aaron is pure and fit to worship Yahweh. Aaron makes the burnt offering to show that Aaron is fully devoted to Yahweh. Yahweh only wants leaders who are right with Yahweh and fully devoted to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, what pressures keep leaders from dealing with their own areas of weakness or sin? How common is it for leaders to admit publicly that the leaders are not right with Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

There is an interesting connection here to things that happened in the past. You will remember that when the Israelite people came out of Egypt, Aaron had made a golden calf idol for the Israelites. Now, before Aaron can take his role as priest to serve Yahweh, Aaron's first sacrifice is of a young male bull. Not only that, but the sacrifice is specifically for Aaron's own sin. In a similar way, the second animal Aaron must sacrifice for Aaron's own burnt offering is a ram or adult male sheep. This adult male sheep might remind the Israelite people of the story of Abraham, when Yahweh provided an animal for Abraham to sacrifice. The young male sheep might remind the Israelite people of the Passover. Just like during the Passover, the blood covers the Israelites' sins and makes Yahweh's anger turn away.

Moses also tells Aaron to tell the Israelite elders, or leaders, to bring animals for offerings. The Israelite leaders must bring a male goat for a sin or purification offering, as well as a calf and a lamb, which is a young male sheep. Both the calf and the lamb must be a year old and physically perfect. The calf and lamb will be burnt offerings for the Israelite people.

The Israelite leaders must also bring animals for fellowship offerings. The assembly or Israelite leaders must bring a ram and an ox. We know from other passages that the ox could be either a male bull, a female cow, or a castrated male bull. A castrated male bull is a male bull that people have changed so that the bull cannot make offspring. Try to use a word that could refer to a male bull or a female cow. However, if you must choose one, use the male form of the word here. In the original language, the storyteller used a word that means larger cattle in general, and it was one of these larger cattle that the people were to use for the fellowship offering.

The Israelite leaders must also bring a grain offering, which is flour that people mix with oil. Aaron and the Israelite leaders bring all these items for the offerings to the front of the Tent of Meeting. There, Moses instructs Aaron to follow Yahweh's instructions so that Yahweh's glory, or majesty, can appear to the people. Aaron must sacrifice Aaron's purification offering and burnt offering. Then Aaron must make the offerings for the Israelites. In this way, Aaron will make atonement for Aaron and the Israelites, just as Yahweh commanded. When Aaron makes atonement for himself and the Israelites, they will be able to have a good relationship with Yahweh, and Yahweh can be close to the people.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 9:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Moses told Aaron, the priests, and the elders of Israel the instructions for how to do the first offerings. First, Aaron must sacrifice a sin or purification offering and a burnt offering for himself. Then the elders of Israel had to offer four sacrifices: a purification offering, a burnt offering, a fellowship offering, and a grain offering. Then Yahweh would come to the Israelites in a special way.

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In the second scene: Moses, Aaron, the priests, and the elders of Israel all came together at the Tent of Meeting with all the animals for the offerings. Then Moses said some important words. Moses told all the people there that Yahweh told these people to make these offerings so that Yahweh could come near to them and show them Yahweh's power. Then Moses told Aaron to make the sacrifices for Aaron and for the people of Israel, so that Aaron could make atonement for everyone.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Aaron
- The priests, whom people also call the sons of Aaron
- The elders of Israel
- Yahweh
- And the Israelite people

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The Israelite people were still camped at the bottom of Mount Sinai. Yahweh was giving Moses and Aaron many laws, instructions, and rules for how the Israelite people could live and please Yahweh. For the last seven days, Moses has been leading the people through the ceremony or ordination of the priests. These ceremonial sacrifices in this passage happen at the end of the ceremony of the ordination service.

In the first scene, Moses told Aaron, the priests, and the elders of Israel the instructions for how to do the first offerings. These events happened on the eighth day of the ordination ceremony. For the last seven days, the Israelites have been celebrating the ordination of the priests. These offerings are part of the ceremony before the priests begin their regular duties around the Tent of Meeting.

Stop here and discuss: Try to think of a story where someone told people what to do, and then the people did what the people were supposed to do. Pay attention to the language you use to describe the instructions, and then how you repeat the instructions as you tell about people doing those things. You will need a similar structure for this passage, where Moses gave instructions, and then everyone followed the instructions. Pause this audio here.

Moses called together Aaron, Aaron's sons, and the elders of Israel. This was a formal way to ask these people to all come together for an important meeting.

Stop here and discuss: Think about a time someone formally invited you to an important event, meeting, or ceremony. In your language, take turns telling each other your stories. Notice what words you use to talk about someone inviting you and to talk about what happened or what people said at the event or meeting. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller uses the phrase "the sons of Aaron" to refer to the priests. Since Yahweh only allowed descendants of Aaron to be priests, this means that all of the priests were related to Aaron. This did not just mean Aaron's sons, but could also refer to Aaron's grandsons, great-grandsons, and later generations. Yahweh only allowed males to be priests.

The elders of Israel were older men in the community whom the community honored due to the elders' age, wisdom, and importance in the families or clans of Israel. The elders met with Moses, Aaron, and the priests in the assembly, which was a special group that met together to make important decisions for all the people of Israel.

Here are the instructions that Moses gave to the assembly. First, Aaron must sacrifice a purification offering and a burnt offering for Aaron. For the purification offering, Aaron must offer a young male bull. The original language says a bull, a son of the herd. This does not tell us how old the bull is, but the bull is probably still young yet old enough to reproduce or to have offspring.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a bull. Pause this audio here.

For the burnt offering, Aaron had to offer an adult male sheep.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of an adult male sheep or ram. Pause this audio here.

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All of the animals for these sacrifices needed to be perfect. This means that the animals cannot be sick or have any physical problems, injuries, or unusual features. The priest must sacrifice all the animals "before Yahweh," which means at the altar of burnt offering in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting.

Then the leaders of Israel had to bring four offerings: a purification offering, a burnt offering, a peace or fellowship offering, and a grain offering. For the purification offering for all of Israel, the assembly had to offer a young male goat.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a young male goat. Pause this audio here.

For the burnt offering, the assembly had to offer a young male bull and a young male sheep. These animals were supposed to be about a year old and perfect. For the fellowship offering, the assembly had to offer a ram, or an adult male sheep, and one large ox. We know from other passages that this could be either a male bull, a female cow, or a castrated male bull, which is a male bull that cannot have offspring. Try to use a word that could refer to either a male bull or a female cow. However, if you must choose one, use the male form of the word here.

Stop here and discuss: What words does your language use to make a difference between the males and the females of herding animals? Pause this audio here.

The assembly also had to offer a grain offering of flour that a person had mixed with olive oil.

After these instructions, the leaders of the Israelites followed the instructions. The leaders brought all the animals and the grain and oil mixture to the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting for the offerings. The assembly of Moses, Aaron, the priests, and the elders of Israel, who represented the Israelite families, did this.

Then Moses said two very important things. Moses told the assembly of Israelites that Yahweh told the Israelites to do these things so that Yahweh would appear to the Israelites in Yahweh's glory. In the original language, glory means "weight" or "heaviness." It means "importance" or "honor." Bible narrators often use this word to refer to how a king shows the king's power and greatness.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, describe someone with a lot of importance or wealth. Notice what words you use to describe this person. Pause this audio here.

Moses told the people that Yahweh would appear to the people. This means Yahweh will present himself or make Yahweh known. Yahweh would reveal who Yahweh was to the assembly. People do not just come to know Yahweh; Yahweh must reveal or show himself to people. It may be helpful to talk about Yahweh introducing or presenting himself, or showing Yahweh's greatness.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, how does someone introduce themselves? Are there any important ceremonies, such as at a wedding, where someone presents another person in an important way? What words do you use to describe a person who is making a big entrance? Pause this audio here.

Then Moses told Aaron that Aaron needed to sacrifice the offerings for Aaron's own atonement and the offerings for the Israelite people's atonement. This refers to all the people of Israel.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 9:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Aaron
- The priests, whom people also call the sons of Aaron
- The elders of Israel
- Yahweh

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- And all of the Israelite people

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Moses tells Aaron, the priests, and the elders of Israel the instructions for how to do the first offerings. First, Aaron must sacrifice a sin or purification offering and a burnt offering for Aaron. Then the leaders of Israel must bring four offerings: a purification offering, a burnt offering, a fellowship offering, and a grain offering. Then Yahweh will come to these people in a special way. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I must offer sacrifices for my own sin before I can atone for other people's sin. I feel sad that we have all disobeyed Yahweh, but thankful that Yahweh has given us a way to have a good relationship with Yahweh again; or
- As I sacrifice the bull for my offering, I remember how I once led the people in worship of a golden calf idol. I feel ashamed when I remember how I disobeyed and dishonored Yahweh; or
- Yahweh is so great and mighty. I have a big responsibility to the community and to Yahweh to do what is right.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Moses, Aaron, the priests, and the elders of Israel all come together at the Tent of Meeting with all the animals for the sacrifices. Then Moses says some important words. Moses tells all the people there that Yahweh told those people to make these offerings so that Yahweh could come near to the people and show the people Yahweh's power. Then Moses tells Aaron to make the sacrifices for Aaron and for the people of Israel, so that Aaron could make atonement for everyone. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am excited that I will be close to my people and can show them who I am; or
- I hope the Israelite leaders understand how important this is; or
- I am pleased that the Israelites are listening to the instructions that I gave to Moses.

Ask the person playing all the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am grateful that Aaron and our elders are doing these sacrifices for us! Now I know Yahweh will come to live with us; or
- I am relieved that there is a way now for us to be close to Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 9:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Moses gave instructions to Aaron, Aaron's sons, and the **elders of Israel**. The elders of Israel are a group of older men who were the heads of different clans or family groups based on family relationship and family line. These older men represented their families at important religious ceremonies and made important decisions for all the Israelite people. When this group of priests and elders met together for a special purpose, people called it the "**assembly**." For more information on "elders and Israel," refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same phrases for "elders of Israel" and assembly as you used in previous passages.

Leviticus 9:1–7

Yahweh chose Aaron and Aaron's descendants to be the priests of Israel. Yahweh appointed Aaron and Aaron's **sons** as priests on this day. Use the same word or phrase for sons as you have used previously, and refer to sons in the Master Glossary for more information.

For Aaron's **sin or purification offering**, Aaron was supposed to sacrifice a young male **bull**. A young bull is an animal that is physically mature and able to reproduce offspring, but is still young. This bull should be **perfect**, or without any problems. Use the same words or phrases for bull, sin or purification offering, and perfect as you used previously. For more information about the purification offering and perfect, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and, as a group, look again at a picture of a young bull as needed. Pause this audio here.

For Aaron's **burnt offering**, Aaron was supposed to sacrifice a perfect ram, or adult male sheep. Use the same word or phrase for burnt offering as you used previously. Burnt offering is in the Master Glossary.

In this passage, Yahweh commanded the assembly to bring a **young male goat** for the purification offering for all the people of Israel. The young male goat was probably about a year old, still young but old enough to reproduce. Use the same word for "young male goat" as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a young male goat. Pause this audio here.

Then the assembly was supposed to sacrifice another **young male bull** and a **male lamb**, or young sheep, as a burnt offering for all of Israel. Both the bull and the lamb should be one year old and also perfect. Use the same words for "young bull" and "male lamb" or "young male sheep" as you used in previous passages.

For the **fellowship offering**, the Israelite leaders had to bring an ox and another adult male sheep, or ram, that were perfect. An ox can be any kind of cattle, such as a male bull or a female cow of any age. Use the same word for ox and ram as you used in previous passages. Use the same word for fellowship offering as you have used previously, and refer to peace or fellowship offering in the Master Glossary for more information.

Aaron must bring these animals to **sacrifice** before **Yahweh**. Use the same word for sacrifice and for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on sacrifice and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

The Israelites must also bring a **grain offering** mixed with **olive oil**. Use the same words for grain offering and olive oil as you used in previous passages. For more information on grain offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Use the same word for **Tent of Meeting** as you used in previous passages. For more information on "Tent of Meeting," refer to tabernacle in the Master Glossary.

Moses says that Aaron and the Israelites must do these things so that Yahweh will show the people Yahweh's glory, or power.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **glory**. If you have used this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word here. For more information on glory, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Moses tells Aaron to make **atonement** for the Israelite people, which means to restore the relationship between Yahweh and the people. For more information on atonement, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same phrase for atonement as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 9:1–7

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (951 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (7.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 9:8–14

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 9:8–14 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 9:8–14 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 9:8–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Through Leviticus, Yahweh has been giving Moses and Aaron instructions on how the Israelite people were supposed to live in good relationship with Yahweh. At this time, the Israelite people were still camping at Mount Sinai. The Israelites had recently built the Tent of Meeting according to Yahweh's instructions. Now the narrator continues the story of when the Israelites celebrated the ordination of Aaron and Aaron's sons as priests.

In the previous passage, Moses told Aaron and the Israelite leaders Yahweh's instructions for how to do the initiation or ordination ceremony so that the priests could start doing priestly duties and perform religious tasks. In the last passage, one week of the ordination ceremony had passed, and Moses gave Aaron Yahweh's instructions on what offerings to make to complete the ordination ceremony for the priests. Now, in this passage, this was the first time that Aaron began doing the sacrifices that Yahweh had commanded in the previous

Leviticus 9:8–14

passages. Specifically, we hear in this passage how Aaron did the two sacrifices that Aaron needed to do to make Aaron ritually clean. Aaron had to make a sin or purification offering, and Aaron had to make a burnt offering. Aaron needed to do these offerings first, before Aaron began to make atonement for other people and the whole community.

There is an interesting connection here to things that happened in the past. When the Israelite people came out of Egypt, Aaron had made the Israelites a golden calf idol and told the people to worship the idol. Now, before Aaron could take Aaron's role as priest to serve Yahweh, Aaron's first sacrifice was of a young male bull. This sacrifice showed that Aaron was ritually clean. This sacrifice was also a way for Aaron to recognize Aaron's own sin and failures to obey Yahweh's commands. Perhaps some of the older people remembered the golden calf as the people saw their new priest killing the young bull and offering the bull to Yahweh. Throughout the Israelite people's time in the wilderness, sometimes Aaron made bad leadership decisions. This ceremony was a chance for Aaron to be ritually clean again and to even be an example for the Israelite people to follow. Aaron's priesthood is a reminder that Yahweh's forgiveness can make ritually dirty people clean again. If a person is ritually dirty, it does not mean that person is physically dirty. It means that the person has done something that does not allow the person to worship with the rest of the Israelite people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Imagine being an ancient Israelite and seeing Aaron kill the young bull, cut it up, and smear the bull's blood on the altar. How would you react? What would you think or say to others? Pause this audio here.

In a similar way, Aaron also must sacrifice a burnt offering for himself. The animal that Aaron must kill is a ram or adult male sheep. This adult male sheep might have reminded the Israelite people of the story of Abraham, when Yahweh provided an animal for Abraham to sacrifice instead of Abraham's son. People in Abraham's time knew that people needed to bring a sacrifice and blood to receive forgiveness from Yahweh. But Yahweh did something surprising, because Yahweh did not require Abraham to bring a sacrifice. Instead, Yahweh gave Abraham exactly what Abraham needed so that Yahweh could forgive Abraham. This was another way that Yahweh had shown that Yahweh was not like the pretend gods or idols that the other people groups worshipped.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people believe about forgiveness? When does someone need forgiveness? How does a person ask for that forgiveness? How does someone show that they have forgiven the other people?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 9:8–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Aaron offers the sin or purification offering for himself. Aaron sacrifices the young male bull. Aaron's sons give Aaron the blood of the bull. Aaron dips his finger in the bull's blood and puts the blood on the horns of the altar. Aaron takes certain internal organs from the animal and burns the pieces on the altar. Then Aaron carries the rest of the dead bull's body outside the camp to burn it.

In the second scene: Aaron offers the burnt offering for himself. Aaron kills the ram, or adult male sheep. Aaron's sons give Aaron the blood of the ram. Aaron splashes the ram's blood on the sides of the altar. Aaron's sons give Aaron parts of the body of the dead ram, and Aaron burns the parts one by one. Aaron washes the internal organs and the legs, and also burns those parts.

The characters in this passage are:

- Aaron
- Aaron's sons, the priests
- Yahweh
- Moses
- And the assembly of Israelites, though the storyteller does not mention the assembly in this part of the story

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The Israelite people were still camped at the bottom of Mount Sinai. Yahweh has given Moses and Aaron many laws, instructions, and rules for how the Israelite people could live and please Yahweh. For the last seven days, Moses has been leading the people through the process of the ordination of the priests. The purification offering and burnt offerings that Aaron sacrifices in this passage happen at the end of the ordination service, on the eighth day.

The beginning of this passage is a transition. The previous passage gave Moses' instructions and an overview or summary of what would happen next. But this is where Aaron follows the instructions and does what Yahweh wants Aaron to do.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, when you tell a story or narrative, how do you transition from telling information about what should happen and start telling the details of what actually happened? Pause this audio here.

In the first scene, Aaron offers the purification offering for himself. The storyteller says Aaron "comes" to the altar. This means Aaron approaches the altar. The altar that the storyteller mentions here is the altar of burnt offering in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, talk about someone walking close to an important person or an important place. What words do you use to talk about how that person comes close to the important person or place? Pause this audio here.

Aaron kills a young male bull for Aaron's purification offering. The young male bull was probably about a year old. The bull was still young but already old enough to have babies. We know from other passages that when a priest made these sacrifices, someone, probably another priest, would catch the animal's blood in a bowl of some kind. In this passage, Aaron's sons are probably the ones who catch the animal's blood, since Aaron's sons are the ones who give Aaron the container of bull's blood.

Aaron's sons give Aaron the blood of the bull in a bowl. Some translations use a special word to show that Aaron's sons give this container to Aaron in a ceremonial way.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what are the most common ceremonies? What kind of special actions do people do in these ceremonies? What kind of special words do people say in these ceremonies? Pause this audio here.

Aaron dips the index finger of Aaron's right hand in the bull's blood and puts some of the blood on the horns of the altar. Aaron also pours out the rest of the blood at the bottom or base of the altar of burnt offering.

Stop here and look at pictures of the altar of burnt offering as a group. Pause this audio here.

Then Aaron has to remove certain parts of the bull's dead body or carcass. Aaron removes all the fat that covers and surrounds the internal organs of the bull, the two kidneys and the fat on them, and the best part of the liver.

Stop here and look at pictures of the internal organs that Aaron removes for the offering. Pause this audio here.

Aaron burns these pieces on the altar of burnt offering. Then Aaron is probably the person who carries the rest of the dead bull's body through the camp to a certain ritually clean place outside the camp where the priests dump ashes. There, Aaron burns the bull's flesh and hide, which are the rest of the bull's meat and the skin of the bull.

In the second scene, Aaron offers a ram, or adult male sheep, for the burnt offering for himself. Though the storyteller does not say "ram" here, we know it is a ram from previous passages where Moses told Aaron to bring a ram for a burnt offering. Aaron kills the ram. Just like for the other sacrifice, someone must catch the blood of the sacrifice in a container. Again, since the storyteller mentions Aaron's sons earlier in the passage, it is probably Aaron's sons who do this while Aaron kills the ram. Aaron's sons give Aaron the blood of the ram in a special way. Aaron throws the ram's blood on the sides of the altar.

Aaron's sons give Aaron parts of the body of the dead ram, including the head, and Aaron burns each body part one by one. Aaron washes the internal organs and the legs, and also burns those parts on top of the rest of the offering.

Leviticus 9:8–14

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 9:8–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Aaron
- Aaron's sons, the priests
- Yahweh
- Moses
- And the assembly of Israelites, though the storyteller does not mention the assembly in this part of the story

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Aaron offers the sin or purification offering for himself. Aaron sacrifices the young male bull. Aaron's sons give Aaron the blood of the bull. Aaron dips his finger in the bull's blood and puts the blood on the horns of the altar. Aaron takes certain internal organs from the animal and burns the pieces on the altar. Then Aaron may be the person who carries the rest of the dead bull's body outside the camp to burn the body. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am ashamed that I have to carry a bloody carcass through the streets; or
- Leaders must show people how to become ritually clean again.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Aaron offers the burnt offering for himself. Aaron kills the ram or adult male sheep. Aaron's sons give Aaron the blood of the ram. Aaron splashes the ram's blood on the sides of the altar. Aaron's sons give Aaron parts of the body of the dead ram, and Aaron burns each body part one by one. Aaron washes the internal organs and the legs and also burns those parts. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing one of the sons of Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am humbled to see my father atone for his own ritual dirtiness; or
- I am honored to be part of this ceremony; or
- I wonder what it will be like doing this every day.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 9:8–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Leviticus 9:8–14

In this passage, Aaron must sacrifice at an **altar**. This is the altar of the **burnt offering**. This altar has **horns**. Use the same words for altar, burnt offering, and horns as you used in previous passages. For more information on altar and burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and, as a group, look again at a picture of the altar of burnt offering as needed. Pause this audio here.

The first offering that Aaron had to make was a **sin or purification offering** for himself. Use the same word or phrase for purification offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on "purification offering," refer to the Master Glossary.

For Aaron's purification offering, Aaron had to kill a young male **bull**. This word refers to an animal that is physically mature and able to have babies, but still young. Use the same word for bull and for killing an animal as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and, as a group, look again at a picture of a bull as needed. Pause this audio here.

Aaron had to **dip** or put his finger into the blood so Aaron could **smear** the blood on the horns of the altar. Use the same words or phrases for dip and smear, and for the horns of the altar, as you used in previous passages.

Aaron also had to **pour** the rest of the blood out of a container onto the base, or bottom, of the altar. Use the same description for pouring the blood onto the base of the altar that you have used in previous passages.

Aaron burned the **fat**, the **kidneys and their fat**, and the **best part of the liver** from the bull for the purification offering on top of the altar. Then Aaron burned the **hide** or **skin**, and the **flesh** of the animal outside the **camp**. Use the same words and phrases for these parts of the animal, and for the Israelite camp, as you have used previously.

Aaron did the things that **Yahweh** commanded Moses to do. Use the same word for Yahweh that you have used previously, and remember that Yahweh is in the Master Glossary.

For the burnt offering, Aaron had to sacrifice a **ram**, which is an adult male sheep. The narrator does not mention the ram in this passage, but if it is necessary in your language, you can include it. Use the same word for adult male sheep as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at a picture of an adult male sheep or ram as a group. Pause this audio here.

Aaron had to **sprinkle** or throw the blood from the burnt offering onto the sides of the altar. Use the same word for sprinkle or throw blood on the side of the altar as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 9:8–14

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (958 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 9:15–24

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 9:15–24 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 9:15–24 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 9:15–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

At this part of the story, the Israelite people were still camping at Mount Sinai. The Israelites had recently built the Tent of Meeting according to Yahweh's instructions. In the last passage, Aaron began to offer the sacrifices for the ordination ceremony so that the priests could start doing their priestly duties and perform religious tasks. This part of the story starts right after Aaron presented the offerings for Aaron in the last passage. This ceremony is the first time that Aaron does the sacrifices that Yahweh had commanded the priests to do. The people who are present at this ceremony are the assembly, which in this case is probably a special gathering of the priests and all the elders of Israel who represent all the people. The elders of Israel were usually older men, who represented the different family lines and groups within the people of Israel.

Aaron offers the sin or purification offering, the burnt offering, the grain offering, and the fellowship offering for the people of Israel. Aaron offers these on top of the morning burnt offering. Remember that the morning burnt offering was one of the two burnt offerings that Yahweh told the priests to offer every day. Notice that for Aaron's first day as a priest, Aaron offers most of the different kinds of offerings, and several kinds of ritually clean animals. The purpose of this ceremony is to make the whole community of Israel ritually clean. The focus right now is not on the ritual cleansing of individual sins, but of the whole community's sins. These offerings also dedicate the people of Israel to relationship with Yahweh and to worship of Yahweh. Lastly, the offerings allow a special way for the people of Israel to receive Yahweh's blessing.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people think is different between the sin that one person might commit and the sin of the whole community? In your culture, when do you ritually

Leviticus 9:15–24

clean yourself only, and when do you ritually clean yourselves as a community? Which is more common? How do you and your community make yourselves ritually clean? Pause this audio here.

After Aaron gives the purification offering, the burnt offering, and the grain offering, Aaron kills the ox and the ram for the fellowship offering. Aaron's sons give Aaron the animals' blood and Aaron sprinkles or throws the sacrificed animal's blood on the sides of the altar. Aaron cuts certain internal organs out of the dead animals. Aaron removes the fatty part of the tail and all the fat that covers and surrounds the internal organs. Aaron removes the two kidneys and the fat on the kidneys. Aaron also removes the fatty part of the liver. Aaron's sons place these parts on the animal's breast pieces and then Aaron burns the fatty pieces on the altar.

Aaron probably only had to offer the fatty part of the tail of the ram, not of the ox. Aaron also offers a wave offering by moving the breasts and the right thigh in a certain way before Yahweh. This is not really a separate offering; it is a part of the ceremonial process.

Aaron blesses the people of Israel after Aaron finishes offering the sacrifices. When a person blesses another person, it means that the person asks Yahweh for safety, health, wisdom, or to provide what the other person needs. Sometimes, people talked about blessing as "asking for peace." In the Old Testament, people often use the word "peace" to refer to a life of wholeness, calm, and safety.

Then Moses and Aaron go into the Tent of Meeting. This is a reminder to the rest of the assembly. Even though the purpose of all the laws and rules is so that the people can be close to Yahweh, there is still a separation between Yahweh and the people. The only people who can go between Yahweh and the people in this special way are the priests.

When Moses and Aaron come out of the Tent of Meeting, Moses and Aaron bless the people of Israel again.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What does peace mean in your culture? What do people think would be the perfect life? How is this the same or different from the peace that Yahweh offers us? Pause this audio here.

After Moses and Aaron give the second blessing, Yahweh shows his glory to the Israelites. Yahweh's presence makes fire that comes down and completely burns up the burnt offering and the pieces of fat. In response, the people of Israel shout all together. It is unclear whether the Israelites shout as part of the ceremony, as a celebration, or if the Israelites are terrified or very scared of what Yahweh had done. The Israelites fall on their faces, which means the Israelites bow to show respect, honor, and worship. When the people bowed in this way, their faces touched the ground. This is how the Israelite people would worship Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you show great respect and honor in your culture?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 9:15–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Aaron offers the purification offering, the burnt offering, and the grain offering for the people of Israel. Then Aaron kills the ox and the ram for the fellowship offering. Then Aaron sprinkles or throws the sacrificed animal's blood on the sides of the altar. Aaron cuts certain internal organs out of the dead animals and burns those pieces on the altar. Aaron also offers a wave offering by moving some of the pieces of meat in a certain way before Yahweh.

In the second scene: Aaron blesses the people of Israel. Then Moses and Aaron go into the Tent of Meeting. When Moses and Aaron come out of the tent, Moses and Aaron bless the people of Israel again. Then Yahweh's presence makes fire that comes down and burns the burnt offering and the pieces of fat. Then the people of Israel worship Yahweh.

The characters in this passage are:

- Aaron the priest
- The people of Israel
- The assembly of people who represent the Israelites
- Aaron's sons, the priests
- Moses
- And Yahweh

The storyteller also mentions how Aaron gives the burnt offering, which requires a young male bull and a young male sheep, but the storyteller does not mention the animals in this passage.

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The Israelite people are still camped at the bottom of Mount Sinai. Yahweh was giving Moses and Aaron many laws, instructions, and rules for how the Israelite people should live and please Yahweh. For the last seven days, Moses has been leading the people through the ordination of the priests. Aaron makes the sacrifices in this passage at the end of the ordination ceremony.

In the first scene, Aaron offers the purification offering, the burnt offering, and the grain offering for the people of Israel. Aaron offers these on top of the normal morning burnt offering.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your language, how do you talk about order of events? Every time you listen to the passage, think about ways that you can talk about the order of the offerings in a way that will make sense to the listener. As you listen, tell each other what you notice in the story. Pause this audio here.

First, Aaron kills the goat for the purification offering for the Israelite people. Aaron does this right after Aaron offers the purification offering and the burnt offering for himself. You may want to use language that makes it clear that Aaron does this immediately after the other two offerings. The storyteller says that Aaron offers this purification offering in a similar way to how Aaron offered a purification offering for himself.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your language, what information about the offering process is helpful to repeat? What is the best way to compare this purification offering to Aaron's purification offering? Pause this audio here.

For the people's purification offering, Aaron offers a young male goat. Aaron slaughters or kills the goat in the proper way and follows the proper instructions for how to sprinkle or splash the animal's blood and burn certain internal organs of the dead animal.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a young male goat. Pause this audio here.

Next, Aaron offers the burnt offering for the people of Israel, which is a young male bull and a young male sheep. These animals are supposed to be about a year old. Some translations say Aaron brings or presents these animals. This means that Aaron ceremonially brings the animals forward before Aaron kills the animals. Although the storyteller does not mention the animals in the passage, you may want to mention that Aaron kills the young male bull and the young male sheep for the burnt offering.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a young male bull and a young male sheep. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says Aaron offers the burnt offering according to Yahweh's "ordinance," or instructions. This means that Aaron follows Yahweh's instructions or rules that Yahweh gave earlier in Leviticus.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your language, talk about a process or a cultural ceremony that is familiar to anyone from your culture. Notice the words, phrases, and patterns of speech you use when you talk about the process or ceremony the first time, and how you talk about it in a similar way or a different way when you talk about it again. Pause this audio here.

Next, Aaron takes a handful of the grain offering and burns the grain in the fire on the same altar as the burnt offering. For this grain offering, a person had to grind wheat into a fine flour and mix it with oil.

For the people of Israel's fellowship offering, Aaron offers an adult male sheep, or ram, and one large ox. We know from other passages that this ox could be either a male bull, a female cow, or a castrated male bull, which is a male bull that cannot have babies.

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Aaron kills the ox and the ram for the fellowship offering. We know from other passages that when a priest made these sacrifices, someone, probably another priest, would catch the animal's blood in a bowl. In this passage, Aaron's sons are probably the ones who caught the animal's blood, since Aaron's sons give Aaron the container of bull's blood.

Aaron's sons give Aaron some of the animal blood in a container. Some translations use a special word to show that Aaron's sons give this container to Aaron in a ceremonial way.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you describe someone doing something in a ceremonial way? In this passage, Aaron does many things in a special way: Aaron presents the animals for sacrifice, Aaron blesses the people in a certain way, Aaron holds up parts of the fellowship offering as a wave offering, and Aaron's sons give Aaron the bowl of blood in a special way. Discuss here what kind of language you can use to show that people do things in a special way. Pause this audio here.

Then Aaron sprinkles or throws the dead animal's blood on the sides of the altar. Either Aaron or Aaron's sons cuts certain internal organs out of the dead animals to burn those pieces on the altar. Aaron removes the fatty part of the tail, as well as all the fat that covers and surrounds the internal organs. Aaron removes the two kidneys and the fat on the kidneys. Aaron also removes the best part of the liver.

Aaron probably only had to take the fatty part of the tail of the ram, not of the ox. Either Aaron or Aaron's sons places these parts on the animal's breast pieces, and then Aaron burns the fatty pieces on the altar.

Aaron also offers a wave offering by moving some of the pieces of meat in a certain way before Yahweh. Aaron waves the breast meat and the right back leg of the ox and the adult male sheep. Sometimes these pieces of meat have special names.

Stop here and, as a group, look at diagrams of bull meat and sheep meat. Discuss what words in your language refer to these cuts of meat. Pause this audio here.

We know that Aaron would do a special motion while Aaron held the breast meat and the right back leg of the ox and the sheep. Aaron would move in a special, ceremonial way. We are not sure exactly how Aaron waved the meat, but Aaron may have held the meat in his hands and then raised and lowered Aaron's arms several times. This was the wave offering.

In the second scene, Aaron blesses the people of Israel. To do this, Aaron lifts his hands. For ancient Israelites, this showed that the person was praying and blessing other people. Then Aaron steps down. Aaron was standing at the altar of burnt offering in front of everyone. It is possible that there were steps or something around the altar of burnt offering, so that the area where Aaron was standing was higher than the areas around it. Aaron steps down out of people's view or away from the altar in some way. But we do not know exactly what it means.

Then Moses and Aaron go into the Tent of Meeting. The storyteller does not tell us what Moses and Aaron do inside. When Moses and Aaron come back out, Moses and Aaron bless the people of Israel again. We do not know if Moses and Aaron did a special gesture or hand motion here, as Aaron did before, because the storyteller does not mention it.

Then Yahweh shows Yahweh's glory to the Israelites. Yahweh's presence makes fire that comes down and completely burns up the burnt offering and the pieces of fat on the altar of burnt offering. Some translations use a word like "suddenly" to show that Yahweh sent fire that appeared out of nowhere and was possibly even loud. Some scholars think that maybe the fire was lightning. It is important that the translation shows that Yahweh sent this fire, but the fire was not Yahweh himself.

Then the people of Israel shout all together. It is unclear whether the Israelites shouted as part of the ceremony, as a celebration, or if the Israelites were terrified or very scared of what Yahweh had done. The Israelites fall on their faces, which means the Israelites bow to show respect and worship to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will describe the way the Israelites shout in your language. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

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Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 9:15–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Aaron the priest
- The people of Israel
- The assembly of people who represent the Israelites
- Aaron's sons, the priests
- Moses
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Aaron offers the purification offering, the burnt offering, and the grain offering for the people of Israel around the same time as the priests made the daily morning burnt offerings. Then Aaron kills the ox and the ram for the fellowship offering. Aaron's sons give Aaron the dead animal's blood, and then Aaron sprinkles or throws the sacrificed animal's blood on the sides of the altar. Aaron burns certain internal organs from the dead animals on the altar. Aaron also offers a wave offering by moving some of the pieces of meat in a certain way before Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a son of Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I think about how our lives will be different as we begin to do all the things Yahweh has commanded us to do; or
- It is exciting to think that we are going to be close to Yahweh; or
- I know the sacrifices purify us before Yahweh, but it still makes me sad that our ritual dirtiness causes so much death.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Aaron lifts his hands and blesses the people of Israel. Then Moses and Aaron go into the Tent of Meeting. When Moses and Aaron come back out, Moses and Aaron bless the people of Israel again. Then Yahweh's presence makes fire that comes down and completely burns up the burnt offering and the pieces of fat. Then the people of Israel shout and fall with their faces to the ground to worship Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a person from the assembly, either a priest or elder, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh is incredibly powerful; or
- Seeing Yahweh's fire makes me very afraid; or
- If Yahweh blesses us, who can fight against us and win?

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 9:15–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

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Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh commanded the people of Israel to bring a **young male goat** for the purification offering. The young male goat was probably about a year old, still young but old enough to have babies. Use the same word or phrase for "young male goat" as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a young male goat. Pause this audio here.

Aaron had to make an **offering** for the people. The first offering Aaron made was the **sin or purification offering** for the people of Israel. Use the same words or phrases for a general offering and for the purification offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on offering and purification offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Aaron also had to make a **burnt offering** for the people of Israel. Use the same word for burnt offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Aaron offered the burnt offering according to Yahweh's **ordinance**, or Yahweh's instruction. Use the same word or phrase for ordinance as you used in previous passages. For more information about ordinance, refer to the Master Glossary.

Use the same word or phrase for **grain offering** as you used in previous passages. For more information on grain offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Aaron **slaughters**, or kills, the animals for the offerings. Use the same word for slaughter or kill as you used in previous passages.

In this passage, Aaron must sacrifice at an **altar**. This is the altar of the burnt offering. Use the same word for altar as you used in previous passages. For more information on altar, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of the altar of burnt offering. Pause this audio here.

For the fellowship offering, Aaron had to sacrifice another **ox**. An ox could be a male bull, or it could be a female cow, or it could be a male castrated bull that worked in the fields. Use the same word for ox as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of an ox. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Aaron must sacrifice a **ram**, which is an adult male sheep, as a fellowship offering. Use the same word for ram or adult male sheep as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of an adult male sheep or ram. Pause this audio here.

Use the same word for **peace or fellowship offering** as you used in previous passages. For more information on peace or fellowship offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Aaron would **sprinkle** or **throw** the blood onto the horns of the altar. Use the same word for sprinkle or throw that you used in previous passages.

Use the same words for the **fatty tail**, the **fat portions**, the **kidneys** and their fat, the best part of the **liver**, and the **breast** and **thighs** of the animals as you used in previous passages.

Aaron took the breast and thighs of the fellowship offering and moved the pieces in a special way before Yahweh. This is a **wave offering**. Use the same word for wave offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on "wave offering," refer to the Master Glossary.

Aaron lifted his hands and blessed the Israelites. When a person blesses other people, the person is praying that God will do good things for the people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **bless**. Look up bless in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Aaron and Moses went into the **Tent of Meeting**. Use the same word for "Tent of Meeting" as you used in previous passages. For more information on the Tent of Meeting, refer to tabernacle in the Master Glossary.

Yahweh shows his **glory**. The glory of Yahweh is something amazing that goes with or shows Yahweh's presence. Sometimes, Yahweh sends a bright light or a big storm. Here, Yahweh sends fire that completely burns up the burnt offering and pieces of fat. Use the same words for Yahweh and glory as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate the way that Yahweh **shows** his glory. Look up glory in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 9:15–24

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (992 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (8.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 10:1–11

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 10:1–11 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 10:1–11 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

Leviticus 10:1–11

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 10:1–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this section of Leviticus, Moses dedicates Aaron and Aaron's sons as priests, as Yahweh instructed Moses, and the priests start offering sacrifices at the Tent of Meeting. But in this passage, something goes wrong. Just before this, Aaron and Aaron's sons offered sin offerings, burnt offerings, a grain offering, and a peace offering to Yahweh for the people of Israel. Then fire came from Yahweh and burnt up what was left on the altar, which showed that Yahweh approved of the offerings the priests had sacrificed to Yahweh. But then in this passage, Aaron's two oldest sons, Nadab and Abihu, did something wrong.

Nadab and Abihu took their censers, which are pans that people use to carry burning coals or incense when people burn incense as an offering to Yahweh. Nadab and Abihu took these pans and put fire and incense on the pans. Then Nadab and Abihu used these pans to offer what the narrator calls "strange or unauthorized fire" to Yahweh.

Stop here and look at a picture of a censer. Pause this audio here.

Now, no one is sure exactly what offering unauthorized fire means. It is possible that Nadab and Abihu offered the wrong kind of incense instead of following Yahweh's instructions from Exodus 39 about how to prepare incense correctly. Or Nadab and Abihu could have offered incense at the wrong time of day. Or Nadab and Abihu may have burned the incense like people in another foreign religion did, instead of how Yahweh commanded. Most likely, though, Nadab and Abihu were trying to go into the most holy part of the Tent of Meeting, where Yahweh's presence was. Nadab and Abihu probably went when Nadab and Abihu wanted, instead of waiting for the time Yahweh wanted the priests to burn incense. But whatever the problem was, the point is that Nadab and Abihu offered incense in a way that Yahweh had not instructed Nadab and Abihu to offer it.

Stop here and, as an activity, try to think of at least three reasons it would be a bad thing for the priests to serve Yahweh without following Yahweh's instructions for how the priests should serve Yahweh. Pause this audio here.

When Nadab and Abihu did this thing that Yahweh had not commanded Nadab and Abihu to do, fire came from Yahweh and burned Nadab and Abihu to death. Then Moses told Aaron something that Yahweh had said earlier to Moses. Even though this previous conversation between Yahweh and Moses is not in the Bible, Yahweh had apparently told Moses two things earlier. The first was probably about the people who were nearby Yahweh, which means the priests who went close to Yahweh's presence in the Tent of Meeting. These people near Yahweh had to treat Yahweh as holy. But it could possibly mean that Yahweh would prove to those people that Yahweh is holy. And the second thing Yahweh told Moses was that all the people of Israel would honor and respect Yahweh because of how holy and powerful Yahweh is. Basically, Moses was explaining to Aaron that what Yahweh had said before had been a warning. Yahweh was so holy and powerful that the priests could not just do whatever the priests wanted when the priests were serving Yahweh, especially since serving brought the priests very close to Yahweh's presence. The priests had to serve Yahweh exactly how Yahweh had said, especially because the priests had the privilege of being close to Yahweh. Yahweh had given the priests instructions about how the priests could interact with Yahweh without danger. Yahweh is so holy that it is dangerous for a person to interact with Yahweh without following Yahweh's instructions. When Aaron heard Moses's explanation, Aaron stayed silent and did not say anything.

Stop here and discuss as a group: We do not know why Aaron stayed silent. Possibly Aaron was very sad, or possibly Aaron was afraid. In your culture, why do people stay silent in situations like these? Pause this audio here.

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Stop here and discuss these questions as a group: Think about places or things that are holy in your culture. What special things do people have to do to go to those holy places or interact with those holy things? Are there things that are dangerous to do in the holy places or before interacting with those holy things? Pause this audio here.

Moses then called Moses' and Aaron's cousins, Mishael and Elzaphan, to come help. Mishael and Elzaphan were the sons of Moses and Aaron's father's brother. Moses asked Mishael and Elzaphan to carry the bodies of Nadab and Abihu out of the camp where the Israelites were staying. Mishael and Elzaphan needed to remove the bodies from the sanctuary, or holy place, in and around the Tent of Meeting so that the bodies would not make the Tent of Meeting unclean, or ritually dirty. Aaron could not bury Aaron's own sons because Yahweh did not allow the high priest to make himself ritually dirty by touching a dead body, even if it was the body of a close relative. It is unclear why Aaron's cousins had to take care of the bodies instead of Aaron's other sons. It is possible that Aaron's remaining sons had to remain ritually clean so that Aaron's other sons could keep serving Yahweh in the Tent of Meeting. In any case, the cousins, Mishael and Elzaphan, did what Moses asked. Mishael and Elzaphan carried the bodies of Nadab and Abihu by holding onto the tunics Nadab and Abihu were wearing, probably so that Mishael and Elzaphan did not have to directly touch the bodies. Mishael and Elzaphan carried the bodies outside the Israelite camp. Mishael and Elzaphan likely wrapped the bodies in cloth and buried the bodies, based on what Israelites normally did with dead bodies, but the storyteller does not talk about that part.

Stop here and discuss these questions as a group: When somebody dies in your culture, who takes care of the body? Is there anything that person has to do or that the person cannot do because that person has touched a dead body? Pause this audio here.

Next, Moses told Aaron and Aaron's remaining sons, Eleazar and Ithamar, not to mourn their dead relatives. Moses said, "Do not let your hair be messy or take off your priestly hats. Do not tear your clothes." These were things that Israelites would have normally done to mourn someone who died. If Aaron and Aaron's remaining sons did not listen to Yahweh and publicly mourned Nadab and Abihu anyway, Aaron and Aaron's sons would die. Yahweh would be angry with the whole Israelite community because of Aaron and Aaron's sons. The rest of the Israelites could mourn for Nadab and Abihu, but if Aaron or Aaron's sons, Eleazar and Ithamar, did, Aaron and Aaron's sons would die. Moses also told Aaron and Aaron's sons not to leave the Tent of Meeting. If Aaron and Aaron's sons left, Aaron and Aaron's sons would die, because the holy oil that Moses had poured on Aaron and Aaron's sons to show that Yahweh had chosen these men as Yahweh's priests was still on these men's bodies. Clearly, Aaron and Aaron's sons did not have to stay in the Tent of Meeting forever, since the priests did not live in the Tent of Meeting. And the priests moved the tent itself every time the Israelites moved camp. However, Aaron and Aaron's remaining sons apparently could not leave the Tent of Meeting early to mourn their relatives. Aaron and Aaron's sons had to stay at the tent and serve Yahweh as long as Aaron and Aaron's sons had planned to. So Aaron and Aaron's sons did just what Moses said. Aaron and Aaron's sons did not leave the Tent of Meeting or mourn for Nadab and Abihu.

Stop here and discuss these questions as a group: When somebody dies in your culture, what do people do to mourn the person who died? What would you think if a close relative of the person who died did not do these things to mourn? Pause this audio here.

Then, Yahweh spoke to Aaron directly. Every other time in Leviticus, Yahweh gave instructions to Aaron by telling the instructions first to Moses. Then Moses would tell the instructions to Aaron. Or Yahweh would talk to Moses and Aaron together. But here, Yahweh spoke directly to Aaron. Yahweh told Aaron that Aaron and Aaron's descendants should never drink wine or any other kind of alcoholic or fermented drink when Aaron or Aaron's descendants came into the Tent of Meeting. Wine is an alcoholic drink that people make from fermented grapes.

If these men came to serve Yahweh after drinking alcohol, these men would die. It is not clear why Yahweh gave this instruction about alcohol right after the deaths of Nadab and Abihu. Possibly, alcohol was part of the reason that Nadab and Abihu had made the bad decision to ignore Yahweh's commands and offer incense the wrong way. Possibly, the Israelites would often drink alcohol when they mourned dead relatives. Whatever the reason, though, Yahweh made sure that Aaron and all of Aaron's descendants would follow this instruction. Yahweh made this instruction a rule for all the generations of priests who would come after Aaron.

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The priests had to be sober and alert when the priests came to serve Yahweh at the Tent of Meeting. Then the priests could properly tell the difference between what people had devoted to Yahweh and what people had not devoted to Yahweh. The priests could also tell the difference between what was ritually clean and could be in Yahweh's sanctuary and what was ritually dirty and could not be in Yahweh's sanctuary. For a person to serve Yahweh as a priest involved being really close to Yahweh's presence, which was dangerous because Yahweh was so holy. Alcohol dulls people's senses, and the priests needed to be alert so that the priests could properly follow the instructions Yahweh gave the priests for how to safely serve Yahweh. Then the priests could also make sure that ritually dirty things never came close to holy things.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: If some people in your culture drink alcoholic drinks, how can drinking alcohol affect people's behavior? Are there things people should not do after those people drink because it is not safe? Pause this audio here.

The priests also needed to be alert so that the priests could teach the Israelites all the statutes, or rules, that Yahweh had given the priests through Moses.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 10:1–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Aaron's sons, Nadab and Abihu, offer incense to Yahweh the wrong way and Yahweh kills Nadab and Abihu for doing so.

In the second scene: Moses calls Aaron's cousins to bury Nadab and Abihu. Then Moses tells Aaron and Aaron's remaining sons how to respond to Nadab and Abihu's deaths.

In the third scene: Yahweh gives Aaron permanent instructions for Israel's priests about alcohol.

The characters in this passage are:

- Nadab
- Abihu
- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- Aaron's cousins Mishael and Elzaphan
- Aaron's remaining sons, Eleazar and Ithamar
- Aaron's descendants who would become priests after Aaron
- And the assembly of people who represent the Israelites, although the storyteller does not mention them in this story

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that Moses has dedicated the Tent of Meeting and all its things to Yahweh, and has just spent seven days dedicating Aaron and Aaron's sons as Yahweh's priests. On the eighth day, Aaron offered a sin or purification offering, a burnt offering, a grain offering, and a fellowship offering to Yahweh for the people of Israel. Then fire from Yahweh totally burned up the burnt offering, which showed that Yahweh was with the people of Israel and accepted Aaron's offerings.

But then, on that same day, in scene one of this story, Aaron's sons Nadab and Abihu offer incense in some way that Yahweh did not say to do. Then, fire from Yahweh comes out from where Yahweh is present in the Tent of Meeting, and the fire burns Nadab and Abihu to death. After that, Moses remembers a warning that Yahweh gave earlier. We do not know when Yahweh said this warning, since it is not in the Bible before this. Sometime before the story in this passage happens, Yahweh warned that the priests would have to treat Yahweh as holy and sacred. Yahweh said that the people of Israel would honor and respect Yahweh because of how powerful Yahweh

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is. Nadab and Abihu did not listen to this warning, since Nadab and Abihu disobeyed Yahweh's instructions on Nadab and Abihu's very first day as Yahweh's priests. So when Moses remembers this warning and tells Aaron, Aaron stays silent and does not say anything. Aaron probably realizes that Yahweh's warning was clear and that Aaron's sons should have known to treat Yahweh as holy and sacred.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: Think about a time that you did something your parent, guardian, or an elder in your community warned you not to do, and something bad happened because of it. Now imagine that afterward, you are remembering their warning. How would you talk about this? Pay attention to how you talk about the warning, since it happened before what you did. Pause this audio here.

In scene two of this passage, Moses tells Nadab and Abihu's relatives how to respond to Nadab and Abihu's deaths. First, someone had to remove the bodies from the sanctuary, which is the entire area in and around the Tent of Meeting. To take care of this, Moses calls Moses and Aaron's cousins, Mishael and Elzaphan, and instructs Mishael and Elzaphan to carry the bodies of Nadab and Abihu outside the Israelite camp, away from the sanctuary. Mishael and Elzaphan grab onto Nadab and Abihu's tunics to lift the dead bodies and obey Moses.

Next, Moses instructs Nadab and Abihu's direct relatives—their father Aaron and their two brothers Eleazar and Ithamar—not to do the normal customs to mourn for Nadab and Abihu. Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar should not let their hair be messy or uncovered, tear their clothes, or end their time of priestly service to Yahweh in the Tent of Meeting early by leaving the courtyard or sanctuary around the tent. In fact, if Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar disobey and mourn for Nadab and Abihu while serving Yahweh as priests, Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar will die, and Yahweh will be angry with the whole community. The rest of the Israelites will be able to mourn for Nadab and Abihu, but Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar cannot, because there is still oil on Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar. Moses poured this oil during the dedication ceremony to dedicate Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar to Yahweh.

Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar obey Moses' instructions and do not mourn for Nadab and Abihu.

In the last scene, scene three, Yahweh gives Aaron a new instruction. All the other times in Leviticus when Yahweh has told Aaron to do something, Yahweh has talked to Moses first or to Moses and Aaron at the same time. But now, Yahweh talks to Aaron alone. Yahweh instructs Aaron and all Aaron's descendants who will become priests after Aaron not to drink wine or any other fermented or alcoholic drinks so that the priests can stay alert when serving Yahweh.

Stop here and do this exercise as a group: Try to come up with a list of all the fermented or alcoholic drinks that some people in your culture drink. How would you talk about this whole group of drinks? Pause this audio here.

The priests have to be aware enough to tell the difference between holy things, or what people have devoted to Yahweh, and what is not something people have devoted to Yahweh. The priests also have to tell the difference between what is ritually clean and what ritually dirty. If the priests are aware enough to recognize how to follow Yahweh's instructions correctly, then the priests will be able to teach the rest of the Israelites all the instructions and statutes that Yahweh gave Moses for the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: If you start talking to someone about something new, like a new topic or a new instruction, but that new thing is related to what the two of you have been doing, what kinds of words do you use to change what your conversation is about? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 10:1–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Nadab
- Abihu

Leviticus 10:1–11

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- Aaron's cousins Mishael and Elzaphan
- Aaron's remaining sons, Eleazar and Ithamar
- Aaron's descendants who would become priests after Aaron
- And the assembly of people who represent the Israelites, although the storyteller does not mention them in this story

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Aaron's oldest sons, Nadab and Abihu, offer incense to Yahweh in some way that Yahweh did not instruct. Have the people playing Nadab and Abihu take pans and act out putting coals and incense in the pans. Then fire comes from Yahweh and kills Nadab and Abihu. Then Moses tells Aaron something that Yahweh has said before. Earlier, Yahweh said, "The people who are near me must treat me as holy, and all the people of Israel will honor me because of how holy and powerful I am." Have the person playing Moses tell this to the person playing Aaron. Aaron does not say anything. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am afraid because I have just started serving Yahweh as a priest, and now this happened because Yahweh is so holy; or
- I am grieving for my sons; or
- I am angry at Moses for reminding me of what Yahweh said instead of grieving for my sons.

Continue the drama. Then, Moses calls Moses and Aaron's cousins, Mishael and Elzaphan, and instructs Mishael and Elzaphan to carry the bodies of Nadab and Abihu away from the holy place and outside the Israelite camp. Have the people playing Mishael and Elzaphan act out carrying away the bodies. Mishael and Elzaphan carry the bodies by holding onto the clothes because Mishael and Elzaphan do not want to touch the dead bodies directly. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Mishael or Elzaphan, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am honored that my relative Moses trusts me to help in this situation; or
- I am horrified at what has happened to my relatives, and I do not want to do anything wrong, so that nothing happens to me; or
- I am grieving for my relatives, Nadab and Abihu.

Continue the drama. Meanwhile, Moses tells Aaron and Aaron's remaining sons, Eleazar and Ithamar, not to do anything to mourn for Nadab and Abihu. Moses says Aaron and Aaron's sons must not leave the Tent of Meeting, so that Aaron and Aaron's sons will not die. Instead, the people of Israel will mourn for Nadab and Abihu. So Aaron and Aaron's sons Eleazar and Ithamar obey Moses. Have the people playing Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar act out serving Yahweh in the Tent of Meeting instead of mourning. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Eleazar or Ithamar, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am upset because of what has happened to my relatives; or
- I am sad because of my brothers, and I am trying not to show it because of what Moses said; or
- I am afraid to keep serving Yahweh in the Tent of Meeting after what happened to my brothers.

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Continue the drama. Then Yahweh tells Aaron that Aaron, Aaron's sons, and Aaron's descendants who will become priests after Aaron must not drink alcohol when the priests serve Yahweh in the Tent of Meeting. The priests must not do this because the priests need to be able to clearly tell the difference between what is holy and what is not holy, and between what is ritually clean and what is not ritually clean. Have the people playing Aaron, Eleazar, Ithamar, and Aaron's descendants who will become priests after Aaron act out serving Yahweh carefully. These priests must also teach the people of Israel everything that Yahweh has taught the priests.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 10:1–11 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Aaron's sons Nadab and Abihu use a censer to offer **incense** to **Yahweh** in some way that Yahweh has not instructed these men to do. Use the same words or phrases for incense and Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and look at a picture of a censer as a group. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for censer. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Then, fire comes from Yahweh and kills Nadab and Abihu. Moses then tells Aaron about something Yahweh said before. Yahweh said that the people who are near to Yahweh must treat Yahweh as **holy** or sacred, and the people of Israel would **glorify** Yahweh, or praise Yahweh, because of how powerful and holy Yahweh is. For more information about what it means to be holy or what it means to glorify, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for holy and glorify as you used in previous passages. Aaron does not say anything back to Moses.

Then, Moses calls in Aaron's cousins Mishael and Elzaphan, and Moses asks these men to carry Nadab and Abihu's bodies outside the Israelite camp and away from the holy place or **sanctuary**. For more information on sanctuary, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for sanctuary as you used in previous passages.

After Moses asks, Mishael and Elzaphan obey Moses and carry the bodies outside the camp by grabbing onto the dead men's clothes instead of touching the bodies directly. You may use the general word for clothing, or your word for **tunic**. For more information about tunic, refer to the Master Glossary.

Moses tells Aaron and Aaron's remaining sons, Eleazar and Ithamar, not to do mourning rituals for Nadab and Abihu, or Aaron and Aaron's remaining sons will die. Instead, the people of Israel will mourn for Nadab and Abihu. Aaron and Aaron's remaining sons also must not leave the entrance to the **Tent of Meeting**, or Aaron and Aaron's remaining sons will die. This means that Aaron and Aaron's remaining sons must stay inside the sanctuary or courtyard that surrounds the Tent of Meeting, because everything inside that area is holy space. Aaron and Aaron's remaining sons must not leave because Yahweh **anointed** or chose Aaron and Aaron's sons to be priests. Moses had poured oil on Aaron and Aaron's remaining sons to show that Yahweh had chosen these men. The oil was still on Aaron and Aaron's sons because Yahweh had just anointed these men the week before. For more information on the Tent of Meeting and anoint, refer to tabernacle and anoint in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for tabernacle and anoint as you used in previous passages. Aaron and Aaron's sons obey the instructions Moses gives.

Then Yahweh gives Aaron an instruction or **statute** for Aaron and all of Aaron's descendants to follow. For more information on statute, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for statute as you used in previous passages. The instruction is that when Aaron and Aaron's descendants come to the tabernacle, or Tent of Meeting, to serve Yahweh, Aaron and Aaron's descendants must not drink wine or any other alcoholic drinks.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **wine**. Look up wine in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for other alcoholic drinks, based on your discussion in the "Defining the Scenes" step for this passage. If you have already translated this concept in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh wants the priests not to drink wine or alcoholic drinks so that the priests can stay aware and be able to tell the difference between what is holy or sacred and what is not holy. It is also so that the priest will be able to tell the difference between what is ritually **clean** and what is ritually **unclean**. For more information about clean and unclean, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for clean and unclean as you used in previous passages. The priests must be able to teach the people of Israel everything that Yahweh instructed the priests through Moses.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 10:1–11

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (950 KB)
- Setting the Stage (9.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 10:12–20

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 10:12–20 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 10:12–20 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

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Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 10:12–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this section of Leviticus, Moses has dedicated Aaron and Aaron's sons as priests, as Yahweh instructed Moses, and the priests started offering sacrifices at the Tent of Meeting. But in the last passage, Aaron's two oldest sons, Nadab and Abihu, offered incense to Yahweh in the wrong way. Because Nadab and Abihu disobeyed Yahweh, fire came from Yahweh and killed Nadab and Abihu. Moses told Aaron and Aaron's remaining sons not to mourn for their relatives or stop serving Yahweh at the Tent of Meeting before the time to stop. Otherwise, Aaron and Aaron's remaining sons would die.

This passage takes place right after what happened to Nadab and Abihu. In this passage, Moses gives Aaron and Aaron's remaining sons some instructions about how to properly serve Yahweh at the Tent of Meeting. Aaron's two remaining sons do not completely follow the instructions, which makes Moses angry, but Aaron responds in a way Moses approves of.

After the disaster of Nadab and Abihu's deaths, it seems that Aaron and Aaron's surviving sons did not eat the parts of the offerings that Yahweh had instructed the priests to eat. So Moses reminds Aaron and Aaron's sons, Eleazar and Ithamar, about the instructions for which things the priests should eat from the offerings. The priests should eat the grain left over from what the priests offered to Yahweh in the grain offering. As Yahweh told Moses in Leviticus 6, the priests must eat the offering unleavened, so the priests must prepare the grain without yeast. The priests also must eat the grain in the sanctuary, so the priests must eat the grain inside the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting, beside the altar. The priests must eat grain there because the priests cannot eat food that is holy outside the holy space of the sanctuary. Aaron and Aaron's sons are supposed to eat the grain because the grain is the part of the offering that Yahweh chose for the priests to have, just as Yahweh commanded Moses earlier.

Aaron and Aaron's family are also supposed to eat the animal breast and thigh from the peace or fellowship offering. Yahweh commanded in Leviticus 7 that Aaron, Aaron's sons, and the rest of the priests should receive these parts of the fellowship offering. The priests' families, including family members who are not priests themselves, like daughters and young sons, can eat these animal breasts and thighs. But the priests' families do not have to eat the meat in the sanctuary, because not all of those family members can enter the sanctuary. However, Moses reminds Aaron and Aaron's sons that the priests and their families still have to eat the meat in a place that is ritually clean. When an Israelite brings a fellowship offering to Yahweh, the Israelite must bring the animal's fat and breast to the priest, and the priest must wave those parts in front of Yahweh's presence to symbolically offer those parts to Yahweh. The priest may then have the breast that the priest waved. The Israelite who brings a fellowship offering must also give the right thigh of the animal to the priests. Yahweh explained all this to Moses in Leviticus 7, but now Moses reminds Aaron of what Yahweh commanded then. After the priest waves these animal parts in front of Yahweh's presence to symbolize offering the parts to Yahweh, these parts of the fellowship offering will be the priests' share every time in the future. In other words, Aaron and all of Aaron's descendants who will become priests after Aaron all have the privilege and responsibility to eat these parts of the fellowship offering.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what are some things that leaders get to do or have the right to do? What are some of the leaders' responsibilities? What kinds of things might be both privileges and responsibilities? Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 10:12–20

Then Moses asks someone what happened to the goat that Aaron and Aaron's sons sacrificed as a sin or purification offering earlier that day. It is not clear who Moses asked, or if Moses just looked around to find out what happened. According to Yahweh's instructions in Leviticus 6, the priests were supposed to eat the meat from the purification offering in the sanctuary, so in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. However, when Moses asks about the goat Aaron and Aaron's sons just sacrificed, Moses finds out that the priests completely burned up the goat. But the priests were supposed to leave the meat to eat instead of burning up all the meat. This makes Moses very angry at Aaron's surviving sons, Eleazar and Ithamar, so Moses asks why Eleazar and Ithamar did not eat the meat in the sanctuary. Moses tells Eleazar and Ithamar that the meat is very holy because the Israelites gave the animal to the priests so that the priests could make atonement for the Israelites' sin or make amends to Yahweh for what the Israelites had done. There were different instructions for purification offerings depending on who had sinned. In some purification offerings, the priests were supposed to take the animal blood into the Tent of Meeting, and in some offerings, the priests were not supposed to do this. The priests could only eat the leftover animal meat when the priests did not take the blood into the Tent of Meeting. Eleazar and Ithamar had not taken the goat's blood into the Tent of Meeting, so the priests were supposed to eat the goat's meat in the sanctuary area, inside the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. Aaron and Aaron's sons should have done this because Moses had commanded the priests to do so in Leviticus 6.

Even though Moses confronts Aaron's sons, Eleazar and Ithamar, because Eleazar and Ithamar failed to obey Yahweh's instructions, Aaron is the one who answers Moses. Aaron explains that earlier that day, Aaron's sons had sacrificed the purification offering and burnt offering to Yahweh, but such things happened to Aaron. Aaron means that even though Aaron's sons Nadab and Abihu offered the sacrifices to Yahweh earlier that day, terrible things had happened to Aaron's family, and Aaron had lost Aaron's two older sons. Aaron then asks Moses, "Would Yahweh have been happy if I ate the purification offering today?" Aaron did not ask Moses this question to get information; Aaron used the question to tell Moses something. It is not clear exactly what Aaron meant, but there are two main options. Possibly, Aaron meant that Aaron's sons had disobeyed Yahweh while Aaron was in charge of the sons. Because Yahweh had punished Aaron's sons, Aaron believed that Aaron was guilty too, and it would not be right for Aaron to eat holy food. More likely, though, Aaron meant that since bad things happened to Aaron's sons when Aaron's sons incorrectly served Yahweh, Aaron was afraid to eat the purification offering that day. Either way, Aaron's answer satisfied Moses, and Yahweh did not punish Aaron and Aaron's surviving sons for not eating the meat from the offerings.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How is the way Nadab and Abihu disobeyed Yahweh in the last passage similar to or different from the way Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar disobeyed Yahweh in this passage?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 10:12–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Moses reminds Aaron and Aaron's remaining sons about Yahweh's instructions to eat grain and meat leftover from what the priests sacrificed to Yahweh.

In the second scene: Moses confronts Aaron's sons about how the sons did not eat the meat left from the offerings to Yahweh. Aaron defends the decision not to eat, and Aaron's answer satisfies Moses.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Aaron
- Aaron's surviving sons, Eleazar and Ithamar
- The priests' families, who may also eat the meat
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

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Remember that Moses has just dedicated the Tent of Meeting and all its things to Yahweh. Moses has also just spent seven days dedicating Aaron and Aaron's sons as Yahweh's priests. On the eighth day, Aaron offered many sacrifices to Yahweh, and Yahweh accepted Aaron's offerings. But then, on that same day, Aaron's sons Nadab and Abihu offered incense in some way that Yahweh did not instruct Nadab and Abihu to offer, so fire from Yahweh came out from where Yahweh is present in the Tent of Meeting, and the fire killed Nadab and Abihu.

This passage happens on the same day that Yahweh's fire killed Nadab and Abihu, so it takes place on the eighth day after Moses started dedicating Aaron and Aaron's sons as Yahweh's priests. In scene one, Moses reminds Aaron and Aaron's surviving sons, Eleazar and Ithamar, of what Yahweh said the priests could eat from the sacrifices the priests made to Yahweh. Yahweh had already given these instructions to Moses earlier in Leviticus, and Moses had told these instructions to Aaron. Now, however, Moses tells these instructions to Aaron and Aaron's sons again.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: In your culture, if you need to remind your children of something you previously told your children to do, what do you say? How is this different from or similar to what you say the first time you tell your children to do something? Pause this audio here.

First, Moses reminds Aaron and Aaron's sons to eat the grain left over from what the priests offer to Yahweh in the grain offering. Aaron and Aaron's sons must eat the grain without adding yeast. Aaron and Aaron's sons must eat the grain in the sanctuary, or inside the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. Moses also says that this is what Yahweh instructed Moses earlier.

Next, Moses reminds Aaron and Aaron's sons that the priests and their families should eat the animal breast and thigh left over from what the priests offered to Yahweh in the fellowship offering. The priests and their families can eat outside the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting, in any ritually clean place. Before the priests can eat this meat, the priests must bring the animal breast and thigh and the fatty parts of the animal to Yahweh. Then the priests must wave the parts in front of Yahweh's presence in the Tent of Meeting to symbolically offer the parts to Yahweh. Then the priests and the priests' families can eat the meat. Moses says that this part of the animal from the fellowship offering is the priests' portion forever. In other words, Aaron and Aaron's sons and all of Aaron's descendants will be able to eat this part of the animals the priests sacrifice every time the priests sacrifice a fellowship offering.

In scene two, Moses finds out that Aaron and Aaron's surviving sons, Eleazar and Ithamar, have not eaten the meat from the goat of the purification offering. Moses is angry with Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar, so Moses asks why Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar did not eat the goat meat. Moses reminds Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar that the meat is very holy. The meat is holy because the Israelite people gave the animal to the priests so that the priests could offer the animal to Yahweh to make amends for the Israelites' sins and take away the Israelites' guilt. Moses says that Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar were supposed to eat the meat because the meat was left from a purification offering where the priests did not take the blood from the animal inside the Tent of Meeting. When the purification offering does not involve that, the priests are supposed to eat the meat leftover after the sacrifice, just like Yahweh commanded Moses earlier in Leviticus.

Moses asks this question and tells these things to Eleazar and Ithamar, but Aaron is the one who answers Moses. Aaron explains that earlier that day, Aaron's sons sacrificed burnt offerings and purification offerings to Yahweh, but terrible things still happened to Aaron. Aaron is talking about how Aaron's two older sons, Nadab and Abihu, died earlier in the day because Nadab and Abihu disobeyed Yahweh and did not treat Yahweh as holy. Aaron then asks Moses if Yahweh would have been happy if Aaron had eaten the meat left from the purification offering. Aaron may mean that Yahweh would not be happy because Aaron is guilty because of what Aaron's sons did earlier in the day. More likely, Aaron means that Aaron is afraid to eat the purification offering because Aaron is not sure Yahweh would be happy for Aaron to eat the meat. Either way, Aaron's answer satisfies Moses.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: In what kinds of situations might you say a question when you do not actually want to know more information? What kinds of things can you say with a question instead of a statement? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

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Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 10:12–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Aaron
- Aaron's surviving sons, Eleazar and Ithamar
- The priests' families, who may also eat the meat
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Moses gives Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar instructions. Have the person playing Moses tell these things to Aaron and Aaron's sons, and have the people playing Aaron and Aaron's sons act out how they follow the instructions. Moses says that Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar should eat the grain leftover from the grain offering. The priests must prepare the grain without using yeast, and the priests have to eat the grain in a holy place. So the priests have to eat the grain in the sanctuary—that is, inside the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting.

Moses also says that Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar should eat the animal breast and thigh leftover from the fellowship offering. The priests and the priests' families, including people who were not priests, such as daughters, should eat those pieces of meat in a ritually clean place, though this does not have to be inside the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. Moses reminds Aaron, Eleazar, and Ithamar that when an Israelite brings an animal to the priests for a fellowship offering, the priest must bring the breast and the fatty parts of the animal and wave these pieces in front of Yahweh's presence to symbolically offer the pieces to Yahweh. Then the priest can have the animal's breast and thigh. Moses then says that these parts leftover from the fellowship offering belong to the priests as the priests' perpetual share, so all Aaron's descendants who become priests after Aaron will do the same thing. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy to explain Yahweh's instructions again so Aaron and Aaron's sons can follow the instructions well; or
- I am worried that Aaron or Aaron's sons might mess up again as the priests try to obey Yahweh's instructions; or
- I am frustrated with Aaron and Aaron's sons because they need to hear these instructions again.

Continue the drama. Then Moses tries to figure out what happened to the goat that Aaron and Aaron's sons sacrificed as a purification offering earlier that day. Have the person playing Moses look around for the goat or ask anybody who is standing nearby what happened to the goat. Moses realizes that Aaron and Aaron's sons did not eat the meat leftover from the offering, but instead burned it all up. Have the person playing Moses confront the people playing Aaron's sons Eleazar and Ithamar and say the following things. Moses first asks why Eleazar and Ithamar did not eat the meat, as Eleazar and Ithamar were supposed to. Moses then says why Eleazar and Ithamar should have eaten the meat. Moses says that the Israelites gave the animal for the purification

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offering to the priests so the priests could sacrifice the animal to atone for the people's sins or make amends with Yahweh for what the people had done wrong. This meant that the meat leftover from the sacrifice was very holy. Because of the type of purification offering the priests sacrificed that day, Aaron and Aaron's sons should have eaten the leftover meat in the sanctuary area. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Eleazar and Ithamar, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I am scared because I made a mistake and my brothers just died for their disobedience to Yahweh; or
- I am sorry for not eating the meat that Yahweh instructed us to eat; or
- I am angry that my uncle Moses is confronting us because we are doing our best.

Continue the drama. Have the person playing Aaron step in and answer Moses' question. Aaron asks a question and says, "Would Yahweh have been happy if I ate the purification offering today?" Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am afraid to eat the holy meat because I feel guilty about how my older sons, Nadab and Abihu, disobeyed Yahweh; or
- I am scared to eat the holy meat because Yahweh is so powerful, and I just saw Yahweh kill my sons; or
- I am confused about what the right way to obey Yahweh is.

Continue the drama. Aaron's answer satisfies Moses, so have the person playing Moses do or say something that shows Moses approves of Aaron's answer.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 10:12–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Moses reminds Aaron and Aaron's sons, Eleazar and Ithamar, of the instructions for what things the priests could eat after the priests gave offerings to **Yahweh**. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word for Yahweh as you used in previous passages.

Aaron and Aaron's sons should eat the grain left over from what the priests offered to Yahweh in the **grain offering**, but the priests must prepare the grain without yeast. For more information on the grain offering, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for grain offering as you used in previous passages.

Aaron and Aaron's sons also must eat the offering in the **sanctuary**, inside the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting or tabernacle, beside the **altar**. For more information on sanctuary or altar, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for sanctuary and altar as you used in previous passages. Aaron and Aaron's sons are supposed to eat the grain because the grain is the part of the offering that Yahweh chose for the priest to have. Earlier in Leviticus, Yahweh had commanded Moses that the priests should eat this part.

Aaron and Aaron's family are also supposed to eat the animal breast and thigh from the **peace or fellowship offering**. For more information on the fellowship offering, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for fellowship offering as you used in previous passages.

Since the priests' family, including family members who are not priests themselves, such as daughters and young sons, can eat these animal breasts and thighs, the families do not have to eat these parts in the sanctuary. The priests and their families can eat the meat in any place that is ritually **clean**. For more information on clean, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for clean as you used in previous passages.

When an Israelite brings a fellowship offering to Yahweh, the Israelite must bring the animal's fat and breast to the priest. The priest must wave these parts in front of Yahweh's presence to symbolically offer these parts to Yahweh in a **wave offering**. The priest and his family may then eat the breast that the priest waved. Use the same word or phrase for wave offering as you have used previously, and refer to wave offering in the Master Glossary for more information.

The Israelite who brings a fellowship offering must also give the right thigh of the animal to the priests. For all of the priests, now and in the future, these parts of the fellowship offering will be the priests' families' **portion**. Use the same word or phrase for portion as you have used in previous passages.

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Then Moses tries to figure out what happened to the goat that Aaron and Aaron's sons offered to Yahweh as a **sin or purification offering** earlier that day. Moses learns that the priests completely burned up the goat instead of eating the meat. For more information on the purification offering, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for purification offering as you used in previous passages.

Moses becomes very angry at Aaron's surviving sons, Eleazar and Ithamar, so Moses asks why Eleazar and Ithamar did not eat the meat in the sanctuary. Moses tells Eleazar and Ithamar that the meat is very holy because the Israelites gave the animal to the priests so that the priests could offer the animal to Yahweh to make **atonement** for the Israelites' **iniquity**. Remember that when someone continues to do something wrong against Yahweh, or disobeys Yahweh, that person becomes guilty. In other words, that person is no longer in a right relationship with Yahweh. The priests have to atone for the person, or help restore the person's relationship with Yahweh. For more information on atonement and iniquity, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for atonement and iniquity as you used in previous passages.

Because of the type of purification offering, Aaron and Aaron's sons had not taken the goat's blood into the **holy place**, or inner part of the sanctuary, of the Tent of Meeting. In cases like this, the priests were supposed to eat the meat in the sanctuary area, inside the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. Moses confronts Eleazar and Ithamar, but Aaron is the one who answers Moses's question. Aaron explains that earlier that day, Aaron's sons had sacrificed the purification offering and the **burnt offering** to Yahweh, but bad things had happened to Aaron's oldest sons. For more information on holy place, or the inside of the tabernacle, and burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for holy place and burnt offering as you used in previous passages. Aaron then asks Moses, "Would Yahweh have been happy if I ate the purification offering today?" Moses approves of Aaron's answer.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 10:12–20

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (968 KB)
- Setting the Stage (7.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.8 MB)

- Embodying the Text (5.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (5.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 11:1–8

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 11:1–8 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:1–8 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Note: You may choose to go through step five before this step. In step five, you will discuss all the animals in the passage and also what the phrases “divided hoofs” and “chew the cud” mean.

In this passage, Yahweh talks to Moses and Aaron. Yahweh gives instructions and tells Moses and Aaron to say the same words to the Israelite people. Yahweh gave the Israelite people many rules about how the Israelites should live, what the Israelites should do, and what the Israelites should not do. Yahweh wants the Israelite people to understand that Yahweh is not like the idols and false gods that the Egyptians worshipped. Yahweh also wants the Israelite people to be different from all the other people groups.

In this passage, Yahweh tells Moses and Aaron what animals the Israelite people can eat for food. Remember, at this time, the Israelite people still live in the wilderness. There is not a lot of food or water in the wilderness where the Israelites are. Many times, the Israelite people worry about what the Israelites can eat. But Yahweh always provides food for the Israelites. All the animals that Yahweh mentions in this passage are animals that the Israelite people would see in the wilderness. Perhaps an Israelite person would see another people group eat one of these foods and want to eat the food too. But the Israelite people are not supposed to eat these animals. The Israelites must trust Yahweh and follow Yahweh’s rules.

Yahweh’s rules put the animals into two groups: ritually clean animals and ritually dirty animals. If the Israelite people eat ritually clean animals, then the people also stay ritually clean. But if an Israelite person eats an unclean or ritually dirty animal, then the Israelite person also becomes ritually dirty. When an Israelite person is ritually dirty, that person is not able to worship Yahweh and make sacrifices to Yahweh or go into the tabernacle area.

In this passage, Yahweh talks about land animals, which are animals that run on the ground with four legs. Yahweh said Israelite people can eat land animals that both chew the cud and have divided hoofs. An animal with divided hoofs is an animal with a hard covering on the animal’s toes. This covering, which people call a hoof, is in two parts, all the way down the foot. If you look at a footprint of an animal like this, you will see two completely separate marks in the ground.

Stop here and look at pictures of divided hoofs as a group. Pause this audio here.

An animal that chews the cud is an animal that eats lots of green plants. These animals chew and chew and chew. Even after these animals swallow, these animals will burp up their food and chew the food again.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a video of an animal chewing the cud. Pause this audio here.

Examples of ritually clean animals that Israelite people could eat are cattle, goats, and sheep. In this passage, Yahweh explains why four different animals are ritually dirty animals.

First, Yahweh mentions the camel. Camels are ritually dirty. Even though camels chew the cud, camels are ritually dirty because camels do not have divided hoofs.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the pictures of the camels and the camels' feet. Pause this audio here.

Next, Yahweh mentions the rock hyrax. Rock hyraxes are ritually dirty. Even though rock hyraxes chew the cud, rock hyraxes are ritually dirty because rock hyraxes do not have divided hoofs.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a rock hyrax. Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh mentions the wild rabbit. Wild rabbits are ritually dirty. Even though wild rabbits chew the cud, wild rabbits are ritually dirty because wild rabbits do not have divided hoofs.

Stop here and look at a picture of a wild rabbit as a group. Pause this audio here.

Last Yahweh mentions the wild pig or boar. These wild pigs, or boars, are ritually dirty. Even though wild pigs have divided hooves, wild pigs are ritually dirty because wild pigs do not chew the cud.

Stop here and look at a picture of a wild pig as a group. Pause this audio here.

At the end, Yahweh warns the Israelite people that even touching the dead body of one of these animals would make the people ritually dirty.

Why did Yahweh tell the Israelite people not to eat these animals? Why were cattle and sheep and goats ritually clean animals but not these other four animals? Was it because cattle, sheep, and goats were more healthy for the Israelite people to eat? Maybe. Was it because some of these ritually dirty animals, like the wild rabbit, would have reminded the Israelite people of the Egyptian people's idol worship? Maybe. We do not know why Yahweh made some animals ritually clean and other animals ritually dirty. Yahweh did not say why Yahweh made these rules this way.

But we know that Yahweh wants Yahweh's people to be different from other people. We know Yahweh wants Yahweh's people to know that Yahweh is not like other idols or false gods that other people worship. We know that Yahweh wants other people to think about what is so special about Yahweh and Yahweh's people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do people in your culture who do not worship Yahweh think about Yahweh? How do the people who follow Yahweh act differently from the people who do not follow Yahweh in your community?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has one scene.

In the first scene: Yahweh is talking to Moses and Aaron. Yahweh is giving instructions to Moses and Aaron for the Israelite people. In this passage, Yahweh is giving Moses and Aaron rules about what food the Israelite people can eat. If the Israelite people eat ritually clean animals, then the people also stay ritually clean. But if an Israelite person eats an unclean or ritually dirty animal, then the Israelite person also becomes ritually dirty. Israelite people were only supposed to eat animals with divided hoofs that chew the cud. In this passage, Yahweh explains why four different animals are ritually dirty animals.

Note: You may choose to go through script five before this script. In script five, you will discuss all the animals in the passage and also what the phrases “divided hoofs” and “chew the cud” mean.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- And the Israelite people

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage’s setting:

Remember that the Israelite people are living in the wilderness at this time. An Israelite person might see one of these animals in the wild and want to eat that animal. The Israelite people probably knew that other people groups ate these animals.

You can act out this passage in different ways. You might choose to have a person represent Yahweh, Moses, and Aaron. The person who is representing Yahweh would be explaining the rules to Moses and Aaron. If you act out the passage in this way, you might want to use the pictures of the animals to show while you talk about the different animals. It may also be helpful to use the pictures of the animal’s feet to show the difference.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the pictures of the different animals. Pause this audio here.

If you want, you might decide to act out Moses and Aaron retelling Yahweh’s words to the people of Israel.

Another way to act out this passage would be to imagine situations where an Israelite person sees one of the dirty animals. You can show the person trying to decide whether or not to eat the dirty animal. Maybe show that people from another people group offer ritually dirty food to the Israelite people. The Israelite people must tell the other people why the Israelites cannot eat the food. Please remember, the storyteller does not mention other people groups in the passage, but it may be helpful to imagine what the scene is like.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will act out this passage. Pause this audio here.

In scene one, Yahweh uses special words to talk about what Yahweh allows the Israelite people to eat and what Yahweh does not allow the Israelite people to eat. Yahweh’s words describe situations that will happen in the future. Yahweh uses words to say what the Israelite people should do and should not do.

Stop here and discuss how someone would give permission to eat something in your language and culture. Think about a situation where you tell someone that that person can do something. You are happy if the person does that thing, and you are happy if the person does not do that thing. Discuss how you would talk to the person. Take turns telling a person that the person can eat something. Pause this audio here.

Now stop here and discuss how someone would warn someone not to eat something in your language and culture. Think about a situation where you tell someone not to do something, not even one time. Discuss how you would talk to the person. Take turns telling a person not to eat something. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells Moses and Aaron the main rule: the Israelite people should only eat animals with divided hoofs that chew the cud. “Divided hoofs” might be hard to translate. You may want to translate this idea with something like “feet split in two parts” or “two hard toes on each foot.”

If you have not done so yet, stop here and discuss how you will translate “divided hoofs.” Pause this audio here.

It may also be difficult to translate “chew the cud.” Some languages need to say something like “animals that eat their food twice” or “animals that chew and chew green plants.”

If you have not done so yet, stop here and discuss how you will translate “chew the cud.” Pause this audio here.

If the Israelite people follow this rule, the Israelites will be ritually clean. Then Yahweh gives examples of ritually dirty animals and explains why if a person eats one of these animals, that person is breaking the rule. A rule is one idea that applies to many different situations. When the Israelite people understood the rule, the Israelites could see a new animal and know whether or not the new animal was a ritually clean or ritually dirty animal.

Stop here and discuss how someone would give a rule in your language and culture. Try to think of a rule that is true in lots of different situations. Pause this audio here.

After Yahweh tells Moses and Aaron the rule, Yahweh gives examples of ritually dirty animals that the Israelite people would see. First, Yahweh mentions the camel. Camels are ritually dirty. Even though camels chew the cud, camels are ritually dirty because camels do not have divided hoofs.

Next, Yahweh mentions the rock hyrax. Rock hyraxes are ritually dirty. Even though rock hyraxes chew the cud, rock hyraxes are ritually dirty because rock hyraxes do not have divided hoofs.

Then Yahweh mentions the wild rabbit. Wild rabbits are ritually dirty. Even though wild rabbits chew the cud, wild rabbits are ritually dirty because wild rabbits do not have divided hoofs.

Last, Yahweh mentions the wild pig or boar. Wild pigs are ritually dirty. Even though pigs have divided hooves, pigs are ritually dirty because pigs do not chew the cud.

At the end, Yahweh warns the Israelite people that even touching the dead body of one of these animals would make the people ritually dirty.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has one scene.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- And the Israelite people

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Yahweh is talking to Moses and Aaron. Yahweh is giving Moses and Aaron rules about what food the Israelite people can eat. If the Israelite people eat ritually clean animals, then the people also stay ritually clean. But if an Israelite person eats an unclean or ritually dirty animal, then the Israelite person also becomes ritually dirty. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Moses and Aaron, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The people might answer things like:

- The Israelite people ate many animals when the Israelites lived in Egypt. I do not think the Israelites will like the new rules; or
- Other people eat these foods. Why can we not eat these foods? What if there is not enough food for the people? or
- Yahweh always provides food for us in the wilderness. I trust Yahweh to feed us.

Leviticus 11:1–8

Continue the drama. Israelite people are only supposed to eat animals with divided hoofs that chew the cud. In this passage, Yahweh explains why four different animals are ritually dirty animals. Those four kinds of animals are the camel, the rock hyrax, the wild rabbit, and the pig.

If you want, you can act out Moses and Aaron telling Yahweh's words to the people of Israel. In that case, you may want to include this. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Israelite people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I am confused why Yahweh does not let us eat these animals; or
- I am sad because I like to eat pig; or
- Yahweh has many rules. I understand some of Yahweh's rules. I do not understand some of Yahweh's other rules. But I know Yahweh wants the best for us.

Continue the drama. You may want to include some people who are not Israelites. These people could be Egyptian people, Midian people, or other people. These people are not in the passage. But you can ask these people what they think of the Israelite people's food rules. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the other people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The Israelite people are not like us. The Israelites are not like any other people group; or
- I am curious why Yahweh gave the Israelite people this rule.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh told Moses and Aaron to talk to the **people of Israel**. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and "people of Israel" or Israelite people as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and Israelite, refer to the Master Glossary.

The Israelite people were only supposed to eat animals with divided hoofs that chew the cud. An animal with divided hoofs has special feet or hoofs that split into two separate toes. Like human toes, these animals' toes can move a little bit to help the animals as the animals walk over hills and mountains.

Stop here and, as a group, look again at pictures of divided hoofs as needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **divided hoofs**. If you have already translated this idea in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Some animals that eat lots of grass and plants, like cattle, sheep, and goats, have a special eating process. These animals chew their food in their mouths for a very long time. Then these animals swallow the food in their mouths, but later, the animals burp the food back into their mouths and chew on the food again. People who work with these animals call this process "chewing the cud."

Stop here and, as a group, look again at a video of an animal as the animal chews the cud as needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **chew the cud**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites must not eat camels. A camel is a large animal with long, slender legs and a long neck. A camel's body has shaggy, light brown hair all over. Camels can go a long time without drinking water and are good at traveling long distances. Today, camels are usually 2 meters tall at their hump and can weigh 500 to 1,000 kilograms. The Israelites would have known two different kinds of camels. The Israelites would know camels with two humps, because Abraham, their ancestor, owned camels with two humps. People would use this kind of camel to travel long distances and to carry heavy loads. The Israelites also would have known camels with one hump, which are wild camels that could swim in the water. Israelites were not supposed to eat either kind of camel.

Stop here and look at pictures of the two kinds of camels as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **camel**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh uses the words **clean** and **unclean** or **dirty** to talk about what foods the Israelite people should and should not eat. In this passage, these words do not refer to physical cleanliness. When an Israelite person eats clean food, the person stays ritually clean. But if an Israelite person eats dirty food, then the Israelite person becomes ritually dirty, and that person cannot worship Yahweh. Use the same words or phrases throughout for ritually clean and ritually dirty as you used in previous passages.

A rock hyrax is a small, round animal that uses all four legs to climb and walk. A rock hyrax has short legs and no tail. Rock hyrax fur is long, thick, and soft. This animal lives in rocky areas in the Middle East. A rock hyrax weighs around 3 or 4 kilograms and measures 30 to 50 centimeters long.

Stop here and, as a group, look again at a picture of a rock hyrax as needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **rock hyrax**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

A wild rabbit or hare is an animal with long, big ears. A wild rabbit has thin front legs with small feet and strong, big back legs with big feet. Wild rabbits can run and jump quickly using these big back feet. A wild rabbit has soft brown or gray hair on its body. A wild rabbit's ears can be 10 centimeters long. A wild rabbit's body can be between 40 and 70 centimeters long, and a wild rabbit weighs between 1 and 5 kilograms.

Stop here and, as a group, look again at a picture of a wild rabbit as needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **wild rabbit**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

A wild pig or boar is a big, strong animal with a thick body and short legs. The wild pig has rough, dark hair. The wild pig has thick hair on its back and neck. The wild pig has a large head with little eyes. The wild pig can run very fast.

Stop here and, as a group, look again at a picture of a wild pig as needed. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **pig**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Yahweh says that the Israelites will be unclean if they even touch the dead body of one of these animals. Use the same word or phrase for **dead body of an animal** that you have used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 11:1–8

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (966 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (6.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 11:9–12

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 11:9–12 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:9–12 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:9–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the book of Leviticus, Yahweh was talking to Moses and Aaron and giving the Israelite people many rules about how the Israelites should live, what the Israelites should do, and what the Israelites should not do. In this passage, Yahweh still talks to Moses and Aaron. Yahweh gives instructions to Moses and Aaron and tells Moses and Aaron to say the same words to the Israelite people. Just like Yahweh did in the previous passage, Yahweh gives Moses and Aaron rules about what foods a ritually clean person could eat.

In this passage, Yahweh tells Moses and Aaron what water creatures the Israelite people can eat for food. Remember, at this time, the Israelite people still live in the wilderness. Many times, the Israelite people have been worried about what the Israelites can eat. But Yahweh always provides food for the Israelites. Perhaps an Israelite person would see another people group eat one of these water creatures and want to eat the creature too. Or perhaps an Israelite person would find a new creature in the water. If the Israelites knew Yahweh's rule, the Israelite person could always know if the Israelite was obeying Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss: How do you know what Yahweh wants? How does it make you feel to know that Yahweh tells us exactly what Yahweh wants from us? Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 11:9–12

Yahweh's rules put the animals into two groups: ritually clean animals and ritually dirty animals. If the Israelite people eat ritually clean animals, then the people also stay ritually clean. But if an Israelite person eats an unclean or ritually dirty animal, then the Israelite person also becomes ritually dirty.

In this passage, Yahweh talks about water creatures, which people can find in salt water or in fresh water. The rule is this: all water creatures that have both fins and scales are ritually clean. Any water creatures that only have fins or only have scales, or do not have scales or fins, are ritually dirty. A fin is a thin, flat body part that sticks out from the animal's body and helps the animal move through the water. A scale is a small, hard piece that grows on the skin of certain sea creatures. These scales overlap and create a protective layer for the creature.

Stop here and look at pictures of fins and scales as a group. Pause this audio here.

At the end of this passage, Yahweh warns the Israelite people that to even touch the dead body of one of these ritually dirty water creatures would make the people ritually dirty. Yahweh makes Yahweh's rules simple and clear for the Israelite people. After the Israelite people hear these rules, the Israelites would know which water creatures are good to eat and which water creatures are bad to eat.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Is seafood a regular part of the diet in your culture? Is it surprising to you that Yahweh wanted the Israelite people to only eat water creatures with fins and scales?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:9–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has one scene.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells the eating rule for water creatures. The rule is that the Israelite people can eat water creatures that have both fins and scales. This rule applies to creatures that live in the saltwater and also to creatures that live in the freshwater.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- And the Israelite people

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The background information is that Yahweh gave eating rules to Moses and Aaron. Yahweh also told Moses and Aaron to tell the Israelite people the eating rules. In this passage, the storyteller does not mention Yahweh, Moses, or Aaron by name, but remember that Yahweh, Moses, and Aaron are having this conversation.

You can act out this passage in different ways. You might choose to have people represent Yahweh, Moses, and Aaron. The person who is representing Yahweh would be explaining the rules to Moses and Aaron. If you do it this way, you might want to use the pictures of fins and scales to show the difference between clean and dirty animals.

If you want, you might decide to act out how Moses and Aaron retell Yahweh's words to the people of Israel.

Another way to act out this passage would be to imagine situations where an Israelite person sees a water creature, either while the person is fishing or maybe in a market. You can show the person trying to decide whether or not to eat the water creature. Maybe show how people from another people group offer ritually dirty food to the Israelite people. The Israelite people must tell the other people why the Israelite people cannot eat the food. Please remember, the storyteller does not mention other people groups in the passage, but it may be helpful to imagine what the scene is like.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will act out this passage. Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 11:9–12

In scene one, Yahweh is giving a rule about what foods the Israelite people can eat and should not eat. Yahweh tells Moses and Aaron the main rule about water creatures: the Israelite people should only eat water creatures that have both fins and scales. The Israelite people should not eat any water creatures that only have fins or only have scales, or do not have any fins or scales.

Stop here and look at the pictures of fins and scales. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says this rule is for water creatures that live in saltwater and for water creatures that live in freshwater, such as rivers or streams. Yahweh also says that this rule applies to big water creatures but also to little water creatures that "swarm," or swim around in big groups.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a group of fish. Discuss as a group what words you can use in your language to refer to creatures that live in groups like that. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the Israelites can eat the water creatures that have fins and scales. In other words, these animals are ritually clean. This means the Israelite people can eat those creatures and remain ritually clean. The water creatures that do not have fins or do not have scales, or do not have either fins or scales, are detestable to the people. This is a strong way to say that these animals are ritually dirty for the Israelites to eat. When something is detestable, it is disgusting—people really do not want to eat that thing. If an Israelite person eats one of those creatures, that person becomes ritually dirty too. Even if an Israelite person touches the dead body of one of the dirty water creatures, that person will become dirty too. Yahweh very much does not want the Israelites to have contact with these creatures.

In this passage, the storyteller says many things in the same way as the storyteller did earlier in Leviticus. It is a good idea to talk about ritually clean and ritually dirty foods in similar ways. Remember that in this passage, Yahweh uses strong language to talk about how these water creatures are ritually dirty.

Stop here and discuss: What words do Yahweh and the storyteller use over and over again in Leviticus 11? What is the same in this passage as Leviticus 11:1–8? What is different in this passage from Leviticus 11:1–8? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:9–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has one scene.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- And the Israelite people

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

Leviticus 11:9–12

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Yahweh is talking to Moses and Aaron. Yahweh is giving Moses and Aaron rules about what food the Israelite people can eat. If the Israelite people eat ritually clean animals, then the people also stay ritually clean. But if an Israelite person eats an unclean or ritually dirty animal, then the Israelite person also becomes ritually dirty. In this passage, Yahweh says the rule for saltwater creatures and freshwater creatures: the only water creatures that the Israelites can eat are creatures that have scales and fins. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I hope the Israelite people will stay ritually clean; or
- The Israelite people will be different from all other peoples.

Continue the drama. If you want, you can act out Moses and Aaron telling Yahweh's words to the people of Israel. In that case, you may want to include this.

Ask the people playing Moses and Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- These rules will be good for the Israelite people; or
- I am glad that we can still eat fish!

Continue the drama. You may want to include some people who are not Israelites. These people are not in the passage. These people could be Egyptian people, Midian people, or other people. Maybe a person tries to sell water creatures to the Israelite people. But you can ask these other people groups what they think of the Israelite people's food rules. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the other people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want the Israelites to buy my food; or
- I am curious why the Israelite people have these rules.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:9–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh talks about ritually **unclean** or dirty animals to talk about what foods the Israelite people should not eat. Yahweh uses very strong language. Yahweh says that these animals are detestable, or disgusting, for the Israelites to eat. You may also need to use the word **clean** to talk about what foods the Israelites could eat. In this passage, these words do not refer to physical cleanliness. When an Israelite person eats clean food, the person stays ritually clean. But if an Israelite person eats dirty food, then the Israelite person becomes ritually dirty. You may either use a word for detestable, or disgusting, or you may use words for ritually dirty in this passage. If you use the words for ritually clean and dirty, use the same words or phrases throughout for ritually clean and ritually dirty as you used in previous passages. See the Master Glossary for more information about clean and unclean.

Some translations make it clear that Yahweh really does not want Yahweh's people to eat things that are ritually dirty, and so the translations say that the Israelites must consider the animals without fins and scales to be detestable. This means that Yahweh does not want the Israelites to interact with those animals at all.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate the idea of someone strongly disliking something. Will you use the term for **ritually dirty**, or for **detestable**? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh refers to the seas. Here, the **sea** or **ocean** can refer to any big amount of salt water. The Israelite people could use the rule about fins and scales to determine whether any sea creature was ritually clean or ritually dirty.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of the ocean. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also refers to **streams** and **wadis**. A wadi is a deep valley between hills or mountains that sometimes fills with rainwater. Yahweh was referring to freshwater sources of water. Freshwater sources of water are streams

and rivers that have water that is not saltwater. The Israelite people could also use the rule about fins and scales to decide whether any creature that lived in a river or stream was ritually clean or ritually dirty.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a wadi. Pause this audio here.

Many creatures that live in the water have **fins**. A fin is a thin, flat body part that sticks out from the animal's body and helps the animal move through the water. For example, a fish has different kinds of fins, including a big fin on its back and a tail fin.

Stop here and look at the picture of a fish as a group. Look at the different kinds of fins that the fish has. Pause this audio here.

A **scale** is a small, hard piece that grows on the skin of certain sea creatures. For example, many fish have lots of flat scales. These scales overlap and create a protective layer for the creature.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the pictures of fish scales.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 11:9–12

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (966 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 11:13–19

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 11:13–19 and put it in your hearts.

Leviticus 11:13–19

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:13–19 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:13–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the book of Leviticus, Yahweh was talking to Moses and Aaron and giving the Israelite people many rules about how the Israelite people should live, what the Israelite people should do, and what the Israelite people should not do. In this passage, Yahweh still talks to Moses and Aaron. Yahweh gives instructions to Moses and Aaron to give to the Israelite people.

In this passage, Yahweh tells Moses and Aaron what flying creatures are ritually dirty for the Israelites. Remember, at this time, the Israelite people still live in the wilderness. Many times, the Israelite people have been worried about what the Israelites can eat. But Yahweh always provides food for the Israelites. The Israelite people have just set up the Tent of Meeting, and Yahweh gives instructions for how the Israelite people are supposed to be ritually clean.

What kind of birds does Yahweh say are ritually dirty? Most of these ritually dirty birds are hunters that eat small animals or even old, dead animals. These birds eat the blood too, as the birds eat the raw meat. In Leviticus, Yahweh's rules show how both people and animals near the Israelite people need to be ritually clean. It is probable that the reason Yahweh says these birds are ritually dirty to eat is that these birds eat things that are ritually dirty.

Some of these birds are also water birds, but these birds live near water that might be dirty and eat dirty things out of that water. Similarly, if these birds eat things that make the birds dirty, it seems that this is one of the reasons that Yahweh does not want the Israelite people to eat these birds.

Although sometimes it is difficult to know exactly what birds Yahweh is talking about in this passage, it seems that several of these birds were birds that the Egyptian people honored, worshiped, or considered symbolic. Think of what it is like for the Israelite people. In Egypt, the people saw the way the Egyptians honored these birds. But now Yahweh says these birds are ritually dirty. Maybe this was another way that Yahweh wants Yahweh's people to be different from all the other people groups.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In what ways does Yahweh want us to be different from other people? Pause this audio here.

Because the list of birds is so long, it is likely that this list was a complete list of all the ritually dirty birds. That means that any other bird would be ritually clean. Here is the complete list of birds that Yahweh talks about in this passage: Eagle, vulture, black vulture, red kite, all kinds of black kite, all kinds of raven, horned owl, screech owl, gull, all kinds of hawk, little owl, cormorant, great owl, white owl, desert owl, carrion vulture, storks, all kinds of herons, hoopoe, and bat.

Stop here and look at photos of all these kinds of birds as a group.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:13–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has one scene.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells what flying creatures, mostly birds, are ritually dirty. Remember, Yahweh is telling this list to Moses and Aaron, who will tell the Israelite people what birds are ritually dirty. If the Israelite people eat ritually clean birds, then the people also stay ritually clean. But if an Israelite person eats an unclean or ritually dirty bird, then the Israelite person also becomes ritually dirty.

Note: You may choose to go through step five before this step. In step five, you will discuss the names for the different kinds of birds.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- And the Israelite people

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The background information is that Yahweh gave eating rules to Moses and Aaron. Yahweh also told Moses and Aaron to tell the Israelite people the eating rules. This passage does not mention Yahweh, Moses, or Aaron by name, but remember that Yahweh, Moses, and Aaron are having this conversation.

You can act out this passage in different ways. You might choose to have people represent Yahweh, Moses, and Aaron. The person who is representing Yahweh can tell Moses and Aaron which birds are ritually dirty. If you do it this way, you might want to use the pictures from step five to show the ritually dirty birds while you talk.

If you want, you might decide to act out Moses and Aaron retelling Yahweh's words to the people of Israel.

Another way to act out this passage would be to imagine situations where an Israelite person sees a flying creature, either while hunting or maybe in a market. You can show the person trying to decide whether or not to eat the flying creature. Maybe show how people from another people group offer ritually dirty food to the Israelite people. The Israelite people must tell the other people why the Israelites cannot eat the food. Please remember, Yahweh does not mention other people groups in the passage, but it may be helpful to imagine what the scene is like.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will act out this passage. Pause this audio here.

Remember, the Israelite people have been wandering in the wilderness. There have been times when the Israelites were worried about having enough food. But Yahweh always gave the Israelites food to eat. The birds in this passage are birds that the Israelite people would see in the wilderness.

In scene one, Yahweh talks about all the different birds that are ritually dirty. Yahweh again uses a strong word to talk about these birds. Yahweh says that these birds are detestable, or disgusting, to the Israelites. Most of these birds are "birds of prey." This means that these are hunting birds that kill and eat other animals. Most of the birds in the list also look for already dead animals and eat the rotten animal meat. Other birds on the list are birds that live near dirty water. These birds also eat many things that are not clean. This is the list of flying creatures in the passage: eagle, vulture, black vulture, red kite, black kite, raven, horned owl, screech owl, gull, hawk, little owl, cormorant, great owl, white owl, desert owl, carrion vulture, storks, herons, hoopoe, and bat. The birds in this list that are birds of prey are: eagle, vulture, black vulture, red kite, black kite, horned owl, screech owl, hawk, little owl, great owl, white owl, desert owl, and carrion vulture. The birds in this list that are water birds are: cormorant, storks, and herons. The raven is also a scavenger bird that eats dead meat that the raven finds. The reason Yahweh includes the hoopoe and the bat in this list is less clear, but it is probably because the hoopoe and the bat ate ritually dirty animals too. If you do not have names for all these kinds of birds, you may want to put the birds in groups based on the kind of bird or based on what the birds do. For example, you could say, "many different kinds of owls" or "birds that eat other animals."

Stop here and look at photos of all these kinds of birds as a group as needed. Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 11:13–19

Stop here and discuss as a group the most natural way to group these birds in your language. Pause this audio here.

You may need to use words from other languages for some of the birds' names. If your language has words for birds that eat old, dead animals, you might want to explain what kind of birds these are in a general way. For example, "any kind of bird that ate animals or old dead animals."

Stop here and discuss as a group the most natural way to translate the names of the birds and how you will describe the birds. Pause this audio here.

In step five, you will hear more about each kind of bird. Sometimes we do not know exactly what kinds of birds Yahweh talks about in the passage. Some of these birds refer to groups of birds. Yahweh says, "any kind of black kite… any kind of raven… any kind of hawk… any kind of heron." That means that the Israelite people knew about different kinds of birds that the Israelites called black kites, and all of those birds were ritually dirty. This is true for all four kinds of birds Yahweh mentions: black kites, ravens, hawks, and herons.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your language, how do you refer to groups of birds that are similar or have the same name? Pause this audio here.

The pictures should give you some idea of what these birds looked like. Ancient people highly praised or valued many of these birds. Egyptians used several of these birds to worship the Egyptian gods and for symbolism in Egyptian art and language.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language and culture, are there any birds that have special meaning? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:13–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has one scene.

Note: You may choose to go through step five before this script. In step five, you will discuss the names for the different kinds of birds.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- And the Israelite people

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Leviticus 11:13–19

Yahweh is talking to Moses and Aaron. Yahweh is giving Moses and Aaron rules about what food the Israelite people can eat and cannot eat. If an Israelite person eats an unclean or ritually dirty animal, then the Israelite person also becomes ritually dirty. In this passage, Yahweh says which flying creatures are detestable, or ritually dirty. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Moses and Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- What if we do not have enough food? or
- I am thankful that Yahweh gives us good food to eat; or
- Yahweh is really different from the Egyptian gods.

Continue the drama. If you want, you can act out Moses and Aaron telling Yahweh's words to the people of Israel. In that case, you may want to include this.

Ask the people playing the Israelite people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- Why is Yahweh giving us so many rules? or
- I wonder why Yahweh says we cannot eat those birds.

Continue the drama. You may want to include some people who are not Israelites. These people are not in the passage. These people could be Egyptian people, Midian people, or other people. Maybe a person tries to sell flying creatures or their meat to the Israelite people. But you can ask these other people what they think of the Israelite people's food rules. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the other people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- In Egypt, we like these birds; or
- I am curious why the Israelite people have these rules.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:13–19 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, the storyteller uses the word **unclean** or **ritually dirty** to talk about what foods the Israelite people should not eat. In this passage, these words do not refer to physical dirtiness. When an Israelite person eats clean food, the Israelite stays ritually clean. But if an Israelite person eats dirty food, then the Israelite person becomes ritually dirty. Use the same word or phrase throughout for ritually dirty as you used in previous passages. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about **clean** and unclean.

If you also use a stronger word for ritually dirty, like **detestable**, use the same word here as you used in previous passages.

Eagles are large, powerful birds. An eagle has a strong beak and sharp claws for hunting. This kind of bird flies high in the sky and can see very well. Eagles hunt and eat many kinds of animals. The Israelite people knew about eagles that had light brown feathers. This kind of eagle lives in mountains and dry areas.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of an eagle. Pause this audio here.

Vultures are large birds with long necks. Most vultures have no feathers on their heads. Vultures find and eat animals that are already dead. This passage mentions three kinds of vultures: vultures, black vultures, and carrion vultures.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the three pictures of vultures. Pause this audio here.

Kites are birds with long wings and thin bodies. Kites have strong, curved beaks and sharp claws that are good for hunting. Kites fly very carefully and glide smoothly in the sky. Kites also eat small animals and sometimes eat dead animals that the kites find.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the two pictures of kites. Pause this audio here.

The kind of **raven** in this passage has shiny black feathers and a short tail. Ravens can live in hot, dry places and rocky areas. Ravens can eat fruits, berries, and seeds, as well as dead animals that the ravens find.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the picture of a raven. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh mentions many kinds of owls. Yahweh mentions the horned owl, the screech owl, the little owl, the great owl, the white owl, and the desert owl. Owls sleep during the day and hunt at night. Owls have round faces and large eyes. Owls can fly very quietly, without making any noise. Owls catch and eat small animals.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of owls. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the different kinds of **owls**. Pause this audio here.

Gulls are birds that live near the ocean and sometimes other water sources. Gulls have pointed wings and can fly over the water for a long time. Gulls are good at catching fish and finding dead things to eat.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of gulls. Pause this audio here.

Hawks are another kind of bird that have sharp claws and sharp beaks. Hawks can also see very well and hunt for small animals. It is possible that hawks referred to different kinds of birds that ancient people used to help people hunt animals.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of a shikra, which is one type of hawk. Pause this audio here.

Cormorants are a kind of bird that also lives by the ocean. Cormorants have shiny black feathers and large beaks that help the cormorants catch fish.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of a cormorant. Pause this audio here.

Storks are very tall birds with long legs and a long neck. Storks have long beaks. Storks like to walk through water and look for fish, insects, and frogs to eat.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of a stork. Pause this audio here.

Herons are tall birds with long legs and long beaks. Herons can fly slowly. Herons like to walk and stand in water and look for fish, insects, and frogs to eat. Herons like to live near water.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of a heron. Pause this audio here.

Hoopoes are small birds that have fancy orange feathers with black spots on their head. Hoopoes also have stripes of white and black feathers on the hoopoes' wings. Hoopoes like to live near the ground and eat insects.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of a hoopoe. Pause this audio here.

Bats are small animals with very large, thin ears. Bats hunt at nighttime and use their big ears to help the bats find insects to eat. Bats have wings and can fly like birds, but bats have fur or hair on their bodies. Bats do not have feathers like birds.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of a bat. Pause this audio here.

Now that you have looked at all the flying creatures, stop here and discuss as a group: Which birds are similar to birds that would be familiar to your people? What birds would be unfamiliar? Discuss how you would order these birds in a list.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 11:13–19

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (994 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (6.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 11:20–23

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 11:20–23 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:20–23 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:20–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the book of Leviticus, Yahweh was talking to Moses and Aaron and giving the Israelite people many rules about how the Israelites should live, what the Israelites should do, and what the Israelites should not do. In this passage, Yahweh still talks to Moses and Aaron. Yahweh gives instructions to Moses and Aaron to give to the Israelite people.

In this passage, Yahweh tells Moses and Aaron what insects are ritually clean for the Israelites. Remember, at this time, the Israelite people still live in the wilderness. Many times, the Israelite people have been worried

about what the Israelites can eat. But Yahweh always provides food for the Israelites. The Israelite people had recently set up the Tent of Meeting, and now Yahweh gives instructions for how the Israelite people are supposed to be and stay ritually clean.

First, Yahweh says that almost all insects are unclean or ritually dirty. Then Yahweh explains that a few insects are ritually clean. This is the rule for what insects are good to eat: the insect has to be a flying insect that jumps. Yahweh also gives the names of the insects that are ritually clean: the locust, the destroying locust, the cricket, and the grasshopper. The Israelites were probably familiar with several kinds of locust, and the grasshopper was probably also a type of locust.

Stop here and look at the pictures of the locusts and crickets as a group. Pause this audio here.

In that time, it was common for people to eat locusts. People might cook the locusts over a fire or cook the locusts in water. The people may even preserve and dry the locusts in salt. We do not know exactly why Yahweh allowed the Israelite people to eat these insects, but not other insects. Is it because Yahweh wanted to protect the Israelite people from eating an insect that could hurt someone? Maybe. Is it because Yahweh wanted to see if the Israelite people would listen to and obey Yahweh? Maybe. Sometimes Yahweh commands something, and Yahweh's people must listen and obey, even when the people do not know the reason why Yahweh says to do it.

Stop here and discuss: Sometimes, we do not know why Yahweh asks us to do something. Do you listen to Yahweh even when you do not understand Yahweh's rules? What makes it easy to listen? What makes it hard to listen?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:20–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has one scene.

In the first scene: Yahweh explains what insects are ritually clean. Remember, Yahweh is telling this list to Moses and Aaron, who will tell the Israelite people what insects are ritually clean. If the Israelite people eat ritually clean insects, then the people also stay ritually clean. But if an Israelite person eats an unclean or ritually dirty insect, then the Israelite person also becomes ritually dirty.

Note: You may choose to go through step five before this step. In step five, you will discuss the names for the different kinds of locusts.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- And the Israelite people

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The background information is that Yahweh gave eating rules to Moses and Aaron to tell to the Israelite people. This passage does not mention Yahweh, Moses, or Aaron by name, but remember that Yahweh, Moses, and Aaron are having this conversation.

You can act out this passage in different ways. You might choose to have people represent Yahweh, Moses, and Aaron. The person who is representing Yahweh can tell Moses and Aaron which insects are ritually clean. If you do it this way, you might want to use the pictures from step five to show the ritually clean insects while you talk.

If you want, you might decide to act out Moses and Aaron retelling Yahweh's words to the people of Israel.

Another way to act out this passage would be to imagine situations where an Israelite person sees an insect, either while hunting or while traveling. You can show the Israelite person trying to decide whether or not to eat the insect. Maybe show how people from another people group offer ritually dirty food with dirty insects to the

Israelite people. The Israelite people must tell the other people why the Israelites cannot eat the food. Please remember, the storyteller does not mention other people groups in the passage, but it may be helpful to imagine what the scene is like.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will act out this passage. Pause audio here.

The Israelite people have been wandering in the wilderness. There have been times when the Israelites were worried about having enough food. But Yahweh always gave the Israelites food to eat. The insects in this passage are insects that the Israelite people might see in the wilderness.

In Leviticus 11:10, Yahweh talked about "swarming things" to mean animals in the water that live and travel in a big group.

In this passage, Yahweh uses the same term "swarming and flying creatures" as Yahweh used in Leviticus 11:10, but this time Yahweh is referring to a certain kind of insect. In some languages, creatures that travel in such groups have names that only refer to the whole group, rather than to the individual creatures.

Stop here and, as a group, watch the video of swarming locusts. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Does your language have any special words for any animal that lives and travels in big groups? Does your language have any special words for insects that live and travel like this? Pause audio here.

In scene one, Yahweh tells Moses and Aaron that almost all insects are ritually dirty. Yahweh again uses a strong word to talk about these insects. Yahweh says that these insects are detestable, or disgusting, to the Israelites.

Then Yahweh talks about the few insects that are ritually clean. This is the rule for what insects are good to eat: the insect has to be a flying and swarming insect. Yahweh says that these insects must jump on four legs. But all the insects in this passage have six legs. Yahweh probably chose this language to show that Yahweh was no longer talking about flying creatures with two legs, like birds or bats. If this is confusing, you may want to translate with a phrase such as "insects with legs and wings" or "insects with sets of legs."

Stop here and discuss the best way to translate this in your language. Pause audio here.

Yahweh is talking about which insects are ritually clean. Although Yahweh gives the general rule, Yahweh does clarify the specific insects that the Israelite people may eat: the locust, the destroying locust, the cricket, and the grasshopper.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Is it common for people to eat bugs in your culture? Pause audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:20–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has one scene.

Note: You may choose to go through step five before this script. In script five, you can see some pictures of different kinds of locust.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- And the Israelite people

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

Leviticus 11:20–23

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Yahweh is talking to Moses and Aaron. Yahweh is giving Moses and Aaron rules about what food the Israelite people can eat and cannot eat. If an Israelite person eats an unclean or ritually dirty creature, then the Israelite person also becomes ritually dirty. In this passage, Yahweh says which insects are ritually clean: the locust, the destroying locust, the cricket, and the grasshopper. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing Moses and Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- At least there are lots of locusts for us to eat; or
- I am overwhelmed by all these rules; or
- I hope the Israelite people will listen to Yahweh.

Continue the drama. If you want, you can act out Moses and Aaron telling Yahweh's words to the people of Israel. In that case, you may want to include this:

Ask the people playing the Israelite people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I am happy that I can still eat locusts because I like to eat locusts; or
- I am worried I will not remember all these rules.

Continue the drama. You may want to include some people who are not Israelites. These people are not in the passage. These people could be Egyptian people, Midian people, or other people. Maybe a person tries to sell insects or offer food with ritually dirty insects to the Israelite people. You can ask these people what they think of the Israelite people's food rules. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the other people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I think that is a good rule; or
- What if the Israelites accidentally eat one of the insects that the Israelites' God said not to eat?

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:20–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, the storyteller uses the word **unclean** or **ritually dirty** to talk about what foods the Israelite people should not eat. You may also need to use the word **clean** to talk about what foods the Israelites could eat. In this passage, these words do not refer to physical cleanliness. When an Israelite person eats clean food, the person stays ritually clean. But if an Israelite person eats dirty food, then the Israelite person becomes ritually dirty. Then the Israelite person needs to go through a cleansing process to become ritually clean again. Use the same words or phrases throughout for ritually clean and ritually dirty as you used in previous passages. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about clean and unclean.

If you also use a stronger word for ritually dirty, like **detestable**, use the same word here as you used in previous passages.

In this passage, Yahweh gives rules about creatures that fly in big groups and have lots of legs. We call this kind of creature "insects." The rule says insects are ritually dirty, except for a few kinds of hopping insects.

The four kinds of insects in this text are the **locust**, the **destroying locust**, the **cricket**, and the **grasshopper**. These insects have strong back legs, which the insects use for jumping. We do not know exactly which name goes with which insect. But here are some pictures of different kinds of locust that would be familiar to the Israelite people. These pictures will show you what kind of insects were ritually clean and good to eat:

Stop here and look at the pictures of kinds of locust as a group. Discuss what you will call each type of insect.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 11:20–23

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (992 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 11:24–28

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 11:24–28 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:24–28 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 11:24–28

3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:24–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the book of Leviticus, Yahweh was talking to Moses and Aaron and giving the Israelite people many rules about how the Israelites should live, what the Israelites should do, and what the Israelites should not do. In this passage, Yahweh still talks to Moses and Aaron. Yahweh gives instructions to Moses and Aaron to give to the Israelite people. Remember, at this time, the Israelite people still live in the wilderness. The Israelite people have recently set up the Tent of Meeting, and Yahweh gives instructions for how the Israelite people are supposed to be, and stay, ritually clean.

In Leviticus 11, Yahweh has been giving rules about which animals are ritually clean and which animals are ritually dirty. The Israelite people could eat the ritually clean animals. But the Israelite people became ritually dirty if the Israelites ate or even touched the dead body of a ritually dirty animal. In the first part of this passage, Yahweh emphasizes that the Israelites could not touch the body of a ritually dirty animal. Some scholars believe that this rule is referring back to the last passage, which spoke about which insects were ritually clean and which insects were ritually dirty. Other scholars believe that this statement is for this passage, which talks about three kinds of ritually dirty animals. Either way, Leviticus 11 clearly states that the Israelite people are not supposed to touch or carry the dead body of any kind of the ritually dirty animals. If an Israelite person does become ritually dirty by touching one of these animals, that person needs to wash their clothes and will be ritually dirty until sunset. That means that the person cannot participate in any form of worship to Yahweh until the day is over.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Do you think verses 24 and 25 go with the last passage or with this passage? Pause this audio here.

The next part of the passage repeats three kinds of animals that are ritually dirty: animals that do not have divided hoofs, animals that do not chew the cud, and animals that have paws.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of hoofs that are not divided and animals with paws. Pause this audio here.

The rule is the same for any person who touches the dead body of one of these ritually dirty animals. If an Israelite person becomes ritually dirty in this way, that person must also wash their clothes. This washing was not to clean the person's body. It was a ceremonial washing to ritually clean the person.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What kind of ceremonial washings do people do in your culture? How do you think people in your culture will respond to the idea of ceremonial washings? Pause this audio here.

After the Israelite person ceremonially washed, the person still had to wait until the sun went down before the person was ritually clean again.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:24–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh states a rule here. The rule is that an Israelite person becomes ritually dirty when that person touches the dead body of a ritually dirty animal. The ritually dirty person must wash their clothes. The person remains ritually dirty until the sun sets.

Leviticus 11:24–28

In the second scene: Yahweh mentions three kinds of animals that are ritually dirty: animals that do not have divided hoofs, animals that do not chew the cud, and animals that walk on their paws. The Israelite person who touches a dead body of one of these types of animals becomes ritually dirty. The ritually dirty person must wash their clothes. The person remains ritually dirty until the sun sets.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The people of Israel
- And an Israelite person who is ritually dirty because that person touched a dead animal's body

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that Yahweh is giving this set of rules to Moses and Aaron. Moses and Aaron would then tell these words to the people of Israel. Even though the storyteller does not mention Yahweh, Moses, and Aaron in this passage, Yahweh, Moses and Aaron are the people who are having this conversation.

In the first scene, Yahweh says what happens if an Israelite person touches the dead body of a ritually dirty animal. If an Israelite person touches the dead body of a ritually dirty animal, the Israelite person also becomes ritually dirty. The Israelite person must wash their clothes. But even after that, the Israelite person stays ritually dirty until the sun sets.

An Israelite person could become ritually dirty either because that person touched the dead animal's body or because that person carried the dead animal's body. This refers both to the Israelite person who accidentally touches a ritually dirty dead animal and also to the Israelite person who purposefully touches a ritually dirty dead animal. In both situations, the Israelite person would be ritually dirty for the rest of the day.

Stop here and discuss: In your own language, describe a time when you accidentally touched something that you should not have touched. Pay attention to the words that you use. Pause the audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh mentions three kinds of animals that are ritually dirty, all of which Yahweh has mentioned before. First, Yahweh mentions animals that do not have divided hoofs. Then Yahweh mentions animals that do not chew the cud. Notice that in this passage, this refers to two separate groups of animals. Yahweh is referring to the animals that have one quality but not the other quality required to be a ritually clean kind of animal. An animal needs to both have divided hoofs and chew the cud in order to be ritually clean. If an Israelite person touches the dead body of either kind of ritually dirty animal, that person also becomes ritually dirty. Lastly, Yahweh says that animals that walk on four feet and have paws are also ritually dirty. This refers to animals like dogs and cats and other animals that have paws.

Stop here and discuss: Does your language have any specific words or phrases for animals that walk or move on their four legs and have paws? Pause the audio here.

Yahweh repeats the same rule as before for these ritually dirty animals. If an Israelite person touches the dead body of one of these animals, that person also must wash their clothes and wait until the sun sets to become ritually clean again.

Stop here and discuss: Think of a riddle, rule, or saying that people repeatedly say in your language. Talk about how to repeat these instructions in a way that makes sense in your own language. Pause the audio here.

The passage ends when it repeats the statement that these animals are ritually dirty.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:24–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

Leviticus 11:24–28

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The people of Israel
- And an Israelite person who is ritually dirty because that person touched a dead animal's body

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In scene one, Yahweh states a rule. The rule is that an Israelite person becomes ritually unclean if that person touches the dead body of a ritually dirty animal. The Israelite person who touches the dead body becomes ritually dirty. The ritually dirty person must wash their clothes. The person remains ritually dirty until the sun sets. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the ritually dirty Israelite person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I wish I had not touched the dead body of the animal; or
- I am worried about what other people will think of me; or
- I am glad that I will be ritually clean soon.

Continue the drama. In scene two, Yahweh mentions three kinds of animals that are ritually dirty: animals that do not have divided hoofs, animals that do not chew the cud, and animals that walk on their paws. The Israelite person who touches a dead body of one of these types of animals becomes ritually dirty. The ritually dirty person must wash their clothes. The person remains ritually dirty until the sun sets. This person cannot join in any worship or ceremony while the person is ritually dirty. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the ritually dirty Israelite person who could not go to worship, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that I do not get to go to worship Yahweh; or
- This is to protect me. If I try to come close to Yahweh right now, I might die. The rule is good; or
- I do not want people to know that I am ritually dirty.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:24–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh uses the word **unclean** or **ritually dirty** to talk about the animals the Israelites should not eat as food or touch if those animals have died. In this passage, these words do not refer to physical cleanliness. If an Israelite person picks up the dead body of an unclean animal, then the Israelite person becomes ritually dirty. Then the Israelite person needs to go through a cleansing process to become ritually clean again. Use the same word or phrase for dead bodies of animals that you have used previously. Use the same word or phrase throughout for ritually clean and ritually dirty as you used in previous passages. For more information about clean and unclean, refer to the Master Glossary.

The Israelite people were only supposed to eat animals with divided hoofs that also chew the cud.

An animal with **divided hoofs** has special feet or hoofs that split into two separate toes. Like human toes, these animals' toes can move a little bit to help the animals as the animals walk over hills and mountains. Use the same word or phrase for divided hoofs as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of divided hoofs. Pause this audio here.

Some animals that eat lots of grass and plants, like cattle, sheep, and goats, have a special eating process. These animals chew their food in their mouths for a very long time. Then these animals swallow the food in their mouths. But later, the animals burp the food back into their mouths and chew on the food again. People who work with these animals call this process "**chewing the cud**." Use the same word or phrase for "chew the cud" as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a video of an animal as it chews the cud. Pause this audio here.

The Israelite people were not supposed to eat or pick up the dead bodies of animals that have four legs and walk on **paws**. Paws are the rough spots on the bottom of furry animals' feet that help the animals walk and balance.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of an animal paw.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 11:24–28

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (743 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.0 MB)

Leviticus 11:29–38

Leviticus 11:29–38

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 11:29–38 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:29–38 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:29–38 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the book of Leviticus, Yahweh has been talking to Moses and Aaron and giving the Israelite people many rules about how the Israelites should live, what the Israelites should do, and what the Israelites should not do. In this passage, Yahweh still talks to Moses and Aaron. Yahweh gives instructions to Moses and Aaron to give to the Israelite people. Remember, at this time, the Israelite people still live in the wilderness. The Israelite people have recently set up the Tent of Meeting, and Yahweh gives instructions for how the Israelite people are supposed to be and stay ritually clean.

In Leviticus 11, Yahweh has been talking about different kinds of animals and whether those animals are ritually clean or ritually dirty. First, Yahweh talked about “cattle” or land animals, then water creatures, then birds, then insects. Now, in this passage, Yahweh explains what crawling animals are ritually dirty. We do not know exactly why Yahweh made a separate category for these animals, but it might be because these were animals that often came into the Israelite people’s tents and homes. Because of this, people would have more questions about how these animals made other things dirty. These animals would likely climb into things and touch many things in the house because it was hard to catch these animals. From this passage, we learn that the ritually dirty animal does not seem to make anyone or anything dirty while it is alive. However, once the ritually dirty animal dies, the animal’s body makes everything the body touches ritually dirty.

First, Yahweh gives the list of ritually dirty crawling creatures: mole, mouse, great lizard, gecko, monitor lizard, wall lizard, skink, and chameleon.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the pictures of these creatures. Pause this audio here.

All of these animals stay close to the ground, and many of these animals live in the ground too. Many of these animals are also great climbers, and some can even climb walls. The list of animals is primarily of lizards and lizard-like animals, although there are also small mammals on the list, too. In step five, we will discuss more about what these animals might actually look like. But the importance of these animals seems to be that the animals can all climb or dig into the Israelite people’s tents and homes. These animals are another category of swarming creatures, [like the insects that Yahweh talked about previously.]{.mark} [These animals, like the swarming insects, move chaotically. These animals do not move in straight lines. These animals also climb into both dirty places and clean places.]{.mark} Again, even though these animals are ritually dirty, these animals do not defile a person if the animal is alive. However, once the animal dies, any person who touches the dead body becomes ritually dirty. However, the person is only ritually dirty until the sun goes down and it is evening time.

Then Yahweh talks about what to do in four situations when one of these ritually dirty animals touches something and dies. First, if one of these animals dies and touches something, an item like a tool, bag, or clothing, then a person could clean the item if the item is wood, cloth, animal hide, or sackcloth. When an Israelite person finds a dirty item, the person must put the item in water. Then, at sunset, the item becomes clean again.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people believe about sunset and nighttime? Why do you think these objects became clean again at sunset? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh talks about the second situation. In this case, the crawling creature dies and touches a cooking pot, a water pot, or another kind of cooking space like an oven. People made these cooking vessels out of clay, which is mud that the sun hardens or that people cook to make hard. Clay pots have a texture that absorbs whatever the clay pot touches. This is probably the reason why the Israelite people must break and destroy these pots when the pots are ritually dirty.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you think of the difference between how the Israelite people should treat ritually dirty clay pots compared to items that people made from other materials? [Why do you think Yahweh made this rule? What kinds of rules do you have, like this, in which the type of material of the vessel matters?]{.mark} Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh talks about the third situation. The crawling creature dies in a cistern, well, or another source of water. In this situation, the crawling creature does not make the water source ritually dirty. However, if someone picks the dead animal's body out of the water and touches the body, then that person is ritually dirty until evening.

In the last situation, the crawling creature dies while touching the plant seeds for the Israelite's fields. If the crawling creature dies and touches the seeds when the Israelites are saving the seeds, the seeds are still ritually clean, and a person can still plant the seeds. But if the crawling creature dies when the seeds are wet, and people are planting the seeds, then the seeds become ritually dirty.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:29–38 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh explains what crawling animals are ritually dirty. Remember, Yahweh is telling this list to Moses and Aaron, who will tell the Israelite people what crawling animals are ritually dirty. If an Israelite person eats or touches the dead body of an unclean or ritually dirty crawling animal, then the Israelite person also becomes ritually dirty.

In the second scene: Yahweh describes four situations. In the first situation, one of the ritually dirty animals falls onto a tool or onto clothes that people made from wood, cloth, animal hide, or sackcloth.

In the third scene: Yahweh gives instructions for the second situation, which describes what to do if one of the ritually dirty animals falls into a cooking pot or other clay pots.

In the fourth scene: Yahweh gives instructions for what the people should do if one of the ritually dirty animals falls into a water source.

In the fifth scene: Yahweh gives instructions for what the people should do if one of the ritually dirty animals falls on plant seeds.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- And the Israelite people

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The background information is that Yahweh gave eating rules to Moses and Aaron. Yahweh also told Moses and Aaron to tell the Israelite people the eating rules. This passage does not mention Yahweh, Moses, or Aaron by name, but remember that Yahweh, Moses, and Aaron are the people who are having the conversation.

Leviticus 11:29–38

You can act out this passage in different ways. You might choose to have people represent Yahweh, Moses, and Aaron. The person who is representing Yahweh can tell Moses and Aaron which crawling animals are ritually dirty. If you do it this way, you might want to use the pictures from script five to show the ritually dirty crawling animals while you talk.

If you want, you might decide to act out Moses and Aaron retelling Yahweh's words to the people of Israel.

For scenes two through five, act out the situations where one of the ritually dirty crawling animals falls on something. Have an Israelite person follow the instructions for what to do in each situation.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will act out this passage. Pause this audio here.

The Israelite people have been wandering in the wilderness. There have been times when the Israelis have been worried about having enough food. But Yahweh always gave the Israelites food to eat. The crawling animals in this passage are ones that the Israelite people might see in the wilderness.

In Leviticus 11:10, swarming things refer to animals in the water that live and travel in big groups. In Leviticus 11:20, swarming things refer to insects that fly. In this passage, the same word refers to creeping animals or animals that crawl along the ground.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your language, how do you describe animals that crawl on the ground? Pause this audio here.

In the first scene, Yahweh talks about the ritually dirty crawling animals: mole, mouse, great lizard, gecko, monitor lizard, wall lizard, skink, and chameleon. Even touching the dead body of one of these animals makes an Israelite person ritually dirty until evening.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the pictures of these creatures. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh mentions that "any kind" of great lizard is ritually dirty. The Israelite people probably knew several different kinds of lizards that fit into this category. The picture of the great lizard in step five gives just one example of the kind of lizard that the Israelite people might recognize.

In scene two, Yahweh describes the first situation. Most of the ritually dirty crawling creatures are creatures that the Israelite people might find inside the Israelites' tents or homes. Many of these animals can climb up walls. What happens if one of these ritually dirty animals dies and falls on something like a tool or a kind of cloth? Yahweh mentions things that people make out of four kinds of materials: wooden things, such as tools and bowls; cloth fabrics, such as wool, linen, or cotton; leather things that a person made out of animal hide; and sackcloth, which people made from coarse material such as goat or camel hair. If this happens, an Israelite person must put the item in water. The item would be ritually dirty during the day, but when the sun goes down, the item becomes clean again.

In scene three, Yahweh describes the second situation. What happens if the ritually dirty crawling animal falls into a cooking vessel or a water jug? Any clay pot for food or drink becomes ritually dirty, and people must break that clay pot into pieces. The Israelite people also must be careful that water from that clay pot does not get into any of the Israelites' other food.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, what are some common rules to keep your food safe and clean? What makes food "dirty"? Pause the audio here.

In scene four, Yahweh describes the third situation. What happens if the ritually dirty crawling animal dies and falls into a water cistern or water source? The water source remains clean, but if an Israelite person touches the dead animal's body, then that person is ritually dirty.

Stop here and look at a picture of a cistern. Pause the audio here.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, how do people collect water and save it for later? Pause the audio here.

In scene five, Yahweh describes the fourth situation. What happens if a ritually dirty animal dies and falls onto plant seeds that the Israelite people are storing somewhere? The seeds remain clean, and a person can plant the seeds. But what if the animal falls on seeds that are wet and ready to grow? Those seeds are ritually dirty.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:29–38 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- And the Israelite people

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh gives the list of ritually dirty crawling animals: mole, mouse, great lizard, gecko, monitor lizard, wall lizard, skink, and chameleon. Even touching the dead body of one of these animals makes an Israelite person ritually dirty until evening.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the pictures of these creatures. Pause this audio here.

[In scene two, Yahweh describes the first situation. One of these ritually dirty animals could die and fall on an item. If people made that item out of wood, cloth, animal skin, or sackcloth, that item becomes ritually dirty, too. The Israelites must put that item in water.]{.mark} The item would be ritually dirty during the day, but when the sun goes down, the item becomes clean again. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am frustrated that I cannot use my tool; or
- Why do I need to put the item in water?

Continue the drama. In scene three, Yahweh gives the second situation. What happens if the ritually dirty crawling animal falls into a cooking vessel or a water jug? Any clay pot for food or drink becomes ritually dirty, and a person must break the clay pot into pieces. The Israelite people also must be careful that water from that clay pot does not get into any of the Israelites' other food. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- At least I can have my tool tomorrow, but why do I need to break the clay pot? or
- I am sad to lose my cooking pot; or
- I am thankful that Yahweh wants us to have clean food; or
- Even the water from the pot can make our food not clean.

Continue the drama. In scene four, Yahweh gives the third situation. What happens if the ritually dirty crawling animal dies and falls into a water cistern or water source? The water source remains clean, but if an Israelite person touches the dead animal's body, then that person is ritually dirty. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am relieved that our water sources stay clean; or

- I am sad to lose my cooking pot; or
- I am thankful that Yahweh wants us to have clean food.

Continue the drama. In scene five, Yahweh gives the fourth situation. What happens if a ritually dirty animal dies and falls onto plant seeds that the Israelite people are storing somewhere? The seeds remain clean, and a person can still plant the seeds. But what if the animal falls on seeds that are wet and ready to grow? Those seeds are ritually dirty. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am relieved that our seeds stay clean while we store the seeds; or
- We could never keep such animals out of the store bins; or
- I hope this does not happen because it would be a waste to lose seeds this way.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:29–38 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh uses the word **unclean** or **ritually dirty** to talk about what animals the Israelite people should not touch. You may also need to use the word **clean** to talk about what things were ritually clean. In this passage, these words do not refer to physical cleanliness. An Israelite person who was ritually clean was able to participate in religious ceremonies and worship. An Israelite person who was ritually dirty, often from touching or eating something that was ritually dirty, had to go through a cleansing process to become ritually clean again. Use the same words or phrases throughout for ritually clean and ritually dirty as you used in previous passages.

A mole is a round, hairy animal that lives underground. A mole has big paws that help the mole dig underground. A mole has very small eyes and does not see well. This kind of mole weighs between 20 and 70 grams.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a mole. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **mole**. Pause this audio here.

A mouse is a rodent with fur that is usually brown or gray. A mouse has big ears and big eyes. A mouse has a long tail that does not have any fur. This kind of mouse is about 10 centimeters long and usually weighs between 40 and 85 grams.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a mouse. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **mouse**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

A great lizard is a large reptile that lives in deserts. A lizard can be light brown or a darker brown. A great lizard has tough, dry scales that cover its body. A great lizard has a flat body and a large tail with scaly horns on the tail. A lizard eats plants. A lizard is usually about 75 centimeters long and can weigh up to one kilogram.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a spiny-tailed lizard, which is a type of great lizard. Pause this audio here.

There are several kinds of lizards in this passage. You will need to decide as a group what you want to call these lizards in your language or whether to refer to the lizards as a group.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **lizard**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

A gecko is a kind of small lizard that makes sounds that might sound like sighs, chirps, or clicks. A gecko has smooth skin and very big eyes that help the gecko see at night. A gecko's toes are sticky, which allows the gecko to crawl on walls and trees. This kind of gecko is usually 11 or 12 centimeters long.

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a gecko. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **gecko**. Pause this audio here.

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A monitor lizard has a long body and strong legs, which the monitor lizard uses to dig and climb. This type of monitor lizard is light brown with dark brown stripes. A monitor lizard has a long tongue that the lizard sticks out of its mouth. This helps the monitor lizard look for food. In Hebrew, people called this lizard the “strong lizard.”

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of a monitor lizard. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **monitor lizard**. Pause this audio here.

A wall lizard, which people also call an agama, is a kind of lizard. An Agama’s body has scales, with pointed scales on its back and down its tail. Agamas are very good at climbing. Agamas can grow up to 30 centimeters long and weigh 20 grams, 50 grams, or sometimes even 70 grams! In Hebrew, people call this animal the “wandering lizard.”

Stop here and, as a group, look at a picture of an agama lizard. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **wall lizard** or **agama**. Pause this audio here.

A skink is a kind of lizard that has a long body that is round and thin. A skink has a thick neck, so it is hard to see where the head ends and the body begins. The kind of skink that lives in this area has a special way of traveling through the sand gracefully.

Stop here and look at a picture of a skink as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **skink**. Pause this audio here.

A chameleon is a reptile with very large eyes. A chameleon has a large bump on its head. A chameleon has a large body and small, skinny legs that help the chameleon climb. A chameleon is often green or brown but has the ability to change its color. In Hebrew, people call this animal the “low to the ground” lizard.

Stop here and look at a picture of a chameleon as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **chameleon**. Pause this audio here.

If anyone touches the **dead body** of one of these animals, that person will be unclean until the sun sets. Use the same word or phrase for “dead body” as you have used previously.

Yahweh talks about items that people made out of different kinds of material. A hide is the skin of an animal that a person has cleaned and stretched into leather. The Israelite people would make cloth from plants such as cotton or flax, or out of sheep’s hair, which people call wool. But the Israelites would make sackcloth from goat hair or camel hair. Sackcloth was scratchy and uncomfortable. Ancient Israelites often wore sackcloth when the Israelites were grieving. Sackcloth was also a symbol of extreme poverty or hardship.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **sackcloth**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

A spring was a place in the ground where fresh water would naturally come up to the surface, and people could collect the water to drink.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for a **spring** of water. Pause this audio here.

A cistern was a large underground cave or well that ancient people used to collect rainwater. Because the rain comes quickly and in large amounts in the desert, it is important that extra water has a place to go. The cisterns would collect that water so that people could use the water when there was not much rain.

Stop here and look at a picture of a cistern as a group. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **cistern**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

If the dead body of an animal falls on seeds that someone will plant in their fields, the seeds remain ritually clean. But if there is water on the seeds, the seeds become ritually dirty.

Stop here and decide as a group what word or phrase you will use for **seeds**. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about seeds, and use the same word for seeds that you have used in previous books of the Bible.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 11:29–38

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (850 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (6.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 11:39–47

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 11:39–47 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:39–47 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:39–47 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Leviticus 11:39–47

Pause this audio here.

In Leviticus 11, Yahweh has been giving Moses and Aaron rules about what animals the Israelite people should consider ritually clean and what animals the Israelite people should consider ritually dirty. Yahweh tells Moses and Aaron to tell these rules to the Israelite people so that the Israelites can be ritually clean and be close to Yahweh. Ritually clean animals are animals that the Israelite people can eat and stay ritually clean. But if an Israelite person eats or touches the dead body of a ritually dirty animal, that Israelite person will also be ritually dirty.

In the first part of this passage, Yahweh says something that may surprise people. Even the bodies of ritually clean animals that die from old age or because of an accident are ritually dirty. An Israelite person who touches, carries, or eats the dead animal's body becomes ritually dirty too. The person must wash their clothes, and the person must wait until the sun sets. Then the person becomes ritually clean again.

Stop here and discuss: Why do you think that the ritually clean animals also become ritually dirty if the animal dies naturally from sickness, an accident, or old age? Pause the audio here.

Next, Yahweh restates a general rule about what animals are ritually dirty. The rule is this: swarming animals are ritually dirty. In Leviticus 11:10, the swarming creatures refer to certain animals that live in the water, many of which travel in big groups and move in odd ways through the water. In Leviticus 11:20, swarming things refer to insects that fly in large groups. In Leviticus 11:29, swarming things refer to animals that creep and crawl along the ground. Some scholars believe that one reason these animals are ritually dirty is that there is something unnatural or chaotic about how these animals move.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, what kinds of animals do people not like or will not touch? Why do people in your culture not like those animals? Pay attention to what words you use to describe these animals. Pause the audio here.

Why do the Israelite people need to follow these rules about what to eat and not eat? The reason is that Yahweh is holy. Yahweh is pure and good. Yahweh asks the Israelite people to be holy because Yahweh is holy. This means the Israelite people need to live in a way that is clean and good. In this passage, Yahweh talks about ritually clean animals in a different way than Yahweh talks about ritually dirty animals. In the same way, Yahweh talks about the Israelite people, Yahweh's people, in a different way than how Yahweh talks about all the other people groups on the earth. Yahweh wants the Israelite people to live differently from all the other people groups because the Israelite people know Yahweh and what is important to Yahweh. Yahweh also wants the Israelite people to show other people groups what Yahweh is like and to show other people how to worship Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss: What kind of actions can a person do that are important to Yahweh? What do you do differently in your life to show others what is important to Yahweh? Pause the audio here.

These rules, which are about eating animals and remaining ritually clean and not becoming ritually dirty, are supposed to remind the Israelite people of something very important. When the Israelites think of these rules, the Israelite people are supposed to remember Yahweh's love and the blessing of having a special relationship with Yahweh. When the Israelite people were slaves in Egypt, Yahweh brought the Israelites out of slavery and promised to be with the Israelites and to protect the Israelites. Yahweh also gave these rules to the Israelite people to teach the Israelites something about what is important to Yahweh.

As Yahweh finishes this section of Leviticus, Yahweh reminds us of the purpose of all the rules in this section. These rules help the Israelite people know which animals are ritually clean and ritually dirty.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:39–47 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

Leviticus 11:39–47

In the first scene: Yahweh explains that even ritually clean animals become ritually dirty when the clean animals die because the animals are old or because an accident happens. In this situation, an Israelite person who touches the dead animal's body, whether by mistake or intentionally, is ritually dirty. An Israelite person who is ritually dirty in this way must wash their clothes and is ritually dirty until the sun sets.

In the second scene: Yahweh restates what animals are ritually dirty. This is a reminder of all the rules in Leviticus 11. Swarming animals are ritually dirty, whether the animals are land animals, water creatures, insects, or creatures that live in the ground. Yahweh reminds the Israelite people why the Israelites must follow these rules: Yahweh is holy, and the Israelites are to be like Yahweh. Then Yahweh gives a final summary statement. These are the rules to help the Israelite people know which animals are ritually clean and which are ritually dirty.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The people of Israel
- And an Israelite person who is ritually dirty

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that Yahweh is giving this set of rules to Moses and Aaron. Moses and Aaron would then tell these words to the people of Israel. Even though Moses and Aaron's names are not in this passage, Moses and Aaron were the original people Yahweh spoke these words to.

Stop here and discuss: Does your language have special words or phrases that you use when you are telling a person someone else's words? Pause the audio here.

In the first scene, Yahweh explains something that Yahweh had not said yet. Even a ritually clean animal can become ritually dirty, depending on how the animal dies. If a person kills the ritually clean animal in the right way, the animal is ritually clean and good to eat. But if the animal dies, whether from old age or because of an accident, the dead animal's body is ritually dirty. An Israelite person who eats, touches, or carries the dead animal's body becomes ritually dirty too. It does not matter if the Israelite person accidentally touches the dead body or purposefully moves the body. In either case, the Israelite person becomes ritually dirty. Sometimes an Israelite person might need to move the dead body, if, for example, the animal dies while the animal is in a pen with other animals. But the person still becomes ritually dirty. The person must wash their clothes and wait until the sun sets. Then the person becomes ritually clean again.

Stop here and discuss: Do you make a difference in your language between something that a person does on purpose and something that a person does accidentally? Pause the audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh reminds the Israelite people of the main food rule. Swarming animals are detestable, which is a strong way to say that these animals are ritually dirty. That includes swarming creatures in the water, insects, and swarming animals that creep on the ground. This rule also talks about any other "creeping" animals that Yahweh has not yet talked about. Remember that the idea of swarming may mean that these animals move around in a chaotic way. The rule about swarming creatures is a general rule to help the Israelite people remember which animals are ritually clean and which animals are ritually dirty.

Stop here and discuss: What are the different words in your language that you might need to use to explain the idea of "swarming animals"? Pause the audio here.

Why do the Israelite people need to follow these dietary rules? The reason is that Yahweh is holy. Yahweh is pure and whole and good. Yahweh asks the Israelite people to be holy because he, Yahweh, is holy. The Israelite people needed to change their eating habits so that the Israelites could be close to Yahweh. It was another sign to all the people in the world that the Israelite people were Yahweh's special people. This statement, "be holy because Yahweh is holy," is a very important one in Leviticus. You will hear this statement many times in Leviticus.

Leviticus 11:39–47

Stop here and discuss: What are some ways in your language that you might emphasize a very special message? How can you translate "be holy because Yahweh is holy" in a way that people can remember and that shows that it is very important? Pause the audio here.

When the Israelite people were slaves in Egypt, Yahweh brought the Israelites out of slavery and promised to be with the Israelites and to protect the Israelites. Yahweh wants a relationship with the Israelite people that is special. Yahweh shows the Israelites many times that Yahweh is not like the false gods that the Egyptian people worshipped.

The last thing Yahweh says is really just a summary, that the Israelite people should use these rules to know what animals are ritually clean and ritually dirty.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:39–47 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The people of Israel
- And an Israelite person who is ritually dirty

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Remember that Yahweh is the one giving this set of rules to Moses and Aaron. Moses and Aaron would then tell these words to the people of Israel. Even though the storyteller does not mention Moses and Aaron in this passage, Moses and Aaron were the original people Yahweh spoke these words to.

In the first scene, Yahweh explains how a ritually clean animal can become a ritually dirty animal. If people kill the animal the right way, the animal is ritually clean and good to eat. But if the animal dies, whether from old age or because of an accident, the dead animal's body is ritually dirty. An Israelite person who touches, eats from, or carries the dead animal's body becomes ritually dirty too and must wash their clothes and wait until the sun sets to be ritually clean again. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite person who is ritually dirty, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I think it is a waste of meat to not be able to eat it; or
- I am ritually dirty, but I did not even cause my animal to die; or
- I really want to do what Yahweh commands us to do.

Leviticus 11:39–47

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh reminds the Israelite people of some main rules for the food the Israelites may eat. For example, swarming creatures are detestable, or ritually dirty, whether in the water, on land, or in the ground. Why do the Israelite people need to follow these special eating rules? Yahweh is holy, and the Israelites are to be holy like Yahweh is. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want my people to be close to me; or
- I brought my people out of slavery so that my people could live good and clean lives.

Continue the drama. Yahweh explains that Yahweh is the God of the people of Israel. Yahweh freed the Israelites from being slaves in Egypt. Again, Yahweh says to be holy like Yahweh is holy. Then Yahweh reminds the Israelites that the Israelite people should use these rules to know what animals are ritually clean and ritually dirty. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Israelite people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I am thankful that Yahweh chose us; or
- When people make rules, the rules can be difficult. But Yahweh's rules are for our good; or
- I am happy that we get to eat good things.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 11:39–47 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh uses the word **unclean** or **dirty** to talk about what dead animals the Israelite people should not touch. In this passage, these words do not refer to physical dirtiness. If an Israelite person touches the dead body of a ritually dirty animal, then the Israelite person becomes ritually dirty. Then the Israelite person needs to go through a cleansing process to become ritually clean again. Use the same words or phrases throughout for bodies of dead animals, and ritually clean and ritually dirty, as you used in previous passages, and refer to the Master Glossary for more information about clean and unclean. If you use a word that means very dirty, or **detestable**, use the same word as you have used previously.

Yahweh tells his people to not make themselves unclean or detestable, or to not defile themselves.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about people making themselves unclean or detestable. Look up **defile** in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already described this idea in another book of the Bible, discuss if you want to talk about it in the same way here. Pause this audio here.

Use the same word for **Yahweh** as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh told the Israelite people to **consecrate** themselves, or make themselves holy. The Israelite people would take special baths, change their clothes, and not have sex for a time to consecrate themselves. In this passage, Yahweh generally wanted the Israelite people to be holy, or different from all the other groups of people. Use the same word or phrase for consecrate as you used in previous passages. Look up consecrate in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh said the Israelite people were to be **holy** because Yahweh is holy. Yahweh is pure and complete and good. Yahweh chose Yahweh's people to have a special purpose. Yahweh wants Yahweh's people to be ritually clean so Yahweh's people can be close to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for holy as you used in previous passages. Look up holy in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh says that this is the **law**, or rule, about eating or touching unclean animals. Look up law in the Master Glossary for more information. Use the same word for law as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 11:39–47

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (920 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 13:1–8

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 13:1–8 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:1–8 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh has been giving Moses and Aaron instructions on how the Israelite people were supposed to live in good relationship with Yahweh. At this time, the Israelite people were still camping at Mount Sinai. The Israelites had

recently built the Tent of Meeting according to Yahweh's instructions. Here, in this passage, Yahweh is giving Moses and Aaron instructions for the priests on how to determine whether a person with a skin problem is ritually clean or ritually dirty.

Remember, for an Israelite person, to be ritually clean or ritually dirty was not actually about physical cleanliness. In the same way, just because an Israelite person had a defiling skin problem, it did not necessarily mean that the person had a serious medical disease. Yahweh wanted the Israelite people to be ritually clean so that the Israelites could be near to Yahweh and worship Yahweh. The main concern was whether the Israelite people were ready spiritually to obey and follow Yahweh.

In the past, translators have translated the phrase "defiling skin disease" as leprosy. However, scholars agree that most likely, the modern disease of leprosy did not exist in that region at that time. Also, Yahweh instructed the priests to look for certain symptoms that do not seem to describe modern leprosy at all. Similarly, Yahweh does not mention certain symptoms that are extremely common in leprosy. So it seems unlikely that the defiling skin disease refers to leprosy. Instead, it likely refers to an entire group or category of skin diseases.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, how do you talk about different kinds of skin diseases? What skin diseases do you consider normal? What skin diseases do you consider a problem? How do people talk about someone who has a bad skin disease? Pause this audio here.

The question remains, why did Yahweh consider some human skin problems to be defiling or something that makes a person ritually dirty, and not other human skin problems? It does seem likely that one of the reasons why Yahweh said that an Israelite person with a defiling skin disease should live apart from others was to keep other people from getting the same skin disease. We know from other passages that a ritually clean Israelite person could become ritually dirty by touching another Israelite person who was ritually dirty. Again, the focus seems to be more on a person being ritually clean and spiritually ready than on someone spreading a disease to someone else.

Yahweh gives three kinds of human skin problems or three kinds of sores that cause an Israelite person to go to see the priest for examination. An Israelite must go to a priest if their skin has swelling, rashes or scabs, or bright spots. Scholars believe that these descriptions also include scaly and flaky skin, which could also be symptoms of a defiling skin disease.

If an Israelite person has one of these three skin conditions, that person must go see a priest for examination. The priest must check for two characteristics when the priest checks the Israelite's skin. First, the priest must determine if the hair around the skin sore has turned white. This requirement causes another problem for scholars. According to modern medicine, skin diseases do not normally cause hair to turn white. However, some scholars have suggested that this refers to psoriasis or even infections, such as fungal infections, which could cause the hair to appear white.

Stop here and, as a group, look at pictures of possible defiling skin diseases. Pause audio here.

Then the priest must determine whether the sore is deeper than the skin around it.

If the priest decides that the hair has turned white and the sore is deep in the skin, then the priest must declare the person to have a defiling skin disease. This means that the Israelite person is a ritually dirty person. This means that until the person heals, the person cannot participate in worship at the Tent of Meeting or in other communal activities with the people of Israel. We know from later in Leviticus that the ritually dirty Israelite person with a defiling skin disease had to live separately from all the other people of Israel. Not only that, but the person with the defiling skin disease must wear torn clothes and keep messy hair, which were signs of mourning. Lastly, the person had to cover their face and warn people that the person was ritually dirty, so that no one would accidentally become ritually dirty by touching the person.

[However, if the sore is not deeper than the skin around it, and the hair does not turn white, then the person has to live alone for seven days. Then the priest will check that person's skin again. If the sore or rash did not spread, the person has to live alone for seven more days. If the sore or rash still has not spread, then the priest will declare that the person is ritually clean. The person just needs to wash their clothes, and the person will be ritually clean again. However, if the sore or rash spreads after the priest declares the person ritually clean, then

the person has to come back to the priest again. If the rash continues to spread, then the priest will declare that person ritually dirty.]{.mark}

When a priest declares that an Israelite person is ritually clean or ritually dirty from a skin condition, this is probably a sort of public proclamation. It is important for other Israelite people to know when someone is ritually dirty, because other people could become ritually dirty by being in contact with the ritually dirty person.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, if the community rejects someone or calls someone taboo, how is that person supposed to act? How are other people supposed to treat the person?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh gives Moses and Aaron instructions for the priests on how to determine whether a person with a skin problem is ritually clean or ritually dirty.

In the second scene: If an Israelite person has a concerning skin problem, the person must go to the priest. If the priest determines that the Israelite person has a defiling skin disease, the priest will declare the person to be ritually dirty.

In the third scene: If the priest determines that the Israelite person's skin disease does not look bad, the priest will isolate the Israelite person for seven days. Then the priest must check the person's skin for a second time. If the rash is the same and has not gotten worse, the priest will isolate the Israelite person for another seven days. If the rash has faded, the priest will declare the Israelite person to be ritually clean. The person must wash their clothes and is then ritually clean.

In the fourth scene: Yahweh explains what to do if the priest has announced that an Israelite person is ritually clean but the rash returns. If, after the Israelite person leaves the priest, the person's rash gets worse, the person must go back to the priest. The priest must examine the person again, and if the rash is worse, the priest must declare that the Israelite person is ritually dirty because of the defiling skin disease.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- An Israelite person with a concerning skin problem
- An Israelite person who comes with the person with a concerning skin problem
- And the priest who examines the skin problem

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Yahweh starts giving a new set of rules. These rules teach the priests how to decide whether an Israelite person with a skin problem is ritually clean or ritually dirty. Moses wrote the rules. Moses and Aaron also told the Israelite people what Yahweh had said.

Stop here and discuss: Imagine an important person tells you something. After that, you go and tell a new person the same words. What words would you use to re-tell someone else's words? Pause the audio here.

In the past, people translated the defiling skin disease in this passage with the word "leprosy." However, most scholars agree that the skin diseases in this passage are not the same as modern-day leprosy.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Is there an accepted Bible in your region, perhaps in another language? If so, how does that Bible translate the defiling skin disease? If it uses a term such as leprosy, discuss whether it would be helpful to follow that translation in your own translation. Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 13:1–8

In this passage, Yahweh gives the priest specific instructions for what to look for in a skin disease. None of those descriptions matches a description of modern-day leprosy. Most scholars think that the defiling skin disease probably refers to a big category that includes many different skin diseases. Yahweh gives instructions so that the priests could look at any skin problem and determine whether or not it was a defiling skin disease.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, how do you talk about different kinds of skin diseases? What skin diseases do you consider normal? What skin diseases do you consider a problem? How do people talk about someone who has a bad skin disease? Pause the audio here.

Yahweh says that someone must bring the Israelite person with the skin problem to the priest. Who brings the person? Probably a close relative will go with the person with the skin problem and be present when the priest looks carefully at the person's skin. However, in some languages, it may be easier to simply say, "If a person has a skin problem, that person must go to the priest."

In scene two, Yahweh gives three kinds of human skin problems or three kinds of sores that will cause an Israelite person to go to see the priest for examination. There is some disagreement between scholars about exactly what these different words mean, but here are some likely descriptions of what each skin problem refers to.

The first human skin problem is swelling. A person with swelling in their skin probably refers to a person whose skin is swollen and inflamed. The person's skin looks puffed up and bigger than it should, and it may be sensitive when a person touches the skin.

The second human skin problem is a rash. This might refer to a raised bump on the skin, such as a scab or a boil. It could also refer to a lot of little bumps on a person's skin, which people often call a rash.

The third human skin problem is a bright spot. This probably refers to white spots on human skin. However, it may refer to any human skin that is an unusual color for that person.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, do you have words for any of these skin problems? How would you talk about or group the skin problems? Pause the audio here.

If an Israelite person has one of these three skin problems, that person must go see a priest so the priest can examine the person. The priest must answer two questions when the priest looks carefully at that person's skin. First, the priest must determine if the hair around the sore has turned white. Then the priest must determine whether the sore is deeper than the skin around the sore. It is unclear whether this means that the sore is an actual hole or dent in the skin or if the sore is deep in the skin down to the flesh of the person, which likely shows infection. If possible, try to translate this phrase in a way that allows for both meanings.

Stop here and discuss. First, listen to this statement: "His sore is deeper than the skin of his body." When you hear this statement, what do you think it means? In your language, how would you describe a human sore that is deep in a person's skin? Pause the audio here.

In this passage, the word "hair" does not refer to a singular strand of hair, but rather to many hairs that might be around the human's sore.

If the priest decides that the hair has turned white and the sore is deep in the skin, then the priest must declare that the person has a defiling skin disease. This means that the Israelite person is a ritually dirty person. This means that until the person heals, the person cannot participate in worship at the Tent of Meeting or other community activities with the people of Israel.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, what term will you use for "defiling skin disease"? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Yahweh tells what the priest should do if the person does not have a defiling skin disease. The Israelite person may have a skin sore that is white. But the priest may see that the sore is not deeper than the rest of the person's skin and that the sore is not turning the person's hair white. If so, then the priest must instruct the Israelite person with the skin sore to live by himself or herself, away from anyone else. After one week, the priest must look carefully at the person's sore a second time. If the person's sore has not changed, the priest instructs the person with the skin sore to live in isolation for another seven days. Then the priest re-examines the person's skin sore a third time. If the person's skin sore has not spread or has become smaller, then the priest can announce that the person is ritually clean. The Israelite person must wash their clothes, and then the person can act like a ritually clean person again.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will describe someone living by themselves. How will you also describe the person coming back to the priest three times for the priest to look at the person's skin? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, Yahweh talks about what to do if the sore returns. After a priest declares the Israelite person with a skin sore to be ritually clean, the Israelite person can go back to normal life. But if the person's skin sore spreads or gets worse, then that person must go back to the priest again. If the priest also agrees that the person's skin sore has spread, then the priest declares that person to be ritually dirty with a defiling skin disease.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- An Israelite person with a concerning skin problem
- An Israelite person who comes with the person with a concerning skin problem
- And the priest who examines the skin problem

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh is giving Moses and Aaron instructions for the priests on how to determine whether a person with a skin problem is ritually clean or ritually dirty. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel bad because I do not want to be around people who have bad diseases; or
- How will I know how to help these people? or
- If I am with the person who is ritually dirty, do I become ritually dirty too?

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh explains that if an Israelite person has a concerning skin problem, the person must go to the priest. The priest may determine that the Israelite person has a defiling skin disease and will declare the person ritually dirty. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite person with the skin disease, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel embarrassed; or
- I am upset that I will not be able to be with my family; or
- I would do anything for someone to heal me! or
- Did Yahweh forget me? Does Yahweh still love me?

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh explains what to do if the priest determines that the Israelite person's skin disease does not look bad. The priest must isolate the Israelite person for seven days and then look carefully at the person's skin for a second time. If the rash is the same and has not gotten worse, the priest will isolate the Israelite person for another seven days. If the rash has not gotten worse, the priest will declare the Israelite person ritually clean. The person must wash their clothes and then can act ritually clean. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am relieved that this person's rash is not worse; or
- I do not want to make a mistake, because it will be bad for someone who is contagious to be around other people.

Continue the drama. In the fourth scene, Yahweh explains what to do if a rash returns. The priest may announce that an Israelite person is ritually clean, even though the person had a rash. But if after the Israelite person leaves the priest, the person's rash gets worse, the Israelite person must go back to the priest. The priest must examine the person again, and if the rash is worse, the priest must declare that the Israelite person is ritually dirty because of the defiling skin disease. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am frustrated because I thought I was still ritually clean; or
- I do not understand why this happened to me; or
- People will think badly of me, but I did not do anything bad to cause this skin disease.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Use the same word for **Yahweh** as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh instructs the priests to determine whether an Israelite person has a defiling skin disease. If the person has a defiling skin disease, the person is ritually dirty. For more information on **leprosy**, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the pictures of possible defiling skin diseases. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **defiling skin disease**. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the **priests** are the people who look closely at a person's skin to decide if a person with a skin disease is ritually dirty or not. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

In this passage, Yahweh gives instructions to the priests to determine whether or not an Israelite person is **ritually dirty** because of a skin disease. Use the same words or phrases throughout for ritually clean and ritually dirty as you used in previous passages. For more information on **clean** and **unclean**, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 13:1–8

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (888 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 13:9–17

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 13:9–17 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:9–17 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:9–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh has been giving Moses and Aaron instructions on how the Israelite people were supposed to live in good relationship with Yahweh. At this time, the Israelite people were still camping at Mount Sinai and had recently built the Tent of Meeting according to Yahweh's instructions. Here, in this passage, Yahweh continues to give Moses and Aaron instructions for the priests on how to determine whether a person with a skin condition is ritually clean or ritually dirty.

Remember, for an Israelite person, being ritually clean or ritually dirty was not actually about physical cleanliness. In the same way, just because an Israelite person had a defiling skin problem, it did not necessarily mean that the person had a serious medical disease. Yahweh wanted the Israelite people to be ritually clean so that the

Leviticus 13:9–17

Israelites could be near to Yahweh and worship Yahweh. The main concern was whether the Israelite people were ready spiritually to obey and follow Yahweh.

In the past, people have translated the phrase “defiling skin disease” as leprosy. You will remember from the previous passage that scholars believe that it is very unlikely that the skin diseases in this passage are modern leprosy. Instead, the phrase “defiling skin disease” likely refers to an entire group or category of skin diseases.

In this passage, Yahweh gives the priests three characteristics of human skin sores to determine if an Israelite person has a chronic skin disease, which is one of the defiling skin diseases. The three characteristics are: white swelling, white hair, and raw flesh.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the pictures of possible defiling skin diseases. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the priest looks for the presence of raw flesh as a definite sign of defiling skin disease. If a person has all three characteristics—white swelling, white hair, and raw flesh—around their skin sores, the priest will declare the person to have a long-term skin disease.

Stop here and discuss: What do people think and say about people with long-term illness in your culture? How do other people treat people with long-term illness? Pause this audio here.

Sometimes a person can recover from a defiling skin disease. In these cases, the priests will again look for signs of raw flesh to decide whether a person’s skin is white because it is healing or a person’s skin is white because the person has a defiling skin disease.

When a priest declared that an Israelite person was ritually clean or ritually dirty from a skin disease, this was probably a sort of public proclamation. It was important for other Israelite people to know when someone was ritually dirty, because other people could become ritually dirty by being in contact with the ritually dirty person. An Israelite person who was ritually dirty had to behave in certain ways. You will remember that we know from later in Leviticus that the ritually dirty Israelite person with a defiling skin disease had to live separately from all the other people of Israel. Not only that, but the person with the defiling skin disease must wear torn clothes and keep messy hair, which were signs of mourning. Lastly, the person had to cover their face and warn people that the person was ritually dirty, so that no one would accidentally become ritually dirty by touching the person.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Imagine having to live as a ritually dirty Israelite person with a defiling disease. What do you think it would be like to live that way? What do you think you would think or feel? Pause this audio here.

Even though the storyteller does not mention it in this passage, there is a certain custom for a person whom the priest declared is ritually clean after having a defiling skin disease. Even though the priest already declared that the person is ritually clean, the person still needs to go and wash their clothes. Then the person could go back to living with other Israelite people, attending worship ceremonies, or being a part of other parts of life in the community.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:9–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: If an Israelite person has a defiling skin disease with white swelling and raw flesh, then another Israelite person should take the Israelite person with the skin problem to the priest. If the priest decides that the Israelite person has a defiling skin disease, the priest will declare the person ritually dirty.

In the second scene: An Israelite person may have a defiling skin disease that spreads and covers their whole body. The priest will examine the person’s body and may declare the person is ritually clean. But any time the person with the concerning skin problem has raw flesh, the person becomes ritually dirty. If the person’s raw

flesh turns white, the person can go back to the priest. If the priest determines that the raw flesh has turned to white skin, the priest can declare the person ritually clean again.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- An Israelite person with a concerning skin problem
- An Israelite person who comes with the person with a concerning skin problem
- And the priest who examines the skin problem

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh was giving Moses and Aaron instructions on how the Israelite people were supposed to live in good relationship with Yahweh. At this time, the Israelite people were still camping at Mount Sinai. The Israelites have recently built the Tent of Meeting according to Yahweh's instructions. Note that the storyteller does not mention Yahweh, Moses, and Aaron in this passage, but at the beginning of Leviticus 13, the storyteller says that Yahweh first gave these instructions to Moses and Aaron.

In the first scene, Yahweh talks about what to do if an Israelite person has a defiling skin disease. Yahweh says that someone must bring the Israelite person with the skin problem to the priest. Who brings the person? Probably a close relative will go with the person with the skin problem and be present when the priest looks carefully at the person's skin. However, in some languages, it may be easier to simply say, "If a person has a defiling skin disease, that person must go to the priest."

Notice that throughout this passage, Yahweh's instructions for the priests are how to treat someone after a priest has already declared that person ritually dirty with a defiling skin disease. The priest looks for three characteristics this time.

First, the priest looks for white swelling. A person with white swelling in their skin probably refers to a person whose skin is swollen and inflamed as well as white. The person's skin might look puffed up and bigger than it should, and may be sensitive when a person touches the skin. White swelling could also refer to scaly or flaky skin.

Next, the priest sees if the hair is white. Again, we do not know exactly what this means. But it is most likely that the skin sore either causes the skin to flake or that there is an infection in such a way that changes the appearance of the hair around the sore.

Next, the priest looks for raw flesh. This means that the human skin sores are deep into the part of the skin that does not always heal on its own. When a person has a skin sore this deep, the person feels hurt when someone touches the sore because the skin is sensitive. When a person has a sore that deep, the sore is also likely to become infected.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, what words would you use to describe these skin characteristics? Pause this audio here.

If the priest sees these skin characteristics, it means the person with the defiling skin disease has a chronic, or long-lasting, disease. This can also mean that the defiling skin disease has advanced into a worse stage. Another way to say this is that the person's skin disease is established, which means that it will take the person a very long time to heal.

Then the priest will declare the person to be ritually dirty. But the priest does not tell the person to live in isolation for a short time period to test whether the skin heals. The reason the priest does not do this is that the priest had already declared the person ritually dirty before. The priest's examination is, in this case, a confirmation that the person with the defiling skin disease is still ritually dirty.

In the second scene, Yahweh explains what to do if an Israelite person has a skin condition or rash that spreads and covers the person's whole body. This likely also means that the rash on the skin spreads very quickly or that the rash is an intense kind of rash. This passage says that the rash covers the person from the person's head to

the person's feet. In your language, you may have another phrase that you use to refer to a body condition that is all over a person's body.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, how would you describe a rash that spreads quickly? How would you describe a rash that covers a person's whole body? Pause this audio here.

This person with the skin problem or rash all over their body must also go to the priest. The priest must examine the person with the skin problem. The priest may see that the rash has spread all over the person's body and turned white. This means that the skin problem is not serious, because the person did not get infected raw skin from the rash. It is possible that this person had the defiling skin disease, but the disease is now cured. Even though the marks of the disease are still on the person's body, the person is no longer at risk of getting infection from it.

In a situation like this, the priest declares the person ritually clean.

However, any time the person with the rash has raw flesh, the priest must declare the person with the rash to be ritually dirty and tell that person that the person has a defiling skin disease.

If the person has a defiling skin disease, but the person's raw flesh becomes white, the person with the skin problem must go back to the priest. In this case, the raw flesh becoming white probably means that skin is growing again where the skin sore was before. If the priest sees that the person's sores have turned white, the priest can declare the person to be ritually clean. If it is confusing to use the term "white" here, you might simply want to say that the priest sees that the person's raw flesh is healed.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:9–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- An Israelite person with a concerning skin problem
- An Israelite person who comes with the person with a concerning skin problem
- And the priest who examines the skin problem

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh explains what to do if an Israelite person has a defiling skin disease with white swelling and raw flesh. Another Israelite person will take the Israelite person with the skin problem to the priest. If the priest determines that the Israelite person has a defiling skin disease, the priest will declare the person ritually

Leviticus 13:9–17

dirty. Pause the drama. After the priest declares that the person with the concerning skin problem is still ritually dirty, ask the person playing the Israelite who went with that person to see the priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I was hoping that the person I love would be healed; or
- My friend is still ritually dirty. We must wait longer; or
- I will pray for healing.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh explains what to do if an Israelite person has a defiling skin disease that spreads and covers their whole body. The priest will examine the person's body, and if the skin is white, the priest will declare the person is ritually clean. But any time the person with the concerning skin disease has raw flesh, the person becomes ritually dirty. If the person's raw flesh turns white, the person can go back to the priest. If the priest determines that the raw flesh has turned to white skin, the priest can declare the person ritually clean again. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite person after the priest declared that person to be ritually clean again, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so excited! or
- I cannot wait to eat with my family and friends again; or
- I will go wash right away so I can go to the Tent of Meeting to thank Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:9–17 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh instructs the priests to determine whether an Israelite person has a **defiling skin disease**. If the person has a defiling skin disease, that person is ritually dirty. Use the same word or phrase for "defiling skin disease" as you used in previous passages. For more information on **leprosy**, an old term for a defiling skin disease, refer to the Master Glossary. Talk about the swelling, the white color, and all the other words you used for the skin conditions in the same way as previous passages.

Stop here and, as a group, look at the pictures of possible defiling skin diseases. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the **priests** are the ones who look at the person's skin to decide if a person with a skin disease is ritually dirty or not. Use the same word for priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

In this passage, Yahweh gives instructions to the priests to determine whether or not an Israelite person was **ritually dirty** because of their skin disease. Use the same word or phrase throughout for ritually **clean** and ritually dirty as you used in previous passages. For more information, refer to the Master Glossary for clean and **unclean**.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 13:9–17

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (898 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 13:18–28

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 13:18–28 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:18–28 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:18–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh has been giving Moses and Aaron instructions on how the Israelite people were supposed to live in good relationship with Yahweh. At this time, the Israelite people were still camping at Mount Sinai. The Israelites recently built the Tent of Meeting according to Yahweh's instructions. Here, in this passage, Yahweh is giving Moses and Aaron instructions for the priests on how to determine whether a person with a skin problem is ritually clean or ritually dirty.

Remember, for an Israelite person, to be ritually clean or ritually dirty was not actually about physical cleanliness. In the same way, just because an Israelite person had a defiling skin problem, it did not necessarily mean that the person had a serious medical disease. Yahweh wanted the Israelite people to be ritually clean so that the Israelites could be near to Yahweh and worship Yahweh. The main concern was whether the Israelite people were ready spiritually to obey and follow Yahweh.

In the past, translators have called the “defiling skin disease” leprosy. You will remember from the previous passage that scholars believe that it is very unlikely that the skin diseases in this passage are modern leprosy. Instead, the phrase “defiling skin disease” likely refers to an entire group or category of skin diseases.

In this passage, Yahweh gives instructions for how a priest will determine a defiling skin disease of two specific kinds: boils and burns. So far in Leviticus 13, the skin problems have been big skin diseases that can cover a person’s whole body. But the two skin problems in this passage do not cover the whole body. Boils are usually small, and even though sometimes there will be whole groups of boils, boils usually come in small groups. A burn from a fire can happen anywhere on a person’s body, but only the skin that the fire touches is burned.

Stop here and look at the pictures of human skin boils and human skin burns. Pause this audio here.

An Israelite person must go to a priest for the priest to examine the boil or burn if the person’s skin has one of two characteristics. If the person has white swelling in the boil or burn, the person must go to the priest. Or, if the person has a white, red, or pink spot in the boil or burn, the person must go to the priest.

Yahweh gives the priest two things to look for in boils or burns. If the boil or burn has these characteristics, it is a defiling disease. If the sore is deeper than the skin, and if the hair around the sore is white, then the priest must declare that the person has a defiling skin disease and is ritually dirty. The hair turning white is another problem for scholars. According to modern medicine, skin diseases do not normally cause hair to turn white. However, some scholars have suggested that this refers to psoriasis or even infections, such as fungal infections that could cause the hair to appear white.

If these skin characteristics are not present, the priest must tell the person with the boil or burn to live alone for seven days. This means that the person must live outside the camp, away from other people. After seven days, the priest will look carefully at the person’s skin again. The same priest must look again so that the priest can compare how the boil or burn looked before to what the priest sees now. If the white swelling or the bright spot in the sore has spread, the priest will say to the person with the skin problem, “You are ritually dirty. You have a defiling skin disease.” But if the white swelling or bright spot in the sore has not spread, the priest will say to the person with the skin problem, “You are ritually clean. It is only a scar.” Then the priest will allow the person to return to the person’s home.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, what do people think or say about scars? Pause the audio here.

When a priest declares that an Israelite person is ritually clean or ritually dirty from a skin disease, this is probably a sort of public proclamation. It was important for other Israelite people to know when someone was ritually dirty, because other people could become ritually dirty by being in contact with the ritually dirty person. An Israelite person who was ritually dirty had to behave in certain ways. We know from later in Leviticus that the ritually dirty Israelite person with a defiling skin disease had to live separately from all the other people of Israel. The person could not visit with or touch their family. Not only that, but the person with the defiling skin disease must wear torn clothes and keep messy hair, which were signs of mourning. Lastly, the person had to cover their face and warn people that the person was ritually dirty, so that no one would accidentally become ritually dirty by touching the person.

Stop here and discuss this question in your language as a group: Imagine someone told you that a family member that you love has to live isolated, far away from everyone else in the community. What would you think? How would you feel? What would you do? Pause the audio here.

Even though the storyteller does not mention it in this passage, there was a certain custom for a person when the priest declared the person was ritually clean after the person had a defiling skin disease. Even though the priest already declared that the person was ritually clean, the person still had to go and wash their clothes. Then the person could go back to live with other Israelite people, attend worship ceremonies, or be a part of other parts of life in the community.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:18–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh explains what to do if an Israelite person has a boil on their skin that has healed, but now a new, concerning skin problem appears where the boil was on the skin. This person must go to the priest and show the priest the new, concerning skin problem. The priest will determine if the person is ritually dirty from a defiling skin disease. If the priest is not certain whether the person has a defiling skin disease, the priest will tell the person to go and live alone for seven days. Then the priest must examine the person with the concerning skin problem again. If the person's skin problem has spread in their skin, the priest will declare that the person is ritually dirty with a defiling skin disease. But if the person's skin problem is the same or is smaller and healing, the priest will declare that the person is ritually clean.

In the second scene: Yahweh explains what to do if an Israelite person has a burn on their skin. As the person's burn heals, a new spot may appear in the raw flesh that is either white, red, or pink. The priest must examine the new skin spot or sore. If the priest determines the person has a defiling skin disease, the priest will tell the person that the person is ritually dirty. If the priest is not certain whether the person has a defiling skin disease, the priest will tell the person to go and live alone for seven days. Then the priest must examine the person with the concerning skin problem again. If the person's skin problem has spread in their skin, the priest will declare that the person is ritually dirty with a defiling skin disease. But if the person's skin problem is the same or is smaller and healing, the priest will declare that the person is ritually clean.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- An Israelite person with a boil on their skin
- A priest who examines the skin problem
- And an Israelite person with a burn on their skin

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh was giving Moses and Aaron instructions on how the Israelite people were supposed to live in good relationship with Yahweh. At this time, the Israelite people were still camping at Mount Sinai. The Israelites recently built the Tent of Meeting according to Yahweh's instructions. Note that Yahweh, Moses, and Aaron's names are not in this passage, but at the beginning of Leviticus 13, the storyteller says that Yahweh first gave these instructions to Moses and Aaron.

In the first scene, Yahweh explains what to do if an Israelite person has a boil on their skin that heals. People also call a boil a sore. These are the same kind of skin sores that the Egyptians had during the 10 plagues in Exodus. If you have already translated the passage with the 10 plagues of Egypt, you will want to use the same word here.

These boils often get infected with pus. Sometimes people call these "eruptions" because the pus sometimes bursts out of the skin.

In this situation, the Israelite person had a boil that healed, but now, in the same place, there is a new kind of concerning skin problem. Yahweh mentions two kinds of concerning skin problems that the Israelite person must go to the priest to examine.

The first concerning skin problem is white swelling of the sore. A person's skin sore with white swelling probably refers to a sore that is swollen and inflamed as well as white. The person's skin around the sore might look puffed up and bigger than it should, and may be sensitive when a person touches it. White swelling could also refer to scaly or flaky skin around or in the sore.

The second concerning skin problem is a bright spot in the sore that is either white or reddish. It is probable that this refers to any bright spots in the sore that are white, red, or pink.

Stop here and look at the pictures of human skin boils. Discuss what words you use to describe skin problems, such as boils, in your language. Pause the audio here.

If the Israelite person with a boil has either of these concerning skin problems in or around their sore, that person must go to a priest for examination. The priest will look for two characteristics of the skin sore. One thing the priest must do is determine whether the skin sore is deeper than the skin around it. It is unclear whether this phrase means that the sore is an actual dent or sunken area in the skin or if the sore is deep in the skin down to the inner flesh of the person, which likely means the skin is infected. If possible, try to translate this phrase in a way that allows for both meanings. The priest must also determine if the hair around the sore has turned white. This does not refer to one specific hair, but any hairs that are around the skin sore. If the person's concerning skin problem is both deep in the skin and has white hairs around it, the priest declares the person is ritually dirty because the person has a defiling skin disease.

If the person with the concerning skin disease does not have white hair around their skin sore and the sore is not deep in the skin, and if the sore looks like it is fading, then the priest must tell the person to live alone and separate for seven days. A skin sore is fading if the sore looks like it is healing, is going away, and is smaller and less noticeable than before.

After seven days, the priest must examine the person with the skin sore again. If the person's skin sore has spread, or gotten worse or bigger, then the priest will declare the person is ritually dirty because the person has a defiling skin disease. But if the person's skin sore has not gotten worse, the priest will declare that the person is ritually clean.

In scene two, Yahweh gives a very similar process for a person with a burn. A burn is when fire touches a person and hurts the person's skin.

If an Israelite person has a burn, and a white, red, or pink bright spot appears in the raw flesh, the person must go to the priest so the priest can look at the burn.

Stop here and look at the pictures of human skin burns. Discuss what words you use to describe burns in your language. Pause the audio here.

The priest looks for the same two characteristics of the skin burn. One thing the priest must do is determine whether the skin sore is deeper than the skin around it. The priest must also determine if the hair around the sore has turned white. If the person's concerning skin problem is both deep in the skin and has white hairs around it, the priest will declare the person is ritually dirty because the person has a defiling skin disease.

If the person with the burn does not have white hair around their skin sore and the sore is not deep in the skin, and if the sore looks like it is fading or healing, then the priest must tell the person to live alone and separate for seven days.

After seven days, the priest must examine the person with the skin sore again. If the person's skin sore has spread, or gotten worse or bigger, then the priest will declare the person is ritually dirty because the person has a defiling skin disease. But if the person's skin sore has not gotten worse, the priest will declare that the person is ritually clean.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:18–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron

- An Israelite person with a boil on their skin
- A priest who examines the skin problem
- And an Israelite person with a burn on their skin

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh explains what to do if an Israelite person had a boil on their skin that healed, but then a new, concerning skin problem appears where the boil was on the skin. This person must go to the priest and show the priest the new, concerning skin problem. The priest determines that the person is ritually dirty from a defiling skin disease. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite person with the boil, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I do not understand why this happened to me; or
- I wonder if Yahweh still loves me; or
- I worry about whether I will ever get better.

Continue the drama. If the priest is not certain whether the person has a defiling skin disease, because of the characteristics of the skin problem, the priest will tell the person to go and live alone for seven days. Then the priest must examine the person with the concerning skin problem again. If the person's skin problem has spread in their skin, the priest will declare that the person is ritually dirty with a defiling skin disease. But if the person's skin problem is the same or is smaller and healing, the priest will declare that the person is ritually clean.

In the second scene, Yahweh explains what to do if an Israelite person has a burn on their skin. As the person's burn heals, a new spot may appear in the raw flesh that is either white, red, or pink. The priest must examine the new skin spot or sore. If the priest determines the person has a defiling skin disease, the priest will tell the person that the person is ritually dirty. If the priest is not certain whether the person has a defiling skin disease, because of the characteristics of the skin problem, the priest will tell the person to go and live alone for seven days. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I will pray that Yahweh heals this person; or
- I really hope that this person is better when I examine the person again.

Continue the drama. Then the priest must examine the person with the concerning skin problem again. If the person's skin problem has spread in their skin, the priest will declare that the person is ritually dirty with a defiling skin disease. But if the person's skin problem is the same or is smaller and healing, the priest will declare that the person is ritually clean.

Remember, Yahweh gave these original instructions to Moses and Aaron. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This is a big responsibility for the priests; or
- What will the people say when the people hear these rules? or
- How will we be able to take care of every person with a skin disease?

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:18–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, the **priests** examine a person to decide if a person with a skin disease is ritually dirty or not. Use the same word for priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh gives instructions to the priests to determine whether or not an Israelite person is **ritually dirty** because of a skin disease. Use the same word or phrase throughout for ritually clean and ritually dirty as you used in previous passages. For more information about **clean** and **unclean**, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh instructs the priests to determine whether an Israelite person has a **defiling skin disease**. If the person has a defiling skin disease, the person is ritually dirty. Use the same word or phrase for defiling skin disease as you used in previous passages. For more information on **leprosy**, an old term that people sometimes use for "defiling skin disease," refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and look at the pictures of human skin boils and burns.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 13:18–28

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (908 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 13:29–37

Leviticus 13:29–37

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 13:29–37 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:29–37 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:29–37 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh was giving Moses and Aaron instructions on how the Israelite people were supposed to live in good relationship with Yahweh. At this time, the Israelite people were still camping at Mount Sinai. The Israelites recently built the Tent of Meeting according to Yahweh's instructions. Here, in this passage, Yahweh is giving Moses and Aaron instructions for the priests on how to determine whether a person with a concerning skin problem is ritually clean or ritually dirty.

Remember, for an Israelite person to be ritually clean or ritually dirty was not actually about physical cleanliness. In the same way, just because an Israelite person had a defiling skin problem, it did not necessarily mean that the person had a serious medical disease. Yahweh wanted the Israelite people to be ritually clean so that the Israelites could be near to Yahweh and worship Yahweh. The main concern was whether the Israelite people were ready spiritually to obey and follow Yahweh. In biblical times, it was common for Israelite people to assume that a person had a physical disease because Yahweh wanted to punish that person.

Stop here and discuss: What do people in your culture believe is the main cause of sickness? How do people assume that spiritual things influence someone becoming sick? Pause the audio here.

In the past, translators have translated "defiling skin disease" as leprosy. You will remember from the previous passage that scholars believe that it is very unlikely that the skin diseases in this passage are modern leprosy. Instead, the phrase "defiling skin disease" likely refers to an entire group or category of skin diseases.

In this passage, Yahweh gives instructions for how a priest will decide whether or not a person with a head sore —either in the person's hair or on the person's face or beard—has a defiling skin disease. This passage describes these head sores as scabs that cause the person to lose hair in those places. For this reason, some scholars think that some likely skin conditions in this passage are ringworm and favus.

Stop here and look at the pictures of ringworm and favus as possible defiling diseases in this passage. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh gives the priest two characteristics to determine if a person with a skin sore or scab on their head has a defiling skin disease. The priest looks to see if the skin sore is deep in the skin and if the skin sore has thin, yellow hairs in it. In other examinations in Leviticus 13 about defiling skin diseases, the priest looks for white hair. We do not know exactly why here the priests look for yellow, thin hair instead. It may be that because these are areas on the body where Israelite people had thick, dark hair, the hair would look different. Or it may be because this refers to a different kind of defiling skin disease. In modern medicine, doctors connect yellow hair with bacterial infections. No matter the reason, it is worth noticing that in this passage, Yahweh gives different instructions to the priests.

Leviticus 13:29–37

If the priest sees these characteristics—a sore deep in the skin with yellow, sparse hairs growing in it—then the priest declares the person ritually dirty because the person has an "itching" defiling skin disease.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, how do you describe something that is extremely itchy on the skin? Pause the audio here.

If the priest sees that the skin sore does not look deep in the skin and the skin does not have black hair in it, the priest tells the person to isolate or live alone for seven days, probably somewhere outside the camp and definitely away from other people. This probably means that it is too early to tell whether the person's skin sore will be a defiling skin disease or not.

After seven days, the priest examines the head sore again. The same priest must examine the person again so that the priest can compare how the person's head skin sore has changed. This time, the priest looks for three things. First, the priest looks to see if the skin sore has not spread or gotten worse. The priest also makes sure there are no yellow hairs in the skin sore. The priest also makes sure that the skin sore does not look deep in the skin. If these three things are true, the priest will tell the person with the head skin sore to shave their hair all around the skin sore. To shave means to cut or remove all the hair. This will help the priest see if the sore has spread later. Then the priest will tell the person with the head skin sore to isolate or live alone for seven more days.

In this passage, Yahweh does not mention what the priest should do if the person's head skin sore has spread. However, based on the pattern in the passage, it is almost certain that if the priest sees the skin sore spread at this point, then the priest will declare the person with the skin sore as ritually dirty with a defiling skin disease.

If the person does a second period of isolation for seven days, at the end of that period, the person must come back to the priest. The same priest must examine the person a third time. This time, the priest looks to see if the person's head skin sore has spread. If the person's head skin sore has not spread and does not look deep in the skin, the priest says to the person, "You are ritually clean," and the person can go wash their clothes and go home.

But even after the priest tells the person with the head skin sore that the person is ritually clean, the person can still become ritually dirty again. If the person with the skin sore goes away and then their skin sore spreads, the person with the skin sore must come back to the priest again for another examination. If the priest sees that the skin sore has spread, even if there are no yellow hairs, the priest still declares that the person with the head skin sore is ritually dirty.

But if the priest thinks the person's head skin sore is the same, and if black hair is growing in the person's head skin sore, the priest declares the person with the healed skin sore as ritually clean. The priest looks for the black hair as a sign that the person's head skin sore is healed.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, who looks at people's infections? How does that person decide if a person is healed or still sick? Pause the audio here.

When a priest declared that an Israelite person is ritually clean or ritually dirty from a skin condition, this was probably a sort of public proclamation. It was important for other Israelite people to know when someone was ritually dirty, because other people could become ritually dirty by being in contact with the ritually dirty person. An Israelite person who was ritually dirty had to behave in certain ways. We know from later in Leviticus that the ritually dirty Israelite person with a defiling skin disease had to live separately from all the other people of Israel. The person could not visit with or touch their family. Not only that, but the person with the defiling skin disease must wear torn clothes and keep messy hair, which were signs of mourning. Lastly, the person had to cover their face and warn people that the person was ritually dirty, so that no one would accidentally become ritually dirty by touching the person.

After a priest declares that an Israelite person is ritually clean after having a defiling skin disease, the person must go and wash their clothes. The person must do this before the person could go back to live with other Israelite people, attend worship ceremonies, or be part of other parts of life in the community.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:29–37 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh explains what to do if an Israelite person has a sore on their scalp or on their face. That person must go to the priest, and the priest must examine the sore. If the person's skin sore has two characteristics, then the priest declares the person ritually dirty because the person has a defiling skin disease. If the priest decides the sore does not look bad or that it is too early to tell, the priest tells the Israelite person with the skin sore to live alone for seven days or one week.

In the second scene: After seven days, the priest will examine the person's skin sore a second time. If the person's skin sore has not spread, the person is supposed to shave or take off the hair around the scab. Then the person with the skin sore has to live alone for another seven days or one week.

In the third scene: After another seven days or one week, the priest will examine the person's skin sore for a third time. If the person's skin sore has not spread, the priest can declare the person ritually clean. The person must go and wash their clothes. But even after this, the person with the healing skin sore might need to come back for the priest to look at their skin sore again. If the person's skin sore spreads, the priest will declare the person ritually dirty. But if the person's skin sore has not changed and has normal, black hair growing in it, the priest will declare the person as ritually clean.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- An Israelite person with a sore on their head or face
- And a priest who examines the skin problem

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Note that the storyteller does not mention Yahweh, Moses, and Aaron in this passage. But at the beginning of Leviticus 13, the storyteller says that Yahweh first gave these instructions to Moses and Aaron.

In scene one, Yahweh explains what to do if an Israelite person has a sore on their scalp or on their face. The original words are "in the head or in the beard." Many translations choose a word for "chin" rather than beard, since Yahweh mentions that both men and women can have this kind of sore. So this probably means a sore that appears in the part of a person's face where some people can grow a beard.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, what words do you use to talk about different parts of the head or face? How do you refer to head hair? How do you refer to beard hair? Pause the audio here.

People also call this kind of sore "a scab." The person with the sore on their scalp or face must go to the priest, and the priest must examine the sore. The priest will look for two skin characteristics. If the person's skin sore looks deeper than the skin and the hair in the sore is yellow and thin, the priest will declare the person with the skin sore as ritually dirty with the defiling skin disease.

It is unclear whether the sore being "deeper than the skin" refers to an actual dent in the skin or to a sore deep in the skin down to the flesh of the person, which shows that there is an infection. If possible, try to translate this phrase in a way that allows for both meanings.

The priest also looks to see if the hair that is in or around the sore is "yellow and thin." This means there is less hair than normal, and that the hair looks unhealthy and brittle.

In this passage, the word "hair" does not refer to a singular strand of hair, but rather to many hairs that might be around or in the human skin sore.

If the priest decides that the hair has turned yellow and the sore is deep in the skin, then the priest must declare that the person has a defiling skin disease. This means that the Israelite person is a ritually dirty person. Until

the person heals, this person cannot join in worship at the Tent of Meeting or other communal activities with the people of Israel.

This time, when it says “defiling skin disease,” the original language mentions that this is a “tearing off” disease. That probably means that it is a skin disease that itches so badly that a person wants to scratch the skin. Some scholars think this defiling skin disease refers to diseases such as ringworm or favus.

Stop here and look at pictures of possible defiling skin diseases, ringworm and favus. Pause this audio here.

If the priest sees that the person’s skin sore is not deep in the skin and that there is no black hair in the person’s skin sore, the priest will tell the Israelite person with the skin sore to live alone for seven days or one week.

Some translations say “no black hair” here, while others say “no yellow hair.” If there is no hair in the sore, it is likely that the priest will decide that the sore is too new to know whether or not the sore will become a defiling skin disease. Ways to avoid this issue are to translate this phrase as “no healthy hair,” or “no normal hair,” or simply “no hair.”

Stop here and discuss: How do the Bible versions you use talk about the hair here? Discuss the best way to translate the phrase “no black hair” in your own language. Pause the audio here.

If the priest decides the sore does not look bad or that it is too early to tell, the priest will tell the Israelite person with the skin sore to live alone for seven days.

In the second scene, after seven days, the priest will examine the person’s skin sore a second time. The priest looks for three characteristics of the skin sore: the person’s skin sore has not spread, there are no yellow hairs in the skin sore, and the skin sore is not deep in the skin. If the person’s skin sore is like this, the person must shave the hair around the sore, but not the sore itself. Most likely, the person just shaves the hair in the area around the sore, or all the hair on their head. To shave means to remove, cut, or take off the hair that is all around the sore. This is the same whether the person’s skin sore is on the head or on the beard. Then the person with the skin sore has to live alone for another seven days or one week.

In the third scene, after another seven days or one week, the priest will examine the person’s skin sore for a third time. If the person’s skin sore has not spread and the skin sore is not deep in the skin, the priest can declare the person ritually clean. The person must go and wash their clothes.

But even after this, the person with the healing skin sore might need to come back for the priest to look at the skin sore again. If the person’s skin sore spreads, the priest will declare the person ritually dirty. But if the person’s skin sore has not changed and has normal, black hair growing in it, the priest will declare the person as ritually clean “as far as the priest can see.” In other words, in the priest’s opinion, the person is ritually clean.

Stop here and discuss: In this passage, the priest examines someone three times. The storyteller repeats Yahweh’s instructions. Discuss in your language what information or instructions you should repeat. Discuss if there is any information that you should shorten or imply. Pause the audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:29–37 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- An Israelite person with a sore on their head or face
- And a priest who examines the skin problem

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh explains what to do if an Israelite person has a sore on their scalp or on their face. That person must go to the priest, and the priest must examine the sore. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite person with a sore on their head, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am nervous about what the priest will say; or
- I might have to live alone for a while, so I will say goodbye to my family before I go; or
- I am worried about what people might think.

Continue the drama. If the person's skin sore has two characteristics, the priest will declare the person is ritually dirty because the person has a defiling skin disease. If the priest decides the sore does not look bad or that it is too early to tell, the priest will tell the Israelite person with the skin sore to live alone for seven days or one week.

In the second scene, after seven days, the priest will examine the person's skin sore a second time. If the person's skin sore has not spread, the person must shave or take off the hair around the scab. Then the person with the skin sore has to live alone for another seven days or one week.

In the third scene, after another seven days, the priest will examine the person's skin sore for a third time. If the person's skin sore has not spread, the priest can declare the person ritually clean. The person must go and wash their clothes. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- After three examinations, the person is finally healed! Hurray! or
- I am amazed. Yahweh made our bodies to be so good at healing; or
- The person will be so happy to go back and see their family after such a long time.

Continue the drama. Even after this, the person with the healing skin sore might need to come back for the priest to look at the person's skin sore again. If the person's skin sore spreads, the priest will declare the person ritually dirty. But if the person's skin sore has not changed and has normal, black hair growing in it, the priest will declare the person as ritually clean.

Remember, Yahweh originally gave these instructions to Aaron and Moses. You may want to act that out as well and ask people what they are feeling or thinking. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want my people to know that taking time to heal is a good thing to do. It is not shameful to stop and heal; or
- I want the person who is ritually dirty to have hope that I can heal that person; or
- I am Yahweh who heals. I will show the people my miracles, and my people will praise me.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:29–37 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Leviticus 13:29–37

In this passage, the **priests** examine a person to decide if a person with a skin disease is ritually dirty or not. Use the same word for priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh gives instructions to the priests to determine whether or not an Israelite person is **ritually dirty** because of their skin disease. Use the same word or phrase throughout for "ritually clean" and "ritually dirty" as you used in previous passages. For more information on **clean** and **unclean**, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh instructs the priests to determine whether an Israelite person has a **defiling skin disease**. If the person has a defiling skin disease, the person is ritually dirty. Use the same word or phrase for defiling skin disease as you used in previous passages. For more information on **leprosy**, an old term for "defiling skin disease," refer to the Master Glossary. Remember that Yahweh specifically calls these skin problems "itching" defiling skin diseases.

Stop here and look at the pictures of possible defiling skin diseases. How will you describe these "**itching**" defiling skin diseases?

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 13:29–37

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (919 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 13:38–46

Leviticus 13:38–46

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 13:38–46 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:38–46 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:38–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh was giving Moses and Aaron instructions on how the Israelite people were supposed to live in good relationship with Yahweh. At this time, the Israelite people were still camping at Mount Sinai, where the people had recently built the Tent of Meeting according to Yahweh's instructions. Here, in this passage, Yahweh is giving Moses and Aaron instructions for the priests on how to decide whether a person with a concerning skin problem is ritually clean or ritually dirty.

Remember, an Israelite person being ritually clean or ritually dirty was not actually about physical cleanliness. In the same way, just because an Israelite person had a defiling skin problem, it did not necessarily mean that the person had a serious medical disease. Yahweh wanted the Israelite people to be ritually clean so that the Israelites could be near to Yahweh and worship Yahweh. The main concern was whether the Israelite people were ready spiritually to obey and follow Yahweh. In biblical times, it was common for Israelite people to assume that a person had a physical disease because Yahweh wanted to punish that person.

In the past, translators have often translated the idea of "defiling skin disease" as leprosy. You will remember from the previous passage that scholars believe that it is very unlikely that the skin diseases in this passage are modern leprosy. Instead, the phrase "defiling skin disease" likely refers to an entire group or category of skin diseases. In this passage, Yahweh talks about a person with a defiling skin disease.

In this passage, Yahweh explains that an Israelite person who has a white spot on their skin must go to the priest for an examination. If the priest looks at the person's skin and sees that the white spot on the person's skin is a dull white color, the priest will declare the person to be ritually clean. Many scholars think this refers to a common skin disease.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a person with this common skin disease, called vitiligo. Pause the audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh also gives instructions for how a priest will determine whether or not a man who is balding, or losing his hair, is ritually clean or ritually dirty. In the last passage, Leviticus 13:29–37, Yahweh gave instructions to the priests on how to know if a person's head sore was a defiling skin disease. In that passage, Yahweh says the priest will look for areas of the head and beard that were not growing normal hair. Yahweh clarifies in this passage that the way a man loses his hair as the man grows older does not make the man ritually dirty. However, if the man is losing hair in his face or beard due to a skin sore, then the priest should use the same rules as before. If the person has a skin sore that is red, white, or pink, or in the same way as the ones Yahweh described in the last passage, the person is ritually dirty.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a man who is balding. Pause the audio here.

Leviticus 13:38–46

Stop here and look at the pictures of the same types of skin sores we talked about in the previous passage, ringworm and favus. These are the possible defiling diseases in this passage. Pause the audio here.

At the end of this passage, Yahweh gives instructions for how a person who is ritually dirty with a defiling skin disease should act. The person with the defiling skin disease must wear torn clothes and have messy hair. Israelite people did these two actions when the people were mourning. The person with the defiling skin disease must rip their clothes and not comb their hair to show that the person is distressed and very sad because the person is ritually dirty.

Yahweh also says that the person with the defiling skin disease must cover their mustache, mouth, or the lower part of their face. This is another sign of mourning. Israelites do these actions to mourn the death of a family member or to show sadness because Yahweh had punished someone who sinned. The emphasis is that the person is very sad.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, how do people mourn or show extreme sadness? For what reasons do people mourn in your culture? Pause the audio here.

The person with the defiling skin disease must also say, “ritually dirty,” or “I am ritually dirty!” to any people who come near. These words are a warning so that other people stay away and do not accidentally become ritually dirty by touching the ritually dirty person.

The person also must live alone, outside the camp, as long as that person is ritually dirty. That person must not join in any community events or celebrations. That person must not visit or touch their family members. A person would be very upset if they must live in isolation, away from their family, friends, and everyone the person knows.

Probably one of the reasons why an Israelite person would mourn when the person had a defiling skin disease is that the person would lose everything and everyone in their life. The person would mourn as if a person were dead. In a way, the person with a defiling skin disease mourned as if they themselves were dead, because that person had lost everything that person had. The person lost their relationships, their family members, and their way of life. For ancient Israelites, if a person lost their family, that person had lost all safety and protection, that person had lost their status, and that person had lost their dignity.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, can the community reject someone and force that person out of the community? When does this happen? How would you feel if your community rejected you? Pause this audio here.

When a priest declares that an Israelite person is ritually dirty from a skin disease, this is probably a sort of public proclamation. It is important for other Israelite people to know when someone is ritually dirty, because other people can become ritually dirty by being in contact with the ritually dirty person.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:38–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh explains what to do if an Israelite person has a white spot on their skin. The person with the white spot must go to the priest for an examination. If the priest looks at the person’s skin and sees that the white spot on the person’s skin is a dull white color, the priest will declare the person to be ritually clean.

In the second scene: Yahweh explains what to do if an Israelite man has balding on his head, which means the man has a spot on his head where no hair will grow. An Israelite man with normal balding is ritually clean. However, if the Israelite man has a bald spot because the man has a red, pink, or white sore on his head, then the man is ritually dirty with a defiling skin disease. The priest must look at the man’s head and decide whether or not the man with the bald spot on his head is ritually clean or ritually dirty.

Leviticus 13:38–46

In the third scene: Yahweh gives instructions for how a person who is ritually dirty with a defiling skin disease should act. The person with the defiling skin disease must wear torn clothes and have messy hair. The person with the defiling skin disease must also cover the lower part of their face and say, “I am ritually dirty!” to any people who come near. The person must live this way as long as the person is ritually dirty. The person also must live alone, outside of the camp, and away from ritually clean people.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- An Israelite person with a dull white spot on their skin
- A priest who examines people with concerning skin problems
- An Israelite man who is balding
- And an Israelite person with a defiling skin disease

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage’s setting:

Note that the storyteller does not mention Yahweh, Moses, and Aaron in this passage. But at the beginning of Leviticus 13, the storyteller says that Yahweh first gave these instructions to Moses and Aaron.

In the first scene, Yahweh explains what to do if an Israelite person has a white spot on their skin. In the original language, it says something similar to “white bright-spots bright-spots.” Yahweh says the word “bright spots” two times to emphasize it. This probably means white blotches, or large areas of discolored skin.

So the person with the white spots must go to the priest for an examination. The priest will look at the person’s skin and may see that the white spot on the person’s skin is a dull white color. In this case, the word dull refers to a faint change in color. Sometimes people translate the phrase “harmless rash” as “rash,” but what it means is a skin condition that is harmless and not deep in the skin. Many scholars think this refers to a common human skin condition.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a person with vitiligo. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss: Have you seen this skin condition before? In your language, how do you talk about a person who has this skin condition? Pause this audio here.

In a situation like this, the priest declares the person to be ritually clean.

In the second scene, Yahweh talks about when an Israelite man has balding on his head, which means the man has a spot on his head where no hair will grow. People who speak different languages might use different phrases to refer to a man who is balding. One person might say, “The man’s hair has fallen out of his head.” Another person might say, “The man is losing his hair,” and another, “The man’s hair is bare.” In this passage, Yahweh specifies that the baldness is on the front of the man’s head, above the man’s forehead.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a man who is balding. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, what words do you use to describe a man who is balding or losing his hair? Pause this audio here.

An Israelite man with typical balding is ritually clean. However, if the Israelite man has a bald spot because the man has a red, pink, or white sore on his head, then the man is ritually dirty with a defiling skin disease. The priest must look at the man’s head and decide whether or not the man with the bald spot on his head is ritually clean or ritually dirty. If the man has a sore on his head, the priest will declare that the man is ritually dirty.

In the third scene, Yahweh gives instructions for how a person who is ritually dirty with a defiling skin disease should act. In this passage, Yahweh mentions something that any person with a defiling skin disease must do. Some translations use the term “leper,” however, this is likely to give the wrong impression, since the defiling skin disease is not the same thing as modern-day leprosy. Because of this, it is better to translate this phrase as “any person with a defiling skin disease.”

Stop here and discuss: In your language, what is the phrase you use for “defiling skin disease”? In your language, what is the simplest way to refer to a person who has a defiling skin disease? Is there a name you can call that person that will make sense to people who are listening to the passage for the first time? Pause this audio here.

The person with the defiling skin disease must wear torn clothes and have messy hair. Israelite people did these two actions when the people were mourning. The person with the defiling skin disease must rip their clothes and not comb their hair to show that the person is distressed and very sad because the person is ritually dirty. Also, a person would be very upset if the person must live in isolation, away from their family, friends, and everyone they know.

Stop here and discuss: Imagine that someone told you that you must live away from everyone you know. No one can touch you or come close to you. In your language, describe how you would feel. How would you tell your family? What would you do? Pause the audio here.

Stop here and discuss: Now imagine that a family member that you love told you they must live away from all people. No one can touch that person or come close to that person. In your language, what would you tell your family member? How would you tell the rest of your family? Pause the audio here.

Yahweh also says that the person with the defiling skin disease must cover their mustache. This was another sign of mourning. Since this instruction was for men and women, it may be helpful to translate this as “mouth” or “the lower part of their face.” The emphasis is that the person is very sad.

The person with the defiling skin disease must also say, “ritually dirty” or, “I am ritually dirty!” to any people who come near. These words are a warning so that other people stay away and do not become ritually dirty.

Stop here and discuss: How do you warn someone in your language? How would you tell someone to stay away from something or someone that people must not go near? Pause the audio here.

The person must do these things—wear torn clothes, have messy hair, cover the lower part of their face, and shout “I am ritually dirty!”—as long as the person is ritually dirty. The person also must live alone, outside the camp and away from ritually clean people, as long as that person is ritually dirty.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:38–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- An Israelite person with a dull white spot on their skin
- A priest who examines people with concerning skin problems
- An Israelite man who is balding
- And an Israelite person with a defiling skin disease

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

Leviticus 13:38–46

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh explains what to do if an Israelite person has a white spot on their skin. The person with the white spot must go to the priest for an examination. If the priest looks at the person's skin and sees that the white spot on the person's skin is a dull white color, the priest will declare the person to be ritually clean.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite person with the dull white spot, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so relieved that I am still ritually clean; or
- I worry that people will think I am ritually dirty; or
- I wonder why Yahweh made me this way.

Continue the drama.

In the second scene, Yahweh talks about when an Israelite man has balding on his head, which means the man has a spot on his head where no hair will grow. An Israelite man with typical balding is ritually clean.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite bald man who is ritually clean, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that I do not have hair; or
- I am envious of others who are not bald; or
- I am grateful that I have lived long enough to become bald.

Continue the drama.

However, if the Israelite man has a bald spot because the man has a red, pink, or white sore on his head, then the man is ritually dirty with a defiling skin disease. The priest must look at the man's head and decide whether or not the man with the bald spot on his head is ritually clean or ritually dirty.

In the third scene, Yahweh gives instructions for how a person who is ritually dirty with a defiling skin disease should act. The person with the defiling skin disease must wear torn clothes and have messy hair. The person with the defiling skin disease must also cover the lower part of their face and say, "I am ritually dirty!" to any people who come near. The person must live this way as long as the person is ritually dirty. The person also must live alone, outside of the camp, and away from ritually clean people.

Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite person with the defiling skin disease, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so sad! I can never see my family or friends; or
- I am scared others will mock me; or
- I do not know how I will be able to live in the wilderness by myself;
- What if I never get better?

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:38–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, the **priests** will decide if a person with a skin disease is ritually dirty or not. Use the same word for priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

Leviticus 13:47–59

Yahweh gives instructions to the priests to determine whether or not an Israelite person was **ritually dirty** because of their skin disease. Use the same word or phrase throughout for ritually **clean** and ritually dirty as you used in previous passages. For more information on clean and unclean, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh instructs the priests to determine whether an Israelite person has a **defiling skin disease**. If the person has a defiling skin disease, the person is ritually dirty. Use the same word or phrase for "defiling skin disease" as you used in previous passages. For more information on **leprosy**, an old term for defiling skin disease, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and look at the pictures of possible defiling skin diseases. Pause this audio here.

A person with a defiling skin disease must live outside the Israelite camp, or the group of tents where all the Israelites lived. Use the same word or phrase for camp as you have used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 13:47–59

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 13:47–59 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:47–59 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:47–59 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh was giving Moses and Aaron instructions on how the Israelite people were supposed to live in good relationship with Yahweh. At this time, the Israelite people were still camping at Mount Sinai, where the people had recently built the Tent of Meeting according to Yahweh's instructions. Here, in this passage, Yahweh is giving Moses and Aaron instructions for the priests on how to determine what to do if a person's moldy garment is ritually dirty. The priests must decide whether a person may clean the garment or not.

Remember, to be ritually clean or ritually dirty was not actually about physical cleanliness. Yahweh wanted the Israelite people to be ritually clean so that the Israelites could be near to Yahweh and worship Yahweh. The main concern was whether the Israelite people were ready spiritually to obey and follow Yahweh. Even the animals and things around the Israelite people needed to be ritually clean.

In this passage, Yahweh explains how an Israelite person with a moldy garment of wool, linen, or leather must bring the garment to the priest so the priest can examine it. The word "garment" means clothing, covering, or fabric.

Stop here and discuss: Describe the kinds of clothes that people commonly wear in your culture. Pay attention to the words you use to describe clothing. Pause this audio here.

It is unlikely that Yahweh's rules in this passage are only for clothes. These rules are probably for anything that people make from wool, linen, or leather. A person makes woolen garments out of a sheep's coat or fur. A person makes linen garments out of the stems of the flax plant. A person makes leather garments out of animal skins. These rules are for the materials. It does not matter what people made with the materials.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of wool, linen, and leather. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss: There are three main materials in this passage: wool, linen, and leather. In your culture, what materials do people use to make clothes or fabrics? How do people use these materials to make other items besides clothes? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh talks about mold in the "warp or woof" of the woven fabric. Weavers use these terms to talk about the different threads that weavers use to make fabric. These are the threads that go in different directions. But many scholars do not think this is what these words mean. Many scholars think that Yahweh is talking about any kind of woven fabric. This means that this rule is for any fabric that a person weaves, no matter what method the person uses to weave or create the fabric.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of ancient weaving techniques. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, what are common ways that people weave fabric? If people in your culture do not weave fabric, discuss your own process for making cloth and fabric. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh mentions two kinds of molds that can be present in garments: greenish mold and reddish mold. The term for "reddish" is actually "reddish-white." It is likely that this refers to pink mold, which is bacteria that often grows on damp fabric and leather.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of green and red mold in fabric and leather. Pause this audio here.

For the Israelite people, being ritually clean was also about being whole or complete. Many of these rules might have seemed inconvenient or perhaps sometimes unnecessary. There may have been times when the Israelite people heard Yahweh's rules and thought, "Why is Yahweh asking us to do so much?" Yahweh wanted the Israelite people to fully commit to being Yahweh's people. The Israelite people needed to decide that being close to Yahweh was more important than anything else. The Israelites also needed to trust Yahweh to tell the Israelites what to do and to believe Yahweh enough to do it, even when the Israelites did not like or understand the instructions.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about a time when you had to do something hard or inconvenient in order to obey Yahweh.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:47–59 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh explains how an Israelite person with a moldy garment of wool, linen, or leather must bring the garment to the priest so the priest can examine the garment. This is the first examination. If green or red mold is present, the priest will isolate the garment for seven days.

In the second scene: The priest will examine the garment for the second time. If the mold has spread or gotten worse in the garment, it is an active defiling mold, and the garment is ritually dirty. So someone must destroy the garment with fire. But if the mold has not spread or not gotten worse, then the priest will tell the person to wash the garment. Then the priest will isolate the garment for another seven days.

In the third scene: After another seven days, the priest will tell the person to wash the garment again. Then the priest must examine the garment for a third time. If the mold has not changed in the garment, even though the mold did not spread, the garment is ritually dirty, and the person must burn the garment. If the mold faded, the priest must tear off the part of the garment that has the mold. If the mold reappears, a person must burn the garment. If a priest declares that a garment that was ritually dirty has become ritually clean again, a person must wash the garment another time, even though the person had already washed the garment for the examinations.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- An Israelite person who has a moldy garment
- And an Israelite priest who examines the moldy garment

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Note that the storyteller does not mention Yahweh, Moses, and Aaron in this passage. But at the beginning of Leviticus 13, the storyteller says that Yahweh first gave these instructions to Moses and Aaron.

In the first scene, Yahweh says that an Israelite person with a moldy garment of wool, linen, or leather must bring the garment to the priest so the priest can examine the garment. The word "garment" can mean any type of clothing. However, the focus of this passage is mainly about Yahweh's rule for the kind of material. So people probably use these same rules for anything that a person made from wool, linen, or leather. You may wish to use a broader term in your language, perhaps one that means "cloth" or "fabric." The original word meant something like "covering," which can be another word for many kinds of woven things.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, what words can you use for the word "garment"? Is there a word that can describe things that people make out of wool, linen, or leather? Pause the audio here.

So far in Leviticus 13, Yahweh has instructed the priests to determine what to do if an Israelite person has a defiling skin disease. In this passage, Yahweh uses similar language for defiling marks of mold and mildew in fabric and leather. Later, in Leviticus 14, Yahweh uses similar language for defiling marks of mold or mildew that grows on walls in houses. Most languages cannot use the same words for each of these kinds of defiling problems.

Stop here and discuss: Describe a person who has a skin disease. Then describe a person who has moldy clothes. Then describe a person who has a home or shelter with mold. Pay attention to what words you use to describe each of these situations. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh mentions three kinds of garments. People make woolen garments out of a sheep's coat or fur. People make linen garments out of the stems of the flax plant. People make leather garments by stretching out animal skins and drying the skins. There might still be hair on the animal skins, or the person might take the hair off the animal skin.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of wool, linen, and leather. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, what do you call each of these types of materials? What do you call things that people make out of these materials? Pause this audio here.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of ancient weaving techniques. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, how do you talk about the different ways that people make fabrics? Pause this audio here.

The priest will look at the moldy garment. This is the first examination. If green or red mold is present, the priest will isolate the garment for seven days.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of green and red mold in fabric and leather. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, the priest will examine the garment for the second time. If the mold has spread or gotten worse in the garment, it is an active defiling mold. An active defiling mold can mean “persistent” because the mold keeps coming back. It can mean “destructive” or “rotting” because it ruins the clothes. It can mean that no person can make the mold go away. Since the garment is ritually dirty in such a bad way, the priest must order that a person should destroy the garment in fire.

But if the mold has not spread or not gotten worse, then the priest will tell the person to wash the garment. Then the priest will isolate the garment for another seven days.

In the third scene, after another seven days, it is likely that the priest tells the person to wash the garment again. Then the priest will examine the garment for a third time. If the mold has not changed in the garment, even though the mold did not spread, the garment is ritually dirty, and the person must burn the garment. There is a phrase here that means something like “on the front or back.” Other ways to say this would be “it does not matter if the mold is on one side or the other side” or “whether the mold is on the inside or outside.”

If the mold has faded after the person washed the garment, the priest must tear off the part of the garment that has the mold. If the mold reappears, a person must burn the garment. If a priest declares that a garment that was ritually dirty has become ritually clean again, a person must wash the garment another time, even though the person had already washed the garment for the examinations.

Yahweh ends this section with a summary statement that these are the rules for how priests should declare moldy clothes as ritually clean or ritually dirty.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:47–59 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- An Israelite person who has a moldy garment
- And an Israelite priest who examines the moldy garment

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh says that an Israelite person with a moldy garment of wool, linen, or leather must bring the garment to the priest so the priest can examine the garment. This is the first examination. If green or red mold is present, the priest will isolate the garment for seven days. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite person with the moldy garment, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- That garment is special to me. I hope I do not need to destroy the garment; or
- I blame my brother for ruining my garment; or
- I do not like mold.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, the priest will examine the garment for the second time. If the mold has spread or gotten worse in the garment, the mold is an active defiling mold, and the garment is ritually dirty. So someone must destroy the garment with fire. But if the mold has not spread or not gotten worse, then the priest will tell the person to wash the garment. Then the priest will isolate the garment for another seven days.

In the third scene, after another seven days, the priest most likely tells the person to wash the garment again. Then the priest will examine the garment for a third time. If the mold has not changed in the garment, even though the mold did not spread, the garment is ritually dirty, and the person must burn the garment. If the mold has faded after the person washed the garment, the priest must tear off the part of the garment that has the mold. If the mold reappears, a person must burn the garment. If a priest declares that a garment that was ritually dirty has become ritually clean again, a person must wash the garment another time, even though the person had already washed the garment for the examinations. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite person with the moldy garment that is now ritually clean again, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am happy; or
- I need to go wash the garment; or
- I will not lend this to my brother again. My brother caused the garment to become moldy, and someone spent a lot of time to make this garment!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 13:47–59 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh instructs the priests on what to do if a person’s garment, clothing, or cloth has mold. Yahweh mentions three kinds of garments. People make woolen garments out of a sheep’s coat or fur. People make linen garments out of the stems of the flax plant. Use the same word or phrase for linen as you used in previous passages. People also weave pieces of wool and flax together to make woven cloth. People make leather garments out of animal skins or pelts. Use the same word or phrase throughout for woolen garment, linen garment, and leather garment.

Stop here and look at pictures of wool, linen, and leather as a group. Discuss what words you will use for wool and linen garments, woven wool and linen garments, and leather. Pause this audio here.

So far in Leviticus 13, Yahweh has instructed the priests to determine what to do if an Israelite person had a defiling skin disease. In this passage, Yahweh uses similar language for defiling marks of mold or mildew in cloth and leather.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of moldy fabric and moldy leather. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **defiling marks** or **defiling mold**. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the **priests** must look closely at a moldy piece of fabric or a moldy piece of leather to determine if the garment is ritually dirty or not. Use the same word for priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh gives instructions to the priests to determine whether or not a moldy piece of fabric or a moldy piece of leather is **ritually dirty**. Use the same word or phrase throughout for ritually **clean** and ritually dirty as you used in previous passages. For more information about clean and unclean, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 13:47–59

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (918 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 14:1–9

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 14:1–9 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:1–9 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

Leviticus 14:1–9

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh was giving Moses instructions on how the Israelite people were supposed to live in good relationship with Yahweh. At this point in time, the Israelite people were still camping at Mount Sinai, where people had recently built the Tent of Meeting according to Yahweh's instructions. Here, in this passage, Yahweh gives Moses instructions for the priests to perform ceremonial cleansings for people, or purify people whose defiling skin disease has healed. The person must go through the ceremonial cleansing before the person is ritually clean again.

Please remember that the ceremonial cleansings do not heal the person. The priest does not do the ceremonial cleansing until after the person with the defiling skin disease is already healed. Remember, for an Israelite person to be ritually clean or ritually dirty was not actually about physical cleanliness. In the same way, just because an Israelite person had a defiling skin problem did not necessarily mean that the person had a serious medical disease. Before the priest agrees to do the ceremonial cleansing, the priest visits the ritually dirty person to make sure that the person is healed and ready for cleansing.

Yahweh wanted the Israelite people to be ritually clean so that the Israelites could be near to Yahweh and worship Yahweh. The main concern was whether the Israelite people were ready spiritually to obey and follow Yahweh. The priest did the ceremonial cleansing so that the person could be ritually clean again and be part of the community again. Yahweh gave the Israelites this process of ceremonial cleansing so that a person who used to be separate from the community had a way to come back into the community.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, what kind of person does the community reject? What do people say and think about these people? How can that person become a part of the community again? Pause this audio here.

The ceremonial cleansing must take place outside the camp or away from the area where people live. This is because the person who was ritually dirty is not allowed to be in the areas where people live. So the priest and anyone else who was part of the ceremony have to come outside the camp to the ritually dirty person.

The priest will tell someone to bring two birds, cedar wood, scarlet thread, and hyssop plant. The two birds must be alive and must be ritually clean birds.

The priest must use three items to sprinkle the blood and water onto the person who is going through ceremonial cleansing: cedar wood, scarlet thread, and hyssop.

Cedar wood is a strong-smelling wood that has a reddish-brown or sometimes tan color. Since ancient times, people have used cedar wood for its ability to preserve things, to purify, and even to keep away bugs. Many people think cedar wood smells nice.

Many scholars think the scarlet thread is a thread or string that a person dyed red. To do this, a person would collect a certain kind of red insect. The person would make the red dye from this insect, and then would put threads and fabrics in the dye to make the threads and fabrics red. The person would already have made and dried the scarlet threads. So the priest will tell someone to go get some of the scarlet thread for the ceremonial cleansing.

Hyssop is a plant that has woody stems and green leaves. People used this plant in the ancient world for purification and for medicine. The priest probably uses the hyssop to sprinkle the blood. Remember, the Israelite people used hyssop to put the lamb's blood on their doors for the Passover in Exodus. It is possible that when the priest would use the hyssop to sprinkle the blood, the priest or the other Israelites would think of the Passover.

Someone will kill one of the birds and catch its blood in a clay pot of spring water. Spring water is water that comes from a flowing or moving water source, like a river or spring.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a clay pot. Pause this audio here.

The priest must dip the live bird in the blood and water mixture in the clay pot. The priest also dips the cedar wood, the scarlet thread, and the hyssop plant in the bird's blood and water mixture. The priest must use the cedar wood, the scarlet thread, and the hyssop plant to sprinkle the bird's blood and water mixture on the ritually dirty person. Then the priest will tell the person, "You are ritually clean again!"

Then the priest must release the live bird and let the bird fly away in an open field. That probably just means that the bird flies away from the Israelite people's tents and living areas. Later in Leviticus, Yahweh will give instructions to the priests about the scapegoat, which a person would also release in the wilderness. It is possible that when the priest releases the bird into the wilderness, the bird reminds the Israelite people of when a person releases the scapegoat into the wilderness.

Then the person must shave or take all the hair off their head and all the hair off their body. The person also must wash their clothes and their body in water.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, do people regularly shave or remove their head hair? If so, what does it mean when a person does that? Why do you think the Israelite person had to shave their head? Pause this audio here.

After shaving and washing, the person can go inside the camp, but the person must wait seven more days before they can go back and live in their own tent again. After the seven days, the person must shave or remove all the hair from their body again. The person must wash their clothes and take a bath again. In the next parts of the chapter, Yahweh also gives instructions for the sacrifices that the priest must make on the eighth day as part of the ceremonial cleansing. Then the person will be fully ritually clean.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh gives Moses instructions about how a person whose defiling skin disease has healed can become ritually clean again.

In the second scene: Yahweh says the priest must examine the person with the defiling skin disease to determine that the person is healed. Then, people must prepare for the ceremonial cleansing. Someone must bring two ritually clean birds and kill one of the birds. The priest must dip the live bird in the dead bird's blood and water mixture. The priest also dips the special items in the bird's blood and water mixture. The priest will sprinkle the bird's blood and water mixture on the ritually dirty person with special items. Then the priest will declare that the person is ritually clean again. Then the priest will release the live bird and let the bird fly away.

In the third scene: After the priest tells the person, "You are ritually clean again!" the person must wash their clothes and shave or remove all the hair from their body. Then the person will be ritually clean and can come into the camp or area where people live. But the person must wait seven more days before the person can go back and live in their own tent again. After the seven days, the person must shave or remove all the hair from their body again. The person must wash their clothes and take a bath. Then the person is fully ritually clean.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The healed Israelite person who needs ceremonial cleansing
- And an Israelite priest

Leviticus 14:1–9

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Yahweh gives Moses the law about how a person whose defiling skin disease has healed can become ritually clean again. Yahweh's laws are special sets of instructions or rules. In this passage, Yahweh says these words to Moses. Then Moses will tell everyone else Yahweh's words. Moses also writes these words down so the Israelite people will always know Yahweh's instructions.

If a person with a defiling skin disease has healed and is ready to be ritually clean again, the person has to go through a ceremonial cleansing before the person is ritually clean again. This ceremony is for ritual cleansing for spiritual purposes, not to heal the person or physically clean the person. Sometimes people call this process a purification process. Use a word in your language that shows that this process is for spiritual cleansing. This original phrase means "day of cleansing," but the ceremonial cleansing actually took a whole week to complete.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, what will you call the ceremonial cleansing? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh says the priest must examine the person with the concerning skin disease or problem to determine that the person is healed. The priest only does the ceremonial cleansing for people who are already healthy, not to try to heal people from their disease. Once the priest determines that the person is healed, the priest will prepare for the ceremonial cleansing.

The priest will tell someone to bring two birds, cedar wood, scarlet thread, and hyssop plant. The two birds must be alive and must be ritually clean birds. The word in the original language for bird means "sparrow," but here it probably means any kind of small bird.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a sparrow. Pause this audio here.

The priest will use three items to sprinkle the blood and water onto the person who is going through ceremonial cleansing: cedar wood, scarlet thread, and hyssop.

Cedar wood is a strong-smelling wood that is reddish-brown or sometimes tan-colored. Someone probably cut this cedar wood into a small enough piece for a person to hold easily in one hand.

Many scholars think the scarlet thread is a thread or string that a person dyed red. The priest would probably use the scarlet thread to tie the cedar wood and the hyssop together.

Hyssop is a plant that has woody stems and green leaves. People used this plant in the ancient world for purification and for medicine.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of cedar wood, scarlet thread, and hyssop. Pause this audio here.

Someone must also bring a clay pot full of spring water. Spring water is water that comes from a flowing or moving water source. The priest will tell someone to kill one of the birds over the clay pot of water, so that the bird's blood falls into the pot too. The priest will use the bird's blood and water mixture in this process a few times. We will call this the bird's blood and water mixture. You will need to decide what to call this in your language.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, what will you call this bird's blood and water mixture? Pause this audio here.

The priest must dip the live bird in the blood and water mixture. The priest also dips the cedar wood, the scarlet thread, and the hyssop plant in the bird's blood and water mixture. The priest probably dips all these things together into the blood and water mixture.

The priest must use the cedar wood, the scarlet thread, and the hyssop plant to sprinkle the bird's blood and water mixture on the ritually dirty person. Then the priest will tell the person, "You are ritually clean again!" Notice this is only the first step of the person becoming ritually clean again. The person will have to wait seven more days and do more things before the person will be fully ritually clean again and ready to go home.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, talk about a process, ceremony, or ritual that takes days to complete. Notice the language you use to talk about things that happen at different times or different parts of the process. Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 14:1–9

Then the priest must release the live bird and let the bird fly away in an open field. That probably just means away from the Israelite people's tents and living areas.

Then the person must shave or take all the hair off their head and all the hair off their body. The person also must wash their clothes and their body in water.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, how do people usually remove head hair and body hair? Pause this audio here.

The person will then be clean enough to enter the camp and to be around people again. But the person cannot go back to live in their tent with their family yet.

After seven days or one week of living in the camp among people, the person must shave or take all the hair off their head and all the hair off their body again. Yahweh lists the hair on a person's head: the person must shave off the hair on their head, beard, and even eyebrows! Then the person must wash their clothes and their bodies with water again.

In the next parts of the chapter, Yahweh will give instructions for the sacrifices that the priest must make on the eighth day as part of the ceremonial cleansing. Then the person will be fully ritually clean and can go back to live in their tent with their family.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The healed Israelite person who needs ceremonial cleansing
- And an Israelite priest

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh is giving Moses instructions about how a person whose defiling skin disease has healed can become ritually clean again. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so happy that people can become ritually clean again! or
- The priests will be happy to perform this ceremony.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh says the priest must examine the person with the defiling skin condition to determine that the person has healed. Then, people must prepare for the ceremonial cleansing.

Leviticus 14:1–9

Someone must bring two ritually clean birds and kill one of the birds. The priest must dip the live bird in the dead bird's blood and water mixture. The priest must also dip the special items in the bird's blood and water mixture. The priest must sprinkle the bird's blood and water mixture on the ritually dirty person with special items. Then the priest will declare that the person is ritually clean again. Then the priest will release the live bird and let the bird fly away. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the person having the ceremonial cleansing, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so excited to see my family. It has been a long time; or
- I am nervous about what people will say about me; or
- I want the week to be over so I can go home.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, after the priest tells the person, "You are ritually clean again!" the person must wash their clothes and shave or remove all the hair from their body. Then the person will be ritually clean and can come into the camp or area where people live. But the person must wait seven more days before the person can go back and live in their own tent again. After the seven days, the person must shave or remove all the hair from their body again. The person must wash their clothes and take a bath. Then the person will be fully ritually clean. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the person having the ceremonial cleansing, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want to go celebrate! or
- I have waited for so long to be healed, and now I do not have to wait anymore! or
- I am so happy and content.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh is giving Moses instructions about how a person who is healed from a defiling skin disease can become ritually clean again. Use the same word for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

These special instructions are Yahweh's **laws**, which can mean rules or instructions. Use the same word for Yahweh's laws that you have used in previous passages. Look up law in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh instructs the priests to help an Israelite person who had a **defiling skin disease**. If the person had a defiling skin disease, the person was ritually dirty. For more information on **leprosy**, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for "defiling skin disease" as you have in previous passages.

Stop here and look at pictures of possible defiling skin diseases as a group. Pause this audio here.

The priest must meet the person outside the **camp** for this ceremony. A camp is a settlement of tents or temporary shelters for people to live in. Use the same word for camp as you used in previous passages.

If a person whose defiling skin disease has healed is ready to be ritually clean again, the person has to go through a ceremonial cleansing, or purification ceremony, before the person is ritually clean again. In this passage, Yahweh gives instructions for how to do a ceremonial cleansing.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **ceremonial cleansing**. For more information, refer to **purification ceremony** in the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the **priests** do the ceremony for the person who has healed. Use the same word for priest as you have used previously, and for more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

In this passage, Yahweh gives instructions to the priests to do a ceremony for an Israelite person who was **ritually dirty** because of their skin disease. Use the same word or phrase throughout for ritually **clean** and ritually dirty as you used in previous passages. For more information on clean and unclean, refer to the Master Glossary.

People bring birds for the ceremonial cleansings. In the original language, the word means "sparrow," but here it probably means any kind of small bird. These birds must be ritually clean birds.

Leviticus 14:1–9

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a sparrow. Pause this audio here.

The priest uses three items to sprinkle the blood and water onto the person who is going through ceremonial cleansing: cedar wood, scarlet thread, and hyssop.

Cedar wood is a strong-smelling wood that is reddish-brown or sometimes tan-colored. Since ancient times, people have used cedar wood for its ability to preserve things, to purify, and even to keep away bugs. Many people think cedar wood smells nice. Someone probably cut this cedar wood into a small enough piece for a person to hold easily in one hand. If you have already translated a word for cedar wood in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Many scholars think the **scarlet thread** is a thread or string that a person dyed red. The person would make the dye from a certain kind of insect. The priest would probably use the scarlet thread to tie the cedar wood and the hyssop together. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Hyssop is a plant that has woody stems and green leaves. People used this plant in the ancient world for purification and medicinal purposes. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of cedar wood, scarlet thread, and hyssop. Discuss what words you will use for these items. Pause this audio here.

The priest has to **dip** the live bird in the dead bird's blood and the water mixture. The priest also has to dip the cedar wood, the scarlet thread, and the hyssop into the bird's blood and water mixture. This means the priest puts these things in the bird's blood and water mixture and brings the items out quickly. Use the same word for this motion that you used earlier in Leviticus 4.

The priest had to **sprinkle** or **splash** the water with the blood of the sacrifice onto the person who was ritually dirty with a defiling skin disease. Use the same word or phrase for sprinkle as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 14:1–9

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (906 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 14:10–20

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 14:10–20 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:10–20 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:10–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh has been giving Moses instructions on how the Israelite people are supposed to live in good relationship with Yahweh. At this time, the Israelite people were still camping at Mount Sinai, where people had recently built the Tent of Meeting according to Yahweh's instructions. Here, in this passage, Yahweh is giving Moses instructions for the priests to perform ceremonial cleansings, or purification, for people whose defiling skin disease has healed. The person must go through the ceremonial cleansing before the person is ritually clean again.

Please note that the ceremonial cleansings did not heal the person. The priest did not do the ceremonial cleansing until after the person with the defiling skin disease had already healed. Remember, for an Israelite person to be ritually clean or ritually dirty was not actually about physical cleanliness. In the same way, just because an Israelite person had a defiling skin problem did not necessarily mean that the person had a serious medical disease. Before the priest agreed to do the ceremonial cleansing, the priest would go visit the ritually dirty person to make sure that the person was healed and ready for cleansing.

Yahweh wanted the Israelite people to be ritually clean so that the Israelites could be near to Yahweh and worship Yahweh. The main concern was whether the Israelite people were ready spiritually to obey and follow Yahweh. The priest did the ceremonial cleansing so that the person could be ritually clean again and be part of the community again. Yahweh gave the Israelite person this process of ceremonial cleansing so that a person who used to be separate from the community had a way to come back into the community.

The first part of the ceremonial cleansing would happen outside the camp, away from the area where people lived. But the second part of the ceremonial cleansing would happen a week later at the Tent of Meeting. This passage is about the second part of the ceremonial cleansing. The person had to offer all the main kinds of sacrifices: a burnt offering, a sin or purification offering, a guilt offering, which included the wave offering, and

a grain offering. The only offering that the person did not need to include was the fellowship or peace offering, which was usually an offering that a person gave on their own because the person wanted to give the offering. This means that Yahweh did not require the fellowship offering from people.

Here is a reminder of the process that the priest went through to make the guilt offering. Usually, the person brought an animal to the Tent of Meeting and laid their hands on the animal's head. The person also usually publicly confessed their sin. In cases of defiling skin diseases, it is unclear whether or not the person confessed something. In ancient times, people thought that disease was a direct result of a god's punishment. Although there are times in the Bible when it says Yahweh punishes someone with a skin disease, such as when Yahweh gave Miriam leprosy, the Bible also encourages people not to assume that disease or disaster was a result of someone's sin. So we do not know whether ancient Israelites would confess a sin when someone made this sacrifice for a defiling skin disease. Then the priest would kill the animal, and someone would catch the blood in a bowl. Although the storyteller does not say this information here, we know that the priest would throw some of the blood on the altar. For this ceremony, the priest would also put the blood on the person's right earlobe, on the thumb of the person's right hand, and on the big toe of the person's right foot. The priest does a similar thing with the one-third liter of oil that the person would bring. In this way, the priest makes atonement for the person who has been healed.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, are there any rituals that involve marking a person's body with a liquid? If so, describe what is similar or different in your rituals compared to the ritual for this kind of guilt offering. If not, talk about what you think people in your culture would think about this kind of ritual. Pause this audio here.

The priest also offered a wave offering of the sheep for the guilt offering and the container of olive oil. The wave offering was not a separate offering but more of a special movement that the priests did with some of the offerings.

Here is a reminder of the full process that the priest went through to make the purification offering, although in this passage the storyteller does not state everything the priest did: First, the priest would sacrifice the young female sheep for the purification offering. The person who was part of the cleansing ceremony had to place their hand on the head of the young female sheep. After the priest killed the sheep, the priest would collect the sheep's blood in a bowl. The priest would then put the blood on the horns of the altar. The priest also had to take some of the sacrificed animal's fat and organs and burn those parts on the altar.

Here is a reminder of the process that the priest went through to make the whole burnt offering: First, the priest would kill the other young male sheep for the burnt offering. The person who was part of the ritual cleansing ceremony had to put their hand on the head of this sheep, too. Like for the purification offering, the priest had to collect the blood during the sacrifice so that the priest could sprinkle or throw the blood on the altar. The priest then had to skin the dead animal's body and cut the body into pieces. The priest also had to wash the animal's internal organs with water. The priest would put the dead animal's head, fat, and organs on the altar, and the priest would burn the whole sacrifice.

Here is a reminder of the process that the priest went through to make the grain offering: First, the person would present the grain offering to the priest. The priest would take a handful of the wheat flour and oil mixture. The priest would burn the handful of wheat flour mixture on the altar for Yahweh. Then the priest would keep the rest of the flour and oil mixture. For this sacrifice in this passage, the person had to bring three times the normal amount of flour and oil. Some scholars think this might be because the person who was becoming ritually clean was offering three sheep.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:10–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh says that the person who is going through ceremonial cleansing has to bring three sheep—two young male sheep and one young female sheep—to the Tent of Meeting. The person also has to bring a grain offering and a container full of olive oil. The priest who pronounced the person ready to be ritually clean must bring the person and their offerings before Yahweh, that is, in front of the Tent of Meeting.

In the second scene: The priest must offer a guilt offering and a wave offering. The priest will kill one of the young male sheep and collect the blood. The priest must put the sacrificed sheep's blood on the person's right earlobe, the thumb of the person's right hand, and the big toe of the person's right foot. Then the priest must sprinkle the olive oil before Yahweh. The priest also has to put olive oil over the blood on the person's right earlobe, the thumb of the person's right hand, and the big toe of the person's right foot. The priest also must pour the rest of the olive oil on the person's head.

In the third scene: The priest must give the purification offering and the burnt offering using the two other young sheep. The priest must also offer the grain offering. This is how the priest makes atonement for the person who is going through the ceremonial cleansing. After all of this, the person will be fully ritually clean.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The person who needs to complete the ceremonial cleansing
- And the Israelite priest

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Note that the storyteller does not mention Moses in this passage. But at the beginning of Leviticus 14, the storyteller says that Yahweh first gave these instructions to Moses.

In the first scene, Yahweh says the person who is going through ceremonial cleansing must bring three sheep —two young male sheep and one young female sheep. The person must bring these animals on the eighth day after the priest has examined the person outside the camp and first declared that they are clean. For the seven days in between, the person has been in the camp, but not living in their tent. The sheep the person brings must be physically perfect. The sheep could not be sick, hurt, or physically maimed. The person must take these sheep to the Tent of Meeting. Throughout this passage, the storyteller refers to "the person who needs to become ritually clean."

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your language, what word or phrase do you use to refer to people who are ritually dirty? What about people who are ritually clean? What words do you use to refer to the ceremonial cleansing? Talk about what words or phrases you would like to use for a person who is going through ceremonial cleansing. Pause this audio here.

The person also has to bring a grain offering of three-tenths of an ephah of flour mixed with olive oil. An ephah was probably a container that people used to carry and measure flour. It is unclear how much three-tenths of an ephah would weigh. It was possibly about 7 liters and weighed about 5 kilograms. You can use whatever measuring system people normally use to measure dry substances like flour.

Ancient Israelites would usually bring wheat or sometimes barley grain for sacrifices. For the ceremonial cleansing, the Israelite person needs to bring fine flour, which probably refers to wheat flour. Fine flour also means the best quality of flour. If necessary, you can use a more general word for seeds of cultivated grasses that people use to make flour.

The person also needs to bring a container full of olive oil. It is possible that a log of oil was about three-tenths of a liter.

So the person who needs to become ritually clean needs to bring three sheep, three-tenths of an ephah of flour, and a container of oil. The priest who pronounced the person ready to be ritually clean must bring the person and their offerings before Yahweh, that is, in front of the Tent of Meeting.

Next, the priest must offer a guilt offering and a wave offering. First, the priest has to kill one of the young male sheep at the altar of burnt offering. The meat from this offering is "most holy." That means that the only people Yahweh allows to eat the meat from this sacrifice are the priests.

When the priest kills the first young male sheep for the guilt offering, the priest must collect the blood in a bowl or cup. The priest must put the sacrificed sheep's blood on the person's right ear lobe, the thumb on their right hand, and the big toe on their right foot.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of a person's right ear lobe, right thumb, and right big toe. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, what words do you use for these human body parts? Describe a person putting a liquid on these body parts in a ceremonial way. What would you call this action? If helpful, have a person act out the process so you can talk about each step in your language. Pause this audio here.

At some point in the process, the priest also offers a wave offering of the animal or of some of the animal's body parts and the container of olive oil. These body parts are probably the same or similar to the animal's body parts that the priests removed for the wave offering in Exodus 29:19–22. The wave offering is not a separate offering but more of a special movement that the priests do with some of the offerings. The priest will lift the offering up in the air in a special way.

We do not know exactly when the wave offering happens, since Yahweh only mentions the wave offering in the summary statement. The priests usually did wave offerings with the meat or fat portions of the animal, which means the priest would do this offering after the priest killed the animal and before the priest burned the animal fat and animal organs on the altar. However, it is possible the priest did these wave offerings before the priest killed the animal. The next passage suggests that the priest does the wave offering for these offerings before the priest kills the animals.

Then the priest has to sprinkle the olive oil before Yahweh. First, the priest will pour some of the olive oil into the palm of his left hand. Then the priest dips his right forefinger into the olive oil. Then the priest sprinkles the oil seven times before Yahweh.

The priest also has to put olive oil over the blood on the person's right earlobe, the thumb of the person's right hand, and the big toe of the person's right foot. The priest puts the oil on top of the marks of sheep's blood that the priest made on the person's body. The priest must also pour the rest of the olive oil on the head of the person who is becoming ritually clean.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a person dipping their finger in oil. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss: First, as a group, copy the actions that the priest must do with the oil. Make sure to use the left hand to hold the oil and the right hand to sprinkle the oil. Talk about how you would describe this process in your language. Pause this audio here.

The priest makes atonement for the person who is going through the ceremonial cleansing. This means that the priest reconciles the person to Yahweh, and Yahweh covers the person's bad actions.

In the third scene, the priest has to give the purification offering and the burnt offering using the two other young sheep. The priest also has to offer the grain offering. This is how the priest makes atonement for the person who is going through the ceremonial cleansing. After all of this, the person will be fully ritually clean.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:10–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The person who needs to complete the ceremonial cleansing

- And the Israelite priest

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh says the person who is going through ceremonial cleansing must bring three sheep—two young male sheep and one young female sheep—to the Tent of Meeting. The person must also bring a grain offering and a container full of olive oil. The priest who pronounced the person ready to be ritually clean must bring the person and the person's offerings before Yahweh, that is, in front of the Tent of Meeting. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I must make many sacrifices today for the person who wants to be ritually clean; or
- I am happy that this person will finally be able to be in the community again; or
- Yahweh requires much from us. But we learn so much by following Yahweh's rules.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh says the priest must offer a guilt offering and a wave offering. The priest has to kill one of the young male sheep and collect the blood. The priest must put the sacrificed sheep's blood on the person's right earlobe, the thumb of the person's right hand, and the big toe of the person's right foot. Then the priest will sprinkle the olive oil before Yahweh. The priest will also put olive oil over the blood on the person's right earlobe, the thumb of the person's right hand, and the big toe of the person's right foot. The priest will also pour the rest of the olive oil on the person's head. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the person who is becoming ritually clean again, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so excited to be ritually clean again! or
- I cannot wait to live with my family again; or
- I wonder if Yahweh will accept me.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh says the priest must give the purification offering and the burnt offering using the two other young sheep. The priest must also offer the grain offering. This is how the priest makes atonement for the person who is going through the ceremonial cleansing. After all of this, the person will be fully ritually clean. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am satisfied with the sacrifices; or
- This person has waited a long time for me to heal them, but the person never stopped praying to me; or
- Well done, my servants. Today, you remembered my instructions and obeyed.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:10–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The person who offers the ceremonial cleansing sacrifice must bring two **young male sheep**. This means a male sheep that was young, but old enough to have babies. Use the same word for "young male sheep" as you used in previous passages.

Leviticus 14:10–20

The Israelite person must also bring a **young female sheep** for the offering. Use the same word for "young female sheep" as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh told the Israelites that when a person chose any animal for sacrifice, the animal must be healthy. That meant that the animal had no physical defects or was **physically perfect** or blameless. The animal could not be blind or deformed. The animal could not have any injuries or bruises. Use the same word for "physically perfect" that you used in previous passages. For more information, refer to perfect in the Master Glossary.

The Israelite person bringing the sacrifice also needed to bring three-tenths of an ephah of flour for a **grain offering**. Use the same word or phrase for "grain offering" that you used in previous passages. For more information on grain offering, look in the Master Glossary.

An **ephah** was probably a large basket that people used to carry flour. Three-tenths of an ephah probably weighed about 5 kilograms. Use the same word or phrase for ephah that you used in previous passages. For more information on ephah, look in the Master Glossary.

Use the same word for **flour** that you used in previous passages. Remember, this probably refers to wheat flour.

The Israelite person also had to bring a **log of olive oil** for the grain offering. A "log of oil" was probably about one-third of a quart or three-tenths of a liter. Use the same word or phrase for oil that you used in previous passages.

In this passage, the **priest** who declared the person clean in the first part of the ceremonial cleansing was the one who was supposed to kill the animals for the offerings to **Yahweh** to finish the ceremonial cleansing. Use the same words or phrases for "kill an animal," priest, and Yahweh that you have used previously. For more information on priest and Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

In this passage, Yahweh gave instructions to the priests for a ceremony for the Israelite person who was no longer ritually dirty because of their skin disease. Use the same words or phrases throughout for "ritually clean" and "ritually dirty" as you used in previous passages, and refer to **clean and unclean** in the Master Glossary for more information.

Use the same phrases for **Tent of Meeting** and **sanctuary**, or **holy place**, as you used in previous passages. For more information on **tabernacle** and sanctuary, refer to the Master Glossary.

The priest brought the animals for the **offerings** and the person to the **entrance of the Tent of Meeting**. This was probably the courtyard area of the tabernacle, around the bronze altar. Use the same words or phrases for offerings and "entrance of the Tent of Meeting" as you have used previously. The general word for offerings is in the Master Glossary.

Use the same phrases for **guilt offering**, **wave offering**, **sin or purification offering**, and **burnt offering** as you used in previous passages. For more information on these offerings, refer to the Master Glossary.

The guilt offering is **most holy**. Use the same word or phrase for "most holy" as you have used previously. Holy is in the Master Glossary.

The priest had to put the blood of the sacrificed sheep on the right earlobe, right thumb, and right big toe of the person.

Stop here as a group and look again at a picture of a person's right earlobe, right thumb, and right big toe as needed. Pause this audio here.

The priest had to pour oil into the palm of his left hand and **dip** his right forefinger into the sacrificed sheep's blood. Use the same word for this motion that you used earlier in Leviticus 4.

Stop here as a group and look again at a picture of a person dipping their finger in oil as needed. Pause this audio here.

The priest had to **sprinkle**, or throw, the blood of the sacrifice in front of Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for sprinkle as you used in previous passages.

The priest must sacrifice the offering on the **altar** of the burnt offering. Use the same word for altar that you used in previous passages. For more information on altar, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the altar of the burnt offering. Pause this audio here.

The priest makes **atonement** for the person who needs to be clean. Use the same word or phrase for atonement that you have used previously, and refer to atonement in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 14:10–20

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (833 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 14:21–32

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 14:21–32 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:21–32 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.

6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:21–32 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh has been giving Moses instructions on how the Israelite people are supposed to live in good relationship with Yahweh. At this time, the Israelite people are still camping at Mount Sinai, where people had recently built the Tent of Meeting according to Yahweh's instructions. Here, in this passage, Yahweh gives Moses instructions for the priests to perform ceremonial cleansings for people whose defiling skin disease has healed. The person must go through the ceremonial cleansing, or purification ceremony, before the person is ritually clean again.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of possibly defiling skin diseases. Pause this audio here.

Please note that the ceremonial cleansings did not heal the person. The priest did not do the ceremonial cleansing until after the person with the defiling skin disease had already healed. Remember, for an Israelite person to be ritually clean or ritually dirty was not actually about physical cleanliness. Before the priest agreed to do the ceremonial cleansing, the priest would go visit the ritually dirty person to make sure that the person had healed and was ready for cleansing.

Yahweh wanted the Israelite people to be ritually clean so that the Israelites could be near to Yahweh and worship Yahweh. The main concern was whether the Israelite people were ready spiritually to obey and follow Yahweh. The priest did the ceremonial cleansing so that the person could be ritually clean again and be part of the community again. Yahweh gave the Israelites this process of ceremonial cleansing so that a person who was separate from the community had a way to come back into the community.

The first part of the ceremonial cleansing happened outside the camp, away from the area where people lived. But the second part of the ceremonial cleansing happens one week later at the Tent of Meeting. This passage is about the second part of the ceremonial cleansing. In the last passage, Yahweh said that the person has to offer all the main kinds of sacrifices: a burnt offering, a sin or purification offering, a guilt offering, which includes the wave offering, and a grain offering. The only offering that the person does not need to include is the fellowship or peace offering, which was usually an offering that a person gave on their own. Yahweh did not require the Israelites to give Yahweh a fellowship offering.

In this passage, Yahweh gives instructions for the ceremonial cleansing of a person who is poor. This person does not own very much and cannot afford three sheep, one for each offering. Instead, a poor person can bring one sheep and two birds for their offerings.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, how do people talk about and treat poor people? What do you think about the way Yahweh treats poor people? Pause this audio here.

This passage is very similar to the last passage because both are instructions on how to do the ceremonial cleansing for a person whose defiling skin disease has healed. The only difference is that these instructions are for the poor person. You may need to decide the best way to repeat this information.

Stop here and discuss: What is the same in this passage and the last passage? What is different in this passage? In your language, what information do you need to include in this passage? Pause this audio here.

Here is a quick reminder of the process that the priest went through to make the guilt offering. Usually, the person brought the animal to the Tent of Meeting and laid their hand on the head of the animal. The person also usually publicly confessed their sin. In cases of defiling skin diseases, it is unclear whether or not the person confessed something. Then the person would kill the animal and let the blood fall into a bowl. The priest would throw the blood on the altar. In this case, the priest would also put the blood on the person's right earlobe, on the thumb of the person's right hand, and on the big toe of the person's right foot. The priest does a similar thing with the one-third liter of oil that the person would bring. In this way, the priest makes atonement for the person who has been healed.

For this cleansing ceremony, the priest also offers a wave offering of some of the animal's body parts and the container of olive oil. The wave offering was not a separate offering, but more of a special movement that the priests did with some of the offerings.

Here is a quick reminder of the process that the priest went through to make the purification offering. When a person brought a bird for this sacrifice, the priest offered the bird by twisting the bird's neck until it died and then pulled until the head started to come off the body. The priest had to make sure the head was still partially attached to the body. As the blood poured out of the dead bird's body, the priest had to collect some of the bird's blood in a bowl. Then the priest had to sprinkle or throw some of the blood on the side of the altar. The priest drained the rest of the bird's blood at the base of the altar of burnt offering.

Here is a quick reminder of the process that the priest went through to make the burnt offering: First, when the person brought a bird for this sacrifice, the priest had to bring the bird to the bronze altar. Then the priest had to wring off the bird's head and burn up the head on the altar. After that, the priest had to drain the blood on the side of the altar. Then, the priest had to remove the inside part of the bird that digests food. After the priest removed the inside part of the bird and feathers, the priest had to throw both things on the east side of the altar in the same place where the priest would put the ashes that were left behind after the fat from a sacrifice burned up. People called this place the place where the fat ashes went.

Stop here and look at a picture of the bronze altar. Note the east side, where the fat ashes were. Pause this audio here.

Here is a quick reminder of the process that the priest went through to make the grain offering: First, the person would present the grain offering to the priest. The priest would take a handful of the wheat flour and oil mixture. The priest would burn the handful of wheat flour mixture on the altar for Yahweh. Then the priest would keep the rest of the flour and oil mixture. In the last passage, Yahweh said a person had to bring three-tenths of an ephah of flour for the grain offering for the ceremonial cleansing. In this passage, Yahweh says the poor person only had to bring one-tenth of an ephah of flour for the grain offering. Some scholars think this might be because the poor person who was becoming ritually clean was only offering one sheep, rather than the three sheep.

In these offerings, the priest would make atonement for the poor person who had been healed of a defiling skin disease.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:21–32 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh explains what to do when an Israelite person is poor and cannot afford three sheep for the cleansing ceremony. This person can bring one sheep and two doves or pigeons instead. The person also only brings one-tenth of an ephah of flour. In all, the person must bring: one young male sheep, one-tenth of an ephah of fine flour mixed with olive oil, a log of olive oil, and either two doves or two pigeons.

In the second scene: The person must bring everything for the sacrifices for the ceremonial cleansing to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. The Israelite priest will present the wave offering and kill the young male sheep for the guilt offering. The priest must put the sheep's blood on the person's right earlobe, the thumb on the person's right hand, and the big toe of the person's right foot. Then the priest will sprinkle the olive oil before Yahweh. The priest must also put olive oil over the blood on the person's right earlobe, the thumb of the person's right hand, and the big toe of the person's right foot. Then the priest will pour the rest of the olive oil on the person's head.

In the third scene: The priest must give the purification offering and the burnt offering using the two doves or pigeons. The priest must also offer the grain offering. This is how the priest makes atonement for the person who is going through the ceremonial cleansing. After all of this, the person will be fully ritually clean. The storyteller

ends this scene with a summary statement that these are the instructions for a person who has healed from a defiling skin disease, who cannot afford three sheep.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- A poor person who is going through ceremonial cleansing
- And an Israelite priest

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Note that the storyteller does not mention Moses in this passage. But the storyteller mentions Moses at the beginning of Leviticus 14, where the storyteller says that Yahweh first gave these instructions to Moses.

In the first scene, Yahweh explains what an Israelite person who is poor needs to do to go through ceremonial cleansing. Yahweh gives a special version of the ceremonial cleansing for people who do not have enough money or resources to get three sheep for the sacrifices.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, how do you say that someone is poor or does not have enough? Pause this audio here.

The poor Israelite person still must bring one young male sheep for the guilt offering. The person must also bring one-tenth of an ephah of fine flour mixed with olive oil for a grain offering. An ephah was probably a container that people used to carry and measure flour. It is unclear how much one-tenth of an ephah would weigh. It was possibly about 2 liters and weighed about 1.5 kilograms. The flour must be finely ground flour, which probably refers to wheat flour. Fine flour also means the best quality of flour. The person also must bring a "log" or container of olive oil. It is possible that a log of oil was about three-tenths of a liter. Since this person is poor, the person can bring two doves or two pigeons instead of bringing a second young male sheep and a young female sheep for the purification offering and the burnt offering.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of doves and pigeons. Pause this audio here.

So in all, the poor person must bring all the same things for the ceremonial cleansing, except that the person may bring two birds instead of two sheep and only bring one-tenth of an ephah of flour rather than three-tenths of an ephah of flour.

In the second scene, the person must bring everything for the offerings for their ceremonial cleansing to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. The priest must hold the young male sheep and the container of oil and move those things in a special way as a wave offering.

Then the priest has to kill the young male sheep for the guilt offering and collect the blood in a bowl. The priest must put the dead sheep's blood on the person's right earlobe, the thumb of the person's right hand, and the big toe of the person's right foot.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a person's right earlobe, right thumb, and right big toe. Pause this audio here.

Then the priest has to pour the olive oil into his left hand and dip his right forefinger into the olive oil.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a person dipping their finger in oil. Pause this audio here.

The priest will sprinkle the olive oil seven times before Yahweh. This probably will happen at the altar of the burnt offering.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the altar of the burnt offering. Pause this audio here.

The priest must also put olive oil over the blood on the person's right earlobe, the thumb on their right hand, and the big toe on their right foot. The priest must put the oil on top of the marks of sheep's blood that the priest made on the person's body. The priest must also pour the rest of the olive oil on the person's head.

The priest makes atonement for the person who is going through the ceremonial cleansing. This means that the priest reconciles the person to Yahweh and covers the person's bad actions. The storyteller uses this phrase throughout the passage to describe how the priest uses the offerings to make the person ritually clean again.

In the third scene, the priest must give the purification offering and the burnt offering using the two doves or two pigeons. The priest must also offer the grain offering. This is how the priest makes atonement for the person who is going through the ceremonial cleansing. After all of this, the person will be fully ritually clean.

The storyteller ends this passage with a summary statement: This is Yahweh's law for a person who has healed from a defiling skin disease and who does not have enough wealth to get three sheep for the ceremonial cleansing.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:21–32 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- A poor person who is going through ceremonial cleansing
- And an Israelite priest

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh talks about what to do if an Israelite person is poor and cannot afford three sheep for the sacrifice. This person can bring one sheep and two doves or two pigeons instead of the other two sheep. The person also only brings one-tenth of an ephah of flour. In all, the person must bring: one young male sheep, one-tenth of an ephah of fine flour mixed with olive oil, a log of olive oil, and either two doves or two pigeons. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the person who is going through ceremonial cleansing, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am relieved that Yahweh provided a way for me to make these offerings; or
- I am thankful my relative helped me get these animals so that I can go through ceremonial cleansing; or
- What if people talk badly about me because I had to bring a poor person's offering?

Continue the drama. In the second scene, the person must bring everything for the offerings for their ceremonial cleansing to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. The Israelite priest will present the wave offering and kill the young male sheep for the guilt offering. The priest must put the sacrificed sheep's blood on the person's right earlobe, the thumb on their right hand, and the big toe on their right foot. Then the priest sprinkles the olive oil before Yahweh. The priest must also put olive oil over the blood on the person's right earlobe, the thumb on their right hand, and the big toe on their right foot. The priest will then pour the rest of the olive oil on the

person's head. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This ceremony reminds me of the ceremony that we did for Aaron and Aaron's sons when Aaron and Aaron's sons became priests; or
- I am surprised. The community rejected this person, but now Yahweh commands us to treat this person with honor.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, the priest must give the purification offering and the burnt offering using the two doves or pigeons. The priest must also offer the grain offering. This is how the priest makes atonement for the person who is going through the ceremonial cleansing. After all of this, the person will be fully ritually clean. The storyteller ends this scene with a summary statement that these are the instructions for a person who has healed from a defiling skin disease and who cannot afford three sheep. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want every person to be able to come back to me; or
- This person is ritually clean, just as much as any other person; or
- I will care for and help people who are poor.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:21–32 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh gave instructions for becoming ceremonially clean, or pure. For more information about how someone can purify themselves, refer to the Master Glossary for **purify** and for **purification ceremony**.

Even if the person going through the ceremonial cleansing was poor, the person must still bring a **young male sheep** for the guilt offering. This means a male sheep that was young, but old enough to have babies. Use the same word for young male sheep as you used in previous passages.

Use the same phrase for **guilt offering** as you used in previous passages. For more information on guilt offering, refer to guilt offering in the Master Glossary.

The Israelite person must bring one-tenth of an **ephah** of finest **flour** for the **grain offering**. Remember, this probably refers to wheat flour. An ephah was probably a large basket that people used to carry flour. One-tenth of an ephah probably weighed about 1.5 kilograms. Use the same words or phrases for ephah, flour, and grain offering that you used in previous passages. For more information on ephah and grain offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

The Israelite person also had to bring **olive oil** for the sacrifices. Use the same word or phrase for oil that you used in previous passages. A **log of oil** was probably about one-third quart or three-tenths of a liter. Use the same phrase for "log of oil" as you used in previous passages.

If the Israelite person was poor, the person could bring two **doves** or two **pigeons** for the sin or purification offering and the whole burnt offering instead of a young male sheep and a young female sheep. Use the same words for doves and pigeons that you used in previous passages.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of doves and pigeons again as needed. Pause this audio here.

Use the same phrases for **purification offering** and for **burnt offering** as you used in previous passages. For more information on purification offering and burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

In this passage, the **priest** who declared the person clean in the first part of the ceremonial cleansing was the one who was supposed to kill the animals for the offerings to finish the ceremonial cleansing. Use the same words for priest and for killing an animal as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

Use the same phrase for **Tent of Meeting** as you used in previous passages. For more information on the Tent of Meeting, refer to **tabernacle** in the Master Glossary. Use the same phrase for "entrance to the Tent of Meeting"

that you used previously. Remember that the entrance was probably the courtyard area around the altar of burnt offering.

Use the same word for **Yahweh** as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Use the same phrase for **wave offering** as you used in previous passages. For more information on wave offering, refer to wave offering in the Master Glossary.

The priest had to put the blood of the dead sheep on the right earlobe, right thumb, and right big toe of the person.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a person's right earlobe, right thumb, and right big toe again as needed. Pause this audio here.

The priest had to pour oil into the palm of his left hand and dip his right forefinger into the sacrificed sheep's blood. The priest was making **atonement** for the person. Use the same word or phrase for atonement as you have used previously, and see atonement in the Master Glossary for more information.

Stop here as a group and look again at a picture of a person dipping their finger on their right hand in oil as needed. Pause this audio here.

The priest had to **sprinkle** or **throw** the blood of the sacrifice in front of Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for sprinkle or throw as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh's **law** is Yahweh's rules and instructions for the Israelite people. Use the same word for law as you used in previous passages. For more information on law, refer to the Master Glossary.

An Israelite person had to go through ceremonial cleansing after the person had healed from a **defiling skin disease**. Before the ceremonial cleansing, the healed Israelite person would be ritually dirty, and after the ceremonial cleansing, the healed Israelite person would be ritually clean. For more information on **leprosy**, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word for "defiling skin disease" as you used in previous passages.

Stop here as a group and look again at pictures of possible defiling skin diseases as needed.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 14:21–32

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (960 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 14:33–42

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 14:33–42 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:33–42 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:33–42 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh gives Moses and Aaron instructions on how the Israelite people are supposed to live in good relationship with Yahweh. At this time, the Israelite people are still camping at Mount Sinai, where people had recently built the Tent of Meeting according to Yahweh's instructions.

Yahweh gives instructions to Moses and Aaron to prepare the Israelites for when the Israelite people move into the Canaan people's land. In the wilderness, the Israelite people live in tents or small shelters that a person lives in for a short amount of time. But when the Israelite people move into the Canaan people's land, the Israelites will have houses to live in. People make these houses by making bricks or building stones out of clay. Then the people make the bricks into a house. In this passage, Yahweh uses the word "stones" for these clay bricks. But depending on your language, using a word like "stones" might be confusing for something that a person makes out of clay. Some people had houses that people built with both stones or rocks and also clay bricks. While some Canaan people probably did build houses out of rocks and stone, in this passage, Yahweh talks about houses that people had built out of clay bricks. A person cannot move these houses like a person can move a tent. Sometimes ancient people would also mix lime, sand, and water together to create a plaster to put on the walls.

Yahweh gives instructions to Moses and Aaron for what a priest should do if a person has a house with a defiling mold in the clay walls.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of mold on clay walls. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kinds of houses do people typically live in? What could be wrong with a house that would make it impossible to live in? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh had promised to give the Canaan people's land and houses to the Israelite people. Yahweh calls the Canaan people's land "the land that I am giving you." This means Yahweh is planning to give the Israelite people

the Canaan people's land, houses, and their possessions if the Israelite people obey Yahweh. Yahweh says this will be the Israelite people's possession. This is a phrase that Yahweh often uses when Yahweh talks about the land that Yahweh promised to give to Abraham. This means that the Israelite people will live in that land and own the houses that the Canaan people used to own.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Why do you think Yahweh promised to give the Israelite people the land and houses that the Canaan people owned? Pause this audio here.

When you listened to this passage, did it remind you of another passage? The instructions that Yahweh gives to the priests for defiling mold in houses are similar to the instructions Yahweh gave earlier about defiling mold in cloth or leather.

Stop here and listen to your translation of Leviticus 13:47–59 to remember Yahweh's instructions for how to deal with mold on cloth. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh gives instructions for what to do when a person who owns a house finds defiling mold in the clay walls. The person who owns the house must go to a priest and tell the priest that the person thinks their house or shelter has defiling mold. Then the priest will tell the person to take all the people and things out of the house or shelter before the priest comes to look at the walls. The person will remove the things from the house before the priest comes, so that if the priest declares the house ritually dirty, the priest will not have to declare the people and their things ritually dirty, since nothing is in the house. If the priest looks at the walls and sees that the mold looks to be deep in the walls, the priest must close the doors to the house or shelter. No person may go into the house for seven days or one week.

After seven days, the priest will come back to examine the house again. If the mold has spread on the walls, the priest must tell the owner that someone must tear all the moldy bricks out of the house or shelter. Someone must carry all the moldy bricks outside the camp to an area that is ritually dirty. Someone also must scrape all the inside bricks of the house or shelter. Someone also must take all the dust that the person scrapes off and carry it outside the camp to an area that is ritually dirty. Then someone must put new clay bricks and plaster in the place where the old, moldy bricks were.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you do when parts of your home have problems? How do you carefully repair your home so that the damaged parts of your home do not affect the people and things in your home?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:33–42 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh gives instructions to Moses and Aaron for what people should do if a person has a house with a defiling mold in the clay walls.

In the second scene: Yahweh explains what to do when a person who owns a house or shelter finds defiling mold in the clay walls. The person must go to a priest and tell the priest that their house or shelter may have defiling mold. Then the priest will tell the person to take all the people and things out of the house or shelter before the priest comes to look at the walls. If the priest looks at the walls and sees that the mold looks to be deep in the walls, the priest must close the doors to the house or shelter. No person is allowed to go into the house for seven days or one week.

In the third scene: Yahweh says the priest must come back after one week to examine the house again. If the mold has spread on the walls, the priest will tell the owner that someone must tear all the moldy bricks out of the house or shelter. Someone must carry all the moldy bricks outside the camp to an area that is ritually dirty. Someone also must scrape all the inside bricks of the house or shelter. Someone also must take all the dust that

comes off the wall and carry the dust outside the camp to an area that is ritually dirty. Then the person must put new clay bricks and plaster in the place where the old, moldy bricks were.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- A person who owns a house with a defiling mold in their house or shelter
- The people who tear out the moldy parts of the house and replace them with new bricks and plaster
- And an Israelite priest

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Yahweh gives instructions to Moses and Aaron to prepare the Israelites for when the Israelite people moved into the Canaan people's land. In the wilderness, the Israelite people lived in tents or small shelters that people live in for short amounts of time. But in the Canaan people's land, people made houses out of clay bricks. The Israelite people will live in these houses. Yahweh had promised to give the Canaan people's land and houses to the Israelite people. Yahweh calls the Canaan people's land "the land that I am giving you." This means Yahweh was planning to give the Israelite people the Canaan people's land, houses, and their possessions if the Israelite people obeyed Yahweh. Yahweh says this will be the Israelite people's possession. This is a phrase that Yahweh often uses when Yahweh talks about the land that Yahweh promised to give to Abraham. This means that the Israelite people will live in that land and own the houses and everything that the Canaan people used to own.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, talk about giving a person a gift. Talk about how you would say that a person gave another person some land. How would you say that Yahweh was going to give the Canaan land to the Israelite people? How would you say that the Israelite people will own the land? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh gives these instructions to Moses and Aaron about what a person and a priest should do if a person has a house or shelter with a defiling mold in the clay walls. Yahweh uses the word "stones" for these clay bricks. But depending on your language, using a word like "stones" might be confusing for something that a person makes out of clay. Some people built houses with both stones or rocks and also clay bricks. Some Canaan people probably did build houses out of rocks and stone. Some Canaan people probably built houses out of clay bricks on foundations of stones. In this passage, Yahweh talks about houses that people had built out of clay bricks.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What will you call these clay "stones" in your language? Pause this audio here.

In an earlier passage, Yahweh gave Moses many rules about how the priests should treat a person with a defiling skin disease. In the original language, Yahweh uses the same words to refer both to the person who has this defiling condition, a cloth or leather garment that has this defiling condition, and a shelter that has this defiling condition. Yahweh uses the word for both red mold that grows on buildings and green mold that grows on buildings.

Stop here and look at pictures of red mold and green mold as a group. In your area, what kinds of molds do you have? Discuss what you will call the kinds of mold in these pictures in your language. Pause audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh explains what to do if a person who owns a house or shelter finds defiling mold in the clay walls. The person must go to a priest and tell the priest that their house or shelter may have defiling mold. Then the priest will tell the person to take all the people and things out of the house or shelter before the priest comes to look at the walls.

Then the priest must come to look at the mark or spot of mold on the clay walls of the house. When the priest looks at the walls, the priest will look for two things. First, the priest will look to see if the mold is either a greenish color or a reddish color. Second, the priest will look to see if the mold looks to be deep in the walls. The words here are like the words that Yahweh uses to talk about the defiling skin disease being deep in the skin of

the person. This probably means that mold is making a hole in the clay bricks or spreading in a way where the mold is destroying the clay bricks.

Stop here and discuss: Remind each other what words you used in your language to talk about how the defiling skin disease was deep in the skin of the person. What words will you use to talk about how the mold is deep in the wall? Pause this audio here.

If the priest looks at the walls and sees that the mold is green or red and that the mold looks deep in the walls, the priest must close the doors to the house or shelter. No person may go into the house for seven days or one week.

In the third scene, Yahweh says the priest must come back after one week to examine the house again. You may want to say that the priest re-examines the mold or that the priest examines the walls a second time. The priest will look to see if the mold has spread on the clay brick walls. “The mold has spread” can mean that the mold is getting bigger and is now on more bricks. “The mold has spread” can also mean that the mold has gotten deeper in the bricks and is making bigger holes in the bricks.

If the mold has spread on the walls, the priest must tell the owner that someone must tear or take all the moldy bricks out of the house or shelter. Someone must carry all the moldy bricks outside the camp to an area that is ritually dirty. This was a place away from where the Israelite people lived. People could leave ritually dirty things in this place so that the people did not become ritually dirty too.

Someone also must scrape all the inside bricks of the house or shelter. The priest will probably tell the person or people who live in the house to scrape the bricks. The people must do this to all the clay bricks on the inside or interior of the house. Someone also must take all the dust that people scrape off the walls and carry the dust outside the camp to an area that is ritually dirty. This word for dust sometimes means mud or can even mean “dry earth.” This might refer to the mortar or mud that a person uses to hold the clay bricks together. Or it may mean the surface of all the bricks. Either way, try to use a word like mud or plaster. Sometimes ancient people would also mix lime, sand, and water together to create a plaster to put on the walls.

Stop here and look at the pictures of the mold on the brick wall again. In your language, what words do you use to talk about how people build houses or shelters? Talk about someone building a shelter with clay bricks. Notice what words you use for things like “bricks,” “taking away bricks,” “putting in new bricks,” and “mortar.” Pause this audio here.

Then the person must put new clay bricks and plaster in the place where the old, moldy bricks were.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:33–42 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- A person who owns a house with a defiling mold in their house or shelter
- The people who tear out the moldy parts of the house and replace them with new bricks and plaster
- And an Israelite priest

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh gives instructions to Moses and Aaron for what a person and a priest should do if a person has a house with a defiling mold in the clay walls. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The priests are responsible for making sure all Israelite things are ritually clean, even houses; or
- If I come into a house with a defiling mold and there are things or people in the house, are those people or things ritually dirty too? or
- Yahweh has promised to give us the Canaan people's houses. I will be happy when we can live in houses instead of the tents we live in now.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, a person who owns a house or shelter may find defiling mold in the clay walls. The person must go to a priest and tell the priest that the person's house or shelter may have defiling mold. Then the priest will tell the person to take all the people and things out of the house or shelter before the priest comes to look at the walls. If the priest looks at the walls and sees that the mold looks to be deep in the walls, the priest must close the doors to the house or shelter. No person may go into the house for seven days or one week. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite person who owns the house, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Where will we stay for the next seven days? or
- I am grateful that we are not ritually dirty, even though our house is.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, the priest must come back after one week to examine the house again. If the mold has spread on the walls, the priest will tell the owner that someone must tear all the moldy bricks out of the house or shelter. Someone must carry all the moldy bricks outside the camp to an area that is ritually dirty. Someone also must scrape all the inside bricks of the house or shelter. Someone also must take all the dust that came off the walls and carry the dust outside the camp to an area that is ritually dirty. Then the person must put new clay bricks and plaster in the place where the old, moldy bricks were. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite person who owns the house, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The priest comes and tells us what to do, but we must do all the work; or
- It is a long way to carry the bricks to the ritually dirty place outside the camp; or
- We will do what the priest says because we know it will make Yahweh happy.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:33–42 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh talks about what to do when the people live in houses in the land of **Canaan**. Ancient people normally made these houses from clay or mud bricks. Sometimes people also used rocks or stones to build these houses. Use the same words for Yahweh and Canaan as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and Canaan, refer to the Master Glossary.

In previous passages, Yahweh gave Moses rules about how the priests should treat a person with a defiling skin disease. In this passage, Yahweh tells Moses how the priests should treat a house or dwelling that has a defiling mold in it. Yahweh uses the same words to refer both to the person who has this defiling condition and the building that has this defiling condition. Remember that at the end of Leviticus 13, you also used a word for defiling marks of mold or mildew in fabric and leather.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of defiling mold. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **defiling mold** in a house. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, an Israelite **priest** is the one who must examine a house for a defiling mold. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for priest as you have used in previous passages.

The priest tells the person to take everything and everyone out of the house, so that those things will not be **unclean** or **ritually dirty**. Use the same words or phrases for unclean as you have used previously. For more information, refer to **clean and unclean** in the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 14:33–42

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (963 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 14:43–57

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 14:43–57 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:43–57 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:43–57 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh was giving Moses instructions on how the Israelite people were supposed to live in good relationship with Yahweh. At this time, the Israelite people were still camping at Mount Sinai, where people had recently built the Tent of Meeting according to Yahweh's instructions. In this passage, Yahweh gives instructions for the priests. The priests were the spiritual leaders who taught the people what Yahweh wanted. The priests were also the experts who decided whether a skin disease was a defiling skin disease and whether a mold was a defiling mold or a persistent defiling mold.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, who are the spiritual leaders? What do these leaders teach people? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh wanted the Israelite people to be ritually clean so that the Israelites could be near to Yahweh and worship Yahweh. The main concern was whether the Israelite people were ready spiritually to obey and follow Yahweh. In this passage, Yahweh says the priest is responsible for making the building or home ritually clean. Even the Israelites' animals, clothes, and buildings needed to be ritually clean so that the Israelite people could be close to Yahweh.

Notice that in the passage, Yahweh never says that skin disease or mold defilement is a punishment for people's sin. Sometimes, the Israelites did see a connection between Yahweh's punishment of sin and skin problems, such as Miriam's defiling skin disease in Exodus. However, the Bible does not say a person who has a defiling skin disease or a person who has a house, or fabric, or leather with a defiling mold has done something bad to deserve it.

Here, in this passage, Yahweh gives Moses and Aaron final instructions about what to do if a house has had a defiling mold in it. Yahweh explains what to do if the mold comes back into the house that someone has cleaned out. Then Yahweh says what to do if a person goes into a defiled house that someone has closed for a period of isolation. Then Yahweh says how to perform ceremonial cleansings for houses that no longer have a defiling mold. After the ceremony, the house will be ritually clean again.

This is what the priest does to ceremonially cleanse a house that no longer has mold. As we review the cleansing ceremony, think about how the process is similar to and different from the ceremonial cleansing that the priest does for a person whom Yahweh healed from a defiling skin disease. For example, notice that in this process the priest kills the bird, but when the priest is performing ceremonial cleansing for a person, it is another person who kills the bird.

For this process, the priest must first bring two birds, cedar wood, scarlet thread, and a hyssop plant to the house that is ready to be ritually clean again. The two birds must be alive and ritually clean small birds. We do not know for sure what size or type of birds these were, but we do know that the birds had to be ritually clean.

Stop here and look at a picture of a sparrow as a group. Pause this audio here.

Next, the priest must use three items to sprinkle blood and water onto the house that needs ceremonial cleansing: cedar wood, scarlet thread, and hyssop. Remember that cedar wood is a strong-smelling wood that is reddish-brown or sometimes tan-colored. Since ancient times, people have used cedar wood for its ability to preserve things, to purify, and even to keep bugs away. Many people think cedar wood smells nice.

Leviticus 14:43–57

Many scholars think the scarlet thread is a thread or string that a person dyed red. A person would collect a certain kind of red insect. A person would make red dye from this insect and then put threads and fabrics in the dye to make the threads and fabrics red.

Hyssop is a plant that has woody stems and green leaves. People used this plant in the ancient world for purification and for medicine. Remember, the Israelite people used hyssop to put the lamb's blood on their doors for the Passover in Exodus. It is possible that when the priest used the hyssop to sprinkle the blood during the ceremonial cleansing, the priest and the other Israelites would remember the Passover.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of cedar wood, scarlet thread, and hyssop. Pause this audio here.

The priest must also have a clay pot full of fresh spring water. Spring water is water that comes from a flowing or moving water source. The priest must kill one of the birds over the clay pot of water, so that the bird's blood falls into the pot and mixes with the water.

The priest must dip the remaining live bird into the blood and water mixture in the clay pot. The priest must also dip the cedar wood, the scarlet thread, and the hyssop plant in the blood and water mixture.

The priest must sprinkle the bird's blood and water mixture on the ritually dirty house seven times using the cedar wood, the scarlet thread, and the hyssop plant. Then the priest must take the live bird into a field or the wilderness, a place away from where people live, and let the bird go. Later in Leviticus, Yahweh gives instructions to the priests about the scapegoat, which a person releases in the wilderness. It is possible that when the priest releases the bird into the wilderness, it reminds the Israelite people of the scapegoat that people also release into the wilderness.

The priest makes atonement for the house in this way. This is atonement for an object rather than for a person. When a priest makes atonement for an object, the priest makes that object ready for people to use in the right and proper way again. After the priest completes this ceremony, the house is ritually clean again.

Stop here and discuss: What parts of the ceremonial cleansing for a house are similar to the ceremonial cleansing for a person who has healed from a defiling skin disease? Pause this audio here.

This passage is the last of Yahweh's instructions for the priests on defiling skin diseases and defiling molds.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:43–57 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh explains what to do if mold starts to grow again in a house that a person cleaned to get rid of the mold. The priest must come back and see that the mold has spread or gotten bigger or worse in the house. Then the priest will declare that it is a persistent defiling mold. The house is ritually dirty, and people must destroy the house and take all the material from the house out of the camp to a ritually dirty place.

In the second scene: Yahweh explains that if a person goes into a house after the priest closes the house up, the person is ritually dirty until the sun sets that day. If a person eats or sleeps in the house, that person also must wash their clothes.

In the third scene: The priest must come to see a house where the people have cleared away all the moldy clay bricks, scraped away all the mold, and rebuilt that part of the house. If the mold is gone, the priest will say that the house is ritually clean. The priest must do the ceremony to make the house ritually clean again.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller ends this passage by explaining that these are the rules for defiling conditions, whether defiling skin diseases, defiling molds in fabric or leather, or defiling molds in houses. These are the instructions for how the priests decide whether or not someone or something is ritually clean or ritually dirty.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- A priest
- The owner of the house
- The people who tear down the house
- A person who goes into the closed house
- And a person who sleeps or eats in the closed house

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Note that the storyteller does not mention Moses or Aaron in this passage. But at the beginning of Leviticus 14, the storyteller says that Yahweh first gave these instructions to Moses and Aaron.

The first scene is about what to do if someone has already cleaned defiling mold from a house, but the defiling mold comes back or grows back.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what words do you use to talk about things like plants or molds growing back again? Pause this audio here.

If the mold starts growing again in the house, the priest must come back and see that the mold has spread. Other ways to say "spread" might be that the mold has gotten bigger or the mold has gotten worse in the house.

Then the priest will declare that the house has a persistent defiling mold. Yahweh uses a similar word about persistent defiling skin disease in a previous passage. It means that this is a condition that will not go away quickly. Some people say that a persistent defiling mold means a destructive mold that causes things to fall apart or rot away.

Because the house has a persistent defiling mold, the house is ritually dirty. The priest must instruct people, probably the people who lived in the house, to destroy the house and take all the building material out of the camp to a ritually dirty place.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how would you describe how someone destroys or knocks down a building or house? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh gives extra information about what happens if a person goes into a house that has a defiling mold. If the priest has closed up a house, and the person goes into that house anyway, the person is ritually dirty until the sun sets that evening. If a person eats or sleeps in that house, that person also must wash their clothes.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how would you talk about a house or shelter if someone closed the door to that house or shelter and told no one to go into it? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Yahweh explains what to do if the mold is gone after the people have cleared away all the moldy clay bricks and scraped away all the mold. The priest must come and look at the house. If the mold is gone, the priest says the house is ritually clean. Then the priest must do a ceremonial cleansing, or purification ceremony, to make the house ritually clean again. This process is similar to the ceremonial cleansing that the priest does for a person who has healed from a defiling skin disease so that the person can be ritually clean again.

The priest brings two birds, cedar wood, scarlet thread, and a hyssop plant to the house that is ready to be ritually clean again. The two birds must be alive and must be ritually clean birds. The word for birds means "sparrow," but here it probably means any kind of small bird.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a sparrow. Pause this audio here.

Someone also must bring a clay pot full of spring water. Spring water is water that comes from a flowing or moving water source. The priest kills one of the birds over the clay pot of water, so that the bird's blood falls into the pot too.

The priest uses three items to sprinkle the blood and water onto the house or shelter that needs ceremonial cleansing: cedar wood, scarlet thread, and hyssop.

Cedar wood is a strong-smelling wood that is reddish-brown or sometimes tan-colored. Someone probably cut this cedar wood into a small enough piece for a person to hold easily in one hand.

Many scholars think the scarlet thread is a thread or string that a person dyed red. The priest would probably use the scarlet thread to tie the cedar wood and the hyssop together.

Hyssop is a plant that has woody stems and green leaves. People used this plant in the ancient world for purification and for medicine.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of cedar wood, scarlet thread, and hyssop. Pause this audio here.

The priest must dip the live bird in the blood and water mixture. The priest also dips the cedar wood, the scarlet thread, and the hyssop plant in the blood and water mixture. The priest probably dips all these things in the blood and water mixture together at the same time.

The priest must sprinkle the blood and water mixture on the ritually dirty house seven times using the cedar wood, the scarlet thread, and the hyssop plant. Then the priest must take the other bird into a field or a place away from where people live and let the bird go.

The priest makes atonement for the house in this way. After this, the house is ritually clean again.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When are some times when you would have a ceremony before someone can use something, such as when someone cleans or prepares a place so people can use the place again? How would you talk about what happens during that kind of ceremony? Now discuss how you want to talk about the way that a priest makes atonement for the house so that people can use the house again. Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller ends this passage by summarizing the laws in this section of Leviticus. The storyteller says these are the rules for defiling problems, whether defiling skin diseases, defiling molds in cloth or leather, or defiling molds in houses.

The storyteller also mentions the three skin problems that priests need to look at for defiling skin disease: swelling, rash, and shiny spots.

The first human skin problem is swelling. A person with swelling in their skin probably means that the person's skin is swollen and inflamed. The person's skin looks puffed up and bigger than it should, and may be painful when a person touches the skin.

The second human skin problem is a rash. This might mean a raised bump on the skin, such as a scab or a boil. It could also mean a lot of little bumps on a person's skin.

The third human skin problem is a shiny spot. This probably means white spots on the skin. However, it may mean any human skin that is an unusual color for that person.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of possible skin defiling disease. Remember how you translated the names of these skin defiling diseases in previous passages. Pause this audio here.

All of these are the instructions for how the priests decide whether or not someone or something is ritually clean or ritually dirty from a defiling skin disease or a defiling mold.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:43–57 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh

- Moses
- Aaron
- A priest
- The owner of the house
- The people who tear down the house
- A person who goes into the closed house
- And a person who sleeps or eats in the closed house

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh explains what to do if the mold starts growing again in the house that a person cleaned to get rid of the mold. The priest must come back and see that the mold has spread or gotten bigger or worse in the house. Then the priest will declare that it is a persistent defiling mold. The house is ritually dirty, and people must destroy the house and take all the building material out of the camp to a ritually dirty place. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the person who owns the house, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that we will have to destroy my house; or
- My community and family will help me carry the blocks away and build a new house; or
- I am thankful that no one in my family has to be ritually dirty because of this.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh says that if a person goes into a house after the priest closes up the house, the person is ritually dirty until the sun sets that day. If a person eats or sleeps in the house, that person also must wash their clothes. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the person who is ritually dirty until evening, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I had nowhere else to sleep; or
- At least I do not need to make offerings to be clean again; or
- Every person is ritually dirty sometimes.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh talks about what to do when the priest comes to see a house where the people have cleared away all the moldy clay bricks and scraped away all the mold. If the mold is gone, the priest says the house is ritually clean. The priest must do the purification ceremony to make the house ritually clean again. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This ceremony is like the ceremony to make people ritually clean after a defiling skin disease; or
- Even our buildings need atonement so people can be ritually clean before Yahweh.

Continue the drama. In the fourth scene, the storyteller ends this passage with summary statements. The storyteller says these are the rules for defiling problems, whether defiling skin diseases, defiling molds in fabric or leather, or defiling molds in houses. These are the instructions for how the priests decide whether or not someone or something is ritually clean or ritually dirty. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Most of our jobs and duties are in the Tent of Meeting. But Yahweh wants us to go to people and help the people when the people are ritually dirty. Why should the priests be the ones to help people who are ritually dirty? or
- I am thankful that Yahweh gave us ways to become ritually clean again; or
- I hope the people of Israel will understand how important it is to be ritually clean.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 14:43–57 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh tells Moses how the priests should treat a house or shelter that has a **defiling mold** in it. Mold or mildew is a fungus that can look like a thin layer of fuzz or fur. Usually, damp or wet weather causes mold, and mold can slowly break down things like clay bricks or food. Mold can also cause people to become sick sometimes. Use the same word or phrase for defiling mold as you used in previous passages.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of defiling mold. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, an Israelite **priest** is the one who must examine a house for a defiling mold. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for priest as you used in previous passages.

The priest may find that the defiling mold is persistent, or that the mold will not go away easily. Use the same word or phrase for "**persistent defiling mold**" as you have used in previous passages.

If the house has persistent defiling mold, the house is **ritually dirty**. Use the same word or phrase for ritually dirty and ritually clean as you have used in previous passages. Refer to the Master Glossary for **clean and unclean** for more information if needed.

The priest must use birds in the ceremony to make the house ritually clean again. The word means "sparrow," but here it probably means any kind of small bird. These birds must be ritually clean birds.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a sparrow. Pause this audio here.

The priest must use three items to sprinkle the blood and water on the house that needs ceremonial cleansing: cedar wood, scarlet thread, and hyssop.

Cedar wood is a strong-smelling wood that is reddish-brown or sometimes tan-colored. Since ancient times, people have used cedar wood for its ability to preserve things, to purify, and even to keep bugs away. Many people think cedar wood smells nice. Someone probably cut this cedar wood into a small enough piece for a person to hold easily in one hand. Use the same word or phrase for cedar wood as you used in previous passages.

Many scholars think the **scarlet thread** is a thread or string that a person dyed red. The person would make the dye from a certain kind of insect. The priest probably uses the scarlet thread to tie the cedar wood and the hyssop together. Use the same word or phrase for scarlet thread as you used in previous passages.

Hyssop is a plant that has woody stems and green leaves. People used this plant in the ancient world for purification and for medicine. Use the same word or phrase for hyssop as you used in previous passages.

Stop here as a group and look again at a picture of cedar wood, scarlet thread, and hyssop as needed. Pause this audio here.

The priest must **dip** the live bird in the dead bird's blood and water mixture. The priest also has to dip the cedar wood, the scarlet thread, and the hyssop into the bird's blood and water mixture. This means the priest puts these things in the bird's blood and water mixture and brings them out quickly. Use the same word for this motion that you used in earlier passages.

The priest must **sprinkle**, or throw, the water mixed with the bird's blood onto the ritually dirty house. Use the same word or phrase for sprinkle as you used in previous passages.

This ceremony is how the priest makes atonement for the house. This atonement is for an object rather than for a person. When a priest makes atonement for an object, the priest makes that object ready for people to use in the right and proper way again.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you want to translate the way that the priest makes **atonement** for the house. For more information on atonement, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that Yahweh has been giving the priests instructions, or laws, for an Israelite person who has a **defiling skin disease**. If the person has a defiling skin disease, that person is ritually dirty. For more information on defiling skin diseases, refer to **leprosy** in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for defiling skin disease as you used in previous passages.

Stop here as a group and look again at pictures of possible defiling skin diseases as needed. Pause this audio here.

Use the same word or phrase for **laws** as you have used previously, and refer to law in the Master Glossary for more information.

In the last few chapters of Leviticus, Yahweh has instructed the priests about what to do if an Israelite person had a defiling skin disease. Yahweh uses similar language for **defiling marks of mold** in cloth and leather. Use the same word or phrase for “defiling marks of mold” in cloth or leather as you used in previous passages.

Stop here as a group and look again at pictures of moldy fabric and moldy leather as needed.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 14:43–57

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (961 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.7 MB)

Leviticus 15:1–12

- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 15:1–12

Hear and Heart

NOTE: This passage talks about subjects that you may want to discuss in groups of only men and only women. Stop here and discuss as a group if you will listen to this passage in groups of only men and only women. Pause this audio here.

In this step, hear Leviticus 15:1–12 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:1–12 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

NOTE: This passage talks about subjects that you may want to discuss in groups of only men and only women. Stop here and discuss as a group if you will listen to this passage in groups of only men and only women. Pause this audio here.

Earlier in Leviticus, Yahweh told Moses how to deal with diseases that affect skin, cloth, and houses. All of these laws are about whether a person is ritually clean or ritually unclean or dirty. A ritually dirty person cannot touch anything holy, which means that person cannot worship in the Tent of Meeting. In this section of Leviticus, Yahweh tells Moses and Aaron to tell the Israelites what the Israelites need to do when someone has issues concerning the reproductive parts of their bodies. This first passage is about when men have anything coming out of their penis that is not urine or semen. People call this a discharge or pus. Israelites do not normally talk directly about the sexual parts of a male and female body, so Yahweh calls a man's penis "flesh." You may also want to use a more general word here if it is more appropriate in your language.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you talk about the reproductive or sexual parts of your bodies? How do you talk about these parts of the body differently if there are different types of people around? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the discharge is ritually dirty. Yahweh also says that the man who has the discharge is ritually dirty. The man is ritually dirty, whether the discharge is flowing out of the man's penis or whether the discharge clogs up the man's penis.

Then Yahweh explains what happens when the man who has a discharge from his penis touches other things. The Israelites believed that if a person was ritually dirty for certain reasons, that person could make other things ritually dirty. Here, Yahweh explains what a man makes ritually dirty when the man has a discharge from his penis. Anything the man lies on or sits on becomes ritually dirty. Anyone who touches what the man lies on or sits on needs to wash their body and their clothes, and that person is ritually dirty until evening. For the ancient Israelites, the day started in the evening, so Yahweh is telling the Israelites that the person will be ritually dirty until the next day. The person specifically needs to wash in water. This probably means that the person needs to find a pool of water and go completely underwater for a brief time.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people wash their bodies? Describe the different ways people wash in different situations. Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 15:1–12

Yahweh also says that anyone who touches the man who has a discharge from his penis needs to wash their clothes and their body with water, and that person who touched the man will be ritually dirty until evening. Anyone who the man with the discharge spits on needs to wash their clothes and their body with water, and the person the man spits on is ritually dirty until evening. Anything the man rides on becomes ritually dirty. This could refer to a saddle, or the cloth people laid on animals when a person rode on an animal, or the seat of a chariot.

Stop here as a group and look at this picture of a person riding on a horse with a cloth across the horse's back. Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what animals or things do people ride on? What do people use to make riding more comfortable? Pause this audio here.

If anyone carries what the man with the discharge sat on while the man rode, that person needs to wash their clothes and their bodies in water, and the person who carried the item will be ritually dirty until evening. The man with a discharge needs to wash his hands before the man touches someone. When Yahweh tells the Israelites to wash their hands, Yahweh is probably telling the Israelites to pour water on their hands so the Israelites can remove anything dirty from their hands.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people clean their hands? When do people clean their hands? Pause this audio here.

If the man with a discharge touches someone without washing his hands, then the person the man touched needs to wash their clothes and their body with water. The person the man touched will also be ritually dirty until evening, like in the other situations.

If the man with the discharge touches any pottery, the man with the discharge or someone else needs to break the pottery. Pottery is pots, dishes, or other containers that people make from clay. When pottery was ritually dirty, Yahweh did not allow the Israelites to wash the pottery. So when pottery was ritually dirty, the Israelites had to break the pottery.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a clay pot. Pause this audio here.

If the man with a discharge touches any wooden container, then the man or someone else needs to wash the wooden container with water. Like with the hands, Yahweh is probably telling the Israelites to pour water on and into the wooden containers to remove anything dirty from the containers.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a wooden bowl.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses and Aaron to tell the Israelites that a man who has pus coming out of his penis is unclean or ritually dirty.

In the second scene: Yahweh explains what happens to people and things the man who has a discharge from his penis touches.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The Israelites
- A man who has a discharge from his penis

Leviticus 15:1–12

- Anyone who touches what the man with a discharge laid on
- Anyone who sits on what the man with a discharge sits on
- Anyone who touches the man with a discharge
- Anyone whom the man with a discharge spits on
- Anyone who carries or touches what the man with a discharge rode on
- And anyone whom the man with a discharge touches without washing his hands

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Earlier in Leviticus, Yahweh told Moses how to deal with diseases that affect skin, cloth, and houses. All of these laws concern whether a person is ritually clean or ritually dirty. In this section of Leviticus, Yahweh tells Moses and Aaron to tell the Israelites what the Israelites need to do when a person has issues concerning the reproductive or sexual parts of their bodies. The storyteller says that Yahweh spoke to Moses and Aaron. The storyteller says this to separate the next passages from the previous passage about diseases that affect houses. This passage is about when men have anything coming out of their penis that is not urine or semen. People call this a discharge or pus. Israelites do not normally talk directly about the sexual parts of a male and female body, so Yahweh calls a man's penis "flesh."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate "flesh" or "penis" in a way that is appropriate for your culture? Pause the audio here.

In the first scene, Yahweh says that any discharge, or pus, that comes out of a man's penis is ritually dirty. Yahweh also says that the man who has the discharge is ritually dirty. The man is ritually dirty, whether the discharge is flowing out of the man's penis or whether the discharge clogs up the man's penis.

In the second scene, Yahweh gives instructions for when the man who has a discharge from his penis touches other things. Yahweh explains for each situation that the person who touches the man who has a discharge or something the man who has a discharge touches needs to wash their body and their clothes with water, and that person is ritually dirty until the evening. When Yahweh repeats this, Yahweh makes it easier for the Israelites to remember what Yahweh is telling the Israelites to do.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about important lists of rules in your culture. How do you help people remember these rules? Pause the audio here.

When Yahweh gives these instructions, Yahweh is not talking about a specific time when these situations happen. Yahweh is giving instructions so that any time in the future that these situations happened, the Israelites would know what to do.

Yahweh says that anything the man lies on or sits on becomes ritually dirty. Anyone who touches what the man lies on or sits on needs to wash their body and their clothes, and that person is ritually dirty until the sun sets. Most people probably lie on a mat on the floor that they use as a bed. You should use a word for something that people regularly lie on to sleep, or just say that it is any object that a person lies on.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about the thing that the man lies on. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also says that anyone who touches the man who has a discharge from his penis needs to wash their clothes and their body with water, and the person who touches the man will be ritually dirty until evening. Anyone who the man with the discharge spits on needs to wash their clothes and their body with water, and the person the man spits on is ritually dirty until evening. Anything the man rides on becomes ritually dirty. Anyone who carries or touches what the man with the discharge sat on while the man rode needs to wash their clothes and their bodies in water, and the person will be ritually dirty until evening. The man with a discharge needs to wash his hands before the man touches someone.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Take some water and pour it over your hands to remove anything dirty from your hands. How is this different from how you normally would clean your hands? Pause the audio here.

If the man with a discharge touches someone without washing his hands, then the person the man touched needs to wash their clothes and their body with water. The person the man touched will also be ritually dirty until evening, like in the other situations.

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If the man with the discharge touches any clay pottery, the man with the discharge or someone else needs to break the pottery. Yahweh does not say who needs to break the pottery because the important thing is that someone destroys the pottery so that no one can use the pottery again.

If the man with a discharge touches any wooden container, then the man or someone else needs to wash the wooden container with water. Like with the hands, Yahweh is probably telling the Israelites to pour water on and into the wooden containers to remove anything dirty from the containers. Yahweh also does not say who needs to wash the wooden container because the important thing is that someone washes the wooden container before someone uses it again.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The Israelites
- A man who has a discharge from his penis
- Anyone who touches what the man with a discharge laid on
- Anyone who sits on what the man with a discharge sits on
- Anyone who touches the man with a discharge
- Anyone whom the man with a discharge spits on
- Anyone who carries what the man with a discharge rode on
- And anyone whom the man with a discharge touches without washing his hands

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Yahweh tells Moses and Aaron to tell the Israelites what to do when a man has a discharge, or pus, coming out of the man’s penis.

In the first scene, Yahweh says that any discharge, or pus, that comes out of a man’s penis is ritually dirty. Yahweh also says that the man who has the discharge is ritually dirty. The man is ritually dirty, whether the discharge is flowing out of the man’s penis or whether the discharge clogs up the man’s penis. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the man with a discharge from his penis, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am feeling a lot of pain because something is wrong with my body; or
- I am sad that I am ritually dirty because I cannot go to the tabernacle now; or

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- This is embarrassing to have something wrong with my penis.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh gives instructions for when the man who has a discharge from his penis touches other things. Yahweh says that anything the man lies on or sits on becomes ritually dirty. Anyone who touches what the man lies on or sits on needs to wash their body and their clothes, and that person is ritually dirty until evening. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the person who touches what the man with a discharge laid on, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am upset because I am ritually dirty now; or
- I feel disgusted and dirty because I touched something ritually dirty; or
- I am glad I only have to be ritually dirty until tomorrow. Yahweh is so nice to give me a way to become ritually clean again.

Continue the drama. Yahweh also says that anyone who touches the man who has a discharge from his penis needs to wash their clothes and their body with water, and the person who touches the man will be ritually dirty until evening. Anyone who the man with the discharge spits on needs to wash their clothes and their body with water, and the person the man spits on is ritually dirty until evening. Anything the man rides on becomes ritually dirty. Anyone who carries or touches what the man with the discharge sat on while the man rode on something needs to wash their clothes and their bodies in water, and that person will be ritually dirty until evening.

Yahweh also says that anyone the man with a discharge touches needs to wash their clothes and their body with water. And the person the man touched will be ritually dirty until evening, if the man with the discharge did not wash his hands before the man touched the person.

If the man with the discharge touches any clay pottery, the man with the discharge or someone else needs to break the pottery. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the man with a discharge from his penis, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am feeling sad because I had to break the pottery I touched; or
- I know that I need to destroy the pottery so that it does not make other people ritually dirty.

Continue the drama. If the man with a discharge touches any wooden container, then the man or someone else needs to wash the wooden container with water.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:1–12 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Earlier in Leviticus, **Yahweh** told Moses how to deal with diseases that affect skin, cloth, and houses. All of these laws concern whether a person is ritually clean or unclean. In this section of Leviticus, Yahweh tells Moses and Aaron to tell the **Israelites** what to do when someone has issues concerning the reproductive or sexual parts of their bodies. Yahweh is God's personal name that Yahweh told the Israelites to call Yahweh. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and Israelites as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and Israelites, refer to the Master Glossary.

This first passage is about when men have anything coming out of their penis that is not urine or semen. People call this a discharge or pus. In this passage, Yahweh calls the penis "flesh." "Flesh" is an indirect word for "penis," because the Israelites did not like to talk directly about these parts of their bodies.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **penis**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **discharge**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the discharge is **unclean** or **ritually dirty**. Yahweh also says that the man who has the discharge is ritually dirty. The man is ritually dirty whether the discharge flows out of the man's penis or clogs up the man's penis. When a person is ritually dirty, the person is not able to touch anything holy, and so the person cannot

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go to the tabernacle to worship God. Use the same word or phrase for unclean or ritually dirty as you used in previous passages. For more information on **clean and unclean**, refer to the Master Glossary.

Then Yahweh explains what happens when the man who has a discharge from his penis touches other things. The Israelites believed that if a person was ritually dirty for certain reasons, the person could make other things ritually dirty. Here, Yahweh explains what a man makes ritually dirty when the man has a discharge from his penis. Anything the man lies on or sits on becomes ritually dirty, and anyone who touches what the man lies on or sits on needs to **wash** their body and their clothes, and that person is ritually dirty until evening. For the ancient Israelites, the day started in the evening, so Yahweh is telling the Israelites that the person will be ritually dirty until the next day. The person specifically needed to wash in water. This probably meant the person needed to find a pool of water and go completely underwater for a brief time. Use the same word or phrase for wash as you used in previous passages. For more information on wash, refer to **purify** in the Master Glossary.

Yahweh also says that anyone who touches the man who has a discharge from his penis needs to wash their clothes and their body with water, and that person will be ritually dirty until evening. Anyone who the man with the discharge spits on needs to wash their clothes and their body with water, and that person is ritually dirty until evening. Anything the man rides on becomes ritually dirty. This could refer to cloth people laid on animals when a person rode an animal or the seat of a chariot. Some translations call this a saddle.

Stop here as a group and look at this picture of a person riding a horse with a cloth across the horse's back. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **saddle**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

If the man with the discharge touches any **pottery**, the man with the discharge or someone else needs to break the pottery. Pottery is pots and dishes that people make out of clay. When pottery was ritually dirty, Yahweh did not allow the Israelites to wash the pottery. So when pottery was ritually dirty, the Israelites had to break the pottery.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a clay pot. Pause this audio here.

If the man with a discharge touches any wooden container, then the man or someone else needs to wash the wooden container or dish with water. Like with the hands, Yahweh is probably telling the Israelites to pour water on and into the wooden containers to remove anything dirty from the containers.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a wooden bowl.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 15:1–12

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (4.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 15:13–18

Hear and Heart

NOTE: This passage talks about subjects that you may want to discuss in groups of only men and only women. Stop here and discuss as a group if you will listen to this passage in groups of only men and only women. Pause this audio here.

In this step, hear Leviticus 15:13–18 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:13–18 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:13–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

NOTE: This passage talks about subjects that you may want to discuss in groups of only men and only women. Stop here and discuss as a group if you will listen to this passage in groups of only men and only women. Pause this audio here.

In this part of Leviticus, Yahweh is talking about things that make people ritually clean and ritually unclean or ritually dirty. In the previous passage, Yahweh told Moses and Aaron to tell the Israelites what happens when a man has pus coming out of the man's penis. People also call that a discharge. In this passage, Yahweh explains what happens when pus stops coming out of a man's penis, as well as what happens when semen comes out of a man's penis.

At the beginning of this passage, Yahweh explains that when a man with a discharge stops having the discharge, the man needs to wait seven days before the man can become ritually clean. On the seventh day, the man needs to wash the man's clothes and the man's body in fresh water. When Yahweh says fresh water, Yahweh means water that comes from a source of water that is flowing or moving. The Israelites considered still, or unmoving, water unsafe, so the Israelites used running water for important purification. When the man who has the discharge waits seven days and then washes his clothes and washes himself, the man will be ritually clean. Then, on the eighth day, the man who had the discharge needs to take two turtledoves or two pigeons

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to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. Turtledoves and pigeons are two different kinds of birds that Israelites sacrificed to Yahweh. The difference between the two birds is sometimes unclear.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of doves and pigeons. Pause this audio here.

The Tent of Meeting is another name for the tabernacle. Israelites made their sacrifices to Yahweh on the altar at the Tent of Meeting. When the man who had the discharge takes the two birds to the Tent of Meeting, the man gives the birds to the priest there. The priests were in charge of helping Israelites make offerings to Yahweh. The priest will use one bird to make a sin or purification offering and one bird to make a burnt offering. That is how the priest will make atonement for the man who had the discharge. Sometimes the Israelites thought that when a person became sick, Yahweh had made the person sick because the person had sinned. It is possible that the man had to make an offering to get atonement because the man had sinned. The man also might need to make an offering because the man was not able to worship Yahweh while the man had the discharge. Atonement restores a person to full fellowship with Yahweh again when the relationship was broken because the person sinned or was ritually dirty. The two birds were the least expensive animal offering a person could make, so it seems that Yahweh did not consider a discharge as serious as something like a skin disease.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, why do people think people get sick? Pause this audio here.

Next, Yahweh says that if semen comes out of a man's penis, the man needs to bathe his whole body in water, and the man will be ritually dirty until evening. In Israel, the new day starts in the evening, so the man is ritually dirty until the next day. Yahweh also says that if the semen touches any piece of clothing or leather item, the man or someone else needs to wash the item with water, and the item is ritually dirty until evening. Leather is any material that people make from animal skins. People clean the skin and turn it into a flexible material that people use for clothes, tents, and bags.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a leather bag as an example of something people make with leather. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh does not say who needs to wash the garment or the leather item because Yahweh does not need any specific person to wash the garment or the leather item that becomes ritually dirty. When Yahweh says "wash," Yahweh means that Yahweh wants someone to thoroughly scrub the cloth or leather item in water.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people wash clothes? When do people wash clothes? Pause this audio here.

Next, Yahweh says that if a man lies with a woman and semen comes out of his penis, then both the man and the woman need to bathe in water. Both the man and the woman will be ritually dirty until evening. In ancient Israel, the Israelites used the phrase "lie with" to talk about when people have sex. The Israelites did that because the Israelites were sometimes uncomfortable talking about sex directly, so the Israelites talked about it indirectly with this phrase and other phrases. Here, Yahweh is clearly talking about sex because Yahweh talks about when semen comes out of the man's penis.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What rituals or rules does your culture have for men and women after a man and woman have sex?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:13–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh explains what a man who has a discharge from his penis needs to do when the discharge stops.

In the second scene: Yahweh explains what the man needs to do when semen comes out of a man's penis.

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In the third scene: Yahweh explains what a man and woman need to do when the man and woman have sex.

The characters in this passage are:

- The man who has a discharge from his penis
- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The Israelites
- The priest
- The man whose semen comes out of his penis
- A man who has sex
- And a woman who has sex with the man

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this part of Leviticus, Yahweh is talking about things that make people ritually clean and ritually dirty. In the previous passage, Yahweh told Moses and Aaron to tell the Israelites what happens when a man has pus coming out of the man's penis. People also call this a discharge. In this passage, Yahweh continues to explain what happens when pus stops coming out of a man's penis, as well as what happens when a man has semen come out of the man's penis.

In the first scene, Yahweh explains that when a man with a discharge stops having the discharge, the man needs to wait seven days before the man can become ritually clean. The man needs to wash the man's clothes and the man's body in fresh water. You will remember that this is water that comes from a source of moving water, like a spring from the ground or running stream.

Stop here and remember how you translated the idea of fresh water in previous passages when someone had to wash with water to become ritually clean again. Pause this audio here.

Probably the man needs to both wash the man's clothes and wash the man's body during the seven days that the man is waiting to become ritually clean. Then, on the eighth day, the man who had the discharge needs to take two turtledoves or two pigeons to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. There in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting, near the bronze altar, the man gives the birds to a priest. The priest will use one bird to make a purification offering and one bird to make a burnt offering. When the priest makes the two offerings, the priest atones for the man. This means that Yahweh will restore Yahweh's relationship with the man, and the man will be able to worship Yahweh again.

In the next two scenes, Yahweh talks about when semen comes out of a man's penis. So Yahweh first talked about when bad things, like pus, came out of a man's penis, and now Yahweh is talking about when good and normal things, like semen, come out of a man's penis. These situations Yahweh describes are not about a specific event. Instead, Yahweh is giving instructions for any time these things happen.

In the second scene of this passage, Yahweh says that if semen comes out of a man's penis, the man needs to bathe his whole body in water, and that the man will be ritually dirty until evening, which is the next day. Yahweh also says that if the semen touches any piece of clothing or leather item, the man or someone else needs to wash the item with water, and the item is ritually dirty until evening. Yahweh does not say who needs to wash the garment or the leather item because Yahweh does not need any specific person to wash the garment or the leather item that becomes ritually dirty. When Yahweh says "wash," Yahweh means that Yahweh wants someone to thoroughly scrub the cloth in water.

In the final scene, Yahweh says that if a man lies with a woman and semen comes out of the man's penis, then both the man and the woman need to bathe in water. Both the man and the woman will be ritually dirty until evening. In ancient Israel, people used the phrase "lie with" to talk about when people have sex. People did that because people were sometimes uncomfortable talking about sex directly, so people talked about sex indirectly with this phrase and other phrases. Here, Yahweh is clearly talking about sex because Yahweh talks about when semen comes out of the man's penis.

Leviticus 15:13–18

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what are some phrases people use to talk indirectly about sex? When do people use those phrases? Pause this audio here.

In the last passage, Yahweh talked about what to do when a man is ritually dirty. In this passage, Yahweh first talks about what to do when a man is ritually dirty. At the end of this passage, Yahweh talks about what to do when men and women who have sex become ritually dirty. In the next passage, Yahweh will begin to talk about when women are ritually dirty because of things that happen with their vagina. The last scene in this passage talks about both men and women, so Yahweh put it between the section about men and the section about women.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:13–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The man who has a discharge from his penis
- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The Israelites
- The priest
- The man whose semen comes out of his penis
- A man who has sex
- And a woman who has sex with the man

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh explains that when a man with a discharge stops having the discharge, the man needs to wait seven days before the man can become ritually clean. The man needs to wash the man’s clothes and the man’s body in fresh water. Then, on the eighth day, the man who had the discharge needs to take two turtledoves or two pigeons to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. There at the Tent of Meeting, the man gives the birds to a priest. The priest will use one bird to make a purification offering and one bird to make a burnt offering. When the priest makes the two offerings, Yahweh will restore Yahweh’s relationship with the man. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the man who had the discharge from his penis, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am so glad that I am healed and that Yahweh restored my relationship with Yahweh; or
- I am embarrassed that I had this discharge from my penis.

Leviticus 15:13–18

Continue the drama. In the second scene of this passage, Yahweh says that if semen comes out of a man's penis, the man needs to bathe his whole body in water, and that the man will be ritually dirty until evening, which is the next day. Yahweh also says that if the semen touches any piece of clothing or leather item, the man or someone else needs to wash the item with water, and the item is ritually dirty until evening.

In the final scene, Yahweh says that if a man has sex with a woman and semen comes out of the man's penis, then both the man and woman need to bathe in water. Both the man and the woman will be ritually dirty until evening. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the man who had sex, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I always have to bathe after I have sex, so it is normal to me; or
- It is a little annoying that I am ritually dirty until evening every time I have sex; or
- Now that I have had sex, I need to bathe, and I will not be able to go to the Tent of Meeting until evening.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:13–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this part of Leviticus, **Yahweh** is talking about things that make people ritually clean and ritually dirty. Yahweh is God's personal name that Yahweh told the Israelites to call Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

At the beginning of this passage, Yahweh explains that when a man with a discharge stops having the discharge, the man needs to wait seven days before the man can do his **ceremonial cleansing**. Use the same word or phrase for ceremonial cleansing or **purification ceremony** as you used in previous passages. For more information, refer to "purification ceremony" in the Master Glossary.

The man needs to wash the man's clothes and the man's body in **fresh water**. When Yahweh says fresh water, Yahweh means water that is flowing. The Israelites considered still, or unmoving, water unsafe, so the Israelites used running water for important purification. The Israelites often got this water from springs in the ground. Use the same word or phrase for fresh water as you used in previous passages.

When the man who had the discharge waits seven days and washes his clothes and himself, the man will be ritually **clean**. Use the same word or phrase for clean as you used in previous passages. For more information on **clean and unclean**, refer to the Master Glossary.

On the eighth day, the man who had the discharge needs to take two **turtledoves** or two **pigeons** to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. Turtledoves and pigeons are two different kinds of birds that Israelites sacrificed to Yahweh. The difference between the two birds is sometimes unclear. Use the same word or phrase for turtledoves or pigeons as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and look at the photos of the doves again, if needed. Pause this audio here.

The Tent of Meeting is another name for the **tabernacle**. Israelites made their offerings to Yahweh on the altar at the Tent of Meeting, which the Israelites sometimes called the **entrance to the Tent of Meeting**. Use the same words or phrases for "Tent of Meeting" and for "entrance to the Tent of Meeting" as you used in previous passages. For more information on the Tent of Meeting, refer to tabernacle in the Master Glossary.

When the man who had the discharge takes the two birds to the Tent of Meeting, the man gives the birds to a **priest** there. The priests were in charge of helping the Israelites make offerings to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

The priest will use one bird to make a **sin or purification offering** and one bird to make a **burnt offering**. A purification offering is an offering that makes a person ritually clean, which means fit for service to God. A burnt offering was a sacrifice where the priest completely burned an animal on the altar. The burnt offering was a way that people showed Yahweh the people were completely devoted to Yahweh. Use the same words or phrases for purification offering and for burnt offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on purification offering and burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

When a priest makes these two offerings, the priest makes **atonement** for the man who had the discharge. Use the same word or phrase for atonement as you used in previous passages. For more information on atonement, refer to the Master Glossary.

Next, Yahweh says that if semen comes out of a man's penis, the man needs to bathe his whole body in water, and that the man will be ritually dirty until evening. In Israel, the new day starts in the evening, so the man is ritually dirty until the next day. Yahweh also says that if the semen touches any **clothing** or **leather** item, the man or someone else needs to wash the item with water, and the item is ritually dirty until evening. Yahweh is talking about any type of clothing. Use the same general word or phrase for clothing as you used in previous passages. Leather is any material that people make from animal skins, which people clean and turn into a flexible material to use for clothes, tents, and bags.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a leather bag. Pause this audio here.

Next, Yahweh says that if a man lies with a woman and semen comes out of the man's penis, then both the man and the woman need to bathe in water. Both the man and the woman will be ritually dirty until evening. In ancient Israel, people used the phrase "lie with" to talk about when people have sex. People did that because people were sometimes uncomfortable talking about sex directly, so people talked about sex indirectly with this phrase and other phrases.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **lie with**. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same phrase that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 15:13–18

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (4.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.0 MB)

- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 15:19–24

Hear and Heart

NOTE: This passage talks about subjects that you may want to discuss in groups of only men and only women. Discuss as a group if you will listen to this passage in groups of only men and only women. Pause this audio here.

In this step, hear Leviticus 15:19–24 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:19–24 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:19–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

NOTE: This passage talks about subjects that you may want to discuss in groups of only men and only women. Stop here and discuss as a group if you will listen to this passage in groups of only men and only women. Pause this audio here.

In this part of Leviticus, Yahweh is talking about the things that make people ritually clean and unclean, or dirty. In the previous two passages, Yahweh told Moses and Aaron to tell the Israelites what men need to do if a man has pus coming out of his penis. Yahweh also explains what a man and woman need to do when the man and woman have sex with each other. In this passage, Yahweh explains what women need to do when the women are on their period, which is the time of the month when a woman bleeds from her vagina.

First, Yahweh says that when a woman has a discharge of blood that is the regular discharge from her body, the woman will be ritually unclean or dirty for seven days. While the woman is ritually dirty, anyone who touches the woman will also be ritually dirty until the evening, which means after the sun sets. The Israelites started each new day when the sun set, so Yahweh is saying that the person will be ritually dirty until the end of the day.

Then Yahweh explains what happens when the woman is ritually dirty in this way. Everything that the woman lies on while the woman is ritually dirty will also be ritually dirty. Anyone who touches the woman's bed needs to wash their clothes and bathe in water, and that person will be ritually dirty until evening. In Israelite culture, people often used a thick piece of cloth as a bed. People also sometimes used a short wooden table with a mat on top as a bed.

Stop here as a group and look at an image of a mat. Pause this audio here.

Stop here as a group and look at an image of a short table. Pause this audio here.

Also, anyone who touches anything the woman sits on needs to wash their clothes and bathe in water, and that person will be ritually dirty until evening. Then Yahweh says these rules again in a different way. Yahweh says that whether it is the bed the woman lay on or anything the woman sat on, if anyone touches those things, that person will be ritually dirty until evening. These rules are similar to the rules for if a man has pus coming out of his penis. Yahweh does not mention anything here about what people need to do if the woman who is on her period touches pottery, or if the woman spits on someone. This is probably because the woman is not sick while the woman is on her period, so the woman does not need to be as strict about what the woman touches.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what are the rules women need to follow when a woman is on her period? Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 15:19–24

Additionally, Yahweh says that if any man has sex with a woman who is on her period and the woman's impurity touches the man, the man will be ritually dirty for seven days. The woman's impurity is the blood from the woman's period. Yahweh might mean that if the woman's period starts while the man and woman are having sex, then the man is ritually dirty. Later in Leviticus, Yahweh will tell the Israelites that men are never supposed to have sex with a woman while the woman is on her period. Yahweh will say that if a man and a woman have sex while the woman is on her period, then the community will cut the man and woman off from the people of Israel. Because Yahweh will say that later, here Yahweh probably means that if a man and woman have sex before the man and woman realize that the woman is on her period, then the man is ritually dirty for seven days.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what are the rules about having sex with a woman on her period? Pause this audio here.

While the man is ritually dirty, every bed the man lies on also becomes ritually dirty. Yahweh does not say it here, but that means that anyone who touches a bed that the man lies on will be ritually dirty as well.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:19–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh explains that a woman on her period is unclean or ritually dirty for seven days. Yahweh explains what people need to do if someone touches that woman, the bed the woman has lain on, or anything the woman sat on.

In the second scene: Yahweh explains what a man needs to do if the man sleeps with a woman and gets some of the woman's period blood on him.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The Israelites
- A woman on her period
- Anyone who touches the woman on her period
- Anyone who touches the bed that the woman on her period lay on
- Anyone who touches anything that the woman on her period sat on
- And a man who had sex with a woman on her period

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Yahweh talks about when a woman has a flow of blood that is the regular flow of blood from her flesh. Here, Yahweh uses the word "flesh" to refer to the woman's vagina.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what words or phrases do people use to refer to a woman's vagina in a way that is appropriate? What word or phrase would work best in this context? Pause this audio here.

The regular flow of blood is a woman's period, or menstruation.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what words or phrases do people use to refer to a period, or menstruation? What word or phrase would work best in this context? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh gives three different situations that might happen whenever a woman is on her period. In the first situation, Yahweh says that if someone touches the woman, then that person will be ritually dirty until the evening. In the second situation, Yahweh says that anything a woman lies on while the woman is on her period becomes ritually dirty. In the third situation, anything the woman sits on while on her period becomes ritually

dirty. If anyone touches anything the woman lies on, then that person becomes ritually dirty until evening. That person needs to wash themselves and their clothes. Also, if anyone touches anything the woman sat on, then that person becomes ritually dirty until evening and needs to wash themselves and their clothes. Finally, Yahweh says again that if someone touches anything the woman on her period has lain on or sat on, then that person will be ritually dirty until evening. Yahweh is summarizing the rules for when a woman is on her period.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how does a person summarize information that a person has given to someone else? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh explains that if a man has sex with a woman and the woman's period blood touches the man, then the man will be ritually dirty for seven days. While the man is ritually dirty, every bed the man lies on becomes ritually dirty. Probably this means that if someone touches the bed the man was lying on, then that person also becomes ritually dirty until evening, and that person needs to wash themselves and their clothes. Yahweh probably does not say that the person needs to wash their clothes and their hands here because the Israelites already know that Yahweh wants a ritually dirty person to wash.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:19–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The Israelites
- A woman on her period
- Anyone who touches the woman on her period
- Anyone who touches the bed that the woman on her period lay on
- Anyone who touches anything that the woman on her period sat on
- And a man who had sex with a woman on her period

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh says that if a woman has a flow of blood that is the regular flow of blood from the woman's flesh, then the woman is ritually dirty. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a woman on her period, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am in a lot of pain because of this period; or
- I am sad because I am ritually dirty for seven days; or
- I am glad that while I am on my period, I do not have to do my normal activities because I am ritually dirty.

Leviticus 15:19–24

Continue the drama. If someone touches a woman who is on her period, then that person will be ritually dirty until the evening. Also, anything a woman lies on while the woman is on her period becomes ritually dirty, and anything the woman sits on becomes ritually dirty. If anyone touches anything the woman lies on, then that person becomes ritually dirty until evening. That person needs to wash themselves and their clothes. If someone touches anything the woman on her period sat on, then that person will be ritually dirty until evening, and that person needs to wash themselves and their clothes. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing anyone who touches the bed that the woman on her period lay on, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am frustrated that I have to wash because I touched this woman's bed; or
- I do not really mind being ritually dirty until evening.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh explains that if a man has sex with a woman and the woman's period blood touches the man, then the man will be ritually dirty for seven days. While the man is ritually dirty, every bed the man lies on becomes ritually dirty. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a man who had sex with a woman on her period, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I did not realize the woman was on her period when I had sex with the woman; or
- I am frustrated because I am ritually dirty for the next seven days; or
- I am glad that Yahweh decided not to punish me when I accidentally had sex with my wife during my wife's period.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:19–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh says that if a woman has blood flowing from her vagina, then the woman is unclean or **ritually dirty**. Use the same word or phrase for ritually dirty as you used in previous passages. For more information on **clean and unclean**, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for a woman who is bleeding during her regular monthly flow of blood. Pause this audio here.

Everyone who touches the woman will be ritually dirty until **evening**. Use the same word or phrase for evening as you used in previous passages.

People who touch the woman or her things must **bathe in water**. Use the same words or phrases for bathing in fresh water as you have used in previous passages.

Anyone who touches a bed that the woman who is bleeding has lain on will be ritually dirty until evening.

Stop here and look at the pictures of a mat and a short table that people might use as a **bed**. Discuss what word or phrase you will use for bed.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 15:19–24

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (3.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 15:25–33

Hear and Heart

NOTE: This passage talks about subjects you may want to discuss in groups of only men and only women. Stop here and discuss as a group if you will listen to this passage in groups of only men and only women. Pause this audio here.

In this step, hear Leviticus 15:25–33 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:25–33 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:25–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

NOTE: This passage talks about subjects you may want to discuss in groups of only men and only women. Stop here and discuss as a group if you will listen to this passage in groups of only men and only women. Pause this audio here.

In this part of Leviticus, Yahweh is talking about things that make people ritually clean and ritually dirty. In the last few passages, Yahweh has been explaining what the Israelites need to do if someone has a discharge, which means that something flows from a person's genitals. In this passage, Yahweh starts by explaining what a woman needs to do if the woman has blood coming out of her vagina when the woman is not on her period, either because the blood started coming out at a completely different time or because the blood kept flowing

past the normal seven days of a period. As long as the woman has blood coming out of her vagina, the woman is ritually dirty, just like when the woman has a normal period.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what does a woman need to do if the woman starts bleeding from her vagina when it is not the woman's period? Pause this audio here.

As long as the woman has the blood flowing from her vagina, any bed the woman lies on or anything the woman sits on becomes ritually dirty, just like when the woman has a normal period. Anyone who touches the things the woman lies on or sits on becomes ritually dirty, and that person needs to wash their clothes and themselves. After that, the person will stay ritually dirty until evening, when the new day starts.

When blood stops flowing from the woman's vagina, the woman has to wait seven days. After those seven days, the woman is ritually clean. Then, on the eighth day, the woman needs to take two turtledoves or two pigeons to a priest at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting, which people also call the tabernacle. Turtledoves and pigeons are two different kinds of birds that Israelites sacrificed to Yahweh. The difference between the two birds is sometimes unclear.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of doves and pigeons. Pause this audio here.

The priest will use one of the birds to make a sin or purification offering and one of the birds to make a burnt offering. That is how the priest will make atonement for the woman who had blood flowing from her vagina. That means that when the priest makes the two offerings, Yahweh will restore Yahweh's relationship with the woman. Sometimes the Israelites thought that when someone became sick, Yahweh had made that person sick because that person had sinned. It is possible that the woman had to make an offering to get atonement because the woman had sinned. The woman also might need to make a sacrifice because the woman was not able to worship God while the woman had blood coming out of her vagina. The two birds were the least expensive animal sacrifice a person could make, so it seems that Yahweh did not consider a discharge as serious as something like a skin disease.

Yahweh wants the Israelites to follow these rules about what people who have a discharge from their genitals should do. If the Israelites do follow these rules, then the Israelites will keep themselves separate from ritual dirtiness. If the Israelites do not follow these rules, the Israelites will make Yahweh's Tent of Meeting or tabernacle, which is in the middle of the Israelite camp, ritually dirty. If the Israelites make Yahweh's tabernacle ritually dirty, Yahweh will kill the Israelites. The Israelites cannot go near anything holy, like the tabernacle, when the Israelites are ritually dirty.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people treat things that are holy or religious? What happens to a person if someone breaks the rules about things that are religiously or spiritually important? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh says that these are the rules for anyone who has a discharge of any kind. These rules are the rules for a man who has semen come out of his penis, which makes the man ritually dirty. These rules are also the rules for a woman who is on her period, and these are the rules for any man or woman who has an abnormal discharge from their genitals. These rules are also the rules for a man who lies with a woman who is ritually dirty because she is bleeding during her normal monthly period of bleeding.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what does someone have to do when that person has a discharge coming from their genitals? How is that similar or different from the rules Yahweh has given in this and in the last four passages?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:25–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh explains the rules for if a woman is bleeding from her vagina outside of the normal time of the woman's period.

In the second scene: Yahweh explains the rules for when a woman stops bleeding from her vagina.

In the third scene: Yahweh says that the Israelites need to keep ritually dirty things and people away from the tabernacle. Then Yahweh says again that these are the rules for when a person has a discharge coming out of their genitals.

The characters in this passage are:

- A woman who has blood coming out of her vagina outside of the normal time of her period
- A person who touches something that the woman laid on or sat on
- The priest
- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The Israelites
- A man whose semen comes out of his penis
- A woman who has her period
- A person who has an abnormal discharge from their genitals
- And a man who has sex with a woman who is ritually dirty from her period

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh has been telling Moses and Aaron what rules Yahweh has for people who have something flowing out of their genitals. Yahweh had just explained what rules Yahweh has for when a woman has a period. Now, Yahweh explains to Moses and Aaron the rules for when a woman has blood flowing out of her vagina outside of the normal time of her period. Then Yahweh finishes the entire section on what people who have a discharge need to do.

In the first scene, Yahweh says that if a woman has blood coming from her vagina for a long time, and it either goes longer than the woman's normal period or the blood starts flowing outside the woman's normal time for her period, then the woman will become ritually dirty. The woman will be ritually dirty as long as the woman has blood flowing out of her vagina.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you talk about blood flowing from a woman's vagina outside the normal time of a woman's period? What would be the most appropriate way for you to describe the situation here? Pause this audio here.

While the woman who has blood coming out of her vagina outside of the normal time of the woman's period is ritually dirty, anything that the woman lies on or sits on becomes ritually dirty, just like when the woman has her period. Yahweh wants to show the Israelites that the rules for a woman who has blood coming out of her vagina outside of the normal time of her period are the same rules as for a woman who has a normal period. Anyone who touches the bed this woman lay on, or something this woman sat on, will become ritually dirty. That person will need to wash their clothes and themselves. Then that person will be ritually dirty until evening.

In the second scene, Yahweh says that when the woman stops bleeding from her vagina in this abnormal way, the woman needs to wait seven days, and the woman will become clean after that. On the eighth day, the woman has to take two doves or two pigeons to the priest at the entrance to the tabernacle. The entrance was in the courtyard of the tabernacle, near the altar in the courtyard. The priest will use one of the birds to make a sin or purification offering and one of the birds to make a burnt offering. That is how the priest will make atonement for the woman who had blood flowing from her vagina. These are the same rules for how a man who had pus coming out of his penis needs to make atonement after the man becomes ritually clean. In both situations, the people need to restore their relationship with Yahweh, but in both cases, it is not as serious as something like a skin disease.

In the third scene, Yahweh finishes talking about what Israelite people need to do when someone has something come out of their genitals. Yahweh says that Moses and Aaron must keep the Israelites separate from their

uncleanness or ritual dirtiness. When Yahweh says that the Israelites will be separate from their ritual dirtiness, Yahweh means that when the Israelites obey these rules, then the Israelites will stop one person from making everyone ritually dirty by spreading their ritual dirtiness. Yahweh also says that these rules will stop people from dying. The people will die if people make Yahweh's tabernacle ritually dirty, which Yahweh put in the middle of the Israelites' camp. Yahweh wants the Israelites to know that the Israelites need to keep holy things like the tabernacle from becoming ritually dirty.

Finally, Yahweh ends this section of Leviticus by explaining that these are the rules for people who have something flowing from their genitals. Then Yahweh again states which situations Yahweh is talking about: men who have semen coming out of their penis, which makes the men ritually dirty, women who have a period, people who have something abnormal coming out of their genitals, and a man who has sex with a woman who is ritually dirty. These are the situations Yahweh has talked about in Leviticus chapter 15.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:25–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- A woman who has blood coming out of her vagina outside of the normal time of her period
- A person who touches something that the woman laid on or sat on
- The priest
- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The Israelites
- A man whose semen comes out of his penis
- A woman who has her period
- A person who has an abnormal discharge from their genitals
- And a man who has sex with a woman who is ritually dirty from her period

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh says that if a woman has blood come out of her vagina outside of the normal time of the woman's period, then the woman becomes ritually dirty. The woman will be ritually dirty as long as the blood is coming out of her vagina, just like when the woman has a period. So, every bed the woman lies on and everything the woman sits on becomes ritually dirty as well. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a woman who has blood coming out of her vagina outside of the normal time of her period, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This is a really bad thing that is happening to me; or

Leviticus 15:25–33

- I feel sad because I am unclean, and it feels like something is wrong with me; or
- I feel sad because I cannot worship Yahweh until I am ritually clean again.

Continue the drama. Anyone who touches something the woman laid on or sat on becomes ritually dirty, and that person needs to wash their clothes and themselves with water. Once the new day starts in the evening, the person will become ritually clean again.

In the second scene, Yahweh says that if the blood stops flowing from the woman's vagina, then the woman needs to wait seven days. After seven days without blood flowing from her vagina, the woman is clean again. On the eighth day, the woman needs to take two turtledoves or two pigeons to the priest at the entrance to the tabernacle. The priest will use one of the birds to make a purification offering and one of the birds to make a burnt offering. That is how the priest will make atonement for the woman who had blood flowing from her vagina. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a woman who has blood coming out of her vagina outside of the normal time of her period, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so happy that I can be ritually clean again; or
- I am glad that Yahweh restored my relationship with Yahweh.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh says that when the Israelites obey these rules, the Israelites will keep themselves separate from ritual dirtiness, and the Israelites will not die because the Israelites will not make the tabernacle ritually dirty. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- It is really important to keep ritually dirty things away from the tabernacle; or
- I am glad that Yahweh is telling us how we can be safe and have Yahweh's presence in our camp; or
- I am scared because I could die if I do not obey these laws, so I will make sure to do the right thing.

Continue the drama. Yahweh finishes by saying these are the laws for anyone who has a discharge: for a man who has semen coming out of his penis, for a woman who has a period, for anyone who has an abnormal discharge, and for a man who sleeps with a woman who is having a period.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 15:25–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

If a woman has blood coming out of her vagina outside of the normal time of the woman's period, then the woman is unclean or **ritually dirty**. Use the same word or phrase for ritually dirty as you used in previous passages. For more information on **clean and unclean**, refer to the Master Glossary.

The **bed** a woman lies on becomes ritually dirty. Israelites had two different types of beds. One kind was a thick mat that people lay on. The other kind of bed was a short wooden table that a person could lie on. Sometimes people would put a soft mat on a table. Use the same word or phrase for bed as you used in previous passages.

Anyone who touches what this woman lies on or sits on is ritually dirty until **evening**. Evening was the time that the new day started for the Israelites. Use the same word or phrase to translate evening as you used in previous passages.

Anyone who touches things the woman has sat on or lain on needs to wash themselves and their clothes with water. Use the same phrases for **washing with water** as you have used previously.

On the eighth day after the woman stops having blood come out of her vagina, the woman needs to take two turtledoves or two pigeons to the priest at the **entrance** of the Tent of Meeting. The entrance was in the courtyard of the tabernacle, near the altar in the courtyard. Use the same word or phrase for the entrance to the Tent of Meeting that you used in previous passages.

Turtledoves and **pigeons** are two different kinds of birds that Israelites sacrificed to Yahweh. The difference between the two birds is unclear. Use the same words or phrases for turtledoves and pigeons as you used in previous passages. For more information on doves, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here as a group and look again at a photo of doves as needed. Pause this audio here.

The **priests** were the people who helped the Israelites have a good relationship with Yahweh, and the priests did that by sacrificing, or killing, animals to make these offerings for the Israelites. Use the same word or phrase for priests as you used in previous passages. For more information on priests, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that he has put his **tabernacle** in the middle of the Israelites' camp, because the tabernacle was where the Israelites met with Yahweh. The tabernacle is another way to talk about the Tent of Meeting. Use the same word or phrase for the tabernacle as you used in previous passages. For more information on tabernacle, refer to the Master Glossary.

The priest will use one bird to make a **sin or purification offering**. Use the same word or phrase for purification offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on purification offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

The priest will use the other bird to make a **burnt offering**. When people made a burnt offering, the people were showing Yahweh that the people were completely devoted to Yahweh by completely burning an animal. Use the same word or phrase for burnt offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

That is how the priest will make **atonement** for the woman who had blood flowing from her vagina. That means that when the priest makes the two offerings, Yahweh will restore Yahweh's relationship with the woman. Use the same word or phrases for atonement as you used in previous passages. For more information on atonement, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and review as a team the words and phrases you have used for ideas like discharge, menstruation, and sex. Make sure that you have used similar words and phrases throughout Leviticus 15.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 15:25–33

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (3.6 MB)

- Defining the Scenes (4.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 16:1–5

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 16:1–5 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:1–5 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

The next five sections in Leviticus focus on one of the holidays that Yahweh told the people of Israel to celebrate every year. People called this holiday the Day of Atonement, the Day of Cleansing, or Yom Kippur. In this section, Yahweh began to tell Moses how to celebrate the Day of Atonement.

Two important things happened before Yahweh told Moses about the celebration. First, Moses had chosen Moses' older brother Aaron and Aaron's four sons to be Yahweh's priests. To be Yahweh's priests meant that only Aaron and Aaron's sons could burn incense to Yahweh and offer sacrifices of grain and animals to Yahweh. The second important thing that happened was that Aaron's two oldest sons, Nadab and Abihu, burned incense the wrong way and then died. It is unclear whether Nadab and Abihu burned the wrong kind of incense or whether Nadab and Abihu went in to try to see Yahweh when they were burning the incense.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of burning incense. Pause this audio here.

Because Nadab and Abihu burned incense the wrong way, Yahweh began this section by telling Moses to warn Aaron not to come into the Most Holy Place that is behind the curtain whenever Aaron wants to. Yahweh allowed Aaron and Aaron's sons to go into the Holy Place inside the tent where the lampstand, table, and incense altar are. But Yahweh does not allow Aaron and Aaron's sons to go behind the curtain to the Most Holy Place where the ark of the covenant is.

Stop here as a group and look at a diagram of the Tent of Meeting. Notice the difference between the area behind the curtain and the main part of the tent. Pause this audio here.

The top part of the ark of the covenant was the "atonement cover," and the people of Israel thought of the cover as Yahweh's earthly throne. Yahweh had told Moses that Yahweh would talk to Moses from above the atonement cover that was on the ark of the covenant. But no one else could go into that space, the Most Holy Place where the ark of the covenant is. If someone went in to try to see Yahweh, that person would die.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the ark of the covenant. Notice the atonement cover where Yahweh said Yahweh would talk to Moses. Pause this audio here.

But we hear later in this part of Leviticus that once a year, on the Day of Atonement, the high priest could go behind the curtain. When the high priest did this, the high priest would burn incense to create a cloud of smoke. Some people believe that the cloud was to make it so that the high priest would not accidentally see Yahweh and then die.

After Yahweh told Moses to warn Aaron not to come into the Most Holy Place behind the curtain whenever Aaron wants, Yahweh told Moses the only way that Aaron may come into that area. On the Day of Atonement, Aaron could go into the Most Holy Place behind the curtain. When Aaron did, Aaron needed to bring to the Tent of Meeting a young bull for a purification or sin offering and a ram for a burnt offering.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a young bull and a ram. Pause this audio here.

Aaron also needed to wear special linen clothes. These clothes included a linen tunic, linen undergarments, a linen sash around Aaron's waist, and a linen turban or hat on Aaron's head. These linen clothes were different from the usual clothes that the high priest would wear. These linen clothes were simpler and less fancy. Nobody knows exactly why these clothes were different, but the priests only wore these clothes for the Day of Atonement ritual. These linen clothes were holy to Yahweh, and so people needed to treat the clothes with extra respect.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When people in your culture perform religious or sacred rituals, what kind of special clothing do those people need to wear? Why? Pause this audio here.

In order to prepare for this yearly ceremony, Aaron needed to wash his body with water and then put on the special linen clothes. Washing with water was an important part to be ritually clean. One of the purposes of this annual ritual was to cleanse everyone and everything from all of the ways that the people of Israel had betrayed and rebelled against Yahweh. When people betrayed Yahweh and rebelled against Yahweh, they had made the priest's family, the holy place, the bronze altar, and the people of Israel ritually and spiritually dirty. That ritual and spiritual dirtiness had built up throughout the year. The Day of Atonement was the day on which the high priest performed the ritual to cleanse everything and everyone from being ritually and spiritually dirty. Because of that, the high priest got ready for the Day of Atonement by first washing his body with water to become clean and then putting on the holy linen clothes.

After Aaron had washed and dressed in the appropriate clothing, the representatives of the people of Israel needed to give Aaron two young goats, probably male, for a purification offering, and one ram for a burnt offering.

Stop and look at a picture of a young goat.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses to warn Aaron that Aaron cannot come into the Most Holy Place behind the curtain whenever Aaron wants.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron what Aaron has to do to prepare to come into the Most Holy Place behind the curtain.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- Aaron's two oldest sons, Nadab and Abihu
- And the assembly, or representatives of the people of Israel

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Leviticus 16:1–5

In this passage, Yahweh talks about things that happen at the Tent of Meeting. Pay special attention to the most holy area behind the curtain, where the ark of the covenant is.

The first scene starts by explaining the background of the Day of Atonement. Before Yahweh talked with Moses to explain the instructions for the Day of Atonement, Aaron's two oldest sons, Nadab and Abihu, had burned incense to Yahweh the wrong way and had died. Although the original story does not say exactly why Nadab and Abihu died, some translations include the information that Nadab and Abihu had burned incense in the wrong way. You may include that information if it is helpful.

Stop and discuss: Tell someone a set of rules and instructions about something important. Pretend that the person you are telling the rules to has a close family member or friend who already broke the rules, and the community has punished that family member or friend. How does the person who tells the rules explain the reason they tell the listener the rules? How does the person mention what has already happened? Pause this audio here.

Some time after Nadab and Abihu died, Yahweh tells Moses to warn Aaron not to come into the most holy area behind the curtain where the ark of the covenant is. Yahweh tells Moses, "Tell your brother Aaron that Aaron cannot come into the most holy area behind the curtain whenever Aaron wants to. If Aaron does, then Aaron will die. That is because the atonement cover is behind the curtain, and I am going to appear in a cloud above the atonement cover."

Stop and discuss: Tell someone a set of rules and instructions about something important. How does the person who tells the rules emphasize how important these rules are? Pause this audio here.

The second scene continues with Yahweh talking to Moses about what to tell Aaron. In this scene, Yahweh focuses on what Aaron needs to do when Aaron goes into the most holy area behind the curtain so that Aaron does not die. Yahweh says, "When Aaron comes into the most holy area behind the curtain, Aaron needs to bring a young bull for a purification offering, and a ram for a burnt offering." We know that Aaron does not bring the actual bull and ram into the most holy area behind the curtain. This probably means that Aaron must bring these animals for these offerings when Aaron comes to the Tent of Meeting to prepare to go into the most holy area behind the curtain.

Aaron also needs to wear the holy linen clothing. This clothing includes a linen tunic, linen undergarments, a linen sash around Aaron's waist, and a linen turban or hat on Aaron's head. Yahweh describes these events out of order because the next thing Yahweh describes Aaron doing is the first thing that Aaron needs to do in order to get ready for these offerings. The first thing Aaron needs to do is to wash Aaron's body with water, and then put on all of the holy linen clothing.

Stop and look at a picture of what the high priest might have worn during the Day of Atonement ritual. Pause this audio here.

Then, after Aaron has washed himself and dressed in the holy linen clothing, Aaron will need to get the bull and the ram for his own offerings. Aaron will also need to get three animals from the assembly, which is the group of representatives of the people of Israel. The three animals that Aaron will need are two young goats and one ram. The two young goats are for the purification offering, and the ram is for the burnt offering.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses

Leviticus 16:1–5

- Aaron
- Aaron's two oldest sons, Nadab and Abihu
- And the assembly, or representatives of the people of Israel

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Scene one starts by explaining the background of the Day of Atonement. Aaron's two oldest sons, Nadab and Abihu, had burned incense to Yahweh the wrong way and then died.

After Nadab and Abihu died, Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron, "Tell your brother Aaron that Aaron cannot come into the most holy area behind the curtain whenever Aaron wants to. If Aaron does, then Aaron will die. That is because the atonement cover is behind the curtain, and I am going to appear in a cloud above the atonement cover." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that Nadab and Abihu died, and I do not want any more people to die; or
- I really hope Aaron and Aaron's descendants listen to me.

Continue the drama. Scene two continues as Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron what Aaron has to do before Aaron can go into the most holy area behind the curtain.

Yahweh says, "When it is time for Aaron to come into the most holy area behind the curtain, Aaron first needs to bring a young bull for a purification offering, and a ram for a burnt offering. Aaron also needs to wear the holy linen clothing. This clothing includes a linen tunic, linen undergarments, a linen sash around Aaron's waist, and a linen turban or hat on Aaron's head. To get ready, Aaron first needs to wash his body with water, and then put on all of the holy linen clothing." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that my sons died, and I wish my sons had done the right thing; or
- I am glad Yahweh is telling me what to do so I will not die; or
- I feel very serious as I get ready to go into Yahweh's presence.

Continue the drama. Yahweh says, "Then, after Aaron has washed himself and dressed in the holy linen clothing, Aaron will need to get three animals from the representatives of the people of Israel. The three animals that Aaron will need are two young goats and one ram. The two young goats are for the purification offering, and the ram is for the burnt offering."

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Before, Aaron's two oldest sons burned incense as **unauthorized fire** to **Yahweh** and died. Use the same terms for unauthorized fire and for Yahweh as you used before. Yahweh is in the Master Glossary.

After Aaron's sons died, Yahweh tells Moses, "Tell your brother Aaron that Aaron cannot come into the **holy area behind the curtain** whenever Aaron wants to." This is where the ark of the covenant was. A curtain separated

this area from the rest of the tent. Some translations call this area the "**Most Holy Place**" behind the curtain to show that it is different from the front room of the tabernacle.

Stop here as a group and look at a diagram of the Tent of Meeting. Notice the difference between the area behind the curtain and the main part of the tent. Discuss how best to refer to the area behind the curtain. For more information, refer to "Most Holy Place" in the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Aaron cannot come behind the curtain in front of the atonement cover. The atonement cover was the lid of the ark of the covenant. The people of Israel thought of the atonement cover as Yahweh's earthly throne. Yahweh had told Moses that Yahweh would talk to Moses from above the atonement cover that was on the ark of the covenant.

Stop here and look at a picture of the ark of the covenant as a group. Notice the **atonement cover** where Yahweh said Yahweh would talk to Moses from. Look up the "ark of the covenant" in the Master Glossary for more information. Discuss what word or phrase you will use to talk about the atonement cover. For more information about **atonement**, see the Master Glossary. If you have already translated the book of Exodus, use the same term for "atonement cover" throughout this book as well. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that Aaron must not come in front of the atonement cover whenever Aaron wants to because Yahweh will appear in a cloud on top of the atonement cover. If Aaron goes into that area on the wrong day or in the wrong way, Aaron will die. This word cloud refers both to the clouds in the sky and to a cloud of smoke or incense.

Stop here and look at a picture of a cloud of incense or smoke. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **cloud** here. If your language also uses the same word for both clouds in the sky and clouds of smoke or incense, use that word. If your language uses different words, then use the word that refers to a cloud of smoke or incense. Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron what Aaron has to do before Aaron can go into the holy area behind the curtain on the Day of Atonement. Yahweh says, "When Aaron comes into the holy area behind the curtain, Aaron needs to bring a young bull for a **sin or purification offering**, and a ram for a **burnt offering**." Look up purification offering and burnt offering in the Master Glossary for more information. Use the same term for purification offering and burnt offering as you used before.

Aaron also needs to wear the **holy linen** clothing. Look up holy in the Master Glossary for more information. Use the same terms for holy and linen as you used before.

The holy linen clothing included a linen tunic, linen undergarments, a linen sash around Aaron's waist, and a linen turban or hat on Aaron's head. The tunic would have covered the top half of the priest's body and likely covered his legs all the way down to his ankles. The priest would have worn the undergarments underneath the tunic. The sash would have been a strip of cloth that went around the priest's waist. The priest would have worn the turban or hat on top of his head.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of what the priestly garments might have looked like. Discuss what words or phrases you will use for **tunic**, **undergarments**, **sash**, and **turban** or **hat**. See the Master Glossary for more information about tunic. If you have already translated the book of Exodus, use the same terms throughout this book as well. Pause this audio here.

To get ready, Aaron first needs to wash his body with water and then put on all of the holy linen clothing. Then, after Aaron has washed himself and dressed in the holy linen clothing, Aaron will need to get three animals from the assembly of the people of Israel. Here, the assembly, or community of Israel, refers to all of the free adult men who had the power and authority to make decisions that affected the entire nation of Israel. It did not include the women, slaves, or children.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **assembly of the people of Israel**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, decide if it is appropriate to use the same word that you have used there. For more information about **Israelites**, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

The three animals that Aaron will need from the community of Israel are two young goats and one ram. The two young goats are for the purification offering, and the ram is for the burnt offering. Use the same words for young goats and the ram as you have used previously.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 16:1–5

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (961 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 16:6–14

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 16:6–14 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:6–14 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.

6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:6–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh gave Moses the instructions for the rest of the work that Aaron needed to do to prepare for the Day of Atonement ritual. Yahweh also gave the instructions for the first part of the Day of Atonement ritual, where Aaron would cleanse himself and Aaron's family from the ways that Aaron and Aaron's family had betrayed and rebelled against Yahweh throughout the year. Even though Yahweh talked about what Aaron needed to do in this ritual, once Aaron died, the next high priest would be the one to do the ritual. This high priest would have been one of Aaron's direct blood descendants. When you listen to what Aaron needed to do, remember that these instructions are not only for Aaron but for every high priest that ever lived.

So, to begin, Aaron must have three animals at the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. These were a bull and two goats. You will remember from the last passage that Aaron and the community also brought two rams to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. Aaron would use those two rams at a later part of the ceremony. The first animal was a bull that Aaron would later sacrifice as a purification or sin offering that would cleanse, or atone for, Aaron and Aaron's entire household. A man's household included the man's wife and concubines, the man's sons, the man's unmarried daughters, and the man's slaves. This included the slaves the man had bought from someone else, and the slaves who were born to slaves who already belonged to the family. People did not consider visitors and hired workers to be members of the household.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, who all is a part of the person's household? Pause this audio here.

The next two animals were the two goats that Aaron had already gotten from the representatives of the people of Israel. To prepare for later in the ritual, Aaron needed to bring both goats to the entrance, or courtyard, of the Tent of Meeting. This courtyard was part of Yahweh's earthly home, which was the tent itself. That is why Aaron needed to present the two goats to Yahweh in the courtyard.

After Aaron presented the goats to Yahweh, Aaron needed to cast lots for the goats. Different people who lived around the Israelites cast lots in different ways. To cast lots, people used physical objects to determine what a god or goddess wanted the people to do. Because the people of Israel made a binding agreement, or a covenant, with Yahweh that Yahweh would be their only God, the Israelites were only supposed to cast lots to see what Yahweh wanted. And Yahweh also told the Israelites not to cast lots in most of the ways that other people did. Most of the normal ways to cast lots allowed the person who interpreted the lots to make up an answer. Yahweh did not want this to happen. Yahweh made it illegal for the people of Israel to cast lots in ways that would allow the person who interpreted the lot to say something different than what Yahweh actually said.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people discover what a god, spirit, or ancestor wants? How are those ways similar or different from what Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to do? Pause this audio here.

Instead of casting lots the way everyone else did, the people of Israel were usually supposed to have Aaron and Aaron's descendants, who were the priests, use the Urim and the Thummim.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of what the Urim and Thummim might have looked like. Pause this audio here.

Nobody knows exactly how the Urim and Thummim worked. Some people believe that one of the stones would glow. Other people believe that the priests rolled the stones. Still other people believe that the priests put stones into a bag and then shook the bag until one of the stones came out. Even though we do not know exactly how the stones worked, we do know that Yahweh always had the option not to answer at all.

For the Day of Atonement, Aaron probably used the Urim and Thummim to cast lots for the two goats. This process was to determine which goat to give to Yahweh and which goat to release. Later in the second part of the Day of Atonement ritual, Aaron would sacrifice the goat for Yahweh as a purification offering. Then, in the third part of the Day of Atonement ritual, Aaron would present the second goat to Yahweh. This other goat had

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to be alive to cleanse the people. Later in the ritual, someone would send this goat into an area where nobody lived. When the goat left, the goat would carry away all of the spiritual dirtiness that had spread among the people and the community because of all the ways that the people had betrayed and rebelled against Yahweh and done wrong to other people throughout the year.

Once Aaron had prepared the bull and cast lots for the two goats, Aaron could begin the first part of the ritual of the Day of Atonement. First, Aaron would kill the bull that Aaron would use as the purification offering for himself and Aaron's entire household. This bull's blood would atone, or cleanse Aaron and Aaron's entire household from all of the ways Aaron and Aaron's household had betrayed and rebelled against Yahweh and done wrong to other people throughout the year. That cleansing meant that Yahweh would not punish Aaron and Aaron's household. Offering Yahweh the bull was also how the high priest and the high priest's household would make amends with Yahweh, which would restore their relationship with Yahweh.

After Aaron killed the bull, Aaron would take a censer full of burning coals from the bronze altar that was in the courtyard surrounding Yahweh's tent.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of what the censer might have looked like. Pause this audio here.

After Aaron filled the censer with burning coals from the bronze altar, Aaron would take a handful of the sweet-smelling, finely-ground incense. Incense is a blend of several spices that smells good when people burn it. For this particular incense, Yahweh had told Moses the recipe of the different spices that Yahweh wanted the Israelites to use for Yahweh's incense, and people could only use this particular recipe for Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When do people burn incense or spices to smell good in your culture? Why do people burn those spices or incense? Pause this audio here.

Then Aaron would take the censer full of burning coals and the handful of incense behind the curtain and into the Most Holy Place of the Tent of Meeting, where the ark of the covenant was. Next, Aaron would take the handful of incense and put the incense on the censer full of burning coals. The burning incense would create a cloud that would surround the atonement cover that was on top of the ark of the covenant. Sometimes people called this ark the "Testimony" or the "ark of the Testimony." This is because the word in the original language that people translate here as "Testimony" was one name for the ten commands that Yahweh wrote on two tablets of stone. These commands were part of the covenant that the people of Israel promised to obey. Moses later put these stone tablets inside the ark.

The reason Aaron was supposed to cover the atonement cover is that it was where Yahweh said Yahweh would meet with Moses. Since Yahweh's presence was there, Aaron needed to cover the top with a cloud of incense so Aaron would not die. Some people believe it was so that Aaron would not see Yahweh's presence and die. Some people believe it was so that Aaron—and later priests—would remember what happened when Yahweh came down on top of Mount Sinai and made the covenant with the people of Israel.

Once there was a cloud of incense to protect Aaron, Aaron would take some of the bull's blood and use his fingers to sprinkle the blood seven times. The number seven is an important number in the Bible because Israelite people believed that the number seven represented completeness or wholeness.

Yahweh said that Aaron needed to sprinkle the bull's blood on the east side of the atonement cover and in front of the atonement cover. The east side would have been the side that faces where the sun rose in the morning. It was also the side of the atonement cover that would have faced Aaron when Aaron entered that part of the tent behind the curtain.

It is not clear whether the words "on top of the atonement cover" and "in front of the atonement cover" refer to the same place. Some people believe that it is the same place. If that is true, then Aaron would enter the tent, see the side of the atonement cover that was facing Aaron, and use his finger to sprinkle the bull's blood seven times. The blood would fall on top of the atonement cover and in front of the atonement cover.

However, some people believe that "on top of the atonement cover" and "in front of the atonement cover" do not refer to the same place. If that is true, then Aaron would enter the tent, see the side of the atonement cover that was facing Aaron, and use his finger to sprinkle the bull's blood on top of the atonement cover seven times.

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Then, Aaron would use his finger to sprinkle the bull's blood on top of the space in front of the atonement cover. Aaron would do this seven times also.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:6–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh gave Moses the instructions for the rest of the things that the high priest needed to do to prepare for the Day of Atonement ritual.

In the second scene: Yahweh gave Moses the instructions for what the high priest needed to do to cleanse the high priest and the high priest's household from the ways that the high priest and the high priest's family had betrayed and rebelled against Yahweh throughout the year.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Aaron the high priest
- Aaron's household
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh talked about what Aaron would do at the Tent of Meeting, especially at the entrance to the courtyard, the bronze altar that is in the courtyard, and the ark of the covenant that is in the Most Holy Place behind the curtain in the tent itself. The important part of the ark of the covenant is the east side that faces where the sun rises.

In scene one, Yahweh continued to tell Moses what Aaron needed to do to prepare for the Day of Atonement ritual. Remember that these instructions for Aaron will also be for every high priest after Aaron.

Stop here and have someone tell someone instructions that apply to that person and to that person's children when the person's children grow up. How does the speaker clearly show that the instructions apply to that person right now and to that person's descendants many years later? Pause this audio here.

Aaron has already begun preparing for the ritual by washing himself and putting on the special clothes. Since Aaron finished those actions, Yahweh gave Aaron instructions on how to use three of the animals that Aaron and the people had gathered for these offerings. The first animal was a bull that Aaron would sacrifice later in the ritual as a purification offering that would cleanse, or atone for, Aaron and Aaron's entire household. The next two animals were the two goats that Aaron had already gotten from the representatives of the people of Israel. To prepare for later in the ritual, Aaron needed to bring both goats to the courtyard, or entrance, of the Tent of Meeting.

After Aaron presented the goats to Yahweh, Aaron needed to cast lots for the goats. Aaron would sacrifice one goat to Yahweh as the purification offering. Aaron would present the other goat alive to Yahweh, and then someone else would send that goat away into an area where no one lived. Even though Yahweh explained what was going to happen to both goats in this section, none of that had happened yet. Aaron would cast the lots first, and then later on, Aaron would sacrifice Yahweh's goat and have someone send the other goat away.

Stop here and have someone tell someone else instructions for how to prepare for an activity, and then instructions for how to actually do that activity. How does the speaker clearly show there is a shift between preparing to do an activity and doing the activity? Pause this audio here.

In scene two, Yahweh gave instructions for how Aaron would begin the first part of the Day of Atonement ritual. First, Aaron would kill the bull that Aaron would use as the purification offering for Aaron and Aaron's entire household. This bull's blood would atone, or cleanse, Aaron and Aaron's entire household from all of the

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ways Aaron and Aaron's household had betrayed and rebelled against Yahweh and done wrong to other people throughout the year.

After Aaron killed the bull, Aaron would take a censer full of burning coals from the bronze altar that was in the courtyard surrounding Yahweh's tent. Then Aaron would take a handful of the sweet-smelling, finely-ground incense.

Then Aaron would bring the censer full of burning coals in one hand and a handful of incense in the other hand behind the curtain and into the Most Holy Place of the Tent of Meeting, where the ark of the covenant was. Then Aaron would put the handful of incense on the censer full of burning coals. The burning incense would create a cloud that would surround the atonement cover that was on top of the ark of the covenant. This cloud would protect Aaron from dying.

Stop here and talk about what happens when you put certain things into a fire and it causes a lot of smoke. How do you describe what happens? Pause this audio here.

After Aaron had made a cloud of incense, Aaron would take some of the bull's blood and use his finger to sprinkle the blood seven times. Aaron needed to sprinkle the bull's blood on top of the atonement cover and in front of the atonement cover on the east side. The east side would have been the side that faced where the sun rose in the morning. It would also have been the side of the ark that was facing Aaron when Aaron went into the area behind the curtain.

It is not clear whether the words "on top of the atonement cover" and "in front of the atonement cover" refer to the same place. Some people believe that it is the same place. If that is true, then Aaron would enter the tent, see the side of the atonement cover that was facing Aaron, and use his finger to sprinkle the bull's blood seven times. The blood would fall on top of the atonement cover and in front of the atonement cover.

However, some people believe that "on top of the atonement cover" and "in front of the atonement cover" do not refer to the same place. If that is true, then Aaron would enter the tent, see the side of the atonement cover that was facing Aaron, and use his finger to sprinkle the bull's blood on top of the atonement cover seven times. Then Aaron would use his finger to sprinkle the bull's blood on top of the space in front of the atonement cover. Aaron would do this seven times also.

Stop here and act out both options. Then, discuss which option you think is most likely. Act out that option again and discuss how to explain what is happening. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:6–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Aaron the high priest
- Aaron's household
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

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The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In scene one, Yahweh continued to tell Moses what Aaron needed to do to prepare for the Day of Atonement ritual. To begin, Aaron needed three animals at the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. The first animal was a bull that Aaron would sacrifice later in the ritual as a purification or sin offering that would cleanse, or atone for, Aaron and Aaron's entire household. The next two animals were the two goats that Aaron had already gotten from the representatives of the people of Israel. To prepare for later in the ritual, Aaron needed to bring both goats to the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting.

After Aaron presented the goats to Yahweh, Aaron needed to cast lots for the goats. Aaron would sacrifice one goat to Yahweh as the purification offering. Aaron would present the other goat alive to Yahweh, and then someone else would send that goat away into an area where no one lived. Both of these things would happen later in the ritual.

In scene two, Aaron would begin the first part of the Day of Atonement ritual. First, Aaron would kill the bull that Aaron would use as the purification offering for Aaron and Aaron's entire household. This bull's blood would atone, or cleanse, Aaron and Aaron's entire household from all of the ways Aaron and Aaron's household had betrayed and rebelled against Yahweh and done wrong to other people throughout the year.

After Aaron killed the bull, Aaron would take a censer full of burning coals from the bronze altar that was in the courtyard surrounding Yahweh's tent. Then Aaron would take a handful of the sweet-smelling, finely-ground incense.

Aaron would bring the censer full of burning coals in one hand and a handful of incense in the other hand behind the curtain and into the Most Holy Place of the Tent of Meeting, where the ark of the covenant was. Then Aaron would put the handful of incense on the censer full of burning coals. The burning incense would create a cloud that would surround the atonement cover that was on top of the ark of the covenant. This cloud would protect Aaron from dying. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am afraid to enter Yahweh's presence, but I am glad Yahweh has a way to protect me; or
- I am happy that Yahweh wants me to live; or
- This reminds me of when Yahweh came down on top of Mount Sinai, and there was fire and a big cloud to hide Yahweh's presence.

Continue the drama. After Aaron had made a cloud of incense, Aaron would take some of the bull's blood and use his fingers to sprinkle the blood on the east side of the atonement cover and in front of the atonement cover. The east side would have been the side that faced where the sun rose in the morning. Aaron needed to sprinkle the bull's blood with his finger seven times.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:6–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, **Yahweh** continued to tell Moses what Aaron needed to do to prepare for the Day of Atonement ritual. Look up Yahweh in the Master Glossary for more information. Translate Yahweh the same way you have done previously.

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To begin, Aaron needed to bring three animals to the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. The first animal was a bull that Aaron would sacrifice later in the ritual as a **sin or purification offering**. Look up purification offering in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for purification offering as you used in previous passages.

This purification offering would cleanse, or **atone** for, Aaron and Aaron's entire household. Look up atonement in the Master Glossary for more information. Use the same word or phrase for atone as you used in previous passages.

A man's household included the man's wives and concubines, the man's sons, the man's unmarried daughters, and the man's slaves. These were the slaves that the man bought from someone else as well as the slaves who were born to slaves who already belonged to the family. Visitors and hired workers were not members of the household.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **household**. Look up household in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

The next two animals were the two goats that Aaron had already gotten from the representatives of the people of Israel.

To prepare for later in the ritual, Aaron needed to bring both goats to the entrance, or courtyard of the **Tent of Meeting**. Look up **tabernacle** in the Master Glossary for more information. Translate "Tent of Meeting" and "entrance to the Tent of Meeting" in the same way you have done previously.

After Aaron presented the goats to Yahweh, Aaron needed to cast lots for the goats. Casting lots refers to the practice where people used physical objects to determine what a god or goddess wanted the people to do. Nobody knows exactly how casting lots worked. Some people believe that one of the stones or objects would glow. Other people believe that the priests rolled the stones. Still other people believe that the priests put stones into a bag and then shook the bag until one of the stones came out. Yahweh had told the people of Israel that the Israelites must only cast lots to see what Yahweh wanted. Yahweh also told the Israelites not to cast lots the way that many of the people around the Israelites did. For this ritual, the people of Israel probably used the Urim and the Thummim, but we do not know that for certain. Use a word that focuses on the idea of using physical objects to know what Yahweh wants. Keep in mind that Yahweh had forbidden the people of Israel from casting lots in ways that would allow the person who interpreted the lot to say something different than what Yahweh actually said.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **cast lots**. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, decide if it is appropriate to use the same phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The lots would decide which goat belonged to Yahweh and which goat was the **scapegoat**. Nobody knows exactly what Yahweh meant by this description of this goat. Some people think it refers to a rough and challenging place, like the wilderness where the goat was sent later in the ritual. Other people think it means "a goat that someone sent away." Regardless of what the word means, Aaron would present the scapegoat alive to Yahweh, and then someone else would send that goat away into the wilderness, which was an area where no one lived.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for this kind of goat. Pause this audio here.

If you use the idea of **wilderness** in your word for scapegoat, look up wilderness in the Master Glossary for more information, if needed. Decide if it is appropriate to translate wilderness the same way you have done previously. Pause this audio here.

Later in the Day of Atonement ritual, Aaron would sacrifice one goat to Yahweh as the purification offering. Aaron would present the other goat alive to Yahweh, and then someone else would send that goat away into an area where no one lived.

After Aaron finished preparing for the Day of Atonement ritual, Aaron would begin the first part. First, Aaron would kill the bull for the purification offering for Aaron and Aaron's entire household. This bull's blood would atone, or cleanse, Aaron and Aaron's entire household from all of the ways that Aaron and Aaron's household had betrayed and rebelled against Yahweh and done wrong to other people throughout the year.

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After Aaron killed the bull, Aaron would take a censer full of burning coals from the bronze altar that was in the courtyard surrounding Yahweh's tent.

Stop here and look at a picture of a censer as a group. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for censer. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, decide if it is appropriate to use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Then Aaron would take a handful of the sweet-smelling, finely-ground incense. Incense was a blend of several spices that would smell good when people burned the spices. For this particular incense, Yahweh had told Moses the recipe of the different spices that Yahweh wanted the Israelites to use for Yahweh's incense. People could only use this particular recipe for Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **incense**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, decide if it is appropriate to use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Aaron would bring the censer full of burning coals in one hand and a handful of incense in the other hand behind the curtain and into the sacred place of the Tent of Meeting. Then Aaron would put the handful of incense on the censer full of burning coals. The burning incense would create a cloud that would surround the atonement cover that was on top of the Testimony, which people also called the ark of the covenant.

Stop here and look up **Testimony** and **ark of the covenant** in the Master Glossary for more information. Decide whether or not to translate the Testimony the same way you have done previously. Pause this audio here.

This **cloud** would protect Aaron from dying. Use the same word for cloud as you used in previous passages.

After Aaron had made a cloud of incense, Aaron would take some of the bull's blood and use his fingers to **sprinkle** the blood on the east side of the **atonement cover** and in front of the atonement cover. The east side would have been the side that faced where the sun rose in the morning. Use the same word or phrase for sprinkle and for atonement cover as you used in previous passages.

Aaron needed to sprinkle the bull's blood with his finger seven times.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 16:6–14

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1012 KB)
- Setting the Stage (7.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (6.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 16:15–22

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 16:15–22 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:15–22 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:15–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this section, Yahweh continued to tell Moses the instructions to tell Aaron about the Day of Atonement ritual. After Aaron finished atoning for Aaron and Aaron's household, Aaron needed to kill Yahweh's goat as a sin or purification offering. This would cleanse the Most Holy Place from all of the bad things that the people of Israel did throughout the year.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a goat. Pause this audio here.

After killing the goat, Aaron needed to bring the goat's blood behind the curtain in the Tent of Meeting, where the ark of the covenant was. Then Aaron needed to do the same thing with the goat's blood that Aaron did with the bull's blood in the previous passage. This means that Aaron needed to use his fingers to sprinkle the goat's blood seven times on the east side, on top of the atonement cover and in front of the atonement cover. The east side would have been the side that faced where the sun rose in the morning. The east side was also the side of the atonement cover that would have faced Aaron when Aaron entered that part of the tent behind the curtain.

Aaron would use the goat's blood to cleanse, or atone for, the Holy Place. When Yahweh told Aaron to cleanse the Holy Place during the Day of Atonement, Yahweh probably meant the "Most Holy Place," or the part of the tent that was behind the curtain. This was where the ark of the covenant was.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the ark of the covenant. Pause this audio here.

Stop here as a group and look at a diagram of the inside of the Tent of Meeting. Notice the area behind the curtain and where the ark of the covenant is. Pause this audio here.

After Aaron cleansed the part of the Holy Place that was behind the curtain, Aaron needed to cleanse the whole Tent of Meeting. This included the main part of the tent, where the incense altar, lampstand, and table with

the bread were. The whole Tent of Meeting was holy, and so was everything inside the tent, so Aaron needed to cleanse the whole tent as well.

Nobody knows exactly how Aaron was supposed to cleanse the Tent of Meeting. Aaron probably did a similar thing to what Aaron just did to cleanse the holy area behind the curtain. This means that Aaron probably sprinkled the goat's blood on the items in the front room of the Tent of Meeting, but we do not know exactly what Aaron did.

Yahweh told Aaron to cleanse the Most Holy Place behind the curtain and the Tent of Meeting because the Israelites had made the Most Holy Place ritually dirty with all of the ways the people had rebelled against Yahweh and betrayed Yahweh throughout the year. The bad things that the Israelites did made the Israelites and the things and places around the Israelites spiritually unclean, or ritually dirty. Since Yahweh's tent was in the middle of where the Israelites were living in their tents, all of the bad things that the Israelites did made both the Israelites' own tents and Yahweh's tent ritually dirty. That was why Aaron needed to cleanse Yahweh's tent once a year during this ritual.

People in the Bible often used the same word "unclean" or ritually dirty to talk about things that were physically dirty and things that were morally or spiritually dirty. Things that were physically dirty were things like dead bodies of people and animals, genital discharge, and certain diseases. Things that were morally and spiritually dirty were things like murdering someone, stealing from someone, cheating on the person you married, worshipping false gods and goddesses, and doing other bad things to Yahweh or other people. In the laws that Yahweh gave the people through Moses, Yahweh said that both the things that made people physically dirty and the things that made people morally or spiritually dirty also made people ritually dirty. If someone was ritually dirty, that person could not go near any place or anything that was holy, which meant that person could not participate in many religious ceremonies and festivals. In order to become ritually clean, the people of Israel would need to do cleansing rituals and sometimes offer sacrifices of animals throughout the year to make themselves ritually clean from the physical dirt and the spiritual dirt. And once a year, the head priest would need to do this Day of Atonement ritual to make all of the people and the entire Holy Place clean from the ritual dirt. Once the priests, the Holy Place, and the people became ritually clean, the people could continue to worship Yahweh at the Holy Place.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How does your culture talk about things that are both physically dirty and spiritually dirty? Do people need to do anything special to become clean from these kinds of dirt? Pause this audio here.

And while Aaron was inside the tent itself, cleansing the Most Holy Place behind the curtain and the Tent of Meeting, nobody else could go into the Tent of Meeting. Usually, Yahweh allowed the priests to go into the Tent of Meeting. However, while Aaron was doing the Day of Atonement ritual, Yahweh did not allow anyone else to go into the Tent of Meeting. The priests had to wait until after Aaron had finished cleansing the Most Holy Place behind the curtain and the Tent of Meeting, and the entire community of Israel.

After Aaron cleansed the Most Holy Place behind the curtain and the Tent of Meeting, Aaron had to go to the bronze altar that was in the courtyard and cleanse, or atone for, the altar. This was the altar in the courtyard where the priests would offer the people's offerings of animals and grain throughout the year.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the bronze altar. Pause this audio here.

To cleanse the bronze altar, Aaron needed to use some of the bull's blood and some of the goat's blood that Aaron had used to cleanse the Holy Place. Aaron would put the blood of the bull and goat on the horns of the bronze altar. Then Aaron was supposed to use his fingers to sprinkle some of the blood on the altar seven times.

The Israelites had made the bronze altar spiritually unclean. But with the blood, Aaron would cleanse the bronze altar and rededicate the altar, to make the altar holy to Yahweh again. Once Aaron finished cleansing, or atoning for, the Most Holy Place behind the curtain, the Tent of Meeting, and the bronze altar, Aaron had to get the live goat. This was the goat that the lots had marked to go away into a place where no one lived.

Aaron was supposed to put both his hands on the head of the live goat and announce over the goat all of the bad things that the people of Israel had done throughout the year. Aaron must announce all of the evil things, or iniquities, that the people of Israel did, including all of the transgressions or rebellions and all of the people's sin or betrayal.

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This word for iniquity refers to actions and behavior so evil that someone needs to severely punish the person who did that evil thing. Some of the things that people in the Bible thought were evil enough to be called iniquities were: someone killing their blood brother, a priest trying to take Yahweh's place and become a god, and the people of Israel breaking their promise to Yahweh and worshipping and serving fake gods and goddesses.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What kinds of things do people in your culture think are so evil that someone needs to severely punish that person? How would you describe that kind of evil thing? Pause this audio here.

The word for transgressions, or rebellions, refers to actions that cross a boundary line that Yahweh has put in place. For example, people might cross a physical boundary by stealing from someone else. People might cross a moral boundary by doing something especially bad like selling their blood brother into slavery. People might cross a leadership boundary line by rebelling against the leader whom Yahweh chose.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What kinds of things do people in your culture think are so rebellious against Yahweh or another person that someone needs to severely punish that person? How would you describe that kind of rebellious thing? Pause this audio here.

The word for sin, or betrayal, refers to any actions that are against another human or against Yahweh. Some of the things that people in the Bible thought were betrayals were: oppressing poor people, breaking a promise to someone, and the people of Israel breaking their promise to Yahweh and worshipping and serving false gods and goddesses.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What kinds of things do people in your culture think betray others that someone needs to severely punish that person? How would you describe when someone betrays someone else or breaks their promise to that person? Pause this audio here.

When Aaron put his hands on the goat and announced all of these bad things, Aaron would put all of the Israelites' rebellion and all of the evil things the Israelites did on the head of the goat. This meant that those bad things would not make the people of Israel ritually dirty anymore, since those bad things were on the goat now. As a result of that, the people of Israel would become ritually clean.

After Aaron put all of the people's rebellion and all of the evil things the people did on the goat, a different man would release the goat into the wilderness area where there were no farms or crops. So the goat would carry away all of the evil things the people of Israel did into an area where no one lived.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the wilderness.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:15–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron how to do the second part of the Day of Atonement ritual. This second part focused on cleansing both the Most Holy Place behind the curtain and the rest of the Tent of Meeting.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron how to do the third part of the Day of Atonement ritual. This third part focused on cleansing the bronze altar.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron how to do the fourth and final part of the Day of Atonement ritual. This fourth and final part focused on cleansing all of the people of Israel.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses

- Aaron, the high priest
- The people of Israel
- And someone else

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh talked about what Aaron should do in the Tent of Meeting, especially the Most Holy Place behind the curtain where the ark of the covenant is. Two more important parts of the setting are the bronze altar in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting and the wilderness where no one lives.

Stop here and remember that Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron to sprinkle blood in a similar way throughout the Tent of Meeting area. Listen to someone give instructions for how to do something. Make sure that part of the instructions requires the listener to repeat some of the steps at a different time and to do some of the steps in a similar way. How does the storyteller make it clear that the listener should do similar things at different times? Pause this audio here.

In scene one, Yahweh told Moses to tell Aaron how to do the second part of the Day of Atonement ritual. During the second part, Aaron was supposed to atone for the Most Holy Place behind the curtain and the rest of the Tent of Meeting. Since the Day of Atonement ritual happened every year, Aaron's descendants would continue to do this after Aaron died.

For the second part, Aaron needed to kill Yahweh's goat as a purification offering. Remember that in the previous section, Aaron cast lots to determine which goat Aaron would sacrifice to Yahweh and which goat someone would send into the wilderness, which was the place where nobody farmed or grew food. Aaron needed to kill the goat that the lots determined was for Yahweh.

After Aaron killed the goat, Aaron needed to bring the goat's blood behind the curtain in the Tent of Meeting. Then Aaron needed to do the same thing with the goat's blood that Aaron did with the bull's blood in the previous passage. This means that Aaron needed to use his fingers to sprinkle the goat's blood seven times on the east side, on top of the atonement cover and in front of the atonement cover. The east side was the side of the atonement cover that would have faced Aaron when Aaron entered that part of the tent behind the curtain.

It is not clear whether the words "on top of the atonement cover" and "in front of the atonement cover" refer to the same place. Some people believe that it is the same place. If that is true, then Aaron would enter the tent, see the side of the atonement cover that was facing Aaron, and use his finger to sprinkle the bull's blood seven times. The blood would fall on top of the atonement cover and in front of the atonement cover.

However, some people believe that "on top of the atonement cover" and "in front of the atonement cover" do not refer to the same place. If that is true, then Aaron would enter the tent, see the side of the atonement cover that was facing Aaron, and use his finger to sprinkle the bull's blood on top of the atonement cover seven times. Then, Aaron would use his finger to sprinkle the bull's blood on top of the space in front of the atonement cover. Aaron would do this seven times also.

Aaron would use the goat's blood to atone for the part of the Holy Place that was behind the curtain. Yahweh told Aaron to cleanse the Most Holy Place because the Israelites had contaminated the Most Holy Place with all of the ways the Israelites had rebelled against Yahweh and betrayed Yahweh throughout the year.

After that, Aaron needed to use the goat's blood to make atonement for the rest of the Tent of Meeting. This included the part of the Tent of Meeting that was in front of the curtain. This area was also holy, and so Aaron needed to cleanse that part too from all of the ways the people of Israel had rebelled against Yahweh and all of the bad things the Israelites did throughout the year.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the Tent of Meeting. Pay attention to the difference between the place behind the curtain and the rest of the Tent of Meeting. Pause this audio here.

And while Aaron was cleansing the Tent of Meeting, nobody could go into the Tent of Meeting until Aaron came out of the tent and had made atonement for Aaron, Aaron's household, and the entire community of Israel. This means that no one could go into the Tent of Meeting until after the fourth and final part of the ritual, where Aaron had someone else send the live goat away.

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In scene two, Yahweh told Moses to tell Aaron how to do the third part of the Day of Atonement ritual. During the third part, Aaron was supposed to make atonement for the bronze altar. This was the altar in the courtyard where the priests would offer the people's sacrifices of animals and grain throughout the year.

To cleanse the bronze altar, Aaron would take some of the bull's blood that Aaron had used to cleanse Aaron and Aaron's household and some of the goat's blood that Aaron had used to cleanse both the Most Holy Place behind the curtain and the Tent of Meeting. Aaron would put the blood of the bull and the blood of the goat on the horns of the bronze altar. Then Aaron would use his fingers to sprinkle some of the blood on the altar seven times. This would cleanse the bronze altar and rededicate the altar and make the altar holy to Yahweh again because the Israelites had contaminated the bronze altar and made the altar ritually dirty.

In scene three, Yahweh told Moses to tell Aaron how to do the fourth and final part of the Day of Atonement ritual. During the fourth and final part, Aaron was supposed to atone for all of the Israelites.

To begin, Aaron would get the live goat. Remember that in the previous section, Aaron cast lots to determine which goat Aaron would sacrifice to Yahweh and which goat someone would send into the wilderness area. This is the goat that someone would send into the wilderness area.

Aaron would put his hands on the live goat and announce over the goat all of the ways that the people of Israel were guilty—the ways the Israelites had rebelled against Yahweh and done very evil things throughout the year. Remember that these actions are so evil that someone needs to severely punish the people who did those evil things.

When Aaron put his hands on the goat and announced all of these bad things, Aaron would put all of the people's rebellion and all of the evil things the people had done on the head of the goat. This meant that those bad things were not making the people of Israel ritually dirty or ceremonially unclean anymore, so the people of Israel would become spiritually and ritually clean.

After Aaron put all of the people's rebellion and all of the evil things the Israelites did on the goat, a different man would release the goat into the wilderness area. So the goat would carry away all of the evil things the people of Israel did into an area where no one lived.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:15–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron, the high priest
- The people of Israel
- And someone else

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

The passage begins as Yahweh continues to tell Moses the instructions to tell Aaron about the Day of Atonement ritual.

Yahweh said, “Aaron needs to kill the goat for the purification offering.” Remember that this is Yahweh’s goat that Aaron had cast lots for.

Yahweh said, “Aaron needs to bring the goat’s blood behind the curtain in the Tent of Meeting. Next, Aaron needs to sprinkle the goat’s blood on the east side of the atonement cover and in front of the atonement cover the same way that Aaron did with the bull’s blood.” Remember that this means that Aaron needs to use his fingers to sprinkle the goat’s blood seven times on the east side, on top of the atonement cover and in front of the atonement cover.

Yahweh said, “This is how Aaron will cleanse, or atone for, the Most Holy Place. Aaron needs to cleanse the Most Holy Place because the people of Israel have become ritually dirty and have rebelled against me and betrayed me, and done bad things to other people. These rebellions, betrayals, and bad things are ritually dirty and make the people who do these things ritually unclean.

“Next, Aaron will need to cleanse, or atone for, the rest of the Tent of Meeting. Aaron needs to cleanse the Tent of Meeting because my tent is in the middle of where the people of Israel are camping. This means that my tent is in the middle of all of the Israelites’ ritual dirtiness.” Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- This is a serious responsibility, and I want to do it right; or
- I am glad Yahweh made a way to cleanse everything.

Continue the drama. Yahweh said, “Nobody else can be inside the Tent of Meeting while Aaron is inside the tent. From the time that Aaron goes into the Most Holy Place to cleanse it until Aaron is finished cleansing himself and his household and everyone in Israel and then comes out, nobody else can be inside the Tent of Meeting.”

Then Yahweh said, “After Aaron leaves the Tent of Meeting, Aaron needs to go to the bronze altar that is in the courtyard before me and cleanse the altar. To cleanse the altar, Aaron will need to put some of the bull’s blood and some of the goat’s blood on the horns of the bronze altar all around. Then Aaron will use his fingers to sprinkle some of the blood on the altar seven times. Doing this will cleanse the bronze altar and rededicate the altar and make the altar holy to me again since the Israelites made it ritually dirty.

“After Aaron has finished cleansing the Most Holy Place behind the curtain, the Tent of Meeting, and the bronze altar, Aaron will need to bring the live goat near. Then Aaron will need to put both of his hands on the head of the live goat and announce over the goat all of the ways that the people of Israel have rebelled against me and all of the evil things that the people have done throughout the year. When Aaron does this, Aaron will put all of these bad things on the goat.” Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people of Israel, “What are you feeling or thinking as you hear Aaron announce all of the bad things that you and your neighbors have done?” The person might answer things like:

- I feel sad about the bad things we have done; or
- I feel relieved that Yahweh told Aaron to put these bad things on the goat; or
- I feel that it is very serious that we have done so many bad things.

Continue the drama. Yahweh said, “After Aaron puts these bad things on the goat, a certain person will need to send this goat into the wilderness area. The goat will carry all of the evil things that the people of Israel have done into a place where nobody lives. That is why the person will need to release the goat into the desert area.”

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:15–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

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In this section, Yahweh continues to tell Moses the instructions to tell Aaron about the Day of Atonement ritual.

Yahweh says, “Aaron needs to **kill** the goat for the **sin, or purification, offering**.” Use the same word for the purification offering that you used before. Look up “purification offering” in the Master Glossary for more information. Use the same word for killing an animal that you have used previously.

Aaron needs to bring the goat’s blood behind the curtain in the **Tent of Meeting**. Use the same word or phrase for “Tent of Meeting” that you used before. Look up **tabernacle** in the Master Glossary for more information.

Next, Aaron needs to **sprinkle** the goat’s blood on the east side of the **atonement cover** and in front of the atonement cover the same way that Aaron did with the bull’s blood. Use the same words for sprinkle and for atonement cover that you used before.

Yahweh says, “This is how Aaron will **atone for** the Most Holy Place.” Use the same word for cleanse or atone for as you used before. Look up atonement in the Master Glossary for more information.

Although your translation may say that Aaron atones for the “Holy Place,” we know that the atonement cover is behind the curtain in the **Most Holy Place**. You may choose to make it clear that this is the Most Holy Place. Look up Most Holy Place in the Master Glossary for more information, and use the same word for Most Holy Place that you used in Leviticus 16:3.

These rebellions, betrayals, and bad things are **unclean** or ritually dirty and make the people who do these things ritually dirty. People in the Bible often used the same word “unclean” to talk about things that were physically dirty and things that were morally or spiritually dirty. And in the laws that Yahweh gave the people through Moses, Yahweh said that both the things that made people physically dirty and the things that made people morally or spiritually dirty also made people ritually dirty and unable to worship Yahweh in his Holy Place. In this section, when Yahweh talks about the people of Israel being “unclean,” the emphasis is on the people of Israel being spiritually and morally unclean, which also made the people unable to worship Yahweh. Use the same words for unclean as you have used previously, and refer to **clean and unclean** in the Master Glossary for more information.

Then Yahweh tells Aaron to cleanse, or atone for, the rest of the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh also says that no one can be inside the Tent of Meeting while Aaron is in there.

After Aaron leaves the Tent of Meeting, Aaron needs to go to the **bronze altar** that is in the courtyard and cleanse, or atone for, the altar. Use the same word for the bronze altar as you used before. Look up altar in the Master Glossary for more information.

To cleanse the bronze altar, Aaron will need to take some of the bull’s blood and some of the goat’s blood, and put the mixed blood on the horns of the bronze altar all around.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the bronze altar. Notice the horns of the altar. Remind each other as a group how you have previously translated the **horns of the altar**. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says, “After that, Aaron will use his fingers to sprinkle some of the blood on the altar seven times. This will clean or **purify** the bronze altar and **consecrate**, or make the altar holy to me again, since the **Israelites** made it ritually dirty.” When someone makes something holy, the person gives it to whatever god that person worships. For the people of Israel, that means that when Aaron makes the altar holy again, Aaron will give the altar to Yahweh again. After someone gives something to Yahweh, that thing belongs to Yahweh. People need to treat anything that belongs to Yahweh with more respect and care. Use the same words or phrases for Israelites, purify, and consecrate as you have used previously. Refer to Israelites, purify, and consecrate in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh says, “After Aaron has finished cleansing, or atoning for, the Most Holy Place behind the curtain, the Tent of Meeting, and the bronze altar, Aaron will need to bring the live goat near.” Aaron was supposed to put both his hands on the head of the live goat and announce over it all of the bad things that the people of Israel had done throughout the year. Aaron must announce all of the evil things, or iniquities, that the people of Israel did, including all of the transgressions or rebellions and all of their sin or betrayal. Although in this case, iniquities, transgressions, and sin all refer to evil things that the Israelites do, you may choose to use three different words

that have slightly different meanings, just like the original language. If you choose to use three different words, here is some information about each word.

The word for iniquity refers to actions and behavior so evil that someone needs to severely punish the person who did that evil thing.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Which word will you use for **iniquities**? You may choose to use the same word for iniquities that you used in Leviticus 7:18. For more information about iniquity, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

The word for transgressions, or rebellions, refers to actions in which people steal from someone, treat someone very badly, or rebel against a leader whom Yahweh chose.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Which word will you use for **transgressions**? For more information about transgression, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

The word for **sin**, or betrayal, refers to any actions that are against another human or against Yahweh. You have used the word for sin several times in the book of Leviticus, so be sure to use the same word for sin as you have used previously. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about sin.

Yahweh says, “When Aaron puts his hands on the live goat and announces all of the bad things that the people of Israel did, Aaron will put all of these bad things on the goat. After Aaron puts these bad things on the goat, an appropriate person will need to send this goat into the **wilderness** area, or an area where no one lives.” The people of Israel used the word “wilderness” to talk about land that nobody could farm or grow crops on. However, sometimes people would graze their animals in the wilderness.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the wilderness area. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **wilderness area**. Look up wilderness in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said, “The goat will carry all of the iniquities that the people of Israel have done into a place where nobody lives. That is why the person will need to release the goat into the desert area.”

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 16:15–22

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (7.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (5.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

Leviticus 16:23–28

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 16:23–28 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:23–28 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:23–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this section, Yahweh finished telling Moses the instructions that Moses needs to tell Aaron about the Day of Atonement ritual.

After Aaron had finished cleansing, or atoning for, Aaron and Aaron's household, the Most Holy Place behind the curtain and the rest of the Tent of Meeting, the bronze altar, and everyone in Israel, Aaron was supposed to go into the Tent of Meeting. There, Aaron would change out of the holy linen clothing that Aaron had been wearing while Aaron cleansed everyone and everything. After Aaron had changed out of the clothes, Aaron needed to leave the holy linen clothing inside the Tent of Meeting.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the holy linen clothing that Aaron wore for this ritual. Pause this audio here.

Aaron needed to go somewhere to change clothes so that nobody would see Aaron naked. Aaron needed to wash himself with water and then put on the clothing Aaron was wearing before Aaron had changed into the holy linen clothing. In this part, when Yahweh talks about washing with water inside the holy place, nobody knows exactly where Aaron washed himself. Some people think that means that Aaron washed himself in the basin in the courtyard with his undergarments on and then went back into the Tent of Meeting to put his clothing back on. Other people think that there was a screened-in area near the tent where Aaron went to wash himself.

Either way, after Aaron washed and changed his clothes, Aaron was supposed to come out of the Tent of Meeting and offer two burnt offerings. The first burnt offering was for Aaron, and the second burnt offering was for all of the people of Israel. You will remember that Aaron and the people had each brought a ram earlier for their burnt offerings. Aaron offered both of these burnt offerings to cleanse, or atone for, both Aaron and the people.

Even though Aaron already cleansed himself and the people, some people believe that Aaron needed to offer the burnt offerings to show how important the cleansing was that happened on this day.

Aaron also needed to offer the fat from the purification offering to Yahweh on the bronze altar. Aaron did this by burning the fat on the altar until there was nothing left. In other words, Aaron needs to burn the fat completely so that it makes smoke and a good smell for Yahweh. This fat was from the bull and goat whose blood Aaron used previously in the ritual to cleanse Aaron and Aaron's household, the whole Tent of Meeting, the bronze altar, and all of the people of Israel.

While Aaron was doing this, the person who had released the live goat into the wilderness area needed to stay outside of the area where the people of Israel were camping until the person made himself clean. In the previous section, Aaron had put all of the bad things that the people of Israel had done onto the live goat. That made the goat ritually dirty. Since the goat was ritually dirty because of all the bad things that the people of Israel had done, the person who had released the goat needed to make himself clean from the goat's ritual dirtiness. The place where the Israelites were camping was holy because Yahweh's tent was in the middle of the camp. That is why the person who had released the live goat could not go back into where people were camping until after the person became clean. In order to make himself clean, the person needed to wash his clothing and his body with water. After that, the person could come back into the area where the people of Israel were camping.

Also, a different person needed to take the bull and the goat that Aaron used for the purification offerings outside of where the people of Israel were camping. This bull and this goat were the animals whose blood Aaron had used to cleanse, or atone for, the Most Holy Place. The person who took the dead bull and dead goat outside the area where the people of Israel were camping needed to burn the hide, meat, and waste with fire. The hide refers to the animal's skin. People would often use the hide to make clothing or tents. The meat refers to the part of the animal that people would normally eat. It is not clear what the "waste" of the animals was. The waste could have been the animal's poop. The waste could have been the animal's intestines. Or the waste could have been both the animal's poop and the animal's intestines. Regardless, burning up the hide, meat, and waste meant that the person needed to burn up every part of the bull and every part of the goat. Nobody could use any part of either animal.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a bull and a goat. Then look at pictures of a slaughtered animal's hide, meat, and waste. Pause this audio here.

After the person burned up the bull and the goat, the person needed to wash his clothes and his body with water. After that, the person could come back into the area where the people of Israel were camping.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:23–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses what Aaron needs to do after he makes atonement for Aaron and Aaron's household, the whole Tent of Meeting, the bronze altar, and all of the people of Israel. To finish, Aaron needs to wash and change his clothes. Then Aaron must offer a burnt offering for Aaron, a burnt offering for the people of Israel, and the fat from the sin, or purification, offerings.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Moses what the person who had released the live goat into the desert area needs to do before that person can come back into the area where everyone else is camping.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells Moses what someone needs to do with the dead bodies of the bull and the goat that Aaron used for the purification offerings.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses

- Aaron, the high priest
- The person who released the live goat
- The person who burned up the dead bodies of the purification offerings
- And the people of Israel

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh talked about what Aaron and other priests would do inside the Tent of Meeting, at the bronze altar, and outside the area where the people of Israel were camping.

Stop here and have someone give instructions about one event. Make sure that this event requires at least two different people to do different things at the same time. How does the storyteller make it clear about who is doing what part? Pause this audio here.

In the first scene, Yahweh focused on what Aaron needed to do next.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will show that this passage comes immediately after what Aaron did in the previous passage. Pause this audio here.

After Aaron had cleansed, or made atonement for, Aaron and Aaron's household, the whole Tent of Meeting, the bronze altar, and all of the people of Israel, Aaron needed to go into the Tent of Meeting to change Aaron's clothing and wash himself. First, Aaron would take off the linen clothing that Aaron had been wearing in the Tent of Meeting. Then Aaron would wash himself in the sanctuary area, which refers to the entire area in and around the Tent of Meeting. Nobody knows exactly where Aaron washed himself in the sanctuary area. Some people think that means that Aaron washed himself in the basin in the courtyard with his undergarments on and then went back into the Tent of Meeting to put his clothing back on. Other people think that there was a screened-in area near the tent where Aaron went to wash himself. After Aaron had washed his body, Aaron needed to put back on the clothing Aaron had been wearing before Aaron had put on the linen clothing.

After Aaron changed his clothing, Aaron needed to come out and sacrifice two burnt offerings. One of the burnt offerings was to cleanse, or atone for, Aaron. The second burnt offering was to atone for all of the people of Israel. You will remember from previous passages that Aaron and the people had brought a ram each for this burnt offering.

After Aaron offered both burnt offerings, Aaron needed to burn up the fat of the purification offerings on the bronze altar.

In the second scene, Yahweh focused on what the person who had released the live goat into the wilderness area needed to do. Nobody knows who this person was or how the priests chose this person. This person was probably an adult man, but we do not know that for certain.

After this person had released the live goat into the wilderness area, the person needed to wash his clothing and his body with water. Then the person could come back into the area where everyone was camping. This person would wash himself and his clothing as soon as the person had finished releasing the goat. The person did not need to wait until after Aaron had washed and changed Aaron's clothes and offered the burnt offerings. This meant that this person might have been washing and changing his clothes while Aaron was offering the sacrifices.

In the third scene, Yahweh focused on how a person should burn up the dead bodies of the bull and goat that Aaron had used as the purification offerings. Nobody knows who this person was or how the priests chose this person. All we know is that this person would have done his or her part immediately after Aaron had burned up the fat from the purification offering on the bronze altar.

The bull and goat each had five parts: the blood, the fat, the hide, the meat, and the waste. Aaron had already used the blood during the Day of Atonement ritual to cleanse, or make atonement for, Aaron and Aaron's household, the whole Tent of Meeting, the bronze altar, and all of the people of Israel. And in the first scene of this passage, Aaron had burned all of the fat on the bronze altar.

The only parts of the animal that were left were the hide, meat, and waste. For these remaining parts, someone would take the hide, meat, and waste outside of the area where everyone was camping. Then, that person needed to burn the hide, meat, and waste with fire.

After the person burned up the hide, meat, and waste, that person needed to wash their clothing and their body with water. After the person had washed their body and clothing, the person could come back into the area where everyone else was camping and join everyone else.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:23–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The person who released the live goat
- The person who burned up the dead bodies of the purification offerings
- And the people of Israel

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In this section, Yahweh finishes telling Moses the instructions that Moses needs to tell Aaron about the Day of Atonement ritual.

Yahweh speaks to Moses first about Aaron. Yahweh says, "After that, Aaron needs to come into the Tent of Meeting and take off the linen clothing that Aaron had put on at the beginning when Aaron first went into the Most Holy Place. Aaron should leave the linen clothing inside the Tent of Meeting.

"Next, Aaron needs to wash his body with water in the holy place and put on the clothes that Aaron had been wearing earlier.

"After Aaron has washed his body and changed his clothing, Aaron needs to come out and offer a burnt offering for Aaron and a burnt offering for the people of Israel. These burnt offerings will cleanse, or atone for, Aaron and the people of Israel.

"Next, Aaron needs to burn the fat from the purification offerings of the bull and goat on the bronze altar."

Yahweh speaks to Moses next about the person who had released the live goat into the desert area where no one lived. Yahweh says, "The person who released the live goat into the area where no one lived needs to wash his clothing and his body with water. After the person has washed himself and his clothing, the person may come back into the area where everyone is camping." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the one who had released the live goat into the desert area, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad Yahweh made an easy way for me to become clean after I released the goat; or

- I am glad to wash the ritual dirtiness from the goat off of me; or
- I want to wash quickly so I do not miss more of the ritual.

Continue the drama. Yahweh speaks to Moses next about what needs to happen to the hide, meat, and waste of the purification offerings of the bull and goat. Yahweh says, "Someone needs to take the dead bodies of the bull and the goat that Aaron used for the purification offerings outside of the area where everyone is camping. This bull and this goat are the animals whose blood Aaron had used to cleanse the holy area.

"After this person brings the bodies of the bull and goat outside of the area where everyone is camping, that person needs to burn up what is left of both animals. This means that the person needs to burn up the animals' hide, meat, and waste.

"After the person burns up the rest of both the bull and the goat, the person needs to wash their clothing and body with water. Then the person can come into the area where everyone is camping." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the one who burned up the rest of the purification offerings, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that I have the honor to burn up the bull and goat; or
- I want to make sure everything burns up; or
- I am glad to be clean so I can join everyone else again.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:23–28 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh finishes telling Moses the instructions that Moses needs to tell Aaron about the Day of Atonement ritual.

Yahweh speaks to Moses first about Aaron. Yahweh says, "After that, Aaron needs to come into the **Tent of Meeting** and take off the **linen clothing** that Aaron had put on at the beginning when Aaron first went into the holy place. Aaron should leave the linen clothing inside the Tent of Meeting." Use the same words for Tent of Meeting and linen clothing that you used before. Look up **tabernacle** in the Master Glossary for more information. For this reference to "holy place," you may use a general word for holy place or sanctuary, or you may use your word for the **Most Holy Place** behind the curtain where the ark of the covenant is. Remember that "Most Holy Place" is in the Master Glossary.

Next, Aaron needs to wash his body with water in the sanctuary, or holy place, and put on the clothes that Aaron had been wearing earlier. It is not clear exactly where this holy place was, but it was probably either the Tent of Meeting or somewhere in the courtyard that surrounded the Tent of Meeting.

Stop here and decide how to refer to where Aaron washed himself. Make sure that whether you use the word for the Tent of Meeting or for the courtyard, you do not use the words that talk specifically about the Most Holy Place behind the curtain where the ark of the covenant is. Look up **sanctuary** in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

After Aaron has washed his body and changed his clothing, Aaron needs to come out and offer a **burnt offering** for Aaron and a burnt offering for the people of Israel. Use the same word for burnt offering that you used before. Look up burnt offering in the Master Glossary for more information.

These burnt offerings will **atone for** Aaron and the people of Israel. Use the same word for atone for that you used before. Look up **atonement** in the Master Glossary for more information.

Next, Aaron needs to offer the **fat** from the **purification offering** on the bronze **altar** as smoke. In other words, Aaron needs to burn the fat completely so that it makes a good smell for Yahweh. Use the same words for fat, purification offering, and bronze altar as you have used before. Look up purification offering and altar in the Master Glossary for more information.

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Yahweh speaks to Moses next about the person who had released the live goat into the wilderness area where no one lived. Yahweh says, “The person who released the goat for the **scapegoat** needs to wash his clothing and his body with water.” Remember that nobody knows exactly what Yahweh meant by the Hebrew word for scapegoat. Some people think it refers to a rough and challenging place, like the wilderness area where the person released the goat. Other people think it is actually two words that mean “sent away goat.” Use the same word for scapegoat as you used before.

Yahweh says, “After the person has washed himself and his clothing, the person can come back into the area where everyone is camping.”

Yahweh speaks to Moses next about what needs to happen to the hide, meat, and waste of the purification offerings of the bull and goat. Yahweh says, “Someone needs to take the dead bodies of the bull and the goat that Aaron used for the purification offerings outside of the area where everyone is camping. This bull and this goat are the animals whose blood Aaron had used to cleanse, or atone for, the holy area.”

Stop here and discuss as a group: It is possible that the phrase “**holy area**” here refers only to the place behind the curtain, the Most Holy Place, but it probably refers to Yahweh’s entire tent, or sanctuary. Your local translation may say “Most Holy Place,” however. Decide how you will translate this: either as the “Most Holy Place” or as the more general term “sanctuary.” Pause this audio here.

After this person brings the bodies of the bull and goat outside of the area where everyone is camping, the person needs to burn up what is left of both animals. This means that the person needs to burn up the animals’ hide, meat, and waste. It is not clear what the “waste” of the animals was. It could have been the animal’s poop. It could have been the animal’s intestines. Or it could have been both the animal’s dung and the animal’s intestines.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a bull and a goat. Then look at pictures of a slaughtered animal’s **hide**, **meat**, and **waste**. Translate these things in the same way you have in Leviticus 4:11, and decide how you will talk about the animals’ waste. Pause this audio here.

After the person burns up the rest of both the bull and the goat, the person needs to wash their clothing and body with water. Then the person can come into the area where everyone is camping. Use the same words and phrases for when a person **washes their clothing and body with fresh water** as you have used previously.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 16:23–28

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (4.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

Leviticus 16:29–34

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 16:29–34 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:29–34 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:29–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this part, Yahweh gave Moses some final commands about the details of the Day of Atonement ritual.

Yahweh told Moses that the Day of Atonement ritual would be a requirement that the people of Israel had to do for all time. This ritual was supposed to happen every year on the tenth day of the seventh month, which was harvest time for the Israelites. On the first day of the seventh month, the people of Israel were supposed to blow trumpets and celebrate a special day of rest. Then, ten days later, the people of Israel were supposed to celebrate the Day of Atonement.

On the Day of Atonement, while the high priest was doing his part of the ritual, the people of Israel were supposed to celebrate the day by doing two things. The first thing the people needed to do was humble, or "lower," their souls. In this part of the Bible, this phrase means that the people of Israel needed to fast. When the people of Israel fasted, the people did not eat or drink as a way to show how sorry the people were for what the people did and to ask Yahweh to forgive the people. It is possible that the people also did not have sexual relations with their husbands or wives on this day, so that the people would remain ritually clean on that day.

The second thing the people of Israel needed to do was rest and avoid working. These requirements about fasting and resting applied to everyone. It did not matter if the person was a descendant of the man named Israel or if the person was not a descendant of Israel but had moved to live with the Israelites. Everyone who was traveling and camping around Yahweh's tent needed to celebrate the Day of Atonement.

People needed to fast and to rest because this was the day that Yahweh chose for the high priest to atone for and cleanse all of the people from the ways the people had betrayed Yahweh. The bad things that people did would make the people ritually dirty. The Day of Atonement ritual would make people ritually clean. To be ritually clean was very important. If no one removed the bad things that people did, then those people would still be

ritually dirty, and Yahweh would punish those people for the bad things those people did. Also, Yahweh was holy, and that meant that everything, every place, and every person near Yahweh needed to be physically, ritually, and spiritually clean. If people wanted to live near Yahweh, the people needed someone to remove all of the bad things that the people had done from the people so that the people could be clean. The Day of Atonement ritual was the way Yahweh made for the people to become clean. Then Yahweh would not punish the people for the bad things the people did, and the people could live near Yahweh. Yahweh wanted the Israelites to know that the Israelites did not need to be afraid or worry because Yahweh had already made a way to cleanse the Israelites from all of the bad things that the Israelites had done. This is the most important part of this passage.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about a time when you felt relieved because someone forgave you for something wrong you did and did not punish you. Why do you think it was important for the Israelites to know that Yahweh had made a way to cleanse them from their sins? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh then repeated that the Day of Atonement was also a special day of rest for the people of Israel. In addition to resting, the people also needed to fast. These were the requirements for the people of Israel on the Day of Atonement.

The anointed priest was the one who would do the cleansing, or atoning, part of the ritual. In this ritual, the anointed priest was the high priest. At this time, the first high priest was Aaron. Earlier, Moses had used oil to anoint, or choose, and confirm Aaron as Yahweh's high priest. During the ritual to anoint Aaron as the high priest, Aaron had filled his hands with bread and meat as an offering to Yahweh. Because Aaron was the high priest, Yahweh said that Aaron would do the first Day of Atonement ritual. But Yahweh knew Aaron would eventually die. So Yahweh made a way for another priest to do the Day of Atonement ritual after Aaron died.

Yahweh decided that after Aaron died, Aaron's son would be the next high priest. The next high priest would then put on the holy linen clothing and do the Day of Atonement ritual to cleanse the Most Holy Place behind the curtain and the rest of the Tent of Meeting, the bronze altar, the priests, and all of the people of Israel. After Aaron's son died, Aaron's grandson would become the next high priest. To become the next high priest, someone would pour oil on the head of each new high priest to anoint that man for the special role of Yahweh's high priest. During the ritual to anoint the new high priest, the priest who became the new high priest would do the same thing that Aaron had done before and fill his hands with bread and meat as an offering to Yahweh. In other words, Yahweh would ordain the new high priest. Each new high priest would then do what Aaron did on the Day of Atonement. This process would continue for all time.

These requirements for the Day of Atonement ritual would also happen every year for all time in order to cleanse the people of Israel from all of the ways the people had betrayed Yahweh and done bad things to other people.

After Moses told everyone what to do, Aaron did what Yahweh had commanded Moses.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:29–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses what the people of Israel need to do to celebrate the Day of Atonement.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Moses that each high priest after Aaron needs to do the Day of Atonement ritual like Aaron does it.

In the third scene: The storyteller emphasizes that Aaron obeys Yahweh.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron

- Aaron's son
- Aaron's other descendants who will be high priests
- Aaron's other descendants who will be other priests
- The Israelites
- And foreigners who live with the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh talks about what to do at the Tent of Meeting and the place where the Israelites were camping.

Stop and have someone give another person instructions about something important. Pay attention to how the speaker emphasizes the important part. Pause the audio here.

Yahweh tells Moses the information in the first scene in a special way because Yahweh wants to emphasize what the Israelites need to do. Yahweh gives Moses two pieces of information, and then Yahweh tells Moses the most important part. After Yahweh tells Moses the most important part of Yahweh's message, Yahweh repeats the two pieces of information in a reverse way. Here is what Yahweh says to Moses.

In the first piece of information, Yahweh tells Moses that the statute, or requirement, will last for all time. Every year on the tenth day of the seventh month, the people of Israel must celebrate the Day of Atonement.

Stop and discuss how people usually talk about times of the year, especially days and months. Pause the audio here.

In the second piece of information, Yahweh tells Moses that all of the people of Israel need to humble their souls and rest on the tenth day of the seventh month. When the people humble their souls, the people deny themselves of something. In this case, the people probably fasted, or did not allow themselves to eat food. The people may have also denied themselves from having sexual relations.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about how the Israelites deny themselves. If in your language you need to say what the people deny themselves, you may say that the people fast or deny themselves from eating. Pause this audio here.

The people also need to rest because this ritual is a special day of rest. Everyone must do this. All of Israel's descendants must do this, and all of the people from other people groups who live with the Israelites must do this. These people from other people groups, or foreigners, have decided to live among the Israelites permanently and follow many of the same rules and customs as the Israelites do.

Then Yahweh tells Moses the most important part. Yahweh reminds Moses that the Day of Atonement is for the people of Israel. Yahweh says that the purpose of the Day of Atonement is to atone for and clean, or purify, the Israelites from all their sins. This means that at the end of the Day of Atonement, Yahweh will restore the Israelites' relationship with Yahweh and completely cleanse the Israelites from all of the ways the Israelites had betrayed Yahweh and all of the bad things the Israelites had done to other people. When the Israelites have a relationship with Yahweh because the Israelites are ritually and spiritually clean, then the bad things the Israelites have done do not make the Israelites ritually dirty anymore. So the people of Israel do not have to worry that Yahweh will punish the Israelites. This statement helps the Israelites not worry because Yahweh makes a way to completely purify the Israelites from all of the bad things the Israelites do.

After Yahweh tells Moses the most important part, Yahweh repeats the first two pieces of information. Yahweh says that these requirements will last for all time and that everyone must fast and rest.

Stop and discuss among yourselves how best to organize the first two pieces of information and the most important part. Make sure to emphasize the most important part. Pause the audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh tells Moses that each high priest after Aaron needs to do the Day of Atonement ritual like Aaron does. Since Aaron will die in the future, Yahweh makes a way for the ritual to continue. Someone will anoint and ordain Aaron's son as the next high priest. This next high priest will do everything that Aaron had done. The new high priest will put on the holy linen clothing and atone for the Most Holy Place behind the curtain and the Tent of Meeting, the bronze altar, all of the priests, and all of the people of Israel. In this scene, Yahweh repeats that the high priest will atone. The reason Yahweh keeps using the word "atone" is to emphasize

the main purpose of the high priest's role on this day. Yahweh requires the high priests to perform the Day of Atonement ritual every year for all time.

In the third scene, the storyteller says that Aaron does exactly what Yahweh told Aaron to do.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:29–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- Aaron's son
- Aaron's other descendants who will be high priests
- Aaron's other descendants who will be other priests
- The Israelites
- And foreigners who live with the Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Yahweh told Moses, "These are what I am requiring you all to do for all time. Every year, on the tenth day of the seventh month, you need to fast, and you must not work at all. These statutes apply to both people who are blood descendants of Israel and people from other people groups who live with you. The reason this day is so important is that it is the day that the high priest will atone for you and cleanse you from all of the ways you have betrayed me and done bad things to other people. The purpose is so that you all will be clean." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a foreigner, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that Yahweh cares about me, even though I am not a blood descendant of Israel; or
- I am glad that Yahweh made a way for me to become clean, too.

Continue the drama. Yahweh said, "The Day of Atonement will be a special rest day for all of you, where you will spend the day fasting from food and water. I require you to do this every year for all time.

"Each high priest after Aaron will make atonement. This is the high priest on whose head someone poured oil to choose the man as high priest. This is the high priest who filled his hands with offerings to Yahweh to ordain himself as the high priest. Each new high priest will take over his father's position. This new high priest will put on the holy linen clothing and atone for the Most Holy Place behind the curtain and the rest of the Tent of Meeting, the bronze altar, all of the priests, and all of the people of Israel. The new high priest will be responsible for cleansing on the Day of Atonement. I require each high priest to do this ritual every year for all time in order

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to cleanse the Israelites from all the ways the Israelites betray Yahweh and from all the bad things the Israelites did to other people."

So Aaron did what Yahweh commanded Moses. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want to do everything exactly right; or
- I wish my two oldest sons had listened to Yahweh and had not died; or
- I am glad Yahweh made a way to cleanse all of us so we do not die and so we can live near Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 16:29–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh told Moses, "These are what I require you to do for all time." People often translate the word for "requirement" as "**statute**." A statute is usually a requirement or instruction that a group of people has to do. Often, when Yahweh used this word in the law Yahweh gave the people through Moses, this word focused specifically on the religious rules about how to celebrate festivals, perform religious rituals, and offer sacrifices of animals and grain. Yahweh also used this word to talk about the rules for what the priests needed to do. Look up statute in the Master Glossary for more information, and translate statute in the same way you have previously.

Yahweh said, "Every year, on the tenth day of the seventh month, you need to deny yourself, or fast, and you must not work at all." People may have denied themselves both food and sexual relations. However, if you need to say what people denied themselves, it is best to talk about people denying themselves of food. When people fasted, people did not eat anything or drink anything. People usually fasted to show how sad those people were that something had happened or how sorry those people were for the bad thing that those people had done. Since the focus of the Day of Atonement was cleansing from the bad things people had done, the people probably denied themselves on the Day of Atonement to show how sorry the people were.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **deny yourself**, or fast. Look up **fasting** in the Master Glossary for more information if you decide to translate this as fasting. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said, "These requirements apply to both people who are blood descendants of Israel and foreigners who moved to live with you." This word for "foreigners" refers to people who were born in a different country and then moved from their home country to live somewhere else. These people were not related to the rest of the people of Israel, but these people had decided to permanently live with the people of Israel.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **foreigner**. Look up foreigner in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, see if it is best to use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said, "The reason this day is so important is that it is the day that the **high priest** will **atone** for you and **purify** you from all of the ways you have betrayed, or **sinned** against, me and done bad things to other people. The priest does this so that you all will be **clean** to **Yahweh**." In the original language, Yahweh does not say who performs the rituals on the Day of Atonement here, but if you need to say who does the rituals, you may say that it is the high priest. Use the same words for high priest, atone, purify, sin, clean, and Yahweh that you used before. Look up high priest, atonement, purify, sin, clean and unclean, and Yahweh, in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh said, "This day will be a special, or Sabbath, rest day for all of you, where you will spend the day fasting from food and water. I require you to do this every year for all time." Some festivals encouraged people to rest but also allowed the people to do some kinds of work on those days. However, the Day of Atonement was a special rest day. This means that people could not do any kind of work at all. You will remember that the Sabbath, or rest day, was normally the seventh day of each week for the Israelites and was also a special day of rest. Here, Yahweh uses the word for Sabbath to remind the Israelites that they should rest on the Day of Atonement in the same way they rest on the weekly Sabbath day of rest.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Sabbath**, or special rest day. Refer to the Master Glossary for Sabbath. If you have already translated this idea in another book of the Bible, see if it is best to use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said, “Each priest after Aaron will make atonement. This is the high priest whom someone anointed. In other words, someone poured oil on that man’s head to choose that man as high priest. Someone ordained this high priest, or filled his hand with meat and bread to offer to Yahweh.” Use the same words for **anoint** and **ordain** that you used before. Look up anoint in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh said, “Each new high priest will take over his father’s position. This new high priest will put on the **holy linen** clothing and atone for the **Most Holy Place** and the rest of the **Tent of Meeting**, the **altar**, all of the **priests**, and all of the people of Israel.” Use the same words for holy, linen, Most Holy Place, Tent of Meeting, altar, and priest as you used before. Look up holy, Most Holy Place, tabernacle, altar, and priest in the Master Glossary for more information.

The high priests made atonement for all the **assembly** or people of Israel, along with the foreigners who lived there. Use the same word or phrase for assembly when it means all the people of Israel, as you have used earlier.

So Aaron did what Yahweh **commanded** Moses. Use the same words for command that you used before.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 16:29–34

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (4.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.2 MB)

Leviticus 17:1–9

Leviticus 17:1–9

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 17:1–9 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 17:1–9 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 17:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

This passage begins the next big section of Leviticus, where Yahweh teaches the Israelites more specific rules about how to live as Yahweh's people in a holy way. This way of life will show other people that the Israelites are Yahweh's special people. In this passage, Yahweh told Moses to give commands to Aaron, Aaron's sons, and all of the rest of the Israelites about where to bring their sacrifices and what not to do with the animal blood that they used in those sacrifices.

Yahweh did not allow the Israelites to kill animals for the sacrifices to Yahweh anywhere except at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. Remember that the Tent of Meeting was where Yahweh met with the Israelites, and the people thought of the tent as Yahweh's home. That is one of the reasons why people had to bring their offerings to the Tent of Meeting.

The other, and more important, reason was that Yahweh did not want the Israelites to sacrifice any part of the animal to false gods, which were demons. The people who lived around the Israelites would sometimes pour blood on the ground to sacrifice to false gods and demons because people believed these gods lived below the earth in the underworld. The underworld was where people believed that people would go after people died. Yahweh did not want the people of Israel to even think about pouring blood on the ground for these false gods and demons. So Yahweh told the people of Israel to always bring their sacrifices to the Tent of Meeting, where the priests would use the animal's blood the way that Yahweh had said to.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Do people in your culture, or in the cultures around you, use blood in any religious or magic rituals? What do people do with the blood? Why do people do that? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said that the people of Israel must not kill any animal for sacrifice inside or outside the area where the people of Israel were camping. It did not matter whether the people were sacrificing an ox, a lamb, a goat, or any other animal. Some people think this rule is for any time a person kills an ox, lamb, or goat, even when the people just want to eat the animal. But this rule is probably for when people specifically want to sacrifice an animal for an offering to Yahweh. The people had to bring the animal to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting to offer the animal to Yahweh. The entrance to the Tent of Meeting was somewhere in the courtyard area between the entrance to the courtyard and the entrance to the tent itself. It was probably near the bronze altar.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the Tent of Meeting, the bronze altar, and the surrounding courtyard. Pause this audio here.

Anyone who did not bring their animal to the Tent of Meeting to sacrifice the animal for Yahweh would be guilty. It is not clear what exactly the person was guilty of. The Hebrew words say that the person would be guilty of pouring out blood. This can mean one of three things. It might mean that the person was guilty of pouring blood

onto the ground as a sacrifice to the underworld demons. Or it might mean that Yahweh was going to consider what the person did the same as murdering a person. Or it might be a general way to say that the person did something wrong with blood. Since life is connected to blood, and Yahweh is the owner of all life—and therefore all blood—then to do something wrong with blood was a serious offense.

If someone was guilty of killing an animal to sacrifice the animal away from the Tent of Meeting, the penalty was to "be cut off from their people." No one knows exactly what this means. It either means that someone killed that person, or that the community sent the person away from the nation of Israel. That meant that the person would have to move away from all of that person's friends and family. That person would no longer be one of Yahweh's people, so Yahweh would not protect, provide for, or take care of that person anymore.

Yahweh said that even though the Israelites had been offering Yahweh animal sacrifices in the open field before people made the Tent of Meeting, now that there was a Tent of Meeting, the Israelites had to bring their sacrifices to the Tent of Meeting. The Israelites could not continue to offer sacrifices to Yahweh in the fields. The Israelites had to bring their sacrifices to the priests at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting.

The entrance of the Tent of Meeting is where the Israelites would offer their fellowship, or peace, offerings. The fellowship offerings were special because those were the only sacrifices where the person who offered the sacrifice would eat part of the meat to show their friendship and connection with Yahweh. Yahweh wanted to be sure that Yahweh's people were only eating sacrifices with Yahweh and not with underworld demons.

After someone brought their sacrifice to Yahweh to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting, the priest would sprinkle or throw the blood on Yahweh's bronze altar, which was near the entrance to the Tent of Meeting. The priest would also burn up the fat from the animals on the bronze altar like incense that would smell good to Yahweh.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the bronze altar. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said that the people of Israel must not sacrifice to the male goats anymore. Nobody knows exactly what these "male goats" refer to. People who lived back then often thought of both goats and demons as living in the wilderness, so these "goats" were probably connected to the underworld demons. But Yahweh said that the people of Israel must not pour out blood to the goats or demons.

Yahweh said that to pour out blood to these goats, or underworld demons, was the same as being unfaithful against Yahweh, like a husband or wife is unfaithful to their husband or wife. When Yahweh and the people of Israel made a covenant with each other, the people of Israel promised that Yahweh would be their only God. This covenant was similar to a wife promising to only have one husband and to be faithful to her husband. If the people of Israel worshipped other gods and goddesses, it was the same as a wife who slept with a man who was not her husband. Yahweh used this language to emphasize how serious it was to sacrifice or pour out blood to other gods and goddesses. Most of the people who lived around Israel were used to worshipping and sacrificing to many different gods and goddesses at the same time, so it was easy for the Israelites to think that the Israelites could worship many different gods and goddesses as long as the Israelites also worshiped Yahweh. But Yahweh said that worshipping other gods and goddesses was as wrong and as serious as a married woman sleeping with men who were not her husband.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Do people in your culture think it is okay to worship or sacrifice to more than one spirit, or god or goddess? Why or why not? If Yahweh were talking to the people in your culture, what language might Yahweh use to emphasize how important it is to only worship Yahweh and sacrifice to Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said that this rule about not pouring out blood or sacrificing animals to anyone other than Yahweh would last forever throughout every generation. This rule would never change. Yahweh also told the people that this rule applied both to the people who were blood-related descendants of Israel and to people who had a different ancestor but who had moved to live with the Israelites. Anyone who offered a burnt offering or any other kind of sacrifice had to bring the animal for the sacrifice to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. Whoever sacrificed the animal somewhere else had to "be cut off." Again, this either means that someone killed that person or that the person was no longer one of Yahweh's people.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 17:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses to command all of the Israelites to bring their sacrifices of animals to Yahweh's Tent of Meeting.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Moses that the commands about only sacrificing animals at Yahweh's Tent of Meeting apply to foreigners who live with the Israelites.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron, who is the head priest
- Aaron's sons, who are the priests
- The people of Israel, who are sacrificing animals
- And foreigners who live with the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh talks about what the Israelites should do at the entrance of Yahweh's Tent of Meeting and the bronze altar, which is in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh also talks about what the Israelites should not do in an open field or anywhere that is not the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting.

These instructions from Yahweh begin a large new section in Leviticus about how to live in a holy, or clean, way.

In this whole passage, Yahweh tells the people to stop sacrificing, or killing animals for sacrifice, in the open field where the Israelites have sacrificed animals to Yahweh in the past. Yahweh also tells the Israelites not to sacrifice to the goat demons, as the Israelites have done in the past. Instead, Yahweh says the Israelites must only sacrifice to Yahweh and that the Israelites must bring all of their sacrifices to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting.

Stop here and have someone give instructions about how people need to stop doing a cultural tradition that people have been doing, and how people need to do something else instead. How does the person who gives the instructions explain the difference between what people have done traditionally and what people need to do now? How does the person emphasize how important it is for people to change their actions? Pause this audio here.

In scene one, Yahweh tells Moses to command Aaron, the head priest, Aaron's sons, who are the priests, and all of the Israelites to bring their sacrifices of animals to Yahweh's Tent of Meeting.

Yahweh says that the Israelites must not kill animals for the sacrifice anywhere except at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. It does not matter whether the people are sacrificing an ox, a lamb, a goat, or any other animal. The Israelites have to bring the animal to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting to offer the animal to Yahweh. If someone kills the animal anywhere else—whether inside the area where the people of Israel were camping or outside the area where the people of Israel were camping—then that person was guilty of doing something wrong with blood. The punishment was that either someone would kill that person or that person would no longer be one of Yahweh's people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you talk about bad things that people do that have to do with blood, such as when people offer blood to the wrong god, spirit, or ancestor, or people kill an animal the wrong way? Discuss how you want to translate the way that the person would be guilty of doing something wrong with blood. Pause this audio here.

In the past, the people of Israel had been sacrificing, or killing animals, for Yahweh in the open fields. But now Yahweh will no longer allow the Israelites to do that. Instead, the Israelites have to bring their sacrifices to Yahweh at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting, to the priests. That is the only place where the people of Israel may sacrifice fellowship or peace offerings.

Once the Israelites give the animal to the priest at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting, the priest will sprinkle or throw the blood around Yahweh's bronze altar. This altar was at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. Then the priest will burn the fat from the sacrifice on top of the bronze altar like incense that smells good to Yahweh.

Yahweh says that the people of Israel must not sacrifice to the goat demons anymore. These were the goat demons that the people of Israel had sacrificed to before. When the people of Israel sacrificed to the goat demons, that was as serious and as wrong as when a married woman sleeps with a man who was not her husband.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you talk about the way a married woman sleeps with a man that she is not married to? Discuss how you will compare the way the Israelites sacrificed to the goat-demons to the way a married woman sleeps with a man who is not her spouse. Pause this audio here.

This statute, or rule, about not pouring out blood or sacrificing animals to anyone other than Yahweh will last forever throughout every generation. This rule will never change.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will describe the way the statue will last forever. Pause this audio here.

In scene two, Yahweh tells Moses that the commands about only sacrificing animals at Yahweh's Tent of Meeting also applied to immigrants or foreigners who moved to live with the Israelites. Anyone who offers a burnt offering or any other kind of sacrifice—whether the person is a blood-descendant of Israel or not—has to bring the animal for the sacrifice to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. If a person sacrifices an animal somewhere else, then either someone needs to kill that person, or that person is no longer one of Yahweh's people.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 17:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron, who is the head priest
- Aaron's sons, who are the priests
- The people of Israel, who are sacrificing animals
- And foreigners who live with the Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Yahweh spoke to Moses and said, "Tell Aaron and his sons and all of the people of Israel what I am commanding you right now.

"If any of the people of Israel kill an animal like an ox, lamb, or goat to sacrifice inside the area where everyone is camping or outside the area where everyone is camping, and the person does not bring the animal to the

Leviticus 17:1–9

entrance of the Tent of Meeting to Yahweh to sacrifice the animal there, then that person will be guilty of doing something wrong with blood. The punishment will be that the person will no longer be a part of his people.

“Even though the people of Israel have been sacrificing in the open fields, the Israelites must not do that anymore. The Israelites need to bring their sacrifices to Yahweh at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. The Israelites must give the animals to the priests to sacrifice the animals as fellowship offerings to Yahweh.

“The priest will throw the blood around Yahweh’s bronze altar, which is at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. The priest will burn the fat from the animal on the bronze altar like incense that smells good to Yahweh.

“The people of Israel cannot continue to sacrifice to the goat demons. The Israelites have been acting like a married woman who sleeps with men who are not her husband, and the Israelites need to stop that.” Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I need to stop sacrificing to goat demons; or
- I did not realize it was this serious; or
- I hope Yahweh protects me from the goat demons if I stop sacrificing to the goat demons.

Continue the drama. Yahweh said, “This statute will last forever for the Israelites. It will apply to every generation.”

Yahweh also said, “Tell the Israelites that this statute applies to Israel’s blood descendants and to immigrants who have a different ancestor but who moved to live with the people of Israel. Anyone who offers a burnt offering or any other kind of sacrifice—whether the person is a blood descendant of Israel or not—and who does not bring their animal to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting to offer it to Yahweh will be punished. The punishment will be either that someone will kill that person or, more likely, that person will not belong to Yahweh anymore.” Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the immigrants, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I did not realize that I would only be allowed to sacrifice to Yahweh; or
- I am glad that Yahweh thinks of me as one of Yahweh’s people; or
- I need to make sure I only sacrifice to Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 17:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh spoke to Moses and said, “Tell Aaron and his sons and all of the **people of Israel** what I am commanding you right now.” Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh and **Israelites** as you have used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and Israelites, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh talks about what happens if any of the people of Israel **kill an animal** like an **ox**, **lamb**, or **goat** to **sacrifice** or give these animals as an **offering** anywhere outside the entrance of the **Tent of Meeting**. Some people might not sacrifice an animal at the Tent of Meeting, but instead inside the area where everyone is camping or outside the area where everyone is camping. If a person does not kill the animal for the offering at the **tabernacle**, then that person will be guilty of doing something wrong with blood.“ Use the same word for ox, lamb, goat, Tent of Meeting, tabernacle, and offering that you used before. Use the same word or phrase for killing an animal as a sacrifice as you have used before. Look up offering, sacrifice, and tabernacle in the Master Glossary for more information. Note that Yahweh uses both the phrases for Tent of Meeting and for tabernacle in this passage.

Stop here as a group and look again at a picture of an ox, a lamb, a goat, and the Tent of Meeting as needed. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said, “The punishment will be that someone will **cut off** the person who used the blood wrongly.” No one knows exactly what this means. It probably means either that someone will have to kill that person to punish them or that the community will send the person away from the people of Israel. That meant that the person

would have to move away from all of their friends and family. The person would no longer be one of Yahweh's people, so Yahweh would not protect, provide for, or take care of that person anymore. Use the same word or phrase for this punishment that you used before.

Yahweh said, "Even though the people of Israel have been sacrificing in the open fields, the Israelites cannot do that anymore."

Stop here and discuss what word or phrase you will use for **sacrifice** here. This is the word that means that someone gives a gift to Yahweh on an altar. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about sacrifices. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and look at a picture of an open grain field as a group. Use the same word or phrase for this place that you used before. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said, "The Israelites need to bring their sacrifices to Yahweh at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. The Israelites must give the animals to the **priests** to sacrifice the animals as **peace or fellowship offerings** to Yahweh. The priest will throw the blood around Yahweh's **altar**, which is at the entrance, or courtyard, of the Tent of Meeting. The priest will burn the **fat** from the animal on the bronze altar so that it will **smell good** to Yahweh." Look up fellowship offering, priest, and altar in the Master Glossary for more information. Use the same words or phrases for fellowship offering, priest, bronze altar, fat, and "burning the fat to smell good" as you did before.

Yahweh said, "The people of Israel must not continue sacrificing to the goat demons." No one knows exactly what this word refers to. The Hebrew word literally means "male goat," but it is a different word than what Yahweh used earlier to talk about the kinds of animals that the people of Israel might sacrifice. Some of the people in other people groups believed that goats were connected with the wilderness and that the wilderness was connected with the underworld. The underworld was where people believed that people would go after people died. So these "goat demons" might have been connected to the false gods and demons that some people believed lived in the underworld. These people would often pour blood on the ground to make the underworld demons not angry anymore. Yahweh did not allow the people of Israel to pour out blood to these goat demons.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **goat demons**. If you use a word for evil spirit or demon, you can look up **demon** in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said, "The Israelites have been acting like a married woman who sleeps with men who are not her husband, and the Israelites need to stop that. This rule, or **statute**, will last forever for the Israelites. It will apply to every **generation**." Look up statute and generation in the Master Glossary for more information. Use the same words for statute and generation that you have used earlier.

Yahweh also said, "Tell the Israelites that this rule applies to Israel's blood descendants and to foreigners who have a different ancestor but who moved to live with the people of Israel." These foreigners were not related to the Israelites. Instead, these foreigners had a different ancestor. However, the foreigners or their ancestors had left their homeland to move to where the Israelites lived. For most of the laws in the Bible, Yahweh said that the foreigners and the Israelites had the same rules and people needed to treat both the foreigners and the Israelites the same.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **foreigner**. Look up foreigner in the Master Glossary for more information. Use the same word for this kind of foreigner that you used in the previous passage. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said, "Anyone who offers a **burnt offering** or any other kind of sacrifice—whether the person is a blood descendant of Israel or not—and who does not bring their animal to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting to offer it to Yahweh will be punished. The punishment will be either that someone will kill that person or that person will not belong to Yahweh anymore." Look up burnt offering in the Master Glossary for more information. Use the same word that you used earlier in this book.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 17:1–9

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (964 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (5.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.3 MB)

Leviticus 17:10–16

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 17:10–16 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 17:10–16 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 17:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 17:10–16

In this passage, Yahweh emphasized that Yahweh does not allow the Israelites or foreigners with the Israelites to eat blood. Yahweh continued talking to Moses and said that no one may eat blood. This rule means that no one could drink blood or eat meat that still had blood in it. Instead, the people of Israel had to fully drain the blood from an animal before the Israelites ate the meat.

Yahweh said that these rules applied to both Israelites who were blood descendants of Israel and to foreigners who were born in a different country and moved to live with the Israelites. Yahweh thought of these foreigners as part of Yahweh's people, even though the foreigners were not descendants of Israel. That was why the rules applied to the foreigners too.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you separate out different kinds of people? Does it depend on family, tribe, social status, how long a family has lived in the area, or something else? Are the laws different for different groups of people? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said that the punishment for a person who drank blood or ate meat with blood still in it was that Yahweh would oppose that person and "cut that person off" from Yahweh's people. This phrase probably means that Yahweh would work against that person until that person died. It might also mean that Yahweh would no longer consider that person as one of Yahweh's people.

Yahweh said that the reason for this rule was that an animal's life was in its blood. People must not eat an animal's life. Yahweh said that the only right way to use an animal's blood was to put the blood on the altar to cleanse, or atone for, people who had done something wrong. The blood would atone for the person's life. Since Yahweh created everything, including the animals, Yahweh owns everything, including the animals' blood. Yahweh said that Yahweh had given the animals' blood to the Israelites to atone for themselves, and that was why the Israelites must not use blood for any other reason.

Since people used an animal's blood to cleanse people, no one who was a member of Yahweh's people—whether a blood descendant of Israel or a foreigner—could drink blood or eat meat that still had blood in it.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people think of animal blood? Do people use blood to cook? Do people use blood for any magical or religious reasons? How is your culture's view of blood similar or different from how Yahweh talks about blood? Pause this audio here.

So, if an Israelite or a foreigner who lived with the Israelites went out to hunt and caught a wild animal or a bird that Yahweh allowed the Israelites to eat, that person first had to pour out the animal's or bird's blood on the ground and cover the blood with dirt. These kinds of animals included deer, gazelle, wild goats, mountain sheep, and other wild animals that Yahweh had said people could eat. These kinds of birds included quail, partridges, and other wild birds that Yahweh had said people could eat.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of the kinds of wild animals and wild birds that the Israelites might have hunted. Pause this audio here.

Even though people could eat these animals and birds, people could not sacrifice the animals. So the blood from these animals and birds would never go on the altar. Instead, whoever caught one of these animals or birds would always have to drain the blood and bury the blood under dirt. No one knows exactly why Yahweh said to cover the blood with dirt. Some people think it was to make sure that no one could drink the blood. Some people think it was to make sure that no one used the blood to do magic or sorcery. And other people think it was to treat the animal with respect by giving the animal's blood a proper burial. But no one knows for certain.

After explaining what to do, Yahweh again emphasized that the reason people had to do this was that the life of animals, birds, and people was in the blood. The blood made it so that animals, birds, and people could live. That was why Yahweh said that no one could drink the blood of anything or eat any meat that had blood in it. The punishment for drinking blood or eating meat with blood in it was that someone would "cut off" that person. In this statement, this phrase either means that that person would die or that people would force the person to leave the community, and that person would no longer be one of Yahweh's people.

Finally, Yahweh told Moses what a person needed to do if that person ate an animal that died of natural causes or that another animal had killed. In Exodus, Yahweh said that the descendants of Israel must not eat an animal that another animal killed. Later in Deuteronomy, Yahweh will say that the descendants of Israel must not eat any

Leviticus 17:10–16

animal that the Israelites find already dead, which would include animals that die of natural causes. However, Yahweh did not give those rules to the foreigners who lived with Israel's descendants. The foreigners could eat both animals that had died of natural causes and animals that had died because another animal killed them. However, the foreigners would become ritually unclean or dirty. So here, Yahweh explained what the foreigners should do if the foreigners become ritually dirty because they ate an animal the foreigners found dead. Yahweh also explains what Israel's descendants should do if one of Israel's descendants breaks Yahweh's rule, eats an animal that he or she found already dead, and becomes ritually dirty.

Anyone who ate animals that died needed to wash his or her clothing and body with water and then wait until evening. That person who ate the animal would be ritually dirty until evening. People had to wait for evening because evening began a new day. If the person had washed their body and clothing with water, then that person would become ritually clean when the new day began at evening. However, if the person did not wash their clothing and body, then that person would pay for their crime. This means that someone would punish that person. Yahweh did not say what the punishment was or who would punish the person.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 17:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh explains to Moses the only right way to use animal blood.

In the second scene: Yahweh explains to Moses what to do with an animal's blood if someone hunts that animal for food.

In the third scene: Yahweh explains to Moses how a person needs to clean themselves if that person eats an animal that dies naturally or an animal that a wild animal killed.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- An Israelite
- And a foreigner who lives with the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh talked about the altar at the Tent of Meeting and places where people would hunt animals.

In the first scene, Yahweh explained to Moses the only right way to use animal blood. The most important information in this scene is in the middle. So at the beginning and the ending of this scene, Yahweh said that Yahweh does not allow the Israelites or foreigners with the Israelites to drink an animal's blood or eat meat with the blood still in it. Yahweh also explained that the punishment for drinking blood or eating meat with the blood still in it was that Yahweh would set Yahweh's face against that person. This phrase probably means that Yahweh would reject and oppose that person and make sure that that person died.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about Yahweh setting his face against a person. Pause this audio here.

The middle part of this scene is the most important because here Yahweh explained why this rule was so important. Yahweh also explained the only right way to use an animal's blood. Yahweh said that an animal's life was in its blood, so people must not eat an animal's life. Yahweh said that the only right way to use an animal's blood was to put the blood on the altar to cleanse or atone for people who had done something wrong. The blood would cleanse, or atone for, the person's life. Since Yahweh created everything, including the animals, Yahweh owns everything, including the animals' blood. Yahweh said that Yahweh had given the animals' blood to the Israelites so that the Israelites could atone for themselves. That was why the Israelites must not use blood for

any other reason. This blood was a gift that Yahweh had given to the Israelites to cleanse them, so the Israelites could not use animal blood for any other reason.

Stop and have someone give another person instructions about something important. Pay attention to how the speaker emphasizes the important part. Pause the audio here.

Stop and discuss among yourselves how best to organize this section in your language. Remember to emphasize the most important part. Pause the audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh explained to Moses what to do with an animal's blood if someone hunted that animal for food. Yahweh explained what an Israelite or a foreigner who lives with the Israelites should do if the person went out hunting and caught a wild animal or a bird. That person first had to pour out the animal's or bird's blood on the ground and cover the blood with dirt.

Then Yahweh explained again the reason why the people had to do this. Yahweh said that the life of animals, birds, and people was in the blood. The blood made it so that animals, birds, and people could live. That was why Yahweh said that no one could drink the blood of anything or eat any meat that had blood in it. The punishment for drinking blood or eating meat with blood in it was that the person who drank or ate blood would be cut off. That person would either have to leave the community or die.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you have translated the idea of Yahweh cutting off someone from the Israelite community. How did you translate this idea? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Yahweh explained to Moses how the people of Israel need to clean themselves if someone eats an animal that dies naturally or an animal that wild animals killed. Remember that Yahweh already told Israel's descendants not to eat animals that another animal had killed. Later, Yahweh will tell Israel's descendants not to eat any animal that they find dead. But Yahweh did not give these rules to the foreigners who lived with Israel's descendants. Yahweh allowed foreigners who lived with Israel's descendants to eat animals that died naturally and animals that wild animals killed. However, anyone who ate an animal that died naturally or an animal that wild animals killed would become ritually dirty, or unclean. We are not sure exactly why Yahweh told Israel's descendants what to do if one of Israel's descendants ate an animal that Yahweh said not to eat. Perhaps Yahweh was telling the descendants of Israel what to do if they disobeyed Yahweh in this way. Either way, anyone who ate an animal that someone found dead, whether the person eating was one of Israel's descendants or a foreigner who lived with Israel's descendants, that person who ate the dead animal would become ritually dirty. That person would need to become ritually clean again.

If anyone ate an animal that died of natural causes, or an animal that another animal killed, that person needed to wash their clothing and body with water and then wait until evening, when a new day began. That person who ate the animal would be ritually dirty until the new day began at evening. If that person had washed their body and clothing with water, then that person would become ritually clean when the new day began at evening. However, if the person did not wash his or her clothing and body, then that person would pay for their iniquity, or guilt. This means that someone would punish that person. Yahweh did not say what the punishment was or who would punish the person.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 17:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- An Israelite
- And a foreigner who lives with the Israelites

Leviticus 17:10–16

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh explained to Moses the only right way to use animal blood. Yahweh said, "If anyone drinks blood or eats meat with the blood still in it, I will completely oppose that person and make sure that person dies. It does not matter which tribe or household that person belongs to. It does not matter if that person is a descendant of Israel or a foreigner who moved to live among the Israelites. I will oppose that person and make sure that person dies.

"The reason this is so important is that blood is what makes an animal, bird, or person live. I gave you the blood of animals and birds so that you could put that blood on the altar to cleanse yourselves. This blood is to cleanse your lives.

"That is why I told Israel's descendants that no one may drink blood or eat meat with the blood still in it. None of Israel's descendants and none of the foreigners who live among the Israelites may drink blood or eat meat with the blood still in it." Pause the drama. Ask the people playing an Israelite and a foreigner, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Wow, Yahweh is very serious about this rule; or
- I want to make sure that I do not ever eat meat with blood in it; or
- I am a little scared of what might happen if I drink blood or eat meat with blood in it.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh explained to Moses what to do with an animal's blood if someone hunted that animal for food. Yahweh said, "If anyone goes hunting and catches any of the animals or birds that I said people could eat, that person has to pour out the blood and cover it with dirt. It does not matter if the person is one of Israel's descendants or a foreigner who lives among the Israelites. Everyone has to pour out the blood of whatever someone hunted and cover that blood with dirt.

"The reason this is so important is that everything that is alive is living because of the blood that is inside the body. This blood keeps every person, animal, and bird alive. That is why I told the Israelites not to eat meat that still has the blood in it. Because blood is what makes an animal, bird, or person live, whoever drinks blood or eats meat with blood in it will be cut off."

In the third scene, Yahweh explained to Moses how the people needed to clean themselves if someone ate an animal that died naturally or an animal that wild animals killed. Yahweh said, "Whoever eats an animal that died naturally or that another animal killed needs to wash their body and clothing in water. That person will be ritually dirty until evening, and then after that, the person will be ritually clean. These rules apply both to blood descendants of Israel and to foreigners who live among the Israelites. If anyone does not wash their body and clothing, then that person will pay for their crime." Pause the drama. Ask the people playing an Israelite, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I need to make sure I wash my clothing and my body if I eat an animal that died naturally; or
- I am glad that it is easy to become ritually clean after eating an animal that died naturally.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 17:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 17:10–16

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh began this passage by saying, “If anyone drinks blood or eats meat with the blood still in it, I will completely oppose that person and make sure that person dies. It does not matter which tribe or household in Israel that person belongs to. It does not matter if that person is a **descendant of Israel** or a **foreigner** who moved to live among the Israelites. I will oppose that person and make sure that person dies.” A person is a foreigner in a country when the person is in a country that is not where that person was born. Some foreigners live with the Israelites. Even though foreigners were not descended from Israel, Yahweh thought of the foreigners as members of the community of Israel. Use the same words for **Israelite** and foreigner that you used previously. Look up Israelite and foreigner in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh said, “The reason this is so important is that **blood** is what makes an animal, bird, or person live. I gave you the blood of animals and birds so that you could put that blood on the **altar** to cleanse yourselves. This blood is to **atone** for your lives.” Use the same words for altar, blood, and atone that you used previously. Look up altar, blood, and atonement in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh said, “That is why I told Israel’s descendants that no one may drink blood or eat meat with the blood still in it. None of Israel’s descendants and none of the foreigners who live among the Israelites may drink blood or eat meat with the blood still in it.”

Yahweh continued and said, “If anyone goes hunting and catches any of the animals or birds that I said people could eat, that person has to pour out the blood and cover the blood with dirt.” The animals that Yahweh said the people could eat refer to ritually clean animals.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of some of the kinds of animals or birds that Yahweh said people could eat. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said, “It does not matter if the person is one of Israel’s descendants or a foreigner who lives among the Israelites. Everyone has to pour out the blood of whatever people hunted and cover that blood with dirt.”

“The reason this is so important is that everything that is alive is living because of the blood that is inside the body. This blood keeps every person, animal, and bird alive. That is why I told the Israelites not to eat meat that still has the blood in it. Because blood is what makes an animal, bird, or person live, whoever drinks blood or eats meat with blood in it will be **cut off**.” This phrase “cut off” either means that that person would die or that people would force that person to leave the community, and that person would no longer be one of Yahweh’s people. Use the same word or phrase for “cut off” as you have used in previous passages.

Yahweh continued and said, “Whoever eats an animal that died naturally or that another animal killed needs to wash their body and clothing in water.” An animal that died naturally was an animal that no person or animal had killed, but that had died anyway.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **died naturally**. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, decide if it is a good idea to use the same phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said, “That person will be **ritually unclean** or dirty until evening, and then after that, the person will be **ritually clean**.” Use the same word for ritually dirty and for ritually clean that you used previously. Look up **clean and unclean** in the Master Glossary for more information.

The person who is ritually dirty must **wash their clothes** and **bathe themselves**. Use the same phrases for “wash their clothes” and “bathe themselves in water” as you have used previously.

Yahweh said, “These rules apply both to blood descendants of Israel and to foreigners who live among the Israelites. If anyone does not wash their body and clothing, then that person will pay for their crime, or iniquity.” The word for **iniquity** here is one of the three main words that people used to talk about bad things that someone did. People often used this word when they talked about bad things that someone was going to punish that person for very soon. Use the same word for iniquity that you used previously. Look up iniquity in the Master Glossary for more information.

The word for pay for here literally means “to carry the burden.” When someone did something wrong to someone else, there was an offender and a victim. The offender was the person who did the bad thing to the other person,

who was the victim. People thought of the bad thing that the offender did, and the punishment for that bad thing or the consequences of doing that bad thing, as the burden. If the victim "carried the burden," that meant that the victim would forgive the offender, and no one would punish the offender. If the offender "carried the burden," that meant that someone would punish the offender for what the offender did. In this passage, Yahweh said that the offender would carry the burden of their iniquity, which means that someone would punish the person who did not wash their body and clothing after eating either an animal that died naturally or an animal that another animal had killed.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **pay for**, or **carry the burden of their iniquity**. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, decide if it is a good idea to use the same phrase that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 17:10–16

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (852 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 18:1–5

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 18:1–5 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:1–5 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 18:1–5

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In previous passages, Yahweh has been explaining to Moses what laws the people need to follow about killing animals and eating blood. In this section of Leviticus, Yahweh will begin explaining a series of laws about who and what the people must not have sex with. Yahweh starts by telling Moses to remind the Israelites who Yahweh is and why the Israelites need to follow Yahweh's rules.

First, Yahweh tells Moses to remind the Israelites that Yahweh is the Israelites' God. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh is the Israelites' God because Yahweh wants the Israelites to pay attention to the laws Yahweh is about to give the Israelites. Yahweh is the Israelites' God because Yahweh chose to help and take care of the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about when someone in authority needed to use their authority to make new rules. How did the person use their authority to convince people to follow the new rules? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites not to do what the Israelites did in the land of Egypt, where the Israelites came from. Before Yahweh started giving the Israelites these laws, Yahweh rescued the Israelites from Egypt, a powerful empire that had enslaved the Israelites for many years. Yahweh does not want the Israelites to do the same terrible things that the Egyptian people do, like worshipping gods other than Yahweh or enslaving and mistreating people for generations. Yahweh also does not want the Israelites to do what people in Canaan do. Canaan is the land Yahweh is bringing the Israelites to and the land Yahweh is going to give to the Israelites. Yahweh does not want the Israelites to worship the gods that the Canaanites worship or do the terrible things that the Canaanites do.

Stop here as a group and look at a map of ancient Egypt and Canaan. Pause the audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What things do other nearby people groups do that people in your culture think are terrible or wrong to do? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites that the Israelites must not obey the laws of those people. Instead, the Israelites need to follow Yahweh's ordinances and statutes. Yahweh reminds the Israelites again that Yahweh is the Israelites' God, and so the Israelites need to follow Yahweh's laws. Yahweh is giving the Israelites laws so that as the Israelites follow the laws, other people will see that the Israelites are different than people around the Israelites. Again, Yahweh says that the Israelites should obey Yahweh's statutes and ordinances. When the Israelites do obey, the Israelites will live. This means that when the Israelites obey Yahweh, Yahweh will take care of the Israelites and not punish the Israelites. Most people who heard these laws mostly focused on the fact that Yahweh was giving the people physical life. But it is clear that in this and similar passages, Yahweh is promising more than just physical life. Yahweh is talking about a happy life in which the Israelites will enjoy all the good things that come from Yahweh: health, children, friends, and everything people need to live well and fulfill Yahweh's purposes for the people in this life. Once again, Yahweh says he is Yahweh.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites not to do what the Egyptians or Canaanites do.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites to follow and obey Yahweh's ordinances and statutes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Yahweh
- The Israelites
- Yahweh mentions the Egyptians
- And Yahweh mentions the Canaanites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh has been telling the Israelites how to kill animals and what to do with the blood of animals. Now Yahweh will tell the Israelites different kinds of laws.

In the first scene of this passage, Yahweh talks to Moses. When the storyteller says this, the storyteller is showing that this is a new section in the book of Leviticus. Yahweh tells Moses to tell the Israelites that Yahweh is Yahweh, the Israelites' God. Yahweh says he is Yahweh their God once here and once in this second scene of this passage. At the end of this passage, Yahweh says that he is Yahweh. Yahweh repeats that he is Yahweh so much because Yahweh wants to make it clear that the Israelites are following Yahweh only, not any other god.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How can you translate these phrases to show how Yahweh is using his authority to establish these new rules? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites not to do what the people in the land of Egypt do, which is where the Israelites had lived. Then Yahweh tells the Israelites not to do what the people in the land of Canaan do, which is where Yahweh is taking the Israelites to. Yahweh ends the scene by telling the Israelites not to follow the statutes that the Canaanites or Egyptians have. Remember that the Israelites are currently at a place called Mount Sinai, far away from any other group of people. Yahweh has just rescued the Israelites from Egypt. The leaders of Egypt had made the Israelites live as slaves in Egypt for 400 years. A long time before the Egyptians had enslaved the Israelites, Yahweh had promised Abraham, who is an ancestor of the Israelites, that Yahweh would give the land of Canaan to Abraham's descendants. Now, Yahweh has repeated this promise to Abraham's descendants, the Israelites.

In the next scene, Yahweh contrasts the statutes of the Canaanites and the Egyptians, which Yahweh tells the Israelites not to follow, with Yahweh's ordinances and statutes, which Yahweh tells the Israelites to follow and obey instead. Yahweh's ordinances are the decisions that Yahweh makes about what the Israelites should do. Yahweh's statutes are the rules that Yahweh gives the Israelites about how to treat each other and how to perform religious rituals. Yahweh emphasizes that the Israelites need to follow Yahweh's ordinances and statutes when Yahweh says again that he is Yahweh, their God. Then Yahweh says again that the Israelites must follow Yahweh's statutes and decisions. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that if the Israelites obey Yahweh's statutes and ordinances, then the Israelites will live. You will remember that it is clear that in this and similar passages, Yahweh is promising more than just physical life. Yahweh is talking about a happy life in which the Israelites will enjoy all the good things that come from Yahweh: health, children, friends, and everything people need to live well and fulfill Yahweh's purposes for the people in this life.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will say that if a person obeys Yahweh's statutes and ordinances, he will live by them. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh ends this passage when Yahweh tells the Israelites again that he is Yahweh, the Israelites' God. This is the third time Yahweh has clearly stated that he is the Israelites' God. This is a very important statement.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Yahweh is emphasizing that Yahweh is Israel's only god. When you translate this, how will you show that this is an important statement? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text
Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Yahweh
- The Israelites
- Yahweh mentions the Egyptians
- And Yahweh mentions the Canaanites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene of this passage, Yahweh talks to Moses. Yahweh tells Moses to tell the Israelites that Yahweh is Yahweh, the Israelites' God.

Yahweh tells the Israelites not to do what the people in the land of Egypt do, which is where the Israelites lived. Then Yahweh tells the Israelites not to do what the people in the land of Canaan do, which is where Yahweh is taking the Israelites to. Yahweh ends the scene by telling the Israelites not to follow the laws that the Canaanites or Egyptians have. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Canaanites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- We do not want to worship Yahweh; or
- I do not understand why the Israelites will not do what we do; or
- I like our laws, because our laws are easier to follow.

Continue the drama. In the next scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites to follow and obey Yahweh's statutes. Yahweh emphasizes that the Israelites need to follow Yahweh's ordinances and statutes when Yahweh says again that he is Yahweh, their God. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I really love my people, the Israelites, and I want the Israelites to do the right thing; or
- I am worried that the Israelites are going to want to do things how the Egyptians and Canaanites do things.

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh says again that the Israelites must follow Yahweh's statutes and ordinances. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that if the Israelites obey Yahweh's statutes and ordinances, then the Israelites will live. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so glad Yahweh explained how I can live a good life; or
- I need to be careful to obey all the laws and decisions Yahweh has; or

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- Yahweh is making us special people when Yahweh gives us these ordinances and statutes.

Continue the drama. Yahweh ends this passage by telling the Israelites that he is Yahweh, the Israelites' God.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In the beginning of this passage, **Yahweh** speaks to Moses. Yahweh is the personal name God gave to Moses for the Israelites to call God. Use the same word or phrase to refer to Yahweh in this passage as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh tells Moses that Yahweh is the Israelites' **God**. God is the most powerful spiritual being who created everything. Use the same word or phrase to refer to God as you used in previous passages. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh tells the Israelites not to follow the **statutes** of the people who live in Egypt or Canaan. Statutes are instructions for living in a society, especially concerning its religious practices. Use the same word or phrase to refer to statutes as you did in other passages. For more information on statute, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh also tells the Israelites to obey and follow Yahweh's ordinances. When a person in authority decides how the people need to act, that ordinance becomes a law or a rule that the people need to follow. The person in authority might make this ordinance after people ask the person in authority what the person thinks people should do in a particular situation. Or the person in authority might make the ordinance when the person decides that people need to follow a new rule.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **ordinance**. Look at ordinance in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 18:1–5

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (839 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 18:6–18

Hear and Heart

NOTE: This passage talks about subjects that you may want to discuss in groups of only men and only women. Stop here and discuss as a group if you will listen to this passage in groups of only men and only women. Pause this audio here.

In this step, hear Leviticus 18:6–18 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:6–18 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:6–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

NOTE: This passage talks about subjects that you may want to discuss in groups of only men and only women. Stop here and discuss as a group if you will listen to this passage in groups of only men and only women. Pause this audio here.

In this part of Leviticus, Yahweh gives specific rules about who Yahweh allows a person to have sex with. In the previous passage, Yahweh introduced this section on appropriate sexual relations by telling Moses to tell the Israelites not to follow the rules of the Egyptians and the Canaanites, and instead follow Yahweh's statutes and ordinances. In this passage, Yahweh begins explaining which family members Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to have sex with. Yahweh does not allow Israelites to marry people outside of the Israelite people. Israelites often wanted to marry people who were in the same clan or extended family so that people outside the extended family or clan did not inherit the land and possessions the family owned. But Yahweh tells the Israelites not to marry anyone who is too closely related.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what close relations can marry each other? What do people in your culture consider inappropriate marriages because the people are too closely related? Pause this audio here.

First, Yahweh says that no one should approach anyone who is immediate family. Immediate family is mother, father, son, daughter, brother, and sister. Yahweh says a person must not approach a family member to uncover their nakedness, or their genitals. Uncovering nakedness is one way the Israelites talk about having sex with someone that they should not have sex with.

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Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people talk about having sex with someone that the person should not have sex with? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that he is Yahweh. That is a way Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh has rescued the Israelites and has authority over the Israelites. Yahweh is also reminding the Israelites that as followers of Yahweh, the Israelites are different than the Egyptians and Canaanites, and the Israelites need to act differently. Yahweh is giving the Israelites rules that help the Israelites show how the Israelites are different. Then Yahweh addresses each man in Israel and starts giving specific rules for whom the men must not have sex with. Yahweh directly talks to the Israelite men. Yahweh says, "You cannot uncover your father's nakedness, or dishonor your father, which means you must not have sex with your mother."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, why do people not allow a man to have sex with his mother? How is that different or similar to the reason Yahweh gives here? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says, "You must not have sex with your father's wife because the woman's naked body belongs to your father." When Yahweh says "your father's wife," Yahweh does not just mean a man's mother. Sometimes an Israelite man married more than one woman, so a person's father's wife might not be that person's mother. Yahweh does not allow a man to have sex with any woman who is married to the man's father.

Yahweh says, "You must not have sex with your sister, whether the sister was born to your father or just to your mother." That means the man cannot have sex with his full sister or half sister, whether the sister was born in the man's house into the man's family or born outside in another house to another family. That probably means the mother gave birth to the sister in the mother's family's house, and then the mother married the man's father.

Yahweh says, "You must not have sex with your granddaughter, whether the woman is your son's daughter or your daughter's daughter, because the family's nakedness is your nakedness." Here, Yahweh probably means that because the granddaughter is the man's descendant, if the man dishonors anyone in his family, then the man also dishonors himself.

Yahweh says, "You also must not have sex with your father's wife's daughter, or your stepsister." Yahweh says the sister was born to the father, but that probably means that the father adopted the sister when the father married the woman's mother, and that is why Yahweh says the sister is the man's sister.

Yahweh says, "You must not have sex with your aunt on your father's side or mother's side. You also must not expose the nakedness of your father's brother, or shame him, by having sex with your uncle's wife. This woman is your aunt.

"You must not have sex with your daughter-in-law who married your son, because the woman is your son's wife.

"You must not have sex with your brother's wife, because the woman's naked body belongs to your brother.

"You must not have sex with both a woman and her daughter, or a woman and her granddaughter through the woman's daughter or son." The reason a man must not have sex with both a woman and the woman's female descendants is that the descendants are flesh. This probably means that the female descendants are related to the man, but it might mean that the female descendants are related to the mother or grandmother. Yahweh says that when people do this, people are doing a wicked thing.

Finally, Yahweh says, "You must not take a rival wife to her sister," which means a man must not have sex with a sister of the man's wife while the wife is alive. Israelite men sometimes married more than one woman, but Yahweh did not want a man to marry two women who were sisters to each other.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:6–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh gives a list of family members that a man cannot have sex with.

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In the second scene: Yahweh gives a list of people who a woman is related to that a man cannot have sex with.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- An Israelite man
- The man's father
- The man's mother
- The man's father's wife
- The man's sister
- The man's half sister
- The man's son
- The man's son's daughter
- The man's daughter
- The man's daughter's daughter
- The man's stepsister
- The man's father's sister
- The man's mother's sister
- The man's father's brother
- The man's father's brother's wife
- The man's daughter-in-law
- The man's brother
- The man's brother's wife
- A woman
- The woman's daughter
- The woman's daughter's daughter
- The woman's son
- The woman's son's daughter
- The man's wife
- And the man's wife's sister

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this part of Leviticus, Yahweh gives specific rules about who Yahweh will not allow the people to have sex with. In the previous passage, Yahweh introduced this section on appropriate sexual relations by telling Moses to tell the Israelites not to follow the rules of the Egyptians and the Canaanites, and instead follow Yahweh's statutes and ordinances. In this passage, Yahweh begins explaining which family members Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to have sex with.

In the first scene, Yahweh says that no one should approach anyone who is immediate family. Immediate family is mother, father, son, daughter, brother, and sister. Yahweh says not to approach immediate family to uncover their nakedness, or their genitals. Uncovering nakedness is a way Israelites talk about having sex with someone they should not have sex with. When someone "uncovers someone's nakedness," they also shame or dishonor that person.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What word or phrase should you use in this passage to describe sex with people you should not have sex with? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that he is Yahweh. That is a way Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh has rescued the Israelites and has authority over the Israelites. Then Yahweh addresses each man in Israel and starts to give specific rules about whom the men cannot have sex with. Yahweh directly speaks to the Israelites in this passage. In your language, you may need to specify each time that Yahweh is talking to each type of Israelite man.

When Yahweh talks about the different family relationships, Yahweh is trying to tell the Israelite men not to sleep with anyone who is too closely related to the men. Each time Yahweh mentions a brother or sister or wife, Yahweh is talking about both younger and older family members. Each time Yahweh talks about a son or a daughter, Yahweh is talking about any sons or daughters. Yahweh is talking about oldest children, second-born children, youngest children, and any other children.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what words do people use to talk about different family members? What are the differences between those words? What are the best ways to translate the words Yahweh is using to talk about the different family members? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says, “You must not shame your father, or uncover your father’s nakedness, by having sex with your mother.” When a man has sex with his mother, the man is not only shaming his mother, but his father as well. Then Yahweh says, “You cannot have sex with your father’s wife because the woman’s naked body belongs to your father.”

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate the family members that Yahweh is talking about here? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you translate that if a man has sex with his mother, it shames both the man’s mother and the man’s father? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says, “You cannot have sex with any of your sisters, older or younger, whether the sister was born to your father or just to your mother.” That means the man cannot have sex with any of his full sisters or any of his half sisters, whether she has both the same father and mother as the man, just the same father as the man, or just the same mother as the man. It could happen that a man’s mother gave birth to the man’s sister and raised the sister in a different home than the man.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are the best words to use for the family members that Yahweh is talking about here? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says, “You also cannot have sex with your granddaughter, whether your granddaughter is any of the daughters of any of your sons or any of the daughters of any of your daughters.” Here, Yahweh probably means that the descendants are the man’s descendants, so the shame or honor that comes from the descendant’s body also reflects on the man.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are the best words to use for family members that Yahweh is talking about here? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says, “You also cannot have sex with any of your father’s wife’s daughters, or your stepsisters.” Yahweh says the sister was born to the father, but that probably means that the father adopted the girl when the father married the girl’s mother, and that is why Yahweh says the girl is the man’s sister.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are the best words to use for the family members that Yahweh is talking about here? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says, “You cannot have sex with any of your aunts, whether the aunt is on your father’s side or your mother’s side. You also cannot shame or expose the nakedness of any of your father’s brothers by having sex with any of your uncle’s wives because these women are your aunts.”

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are the best words to use for the family members that Yahweh is talking about here? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says, “You cannot have sex with any of your daughters-in-law who married any of your sons, because these women are your sons’ wives.”

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are the best words to use for the family members that Yahweh is talking about here? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says, “You cannot have sex with any of the wives of any of your brothers, because these women’s naked bodies belong to the brother the woman is married to.”

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are the best words to use for the family members that Yahweh is talking about here? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh says a man cannot have sex with both a woman and any of the woman’s daughters, or with both a woman and any of her granddaughters through any of her daughters or any of her sons. The reason a man cannot have sex with a woman and her female descendants is that the descendants are flesh. This probably means that the female descendants are related to the man, but it might mean that the female

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descendants are closely related to each other. Yahweh says this is wickedness. When Yahweh calls something wickedness, Yahweh means that if a person does this action, then the person is doing an especially bad thing.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate the family members that Yahweh is talking about here? Pause this audio here.

Finally, Yahweh says, “You cannot take your wife’s sister as another wife,” which means a man cannot have sex with a sister of the man’s wife while the man’s wife is alive.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:6–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- An Israelite man
- The man’s father
- The man’s mother
- The man’s father’s wife
- The man’s sister
- The man’s half-sister
- The man’s son
- The man’s son’s daughter
- The man’s daughter
- The man’s daughter’s daughter
- The man’s stepsister
- The man’s father’s sister
- The man’s mother’s sister
- The man’s father’s brother
- The man’s father’s brother’s wife
- The man’s daughter-in-law
- The man’s brother
- The man’s brother’s wife
- A woman
- The woman’s daughter
- The woman’s daughter’s daughter
- The woman’s son
- The woman’s son’s daughter
- The man’s wife
- And the man’s wife’s sister

As a group, retell the passage twice. You should retell the passage in your own language.

Because your translators may not want to act out the content of this passage, you may just want to have someone speak the passage, or you may want to use objects to show the different relationships of people. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and retell the passage.

The group should retell this passage a second time. At certain points, in the retelling, pause the retelling and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the retelling.

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Pause this audio here and retell the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the retelling and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh says that no one should approach anyone who is immediate family to have sex. Yahweh says that he is Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I love the Israelites, and I want the Israelites to have good relationships with each other; or
- I know that people will try to have sex in ways people should not have sex, so I really need to convince people not to do that.

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh says, "You cannot uncover your father's nakedness, which means you cannot have sex with your mother. You cannot have sex with your father's wife because the woman's naked body belongs to your father.

"You cannot have sex with your sister, whether your sister was born to your father or just to your mother, whether your sister was born in your house into your family or born outside in another house to another family. You cannot have sex with your son's daughter, and you cannot have sex with your daughter's daughter, because their nakedness is your nakedness. You also cannot have sex with your father's wife's daughter, or your step-sister. You cannot have sex with your aunt on your father's side or your mother's side. You also cannot expose the nakedness of your father's brother by having sex with your uncle's wife because that woman is your aunt. You cannot have sex with your daughter-in-law who married your son, because that woman is your son's wife." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing an Israelite man's son, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad I do not have to worry about my father having sex with my daughter or my wife; or
- My father is important to me, so I am glad Yahweh gave clear instructions so that we can continue to have a good relationship.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh says, "You cannot have sex with both a woman and the woman's daughter, or a woman and her granddaughter through her daughter or her son. The reason you cannot have sex with a woman and her female descendants is that they are closely related to each other. This is wickedness. You cannot take your wife's sister as another wife, which means you cannot have sex with a sister of your wife while your wife is alive." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the wife's sister, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad I do not have to fight with my own sister to get my husband's love; or
- Even if I want to marry the man who married my sister, I know that I cannot; or
- My sister is important to me, so I am glad Yahweh gave clear instructions so that we can continue to have a good relationship.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:6–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh tells the Israelites not to have sex with their immediate family, then Yahweh says that he is Yahweh. Yahweh is the personal name that the Creator God gave to the Israelites to call God. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that if an Israelite man has sex with a woman and any of her female descendants, it is wickedness. When Yahweh calls something wickedness or evil, Yahweh means that if a person does that action, that person is doing an especially bad thing. Yahweh uses this word often when Yahweh is talking about sexual immorality.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **wickedness**. Look up wickedness in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 18:6–18

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (3.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (887 KB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 18:19–23

Hear and Heart

NOTE: This passage talks about subjects that you may want to discuss in groups of only men and only women. Stop here and discuss as a group if you will listen to this passage in groups of only men and only women. Pause this audio here.

In this step, hear Leviticus 18:19–23 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:19–23 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:19–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

NOTE: This passage talks about subjects that you may want to discuss in groups of only men and only women. Stop here and discuss as a group if you will listen to this passage in groups of only men and only women. Pause this audio here.

Remember that in this part of Leviticus, Yahweh has been telling the Israelites Yahweh's laws and decisions about sex, because Yahweh does not want the Israelites to do what the Canaanites and the Egyptians do. In the previous passage, Yahweh told the Israelites which members of a person's family Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to have sex with. In this passage, Yahweh gives more rules about things that the Egyptians and Canaanites do that Yahweh does not want the Israelites to do. Yahweh is giving these laws mostly to the men of Israel, and Yahweh expects people to be able to use these laws to understand what people need to do in similar situations.

First, Yahweh tells the Israelite men not to approach a woman to uncover her nakedness while the woman is in her time of uncleanness. Yahweh uses special language here twice. First, Yahweh says that a man cannot approach a woman to uncover her nakedness. When a man uncovers a woman's nakedness, the man has sex with the woman. Also, the time of a woman's uncleanness could refer to any time a woman is ritually dirty, but here it almost certainly means that the woman is on her period and ritually dirty because of that. So Yahweh is telling the Israelites not to have sex with a woman while the woman is on her period. You will remember that in Leviticus 15, Yahweh told the Israelite men that they would become ritually dirty if they had sex with a woman while she was on her period.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what rules do people have about having sex with a woman on her period? Pause this audio here.

Next, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to have sex with the wife of a kinsman, or another Israelite. Here, Yahweh does not use special language to talk about sex; instead, Yahweh uses very clear and specific language. Yahweh says if a man has sex with a kinsman's wife, the man will make himself ritually dirty. This does not just mean that the man will not be able to participate in religious rituals and special worship. In this case, Yahweh means the man will be spiritually dirty, which means the man will be unable to stay with the Israelites or stay in the land of Israel. Later in Leviticus, we hear that the punishment for a man who had sex with a married woman was death.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time someone had sex with their neighbor's wife. How did people treat the people who had sex with each other? Pause this audio here.

Then, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to give any of the Israelites' children to pass over to Molech. Yahweh is using special language to say that the Israelites must not use the Israelites' children as a sacrifice to Molech by killing the children. Molech was probably the name of a god that the Canaanites and other people around Israel would worship by killing their children as a sacrifice to Molech.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what terrible thing do people sometimes do to worship a god? How do other people react when someone does that? Pause this audio here.

People would think that Yahweh is a terrible and evil god if Yahweh let the Israelites kill their children as a sacrifice, so Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh is their God and he is Yahweh.

Then, Yahweh tells the Israelite men not to lie with a man as a man does with a woman. This is special language that means Yahweh does not allow the Israelite men to have sex with men. When men have sex with men, that is an abomination, or a terrible thing to do. Yahweh does not allow men to have sex with an animal either, which would make the men spiritually dirty. Yahweh does not allow the Israelite women to try to get an animal to have sex with the woman, either. If a person has sex with an animal, that person has done something perverse and terrible.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:19–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites not to have sex with a woman who is on her period.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites not to have sex with another Israelite's wife.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites not to sacrifice their children to Molech.

In the fourth scene: Yahweh tells the Israelite men not to have sex with men.

In the fifth scene: Yahweh tells the Israelite men and women not to have sex with animals.

The characters in this passage are:

- The Israelite men
- The Israelite women
- A woman on her period
- Another Israelite man
- Another Israelite man's wife
- The Israelite man's children
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that in this part of Leviticus, Yahweh has been telling the Israelites Yahweh's laws about sex, because Yahweh does not want the Israelites to do what the Canaanites and the Egyptians do. In the previous passage, Yahweh told the Israelites which members of their family Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to have sex with. In this passage, Yahweh gives more rules about things that the Egyptians and Canaanites do that the Israelites must not do. Yahweh is giving these laws mostly to the men of Israel, and Yahweh expects people to be able to use these laws to understand what people need to do in similar situations. As Yahweh did in the last passage, Yahweh addresses each man in Israel and starts giving specific rules about whom the men cannot have sex with. Yahweh directly speaks to the Israelites in this passage. In your language, you may need to specify each time that Yahweh is talking to each type of Israelite man.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells the Israelite men not to approach a woman to uncover her nakedness while the woman is in her time of uncleanness. Yahweh uses special language here twice. First, Yahweh says not to approach a woman to uncover her nakedness. When a man uncovers a woman's nakedness, the man wrongly has sex with the woman and dishonors her.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What words or phrases would be appropriate to refer to having sex with a woman in this scene? Pause this audio here.

Also, the time of a woman's uncleanness could refer to any time a woman is ritually dirty, but here it almost certainly means that the woman is bleeding during her monthly period and ritually dirty because of that. So Yahweh is telling the Israelites not to have sex with a woman while the woman is on her period.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What words or phrases would be appropriate to refer to a woman's period in this passage? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to have sex with the wife of a kinsman, or another Israelite. Here, Yahweh does not use special language to talk about sex; instead, Yahweh uses very clear and specific language.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What words or phrases would be appropriate to refer to having sex with a woman in this scene? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says if a man has sex with a kinsman's wife, the man will make himself ritually dirty. A kinsman most likely means a fellow Israelite. You may use a term like "fellow Israelite" or "neighbor." This is a very serious wrongdoing. This does not just mean that the man will not be able to participate in religious rituals and special

worship. In this case, Yahweh means the man will be spiritually dirty, which means the man will be unable to stay with the Israelites or stay in the land of Israel.

In the third scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to give any of their children to pass over to Molech. When Yahweh tells the Israelites not to give any of their children to pass over to Molech, Yahweh is using special language to say that the Israelites must not use their children as a sacrifice to Molech by killing the children.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What words or phrases would be appropriate to translate the special language about sacrificing children? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that if the Israelites sacrifice their children to Molech, it will profane the name of their God. Here, Yahweh is using special language to mean that people will not think Yahweh is special or worth obeying if the Israelites sacrifice children to Molech. To the Israelites, a person's name was a way to talk about that person's reputation, or other people's opinion of that person.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about times when people in your culture have insulted or said bad things about each other. How will you talk about profaning the name of Yahweh, or causing people to think badly of Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh. Yahweh does this when Yahweh wants to make sure the Israelites pay attention and carefully follow the rules Yahweh is giving to the Israelites. Yahweh also does this to remind the Israelites of the difference between Yahweh and the Canaanites' gods.

In the fourth scene, Yahweh tells the Israelite men not to lie with a man like a man does with a woman. This is special language that means Yahweh does not allow the Israelite men to have sex with men. When men have sex with men, that is an abomination, or a terrible thing to do. In other words, Yahweh hates it when men have sex with men.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What in your culture is an especially terrible thing to do that Yahweh hates? What are words that you use to describe actions or events like these? Pause this audio here.

In the fifth scene, Yahweh does not allow the Israelite men or women to have sex with an animal, either, which would make the person spiritually dirty. If a person has sex with an animal, the person has done something perverse that people should avoid.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:19–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The Israelite men
- The Israelite women
- A woman on her period
- Another Israelite man
- Another Israelite man's wife
- The Israelite man's children
- And Yahweh

Because your translators may not want to act out the content of this passage, you may just want to have someone speak the passage, or you may want to use objects to show the different relationships of people. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and retell the passage.

Leviticus 18:19–23

The group should retell this passage a second time. At certain points, as you retell the passage, pause the retelling and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the retelling.

Pause this audio here and retell the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the retelling and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to have sex with a woman while the woman is on her period.

In the second scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to have sex with the wife of a kinsman, or another Israelite, because the Israelites will make themselves spiritually dirty. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the wife or the husband of the wife, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am angry that my wife is having sex with someone else; or
- I am jealous of the man my wife is having sex with; or
- I am unhappy with my relationship with my husband, and I want to have sex with someone else.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to use their children as a sacrifice to Molech by killing their children. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing an Israelite man’s child, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am scared of Molech because Molech wants my parents to kill me; or
- I am so glad that Yahweh wants to keep me safe and will not let my parents sacrifice me.

Continue the drama. People will think that Yahweh is a terrible and evil god if Yahweh lets the Israelites kill their children as a sacrifice, so Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is their God and he is Yahweh.

In the fourth scene, Yahweh tells the Israelite men not to have sex with men, because that is an abomination, or a terrible thing to do.

In the fifth scene, Yahweh does not allow the Israelite men to have sex with an animal either, which would make the men spiritually dirty. Yahweh does not allow the Israelite women to try to get an animal to have sex with the women, either. If a person has sex with an animal, that person has done something perverse and terrible.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:19–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh tells the Israelites not to approach a woman while the woman is in the **uncleanness** of her monthly period. This is a reference to a woman’s period. Use the same word or phrase for uncleanness or ritual dirtiness as you used in previous passages. See **clean and unclean** in the Master Glossary.

Yahweh then says that if an Israelite has sex with a fellow Israelite’s wife, the person will **defile** themselves or make themselves ritually and spiritually dirty. Yahweh does not allow ritually dirty people to go to the tabernacle or do religious rituals. Here, the people are unclean because of how wrong their actions are, not just because of what the people touched. Use the same word or phrase to translate defile as you used in previous passages. For more information on defile, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that if someone sacrifices their children to Molech, that person will profane, or make people think less of, the name of Yahweh, or Yahweh’s reputation.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **profane**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. See profane in the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites that he is Yahweh. Yahweh is the personal name that the one true **God** gave to the Israelites as the name the Israelites should call God. Yahweh uses his name, Yahweh, to show the difference

between Yahweh and the Canaanite gods. Use the same words for Yahweh and for God as you used in previous passages. Refer to the Master Glossary for more information about Yahweh and God.

Yahweh tells the Israelite men not to have sex with men because it is an abomination, or a terrible thing to do. Yahweh hates this action.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **abomination**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh says that Yahweh does not allow the Israelite men or women to have sex with animals, because it is perversion. It is deeply wrong in a way that goes against how Yahweh organized people and animals and how people and animals should relate to each other. People should avoid doing anything that is a perversion.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **perversion**.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 18:19–23

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (2.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 18:24–30

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 18:24–30 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:24–30 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:24–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Remember that in this part of Leviticus, Yahweh has been telling his people Yahweh's rules about who and what the people cannot have sex with. In this passage, Yahweh explains why the people cannot do all these terrible things Yahweh described.

Yahweh tells the Israelites not to defile themselves, or make themselves ritually and spiritually dirty, by doing any of the things Yahweh just described. When Yahweh talks about being ritually dirty in these cases, Yahweh means that the people cannot participate in the religious rituals because the people have done wrong things against Yahweh's laws. This also means Yahweh will punish the ritually and spiritually dirty people. Yahweh explains that the nations who live in the land did these things and made themselves dirty. Yahweh is talking about the land of Canaan, which Yahweh promised to the Israelites' ancestor, Abraham. We hear in the book of Exodus how Yahweh had promised the Israelites that Yahweh would give the land to the Israelites and help the Israelites remove the different nations that are in the land now in this story.

Stop here as a group and look at a map of Canaan and the area around it. Pause this audio here.

When the people who lived in the land of Canaan made themselves ritually dirty, those people made the land ritually dirty, so Yahweh is punishing the land for the sin that happened in the land. The ancient Israelites and other people groups thought that if people were ritually dirty, those people could spread the dirtiness to the things people interacted with. Here, Yahweh is saying that if people do these terrible things Yahweh has been talking about in the last two passages, then those people become ritually dirty, and that spreads to the land the people live in, just like how other dirtiness can spread to things like people, couches, and beds.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about how people changed their opinion about a place because of what people did in that place. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says the land will vomit out the people there. This is special language that means Yahweh will remove the people from the land. Then Yahweh tells the Israelites that the Israelites need to keep Yahweh's statutes and follow Yahweh's ordinances. The Israelites must not do any of the things that Yahweh has been talking about in the last two passages. Both the descendants of Israel, or the Israelites, and any foreigner who lives among the Israelites as part of the community need to follow these rules. You will remember that some people who were not Israelites chose to live among the Israelites and also follow Yahweh. This meant that these foreigners needed to follow the same laws that the Israelites followed.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are some examples of rules that only apply to people who are citizens of your country? What are some rules that apply to both citizens and foreigners who live there as part of the community? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh again reminds the Israelites that the reason the Israelites must not do the things Yahweh has talked about is that those things are what the people who are currently living in the land did. Those people have done those evil things and defiled the land. If the Israelites do not do what Yahweh says to do, the land will vomit the Israelites out, too. This means Yahweh will remove the Israelites just like Yahweh will remove the nations currently in the land if the Israelites make the land ritually dirty. Whoever does these evil things will be cut off from their people, which means the Israelites will not consider that person to be an Israelite anymore, and Yahweh will not consider that person to be one of Yahweh's people anymore. It is even possible that Yahweh

would kill the person. You will remember that we are not exactly sure what it means to "cut off" someone from their people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what would a person have to do for their people to stop considering that person to be part of the group? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh tells the Israelites to obey Yahweh's command not to do any of the terrible things that the people in the land were doing. Yahweh does not want the Israelites to become ritually dirty by doing these things. Yahweh ends this passage by reminding the Israelites that he is Yahweh, their God.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:24–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites not to do the things that caused Yahweh to reject the people who currently live in Canaan.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites to obey Yahweh's rules so that Yahweh does not reject the Israelites from the land.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites not to do the terrible things that Yahweh has been talking about, or Yahweh will reject the Israelites from the community of Israel.

The characters in this passage are:

- The nations, or people groups, in the land of Canaan
- Yahweh
- Foreigners who live with the Israelites
- And the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this passage, Yahweh is trying to convince the Israelites not to do all the terrible things that Yahweh has described in the last two passages. Yahweh wants to show that this is very important, so Yahweh repeats himself a lot. Yahweh talks five times about people defiling themselves, or making themselves ritually dirty. Yahweh says four times that what the people do is an abomination, or a very terrible thing. Three times, Yahweh mentions that the land will vomit out or reject its people. Yahweh repeats these phrases to make sure the Israelites understand and remember how bad it is to do any of the terrible things Yahweh commanded the Israelites not to do in the last two passages.

When Yahweh tells the Israelites these rules, the Israelites are in the wilderness near Mount Sinai. Yahweh is preparing the Israelites to go to the land of Canaan. There, Yahweh will cause the Israelites to force out the nations living there and take the land for themselves. Here, Yahweh talks about what those nations have done to cause Yahweh to remove the nations from the land, but Yahweh has not actually removed the nations from the land yet. When Yahweh talks about removing the nations from the land, Yahweh is talking about something that Yahweh will do in the future.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to defile themselves, or make themselves ritually dirty, by doing the things Yahweh has been talking about. The nations, or people groups, that live in the land Yahweh is giving the Israelites did these things and made themselves ritually dirty. When the nations made themselves ritually dirty, the nations also made the land ritually dirty. So Yahweh punished the land because of the sins that people did in the land, and the land vomited out the people who lived in it. Yahweh is using special language here. Yahweh is talking as if the land were a person that Yahweh can punish and that can vomit because of people's ritual dirtiness. In reality, Yahweh is the one who removes people from the land.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way in your language to express this special language about the land vomiting? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh is talking about the people who are in the land of Canaan before the Israelites are in the land of Canaan because Yahweh wants the Israelites to understand that Yahweh really will force the Israelites to leave the land if the Israelites make themselves ritually dirty. Yahweh is using the people in the land as an example of what Yahweh is willing to do.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time someone proved that the person was willing to do something by showing that the person had done it in the past. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh tells the people to obey Yahweh's ordinances and statutes, and not to do any of the terrible things Yahweh has been talking about in the last two passages. Yahweh calls these terrible things "abominations." You will remember that abominations are terrible things that Yahweh hates. Yahweh does not want the Israelites to do any of these things, and Yahweh also does not want any foreigners who will live with the Israelites to do any of these things either.

Stop here and remind each other of how you described abominations in previous passages. Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh reminds the Israelites again that the people who are in the land of Canaan did all these terrible things, which made the land ritually dirty. If the Israelites do not obey Yahweh, the land will vomit the Israelites out because the Israelites defiled the land, just like the land vomited out the nations that were in the land before the Israelites. Yahweh is using the same special language Yahweh used earlier when Yahweh spoke as if the land could vomit.

In the third scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites that anyone who does any of the terrible things Yahweh has talked about in the last two passages will be cut off from their people. This probably means that Yahweh will no longer consider the person an Israelite and that Yahweh will expect the other Israelites not to consider the person an Israelite. Yahweh is probably strengthening Yahweh's statements about not defiling the land by telling the Israelites to disown anyone who does these things. If the Israelites remove anyone who does these terrible things Yahweh has been talking about in the previous two passages, then Yahweh will not have to remove the entire Israelite nation from the land. Yahweh once again tells the Israelites not to defile themselves by doing any of the terrible things Yahweh has talked about in the last two passages. Yahweh finishes by reminding the Israelites that he is Yahweh, the Israelites' God.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:24–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The nations, or people, in the land of Canaan
- Yahweh
- Foreigners who live with the Israelites
- And the Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to make themselves ritually dirty in any of the ways Yahweh has described in the last two passages, because the nations that are currently in the land made themselves ritually dirty by doing these things. When the nations made themselves ritually dirty, the nations made the land ritually dirty. Yahweh is punishing the land, and the land is vomiting out the nations in the land. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am angry because these people are doing terrible things; or
- I will be upset if my people do what the Canaanites do; or
- I want my people to live in the best way, not in ways that make the people ritually dirty. Then the people cannot have good relationships with me or with other people.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites to obey Yahweh's ordinances and statutes. Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to do any of the abominations Yahweh talked about in the last two passages. Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to allow any foreigners, or non-Israelites, who are living in the land to do any of these things either. When the people who are living in the land did these abominations, those people made the land ritually dirty. If the Israelites do these abominations, then the land will vomit the Israelites out because the Israelites defiled the land, just like the land is vomiting out the nations that live in the land now. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I do not want the land to vomit me up; or
- I am glad that Yahweh has warned me now what I need to avoid in order to stay in the land; or
- I know that we need to remember these rules so that Yahweh does not punish us.

Continue the drama. In the last scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites that Yahweh does not consider anyone who does these abominations to be an Israelite. Yahweh tells the Israelites again to follow Yahweh's rules and not to do any of these abominations that the people already living in the land are doing. Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to make themselves ritually dirty by doing these terrible things Yahweh has talked about in the last two passages. Yahweh ends this passage by telling the Israelites that he is Yahweh and he is their God. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I know that if the Israelites follow these rules, the Israelites will live a good life in the land I will give to the Israelites; or
- I want the Israelites to do the right thing and take good care of the land I am giving to the Israelites; or
- These are my people, so I need to tell my people what the right and wrong things to do are.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 18:24–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

At the beginning of this passage, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to **defile** themselves, or make themselves **unclean**. If a person is unclean or ritually dirty, then that person is not fit for service to God. Use the same word or phrase for defile as you used in previous passages. For more information on defile, and clean and unclean, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that the nations living in the land made themselves ritually dirty. A nation is a group of people who belong together and who live in the same country and who have the same ruler.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **nations**. Look up nation in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites that Yahweh will punish the land for the **iniquity** the people have done in the land. These iniquities are perverse actions that make people guilty. These are the sins that the nations in the land committed, which are causing Yahweh to punish the nations. Use the same word or phrase for iniquity as you used in previous passages. For more information, see iniquity in the Master Glossary.

Yahweh tells the Israelites to obey Yahweh's **statutes**. A statute is an instruction for living in a society. Use the same word or phrase for statute as you used in previous passages. For more information on statute, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh also talks about Yahweh's **ordinances**, or decisions. When a person in authority decides how the people they rule need to act, that ordinance becomes a law or a rule that the people need to follow. The person in authority might make this decision after people ask the person what people should do in a particular situation. Or the person in authority might make the decision when the person decides that people need to follow a new rule. Use the same word or phrase for ordinance as you used in previous passages. For more information on ordinance, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh describes the actions that the people in the land have done as **abominations**. An abomination is an action that is completely wicked and that Yahweh hates. Use the same word or phrase to translate abomination as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh says that these ordinances apply to everyone, including the **foreigners** who live with the Israelites. A foreigner is a non-Israelite who is living in the Israelites' land. Use the same word or phrase to translate foreigner as you used in previous passages. For more information on foreigners, refer to the Master Glossary.

If anyone does one of these abominations, Yahweh says the person will be **cut off from the people**. This means that Yahweh will not consider that person to be part of the community of Israel anymore. Use the same word or phrase to translate "cut off from the people" as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh finishes this passage by reminding the Israelites that he is Yahweh. Yahweh is the personal name that the one true God told the Israelites to call him. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh also says that he is the Israelites' **God**. That means Yahweh is the most powerful spiritual being and the God who created everything. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages. For more information, refer to God in the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 18:24–30

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (849 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 19:1–8

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 19:1–8 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:1–8 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passages in Leviticus, Yahweh has been telling the Israelites what rules to follow about sex. In this passage, Yahweh speaks to Moses again and tells Moses to speak to the assembly of Israelites who had gathered to hear the laws. Yahweh tells Moses to tell the Israelites that each Israelite needs to be holy because Yahweh, their God, is holy. You will remember that Yahweh wants the Israelite people to be holy, or live differently from all the other people groups, because the Israelite people know Yahweh and what is important to Yahweh. Yahweh also wants the Israelite people to show other people groups what Yahweh is like and to show other people how to worship Yahweh.

Each Israelite also needs to fear their mother and father. Yahweh says that the Israelites should fear their parents because when the Israelites fear people, the Israelites recognize that this person has authority, and so they need to listen to this person. In other words, the Israelites need to respect their parents and honor their parents.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people treat their parents? Tell a story about someone who honors their parents. How do you know that person honors their parents? Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 19:1–8

The Israelites need to obey Yahweh's rules about the Sabbath every week. Yahweh had told the Israelites through Moses that the seventh day of every week was special. On the seventh day, the Israelites should not do any work. Instead, the Israelites were supposed to rest and let anyone they were in charge of rest as well. Yahweh called this day the Sabbath. Yahweh gave the Israelites rules to help the Israelites understand what counted as work on the Sabbath. Here, Yahweh reminds the Israelites to follow the rules Yahweh gave for this special day. When the Israelites obeyed Yahweh's instructions for the Sabbath, the Israelites acted differently from all the people around the Israelites. This let the other people around the Israelites know that the Israelites' God was special.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what days do people rest? Why do people rest on those days? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh and he is the Israelites' God. Here, like in the previous passages, Yahweh is reminding the Israelites that they are a special people, set apart for and belonging to Yahweh himself. Yahweh is holy, so the Israelites should show that they belong to Yahweh by acting in these holy ways also.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, who are the special groups of people? How do those people act to show that they belong to the special group? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also does not allow the Israelites to stop worshipping Yahweh and start worshipping idols. Yahweh calls these idols worthless. Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to melt metal and form the metal into an image that people can worship. Yahweh does not want anyone to make an image that represents Yahweh or any other god. But Yahweh especially does not want Yahweh's special people to worship any other gods. Here, Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh expects the Israelites to totally devote themselves to Yahweh. Yahweh also reminds them again that he is Yahweh and he is the Israelites' God.

Stop here as a group and look at a metal idol. Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh tells the Israelites some of the rules for when people offer a peace or fellowship offering. A fellowship offering was a sacrifice people made to Yahweh when people were thankful for something Yahweh had done. These offerings were special because Yahweh did not require people to give these fellowship offerings. You will remember that when the Israelites gave a fellowship offering, the people ate some of the meat from the animal that they sacrificed for the offering. When the people ate some of the food and burned some of the food on the altar, it was like the people were sharing a meal with Yahweh, and people made their relationship with Yahweh better when people did that.

The Israelites need to offer their fellowship offerings in such a way that Yahweh accepts the offering. Yahweh allows the Israelites to eat this offering on the same day that someone offers the offering or the day after, but people need to burn anything that is left on the third day. If an Israelite eats any of the fellowship offering on the third day, then the fellowship offering becomes ritually dirty meat. Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to eat ritually dirty meat, and Yahweh will not accept the offering. Also, Yahweh will punish anyone who eats the fellowship offering on the third day or later, because that person profaned that thing, or made that thing not holy. Yahweh will cut that person off, or stop considering that person an Israelite, if that person eats the fellowship offering more than two days after the person offered the fellowship offering. Yahweh expects all the Israelites to treat that person the same way.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is an example of special food in your culture that has special rules about how and when to eat it? How do people punish a person if someone breaks those rules?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses to tell the Israelites to be holy because Yahweh is holy.

In the second scene: Yahweh reminds the Israelites of Yahweh's rules about honoring their parents, Yahweh's rules about the Sabbath, and Yahweh's rules about idols.

In the third scene: Yahweh reminds the Israelites of Yahweh's rules about eating food from fellowship offerings.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelites
- The parents
- And someone who eats meat from a fellowship offering after the second day

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that Yahweh has been telling the people Yahweh's statutes and ordinances about sex. Yahweh has told the people that if they do not follow those rules, the people will make the land Yahweh is giving to the people ritually dirty, and Yahweh will remove the people from the land. In this passage, Yahweh reminds the Israelites of other rules Yahweh has already given to the Israelites.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses to talk to the assembly, or large group, of Israelites who have gathered to hear what Yahweh has to say. Each time the storyteller of Leviticus reminds us that Yahweh is talking to Moses, the storyteller tells us that Yahweh is talking about something new. Like in previous passages, Yahweh speaks to Moses as if Yahweh were speaking directly to the people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time someone needed to explain a lot of different rules. How did that person show they were talking about a new set of rules? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh requires the Israelites to be holy, or completely devoted to Yahweh. The Israelites should show everyone that the Israelites belong to Yahweh by what the Israelites do. The reason Yahweh requires the Israelites to be holy is that Yahweh, the Israelites' God, is holy; Yahweh is completely good, pure, powerful, and majestic.

Stop here and remember how you translated the phrase in Leviticus 11:44 that the Israelites should be holy because Yahweh is holy. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh tells Moses to tell the Israelites to respect, or honor, their mother and father. Normally, when people mention parents, people talk about the father and then the mother. Here, Yahweh does the opposite. This is probably because Yahweh wants to focus on the mother, since mothers primarily raise the children in Israelite culture. When Yahweh tells the Israelites to respect or honor their parents, Yahweh wants the Israelites to understand that the parents have authority over their children and that people need to respect that authority.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about people in your culture that you highly respect. When you talk about how you feel about those people and how you do what those people tell you to do, what words and phrases do you use? Pause this audio here.

The Israelites also need to obey the rules Yahweh has about the Sabbath. To remind the Israelites why the Israelites need to follow both these rules, Yahweh tells the Israelites that he is Yahweh and he is their God.

Next, Yahweh says that Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to abandon Yahweh to worship worthless idols. Yahweh also does not allow the Israelites to make sculptures out of metal to worship the sculptures. Yahweh reminds the Israelites again that he is Yahweh and he is their God.

In the third scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites that when someone offers a fellowship offering to Yahweh, that person needs to make sure that Yahweh accepts the offering. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh allows the Israelites to eat the meat from the fellowship offering on the day that someone gives the offering, and the day after someone gives the offering. On the third day, the Israelites must burn the meat in a fire, because the meat becomes ritually dirty meat, or meat that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to eat. Yahweh will punish anyone who eats the meat from a fellowship offering three days after someone offered the meat because that person profaned something holy. When people profane something holy, people make that thing common or ordinary. But Yahweh's things are holy, so Yahweh is not pleased when people profane something that is holy. If

someone mistreats things that are special to Yahweh, Yahweh will cut off that person from the people. Yahweh will not consider that person to be an Israelite, and Yahweh will expect the other Israelites to treat that person the same way.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is an appropriate way to talk about Yahweh cutting someone off from the people? Remember how you have translated this in previous passages. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelites
- The parents
- And someone who eats meat from a fellowship offering after the second day

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses to tell the Israelites who have assembled together that the Israelites need to be holy because Yahweh, the Israelites’ God, is holy. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I want my people to be special and to do the right things; or
- I love my people so much, and I want my people to do the right thing.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, each Israelite needs to respect their mother and father. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I know that my parents have authority and power over me; or
- I respect my parents; or
- I need to obey my parents.

Continue the drama. The Israelites also need to obey Yahweh’s rules about the Sabbath. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh and he is their God.

Yahweh also does not allow the Israelites to abandon Yahweh for a worthless idol. Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to make metal sculptures of gods and worship those sculptures. Yahweh reminds the Israelites again that he is Yahweh and he is their God.

In the third scene, Yahweh says that when the Israelites offer a fellowship offering, the Israelites need to offer this offering so that Yahweh accepts and is happy with the offering. The Israelites can eat the meat from the fellowship offering on the day someone offers the offering and the day after someone offers the offering. However, on the third day, the Israelites need to burn the meat in a fire. If anyone eats the meat from the fellowship offering on the third day, that person does a terrible thing, because on the third day the meat becomes ritually dirty meat, or meat that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to eat. Yahweh will not accept the fellowship offering, and Yahweh will punish the person who eats the meat at the wrong time. A person who eats the meat from the fellowship offering on the third day after someone offers the fellowship offering is profaning that offering, which is holy, or completely devoted to Yahweh. Yahweh will cut that person off from the people of Israel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing someone who eats meat from a fellowship offering after the second day, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so upset because Yahweh is punishing me; or
- I feel so lonely because I am no longer a part of my people; or
- I regret that I did not treat the fellowship offering correctly.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh talks to Moses. Yahweh is the name that the one true God gave to the Israelites to call God. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh that you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh is the name of the Creator **God**. God is the most powerful spiritual being. Use the same word or phrase for God that you used in previous passages. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh tells the **assembly** of Israelites to be **holy**. Use the same word or phrase for assembly, or large group of Israelites, as you have used in previous passages. People who are holy are people Yahweh has dedicated to himself. Those people must not act like the people around them. Use the same word or phrase for holy in reference to people as you used in previous passages. Yahweh also reminds the Israelites that Yahweh is holy. That means Yahweh is completely good, pure, powerful, and majestic. Use the same word or phrase for holy in reference to Yahweh that you used in previous passages. For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh tells the Israelites to obey Yahweh's rules about the Sabbath. The Sabbath is the seventh and final day of the week in the Jewish calendar, and it is a day that the Israelites dedicate to Yahweh. On that day, no one is allowed to work.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Sabbath**. Look up Sabbath in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to worship worthless idols. Idols are images of gods that represent the gods. In this passage, people made these images of god from melted metal. People would make sacrifices or worship the idol as a way to worship the god it represented.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **idol** and **gods**. Look up idol and gods in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these words in another book of the Bible, use the same words that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh gives the Israelites instructions about how to sacrifice a **peace or fellowship offering**. A fellowship offering was a **sacrifice** that the Israelites offered to Yahweh to thank Yahweh. The Israelites also offered a peace or fellowship offering when the Israelites had finished doing something they had made an oath to do. Use the same words or phrases for sacrifice and peace or fellowship offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on sacrifice and peace or fellowship offerings, refer to the Master Glossary.

After the second day, the meat from a peace or fellowship offering becomes **unclean** or **ritually dirty**. When food is unclean, the Israelites cannot eat the meat because the meat will make the Israelites ritually dirty. Use the same word or phrase for unclean or ritually dirty as you used in previous passages. For more information on **clean and unclean**, refer to the Master Glossary.

If someone eats the ritually dirty meat from the fellowship offering, that person will receive punishment for their **iniquity**. The person is guilty. When someone is guilty, it means that person did something wrong, and Yahweh should punish that person. Use the same word or phrase for iniquity as you used in previous passages. For more information on iniquity, refer to the Master Glossary.

If someone eats the meat from a fellowship offering in the wrong way, that person will **profane** the offering. When someone profanes something, that person mistreats something that is holy and instead treats that thing as if it is common. Use the same word or phrase for profane that you used in previous passages. For more information on profane, refer to the Master Glossary.

If an Israelite eats the meat from the fellowship offering in the wrong way, Yahweh will **cut that person off** from the Israelites. When Yahweh cuts someone off from the Israelites, Yahweh will not consider that person to be an Israelite, and Yahweh will expect the other Israelites to treat that person the same way. Use the same word or phrase for “cut them off” as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 19:1–8

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (845 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 19:9–14

Leviticus 19:9–14

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 19:9–14 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:9–14 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:9–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh continues to remind the Israelites of the rules that the Israelites must follow so that the Israelites can show they are holy people, or people dedicated to Yahweh.

When the Israelites harvest their crops in the land Yahweh is giving to the Israelites, Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to harvest all the way to the edge of the field where they had planted the crops. In most cultures, people would expect the farmers to harvest all the crops the farmers had planted and cared for. Normally, the farmers should pay attention to even the crops in the corners of and at the edge of the fields. However, Yahweh wants the Israelites to stop harvesting before the Israelites finish clearing out the edges and corners.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a grain field. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also does not allow the Israelites to gather the gleanings when the Israelites harvest. A gleaning was the crop that a person accidentally did not harvest. Perhaps the crop fell on the ground, or perhaps a person did not remove the food from the plant. In many cultures, people would go back through the field again after harvesting the crops and check for any crops they missed. Yahweh is telling the Israelites not to do that.

Stop here and look at a photo of crops that people have left in a field. Discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people harvest crops? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also tells the Israelites not to take off every single grape from the grapevine, and not to gather the grapes that have fallen when people harvest the vineyard. A vineyard is a special farm where people grow grapes.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a vineyard. Pause this audio here.

Instead of completely harvesting their fields and their vineyards, Yahweh wants the Israelites to let the poor people and the foreigners gather the food the Israelites leave behind. People mainly made money by growing crops on the land they owned. The poor people were the people who could not provide food for themselves or their families. Foreigners would also have trouble providing food for themselves because the foreigners would not have land. You will remember that foreigners are people who have come from another people group, but who have chosen to live among the Israelites. Yahweh wants the Israelite farmers to help people who need food by not harvesting everything in the fields.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people help poor people and foreigners? Why would a poor person or a foreigner in your land need your help? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh and he is their God, which is why the Israelites should do what Yahweh says to do.

Leviticus 19:9–14

Next, Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to steal, trick people, or lie to each other. Yahweh also does not allow the Israelites to swear falsely by Yahweh's name. Yahweh does not want people to make promises that people do not plan to keep. Sometimes a person would make a strong promise and say that Yahweh could punish that person if the person did not keep that promise. Yahweh especially commands his people to never use Yahweh's name to make a promise that they do not plan to keep. Yahweh says that if the Israelites swear falsely by Yahweh's name, then the Israelites profane Yahweh's name. This means that the Israelites will make people think that the Israelite's God is not holy. People will think that Yahweh is not completely good, pure, powerful, and majestic.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time someone used someone's name or authority to trick people or make people think that the person was going to do something that the person was not going to do. Pay attention to the words you use when that person deceives people. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh reminds the Israelites again that he is Yahweh, which is a way for Yahweh to say that he is the one true God.

Next, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to oppress their neighbors. A neighbor is someone in your community. Yahweh means that the Israelites must not oppress anyone, but Yahweh calls the people neighbors so that the Israelites would realize how bad it is to oppress people. Yahweh also tells the Israelites not to rob people and not to hold on to the wages of a worker until morning. When people would hire a person for a job, it was normal to pay that worker the day someone hired the worker, because otherwise the worker might not have money to buy food for the day.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how does a good employer need to treat their employee? When should a good employer pay their employee? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also will not allow the Israelites to curse a deaf person, even though the deaf person cannot hear the curse. Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to put an obstacle or a tripping hazard in front of a blind person. Then, Yahweh tells the Israelites to fear their God. Yahweh probably means that Yahweh wants the Israelites to respect Yahweh. But Yahweh also means that Yahweh wants the Israelites to be afraid of what Yahweh will do if the Israelites mistreat people in the ways Yahweh is describing. Finally, Yahweh reminds the Israelites one more time that he is Yahweh.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:9–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh reminds the Israelites of the rules to follow about harvesting crops.

In the second scene: Yahweh reminds the Israelites of the rules Yahweh has about deceiving people.

In the third scene: Yahweh reminds the Israelites of the rules Yahweh has about treating people who do not have money, power, or family to protect themselves.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelites
- Poor people
- The foreigner
- The neighbor
- The worker
- Deaf people
- And blind people

Leviticus 19:9–14

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that in this part of Leviticus, Yahweh is reminding the Israelites, through Moses, how to act because Yahweh is the Israelites' God. Yahweh is giving the Israelites these rules so that the Israelites are ready to live in the land that Yahweh has promised to give to the Israelites.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites some of the things the Israelites must not do when they harvest crops. At the time that Yahweh is giving these instructions to the Israelites, the Israelites are still traveling to the land Yahweh will give to the Israelites. The Israelites have not started planting or harvesting crops. Yahweh is talking about how the Israelites need to behave when the Israelites live on and farm the land Yahweh promised to give to the Israelites.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of Canaan and the Arabian Peninsula, where the Israelites are at the time of this passage. Pause the audio here.

Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to harvest the crops at the edge of their fields. The Israelites also must not gather the crops that the Israelites accidentally left behind when the Israelites harvested the first time. Yahweh also will not allow the Israelites to completely harvest all the grapes in their vineyards or pick up the grapes that fall to the ground. Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to do these things because Yahweh wants the Israelites to let the poor people and the foreigners take the extra crops and grapes. Yahweh also reminds the Israelites again that he is Yahweh and he is their God. The reason the Israelites need to obey Yahweh is that Yahweh became the Israelites' God when Yahweh made a covenant with the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss how you will translate the idea of having leftover crops in the field. This includes crops that people did not harvest, and crops that people did not pick up and accidentally left in the field. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to secretly take things that do not belong to the Israelites. Yahweh also will not allow the Israelites to trick people into believing something that is not true, or to lie to each other. These are two similar ideas.

Finally, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to swear falsely by Yahweh's name. When Yahweh talks about his name, Yahweh is using special language. Yahweh's name represents Yahweh's reputation and character. Yahweh means that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to use Yahweh's reputation to swear an oath to do something that the Israelites do not intend to do. Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to use Yahweh's reputation to swear an oath that they are telling the truth when they are not telling the truth.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate this special language about Yahweh's name. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to oppress their neighbors or rob their neighbors. When someone oppresses a weaker person, they take advantage of that person because they are stronger than the weaker person in some way. When a person robs someone else, that person takes something away from someone else that does not belong to that person.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about Yahweh's rule that the Israelites not oppress or rob their neighbors. Pause this audio here.

A neighbor is someone you have a connection with. A neighbor may be someone who lives in your town, or a neighbor may be someone from your people group. A neighbor may not live very close to you! In other words, Yahweh is telling the Israelites that the Israelites should not oppress anyone or rob anyone.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Name a person you would consider a neighbor based on this description. What words do you use to describe that person? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also will not allow an Israelite to hold on to money that the Israelite owes to a worker for working. The Israelites need to pay the worker before the next morning. Yahweh also will not allow the Israelites to curse a deaf person or place something in front of a blind person to make the blind person trip and fall. Yahweh tells the Israelites that the Israelites need to be afraid of their God so that the Israelites will not do these evil things to people. Finally, Yahweh reminds the Israelites again that he is Yahweh.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text
Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:9–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelites
- Poor people
- The foreigner
- The neighbor
- The worker
- Deaf people
- And blind people

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites that when the Israelites harvest their crops in the land Yahweh will give the Israelites, Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to harvest all the way to the very edge of the field. Yahweh also will not allow the Israelites to go back over an area the Israelites have harvested to get any crops they missed. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am frustrated that Yahweh will not allow me to harvest everything in my fields; or
- I know that I need to take care of the poor people and foreigners. I am happy that Yahweh cares for these people. One day, I may need this help too!

Continue the drama. In the Israelites' vineyards, Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to completely strip all the grapes when the Israelites harvest the grapes. Yahweh also will not allow the Israelite farmers to harvest the grapes that fall on the ground. Instead, the Israelites need to leave these extra crops for the poor and the foreigners to eat. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh and he is the Israelites' God.

In the second scene, Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to secretly take things that do not belong to the Israelites. Yahweh also does not allow the Israelites to trick people or to lie to each other. Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to use Yahweh's name to swear an oath when the Israelites are not being honest, because that will make people think Yahweh is not holy. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am angry at the idea that someone would use my name to lie to people; or
- I need people to understand how holy I am so that people will do the right thing.

Leviticus 19:9–14

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to oppress their neighbors or rob people. Yahweh also does not allow the Israelites to keep the money the Israelites owe a worker overnight, instead of giving the money to the worker. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the laborer, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so grateful that I get paid every day; or
- I know that I will get paid today for the work I did today.

Continue the drama. Yahweh also does not allow the Israelites to curse a deaf person or place something in front of a blind person to make the person trip and fall. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the blind person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so glad that Yahweh is taking care of me; or
- I know it is safe to walk around because Yahweh will not let people hurt me.

Continue the drama. Instead, the Israelites need to be afraid of what Yahweh will do to the Israelites if the Israelites hurt people. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:9–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh tells the Israelites not to harvest all the grapes in their vineyard. A vineyard is a garden for growing grapes. Grapes are a soft, juicy fruit that grows in clusters on a vine.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **vineyard**. Look up vineyard in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites to leave the leftover crops for the **foreigners**. A foreigner is someone who is not an Israelite but lives in the land of Israel. Use the same word for foreigner as you used in previous passages. For more information on foreigner, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is **Yahweh** and he is their **God**. Yahweh is the name the one true God gave to the Israelites to call God. Use the same words for Yahweh and God as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh also tells the Israelites that Yahweh will not allow them to curse deaf people, or people who cannot hear. When you curse someone, you wish that something bad will happen to that person.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **curse**. Look up curse in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also tells the Israelites that the Israelites must not use Yahweh's name to swear an **oath** when the Israelites do not plan to do what they promise. When someone swears an oath, that person is saying, "If I do not do what I promised to do, God will punish me." Use the same word or phrase for swear as you used in previous passages. For more information on swearing an oath, refer to oath in the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that if the Israelites swear falsely, the Israelites will **profane** Yahweh's name. Use the same word for profane as you used in previous passages. For more information, see profane in the Master Glossary.

Yahweh then tells people not to oppress their **neighbor**. A neighbor is someone you have a connection to who lives in your community or belongs to your people group. Translate neighbor in the same way as you have in previous passages. Look up neighbor in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh tells the Israelites to fear Yahweh. When someone fears Yahweh, that person has a great reverence, honor, and respect for Yahweh. That person believes that everything that Yahweh has said is true. As a result,

that person obeys Yahweh because the person knows that Yahweh's commandments are good, and that Yahweh will punish that person if that person disobeys Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **fear of God**. Look up "fear of God" in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same phrase that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 19:9–14

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (839 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 19:15–18

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 19:15–18 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:15–18 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.

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4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:15–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this part of Leviticus, Yahweh is reminding the Israelites of the rules that Yahweh has for the Israelites so that the Israelites will be holy people, or people dedicated to Yahweh.

Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to make a legal decision that is unjust. In the Israelite culture, when two people disagreed with each other, those two people would go to a leader in the community and talk to the leader about the disagreement. Perhaps the two people disagreed about whether someone should receive a punishment or who owned a specific piece of property. The leader would decide what the people needed to do, and the people would need to obey that leader's decision. Yahweh says that Yahweh will not allow the leader to make a decision that is not right or fair to the people who have a disagreement.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time that two people had a disagreement over something, such as who should own a piece of property. How did those people decide what to do? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will not allow the Israelite leaders to decide something that helps a poor person just because that person is poor. Yahweh also does not allow the Israelite leaders to honor a rich person by making a decision that helps the rich person if the decision is not fair or right. Instead, Yahweh always wants the Israelite leaders to do the right thing when the leaders make a decision about a disagreement between their fellow Israelites.

Next, Yahweh talks about how Yahweh wants the people in the community to act. Yahweh will not allow any Israelite to lie about other people. Most times that the Israelites had a disagreement, the Israelites would ask someone else to confirm or explain what had happened. This person would also go with the two people who had the disagreement to the leader to talk about the disagreement. However, if this other person lied about what really happened, the person could cause the Israelite leader to make a decision that was not right or fair to the people who disagreed with each other.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time that someone in the community lied about another person to make that other person look bad. What happened to the person who lied? What happened to the person they lied about? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also will not allow the Israelites to stand on the blood of other Israelites. This is special language. Yahweh probably means that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to lie about a person specifically if the lie would cause the Israelite leaders to decide to kill the person. Yahweh could also mean that Yahweh wants the Israelites to say something if the Israelites have information that could stop an Israelite leader from deciding to punish a specific person.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time someone lied and the lie caused someone to die. How did people feel about this person who lied? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh reminds the Israelites again that he is Yahweh.

Then, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to hate their brother in their heart. This is special language. Yahweh probably means that Yahweh does not want an Israelite to remain silent if another Israelite does something wrong to the first Israelite. Instead, Yahweh wants the Israelites to confront the person who did something wrong. Yahweh may mean that Yahweh wants the Israelites to confront the person who did something wrong directly, so the person can fix what the person did, or make it right. Yahweh may also mean that Yahweh wants the Israelites to tell an Israelite leader that the person did something wrong, so that the leader can make a decision about what needs to happen.

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Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, when someone does something wrong to another person, how is the other person supposed to act? What is that person supposed to do about the person who did something wrong? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a person who hurt a second person, but the second person did not say anything to the first person about it. Later, the second person hated the first person because the second person never said anything to the first person. The second person was silent about the wrongdoing. What did the second person do to the person they hated? Pause this audio here.

If the Israelites do not accuse the person who did something wrong, the Israelites will also become guilty. Yahweh may mean that the Israelites will be guilty because the Israelites did not let the Israelite leaders punish the person who did something wrong. Yahweh may also mean that the Israelites will become guilty because the Israelites will try to punish the person who did something wrong themselves, rather than letting the Israelite leaders punish that person.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time that someone tried to punish a person themselves instead of talking to the appropriate leaders. What happened to the people involved? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to punish a person who did something wrong without first going to the Israelite leaders. Yahweh also will not let the Israelites keep being angry at other Israelites. Yahweh probably means that Yahweh wants the Israelites to quickly handle any problems the Israelites have with each other instead of being angry with each other for a long time. Yahweh tells the Israelites instead to love their neighbors as much as the Israelites love themselves. Yahweh reminds the Israelites again that he is Yahweh.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:15–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites how to act when an Israelite leader is making a decision about a disagreement.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells an Israelite person how to act when someone does something wrong to the Israelite person.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- The Israelite leaders
- Poor people
- Rich people
- An Israelite
- Another Israelite
- And Yahweh

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that in this part of Leviticus, Yahweh has been reminding the Israelites, through Moses, about the rules Yahweh wants the Israelites to follow so that the Israelites will be holy, or dedicated to Yahweh. Here, Yahweh talks about how Yahweh expects people to act when people need to handle a disagreement or deal with someone who did something wrong.

In the first scene, Yahweh reminds both the Israelite leaders and the other Israelites how an Israelite leader should make a decision when people disagree, or when someone accuses someone else and says that person did something wrong. Yahweh tells the Israelite leaders not to make a decision about a disagreement that is

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not fair or right. Yahweh then says more about that by telling the Israelite leaders not to unfairly favor poor people or unfairly honor the great or rich people. Here, Yahweh uses special language to show that Yahweh does not want the Israelite leaders to make a decision about a disagreement based on how much money or power someone has.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Yahweh says that leaders should judge fairly. The leaders should not be more kind to the poor person because that person has no money. The leaders should not be more kind to the rich person because the rich person has more money. How will you talk about the way judges should judge people fairly? Pause this audio here.

Instead, Yahweh tells the Israelite leaders to act justly, or do the right thing, when the leaders need to make a decision about a disagreement or an accusation.

Then, Yahweh talks about how Yahweh wants people in the community to act when an Israelite leader is trying to make a decision between two people who disagree or accuse each other of doing something wrong. Yahweh tells the Israelites not to slander other Israelites, or lie about something an Israelite did, to a leader who is trying to make a right decision. Yahweh also will not allow the Israelites to stand on the blood of other Israelites. This is special language. Yahweh probably means that Yahweh will not allow an Israelite to lie about another person, specifically if the lie would cause the Israelite leaders to decide to kill the other person. Yahweh may also mean that Yahweh wants an Israelite person to say something if the Israelite has information that could stop an Israelite leader from deciding to punish the other person.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to talk about “standing on the blood of other Israelites”? In other words, how will you translate that Yahweh does not want the Israelites to tell a lie that would cause the leaders to punish an innocent person? Or how will you translate that Yahweh does not want the Israelites to remain silent when they have information that can help an innocent person? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Act out a situation where someone accuses someone else of doing something wrong, and a leader has to decide what the right thing to do is. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh ends this scene by reminding the Israelites that he is Yahweh. When Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh, Yahweh wants the Israelites to think about everything that Yahweh has done for the Israelites and how powerful Yahweh is. Yahweh wants the Israelites to think about all of this because it will help the Israelites understand how the Israelites need to act.

In the next scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites how to act when one Israelite has done something wrong to another Israelite. Yahweh tells the Israelites that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to hate their brother in their heart. Yahweh uses special language twice here. When Yahweh talks about their brother, Yahweh means any Israelite, since the Israelites are all related to each other through their common ancestor Jacob, or “Israel.” When Yahweh says not to “hate your brother in your heart,” Yahweh probably means that Yahweh does not want an Israelite to secretly hate someone else instead of openly telling that other person what the other person has done wrong. For example, if a man does something wrong to a woman, and the woman does not say anything about it to the man, the woman may begin to hate and feel bad towards the man, who is her fellow Israelite. Yahweh does not want an Israelite to secretly hate another Israelite and not properly deal with the problem.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to describe when someone hates a brother, or fellow community member, in that person’s heart? Pause this audio here.

Instead, Yahweh tells the Israelites to confront the other Israelite who did something wrong. Yahweh calls the other Israelite their neighbor. Both brother and neighbor are words that people used to refer to people in the same nation, like Israel. If a person does not say something about the Israelite who did something wrong, either to that Israelite or to an Israelite leader, then the original person will become guilty of doing something wrong.

Yahweh also will not allow an Israelite to take revenge, which is when someone punishes someone themselves rather than let a leader decide what to do. Yahweh also will not allow an Israelite to be angry at another person for a long time. Instead of punishing someone themselves, Yahweh wants the Israelites to love their fellow Israelites as much as the Israelites love themselves. Yahweh ends this passage by reminding the Israelites that he is Yahweh.

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Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:15–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- The Israelite leaders
- Poor people
- Rich people
- An Israelite
- Another Israelite
- And Yahweh

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh will not allow the Israelite leaders to make a decision about a disagreement or an accusation that is not right or fair to the people involved. Yahweh will not allow the Israelite leaders to decide in favor of a person because of how much money that person has, whether that person is a poor person or a rich person. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the rich people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that my money will not cause the Israelite leaders to decide in my favor; or
- I know that if I have a disagreement, the leader who decides what to do about it will treat me fairly; or
- I am glad that the Israelite leaders will not rule against me just because I am rich.

Continue the drama. Yahweh expects the Israelite leaders to do the right thing when the leaders decide a case.

Yahweh will not allow an Israelite to lie about a person, and Yahweh will not allow an Israelite to lie about another Israelite so that an Israelite leader decides to kill the person. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I really care about whether the Israelites do the right thing when the Israelites have a disagreement or when someone does something wrong; or
- I hate when people lie, especially if someone else dies because of the way that someone lied.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh will not allow an Israelite to secretly hate another Israelite. Instead, Yahweh tells the Israelites to confront the other Israelite if the Israelite has done something wrong, or the first Israelite will become guilty themselves. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing an Israelite, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

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- I really hate this person because this person did something wrong; or
- I need to tell a leader that this person did something wrong.

Continue the drama. Yahweh will not allow an Israelite to punish a person themselves instead of talking to the Israelite leaders. Yahweh also will not allow an Israelite to be angry at another Israelite for a long time. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing another Israelite, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that Yahweh will not let people punish me without talking to an Israelite leader; or
- I am scared because an Israelite leader will decide how to punish me; or
- I am glad that we are dealing with this situation quickly instead of taking a long time.

Continue the drama. Instead, Yahweh tells the Israelites to love each other as much as the Israelites love themselves. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:15–18 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh tells the Israelites to use justice, or do the right thing, when the Israelites judge their neighbor. Justice is when someone treats someone else fairly according to the law.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **justice**. Look up justice in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Someone judges actions that people do by deciding if what that person does is right or wrong, and therefore if the person is guilty or innocent of breaking a law. A judge will punish the person if the judge decides that the person is guilty of doing wrong.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **judging** if an action is right or wrong. Look up **judge** in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the Israelites should not hate their fellow "brother," or "neighbor," in their heart. The Israelites talked about their heart as the place where they had feelings and thoughts. When someone hates someone else in their heart, they hate that person, but they do not tell anyone.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about hating a fellow "brother," or a "neighbor," in your **heart**. For more information about heart, refer to heart in the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

A **neighbor** is a person in your community with whom you come into contact. Use the same word or phrase for neighbor as you used in previous passages. Use the same word or phrase for neighbor throughout this passage. For more information on neighbor, refer to the Master Glossary.

If an Israelite does not confront another Israelite when that other Israelite does something wrong, the first Israelite will be **guilty** of **sinning**. When someone has guilt, it means that the person did something wrong, and someone must punish that person. Although Yahweh does not use the word for guilt in this passage, Yahweh is saying that the person will be guilty of sinning. Use the same words or phrases for guilt and sin as you used in previous passages. For more information on guilt and sin, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is **Yahweh**. Yahweh is the name the one true God gave to the Israelites to call God. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 19:15–18

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (845 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 19:19–25

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 19:19–25 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:19–25 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:19–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

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In this part of Leviticus, Yahweh has been telling the Israelites what the Israelites need to do to be holy. Here, Yahweh continues telling the Israelites the rules Yahweh wants the Israelites to follow so that the Israelites will be holy, or different from the other people groups.

At the beginning of this passage, Yahweh tells the Israelites that Yahweh requires the Israelites to obey Yahweh's statutes. Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to breed two different kinds of animals together. Yahweh is not talking about the same kinds of animals that look different, such as two kinds of dogs. Yahweh is talking about animals that are completely different, like how cows are completely different from goats. Yahweh will also not allow the Israelites to sow two different kinds of crops in one field. Yahweh is not talking about two kinds of the same crop that look different, such as two kinds of corn. Yahweh is talking about crops that are completely different, like how wheat is completely different from barley. Yahweh also will not allow the Israelites to put on a piece of clothing that people made from two different materials. Israelites used different materials to make clothes, such as linen from a flax plant or wool from sheep. Here, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to wear clothes made of both linen and wool, or any other two materials.

Stop here as a group and look at this picture of a wool tunic. Pause this audio here.

Stop here as a group and look at this picture of a linen tunic. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people make clothes out of? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group: What kinds of crops do you consider to be different kinds of the same crop? What kinds of crops do you consider to be completely different from one another? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh does not want the Israelites to mix two crops in the fields, two different animals, and two different types of materials because this represents how Israel is supposed to be pure, or completely devoted to Yahweh.

Then Yahweh gives the Israelites an example of a specific situation and explains what Yahweh expects the Israelites to do in the situation. In this situation, a man has sex with a woman who is a slave. This slave woman is engaged to marry a second man. The second man has not yet paid the price to free the slave woman and make the woman his wife. The woman's master also has not freed the woman. Yahweh probably wants the Israelites to punish the slave woman and the man who had sex with her in this situation. Yahweh also might want the people of Israel to investigate the situation to make sure all the facts are true. Either way, Yahweh does not want the Israelites to kill the people who had sex, since the woman is not a free woman. Normally, the Israelites would kill the man and woman who had sex when they were not married, but this law does not apply to slave women. Instead, the man who had sex with the slave woman needs to bring a guilt offering for himself to Yahweh. This means the man needs to take the guilt offering to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting, which people also call the tabernacle. This offering is for the sin that the man committed when the man had sex with the woman. You will remember that Israelites give the guilt offering when they have taken something of value from someone else. The man has taken away the slave woman from the second man, who is engaged to marry the woman. When the man who had sex with the woman offers the guilt offering, the priest will atone for the sin the man did.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people do if a man has sex with a woman the man is not married to? How do people react in different ways based on who the woman is? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh describes another situation for when the Israelites enter the land that Yahweh is going to give them. In this situation, the Israelites plant trees so that the Israelites can eat the fruit that the trees produce.

Stop here as a group and look at the picture of an orchard. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh explains that the Israelites need to consider the fruit that the trees produce in the first three years to be uncircumcised. When Yahweh says the fruit is uncircumcised, Yahweh is using special language to tell the Israelites that they should not eat the fruit but instead treat the fruit from the new trees as something Yahweh considers ritually dirty, just like Yahweh considers uncircumcised men to be ritually dirty. However, Yahweh commands the Israelites to circumcise their boys when the boys are eight days old, and then dedicate their boys to Yahweh. In a similar way, when the trees are more mature, in the fourth year that the tree produces fruit, the fruit will be holy, and the Israelites need to use the fruit to rejoice in Yahweh. Yahweh probably means that

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Yahweh wants the Israelites to use the fruit as an offering to Yahweh. That means the Israelites will give the fruit to the priests. This is a similar idea to how the first fruit in each harvest season belongs to Yahweh. Then, when the trees produce fruit in the fifth year, Yahweh will allow the Israelites to eat the fruit. If the Israelites do everything that Yahweh tells the Israelites to do about the fruit trees, then the trees will produce more fruit.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what rules do people have about fruit trees? Why might someone wait to eat the fruit from fruit trees? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh reminds the Israelites again that he is Yahweh and he is God.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:19–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites not to mix two different animals, crops in a field, or materials in a piece of clothing.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites what to do if a man has sex with a slave woman who is engaged to marry another man.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites what to do with fruit trees that the Israelites plant in the land Yahweh is going to give the Israelites.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelites
- A man
- A woman who is a slave
- The man the slave woman is engaged to
- The owner of the slave woman
- And a priest

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that in this part of Leviticus, Yahweh has been telling the Israelites, through Moses, the rules the Israelites need to follow so that the Israelites can be holy to Yahweh. Also, remember that Yahweh has just led the Israelites out of the country of Egypt, and Yahweh is going to lead the Israelites into the land of Canaan. When the Israelites are in Canaan, Yahweh will give the land to the Israelites and will force out the people who live there in Canaan. Many of the laws Yahweh is giving the Israelites are about what the Israelites need to do when the Israelites live in the land of Canaan.

In the first scene, Yahweh again tells the Israelites to keep Yahweh's statutes, or laws. Yahweh repeats that the Israelites need to keep Yahweh's statutes because Yahweh wants the Israelites to understand how much Yahweh wants the Israelites to obey Yahweh's laws.

Then, Yahweh gives the Israelites three statutes about mixing different things. Yahweh tells the Israelites not to breed two different kinds of animals together. Yahweh also tells the Israelites not to sow two different kinds of crops in their fields. When the Israelites sowed seed in a field, the Israelites often pulled a heavy piece of metal across the ground in their field. This broke up the soil and caused the soil to be very loose. Then the Israelites often took a bag full of seeds, grabbed handfuls of the seeds from the bag, and threw the seeds in the field.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people sow or plant seeds? What words or phrases can you use to describe how the Israelites sow seeds? Pause this audio here.

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Finally, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to put on a piece of clothing that people made of two different materials, like linen and wool.

In the second scene, Yahweh gives the Israelites a specific situation. In this situation, a man has sex with a woman who is a slave. This woman is engaged to marry another man, but the man she is engaged to has not paid the money so that the woman can be free. The woman's master has also not given the woman her freedom. If this happens, Yahweh probably wants the Israelites to punish the woman and the man who had sex with each other. Yahweh also might want the Israelites to ask people questions to make sure that the Israelites really know what happened. Yahweh does not want the Israelites to kill the man and the woman who had sex with each other, because the woman is not a free woman. But Yahweh does tell the Israelites that Yahweh requires the man who had sex with the slave woman to bring a guilt offering for himself to Yahweh. The man needs to bring the guilt offering to the Tent of Meeting, or the tabernacle, and it needs to be a ram. Then the priest will sacrifice the guilt offering, and that will make atonement for the man. That means when the priest sacrifices the guilt offering, Yahweh will forgive the man, restore Yahweh's relationship with the man, and clean the guilt from the man. Yahweh then says this in another way when Yahweh says that Yahweh will forgive the sin the man has committed. Yahweh probably says that Yahweh will forgive the man because Yahweh wants the Israelites to really understand that in this situation, the man should not die, even though the man had sex with a woman who was engaged to marry another man.

In the third scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites the rules for when the Israelites plant fruit trees in the land of Canaan. Yahweh tells the Israelites that for the first three years that the trees produce fruit, the Israelites need to consider the fruit uncircumcised. When Yahweh says the fruit is uncircumcised, Yahweh is using special language to tell the Israelites that people should treat the fruit as ritually unclean, just like Yahweh considers uncircumcised men ritually unclean. The Israelites should not gather the fruit, eat the fruit, and or sell the fruit.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when God or a leader told you that you should avoid eating something because it was wrong to eat it. How did you talk about the leader telling you to avoid eating that thing? What is the best way to describe the fruit as something the Israelites should avoid, like Yahweh does when Yahweh calls the fruit uncircumcised? Pause this audio here.

Then, Yahweh says that in the fourth year the tree produces fruit, the fruit the tree produces is holy, and the Israelites should use the fruit to celebrate Yahweh. This probably means the Israelites should use the fruit as an offering to Yahweh. Finally, in the fifth year the tree produces fruit, the Israelites can eat that fruit. Yahweh tells the Israelites that if the Israelites do this, the trees will produce more fruit. Yahweh means that if the Israelites obey Yahweh's laws, then Yahweh will bless the Israelites' fruit trees and make the trees produce more fruit. Then Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh and he is their God. When Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh, Yahweh is reminding the Israelites why the Israelites should follow the rules that Yahweh gives the Israelites. Yahweh is also reminding the Israelites that Yahweh has a special relationship with the Israelites and that the Israelites made a covenant, or promise, to obey Yahweh's rules.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:19–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelites
- A man
- A woman who is a slave
- The man the slave woman is engaged to

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- The owner of the slave woman
- And a priest

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites to keep Yahweh's statutes. Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to breed two different species of animals together. Yahweh also will not allow the Israelites to sow two different kinds of plants in the same field. Yahweh also will not allow the Israelites to put on a piece of clothing that someone made from two different materials.

In the second scene, Yahweh describes a situation. In this situation, a man has sex with a woman who is a slave and who is also engaged to be married to another man. No one has paid the slave woman's master to buy the slave woman's freedom, and the slave woman's master has not freed the woman. In this situation, Yahweh probably wants the Israelites to punish the man and the woman who had sex, but Yahweh does not want the Israelites to kill the man and woman, because the woman is not a free woman. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a man, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that Yahweh will not let people kill me even though I had sex with a woman who was engaged to someone else; or
- I am sad that the Israelites are punishing me; or
- I am sorry that I broke Yahweh's law by having sex with this slave woman.

Continue the drama. The man needs to bring a guilt offering to Yahweh for himself. The man needs to bring a ram to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. There, the priest will use a ram to sacrifice a guilt offering for the man who had sex with a slave woman. When the priest sacrifices the guilt offering, Yahweh will restore Yahweh's relationship with the man, forgive the man for his sin, and clean the man from the guilt that the man has. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that this man wants to restore his relationship with me; or
- I forgive this man for what the man did wrong.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh gives the Israelites another situation. In this situation, the Israelites plant trees in the land that Yahweh is going to give the Israelites so that the Israelites can eat the fruit the trees produce. In the first three years, when the trees produce fruit, Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to touch or eat the fruit. In the fourth year, when the trees produce fruit, the Israelites need to set that fruit aside and use the fruit to celebrate Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am frustrated that this tree has produced fruit for four years and Yahweh has not allowed us to eat the fruit yet; or
- I am so grateful to Yahweh because of everything Yahweh has done for us. I am glad to give this fruit to Yahweh; or
- If I give this fruit to Yahweh, Yahweh will bless this tree to make even more fruit.

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Continue the drama. In the fifth year, when the trees produce fruit, the Israelites can eat the fruit. If the Israelites obey Yahweh's laws about the fruit trees, the trees will produce even more fruit. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh and he is their God.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:19–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh tells the Israelites to keep Yahweh's **statutes**. Yahweh's statutes are instructions that Yahweh has for living in society. Yahweh tells the Israelites to obey these instructions. Use the same word or phrase for statutes as you used in previous passages. For more information on statutes, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that the Israelites should not use two kinds of **seed** in the same field. Use the same word for seed as you have used previously, and refer to seed in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh also talks about a man who has sex with a woman who is a slave. A slave is a person who works for someone else and does not have the freedom to leave their master.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **slave**. Look up slave in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

No one has ransomed this slave woman. This means that no one has paid money to the woman's master so that the woman can go free.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **ransom**. Look up ransom in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the man who had sex with the slave woman needs to make a **guilt offering** to Yahweh. A person gives a guilt offering when the person did something wrong that took value from someone else, or from Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for guilt offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on guilt offerings, refer to the Master Glossary.

The guilt offering is a ram that the person takes to **Yahweh**. Yahweh is the name the one true God gave to the Israelites to call God. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

The man takes the ram for the guilt offering to the entrance of the Tent or Meeting, or the **tabernacle**. Use the same word or phrase for Tent of Meeting and entrance to the Tent of Meeting as you used in previous passages. For more information, refer to tabernacle in the Master Glossary.

At the tabernacle, a **priest** will sacrifice the guilt offering. Yahweh appointed priests to be between Yahweh and the people. The priests did this by offering sacrifices on behalf of the people. Use the same word or phrase for priests as used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

When the priest sacrifices the guilt offering, the priest will make **atonement** for the man. When people make atonement, Yahweh reconciles and restores the relationship. Use the same word or phrase for atonement as you used in previous passages. For more information on atonement, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh promises to **forgive** the man for the **sin** the man did when the man had sex with the woman. When Yahweh forgives someone who has done something bad, Yahweh stops being angry with that person. Yahweh no longer wants to punish the person. Use the same words or phrases for forgiveness and sin as you used in previous passages. For more information on forgiveness and sin, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that the fruit of a new fruit tree is uncircumcised. Although this means that the fruit is ritually dirty, or that Yahweh does not want them to eat it, you may choose to use terms for uncircumcised or for ritually dirty in your translation.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will say that the fruit is uncircumcised, or ritually dirty. Or will you say it a different way? For more information about **circumcision** and **clean and unclean**, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh talks about the fruit trees that the Israelites will plant in the land Yahweh will give the Israelites. In the fourth year, when the trees produce fruit, Yahweh tells the Israelites that the fruit is **holy**. That means the fruit is dedicated to Yahweh. The fruit is not common or ordinary, and the Israelites must not use it for ordinary purposes. Use the same word or phrase for holy as you used in previous passages. For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary.

Finally, Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is their **God**. In the Bible, God refers to the God who created everything. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (845 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 19:26–30

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 19:26–30 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:26–30 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

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Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:26–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this part of Leviticus, Yahweh has been telling the Israelites various laws that the Israelites need to follow to be holy. In this passage, Yahweh continues to give laws that Yahweh requires the Israelites to obey. Bible scholars do not fully understand what everything in this passage means.

First, Yahweh says that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to eat over blood. This might refer to a specific ritual that other people groups in Canaan would sometimes do. Other people groups would sacrifice an animal to spirits or gods by cutting the animal's throat and letting the blood drain onto the ground. Then people would eat the sacrifice over the blood. People would do this so that spirits of dead people or gods would come and tell the people information that the people wanted to know. We know that Yahweh has also told the Israelites that the Israelites must not eat the blood of animals, so this law may be reminding the Israelites of that law. In any case, Yahweh cares about what the Israelites do with the blood of animals that the Israelites are going to eat.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people do to talk to gods or the spirits of dead people? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also will not let the Israelites practice divination. When people practiced divination, people tried to understand what would happen in the future or a secret about the present. People believed that gods or spirits would leave signs of what would happen in various places, including in animal livers, the flight patterns of birds, and the patterns two liquids made when someone poured the liquids into the same cup. Yahweh also uses another term for divination, or magic. Although we do not know exactly what this second word means, we do know that Yahweh did not want his people to use magic to try to control nature or understand the future.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people try to learn about what will happen in the future? Pause this audio here.

Then, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to cut the edges of their heads or the edges of their beards. In some cultures, people thought that a person's hair represented how powerful that person was. Some people probably cut the hair at the edges of their head or face and gave that hair to the spirits of dead people. People may have given the hair to the spirits to honor the spirits and to get the spirits to tell people secrets about what was happening at that time or in the future.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people cut or take care of their hair? When do people cut their hair? Why would people cut their hair in a special way? Pause this audio here.

Next, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to cut themselves for the dead or tattoo any marks on themselves. In some cultures, people probably cut themselves because people believed that the spirits of dead people, mostly dead ancestors, would drink people's blood and have food in the afterlife. People also cut themselves to mourn a person who had died. People also sometimes gave themselves tattoos to honor dead people or to mourn someone who had died. People also might have cut themselves or given themselves tattoos for other reasons.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, when do people cut themselves? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, when do people get tattoos? Why would people get tattoos in your culture? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh reminds the Israelites again that he is Yahweh.

Next, Yahweh tells the Israelites that Yahweh will not allow any Israelite to make their daughter a prostitute. Yahweh considers all the Israelites to be holy, or special to Yahweh. If an Israelite made his daughter a prostitute, then the Israelite would profane his daughter, which means the Israelite would not treat his daughter like the holy person she was. Yahweh also might mean that Yahweh does not want the Israelites to make their daughters prostitutes for religious rituals for other gods. Yahweh says that if the Israelites made their daughters prostitutes, the land would become a prostitute. When Yahweh says that the Israelites will make the land a prostitute, Yahweh is using special language to mean that the Israelites will do things in the land that Yahweh does not want the Israelites to do, like how a prostitute has sex with people in a way that Yahweh does not want people to have sex. Then wickedness, or evil actions, will fill the land. When Yahweh says that wickedness will fill the land, Yahweh is using special language to mean that people will do a lot of wicked things in the land.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people think about someone who is a prostitute? Pause this audio here.

Then, Yahweh tells the Israelites to keep Yahweh's Sabbaths. The Sabbath was the seventh day of every week. On a Sabbath, Yahweh expected his people not to work. Yahweh expected his people to worship Yahweh and think about Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, when do people not work? Why do people not work at those times and on those days? Pause this audio here.

Then, Yahweh tells the Israelites to fear the sanctuary, or to treat the sanctuary with respect. The sanctuary was the place that was holy, or that the people had dedicated to Yahweh. The tabernacle was the sanctuary, and then later, when King Solomon built the temple, the temple was the sanctuary. Finally, Yahweh again reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:26–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites the laws Yahweh has against interacting with spirits.

In the second scene: Yahweh gives instructions to avoid profaning sacred people and things.

The characters in this passage are:

- The Israelites
- Moses
- Yahweh
- And the daughters of the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that Yahweh has been telling the Israelites, through Moses, how to behave so that the Israelites can be holy. Yahweh has just told the Israelites not to eat the fruit from a tree that the Israelites plant in the land Yahweh will give the Israelites until the fifth year that the tree produces fruit.

In this passage, Yahweh tells the Israelites rules to follow about spirits, and rules to follow about holy people and things. In this passage, though Yahweh is still speaking to Moses, Yahweh speaks as if Yahweh is speaking directly to the Israelites. Yahweh should be speaking directly to the Israelites in your translation if your language allows.

In the first scene, Yahweh says that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to eat over blood. This probably refers to a specific ritual that other people groups in Canaan would sometimes do. Other people groups would sacrifice an

animal to spirits or gods by cutting the animal's throat and letting the blood drain onto the ground. Then people would eat the sacrifice over the blood. People would do this so that spirits of dead people or gods would come and tell people information that people wanted to know. We know that Yahweh has also told the Israelites that the Israelites cannot eat the blood of animals, so this law may be reminding the Israelites of that law.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best word or phrase to use to translate when Yahweh says to avoid eating over the blood? Will you say instead that Yahweh says to avoid eating meat with blood? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also tells the Israelites not to practice divination of any kind.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about the different ways that people in your culture describe using magic or things in nature to talk with spirits to determine what will happen in the future, or what a dream means. How will you say that Yahweh forbids using these forms of magic? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites not to cut the hair at the edges of their head or the hair at the edges of their beard. Finally, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to cut their flesh for a dead person or tattoo themselves. When someone makes tattoos on themselves, that person makes tiny cuts in their skin and fills the cuts with color. Altogether, the tattoo makes a permanent picture on the person's skin. Then, Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh. Yahweh reminds people that he is Yahweh when Yahweh wants the people to remember why the people need to follow the laws that Yahweh gives.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about the Israelites cutting the edges of hair and beards, cutting themselves to show that they are mourning dead people, or making tattoos on themselves. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to profane, or mistreat, their daughters by making their daughters prostitutes. Yahweh has made all the Israelites holy, or dedicated to himself, so the daughters are holy. If the Israelites take something holy and make it unclean or use it for common things, then the Israelites profane that holy thing. If the Israelites make their daughters prostitutes, the Israelites will also make the land that Yahweh is going to give to the Israelites a prostitute. When Yahweh says the Israelites will make the land a prostitute, Yahweh is using special language to mean that the Israelites will do things in the land that Yahweh does not want the Israelites to do. Yahweh might also specifically mean that the Israelites will serve other gods besides Yahweh in the land, which will make the land itself like a prostitute that serves other gods at temples to false gods.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate that the Israelites will make the land a prostitute? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also says that if the Israelites make their daughters become prostitutes, then the Israelites will fill the land with wickedness, or evil actions. When Yahweh says that the Israelites will fill the land with wickedness, Yahweh is using special language to mean that people in the land will do wicked things, and that will cause the land to become ritually dirty.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate that the Israelites will fill the land with wickedness? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh says that the Israelites need to keep Yahweh's Sabbaths and fear Yahweh's holy place, or the place Yahweh has dedicated to himself. This sanctuary, or holy place, can mean the entire tabernacle with the tent and courtyard, just the tent, and later the temple. The Israelites should respect and honor the place where they worship Yahweh.

Stop here as a group and look at this picture of the tabernacle. Pause this audio here.

When Yahweh tells the Israelites to fear Yahweh's holy place, Yahweh wants the Israelites to treat the holy place with respect and be afraid of what Yahweh will do if the Israelites do not treat the holy place with respect. Finally, Yahweh reminds the Israelites again that he is Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you translate that the Israelites should fear, or respect, Yahweh's holy place? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text
Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:26–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The Israelites
- Moses
- Yahweh
- And the daughters of the Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to eat anything over blood. Yahweh also does not allow the Israelites to practice divination of any kind. Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to cut the hair at the edges of their head or to cut their hair at the edges of their beard. Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to cut themselves for dead people or tattoo any marks on their bodies. Then Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I hate when people try to interact with the spirits of dead people instead of coming to me; or
- It is really important for the Israelites to know that they cannot use divination; or
- I need to stop the Israelites from doing things that cause the Israelites to trust other gods or trust in magic instead of me. I know what is best for the Israelites. These other spirits will tell the Israelites lies!

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to profane their daughters by making the daughters be prostitutes, so that the Israelites will not make the land a prostitute. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites' daughters, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so glad that Yahweh cares enough about us to stop our parents from making us prostitutes; or
- I am honored that Yahweh considers me holy, or dedicated to Yahweh; or
- I want to keep the land from becoming a prostitute, so I will not let myself become a prostitute.

Continue the drama. If the Israelites make their daughters prostitutes, the Israelites will fill the land with wickedness, or behave badly. Then Yahweh tells the Israelites to obey the laws Yahweh has about the Sabbath and to fear, or respect, Yahweh's holy place. Then Yahweh reminds the Israelites again that he is Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps
Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:26–30 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 19:26–30

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to eat anything over **blood**. Blood symbolizes the life breath that Yahweh uses to make people and animals live. Use the same word or phrase to translate blood as you used in previous passages. For more information on blood, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh also tells the Israelites not to use divination. When people used divination, the people tried to talk to spirits or gods or learn things from spirits or gods.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **divination**. Look up divination in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh. Yahweh is the name that the one true God gave to the Israelites to call God. Use the same word or phrase to translate Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh tells the Israelites not to **profane** their daughters by making their daughters be prostitutes. When someone profanes a person or object, that person takes something that is holy, or dedicated to Yahweh, and makes it ritually dirty. This means the item cannot be holy as long as the item remains ritually dirty. Use the same word or phrase to translate profane as you used in previous passages. For more information on profane, refer to the Master Glossary.

Then, Yahweh tells the Israelites that the Israelites need to keep the rules Yahweh has about the **Sabbath**. The Sabbath is the seventh day of the week for Israelites. On the Sabbath, Yahweh did not allow the Israelites to work. Use the same word or phrase to translate Sabbath as you used in previous passages. For more information on Sabbath, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh also tells the Israelites to fear, or respect, Yahweh's holy place, or **sanctuary**. In this passage, the holy place refers to the tabernacle, because it is the place Yahweh dedicated to himself, where people can worship Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase to translate holy place, where holy place means the sanctuary, as you used in previous passages. For more information on holy place, refer to sanctuary in the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 19:26–30

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (847 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 19:31–37

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 19:31–37 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:31–37 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:31–37 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this part of Leviticus, Yahweh has been telling the Israelites the laws Yahweh expects them to obey so that the Israelites can be holy. Here, Yahweh continues telling the Israelites the laws that the Israelites need to follow to be holy.

Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to use mediums or wizards. These are people who talk to spirits on behalf of other people. Sometimes mediums and wizards also refer to the spirits themselves that the people talk to. People in Canaan and the people around Canaan often asked mediums and wizards to help them learn secrets and other information they wanted to know from spirits and ghosts of dead people. Yahweh does not want the Israelites to ask these mediums and wizards for advice from the spirits. If the Israelites do this, the Israelites will be ritually dirty because the Israelites have disobeyed Yahweh's laws. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh and he is their God.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kind of people talk to spirits? What do people think about those people who talk to spirits? How do people treat those people who can talk to spirits? Pause this audio here.

Then, Yahweh tells the Israelites that the Israelites need to stand up in front of people with gray hair and honor people who are old. These two instructions mean the same thing. In Israelite culture, when people stood up in front of a person, the people showed that person respect and honored that person. Additionally, the Israelites associated gray hair with old age, so Yahweh talks about people with gray hair to talk about people with old age.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people show respect to people who are old? Why do people show respect to people who are old? Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 19:31–37

Then, Yahweh tells the Israelites to fear their God, or to deeply respect Yahweh and do what Yahweh tells the Israelites to do. Then Yahweh tells the Israelites again that he is Yahweh.

Then, Yahweh tells the Israelites how to treat foreigners who live with the Israelites in the land Yahweh is giving the Israelites. These foreigners have chosen to be a part of the Israelite community, and these foreigners follow most of the Israelite customs and Yahweh's laws. The Israelites must not oppress, or mistreat, those foreigners. Yahweh will require the Israelites to treat any foreigner who lives with the Israelites in the land as a citizen of Israel. Yahweh means that Yahweh wants the Israelites to take care of the foreigner. Then Yahweh tells the Israelites to love a foreigner as much as the Israelites love themselves because the Israelites were foreigners in the land of Egypt. Yahweh is talking about how the ancestors of the Israelites moved to Egypt when there was a famine. After some time, the Egyptians enslaved the Israelites and oppressed the Israelites, and Yahweh had to rescue the Israelites from Egypt. Yahweh does not want the Israelites to treat foreigners in the same way the Egyptians treated the Israelites when the Israelites were foreigners. Yahweh reminds the Israelites again that he is Yahweh and he is the Israelites' God.

Then, Yahweh tells the Israelites that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to do anything unfair or wrong when the Israelites measure something. The Israelites must fairly measure how long something is or how much that thing weighs. The Israelites must also fairly count things. Yahweh is specifically talking about when the Israelites measure things to buy or sell those things. Yahweh tells the Israelites to have righteous scales, or scales that truly show how much something weighs. A scale was a tool people used to weigh things by comparing that thing's weight to the weight of another object.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a scale. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also tells the Israelites to have accurate weights. The weights were small objects that people often made out of rock or metal to be a certain weight. A person would put the weights on one side of the scale. Then the person would put the object or group of objects they were weighing on the other side. Then people would add or remove weights until the two sides of the scale were level. When the two sides of the scale were level, it showed that the object or group of objects weighed the same amount as the weights. If the weights weighed more or less than the merchant said the weights did, the merchant could trick people into getting less or paying more than people thought.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of weights. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people compare the weight of objects or groups of objects? How are your methods similar to how the Israelites weighed objects? How are your methods different from how the Israelites weighed objects? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also wants the Israelites to have an accurate ephah. An ephah was a standard dry measurement. The Israelites would measure their grain in ephahs. Here, Yahweh is probably talking about a basket or bag that was supposed to hold exactly one ephah of grain. Yahweh might have also been talking about the idea of an ephah, instead of a specific container that measured an ephah. If a person used a container that was actually smaller than an ephah, that person could give someone less grain than the other person paid for.

Stop here and look at a picture of a basket full of grain. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also wanted the Israelites to have a righteous hin. A hin was a standard measurement of volume that the Israelites used for liquids. Here, Yahweh is probably talking about a container that was supposed to hold exactly one hin of liquid. Yahweh also might have been talking about the idea of a hin, instead of a specific container that measured a hin. If a person who sold a liquid used a container that actually held less than a hin, the person who sold the liquid could give the person who bought the liquid less liquid than the buyer paid for.

Stop here and look at a picture of a container that holds a hin of liquid. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh then reminds the Israelites again that he is Yahweh and he is their God, and this time Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh brought the Israelites out of the land of Egypt. Yahweh tells the Israelites to obey all Yahweh's statutes and ordinances, and to do what Yahweh says. Then Yahweh reminds the Israelites again that he is Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what are some ways that people trick other people into paying more or getting less than they paid for?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:31–37 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites not to ask for help from people who talk to the spirits of dead people.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites to respect people who are old.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites to treat foreigners in their land like citizens.

In the fourth scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites to be honest when the Israelites do business with someone.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- The Israelites
- Mediums
- Wizards
- Yahweh
- People who are old
- And foreigners who live in Israel

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that in this part of Leviticus, Yahweh has been giving the Israelites rules, through Moses, that the Israelites need to obey to be holy. Yahweh groups similar rules together and ends several of the groups of rules by reminding the Israelites that he is Yahweh.

In the first scene of this passage, Yahweh is continuing to talk to Moses. Yahweh tells the Israelites, through Moses, not to use mediums or wizards, which are people who talk to spirits on behalf of other people. Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to face mediums or wizards. Yahweh also will not allow the Israelites to look for the mediums or wizards. When Yahweh says that he will not allow the Israelites to face or look for mediums or wizards, Yahweh is using special language to mean that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to look for the mediums or the wizards to ask for their help. Yahweh says this command in two different ways, but both mean the same thing.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate when Yahweh tells the Israelites that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to face mediums or wizards and that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to look for mediums or wizards? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that if the Israelites use mediums or wizards, the mediums and wizards will make the Israelites unclean. Yahweh does not just mean that the Israelites will be ritually dirty. Yahweh also means that the Israelites will be spiritually dirty because the Israelites have disobeyed God's laws. Then Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh and he is their God. Yahweh calls himself the Israelites' God because Yahweh has made a covenant to take care of the Israelites as their God, and the Israelites made a covenant to worship and rely only on Yahweh. Yahweh probably also tells the Israelites that he is their God because Yahweh wants the Israelites to rely on Yahweh instead of relying on mediums or wizards.

Yahweh tells the Israelites to stand up in front of people with grey hair. To stand up in front of someone is one way that people show respect.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people show respect? What ways can you translate when Yahweh tells the Israelites to stand up in front of people with grey hair to show that standing up is a sign of respect? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites to show respect to those with grey hair. This is another way to talk about old people, as old people often have grey hair. So when Yahweh tells the Israelites to respect people who have grey hair, Yahweh means that Yahweh wants the Israelites to respect people who are old.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what words or phrases do you have that refer to old people? What word or phrase works best here to refer to old people? Pause this audio here.

Then, Yahweh tells the Israelites to fear their God, who is Yahweh. When Yahweh tells the Israelites to fear him, Yahweh means that the Israelites need to deeply respect Yahweh and know that Yahweh will punish the Israelites if the Israelites disobey Yahweh's laws. Then Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh.

In the third scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites to be kind and just to the people from other nations who choose to live in the Israelites' land and follow the Israelites' laws. Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to oppress the foreigners. Instead, Yahweh tells the Israelites to treat the foreigners like any other citizen of Israel. Yahweh tells the Israelites to love the foreigner as much as the Israelites love themselves. Yahweh tells the Israelites why the Israelites need to treat the foreigners well; Yahweh reminds the Israelites that the Israelites were once foreigners in Egypt. Then, Yahweh tells the Israelites again that he is Yahweh and he is the Israelites' God.

In the fourth scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites to be honest and fair when the Israelites do business. Yahweh tells the Israelites that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to cheat people when the Israelites measure something. The Israelites must fairly measure how long something is or how much something weighs. The Israelites must also fairly count things. Then Yahweh tells the Israelites to use righteous balances, weights, ephahs, and hins. When Yahweh says these measurements need to be righteous, Yahweh means that the Israelites need to be honest when the Israelites use these measurements. The Israelites should not use unfair or incorrect measurements to cheat or trick people. Yahweh is telling the Israelites to be honest when the Israelites do business with people, and Yahweh uses the four examples of balances, weights, ephahs, and hins as ways that people measure things to trade.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how would you describe measurements that are good and correct? Discuss how you want to translate the way Yahweh says these measurements must be "righteous." Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh tells the Israelites that he is Yahweh, their God, who brought the Israelites out of Egypt. Yahweh tells the Israelites to obey all Yahweh's ordinances and statutes, and Yahweh tells the Israelites to do these ordinances and statutes. Finally, Yahweh tells the Israelites that he is Yahweh. Yahweh is telling the Israelites to obey Yahweh's rules again because Yahweh really wants the Israelites to remember and obey these rules. Yahweh also tells the Israelites to follow all these rules because Yahweh is ending this set of laws in Leviticus before he states another set of laws.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:31–37 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- The Israelites
- Mediums
- Wizards
- Yahweh

- People who are old
- And foreigners who live in Israel

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites, through Moses, not to use mediums or wizards. Yahweh does not want the Israelites to ask any mediums or wizards for help, because if the Israelites use mediums or wizards, then the Israelites will become ritually dirty. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I do not want to become ritually dirty, so I will not use mediums or wizards; or
- I know Yahweh does not want me to try to talk to dead people; or
- I will not look for a medium or a wizard.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites to show respect to people who are old. Yahweh also wants the Israelites to fear their God, who is Yahweh. Yahweh tells the Israelites again that he is Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I know that if I do not obey Yahweh, then Yahweh will punish me; or
- I respect the people who are old because those people have learned many things; or
- I know that Yahweh expects me to respect people who are old; or
- I respect Yahweh because of what Yahweh has done for us.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to oppress any foreigner who lives with the Israelites. Yahweh tells the Israelites to treat any foreigner who lives with the Israelites as if that foreigner is a citizen of Israel. Yahweh tells the Israelites to love foreigners as much as the Israelites love themselves, because the Israelites were foreigners in the land of Egypt. Yahweh tells the Israelites again that he is Yahweh and he is their God. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing foreigners living in Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am surprised that the people in Israel treat me so well; or
- I am grateful that I am completely safe in Israel; or
- I do not have to worry about the Israelites because Yahweh told the Israelites to be kind to me.

Continue the drama. In the fourth scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to cheat when the Israelites measure the length, weight, or quantity of something. Yahweh tells the Israelites to be honest and fair when the Israelites use a scale or weights, and when the Israelites use an ephah or a hin to measure something. Yahweh tells the Israelites again that he is Yahweh and he is their God, and Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh brought the Israelites out of Egypt. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I care about the Israelites; or
- I do not want anyone to cheat the Israelites or anyone else who is in Israel; or
- I really want the Israelites to be fair and honest with people; or
- I rescued the Israelites from Egypt, and now I want the Israelites to do the right thing.

Leviticus 19:31–37

Continue the drama. Yahweh tells the Israelites to obey all Yahweh's statutes and ordinances, and Yahweh tells the Israelites to do those statutes and ordinances. Finally, Yahweh tells the Israelites that he is Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 19:31–37 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh tells the Israelites not to use mediums or wizards. People believed that a medium could use divination to call the spirits of dead people from the place where dead people live.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **medium**. Look up medium in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also tells the Israelites not to use wizards. A wizard is very similar to a medium. A wizard learns information from dead people and tells it to other people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **wizard**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites that if the Israelites ask mediums or wizards for help, then the Israelites will **defile** themselves, or make themselves **unclean**. When someone is unclean or ritually dirty, that person is unfit for service to God. Use the same word or phrase for either defile or unclean as you used in previous passages. For more information on defile and clean and unclean, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh tells the Israelites that he is **Yahweh**. Yahweh is the personal name that the one true God gave to the Israelites for them to call God. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh also tells the Israelites that Yahweh is their **God**. In the Bible, "God" refers to God who created everything. God is the most powerful spiritual being. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh tells the Israelites to **fear their God**. When someone fears God, that person has a great reverence, honor, and respect for God. Use the same word or phrase for fear of God as you used in previous passages. For more information on "fear of God," refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh tells the Israelites not to oppress **foreigners** who live with the Israelites. A person is a foreigner in a country when that person lives in a nation that is not where the person was born. Use the same word or phrase for foreigner as you used in previous passages, when it refers to foreigners who have chosen to join the community of Israelites and follow the same laws as the Israelites. For more information on foreigner, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh requires the Israelites to have righteous measurements. Someone who is righteous is behaving in the right way. A righteous person is honest and in right relationship with others. In this passage, Yahweh is calling the measurements righteous to show that these measurements should be honest, or right.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate **righteous** in this passage. Discuss whether you will use the same word as your word for righteous, or if you will use a different word, like honest, or right. For more information on righteous, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh requires the Israelites to have an honest **ephah**. An ephah was a measure of dry volume, and the Israelites probably used it because it was the volume of grain that a donkey could carry. An ephah was about 20 liters, but the amount changed throughout history. Use the same word or phrase for ephah as you used in previous passages, like in Leviticus 14:21. For more information on ephah, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh also requires the Israelites to have an honest **hin**. A hin was a measure of liquid volume. A hin was roughly equal to 4 liters. Use the same word or phrase for hin as you used in previous passages. For more information on hin, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for “hin.” Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites to obey all Yahweh’s **statutes**. A statute is a law about how to live in society. Use the same word or phrase for statute as you used in previous passages. For more information on statute, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh also tells the Israelites to obey all Yahweh’s **ordinances**, or decisions. When a person in authority decides how the people they rule need to act, that decision becomes a law or a rule that the people need to follow. Use the same word or phrase for ordinance as you used in previous passages. For more information on ordinance, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 19:31–37

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (852 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 20:1–9

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 20:1–9 and put it in your hearts. It is important to note that Leviticus 20:1–9 contains difficult content.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:1–9 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 20:1–9

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last story, Yahweh told Moses many laws for the Israelites to obey because the Israelites were Yahweh's special people and Yahweh is a holy God. Now, Yahweh tells Moses how the Israelites should punish the people who break Yahweh's laws. Yahweh tells Moses that all of the Israelites need to hear these rules.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell stories about times people in your community broke the community's rules, and so the community punished those people. How does your community punish people who break the rules? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells Moses that Yahweh wants the Israelites to kill anyone who gives a child from their family to the false god Molech. It is important to remember that Molech was a god whom the people who lived near the Israelites worshiped. Those people believed that if people gave their children to Molech, then Molech would protect the people and do good things for the people. We do not know exactly how people gave their children to Molech. Some scholars think that people burned up the children on an altar as a sacrifice. Some scholars think that people left their children at Molech's temple, where the children would work for their whole lives. Either way, these people who gave their children to Molech were saying that Molech was the one in charge of the children's lives. These people were saying that the children belong to Molech and not to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when someone in your community gave a child to Yahweh, a god, spirits, or an ancestor. Pause this audio here.

Sometimes people gave their own children to Molech, and sometimes people gave their grandchildren or one of their other descendants.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about your descendants. How do you talk about the children in your family, even if those children are not your sons or daughters specifically? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh explains that the Israelites must kill anyone who gives a child to Molech—even if the person who gives the child to Molech is not an Israelite. Foreigners, strangers, refugees, or immigrants will one day live in Israelite towns. If one of those foreigners decides to sacrifice a child to Molech, then Yahweh wants the Israelites to kill the foreigner because of what that foreigner did.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when your community punished someone who was not originally from your community. Why did the community punish the foreigner? What rules are foreigners in your community supposed to follow in the same way as people who belong to your community? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the Israelites are supposed to kill the person who gives a child to Molech. The Israelites must throw stones at that person until the person dies. Yahweh will also punish the person. Yahweh will set Yahweh's face against the person, which means Yahweh will look at what the person is doing and punish that person himself.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when Yahweh, a god, powerful spirits, or an ancestor punished someone in your community. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will punish the person by cutting the person off from the community so that the person is not one of Yahweh's people anymore. Yahweh will punish the person because the person defiled Yahweh's Tent of Meeting. It is important to remember that Yahweh's Tent of Meeting was the place where Yahweh lived with Yahweh's

people. It is also important to remember that to defile something means to make something that is supposed to be holy or ritually clean into something that is ritually dirty and not holy anymore. If someone defiles Yahweh's holy Tent of Meeting, then it is as if that person tries to make Yahweh ritually dirty and not holy anymore.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the most important or most holy thing in your community? Tell a story about how your community takes care of that thing to make sure that people always respect that thing. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will also punish the person who gives a child to Molech because giving a child to Molech profanes Yahweh's holy name. It is important to remember that to profane something means to make something the opposite of holy. It means choosing to use something only for things that are ritually dirty or evil. It is also important to remember that the Israelites talked about their honor by talking about their names. When the Israelites wanted people to treat the Israelites with honor and respect, the Israelites would say that the Israelites wanted people to say the Israelites' names with honor and respect. When the Israelites were upset because people were disrespecting or dishonoring the Israelites, the Israelites would say that people were attacking the Israelites' names. Here, Yahweh says that when people give their children to Molech, the people who give their children to Molech make Yahweh's holy name into something that is ritually dirty and evil.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Who is the person that your community respects and honors the most? Tell a story about that person. Who is the person that your community respects and honors the least? Tell a story about that person. Pause this audio here.

Next, Yahweh explains what Yahweh will do if the Israelites do not kill the person who gives a child to Molech. In many Israelite communities, everyone in the community knew everyone else, and many people were related to each other. Sometimes, people would not punish someone in their community because the person who did the wrong thing was one of their family members or friends. People would pretend like they did not know that the person had done something wrong, even when people knew that the person had done something horrible.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do people in your community do when one of their family members or close friends does something wrong? Tell a story about how a family in your community acted when one of their family members did something wrong. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that Yahweh will punish the community if someone gives a child to Molech and the community does not kill the person who gave the child. If the community ignores the problem and does not kill the person, then Yahweh will punish the person himself. Yahweh will cut off the person who gave the child, and Yahweh will also cut off the person's whole family and everyone who ignored the problem. The person who gave the child to Molech, that person's family, and everyone who ignored the problem will not belong to Yahweh's people anymore. Yahweh explains that giving the child to Molech or ignoring the problem when someone else gives a child to Molech is like becoming a prostitute and selling your body for sex. It is like being married to someone and then going and having sex with someone who is not your husband or wife. In Israelite culture, selling your body for sex and having sex with someone who is not your husband or wife were horrible things for people to do. People who sacrificed a child acted like people who betrayed their husband or wife, their community, and Yahweh.

Stop this audio and discuss this question as a group: What is the worst thing someone in your community could do? What is the worst thing someone in your family could do? Tell a story about a time someone betrayed you, your community, or your family. Pause this audio here.

Then, Yahweh tells Moses that Yahweh will punish anyone who goes to a medium or a spiritist. It is important to remember that mediums, spiritists, and necromancers tried to talk to dead people's spirits or to learn things that dead people knew. Yahweh will punish anyone who visits a medium, spiritist, or necromancer. Yahweh will cut off the person from Yahweh's people so that the person is not one of Yahweh's people anymore.

Stop this audio and discuss this question as a group: How do people communicate with the spirits of dead people in your community? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelites need to consecrate themselves, or make themselves holy. It is important to remember that consecrated people are people whom Yahweh sets apart so that those people can do something

special for Yahweh. The Israelites need to live like they belong to Yahweh because Yahweh is their God. The Israelites need to obey what Yahweh says because Yahweh is God and Yahweh makes the Israelites holy.

Pause here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about something you do that shows that you are part of your family and not someone else's family. Tell a story about something you are proud of that your community does that is different from how the communities around you do things. Pause this audio here.

Finally, Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill any person who curses that person's father or mother. It is important to remember that people believed that people could make bad things happen to someone else by saying evil words about that person and cursing that person. Yahweh says that the Israelites need to punish any person who tries to make bad things happen to their parents by saying evil things about their parents. It was very important to respect and honor your parents in Israelite culture.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when someone in your community treated his or her parents very well. Tell a story about a time when someone in your community treated his or her parents very badly. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the person who curses their own parents is responsible for their own death.

The person did a horrible, evil thing and deserves to die.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when someone did something wrong and deserved for the community to punish that person.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses how the Israelites need to punish someone who gives a child to Molech.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Moses how Yahweh will punish someone who goes to a medium, spiritist, or necromancer.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites to be holy.

In the fourth scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites to kill any person who curses that person's parents.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelites
- A disobedient foreigner
- And a disobedient Israelite

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this passage, Yahweh is telling Moses the rules Yahweh wants Moses to tell the rest of the Israelites. Even though the Israelites are not there with Moses listening to Yahweh, Yahweh wants all of the Israelites to follow these rules carefully.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelites need to kill anyone who gives one of their own descendants to Molech. If someone gives their own child to Molech, then the other Israelites need to kill that person who gave the child to Molech. It does not matter if the person is an Israelite or a foreigner. The Israelites need to kill the person. The Israelites need to throw stones at the person until the person dies.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Find a tree stump, a large rock, or a bag full of cloth. Have everyone in the group find three to ten stones that are small enough to throw but heavy enough to hurt someone or

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something. Stand together as a group and throw the stones at the tree stump, rock, or bag of cloth. Make sure that no one will accidentally hit a person with one of the stones you throw. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that Yahweh will set his face against the person who gives a child to Molech. This means that Yahweh will oppose and punish that person. Yahweh also says that Yahweh will cut off that person from the community. It is important to remember that to cut someone off was a very severe punishment. It meant that the person could not be part of Yahweh's people and might even mean that Yahweh killed the person. Yahweh will punish the person because the person who gave a child to Molech defiled the Tent of Meeting where Yahweh lives and profaned Yahweh's holy name.

Stop here and tell a story about a time when a god or a leader gave your people a rule, and if anyone disobeyed the rule, then that person could no longer be a part of the community. What happened when someone disobeyed that rule? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and review the way you translated the phrases "set Yahweh's face against" and "cut the person off from their community" in Leviticus 17:10. Discuss if you want to translate those phrases in the same way here. Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh says that Yahweh will punish anyone in the community who knows that someone gave a child to Molech but ignores what that person did and does not kill the person who gave the child. Yahweh will punish the person who gave the child, and Yahweh will also punish that person's family and everyone else in the community who ignored what happened. Yahweh says that giving the child to Molech is like if a person went to Molech and sold his or her body to Molech so that Molech could have sex with that person. This is why it is so bad for someone to give a child to Molech.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you talk about someone who sells their body so that other people can have sex with that person? Discuss how you will translate this in an appropriate way in your language, but in a way that still shows how bad this action is. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh gives Moses different instructions to tell the Israelites. This time, Yahweh says that Yahweh will punish anyone who asks a medium or spiritist to talk to dead people's spirits to get information. Similarly to when someone gives their child to Molech, Yahweh says that when a person goes to talk to dead people's spirits, it is like when a person chooses to be a prostitute or to go sleep with someone who is not that person's husband or wife. Yahweh will punish anyone who goes to talk to a dead person's spirit by cutting that person off so that that person is not part of Yahweh's people anymore.

In the third scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites to be holy. It is important to remember that the Israelites are not there with Moses and Yahweh when Yahweh gives these instructions. Yahweh is still telling Moses to tell all these instructions to the Israelites, but Yahweh tells the instructions to Moses as if Yahweh is talking to all the Israelites at the same time.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about a time when you told someone else to go and give instructions to a group of people. How did you tell the messenger the instructions? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the Israelites need to consecrate themselves, or make themselves holy and act like holy people, because the Israelites belong to Yahweh. Yahweh made the Israelites holy by choosing the Israelites to be Yahweh's people. Now, the Israelites need to obey Yahweh and do what Yahweh says because the Israelites belong to Yahweh, and Yahweh is holy himself.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you say that Yahweh tells the Israelites to act in a holy way and to be Yahweh's holy, or special, people? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill any person who curses that person's father or mother. Yahweh says that a person who cursed their father or mother should not be confused about why the Israelites need to kill that person. The person chose to curse their father or mother even though that person knew that the punishment was death. Yahweh says that person's blood is on their own head, which means that person alone is responsible for that person's own death. Sometimes in the Bible, people use the idea of blood to show guilt. No one else is responsible for what the person did.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you talk about how a person's blood will be on their own head, or how that person will be guilty of wrongdoing if they curse their father or mother? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelites
- A disobedient foreigner
- And a disobedient Israelite

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Yahweh tells Moses to give these instructions to the Israelites. Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill any Israelite or foreigner who gives a child to Molech.

The disobedient Israelite and the disobedient foreigner can each pretend to give a child to Molech, and then the rest of the Israelites can pretend to stone the disobedient foreigner and the disobedient Israelite. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the disobedient foreigner and the disobedient Israelite, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I wanted Molech to give me good things, and that is why I gave Molech my child; or
- I do not care what Yahweh says! I want Molech to be my god.

Ask the people playing the obedient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- That person is worshipping someone other than Yahweh! I am so angry! or
- I want to obey Yahweh, even if it means I need to kill this person; or
- Why would that disobedient person do something so evil? That person deserves to die.

Continue the drama. Then the person playing Yahweh can act out how Yahweh opposes and punishes the disobedient Israelite and foreigner. Yahweh forces the disobedient Israelite and the disobedient foreigner to leave the community. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The Israelites promised to be my people, and I am the Israelites' God. I do not want the Israelites to worship other gods; or

- I am angry! These disobedient people hurt innocent children and made those children worship other gods instead of teaching their children to worship me; or
- People who give their children and descendants to Molech are very evil. I do not want my people to do evil things.

Continue the drama. Next, the disobedient Israelite and the disobedient foreigner pretend to give their children to Molech again. This time, the Israelites ignore what the disobedient people are doing and do not kill the disobedient people. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- The person who disobeyed Yahweh is my friend! I do not want to kill my friend. Yahweh will not punish me; or
- The person who disobeyed Yahweh is part of my family! I cannot kill someone who is part of my family! or
- I do not think that what the disobedient people did is very bad. Everything will be fine.

Continue the drama. This time, Yahweh punishes the disobedient people and all the rest of the community who ignored what the disobedient people did. Yahweh makes all those people leave the community. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This whole community is so evil! These people are not listening to me and are worshipping other gods! or
- What these people did is so bad. It is like these people went and sold their bodies to Molech instead of living with me as the people promised! or
- These people did not kill the person who disobeyed me, so these people are acting like the disobedient person did a good thing. These people care more about the disobedient person than me, their God!

Continue the drama. Next, the disobedient Israelite pretends to visit a medium or a spiritist. Yahweh makes the disobedient Israelite leave the community. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the disobedient Israelite, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I wanted to know what to do, so I went to the medium so I could talk to my dead ancestor; or
- I wanted spiritual power, so I went to the medium and the spiritist so that I could do what I wanted.

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am here! The Israelites are supposed to talk to me when the Israelites do not know what to do or when the Israelites need help! I am so sad and angry that this person went to dead people's spirits instead; or
- What this person did is so bad. It is like this person went and sold their body to someone else instead of living with me as the person promised!

Continue the drama. Yahweh tells the people to follow Yahweh's laws, because the people belong to Yahweh. Yahweh says that he is Yahweh, the Israelites' God. Yahweh tells the Israelites to obey Yahweh's instructions and do what Yahweh says. Yahweh explains that the Israelites are holy because Yahweh made the Israelites holy. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The Israelites are my people! The Israelites are special to me because I chose the Israelites. I love the Israelites; or
- I want the Israelites to live like the Israelites belong to me. I made the Israelites different from all the other nations because I chose the Israelites to be my people.

Continue the drama. Finally, the disobedient Israelite pretends to curse his father or mother. The rest of the Israelites pretend to kill the disobedient Israelite. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the disobedient Israelite, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so angry at my parents! I want bad things to happen to my parents; or
- I do not care what Yahweh said! I am going to try to hurt my parents anyway.

Ask the people playing the obedient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This person deserves to die! No one made this person say such evil things about his parents! or

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- Yahweh clearly said that people who curse their parents deserve to die! This person knew what would happen and still decided to curse his parents!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

The story starts with **Yahweh** telling Moses what to say to the Israelites. Yahweh is God's personal name. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh that you have in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh explains that the Israelites need to punish both **Israelites** and **foreigners** who give children to Molech. Foreigners are people who live in a country that is not where those people were born. These foreigners have chosen to live among the Israelites and to follow the same laws as the Israelites do. Use the same word for Israelites and foreigners as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israelites and foreigners, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill any Israelite or foreigner who gives a child to Molech. The phrase here could mean that the person burned up the child as a sacrifice or that the person gave the child to Molech's priests so that the child grew up doing whatever Molech's priests told the child to do. The child could be the Israelite's or the foreigner's son or daughter, or the child could be any of the Israelite's or the foreigner's descendants.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use to talk about **giving a child to Molech**. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Molech was the false god whom people would give their children to. Use the same word or phrase for Molech as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh says that the community needs to stone anyone who gives a child to Molech. The Israelites stoned people by throwing rocks at that person until that person died.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use to talk about **stoning**. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that Yahweh will **set his face against** the person who gives a child to Molech. This means that Yahweh will oppose and punish the person. Yahweh also says Yahweh will **cut the person off** from the people because of what that person did. Use the same phrases for "set Yahweh's face against" and "cut the person off from the people" as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh says that Yahweh will punish the person who gives a child to Molech because the person has **defiled** Yahweh's sanctuary, or makes the sanctuary unclean or ritually dirty. Use the same word or phrase for defiled as you used in previous passages. Look up defile and **clean and unclean** in the Master Glossary for more information.

The **sanctuary** is the place where people worship Yahweh and where Yahweh lives with Yahweh's people. In this story, the sanctuary is the Tent of Meeting and the surrounding courtyard area. Use the same word or phrase for sanctuary as you used in previous passages. Look up sanctuary in the Master Glossary for more information.

The person who gives a child to Molech also **profanes** Yahweh's **holy** name. To profane something is to shame it and use it to do evil things. Use the same words or phrases for profane and holy as you used in previous passages. Look up profane and holy in the Master Glossary for more information.

If the members of the community do not punish the person who gives a child to Molech, then Yahweh will set Yahweh's face against the person who gives the child to Molech. Yahweh will also set Yahweh's face against the person's family or clan. The word for family here talks about all the person's relatives and not just the person's parents, husband or wife, and children. It talks about the bigger family that the person belongs to, which includes the person's aunts, uncles, cousins, grandparents, and their families. Sometimes translations use the

word clan here to show the difference between a person's parents, children, and husband or wife and the rest of the person's larger family.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **clan**, or large family group. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that Yahweh will punish anyone who gives a child to Molech and anyone who ignores the person who gives a child to Molech because those people are **prostituting** themselves to Molech. It is important to remember that the Israelites did not actually have sex with Molech. Yahweh is saying that what the Israelites are doing is just as bad as if the Israelites were selling their bodies for sex all the time or having sex with someone who was not their husband or wife. Use the same word or phrase for prostituting as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh also says Yahweh will set Yahweh's face against anyone who goes to a **medium**. It is important to remember that a medium is someone who speaks to dead people's spirits. Use the same word or phrase for medium as you used in previous passages. Look up medium in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh will also punish anyone who goes to a **necromancer** or a **spiritist**. This is a person who tries to learn important information from dead people's spirits. A spiritist is very similar to a medium. Use the same word for necromancer or spiritist as you used in previous passages.

Then, Yahweh tells the Israelites to **consecrate** themselves. It is important to remember that Yahweh consecrates someone by giving the person a special job serving Yahweh. Here, Yahweh is telling the Israelites to focus on doing what Yahweh told the Israelites to do and living the holy way Yahweh told the Israelites to live. Use the same word or phrase for consecrate as you used in previous passages. Look up consecrate in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh tells the Israelites to obey his **statutes**, or laws, for how to live in society and how to do important things in the tabernacle. Use the same word or phrase for statute as you have previously, and refer to statute in the Master Glossary for more information.

Finally, Yahweh tells the Israelites to kill anyone who **curses** their father or mother. It is important to remember that the Israelites believed that people could make evil things happen to someone by saying evil things about the person. That is what Yahweh is talking about in this story. Use the same word or phrase for curse as you used in previous passages. Look up curse in the Master Glossary for more information.

If a person curses his father or mother, then the person's "blood is on his own head." This means that the person deserves to be killed and that the person cannot say that what that person did was someone else's fault.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **blood is on his own head**. If you have already translated this word or phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. For more information, you can refer to **blood** in the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 20:1–9

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (852 KB)
- Setting the Stage (6.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 20:10–16

Hear and Heart

NOTE: This passage talks about subjects that you may want to discuss in groups of only men and only women. Stop here and discuss as a group if you will listen to this passage in groups of only men and only women. Pause this audio here.

In this step, hear Leviticus 20:10–16 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:10–16 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

NOTE: This passage talks about subjects that you may want to discuss in groups of only men and only women. Stop here and discuss as a group if you will listen to this passage in groups of only men and only women. Pause this audio here.

In the last story, Yahweh started telling Moses how to punish people who broke Yahweh's laws, especially people who had sex with someone they should not have had sex with. You will remember that Yahweh gave Moses these laws in Leviticus chapter 18. In this story, Yahweh tells Moses how to punish people who break these laws. All of the laws in this story are about what the Israelites should do if someone has sex with someone that the person should not have sex with. In all of these rules, Yahweh assumes that both of the people wanted to have sex with each other. In a different story, Yahweh gives Moses different rules for what the Israelites should do if one person forces another person to have sex.

Leviticus 20:10–16

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time someone in your community had sex with someone that the person should not have had sex with. What did your community do? Pause this audio here.

First, Yahweh tells Moses what the Israelites need to do if a man has sex with another man's wife. Adultery is when a married person has sex with someone who is not their husband or wife. Yahweh says that a man should not have sex with another man's wife. If a man has sex with another man's wife, then the man is having sex with his neighbor's wife. A neighbor is someone the man is supposed to be loyal to and take care of. If the man has sex with his neighbor's wife, then the man is betraying someone the man is supposed to be loyal to. Yahweh says that the Israelites need to punish the man who had sex with another man's wife. Yahweh says that the Israelites are also supposed to punish the woman that the man had sex with. The Israelites need to kill both the man and the woman because of what the man and the woman did. It is important to know that the Israelites only killed the man and the woman together when the married woman wanted to have sex with the man. If the man forced the married woman to have sex with the man, then the Israelites would only punish the man.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What does your community do when a married person has sex with someone who is not their husband or wife? Pause this audio here.

Second, Yahweh tells Moses what the Israelites need to do if a man has sex with the man's father's wife. This could mean that the man had sex with the man's mother, or it could mean that the man had sex with a different woman who was married to the man's father. Either way, the man is shaming his father in one of the worst possible ways.

Yahweh says that if an Israelite man has sex with any of his father's wives, then the Israelites need to kill the man and the woman who had sex with the man. The man and woman knew what they were doing was wrong and still did it anyway.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time someone in your community shamed someone else in a horrible way. Pause this audio here.

Third, Yahweh tells Moses what the Israelites need to do if a man has sex with the man's son's wife. Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill the man and the woman who had sex with the man. Yahweh says that the man and the son's wife have done something very evil, and it is not the way Yahweh wants his creation to behave.

Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill the man who had sex with the son's wife, and the Israelites also need to kill the son's wife. Yahweh says that the man and the woman are guilty, or their blood is on their heads, because the man and the son's wife should have known that what they were doing was wrong, but did it anyway.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time someone did something truly evil and wrong. Pause this audio here.

Fourth, Yahweh tells Moses what the Israelites need to do if a man has sex with another man. Yahweh says that men who have sex with each other are doing something ritually dirty and wrong. Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill both of the men because these men knew what they were doing was wrong, but did it anyway.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when a man had sex with another man in your culture. What does your culture think about men who have sex with other men? Pause this audio here.

Fifth, Yahweh tells Moses what the Israelites need to do if a man marries a woman and the woman's mother. Yahweh says that this man does something wicked—or something very wrong—if the man marries both a woman and the woman's mother. Yahweh says that the Israelites need to burn the man and both the woman and the woman's mother because of what they did. It is not clear here if the Israelites were supposed to kill the man and both of the women first and then burn their dead bodies, or if the Israelites were supposed to burn the man and both the women until they all were dead. Either way, the Israelites thought that burning someone was one of the worst punishments. The Israelites believed that burning a person completely removed the person from the community because the person did not even have any bones left in the community. It was like the person never existed. Yahweh says that the Israelites need to burn the man and both of the women because it totally removes the evil from the community.

Stop here and discuss this question as a community: What are some of the ways your community takes care of people's dead bodies? What are the most honorable ways you take care of a person's dead body? What are the most shameful things to do to a person's dead body? Pause this audio here.

Sixth, Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man has sex with an animal. Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill the man and the animal that the man had sex with.

Then Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a woman goes to a male animal so that the woman can have sex with the animal. Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill the woman and the animal because the woman and the animal are completely responsible and guilty for this action, and no one else is responsible.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What rules does your community have about whether or not people should have sex with animals?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has six scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man has sex with another man's wife.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man has sex with the man's father's wife.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man has sex with the man's son's wife.

In the fourth scene: Yahweh tells Moses what to do if two men have sex with each other.

In the fifth scene: Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man marries a woman and the woman's mother.

In the sixth scene: Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a person has sex with an animal.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Disobedient Israelites
- And obedient Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

It is important to remember that Yahweh is telling these instructions to Moses. Later, Moses will tell all these instructions to the Israelites.

In this story, Yahweh tells Moses how to punish people who break certain of Yahweh's laws. These are the laws that Yahweh has already given Moses, and now we hear that all of the laws have very serious consequences and strong punishments when someone disobeys the laws. All of the laws are about what the Israelites need to do when someone in the community has sex with someone the person is not supposed to have sex with.

Stop here and, as a group, discuss your community's laws about who can have sex with whom, and the consequences when someone disobeys those laws. What do you notice about these laws? How do people show how important these laws are? Pause this audio here.

In the first scene, Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill any man who has sex with another man's wife. Yahweh calls this other man the first man's neighbor. A neighbor is a member of your community. Yahweh says that a man who has sex with another man's wife is betraying someone that the man is supposed to be loyal to. The Israelites need to kill the man and the woman who had sex with each other.

Stop here and discuss how you talk about people in your community whom you should be loyal to. What do you call those people? Since you will not be able to act out what these characters do, discuss how you will remember or talk about this law in an appropriate way. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man has sex with one of the man's father's wives. Yahweh says that the man is "uncovering his father's nakedness." This means that the man is shaming his father in one of the worst ways. So the Israelites need to kill the man who had sex with his father's wife and the woman who had sex with the man. Yahweh says that their blood is on their own heads because the man and woman knew what they were doing was wrong and still did it. The man and woman are completely responsible for what they did. Remember that Yahweh used the phrase "their blood will be on their own head" in the last passage.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Since you will not be able to act out what these characters do, discuss how you will remember or talk about this law in an appropriate way. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man has sex with the wife of the man's son. Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill both the man and the woman who had sex with the man. Yahweh says that what the man and woman did is a "perverse" act. The word "perverse" talks about something that is opposite to the way Yahweh made the world to work. If someone does a perverse thing, then the person does something so wrong that it breaks the most important rules of the world. Yahweh says that the man and woman's blood is on their own heads because the man and woman knew what they were doing was wrong and still did it.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Remember the story you told in the last step about someone who did something truly evil and wrong. What words or phrases would you use to describe the way that person acted? Discuss if you can translate perverse in the same way that you did in Leviticus 18:23. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Since you will not be able to act out what these characters do, discuss how you will remember or talk about this law in an appropriate way. Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man has sex with another man, just like how a man has sex with a woman. Yahweh says that the men did something detestable. The word "detestable" means something that is evil and wrong, and something that Yahweh hates. Some translations call this "an abomination." So the Israelites need to kill both men. The men's blood is on their own heads because the men knew what they were doing was wrong and still did it.

Stop here and discuss how you translated abomination or something that is detestable in Leviticus 18:30. Discuss whether you can translate it in the same way here. Since you will not be able to act out what these characters do, discuss how you will remember or talk about this law in an appropriate way. Pause this audio here.

In the fifth scene, Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man marries a woman and the woman's mother. Yahweh says that a man who marries a woman and the woman's mother has done something very wrong. The Israelites need to kill the man and both the women. The Israelites might kill the man and both the women by burning them with fire, or the Israelites might kill the man and both the women in a different way and then burn their bodies with fire. Yahweh says that burning the man and both the women with fire cleans the land by destroying all the evil that the man and the women brought into the community when the man married these two women.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Since you will not be able to act out what these characters do, discuss how you will remember or talk about this law in an appropriate way. Pause this audio here.

In the sixth scene, Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man has sex with an animal. Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill the man and the animal that the man had sex with. Then Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a woman goes to a male animal and has sex with the male animal. Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill the woman and the animal. Yahweh says the blood is on the woman and the animal's heads, so the woman and the animal are guilty. No one else is responsible for what the woman and the animal did.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Since you will not be able to act out what these characters do, discuss how you will remember or talk about this law in an appropriate way. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has six scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Disobedient Israelites
- And obedient Israelites

It is important to remember that Yahweh is telling these instructions to Moses. Later, Moses will tell all these instructions to the Israelites.

As a group, retell the passage twice. You should retell the passage in your own language.

Because your translators may not want to act out the content of this passage, you may just want to have someone speak the passage, or you may want to use objects to show the different relationships of people. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and retell the passage.

The group should retell this passage a second time. At certain points in the retelling, pause the retelling and discuss what you think the characters would be feeling and thinking. Then continue the retelling.

Pause this audio here and retell the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the retelling and possible responses.

Yahweh tells Moses Yahweh's instructions.

Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelites need to kill anyone who commits adultery. If a man and a woman who is married to someone else have sex together, then the other Israelites must kill that man and woman. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The person might answer things like:

- I am upset and angry. Those disobedient Israelites promised to respect my rules about marriage, but then the Israelites had sex with each other instead! or
- I am sad and angry. The disobedient Israelite betrayed the woman's husband.

Ask the people playing the obedient Israelites, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The people might answer things like:

- I cannot believe this man and this woman betrayed Yahweh! I am so angry! or
- This woman betrayed her husband, and this man betrayed someone the man was supposed to be loyal to. What the man and woman did was so wrong! or
- I am sad that we have to kill two people from our community. What the man and the woman did is very wrong, and I am upset about this whole situation.

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh tells Moses what the Israelites need to do if a man has sex with the man's father's wife. The other Israelites need to kill the man and the woman who had sex with the man. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the disobedient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I know what we did was wrong, but I wanted to do it anyway; or
- I do not care what Yahweh says! I want to do what I want to do.

Ask the people playing the obedient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- These disobedient Israelites knew what they were doing was wrong, but did it anyway! These two people deserve to die; or
- That disobedient Israelite man shamed his father in such a horrible way! I cannot believe that man would do something that terrible to his own father!

Continue the drama. Yahweh tells Moses what the Israelites need to do if a man has sex with the man's son's wife. The other Israelites need to kill that man and woman because what that man and woman did is very evil. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the disobedient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I know what we did was wrong, but I wanted to do it anyway; or
- I do not care what Yahweh says! I want to do what I want to do.

Ask the people playing the obedient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- These disobedient Israelites knew what they were doing was wrong, but these people did it anyway! These people deserve to die; or
- These disobedient Israelites did something perverse and bad! What these people did broke the rules that Yahweh made when Yahweh made everything. These people deserve to die.

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh tells Moses what the Israelites need to do if a man has sex with another man. The other Israelites need to kill those two men because what those men did is something that Yahweh hates. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the disobedient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- I know what we did was wrong, but I wanted to do it anyway; or
- I do not care what Yahweh says! I want to do what I want to do.

Ask the people playing the obedient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- These disobedient Israelites knew what they were doing was wrong, but these people did it anyway! These people deserve to die; or
- These disobedient Israelites made themselves so ritually dirty that these two people need to die to make the community ritually clean again.

Continue the drama. Next, Yahweh tells Moses what the Israelites need to do if a man marries both a woman and the woman's mother. The other Israelites need to kill that man and the two women and burn their bodies, to get rid of any wickedness. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the obedient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- These disobedient Israelites did such a horrible thing! We do not even want these people's bones to be in our land anymore; or
- We need to make sure our community stays ritually clean. We need to completely destroy these people so that these people do not make our land ritually dirty even after these people are dead.

Continue the drama. Next, Yahweh tells Moses what the Israelites need to do if a man has sex with an animal or if a woman goes to a male animal and has sex with it. The other Israelites need to kill that man or woman and the animal. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the disobedient Israelite woman, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I know what we did was wrong, but I wanted to do it anyway; or
- I do not care what Yahweh says! I want to do what I want to do.

Ask the people playing the obedient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- This disobedient Israelite knew what she was doing was wrong, but she did it anyway! This disobedient Israelite deserves to die; or

Leviticus 20:10–16

- Yahweh says that people are only supposed to have sex with the person they are married to! I am sad and angry that these disobedient Israelites did not obey Yahweh's instructions.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill anyone who commits adultery. A person commits adultery if the person has sex with someone who is married to someone else or has sex with someone who is not the person's husband or wife.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **adultery**, and for both the man and the woman who commit adultery. Look up adultery in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that a man who has sex with another man's wife is having sex with his **neighbor**'s wife. Use the same word or phrase for neighbor as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill anyone who has sex with his **father's wife**. This might mean that the man had sex with the man's own mother, or it might mean that the man had sex with a different woman who was also the man's father's wife. Use the same word or phrase for "father's wife" as you used in Leviticus 18.

Yahweh says that anyone who has sex with his father's wife has **uncovered his father's nakedness**. It is important to remember that uncovering your father's nakedness means shaming your father in a horrible way. Use the same word or phrase for "uncovered his father's nakedness" as you used in Leviticus 18.

If a man has sex with his father's wife, Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill that man and the woman who had sex with the man. The Israelites do not need to feel guilty. Yahweh says that the man and woman who had sex with each other have **their own blood on their heads**. It is important to remember that this phrase means that the man and the woman deserve their punishment because the man and the woman knew what they were doing was wrong and still did it anyway. Use the same word or phrase for "their blood is on their heads" as you used in previous passages and throughout this passage.

Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill a man who has sex with the man's **son's wife**. Use the same word or phrase for "son's wife" as you used in Leviticus 18.

Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill the man who had sex with his son's wife and also the woman that the man had sex with because what the man and woman did was a **perversion**. It is important to remember that a perversion is something that breaks Yahweh's rules for how the world is supposed to work. Use the same word or phrase for perversion as you used in Leviticus 18:23.

Then Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill any man who has sex with another man in the same way that a man has sex with a woman. Use the same word or phrase to talk about a man having sex with another man as you did in previous passages.

Yahweh says that a man who has sex with another man does something **detestable** or that it is an **abomination**. It is important to remember that something detestable is something that is even worse than making something ritually dirty. It is something that no one should ever do because Yahweh hates it. Use the same word or phrase for detestable or abomination as you used in previous passages.

Next, Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill anyone who marries both a woman and the woman's mother.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will say this so that it is clear that the man is marrying the woman and the woman's mother. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites need to kill the man and both of the women the man married because what the man did was **wicked**. It is important to remember that the word wicked shows how evil the action is. It is like saying, "This is

something truly bad that no one should ever do." Use the same word or phrase for wicked or depraved as you used in previous passages. Look in the Master Glossary for more information about wickedness.

When the Israelites kill the man and both of the women, the Israelites need to burn the man and the women with fire. This either means that the Israelites burned the man and the women with fire until the man and women died, or the Israelites killed the man and the women and then burned their dead bodies with fire until there was nothing left. The Israelites need to burn the man and both the women he married with fire so that none of their wickedness stays in the Israelite community.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **burned in the fire**. Pause this audio here.

Finally, Yahweh says that the Israelites need to kill anyone who has sex with an animal. If a man has sex with an animal, then the Israelites need to kill the man and the animal. If a woman goes to a male animal and has sex with the male animal, then the Israelites need to kill the woman and the animal.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 20:10–16

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (4.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 20:17–21

Leviticus 20:17–21

Hear and Heart

NOTE: This passage talks about subjects that you may want to discuss in groups of only men and only women. Stop here and discuss as a group if you will listen to this passage in groups of only men and only women. Pause this audio here.

In this step, hear Leviticus 20:17–21 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:17–21 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:17–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

NOTE: This passage talks about subjects that you may want to discuss in groups of only men and only women. Stop here and discuss as a group if you will listen to this passage in groups of only men and only women. Pause this audio here.

In this story, Yahweh gives Moses more instructions about how to punish people who break Yahweh's laws. All five of the laws in this story are about what the Israelites should do if someone has sex with someone that the person should not have sex with. You will remember that Yahweh has already given similar laws to Moses in Leviticus chapter 18, but here Yahweh tells the Israelites how to punish people who disobey these laws. In all of these rules, Yahweh assumes that both of the people wanted to have sex with each other. In a different story, Yahweh gives Moses different rules for what the Israelites should do if one person forces another person to have sex.

First, Yahweh tells the Israelites what to do if a man and the man's sister agree to get married and then get married. Yahweh says that the law applies to any man who marries his sister. The Israelites allowed a man to have more than one wife, so sometimes people would have a brother or a sister who had the same mother or a brother and a sister who had the same father but not the same mother. Yahweh says that a man may never marry his sister, even if the sister has a different father or a different mother.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Describe a normal family in your community. How many husbands or wives can a person have? Tell a story about your own family. How do you talk about your brothers or sisters? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh explains that if a man marries the man's sister, then the man sees his sister's naked body and the sister sees her brother's naked body. Yahweh says that this is a shameful thing and the opposite of what a loyal and honorable brother should do. The Israelites need to exile the man and his sister. When the Israelites exile the man and his sister, the Israelites are publicly shaming the man and the man's sister for what these two people did.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about a time when your whole community publicly punished someone for what the person did. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the man who married his sister is even more guilty than his sister is. The Israelites believed that a brother's job was to protect his sister's honor and reputation. Instead of protecting his sister, the man who married his sister destroyed the sister's reputation and honor. The man is even more guilty than the sister is because the man was supposed to protect his sister, and the man did not.

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Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about a time when a man in your community did the right thing as a brother for his sister. Tell a story about a time when a man in your community did the wrong thing and failed to be a good brother to his sister. Pause this audio here.

In the second rule, Yahweh tells Moses what the Israelites need to do if a man in the community has sex with a woman who is currently on her period, or time of menstruation. Menstruation is when a woman has her monthly bleeding. The Israelites believed that a woman who was having her monthly bleeding was ritually dirty and needed to rest in a special way until the woman's bleeding stopped. Yahweh says that it is wrong for a man to have sex with a woman while the woman is having her monthly bleeding because it means that the man looks at the woman's bleeding and the woman shows the man her bleeding. If a man and a woman have sex during the woman's monthly bleeding, then the Israelites need to cut off or exile both the man and the woman.

Pause here and discuss this question as a group: What are things that women in your community can do while those women are having their monthly bleeding? What are things that those women cannot do? If it is appropriate, politely ask an appropriate woman in your community to tell the story of what that woman does during her monthly bleeding. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh's third rule is that a man should not have sex with a sister of the man's parents. The man should not have sex with his mother's sister or with his father's sister.

Pause here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about your father's sister. Tell a story about your mother's sister. Stop this audio here.

A man who has sex with his mother's sister or his father's sister is having sex with a woman who is related to the man by blood. Yahweh does not want the Israelites to marry people who are too closely related. Yahweh says that the man and woman who had sex will bear their guilt. Yahweh will punish the man and woman for having sex with each other when the man and woman are closely related.

Pause here and discuss this question as a group: Who are people in your community allowed to marry? Tell a story about someone who chose the right person to marry. Tell a story about someone who chose the wrong person to marry. What makes someone the right person to marry in your community? Stop this audio here.

Yahweh's fourth rule is that a man should not have sex with the woman his father's brother marries. It is not clear in this rule whether the man's uncle has died or is still alive. Either way, a man should not have sex with his uncle's wife. Yahweh says that if a man has sex with his uncle's wife, then the man is shaming his uncle in one of the worst possible ways.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about your father's brother. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that Yahweh will punish the man and the man's uncle's wife for having sex with each other. Yahweh will punish the man and woman by making it so that the man and woman never have children and have no descendants. The Israelites believed that it was very important for a family to continue to exist for generations. It was a very shameful and horrible thing for someone's family line to die out because the person did not have any descendants.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about a family in your community that did not have any children. What does your community think of people who do not have children? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh's fifth rule is that a man should not marry his brother's wife. In other parts of the Bible, Yahweh tells a man that a man needs to marry his brother's wife if his brother dies without having any children. In that situation, the man who marries his brother's wife is honoring his brother and making sure that his brother's family can continue. The community treats any children that the brother's wife has as the dead brother's children, even if the brother is already dead. Here, Yahweh is not talking about that specific situation. Yahweh's rule is about what will happen if a man marries his brother's wife while his brother is still alive, or marries his brother's wife after his brother dies, if his brother already has children. Yahweh says that doing this makes the man and woman ritually dirty—it is a very bad thing, and Yahweh hates it! A man who marries his brother's wife in the wrong way shames his brother in the worst possible way. Yahweh says that Yahweh will punish the man and the woman by not letting the man and woman have children. The man and woman will have no descendants because of the horrible thing that the man and woman did.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Has there ever been a time in your community where someone married his brother's wife? What happened in that situation, and what did your community do in response?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:17–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has five scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man marries his sister.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man has sex with a woman who is having her monthly bleeding.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells Moses what will happen if a man has sex with his father's or mother's sister.

In the fourth scene: Yahweh tells Moses what will happen if a man has sex with his father's brother's wife.

In the fifth scene: Yahweh tells Moses what will happen if a man marries his brother's wife in the wrong way.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Obedient Israelites
- And disobedient Israelites

It is important to remember that Yahweh is telling Moses these instructions so that Moses can tell the instructions to the rest of the Israelites. The Israelites are not listening to Yahweh talk in this specific story.

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this story, Yahweh gives Moses a list of rules and instructions. These are the laws that the Israelites need to follow, and all of the laws have very serious consequences and strong punishments. All of the laws are about what the Israelites need to do when someone in the community has sex with someone the person is not supposed to have sex with. In this story, Yahweh tells Moses how Moses should punish people who do not obey the five rules Yahweh reminds Moses of in this story.

Stop here and discuss how you can talk about the action of sex in a way that is appropriate to talk about when both men and women are present. How did you translate this appropriately in Leviticus 18? Pause this audio here.

First, Yahweh tells Moses what to do when a man marries his sister. This rule applies to anyone who marries his father's daughter or anyone who marries his mother's daughter. The man who marries his sister sees his sister naked, and his sister sees her brother naked. Yahweh says that what the man and his sister have done is the opposite of the kind of loyalty a family should have for family. Yahweh says that the "sons of their people," who are the Israelites, need to exile the man and his sister because of what the man and his sister have done. The phrase "sons of their people" means that the punishment is very public so everyone will know what the man and his sister have done. The Israelites will work together to exile the man and woman so that the man and woman can never be part of the community again. This was a deeply shameful punishment. Yahweh says that the man who married his sister "bears his guilt." This means that the man is even more guilty than his sister.

Stop here and tell a story about someone who dishonored someone else. How do you talk about the way that someone dishonors someone else? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and tell a story about someone who did something so bad that the community sent that person away so that person could never return. What do people think about the person who could never come back? How did the community send that person away? Discuss how you will make it clear in your translation that the Israelites will publicly exile the man and the woman here. Pause this audio here.

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Second, Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man has sex with a woman who is menstruating, or having her monthly bleeding. Yahweh says that the man who has sex with a woman who is having her monthly bleeding has seen her bleeding, and that the woman has shown the man her bleeding when the woman was not supposed to. Yahweh says that the community must cut off or exile both the man and the woman from the people. You will remember that it is possible that when someone cuts off others from the community, Yahweh wants the community to kill the man and woman, but it is more likely that Yahweh just wants them to send the man and woman away from the community.

Stop here and discuss how you talk about menstruation in an appropriate way in your language. Discuss how you have talked about menstruation in earlier passages. Pause this audio here.

Third, Yahweh tells Moses what will happen if a man has sex with the sister of the man's father or mother. Yahweh says that a man who has sex with his aunt has had sex with someone who is close family. Yahweh will punish the man and the woman who had sex with each other because of the horrible thing those people did. The man and woman will carry their iniquity, which means the man and woman are guilty for what they have done.

Stop here and discuss how you will talk about the way that someone bears their own iniquity, or is guilty for what that person has done. Pause this audio here.

Fourth, Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man has sex with his father's brother's wife. Yahweh says that a man who has sex with his father's brother's wife is "uncovering his uncle's nakedness." This means that the man has shamed his father's brother—his uncle. Both the man and the woman are guilty, and Yahweh will punish the man and the woman who had sex.

Stop here and review how you have translated the way that someone uncovers another person's nakedness, or deeply shames someone. Pause this audio here.

Fifth, Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man marries his brother's wife when the man is not supposed to. Yahweh says that it is detestable for a man to marry his brother's wife in those situations. The word for "detestable" here talks about something that makes someone very, very ritually dirty. Some translations call what the man and woman did "an abomination," or something that Yahweh hates. Yahweh says that the man who marries his brother's wife when the man is not supposed to has shamed his brother by "uncovering his brother's nakedness." The man and the woman will die without having any children or any descendants. The man and woman's family will not exist anymore.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group. In two of these situations, the first and last, Yahweh talks about people who get married, or live together in the same way as husband and wife do. In the other situations, Yahweh talks just about having sexual relations, without getting officially married. Discuss how you will show the difference between the two kinds of situations Yahweh talks about in this passage. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:17–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has five scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Obedient Israelites
- And disobedient Israelites

As a group, retell the passage twice. You should retell the passage in your own language.

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Because your translators may not want to act out the content of this passage, you may just want to have someone speak the passage, or you may want to use objects to show the different relationships of people. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and retell the passage.

The group should retell this passage a second time. At certain points in the retelling, pause the retelling and discuss what you think the characters would be feeling and thinking. Then continue the retelling.

Pause this audio here and retell the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the retelling and possible responses.

Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man marries the man's sister. It does not matter if the sister is the daughter of the man's mother or of the man's father and another woman who is not the man's mother. The Israelites must publicly send this man and his sister away. The man has dishonored his sister and is very guilty. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the obedient Israelites, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The people might answer things like:

- I am so angry and horrified! I cannot believe this man destroyed his sister's honor when the man was supposed to protect his sister; or
- The disobedient Israelites are not part of our community anymore. It is like those people are dead. I do not ever want to see those people again; or
- Yahweh said that we needed to punish people who do such horrible things. I want to follow Yahweh.

Ask the person playing the disobedient Israelite man, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The person might answer things like:

- I am even more guilty than my sister is because I was supposed to honor and protect my sister, but I married my sister instead; or
- I feel so horrible about what I did. I should have listened to Yahweh.

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man has sex with a woman who is having her monthly bleeding. The Israelites must force this man and woman to leave the community. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the obedient Israelites, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The people might answer things like:

- I feel disgusted. Why would the disobedient Israelites have sex when it would make them so ritually dirty? or
- The woman was supposed to rest in a special way. I cannot believe the woman had sex with that man instead! That man and woman disobeyed Yahweh, and so the man and woman need to leave the community now; or
- I am upset and sad that members of our community act in this way.

Continue the drama. Next, Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man has sex with his mother's sister or with his father's sister. This man dishonors a close relative. Both the man and woman will be guilty, so Yahweh will punish the man and woman. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel disgusted. This man had sex with a woman who was closely related to the man. That is not what I want people to do; or
- This man and these women deserve a punishment for breaking my rules; or
- I am sad that people do not follow my good rules for sex and marriage.

Ask the person playing the disobedient Israelites, "What are you thinking or feeling?" The people might answer things like:

- Yahweh himself is punishing us for what we did! We should not have had sex with each other! or
- I feel so guilty and horrible because of what I did!

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh tells Moses what will happen if a man has sex with his uncle's wife. This man dishonors his uncle. Yahweh will punish the man and woman for what they did, so the man and woman will not have any children or any descendants. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the uncle, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

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- I am so ashamed. My nephew and my wife did such a horrible thing! or
- I am angry! I cannot believe my nephew and my wife would do such a shameful thing to me!

Ask the people playing the man and his uncle's wife, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- Yahweh did not let us have any children! Our family will die out, and it will be like we never existed in the community! We should have listened to Yahweh; or
- This is such a horrible punishment! We will not have any descendants. What will we do?

Continue the drama. Finally, Yahweh tells Moses what will happen if a man marries his brother's wife in the wrong way. This is a very shameful way to treat a brother. Yahweh will cause the man and the brother's wife to not have any children. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the brother, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I cannot believe my brother would do such a horrible thing and shame me so much! or
- I am angry! I cannot believe my brother and my wife would do such a shameful thing to me! or
- I am disgusted. My brother and my wife did something so evil and ritually dirty and impure.

Ask the people playing the disobedient Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The people might answer things like:

- Yahweh did not let us have any children! Our family will die out, and it will be like we never existed in the community! We should have listened to Yahweh; or
- This is such a horrible punishment! We will not have any descendants. What will we do?

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:17–21 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

First, Yahweh says what will happen if a man marries his **father's daughter** or his **mother's daughter**. These are two different ways to talk about someone's sister. A woman might be a man's sister because they have the same mother, or the woman might be the man's sister because they have the same father but a different mother. Use the same word or phrase for "father's daughter" or "mother's daughter" as you have used in Leviticus chapter 18.

Yahweh says that a man who marries his sister sees his sister's naked body, and the sister sees the man's naked body. Yahweh says that this is a disgrace. The word for disgrace here is a word that normally means loyalty and love. Here, it means that the man is doing the opposite of what a loyal and loving brother should do.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **disgrace**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites need to **cut off** the man and the woman from the community. This probably means that the Israelites exiled the man and the woman. Use the same word or phrase here as you used in previous passages. Use the same word or phrase throughout.

The Israelites needed to cut off the man and the woman "in the sight of the sons of their people." This phrase means that the Israelites needed to punish the man and the woman publicly so everyone knew what a shameful thing the man and the woman had done.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **in the sight of the sons of their people**. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the man has **uncovered his sister's nakedness**. The phrase uncovered his or her nakedness is one way the Israelites talked about having sex with someone else when they should not. You will remember that this phrase also means that the man has made his sister ashamed. Use the same word or phrase for "uncovered her nakedness" as you used in previous passages. Use the same word or phrase throughout.

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Then Yahweh says the man who marries his sister will **pay for, or carry the burden of, his iniquity**. It is not entirely clear how the man will carry his iniquity, but it does mean that the man will be guilty and that Yahweh will punish the man for what the man did. Use the same phrase for carrying the burden of his iniquity as you did in Leviticus 17:16.

Next, Yahweh tells Moses what to do if a man has sex with a woman who is **menstruating**. Menstruation is when a woman has her monthly bleeding. Use the same word or phrase for menstruation as you used in Leviticus chapter 18.

Then, Yahweh says that a man should not have sex with his **father's sister** or his **mother's sister**. Use the same word or phrase for "father's sister" or "mother's sister" as you used in Leviticus chapter 18.

Yahweh says that a man should not have sex with his father's sister or his mother's sister because the woman is a close **blood relative** or a close relative. Use the same word or phrase for "blood relative" or "close relative" as you used in Leviticus chapter 18.

Next, Yahweh says that a man should not have sex with his **father's brother's wife**. Use the same word or phrase for "father's brother's wife" as you used in Leviticus chapter 18.

Yahweh says that the man and woman who have sex will die childless. This means that the man and woman will not have any descendants who live after them. The man and woman will not have their own children or any descendants.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **childless**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Finally, Yahweh talks about what will happen if a man marries his **brother's wife**. Use the same word or phrase for "brother's wife" as you used in Leviticus chapter 18.

Yahweh says that what the man and his brother's wife have done is **detestable** or is an **abomination**. This means that what the man and the brother's wife have done is very ritually dirty and impure, and Yahweh hates it. Use the same word or phrase for detestable as you have used in previous passages, especially when it means something that is ritually dirty.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (1.0 MB)
- Setting the Stage (4.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.3 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 20:22–27

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 20:22–27 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:22–27 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:22–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this story, Yahweh keeps telling Moses the rules and instructions Yahweh wants the Israelites to obey. Later, Moses will tell the Israelites all of these instructions so that the Israelites will know how to live as Yahweh's people.

Yahweh says that the Israelites need to keep all of Yahweh's statutes and ordinances and do what Yahweh says. Yahweh says the Israelites need to do all these things so that the Israelites can live peacefully in the land that Yahweh is leading the Israelites to. It is important to remember that the Israelites were traveling from the country of Egypt, where the Israelites had been slaves, to Canaan. Yahweh had promised to give the Israelites the land of Canaan, but the Israelites had not arrived there yet.

Stop here as a group and look at a map of the Israelites' travel from Egypt to Canaan. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh had promised to give the land of Canaan to the Israelites as their new home. However, Yahweh warns Moses that the Israelites need to obey Yahweh's rules. If the Israelites do not obey Yahweh, Yahweh will send the Israelites out of the land.

Yahweh warns the Israelites to be careful about how the Israelites live when the Israelites finally arrive in Canaan. The Israelites must not live the same way that the Canaanites live. Yahweh says that Yahweh is giving the land of Canaan to the Israelites because the people who live in the land of Canaan, the Canaanites, did evil, horrible things that made Yahweh angry. Yahweh is punishing the Canaanites by giving their land to the Israelites instead. This is why Yahweh does not want the Israelites to live the same way that the Canaanites live. If the Israelites live the same way that the Canaanites live, then Yahweh will need to punish the Israelites the same way Yahweh is punishing the Canaanites.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when you needed to take away something from someone because that person was not taking good care of that thing or doing what that person was supposed to do. Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh reminds Moses that Yahweh promised the Israelites that Yahweh would give the Israelites the Canaanites' land as the Israelites' new homeland. The land is a gift from Yahweh. Yahweh says that the land is a beautiful place that flows with milk and honey. This means that the land is perfect for the Israelites' animals to live on so that the animals can produce a lot of milk and other good food. It also means that the land can grow delicious food for the people. The word "honey" here refers to something sweet and delicious. It can be talking about sweet syrup that people made using fruit, like the date fruit, or it can be talking about the sweet syrup that bees make. Either way, when Yahweh talks about a land flowing with milk and honey, Yahweh is saying that the land has plenty of good food to eat and plenty of water to drink.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of milk, dates, and honey. Then, as a group, describe the best land you have ever seen. What made the land such a good place to be? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will give the beautiful land of Canaan to the Israelites because he is Yahweh, the Israelites' God, who chose the Israelites to be different from all the other people in the world. So Yahweh says that the Israelites need to make sure to live in a different way from the other nations. If the Israelites do not, it is like the Israelites are shaming Yahweh since the Israelites are Yahweh's representatives to the other nations.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when you needed to act differently because you were representing someone else. What did you need to do differently? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the Israelites need to separate the ritually clean animals and birds from the ritually dirty animals and birds. Yahweh warns the Israelites not to eat any of the ritually dirty animals, birds, or other animals that crawl all over the land because eating those animals makes the Israelites ritually dirty as well. Then Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh told the Israelites clearly which animals are ritually dirty so that the Israelites know exactly what the Israelites can or cannot eat. Yahweh reminds the Israelites to be holy because Yahweh is holy and Yahweh chose the Israelites to be Yahweh's people out of all the people in the world.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when someone ate a ritually dirty animal that the person should not have eaten. What happened? Pause this audio here.

Finally, Yahweh tells Moses what to do if one of the Israelites ever acts as a medium or tries to talk to the spirits of dead people. If the Israelites see any man or woman acting as a medium, spiritist, or necromancer, then the Israelites need to kill that person by throwing stones at the person until that person dies. This is because the medium tried to learn spiritual information without talking to Yahweh. Yahweh says that the person is guilty because the person knew that they should talk to Yahweh to learn that information and chose to talk to dead people's spirits instead.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when someone in your community tried to gain spiritual information the wrong way. What did your community do?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:22–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh warns Moses and the Israelites not to live like the Canaanites so that the Israelites can stay in the land that Yahweh will give to the Israelites.

In the second scene: Yahweh reminds the Israelites to only eat ritually clean animals.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells Moses how the Israelites need to punish mediums or spiritists.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Canaanites
- Obedient Israelites
- And disobedient Israelites

It is important to remember that Yahweh is still telling these instructions to Moses so Moses can tell the Israelites. Later, Moses will tell these instructions to the Israelites.

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the previous stories, Yahweh told Moses how to punish people who disobeyed Yahweh's laws. Now, in scene one, Yahweh tells Moses why it is so important for the Israelites to obey all of Yahweh's laws. Instead of telling Moses how to punish individual people for breaking Yahweh's laws, Yahweh tells Moses how Yahweh will punish all of the Israelites if the Israelites disobey Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when someone in your community warned the entire community about something. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelites need to obey all of Yahweh's statutes and ordinances. If the Israelites do obey what Yahweh says, then the land that Yahweh is bringing the Israelites to will not vomit the Israelites out. A person vomits when a person gets so sick that the things in the person's stomach come back out the person's mouth. Yahweh says that when the Israelites disobey Yahweh and become ritually dirty, the dirtiness is so bad that it is as if the land itself becomes sick. Then the land vomits the Israelites out and forces the Israelites to leave. It is important to know that Yahweh is the one who would actually make the Israelites leave. Yahweh is using this special language of the land getting sick and vomiting to show the Israelites how important it is for the Israelites to continue to obey Yahweh when the Israelites arrive at the new, beautiful land.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about a time when you were extremely sick. What happened, and how did you get better? How do you talk about the way that a person vomits food out of their stomach? How will you talk about the way Yahweh says the land will vomit the Israelites out if the Israelites disobey Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites that the people who currently live in the land of Canaan do shameful things, and that is why Yahweh is making the Canaanites leave the land. Yahweh says that the Canaanites did all these things. The phrase "all these things" here refers to shameful things that are evil and that people should be ashamed to do. Yahweh warns the Israelites not to follow the customs of the Canaanites, or to live in the same way that the Canaanites do. If the Israelites do, Yahweh says Yahweh will force the Israelites to leave the land as well.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are some ways that other people groups act that are different than how your people group acts? How do you talk about this different way of life, or different customs? How do you talk about someone who lives in the same way as a different people group does? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh promised to give the Israelites the land of Canaan. Yahweh quotes a promise that Yahweh made earlier in the Bible. Yahweh said that the Israelites would own the Canaanite land because Yahweh would give that land to the Israelites. Yahweh also said that the land of Canaan is a "land flowing with milk and honey," or a land with plenty of good food and water.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate the way that Yahweh says that the land of Canaan is a land flowing with milk and honey. Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh their God who made the Israelites different from all the other people by making the Israelites Yahweh's people. It is important to see that Yahweh wants the Israelites to be careful about how the Israelites live because the Israelites are Yahweh's people.

Stop here and discuss as a group how to talk about special groups of people or nations that someone has set aside for a special purpose. How will you talk about the way that Yahweh has set the Israelites apart to be Yahweh's people? Pause this audio here.

In scene two, Yahweh tells Moses to tell the Israelites to be careful about what the Israelites eat. Yahweh says that because the Israelites are Yahweh's people, the Israelites need to be careful to separate ritually clean birds and animals from ritually dirty birds and animals. When the Israelites eat meat, the Israelites must only eat ritually clean birds or animals. The Israelites must not eat any ritually dirty animal, bird, or any other creature. If the Israelites eat anything that is ritually dirty, then the Israelites defile themselves and become ritually dirty as well. The Israelites cannot serve Yahweh until the Israelites are ritually clean again. The Israelites cannot eat anything that is ritually dirty because Yahweh told the Israelites that those animals, birds, and other creatures were ritually dirty. Yahweh says that the Israelites need to be careful about what the Israelites eat because Yahweh chose the Israelites. Just like Yahweh made the priests holy by choosing the priests to be different from the other Israelites and serve Yahweh, Yahweh also made all of the Israelites holy by choosing the Israelites from all of the other nations in the world to be Yahweh's people. Yahweh is a holy God, so the Israelites need to live holy lives as Yahweh's people. Again, Yahweh says his name and that Yahweh has separated the Israelites from the nations for Yahweh.

In scene three, Yahweh gives Moses more instructions about what the Israelites need to do if one of the Israelites disobeys one of Yahweh's laws or regulations. Yahweh says that the Israelites need to punish anyone who acts as a medium for spiritual forces or who acts as a spiritist or necromancer, whether that person is a man or a woman. If a man or woman acts as a medium or spiritist, then the Israelites need to kill that person. The Israelites must throw rocks at that person until the person dies. Yahweh says that the person's blood is on that person's own head. Yahweh means that the person is completely responsible and guilty because that person knew Yahweh's law and chose to be a medium or spiritist anyway.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will transition from the general instructions and warnings that Yahweh told Moses to tell the Israelites to this specific law about what to do with Israelites who become mediums or spiritists. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:22–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Canaanites
- Obedient Israelites
- And disobedient Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Yahweh warns Moses about what the Israelites need to do. As Yahweh speaks, the people playing the obedient and disobedient Israelites can act out what Yahweh is saying.

First, Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelites need to obey all of Yahweh's statutes and laws by doing what Yahweh says. If the Israelites disobey Yahweh, then the land that Yahweh is giving to the Israelites as their new home will vomit the Israelites out. While Yahweh is talking, the people playing the disobedient Israelites should pretend to disobey Yahweh. Then show how Yahweh makes the people leave the land, just like food leaves a person's stomach when a person vomits. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you thinking and feeling?" The person may say things like,

- I do not want the Israelites to do such horrible things! The Israelites deserve a punishment; or

  - I warned the Israelites not to do that. I am sad that the Israelites disobeyed me, and now I have to punish the Israelites.

  Ask the people playing the disobedient Israelites, "What are you thinking and feeling?" The people may say things like:

  - I did not think that Yahweh would actually punish me for disobeying Yahweh! I wish I had obeyed Yahweh; or
  - I am sad because Yahweh warned us that Yahweh would punish us if we disobeyed Yahweh, and now we cannot live in the good land anymore; or
  - I am angry that I have to leave the land even though I disobeyed Yahweh!

  [!end] Continue the drama.

Yahweh warns Moses that the Israelites should not live the same way that the Canaanites live. Yahweh says that the Canaanites did shameful, horrible things. That is why Yahweh is taking the land away from the Canaanites and giving the land to the Israelites instead. While Yahweh is talking, Yahweh acts out how Yahweh forces the Canaanites to leave the land and gives the land to the Israelites instead. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The Canaanites did horrible, shameful things. I do not want my special people to live like that! or
- I hate what the Canaanites are doing. The Canaanites are hurting themselves and others; or
- I do not want the Israelites to live the way the Canaanites are living. If the Israelites do, I need to punish the Israelites, and I do not want to punish the Israelites.

Continue the drama. Yahweh says that Yahweh made a promise to Israel. That promise was that the Israelites would own the Canaanites' land because Yahweh would give the land to the Israelites. Yahweh also promised that the land of Canaan would be a good land that flows with milk and honey. Then Yahweh says that he is Yahweh, the Israelites' God, and that Yahweh made the Israelites different from all the other people. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I love the Israelites! I am so excited to give the Israelites this beautiful land! or
- I chose the Israelites to be my people, and I want the Israelites to have this special land.

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelites need to be careful to separate the ritually clean animals and birds from the ritually dirty animals and birds. Yahweh says that the Israelites need to do this because Yahweh chose the Israelites to be Yahweh's people. Yahweh says that the Israelites cannot eat any bird, animal, or other creature that Yahweh says is ritually dirty because then the Israelites will be ritually dirty as well. The Israelites need to become holy people because Yahweh is a holy God. Yahweh chose the Israelites to be Yahweh's very own people and separated the Israelites from all the other nations. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person may say things like:

- It is so important for the Israelites to carefully choose what the Israelites eat because I carefully chose the Israelites to be my people out of all the people in the world; or

- I love the Israelites, and I want the Israelites to live holy lives. The Israelites are special to me. I want the Israelites to live in a special way so that the Israelites remember that the Israelites are special to me and so that everyone else in the world knows that the Israelites are special to me.

Continue the drama. Finally, Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelites need to kill men and women who act as mediums or who talk to dead people's spirits. Yahweh says that the people who do those things have their own blood on their heads because these people know what Yahweh said to do, but chose to be mediums anyway. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person may say things like:

- I feel hurt and betrayed because the person who was a medium was one of my people. This person should have talked to me to learn things. Instead, the person talked to dead people's spirits; or
- The Israelites promised that I would be their God and the Israelites would be my people. However, this person tried to make the Israelites stop trusting me and trust dead people's spirits instead! or
- I am angry that this person disobeyed my rules and treated dead people's spirits as more powerful and important than I am.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 20:22–27 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelites need to keep Yahweh's **statutes**. It is important to remember that statutes are laws or rules about how to live in a society. Use the same word or phrase for statute as you used in previous passages. Look up statute in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh also says that the Israelites need to be careful to obey all of Yahweh's **ordinances**. It is important to remember that ordinances are rules that people have to keep. Use the same word or phrase for ordinances as you used in previous passages. Look up ordinances in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh says that the Israelites need to keep Yahweh's statutes and laws because otherwise the land that Yahweh is bringing the Israelites to will vomit the Israelites out instead of being their new home. While Yahweh does not say the name of the land here, we know that this land is the land of Canaan.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the **land** of Canaan on a map. Use the same word or phrase to talk about the land Yahweh gave the Israelites as you used in previous passages. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the land will **vomit** the Israelites out if the people do not listen. Use the same word or phrase for the land vomiting out the Israelites as you used in previous passages.

Then Yahweh says that when the Israelites get to the land, the Israelites need to live differently than the people who already live there.

Yahweh says that Yahweh detests the Canaanites because of all the things that the Canaanites have done. The word detest here means to strongly dislike or to hate someone or something. Yahweh is saying that the Canaanites have done so many horrible things that Yahweh does not want a relationship with the Canaanites anymore.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **detest**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh says that Yahweh has promised that Yahweh will give the land to the Israelites as their possession or for the Israelites to possess. A possession is something that belongs to you. Yahweh is saying that Yahweh wants the Israelites to live in the land and own the land instead of the people that currently live in the land.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **possess** or **possession**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the land is flowing with milk and honey. It is important to remember that the land did not have milk and honey flowing across it. Instead, this phrase means that the land had enough grass and other plants

for cows and goats to make a lot of milk, and it had good ground so that fruits and other sweet foods could grow. It might also mean that the land had many bees that made sweet food for the Israelites to eat. The phrase "flowing with milk and honey" is an expression that describes a very good land where people have plenty to eat and can grow many good things.

Stop here and look at the pictures of milk, dates, and honey again as a group. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **flowing with milk and honey**. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that he is **Yahweh**, the Israelites' **God**, who set the Israelites apart from other people. In this story, God refers to himself with his personal name, Yahweh. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and God that you have in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that Yahweh **set the Israelites apart** or **made the Israelites different** from other people. Yahweh is saying that Yahweh made the Israelites different from all the other people groups in the world because Yahweh chose the Israelites to be Yahweh's special people. Use the same phrase for "set apart" or "made them different from other people" as you used in previous passages and throughout this story.

Yahweh says that the Israelites need to make a difference between **ritually clean** and **ritually dirty** animals and birds. Use the same word or phrase for ritually clean and ritually dirty as you used in previous passages. For more information about "clean and unclean," refer to the Master Glossary.

Then Yahweh explains that the Israelites must not **defile** themselves by eating anything ritually dirty. It is important to remember that a person who defiled himself or herself was ritually dirty and could not serve Yahweh anymore until that person was ritually clean again. Use the same word or phrase for defile as you used in previous passages. For more information about defile, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that the Israelites need to avoid ritually dirty **animals, birds, and creatures that swarm, or move around, on the ground**. It is important to remember that the Israelites used the phrase "animals, birds, and creatures that move around on the ground" to talk about every kind of animal. Here, Yahweh is saying that the Israelites cannot eat anything that is ritually dirty, no matter what. Use the same word or phrase for "animals, birds, and creatures that move around on the ground" as you used in previous passages.

After Yahweh explains that the Israelites cannot eat anything ritually dirty, Yahweh says that the Israelites need to be **holy**. The word holy means that something belongs to Yahweh or that Yahweh is God. Use the same word or phrase for holy as you used in previous passages. For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary.

Finally, Yahweh tells Moses how the Israelites need to punish men or women who become **mediums**. It is important to remember that mediums were people who would try to talk with or become possessed by dead people's spirits. Yahweh also tells Moses how the Israelites need to punish men or women who become **spiritists** or **necromancers**. Spiritists and necromancers were people who tried to learn information by talking to dead people's spirits. These are two very similar kinds of people. Use the same words or phrases for medium and spiritist or necromancer as you used in previous passages. Look at "medium" in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelites need to punish mediums and spiritists by **stoning** these people. This meant that the Israelites would throw rocks at the person until the person died. Use the same word or phrase for "stone to death" as you used in previous passages.

Finally, Yahweh says that the person who is a medium or spiritist is guilty, or that their **blood is on their head**. It is important to remember that the phrase "his blood is on his head" means that the person earned their punishment because the person knew Yahweh's laws but chose to disobey anyway. Use the same word or phrase for "his blood is on his head" as you used in previous passages. For more information, see blood in the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 20:22–27

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (848 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.8 MB)
- Embodying the Text (4.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 21:1–9

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 21:1–9 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 21:1–9 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 21:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 21:1–9

In previous passages of Leviticus, Yahweh has told Moses what the Israelites need to do to be holy and how the Israelites need to punish people who do not obey Yahweh's laws. In this passage, Yahweh begins to give Moses laws for the priests to obey so that the priests can be holy.

First, Yahweh tells Moses to talk to the priests. Yahweh also calls the priests the sons of Aaron because Yahweh said that all of Aaron's descendants will be the priests. Yahweh wants Moses to tell the priests several things.

First, Yahweh will not allow a priest to defile himself when one of the priest's relatives dies. Normally, when a person died, that person's relatives would help prepare and bury the body together, and the relatives would mourn the person together. When a person touched the dead body or went to the place where people buried the dead body, that person would become ritually dirty. Normally, Yahweh allowed people to bury and mourn the body and become ritually dirty, but here Yahweh explains that Yahweh will not allow priests to become ritually dirty for one of their relatives. However, Yahweh does allow a priest to defile himself, or make himself ritually dirty, for a relative if the relative is one of the priest's closest family members. Yahweh explains that the closest family members are a mother, a father, a son, a daughter, and a brother. Yahweh also says that a sister who is not married yet and is close to the priest, because the sister does not have a husband, is one of the priest's closest family members. Yahweh will allow the priest to defile himself for this sister and all the rest of these closest family members.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people expect a man to care for and treat the members of his family? How do people expect a man to treat his unmarried sisters? Pause this audio here.

However, Yahweh will not allow the priests to defile themselves in other situations. Yahweh probably does not want the priest to defile himself for any of the priest's wife's family members. Yahweh might also mean that Yahweh does not want the priest to defile himself in normal situations because the priest is a leader of the Israelites. In either situation, if the priest makes himself ritually dirty, the priest will defile himself or bring shame to himself when the priest is holy.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, which people are special, or dedicated to a spirit or god? What rules do those people have to obey that no one else obeys? Pause this audio here.

Second, Yahweh will not allow the priests to make a bald spot on their heads, shave the edges of their beards, or cut themselves. Each of these different actions is what the people around Israel did when people mourned a dead person. Yahweh does not want the priests to mourn in these ways. Earlier in Leviticus, Yahweh also told all the rest of the Israelites that Yahweh does not want the Israelites to cut themselves or shave the edges of their beards to mourn a person who was dead.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people mourn someone who has died? When do people not allow someone to mourn a person who has died? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the priests need to be holy, or dedicated, to their God. Yahweh says the priests must not profane, or mistreat, their God's holy name. When Yahweh says Yahweh will not allow the priests to profane Yahweh's name, Yahweh is using special language to mean that the priests must not shame or dishonor Yahweh. Because the priests burn the sacrifices people give to Yahweh, the priests need to be holy. Yahweh calls these sacrifices Yahweh's food. People bring offerings of food, or fire offerings, to present to Yahweh, so that food belongs to Yahweh.

Third, Yahweh will not allow the priests to marry a prostitute or a woman who has defiled herself. When Yahweh talks about a woman who has defiled herself, Yahweh probably means a woman who has sex with people at a temple as part of special rituals. Yahweh also will not allow a priest to marry a woman whose husband has divorced that woman. The priests cannot marry any of these women because the priests are holy to their God. Yahweh tells the Israelites to treat the priests like the priests are holy people, or people who are dedicated to God, because the priests offer food to their God, which people call fire offerings. Remember that even though the priests offer the food to Yahweh, Yahweh does not eat the food. Yahweh tells the people to consider the priests holy, because Yahweh, who makes people holy, is holy.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, who can priests marry? What do people think about women who are prostitutes and women whose husbands have divorced them, or women who have divorced

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their husbands? What do people think about the men who marry prostitutes and the men who marry women who have had a divorce? Pause this audio here.

Finally, Yahweh tells Moses that when a daughter of a priest becomes a prostitute, she profanes or makes herself ritually dirty and dishonors or shames her father. If the daughter of a priest becomes a prostitute, Yahweh tells the Israelites to burn the daughter. Yahweh probably means that after the Israelites stone the daughter to death, the Israelites need to burn the daughter's body. People would often burn a person's dead body because the people wanted to insult that person even after that person was dead. Yahweh tells the Israelites to burn the daughter's body to show how serious the crime the daughter committed was.

Stop here and ask this question as a group: In your culture, what do people think about a leader when the leader's children act in a bad way? What do people expect a leader to do when their children act in a bad way?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 21:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron and the other priests that the priests must not defile themselves for anyone but the priests' closest family.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells the priests not to make a bald spot on their head, shave the edges of their beard, or cut themselves, because the priests are holy.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells the priests to avoid marrying women who have a bad reputation.

In the fourth scene: Yahweh tells the priests to burn any of their daughters who become prostitutes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The priests
- A priest's relatives
- A priest's mother
- A priest's father
- A priest's son
- A priest's daughter
- A priest's brother
- A priest's unmarried sister
- The Israelites
- A prostitute
- A woman who has sex at a temple
- And a divorced woman

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that in previous passages, Yahweh has been telling Moses the laws the Israelites must obey so the Israelites can be holy. Yahweh has also been telling Moses how the Israelites need to punish people who do not follow those laws. In this passage, Yahweh begins to talk about the special rules that priests need to follow because the priests are holy, or set apart, for special service to Yahweh in a way that other Israelites are not.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses to talk to the priests. Yahweh also calls the priests the sons of Aaron, because Aaron's male descendants will be the priests. Yahweh says the priests must not become ritually dirty because of a dead body. When a person died, their dead body made everyone near the body ritually dirty. The

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dead person's relatives would still get near the dead body and prepare the person's body so the relatives could bury the body. That would make the relatives ritually dirty for a short time. Yahweh does not want the priests to do things that would make the priests ritually dirty, except for the priests' closest family members. Yahweh lists the closest family members of a priest: the priest's mother, father, sons, any daughters, any brothers, and any sisters who have not married a man yet. You may notice that Yahweh does not mention a priest's wife. Many people think that because the wife is married to the priest, everyone would know that the wife is a close family member. Everyone would already know that a priest could mourn and become ritually dirty for the priest's wife. So perhaps that is why Yahweh does not mention a priest's wife here.

A priest may also defile himself for his sister who has not married a man. If the priest's sister is married, her husband would be responsible to bury the sister. If the sister is not married, her brother, who is the priest, may need to help bury the sister. When Yahweh mentions a priest's sons and daughters, Yahweh is including all of the children that a priest would have, from the first child through the last child. When Yahweh mentions a priest's brothers and sisters, Yahweh means brothers and sisters who are older and younger and the same age as the priest. These brothers and sisters would be children of the priest's father or mother.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to talk about all the family members Yahweh is talking about in this passage? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will not allow any priest to defile himself as a husband among the priest's people. Yahweh probably does not want the priest to defile himself for any of his wife's family members. Yahweh might also mean that Yahweh does not want the priest to defile himself in normal situations because the priest is a leader of the Israelites. If the priest defiles himself as a husband among his people, the priest will profane himself. The priest is holy, or special to Yahweh. So Yahweh does not want the priest to profane himself, or make himself common or unholy.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How have you heard this part of the passage before in your area? What is the best way to translate that a priest cannot defile himself as a husband among his people? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh will not allow a priest to make bald spots on the priest's head. Yahweh also will not allow a priest to cut the edges of the priest's beard. Yahweh also will not allow any priest to cut himself. These three actions are things that people did when people wanted to mourn someone who had died. Yahweh is probably saying that Yahweh will not allow the priests to do any of these things to show how sad the priests are that someone died. Yahweh says that the priests will be holy, or special, to the God that the priests serve, who is Yahweh. Yahweh will not allow the priests to profane Yahweh's name, or Yahweh's reputation, because the priests offer the sacrifices the Israelites make to Yahweh by burning the sacrifices. Yahweh calls these sacrifices the food of their God, because people gave food as offerings to God. Remember that Yahweh does not eat this food. Because the people have dedicated this food to God and the food belongs to God, the people must treat the food the way God tells the people to.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate this in such a way to make it clear that Yahweh does not say Yahweh will eat this food? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Yahweh shows how a priest's wife must have a good reputation, because a wife's reputation affects the husband's reputation. Yahweh will not allow any priest to marry a prostitute or a woman who has sex at a temple. Sometimes, women who worshiped other false gods would work at those gods' temples. These women would have sex with men who came to worship at the temple as part of a ritual. Yahweh calls these women defiled, and Yahweh will not allow priests to marry these women. Yahweh will also not allow any priest to marry a woman whose husband has divorced her. Often, when a man divorced his wife, it was because the woman was not faithful to her husband, so divorce was shameful to a woman. Yahweh did not want the priests to marry any woman who did not have a good reputation.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you talk about a prostitute or someone who has sex with multiple people who they are not married to? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the priests cannot marry any of these women because the priests are holy to Yahweh, who is the God the priests serve. Then, Yahweh says, "You must treat the priests as holy." Remember, Yahweh is talking to Moses at this part of the story. Since Moses will repeat these instructions to the Israelites, we can tell that

Leviticus 21:1–9

Yahweh is actually saying to Moses that Moses and all the Israelites should treat the priests as holy. The priests are holy, or special, since the priests offer the food to the God the Israelites serve. Yahweh is talking again about the fire offerings that the priests offer for the Israelites, which are food that belongs to Yahweh. Yahweh says that the Israelites will treat the priests as holy because Yahweh, who made the Israelites holy, is holy himself. Yahweh is the one who makes the priests holy.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate that the Israelites need to consider the priests holy because Yahweh, who made the Israelites holy, is holy himself? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, Yahweh says that when a priest's daughter profanes herself by becoming a prostitute, the daughter profanes her father. All priests are holy to Yahweh. If the priest's daughter becomes a prostitute, the daughter brings shame or dishonor to her family's reputation and to her father's status as holy. Just like the priest's wife could affect the priest's reputation, the priest's daughter can also affect the priest's reputation. Yahweh tells the Israelites to burn any daughter of a priest who becomes a prostitute.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 21:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The priests
- A priest's relatives
- A priest's mother
- A priest's father
- A priest's son
- A priest's daughter
- A priest's brother
- A priest's unmarried sister
- The Israelites
- A prostitute
- A woman who has sex at a temple
- And a divorced woman

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses to talk to the priests. Yahweh also calls the priests the sons of Aaron, because Aaron's male descendants will be the priests. Yahweh will not allow any priest to make himself unclean

in order to bury and mourn a dead person the priest is related to, except the priest's closest family members. Yahweh lists the closest family members of a priest: the priest's mother, father, any sons, any daughters, any brothers, and any sisters who have not married a man yet. A priest may defile himself for his sister who has not married a man yet because the sister depends on her brother, the priest, since the sister has no husband. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that I cannot mourn like other people do when any of my grandparents or cousins die; or
- I am glad that Yahweh will let me deeply mourn when my closest family members die; or
- I know that I am really special, and I cannot let myself become ritually dirty unless the reason is really important; or
- This law will be very hard to obey, especially when a friend of mine dies and I cannot mourn as other people mourn. I trust that Yahweh has a good reason for this law, though.

Continue the drama. But a priest must not profane himself and make himself ritually dirty for someone who is related to the priest only by marriage

In the second scene, Yahweh will not allow a priest to make bald spots on the priest's head. Yahweh also will not allow a priest to cut the edges of the priest's beard. Yahweh also will not allow any priest to cut himself. Yahweh says that the priests will be holy, or special, to the God that the priests serve, who is Yahweh. Yahweh will not allow the priests to profane Yahweh's name, or Yahweh's reputation, because the priests offer the fire offerings the Israelites make to Yahweh by burning the sacrifices. Yahweh calls these fire offerings the food that belongs to the Israelites' God. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The priests are really special to me, so people will see how the priests act and learn more about who I am and the respect I deserve; or
- I need people to realize how good and powerful I am; or
- I want the priests to act differently from everyone else so people will know I am different than everyone else.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh will not allow any priest to marry a prostitute or a woman who has sex at a temple. Yahweh will also not allow any priest to marry a woman whose husband has divorced her. Yahweh says that the priests cannot marry any of these women because the priests are holy to Yahweh, who is the God the priests serve. Then, Yahweh says the Israelites need to treat the priests like the priests are holy, or special, since the priests offer the food to the God the Israelites serve. Yahweh says that the Israelites will consider the priests holy because Yahweh, who made the Israelites holy, is holy himself. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am amazed that the priests have to follow all these rules! These rules are very different than the rules that other gods' priests must follow; or
- I know that the priests are different because of how the priests act; or
- Yahweh's priests are really special, so Yahweh must be really special.

Continue the drama. In the fourth scene, Yahweh says that when a priest's daughter profanes herself by becoming a prostitute, the daughter profanes her father. Yahweh tells the Israelites to burn any daughter of a priest who becomes a prostitute. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I would be so deeply sad if my daughter acted like this! I will be very careful to teach my daughters that they must not do this; or
- I would be very angry if my daughter acted like that! My daughters would know who Yahweh is because I serve Yahweh. My daughters would know how wrong it is to be a prostitute! or
- This is a very strong punishment! This shows me how terrible it is to sin against our God!

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 21:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, **Yahweh** speaks to Moses. Yahweh is the personal name that the one true God gave to the Israelites to call God. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh tells Moses to speak to the **priests**. The priests are the people Yahweh chose to offer sacrifices to Yahweh for the Israelites. The priests also take care of the Tent of Meeting and teach the people how to worship Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for priests as you used in previous passages. For more information on priests, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh will not allow the priests to **defile** themselves, or make themselves unclean for a dead person. When someone is unclean or ritually dirty, that person cannot participate in ritual worship to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for defile as you used in previous passages. For more information on defile, and **clean and unclean**, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh will allow the priests to become ritually dirty for a close relative. This includes the priest's mother, father, sons, daughters, brothers, and unmarried sisters.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about **close relatives** here. Pause this audio here.

If a priest defiles himself for one of his wife's relatives, the priest will **profane** himself. When someone profanes something, that person takes something that is holy and mistreats that thing. That person makes the holy thing common or unholy. Use the same word or phrase for profane as you used in previous passages. For more information on profane, refer to the Master Glossary.

The priests need to be **holy**, or special, to Yahweh. Any person, place, or object that someone dedicates or devotes to God is holy. Use the same word or phrase for holy as you used in previous passages. For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh is the **God** the priests serve. In the Bible, "God" refers to the God who created everything. God is the most powerful spiritual being. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary.

The priests **approach** the altar to offer fire offerings to Yahweh. Use the same phrase for approaching the altar as you used in previous passages.

The **fire offerings** are food that belongs to Yahweh. An offering is a gift or a sacrifice that people give in a ritual to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for fire offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on "fire offering," refer to the Master Glossary.

A priest cannot marry a woman whose husband divorced her. Divorce is a permanent and legal separation between a husband and a wife.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **divorce**. Look at "divorce" in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, discuss if you can use the same word or phrase here.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 21:1–9

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (847 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 21:10–16

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 21:10–15 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 21:10–15 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 21:10–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In previous passages, Yahweh told Moses rules that priests needed to follow because the priests were holy. In this passage, Yahweh tells Moses the rules that the high priest needs to follow about when the high priest mourns dead relatives and when the high priest marries. The high priest is the most important priest because the high priest is the only person whom Yahweh allows to go into the Most Holy Place. This was the place where Yahweh himself lived, where the ark of the covenant was. At that time, Aaron was the high priest. After Aaron died, one of Aaron's sons became the high priest, and that tradition continued for hundreds of years.

Yahweh describes the high priest in three ways. First, Yahweh says that the high priest is more important than the high priest's brothers. The high priest's brothers are all the other priests, or other descendants of Aaron. The high priest is more important because Yahweh gives the high priest more responsibility to help the Israelites than Yahweh gives the other priests. Second, Yahweh says that someone poured anointing oil on the high priest's head. Anointing oil was a special oil, probably olive oil, that people would pour onto someone's head in a ritual

that gave the person a special job or role. In this case, before someone became a high priest, someone else needed to pour anointing oil on the new high priest's head. We do not know who poured the oil on the high priest's head. Third, Yahweh says that Yahweh chose the high priest to wear the clothes. Yahweh is talking about the special clothes that Yahweh told Moses to make for the high priest when Yahweh gave Moses all the instructions for how people should build the tabernacle. The high priest needs to wear these clothes every time the high priest does a ritual for God.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the high priest's clothes. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think about a very important religious or political leader in your culture. Describe this person to each other, and pay attention to the things about this person that you feel are important to say. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will not allow the high priest to make the high priest's hair messy. Yahweh also might mean that Yahweh will not allow the high priest's hair to be loose. People in Israel and other people groups probably liked to keep their hair clean and neat, and might have also used string or other materials to hold the hair together. When people wanted to mourn someone who had died, people would make their hair not neat, but instead messy. Yahweh does not want the high priest to do this to his hair, even when the high priest wants to mourn someone who died.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people do with their hair? What special situations cause people to do something different with their hair? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also will not allow the priest to tear the high priest's clothes. When people in Israel wanted to express a strong emotion like grief, people would often tear their clothes. Yahweh does not want the high priest to tear the high priest's clothes like other Israelites do.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time someone mourned a person who died who had been a close friend or family member. What did the person do to show that they were mourning the dead person? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will not allow the high priest to go where there is a dead body, because if the high priest goes near a dead body, the high priest will become unclean or ritually dirty. Yahweh will not even allow the high priest to become ritually dirty if the high priest's father or mother died. Yahweh will not allow the high priest to leave the holy place, or the tabernacle, to mourn a person who has died. If the high priest leaves the sanctuary to mourn a person who has died, the high priest is mistreating Yahweh's sanctuary and is making the sanctuary less holy. The high priest mistreats the sanctuary because someone anointed the high priest with oil to be in the sanctuary for Yahweh. Yahweh tells the Israelites that he is Yahweh.

Then Yahweh tells Moses that Yahweh will only allow the high priest to marry a woman who is a virgin, or who has not had sex with a man. Yahweh will not allow a high priest to marry a widow, a divorced woman, a woman who has sex at a temple, or a prostitute. Sometimes, women who worshiped other gods besides Yahweh would work at a temple that was not Yahweh's. Men would go to the temple, and the women would have sex with the men as part of a ritual to worship the god. Yahweh calls these women defiled. Yahweh requires the high priest to marry a virgin who is one of the high priest's own people. Yahweh might mean that the high priest needs to marry a priest's daughter, but Yahweh probably means that the high priest needs to marry an Israelite. If the high priest does not marry one of the high priest's own people, the high priest will profane his children. In other words, the high priest will make the high priest's children be not holy. Yahweh will not allow the high priest to do this because of who Yahweh is and how Yahweh made the high priest holy.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 21:10–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh says that Yahweh will not allow the high priest to mourn people who have died.

In the second scene: Yahweh says that Yahweh will only allow a high priest to marry a woman who is both a virgin and an Israelite.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- The high priest
- The priests
- The high priest's parents
- A woman whose husband has died
- A woman whose husband divorced her
- A woman who has sex at a temple
- A prostitute
- And a virgin woman who is an Israelite

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that in the previous passage, Yahweh has been telling Moses to tell the priests the rules priests must obey when they mourn or marry. In this passage, Yahweh talks about the rules a high priest specifically has to follow.

In the first scene, Yahweh describes the high priest in three ways. Yahweh is about to give very difficult rules for the high priest to follow, so Yahweh wants the priests to realize why the high priest needs to follow these rules. First, the high priest is more important than his "brothers," or the other priests. Second, someone poured anointing oil on the high priest's head. Third, Yahweh chose the high priest to wear the special clothes that a high priest has to wear.

Then Yahweh says that Yahweh will not allow the high priest to make his hair messy or tear his clothes. Yahweh also will not allow the high priest to get near a dead body, even if the dead body is the high priest's mother or father. If the high priest gets near a dead body, the high priest will become ritually dirty. The high priest will not be able to serve Yahweh while the high priest is ritually dirty. Yahweh will not allow the high priest to leave the holy place, or the tabernacle, to mourn someone who has died. This does not mean the high priest can never leave, but only that the high priest cannot leave to go mourn somewhere. If the high priest leaves the holy place to mourn someone who has died, the high priest will mistreat the holy place. The high priest will make the holy place less holy, because when someone poured the anointing oil on the high priest, then the high priest became holy. Yahweh tells the priests Yahweh's name. Yahweh's name reminds people of who Yahweh is, so Yahweh often states his name to remind people that Yahweh is holy.

In the second scene, Yahweh tells the priests that Yahweh will only allow the high priest to marry a woman who is a virgin. Then, Yahweh gives a list of women who are not virgins: widows, divorced women, women who have sex at temples, and prostitutes. Sometimes, women would work at false gods' temples and have sex with men who came to worship at the temple as part of a ritual. Yahweh calls these women defiled, and Yahweh will not allow the high priest to marry any of these women. Yahweh also tells the high priest that the virgin the high priest marries needs to be an Israelite, or the high priest's children will not be holy like the other priests' children. Yahweh will not allow the high priest to marry in the wrong way because Yahweh is Yahweh and Yahweh makes the high priest holy.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What kinds of women can the high priest marry? What kinds of women can the high priest not marry? How do you describe the kind of woman that the high priest can marry in your culture? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 21:10–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 21:10–16

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- The high priest
- The priests
- The high priest's parents
- A woman whose husband has died
- A woman whose husband divorced her
- A woman who has sex at a temple
- A prostitute
- And a virgin woman who is an Israelite

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh describes the high priest in three ways. First, the high priest is more important than the other priests. Second, someone poured anointing oil on the high priest's head. Third, Yahweh chose the high priest to wear the special clothes that a high priest has to wear. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the high priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so happy that Yahweh has chosen me to be so special; or
- I know that I need to do the right thing because of how important I am.

Continue the drama. Then, Yahweh says that Yahweh will not allow the high priest to make the high priest's hair messy or tear his clothes. Yahweh also will not allow the high priest to get near a dead body, even if the dead body is the high priest's mother or father. If the high priest gets near a dead body, then the high priest will become ritually dirty, and the high priest will not be able to serve Yahweh while the high priest is ritually dirty. Yahweh will not allow the high priest to leave the holy place, or the tabernacle, to mourn someone who has died. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the high priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that I cannot mourn even my parents; or
- I know I need to keep doing my job for Yahweh even though someone close to me died.

Continue the drama. If the high priest leaves the holy place to mourn someone who has died, the high priest will mistreat the holy place and will make it less holy, because when someone poured the anointing oil on the high priest, then the high priest became holy. Yahweh tells the priests that Yahweh is Yahweh.

In the second scene, Yahweh tells the priests that Yahweh will only allow the high priest to marry a woman who is a virgin. So Yahweh will not allow the high priest to marry a widow, a divorced woman, a woman who has sex at temples, or a prostitute. These are two different scenarios where women have sex, one which involves rituals to honor other gods, and one where women have sex for money. Yahweh calls both kinds of these women defiled. Yahweh also tells the high priest that the virgin the high priest marries needs to be an Israelite, or the high priest's children will not be holy like the other priests' children. Yahweh will not allow the high priest to do that because Yahweh is Yahweh and Yahweh made the high priest holy. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want the high priest to be completely holy because the high priest is so important to me and to the Israelites; or
- I love my people and want their high priest to be careful who he marries.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 21:10–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh talks about the **high priest**. **Priests** are people who are responsible for offering sacrifices to God on behalf of the Israelites. The high priest was the most important priest. Use the same words or phrases for priests and high priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on high priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh talks about the **anointing** oil. In the Old Testament, before God gave someone a special task, God would instruct someone else to pour oil over that person's head. Use the same word or phrase for anoint as you used in previous passages. For more information on anoint, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that Yahweh will not allow the high priest to make himself **unclean** or **ritually dirty**. When someone is unclean, that person cannot participate in worship to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for unclean as you used in previous passages. For more information on clean and unclean, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh will not allow the high priest to leave the **sanctuary**, or tabernacle, to mourn someone who died. Use the same word or phrase for sanctuary, or holy place, as you used in previous passages. For more information on sanctuary, refer to the Master Glossary.

If the high priest leaves the sanctuary, the high priest will **profane** the sanctuary. When someone profanes something, that person mistreats something that is holy and makes it common or unholy. Use the same word or phrase for profane as you used in previous passages. For more information on profane, refer to the Master Glossary.

When someone poured the anointing oil on the high priest's head, that person **consecrated** the high priest, or made him holy. Use the same word or phrase for consecrate as you have used previously, and refer to consecrate in the Master Glossary for more information.

Yahweh says that if the high priest leaves the sanctuary, the high priest will profane the sanctuary of **God**. Use the same word for God as you used in previous passages. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh emphasizes that he is **Yahweh**. Yahweh says this to remind the people that Yahweh and Yahweh's people are special. Use the same word for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 21:10–16

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (847 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 21:17–25

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 21:16–24 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 21:16–24 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 21:16–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passages, Yahweh told Moses to tell the priests the rules to follow when a priest mourned someone or married someone. In this passage, Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron, the high priest and the ancestor of all Israel's priests, who Yahweh will allow to offer food offerings to Yahweh. Yahweh will not allow any of Aaron's descendants who have a physical problem or defect to go to Yahweh and offer Yahweh food. When Yahweh talks about offering food, Yahweh is talking about the sacrifices that the priests made to Yahweh on behalf of themselves and the Israelites.

Yahweh will not allow any of Aaron's descendants who have a long-term physical problem of some kind to go offer food to Yahweh at the tabernacle. Yahweh will not allow a priest who is blind or unable to walk to offer food to Yahweh. Yahweh also will not allow a priest whose face is deformed in any way or whose limbs are too long to offer food to Yahweh. Yahweh also will not let a priest whose hand or foot is broken in some way offer food to Yahweh. Yahweh also will not let someone with a hunchback or someone who is unusually small offer

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food to Yahweh. When someone has a hunchback, their back curves forward a lot. It makes that person walk differently and can cause that person pain.

Stop here and look at this picture of a person with a hunchback. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also will not allow a priest with something wrong with his eyes, skin, or testicles to offer food to Yahweh. Then, Yahweh says again that Yahweh will not allow any of Aaron's descendants who have something physically wrong with them to offer the offerings to Yahweh by fire. When Yahweh talks about offering the food by fire, Yahweh is talking about the way the priests offer food to Yahweh. The priests burn offerings on the altar in the courtyard of the tabernacle.

Stop here and look at a picture of the altar in the courtyard at the tabernacle. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people treat people who have something physically wrong with them? What does the community not allow people to do when those people have something physically wrong with them? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will allow the priest who has something physically wrong with him to eat Yahweh's food. When Yahweh talks about Yahweh's food here, Yahweh is talking about the food that the Israelites give to Yahweh when the Israelites tithe or when the Israelites make sacrifices. Yahweh then gives most of that food to the priests to eat. Yahweh expects the priests to eat that food to survive rather than doing other work to get food. Yahweh also wants the priests who have something physically wrong with them to eat from that same food to survive. Yahweh allows the priests who have something wrong with them to eat the most holy food and the holy food. The most holy food probably refers to the food that people gave the priests when the Israelites made a sacrifice. The holy food probably refers to the food the Israelites gave the priests when the Israelites tithed, when the Israelites offered the firstborn animals, and when the Israelites offered the first crops of a harvest. Yahweh does not stop the priests who have something physically wrong with them from eating any of the food Yahweh allows a normal priest to eat.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people take care of people who have something physically wrong with them? Pause this audio here.

However, Yahweh will not allow the priests with something physically wrong to go near the curtain that separates the Most Holy Place from the Holy Place inside the tabernacle. Yahweh probably will not allow the priests who have something physically wrong with them to enter the Holy Place in the tabernacle at all.

Stop here as a group and look at this diagram of the tabernacle. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also will not allow the priests who have something physically wrong with them to go close to the altar where the priests burn the sacrifices to Yahweh. If a priest who has something physically wrong with him does go near the curtain or the altar, that priest will profane, or mistreat, the holy places in the tabernacle, and make those places not holy. Yahweh tells the priests to obey these rules because he is Yahweh and Yahweh made the priests and the holy places in the tabernacle holy.

Then Moses tells Aaron and Aaron's sons and all the Israelites everything that Yahweh told Moses to say.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 21:16–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron what physical deformities will prevent a priest from offering food to Yahweh.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron that Yahweh will allow the priests who have something physically wrong with them to eat the holy food. However, Yahweh will not allow those priests with something physically wrong with them to be in the holy places.

In the third scene: Moses repeats Yahweh's words to Aaron and the Israelites.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The priests
- The priests who have something physically wrong with them
- And the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that in previous passages, Yahweh told Moses to tell the priests the rules to obey when the priests mourned people who had died and when the priests married women. In this passage, Yahweh is still giving rules for the priests to obey. Here, Yahweh is giving the rules the priests must obey when a priest has something physically wrong with them.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses to talk to Aaron. The storyteller of Leviticus reminds us that Yahweh is talking to Moses because Yahweh is now changing to a different subject. Now Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron that Yahweh will not allow any of Aaron's descendants who have something physically wrong with them to come to Yahweh and offer food to Yahweh.

Stop the audio here and discuss this question: Describe a person in your culture who has something physically wrong with that person. What words do you use to describe that person's condition? What words will you use to translate this idea? Pause this audio here.

When Yahweh talks about offering food to Yahweh, Yahweh is also referring to the entire work that the priests do. Yahweh will not allow a priest who has something physically wrong with him to do the jobs that Yahweh gave to the priests to do.

In this passage, though Yahweh is speaking to Moses, Yahweh speaks as if Yahweh is speaking directly to Aaron and the Israelites. You should also translate the parts where Yahweh is speaking as if Yahweh is speaking directly to Aaron and the Israelites, if possible.

Then Yahweh lists the different types of physical problems a priest can have. Yahweh will not allow any priest who is blind or unable to walk, or who has a deformity on their face, to come near Yahweh in the tabernacle. Yahweh also will not allow any priest who has a limb that is too long, who has a broken foot or a broken hand, who has a hunchback, or who is unusually short to come near Yahweh in the tabernacle. Someone who has a hunchback cannot walk or stand upright because that person's spine is curved. Yahweh also will not allow someone who has something wrong with their eyes, skin, or testicles to come near to Yahweh in the tabernacle.

Stop this audio here and discuss as a group: What words do you use for these kinds of physical problems? How will you translate this part of the passage into your language? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh says again that Yahweh will not allow any of Aaron's descendants to get close to Yahweh to give the offerings with fire. Yahweh calls Aaron "the priest" here to remind the Israelites that Aaron is the first priest and the ancestor of all the priests. Then Yahweh says again that if a priest has something physically wrong with him, Yahweh will not allow that priest to go close to Yahweh to offer food to Yahweh.

In the second scene, Yahweh says that Yahweh will allow a priest who has something wrong with him to eat food that the Israelites offer to Yahweh. Yahweh allows the priest to eat the most holy food and the food that is holy. The holy food is probably the food that people give to Yahweh as a tithe, and the most holy food is probably the food that the people offer as a sacrifice to Yahweh. But Yahweh will not allow a priest who has something physically wrong with him to go near the curtain to the holiest place or the altar because there is something physically wrong with that priest. If the priest with something physically wrong with him does go near the curtain or the altar, that priest will profane, or mistreat, the holy places in the tabernacle and make those places common, or not holy. Yahweh will not allow a priest who has something physically wrong with him to profane the sanctuary, or holy places, in the tabernacle because Yahweh is Yahweh and Yahweh makes the holy places and the priests holy.

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Then, in the third scene, Moses tells Aaron and Aaron's sons and all the people of Israel what Yahweh told Moses about all the rules for the priests. This includes information from previous passages regarding rules for the priests.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text
Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 21:16–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The priests
- The priests who have something physically wrong with them
- And the Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses to talk to Aaron. Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron that Yahweh will not allow any of Aaron's descendants who have something physically wrong with them to come to Yahweh and offer food to Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priests, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that I will not be able to offer food to Yahweh if I have something physically wrong with me; or
- Yahweh is really special and holy if the priests cannot have any physical problems to serve Yahweh; or
- I am glad Yahweh is telling us exactly what Yahweh wants us to do when we have something physically wrong with us.

Continue the drama. Yahweh will not allow any priest who is blind, who is unable to walk, or who has a deformity on their face to come near Yahweh in the tabernacle. Yahweh also will not allow any priest who has a limb that is too long, who has a broken foot or a broken hand, who has a hunchback, or who is unusually short to come near Yahweh in the tabernacle. Yahweh also will not allow someone who has something wrong with their eyes, skin, or testicles to come near to Yahweh in the tabernacle. Then Yahweh says again that Yahweh will not allow any of Aaron's descendants who have a defect to come close to Yahweh to offer the offerings with fire. Then Yahweh says again that if the priest has something physically wrong with him, Yahweh will not allow that priest to come close to Yahweh to offer food or fire offerings to Yahweh.

In the second scene, Yahweh allows a priest who has something wrong with him to eat food that the Israelites offer to Yahweh. Yahweh allows the priest to eat the holiest food and the food that is just holy. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I love these priests who have something physically wrong with them, so I am going to make sure the Israelites take care of these priests; or
- I really want everyone in Israel to have enough food to eat, even if those people cannot work as other people do; or
- Even though these priests have something physically wrong with them, the priests are holy, so I will take care of those priests.

Continue the drama. But Yahweh will not allow a priest who has something physically wrong with him to go near the curtain to the holiest place or the altar because there is something physically wrong with that priest. If the priest with something physically wrong with him does go near the curtain or the altar, that priest will profane, or mistreat, the sanctuary, or holy places in the tabernacle and will make those places less holy. Yahweh will not allow a priest who has something physically wrong with him to mistreat the holy places in the tabernacle because Yahweh is Yahweh and Yahweh made the holy places and the priests holy. Then, Moses tells Aaron and Aaron's sons and all the people of Israel what Yahweh told Moses.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 21:16–24 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, **Yahweh** speaks to Moses. Yahweh is the personal name that the one true God gave the Israelites to call God. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh also describes himself as **God** in this passage. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh talks about Aaron's **descendants**. A person's descendants are his children, grandchildren, and all future **generations** from the same family line. Use the same words or phrases for descendants and generations as you used in previous passages. For more information on descendants and generations, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh calls Aaron a **priest**. Priests are people who are responsible for offering sacrifices to God on behalf of the Israelites. Use the same word or phrase for priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on priests, refer to the Master Glossary.

In this passage, Yahweh talks about the priests who have a physical problem. These physical problems may include someone who is blind, unable to walk, whose face is deformed in any way, or whose limbs are too long, whose hand or foot is broken, or who has a hunchback. They may also include anyone with open sores or anyone with damaged testicles.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about the **physical problems** that keep a priest from offering fire offerings to Yahweh. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh allows priests who have something physically wrong with them to eat the most **holy** and the holy food. Any place, person, or object that is dedicated to God is holy. That means that God sets apart the object or person for God's special purposes. That person and object are no longer "common" or "ordinary," and people can no longer use those things for common or ordinary purposes. Use the same word or phrase for holy as you used in previous passages. For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh will not allow a person who has something physically wrong with them to go near the **altar** to offer **fire offerings** to Yahweh. You will remember that the fire offerings are the animals that the Israelites burned on the altar as food for Yahweh. The altar is a large bronze platform that the Israelites used to make sacrifices to Yahweh. Use the same words or phrases for altar and fire offerings as you used in previous passages. For more information on altar and fire offerings, refer to the Master Glossary.

If a priest who has something physically wrong with him does go near the altar, that priest will **profane** Yahweh's **sanctuary**. The word sanctuary means a holy place, so it is another name for Yahweh's tabernacle or Tent of Meeting. When someone profanes something, that person mistreats the item and makes that item unholy. Use

the same words or phrases for profane and sanctuary as you used in previous passages. For more information on profane and sanctuary, refer to the Master Glossary.

Moses said these things to Aaron, Aaron's sons, and to all the **Israelites**. Use the same word or phrase for Israelites as you have used previously, and refer to Israelites in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

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Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (856 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.1 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 22:1–9

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 22:1–9 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:1–9 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.

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5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In previous passages, Yahweh has been telling Moses how the priests need to act when the priests mourn someone, when the priests marry someone, and when the priests have a long-term physical defect. In this passage, Yahweh starts to tell Moses who can eat the sacred food Yahweh gives to the priests.

Yahweh tells Moses to talk to Aaron and Aaron's sons, who are the priests. Yahweh probably says that Yahweh wants Moses to tell Aaron and the priests when to stay away from holy food, or food that is dedicated to Yahweh. Yahweh might be saying that Yahweh wants Moses to tell Aaron and the priests to treat the holy food with respect. The holy food is the food that the Israelites consecrate, or dedicate, to Yahweh. The priests receive this holy food from the Israelites, and Yahweh gives some of this food to the priests to eat. The priests need to treat the food in the right way.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what food do people consider special? What rules do people have to follow about that food? Pause this audio here.

If the priests do not stay away from the holy food when Yahweh says to, the priests will profane Yahweh's holy name. The priests will dishonor Yahweh by making other people think that Yahweh is not completely good and powerful. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh is Yahweh.

Then Yahweh tells Moses to tell the priests that if a priest comes close to the sacred donations while the priest is unclean or ritually dirty, Yahweh will not allow that priest to go to the holy place and serve Yahweh as a priest anymore. Yahweh is not just talking about the priests who are alive while Moses is talking to the priests. Yahweh is talking about all his priests, including those who will serve Yahweh in the future. Yahweh reminds the priests again that he is Yahweh.

Then, Yahweh says that none of Aaron's descendants, who are the priests, can eat the holy donations of food if those descendants have a serious skin disease or if something abnormal is coming out of their penis. Those descendants need to wait until the descendants are ritually clean before they can eat the holy food. Yahweh says that the descendants cannot eat the holy food while ritually dirty. A priest can become ritually dirty if the priest touches something a dead body touched, if the priest has semen come out of his penis, or if the priest touches a ritually dirty small animal or insect. A priest can also become ritually dirty if a priest touches a person who will make other people ritually dirty, no matter why that person is ritually dirty. If a priest does any of these things, then the priest will be ritually dirty until evening, and Yahweh will not allow the priest to eat the holy food. The priest who becomes ritually dirty for any of these reasons needs to wash his body in water before the priest can eat the holy food again. After the priest has washed his body in water, and after the sun has set, then the priest will be able to eat the holy food again.

Yahweh will not allow the priests to eat an animal that died on its own or because another animal killed it. The priests can only eat animals that a person kills. If the priest eats an animal that died when a human did not kill that animal, then the priest will become ritually dirty. Yahweh reminds the priests that he is Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kind of dead animals will you eat? What kind will you not eat? How do people treat animals that died when a human did not kill the animals? What do people do with those animals? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh tells Moses that the priests need to do the things Yahweh tells the priests to do. If the priests do not do the things Yahweh tells the priests to do, then the priests will become guilty because they have sinned. The priests will die because the priests profaned something holy to Yahweh. Yahweh is probably talking about how the priests profane the holy food. Yahweh might be talking about how the priests profane the things Yahweh told the priests to do. Then Yahweh reminds the priests that he is Yahweh, and Yahweh makes the priests holy.

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Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses to tell the priests not to eat the holy food while the priests are ritually dirty.

In the second scene: Yahweh talks about different things that could make a priest ritually dirty and explains when the priests can become clean and eat the food again.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells the priests not to eat food from animals that humans did not kill.

In the fourth scene: Yahweh reminds the priests that they should do what Yahweh tells the priests to do because Yahweh is the one who is holy, and Yahweh is the one who makes the priests holy.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The priests
- Israelites
- And a person who is ritually dirty

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that in this section of Leviticus, Yahweh is telling Moses the rules the priests must obey. In the previous passages, Yahweh told Moses the rules for the priests when the priests marry someone or mourn someone, and the rules Yahweh has for priests who have something physically wrong with them.

In this passage, Yahweh begins to tell Moses that Yahweh will not allow the priests to eat the holy food when the priests are unclean or ritually dirty.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses to talk to Aaron and Aaron's sons, the priests. Yahweh does not use the term for priests in this passage, but we know that Aaron's sons refer to Aaron's male descendants, who are the priests in Israel. You may need to use your term for priests in this passage to be clear about who Yahweh is talking about. Aaron and Aaron's sons need to sometimes stay away from the holy food that the Israelites dedicate to Yahweh. Yahweh is talking about the times when the priests need to avoid eating the holy food that the Israelites give to Yahweh, and then when Yahweh allows the priests to eat. If the priests eat the holy food when Yahweh does not want the priests to, then the priests will profane, or mistreat, Yahweh's name. When Yahweh says the priests will mistreat Yahweh's name, Yahweh is using special language to mean that the priests profane, or dishonor, Yahweh by making other people think that Yahweh is not completely good and powerful.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way for you to translate when Yahweh tells the priests to stay away from the holy food? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the priests that he is Yahweh. When Yahweh says that he is Yahweh, Yahweh is giving the reason why the Israelites should follow Yahweh's rules.

Then Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron and the priests that if any of the priests or their descendants are ritually dirty, those people cannot go close to the holy food that the Israelites dedicated to Yahweh. If a priest does go close to the holy food when ritually dirty, then Yahweh will cut that priest off from Yahweh's presence. Yahweh says that the priests must follow this rule for all generations, which means that any priests in the future must also follow this rule. When Yahweh says Yahweh will cut that priest off from Yahweh's presence, Yahweh is using special language to mean that Yahweh will not allow the priests to do the jobs that a priest should do, like

offering sacrifices to Yahweh. Then Yahweh says again that he is Yahweh. Yahweh is reminding the Israelites that Yahweh is their holy God.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when someone did their work in a wrong way so that people did not allow that person to work that job ever again. How would you describe how other people stopped that person from doing that job? What is the best way for you to translate the way that Yahweh says Yahweh will cut the priests off from Yahweh's presence? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh gives several examples of situations where a priest would be ritually dirty. The first two situations would make a priest ritually dirty for a long time, and the next four situations would make a priest ritually dirty until evening. In the first two situations, Yahweh will not allow any of Aaron's descendants, who are the priests, who have a serious skin disease or who have something abnormal coming out of their penis, to eat the holy food until the priests are ritually clean. There are four more situations that make a priest ritually dirty, but in these cases, the priest will just be ritually dirty until evening. This is when a priest touches something that a corpse has made ritually dirty, and when a priest has semen come out of his penis. This also includes when a priest touches a ritually dirty animal or insect, and when a priest touches a ritually dirty person. Any of Aaron's descendants who do any of those things will be ritually dirty until evening. Yahweh will not allow any ritually dirty priest to eat the holy food until the priest washes his body in water. Yahweh wants Aaron's descendants to eat the holy food because that is their food. Yahweh is telling the Israelites this because even though Yahweh does not want the priests to eat food when the priests are ritually dirty, Yahweh does want the priests to eat the food that Yahweh gives the priests.

In the third scene, Yahweh will not allow the priests to eat animals that died without a human killing the animal, or that other animals killed. If the priests eat those animals, the priests will become ritually dirty.

In the fourth scene, Yahweh says again that he is Yahweh. Yahweh tells Moses that the priests need to do what Yahweh tells the priests to do. If the priests do not do what Yahweh tells the priests to do, the priests will carry their sin. This means that the priests will become guilty because the priests profaned the holy food and the priests will die. Yahweh says again that he is Yahweh and that Yahweh makes the priests holy.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How will you translate when Yahweh says that the priest will carry their sin? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- The priests
- Israelites
- And a person who is ritually dirty

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses to talk to Aaron and Aaron's sons. Yahweh promised that Aaron and Aaron's sons would be the priests who would make sacrifices to Yahweh for the Israelites. Aaron and Aaron's sons need to sometimes stay away from the holy food that the Israelites dedicate to Yahweh. If the priests eat the holy food when Yahweh does not want the priests to, then the priests will mistreat Yahweh's name. Yahweh tells the priests that he is Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want people to know that I am completely good and powerful; or
- The priests need to be really careful when the priests eat the holy food.

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron and the priests that if any of the priests or their descendants are ritually dirty, those people cannot come close to the holy food that the Israelites dedicated to Yahweh. If a priest does come close to the holy food when the priest is ritually dirty, then Yahweh will not allow that priest to serve Yahweh as a priest anymore. Then Yahweh says again that he is Yahweh.

In the second scene, Yahweh explains when Yahweh will not allow a priest, one of Aaron's descendants, to eat the holy food until that priest is clean. Yahweh will not let a priest eat the holy food when the priest has a serious skin disease or if the priest has something abnormal coming out of his penis. Then, Yahweh talks about anyone who touches something that a corpse made ritually dirty, anyone who has semen come out of his penis, anyone who touches a small animal or bug that makes someone ritually dirty, and anyone who touches a person who can make people ritually dirty. Yahweh says that any of Aaron's descendants who do any of those things will be ritually dirty until evening. Yahweh will not allow the person to eat the holy food until that person washes their body in water. Then Yahweh says again that when the sun sets, the person will be ritually clean and that person can eat the holy food. Yahweh wants Aaron's descendants to eat the holy food because that is their food. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the priests, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that I have to wait until sunset before I can eat the holy food because I am ritually dirty; or
- I am so glad that Yahweh is letting me eat the holy food people are giving to Yahweh; or
- I know how important it is for me to be clean when I eat the holy food.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh will not allow the priests to eat animals that people did not kill or that other animals killed. If the priests eat those animals, the priests will become ritually dirty. Yahweh says again that he is Yahweh.

In the fourth scene, Yahweh tells Moses that the priests need to do what Yahweh told the priests to do. If the priests do not do what Yahweh has told the priests to do, the priests will become guilty because the priests profaned the holy food, and the priests will die. Yahweh says again that he is Yahweh and that Yahweh makes the priests holy.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, **Yahweh** talks to Moses. Yahweh is the personal name that the one true God gave to the Israelites to call God. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Leviticus 22:1–9

Yahweh talks about the **holy** food, or offerings. When something is holy, someone has dedicated it to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for holy as you used in previous passages. For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary.

Someone has **consecrated** the holy food to Yahweh. When someone consecrates something, someone has set that thing apart for a special purpose. Use the same word or phrase for consecrate as you used in the previous passages. For more information on consecrate, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh does not want the Israelites to **profane** Yahweh's name. When a person profanes something, that person takes something holy and mistreats it and makes it not holy. Use the same word or phrase for profane as you used in previous passages. For more information on profane, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh tells the priests that these rules are for the **priests** and their **descendants**. Yahweh does not use the term for priests in this passage, but Aaron's male descendants are the priests. You may need to use your term for priests in this passage to be clear. A person's children, grandchildren, and all future children from the same family line are that person's descendants. Use the same words for priests and descendants as you used in previous passages. For more information on priests and descendants, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says these rules are for all future **generations**. A generation refers to a group of people who are living at the same time and belong to about the same age group. When Yahweh says these rules are for all future generations, Yahweh means that the Israelites should follow these rules forever. For more on generations, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh does not want the priests to eat the holy food while the priests are **unclean** or ritually dirty. When someone is unclean, that person is unable to do things for Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for unclean as you used in previous passages. For more information on clean and unclean, refer to the Master Glossary.

One of the things that could make a priest ritually dirty is if the priest has a serious skin disease. Sometimes people call this disease **leprosy**, although you will remember that this is not the same disease that we call leprosy today. Use the same word or phrase for this kind of skin disease as you used in previous passages. For more information, refer to leprosy in the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that a person who does this will carry their **sin**. This means that the person is **guilty** for what the person has done. Use the same word or phrase for carrying sin as you used in previous passages. For more on sin and guilt, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 22:1–9

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (842 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 22:10–16

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 22:10–16 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:10–16 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, Yahweh told the priests who are ritually dirty not to eat the holy food that Yahweh gave to the priests to eat from the sacred food the Israelites offered. In this passage, Yahweh says that Yahweh will not allow people who are not in a priest's family to eat the holy food. Here, Yahweh is providing for the priest and those in the priest's household, who have no other way to get food. We can see from the rules Yahweh gives that the people Yahweh includes in a priest's household are those people who do not have anyone else to help them.

First, Yahweh says that only the priest's family can eat the holy food. Yahweh also says that Yahweh will not allow any person who is staying with a priest while the person is traveling to eat the holy food. When the Israelites traveled, the Israelites would rest or spend the night in other people's houses. People would often share food with travelers and help travelers.

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Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how often do people travel? Where do people stay when people travel? How do you take care of travelers or guests in your house? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also will not allow a worker that a priest has hired to eat the holy food. Sometimes, when an Israelite hired someone to do some work, the worker would live with the person they worked for. Yahweh does not want those workers to eat the holy food, even though those workers might live with the priest.

Leviticus 22:10–16

Yahweh will allow a slave that a priest bought to eat the holy food. Sometimes people had a lot of debt and had to sell themselves as slaves to pay off their debt. Other people became slaves when someone captured those people during a war. A priest's slaves were part of the priest's household. In other words, the priest was responsible for the slaves, and so Yahweh will allow a priest's slaves to eat the holy food.

Yahweh also will allow anyone born in a priest's household to eat the holy food. When Yahweh says a priest's household, Yahweh is using special language to talk about a priest's family and slaves. So Yahweh will allow the priest's children to eat the holy food, and Yahweh will allow the children of the slaves of the priest to eat the holy food.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, who is part of a person's household, or family? Pause this audio here.

If a priest's daughter marries a person who is not a priest, then Yahweh will not allow the daughter to eat the holy food, because the daughter is now part of her husband's family, not her father's family. Yahweh will allow a priest's daughter whose husband dies, or whose husband divorces the daughter, to eat the holy food. Yahweh will only allow this if the priest's daughter does not have any children. If the daughter has children, Yahweh expects the children to take care of their mother. If the priest's daughter does not have any children, she needs to move back to her father's house, where the daughter lived when she was young, and then Yahweh will allow the daughter to eat the holy food.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, when a woman marries a man, where does the woman live? Whose family is the woman now a part of? Who takes care of the woman? What happens to a wife when a husband dies? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says again that Yahweh will not allow anyone besides these people to eat the holy food.

Then Yahweh says that if an outsider eats the holy food without meaning to eat the holy food, then that person needs to give the priest something that is equal to the value of the food that the person ate. That person also needs to give the priest something that is worth an extra one-fifth, or 20 percent, of the food the person ate. Yahweh does not say if the person needs to pay with money or with food. Yahweh will probably allow a person to pay with money or food.

Then Yahweh says that Yahweh will not allow anyone to profane the holy food of the Israelites. When someone profanes the holy food, that person mistreats the food and makes the food not holy. The Israelites give this holy food to Yahweh. If the priests, or anyone, profane the holy food by allowing someone who is ritually dirty or not authorized to eat the holy food, then the person who eats the food will become guilty and will probably need to offer a guilt or reparation offering. We are not sure who eats the holy food—this may be the priests who eat it when they are ritually dirty, or this may be other people who eat the food that only the priests should eat.

Yahweh says that he is Yahweh, and Yahweh makes the food holy. Because Yahweh makes the food holy, the Israelites need to be careful not to profane the food.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells the priests that no one outside the priest's household can eat the holy food.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells the priests when the priests' daughters can eat the holy food.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites what to do if someone accidentally eats the holy food.

The characters in this passage are:

- People who can eat the holy food, who are

- A priest
- Members of the priest's household, which includes
- Slaves
- A priest's daughter
- People who cannot eat the holy food, such as
- A person who is not a priest or part of the priest's family
- A traveler staying with a priest
- A worker whom a priest has hired
- Yahweh
- And Moses—although the storyteller does not mention Moses in this passage, we know that Yahweh is giving these rules to Moses

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that in the last passage, Yahweh told the priests that Yahweh will not allow the priests to eat the holy food when the priests are ritually dirty. Now, in this passage, Yahweh explains who Yahweh will and will not allow to eat the holy food.

In the first scene, Yahweh will not allow a person who is an outsider, or is not in the priest's family, to eat the holy food. Guests and hired workers cannot eat the holy food, even though guests and hired workers might stay in the same house as the priest. But slaves and people born into a priest's house may eat the holy food. When Yahweh talks about a priest's house, Yahweh is using special language to talk about the people who would live in a priest's house because those people are part of a priest's closest family. This includes a priest's children, wife, slaves, and the slaves' children.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you talk about the people who live together in a household? Discuss how you want to translate the way Yahweh talks about people who are born in a priest's household. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh talks about a priest's daughter. If a priest's daughter marries someone who is not a priest, then Yahweh will not allow the daughter to eat the holy food. But if a priest's daughter becomes a divorced woman or a widow, and the daughter has no children who can take care of her, then the daughter can go back to her father and eat the holy food again. Then Yahweh says again that Yahweh will not allow any outsider to eat the holy food. Yahweh says this again because Yahweh wants the Israelites to remember this rule. The rest of the rules that Yahweh gives in this passage are just to help the Israelites understand how to obey this rule.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: Tell a story about a time someone gave one rule and then explained what people needed to do to follow that rule. Pay special attention to how the person emphasized how important this rule was. Pay attention also to how the person showed that everything the person said was about the original rule. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Yahweh gives an example of a person who eats the holy food but does not know it is holy food. In this situation, Yahweh tells the Israelites that the person needs to give the priest something that is as valuable as the holy food the person ate, plus one-fifth, or 20 percent, of the value of the food. This is a guilt offering, or a way to pay back for the wrong thing that person has done.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: In Leviticus 5:14–16, Yahweh talked about a guilt or reparation offering. In step three for that passage, you did an activity to see what 20 percent looks like. You had 10 items. Twenty percent of 10 items is 2, so you added those 2 items to the 10 to show what the whole value, plus 20 percent, looked like. If needed, review how you discussed and translated 20 percent in that passage and discuss how you will translate it in this passage. Pause this audio here.

In this final section, there is difficult wording that can make the passage difficult to understand. Yahweh probably is saying that Yahweh will not allow anyone to profane the holy food that the Israelites give to Yahweh. If someone does profane the holy food by eating the food when Yahweh does not want that person to, then that person will become guilty. That person will need to offer a guilt offering. Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to profane the holy food, or make it unholy, because he is Yahweh and Yahweh makes the food holy. Yahweh is

saying that because Yahweh makes the food holy, when the Israelites profane the food, the Israelites disrespect Yahweh.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text
Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- People who can eat the holy food, who are
- A priest
- Members of the priest's household, which includes
- Slaves
- A priest's daughter
- People who cannot eat the holy food, such as
- A person who is not a priest or part of the priest's family
- A traveler staying with a priest
- A worker whom a priest has hired
- Yahweh
- And Moses—although the storyteller does not mention Moses in this passage, we know that Yahweh is giving these rules to Moses

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh will not allow anyone who is not a part of a priest's family to eat the holy food. Yahweh will not allow any person who is staying with a priest while the person is traveling or any worker whom a priest has hired to eat the holy food. But if the priest buys someone as a slave, then Yahweh will allow that slave to eat the holy food. Also, if someone in the priest's family or household gives birth to someone, Yahweh will allow that new person to eat the holy food. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a traveler and the person playing a hired worker, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am surprised that the priest does not share food with me; or
- I can see that the priests are set apart because even their food is holy.

Ask the person playing a person the priest has bought, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that Yahweh will allow me to eat the holy food; or
- I am relieved that I and my children can have food; or
- I am a part of the priest's house, so I can eat what the priest's family eats; or
- Even my children can eat the holy food.

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Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh will not allow a priest's daughter to eat the holy food if the daughter is married to someone who is not a priest. But if the priest's daughter's husband dies or divorces the daughter and the daughter has no children, then the daughter can go back to her father's house. Yahweh will then allow the daughter to eat the holy food that people give to her father. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a priest's daughter, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- When I am married, I am no longer part of my father's family; or
- I am so glad that Yahweh will let me eat the holy food when I am at my father's house; or
- Yahweh is always making sure that someone takes care of me.

Continue the drama. Yahweh says again that Yahweh will not allow a person who is not in the priest's family to eat the holy food.

In the third scene, Yahweh talks about a person who eats the holy food when the person does not mean to eat the holy food. The person who does that needs to give the priest something that is as valuable as the food. The person also has to give the priest an additional amount that is as valuable as one-fifth, or 20 percent, of the holy food that the person ate. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a person who is not a priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- While I was staying at the priest's house, I ate some food on the table. I did not realize it was the holy food, not the food I could eat; or
- I am so sorry that I ate the holy food accidentally; or
- I am glad that Yahweh will let me make up for my mistake.

Continue the drama. Then, Yahweh says that Yahweh will not allow anyone to profane the holy food that the Israelites give to Yahweh. If someone does profane the holy food by eating the holy food when Yahweh does not want that person to, then that person will become guilty. Yahweh tells that person to offer a guilt offering because he is Yahweh and Yahweh makes the food holy. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want the Israelites to know how special this holy food is; or
- I want to give this food to the priests because the priests work for me; or
- I do not want people to think that I am not good and powerful because people do not respect my holy food.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:10–16 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh talks about the **holy** food, or offering to Yahweh. When something is holy, someone has dedicated that thing to Yahweh and it is special. Use the same word or phrase for holy as you used in previous passages. For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary.

Only the **priests** and their families are supposed to eat the holy food. A priest is a person who works in the tabernacle and helps the Israelites worship Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

A priest's hired workers may not eat the holy food. Hired workers are people the priest pays to work for him.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate the idea of **hired workers**. If you have translated this idea in another passage, translate it the same way here. Pause this audio here.

A priest's **slaves** may eat the holy food. A slave is a person who does work for someone else without payment, and who cannot leave when that person wants. Use the same word or phrase for slave as you used in previous passages. For more information on slaves, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh allows anyone in a priest's **household** to eat the holy food. A household means all the people living together in one house. Use the same word or phrase for household as you used in previous passages. For more information on household, refer to the Master Glossary.

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If a priest's daughter is **divorced** and goes back to live in her father's house, the daughter can eat the holy food. Divorce is a permanent and legal separation between husband and wife. Use the same word or phrase for divorce as you used in previous passages. For more information on divorce, refer to the Master Glossary.

If someone else eats the holy food, that person needs to offer a **guilt offering**. People made a guilt offering when people did something wrong that took value from Yahweh or someone else. Use the same word or phrase for guilt offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on guilt offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh does not want people to **profane** the holy food. When a person profanes something, that person mistreats something holy and makes that thing not holy. Use the same word or phrase for profane as you used in previous passages. For more information on profane, refer to the Master Glossary.

When someone profanes the holy food, Yahweh punishes that person because that person is guilty. Use the same word or phrase for **guilt** as you have used previously, and refer to guilt in the Master Glossary for more information.

The holy food is the food that belongs to **Yahweh**. Yahweh is the personal name that the one true God gave to the Israelites to call God. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 22:10–16

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (845 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 22:17–25

Leviticus 22:17–25

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 22:17–25 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:17–25 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:17–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passages, Yahweh told the Israelites the rules Yahweh had for the priests and the holy food. In this passage, Yahweh tells the Israelites the rules Yahweh has for sacrifices and offerings Yahweh will accept.

In the beginning of this passage, Yahweh tells Moses to talk to Aaron and Aaron's sons and all the people in Israel. Aaron and Aaron's sons are also Israelites, so Yahweh is talking to the Israelites and especially to Aaron and the rest of the priests. Yahweh tells Moses to say that when anyone who is an Israelite or someone who is living in Israel makes an offering, the offering needs to be physically perfect. The offering cannot have anything wrong with it. The offering could be payment for a vow, or it could be a freewill offering that someone sacrifices to Yahweh as a burnt offering. These offerings are offerings that people give when people want to or promise to, rather than offerings that Yahweh requires the people to give. These offerings are a type of peace or fellowship offering. For Yahweh to accept the offering, the offering needs to be completely perfect. The offering cannot have anything wrong with it. The offering needs to be cattle, sheep, or goats. Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to offer anything that has something wrong with it, because Yahweh will not accept it as an offering from the Israelites. When Yahweh accepts an offering from someone, Yahweh appreciates the offering and Yahweh strengthens his relationship with the person who made the sacrifice.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people think gods or spirits react to sacrifices that people make to the gods or spirits? Why would it be good that the spirits or gods accept the sacrifices? Pause this audio here.

Then, Yahweh says that when anyone offers a fellowship offering to Yahweh it needs to be completely perfect in every way. The offering needs to be perfect, whether it is bulls or sheep or goats. The offering also needs to be perfect if it is a fellowship offering to complete a vow or if it is a freewill offering. Yahweh is talking about animals with permanent physical problems, not animals that are sick for a short amount of time. Yahweh lists the reasons that an animal might not be physically perfect. If the animal is blind, or crippled, or severely cut, or if something is wrong with the animal's skin in some way, then Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to use that animal as a sacrifice. When Yahweh talks about skin problems, we are not exactly sure what Yahweh means. However, these problems are probably serious or permanent skin diseases of some kind.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What skin diseases do animals in your area have? How do people treat these animals that have these skin diseases? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to put an animal that has these physical problems on the altar for the priests to burn for Yahweh. The altar was the only place where the Israelites made sacrifices to Yahweh.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the altar. Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 22:17–25

Yahweh will allow the Israelites to offer a bull or cow, or a sheep that has a leg that is too long or too short, if the Israelites are making a freewill offering. But Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to offer a cow or bull, or a sheep that has a leg that is too long or too short as a sacrifice when the Israelites are fulfilling a vow. Yahweh has different standards for the freewill offerings, perhaps because Yahweh thinks sacrifices for vows are more important than sacrifices people make when people are grateful.

Then, Yahweh says that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to offer an animal to Yahweh if the animal's testicles are bruised, crushed, torn, or cut. A male animal's testicles are the parts that allow a male to have babies with a female. In different cultures throughout the world, people would often remove the testicles of animals that they owned when people did not want the animals to have babies. Yahweh is probably talking about that here. Yahweh definitely does not want the Israelites to offer any animal that has something wrong with its testicles for any reason.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people stop animals that people own from having babies? Would you give that animal as a gift to someone? How much is that animal worth compared to an animal that can have babies? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to do this in Israel. Yahweh probably means that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to offer animals with something wrong with their testicles anywhere in Israel. Yahweh also might be saying that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to remove or damage an animal's testicles anywhere in Israel. Yahweh also will not allow the Israelites to offer an animal that has something wrong with it that the Israelites bought from a foreigner. Since the animal has something wrong with it, Yahweh will not accept that animal. Yahweh spends more time talking about an animal whose testicles are damaged than any other problem an animal might have because Yahweh cares more that the animal's testicles are undamaged than that the animal is undamaged in any other way. Damaging the animal's testicles stops the animal from having babies, which damages Yahweh's creation and the way Yahweh intends his creation to be.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:17–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses to tell the Israelites and the priests specifically that Yahweh will not accept any animal as an offering if the animal is not physically perfect.

In the second scene: Yahweh says the Israelites may only give physically perfect animals as freewill offerings.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites to never offer an animal that has something wrong with its testicles.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- Aaron's sons
- The Israelites
- And people from other countries who live in Israel

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that in previous passages, Yahweh told the Israelites how to treat the holy food. Now, in this passage, Yahweh tells Moses to tell Aaron and the other priests and the other Israelites to offer animals that are physically perfect.

Leviticus 22:17–25

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses to talk to Aaron and Aaron's sons and all the people of Israel. Aaron is the high priest who is responsible for maintaining the relationship between Yahweh and the Israelites, and Aaron's sons are the other priests. Aaron and Aaron's sons are all Israelites. Yahweh mentions Aaron and Aaron's sons specifically because the priests are responsible for offering the sacrifices to Yahweh, so Yahweh wants the priests to pay special attention to these rules.

Yahweh starts by giving a specific situation. In this situation, someone presents an offering to Yahweh. This person could be an Israelite or someone from another country who is living in Israel. This person could be offering a peace or fellowship offering to fulfill a vow. Or the person could be making a burnt offering simply because the person wanted to. In this situation, the person needs to offer a male animal without anything wrong with it. The animal can be cattle or a sheep or a goat. You will remember that cattle is a general term that can mean a female cow, a bull, or an ox. These are the three large animals that Yahweh allows the Israelites to sacrifice. Yahweh will not accept any of these animals that have something wrong with them. Yahweh says twice that Yahweh will not allow the animal to have anything wrong with it because Yahweh really cares that the people give Yahweh animals that are valuable and perfect. Yahweh wants the people to obey Yahweh's instructions and only offer something that is good, not something that is bad.

In the second scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites more details about the physical problems an animal for sacrifice must not have. Yahweh repeats that Yahweh will not accept an animal with a defect as a freewill offering or an offering for a vow to show how important this command is. Yahweh mentions the offerings from the herds and flocks as a way to talk about the groups of animals that the Israelites can sacrifice to Yahweh. Herds refer to cattle, and flocks refer to sheep and goats. If an animal is blind, unable to walk, severely injured, or if the animal has a serious skin disease of any kind, then Yahweh will not allow anyone to offer the animal to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What kinds of defects do your animals have? How will you translate these terms for animals that have a physical problem? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that Yahweh will not allow anyone to put an animal that has one of these problems on the altar to burn as an offering to Yahweh. Yahweh says twice, in two different ways, that Yahweh will not allow anyone to give an animal with something wrong with it as an offering. Yahweh wants the Israelites to know how much Yahweh wants the animals to be valuable and undamaged. The Israelites must not give Yahweh a bad or damaged thing as a gift, which would be insulting to Yahweh.

Yahweh will allow someone to sacrifice cattle or a sheep as a freewill offering, even if the animal has a leg that is too long or a leg that is too short. But Yahweh will not allow someone to sacrifice an animal that has a leg that is too long or a leg that is too short to fulfill a vow. You will remember that people would sometimes vow to give Yahweh an offering if Yahweh did something good for them. If this happened, people had to give Yahweh a perfect animal.

Stop here and discuss this question: How do you describe an animal with a leg that is too long or too short? How will you translate this here? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites that Yahweh will not allow anyone to offer an animal that has damaged testicles, which means that the animal has bruised, crushed, torn, or cut testicles. Yahweh lists four different ways something might damage an animal's testicles because Yahweh wants the Israelites to know how much Yahweh wants the animal's testicles to be completely undamaged. Yahweh says that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to offer an animal whose testicles are damaged in the land Yahweh will give to the Israelites. Yahweh is talking to the Israelites about the land that Yahweh has promised to give to the Israelites, but that Yahweh has not given to the Israelites yet. Yahweh probably talks about the land of Israel because Yahweh wants the Israelites to remember that Yahweh gives this land.

Stop here and discuss this question: How do you describe an animal that has damaged testicles? How will you translate this here? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also will not allow the Israelites to offer a damaged animal that the Israelites got from the hand of a foreigner. In other words, the Israelites should not buy an animal with damaged testicles from a person who is not an Israelite, and then try to give the animal to Yahweh. Yahweh wants the Israelites to follow this instruction

in the future, when the Israelites are living in the land Yahweh will give to the Israelites and when foreigners are living in the land too. Yahweh will not accept damaged animals as a true sacrifice.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:17–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Aaron
- Aaron's sons
- The Israelites
- And people from other countries who live in Israel

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses to speak to Aaron and Aaron's sons and the rest of the Israelites. Yahweh wants Moses to say that when any Israelite or anyone else living in Israel gives an offering to Yahweh, the offering needs to be physically perfect. The offering could be payment for a vow or a freewill offering that the person offers to Yahweh as a burnt offering. The offering needs to be a male, and it can be cattle, sheep, or goats. Yahweh will not allow anyone to offer an animal that has something wrong with it, because Yahweh will not consider the sacrifice to be valid. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I would be insulted if someone offered a damaged animal to me, since people would not give a damaged animal as a gift to another person; or
- When the Israelites give me only good animals, this shows other people how much the Israelites honor and respect me. This shows other people how good and powerful I am; or
- I really want the Israelites to know what I will and will not consider valid.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh says that when anyone offers a fellowship offering, the offering needs to be physically perfect, or Yahweh will not accept the offering. This is true whether people are giving an offering to fulfill a vow or as a freewill offering. The Israelites can offer a bull, a sheep, or a goat, but the animal cannot have anything wrong with it. Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to offer an animal to Yahweh if the animal is blind, or crippled, or severely damaged, or if the animal has anything wrong with its skin. Yahweh will not allow anyone to place one of these animals on an altar to burn as a sacrifice to Yahweh. Yahweh will allow someone to offer cattle or a sheep as a freewill offering, even if the animal has a leg that is too long or a leg that is too short. However, Yahweh will not allow someone to offer an animal that has a leg that is too long or

a leg that is too short when that person fulfills a vow. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh is very particular that we must offer perfect animals to Yahweh. I will learn Yahweh's laws very carefully so that I do not accidentally disobey Yahweh; or
- I want to offer an undamaged animal to Yahweh to show how much I respect and honor Yahweh; or
- I am worried I might have a damaged animal, and then I cannot offer the animal to Yahweh.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh will not allow anyone to sacrifice an animal with bruised, crushed, torn, or cut testicles. The Israelites cannot do this anywhere in the land that Yahweh is going to give the Israelites. The Israelites must not offer an animal with damaged testicles that the Israelites bought from a foreigner to Yahweh, either. That animal is damaged and is not physically perfect. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a person from another country, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh expects me to respect Yahweh even though I am not an Israelite; or
- I am surprised that the Israelites have many rules about offering animals to Yahweh; or
- I am surprised that the Israelites offer sacrifices differently than I do; or
- I am impressed that the Israelites really do honor their God, Yahweh, when the Israelites give valuable animals as gifts; or
- I am impressed that Yahweh is so careful to make sure that when people sacrifice animals to Yahweh, the animals are good animals.

Continue the drama. Yahweh will not consider an animal with damaged testicles to be a good sacrifice.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:17–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, **Yahweh** talks to Moses. Yahweh is the personal name that the one true God gave to the Israelites to call God. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh tells the **Israelites** that even **foreigners** who live among the Israelites in **Israel** but are not from Israel need to obey Yahweh's laws about offerings. A person is a foreigner when the person is in a country that is not where the person was born. Use the same words or phrases for Israel, Israelites, and foreigner as you used in previous passages. For more information on foreigner, refer to the Master Glossary.

In this passage, Yahweh talks about **offerings**. An offering is a gift or sacrifice that a person offers to a god in a ritual. Use the same word or phrase for offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Sometimes people made offerings to fulfill a **vow**. A person who is making a vow is asking God to do something for that person, and is offering to do something in return. Yahweh does not require people to make vows, but if a person makes a vow, the vow is seriously binding like an oath. Use the same word or phrase for vow as you used in previous passages. For more information on vow, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh is also talking about **freewill offerings**. A freewill offering is a special kind of peace or fellowship offering that Yahweh does not require people to make. Instead, people will decide to make this kind of offering when people fulfill a vow or want to thank Yahweh for something. Use the same word or phrase for freewill offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on freewill offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh talks about people who offer a freewill offering as a **burnt offering**. A burnt offering is an offering that a person burns completely when the person sacrifices it to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for burnt offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh accepts animals from herds and flocks. Herds are groups of cattle. Flocks are groups of sheep or goats. First, Yahweh accepts **cattle**. Use the same word for cattle as you used in Leviticus 7:23.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of cattle as needed. Pause this audio here.

Second, Yahweh accepts **sheep**. Use the same word for sheep as you used in previous passages.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a sheep as needed. Pause this audio here.

Finally, Yahweh accepts **goats**. Use the same word for goat as you used in previous passages.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a bull as needed. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh requires that the offering be physically **perfect**, or **blameless**. When an animal is perfect, the animal does not have anything wrong with it. Use the same word or phrase for a perfect animal as you used in previous passages. For more information on perfect, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that when people make these offerings, which are **peace or fellowship offerings**, that people should only use undamaged animals. A fellowship offering is a type of offering someone makes when the person wants to make their relationship with Yahweh better. Fellowship offerings include offerings to fulfill a vow, thanksgiving offerings, and freewill offerings. Use the same word or phrase for fellowship offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on “fellowship offering,” refer to the Master Glossary.

The Israelites offer their offerings on the **altar** as a **fire offering** to Yahweh. An altar is a place where people make offerings or sacrifices to Yahweh. Use the same words or phrases for altar and fire offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on altar and fire offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 22:17–25

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (850 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.9 MB)

- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 22:26–33

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 22:26–33 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:26–33 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:26–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In previous passages, Yahweh told the Israelites that Yahweh would only accept animals that were physically perfect as a sacrifice. In this passage, Yahweh gives some more rules that the Israelites need to obey when the Israelites sacrifice an animal.

Yahweh tells Moses that when a cow, sheep, or goat gives birth, the baby needs to stay with the mother for seven days. Yahweh will allow the Israelites to give a baby animal as a burnt sacrifice on the eighth day or later after the animal was born. The number seven was very important to the Israelites because the Israelites thought that the number seven represented completeness.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what numbers are special? Why are those numbers special? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, when an animal that you eat gives birth, how long do people wait before people will eat the baby animal? Why do people wait? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also will not allow the Israelites to kill a cow, sheep, or goat on the same day that the Israelites kill any offspring that the cow, sheep, or goat has.

Yahweh also tells the Israelites that when the Israelites offer a thanksgiving sacrifice, the Israelites need to make sure that Yahweh will accept it. The Israelites need to eat the meat from the sacrifice the same day the Israelites offer the sacrifice. Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to keep any of the meat until the next day. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh. This offering is a type of peace or fellowship offering.

Finally, Yahweh tells the Israelites to make sure that the Israelites do what Yahweh is telling the Israelites to do. Yahweh says that he is Yahweh. Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to profane Yahweh's holy name, or the name that represents Yahweh, which shows people that Yahweh is special. If the Israelites do not profane Yahweh's name, then the Israelites will show people that Yahweh is completely good and powerful. Yahweh tells the Israelites again that he is Yahweh and that Yahweh makes the Israelites holy. Yahweh also tells the Israelites that Yahweh brought the Israelites out of the land of Egypt so that Yahweh could be the Israelites' God. Yahweh is talking about how the Israelites used to be slaves in Egypt. Yahweh wants the Israelites to understand that Yahweh is holy and that Yahweh is the one who rescued the Israelites from Egypt. Yahweh tells the Israelites a third time that he is Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, when a god or a spirit focuses or pays attention to a specific person or a specific group of people, what does that god or spirit do to those people?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:26–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites when Yahweh will allow the Israelites to sacrifice baby animals.

In the second scene: Yahweh says that when the Israelites offer a thanksgiving offering, the Israelites must eat the meat from the offering on the same day.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites to do what Yahweh says to do and to not profane Yahweh's reputation.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Yahweh
- And the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the previous passages, Yahweh told the Israelites some of the rules Yahweh has for when the Israelites sacrifice an animal to Yahweh. In this passage, Yahweh tells the Israelites more rules that Yahweh has for when people sacrifice an animal. Then Yahweh ends this part of Leviticus by telling the Israelites to obey the rules Yahweh has given to the Israelites.

In the first scene, Yahweh speaks to Moses. When the storyteller reminds us that Yahweh speaks to Moses, the storyteller is telling us that Yahweh will talk about a new topic. Yahweh is still giving these commands to Moses to give to the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time someone had to give someone else a lot of rules about a lot of different things. Pay attention to the ways that the person showed that they were talking about a new part of the rules. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells Moses the rules for how soon Yahweh will allow the Israelites to sacrifice an animal after it is born. Yahweh says that when a cow, sheep, or goat gives birth to a new animal, Yahweh will require the Israelites to let the baby animal stay with its mother for seven days. After the end of the seventh day, when the animal is eight days old, Yahweh will allow the Israelites to sacrifice the baby animal to Yahweh. Yahweh calls this a fire offering because the Israelites burned the meat that the Israelites gave to Yahweh on the fire on the altar at the tabernacle.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you refer to newborn cattle, sheep, and goats? Look at a photo of each of these animals. How will you translate these terms? If, in your language, you need to choose between male and female names, you should choose male names. Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh says that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to kill a cow or a sheep or a goat on the same day that the Israelites kill that animal's baby.

In the second scene, Yahweh talks about when the Israelites sacrifice a thanksgiving sacrifice. The Israelites need to make sure that Yahweh will accept their thanksgiving offering. The Israelites need to eat the meat from the sacrifice on the same day that the Israelites offer the sacrifice, which is one of the ways to make sure Yahweh accepts the offering. Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to keep any of the meat from the sacrifice until the next morning.

In the third scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites that Yahweh wants the Israelites to obey Yahweh's commands. Yahweh also tells the Israelites why Yahweh wants the Israelites to obey Yahweh's commands. Yahweh speaks like this to show that Yahweh is ending this section of Leviticus. Next, Yahweh will talk about laws that have to

do with holidays, and so Yahweh is done talking about the laws that have to do with sacrifices. Before Yahweh goes on to the next subject, Yahweh wants the Israelites to realize how much Yahweh wants the Israelites to obey the laws Yahweh has about sacrifices.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time someone really wanted people to know how much the person wanted the other people to obey a specific rule. Pay attention to how the person made sure that the other people knew the rule was important. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites to obey Yahweh's commands. Yahweh wants the Israelites to do what Yahweh told the Israelites to do. Yahweh tells the Israelites that he is Yahweh. Yahweh tells the Israelites that he is Yahweh when Yahweh wants the Israelites to think about the things that Yahweh has done for the Israelites and how powerful Yahweh is.

Then, Yahweh tells the Israelites that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to profane Yahweh's holy name. When Yahweh talks about his name, Yahweh is using special language to talk about Yahweh's reputation, or what people think about Yahweh.

If the Israelites do not profane Yahweh's name, then the Israelites will realize and tell others how holy, or completely good and powerful, Yahweh is. Yahweh says again that he is Yahweh, and that Yahweh made the Israelites holy, because Yahweh dedicated the Israelites to himself. Yahweh tells the Israelites that Yahweh brought the Israelites out of the land of Egypt so that Yahweh could be the Israelites' God. Because the Israelites are Yahweh's special people, Yahweh takes care of the Israelites and helps the Israelites be good people. Yahweh ends this scene by telling the Israelites again that he is Yahweh.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:26–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Yahweh
- And the Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh talks to Moses. Yahweh tells Moses that Yahweh requires the Israelites to let a calf, sheep, or goat stay with its mother for the first seven days after it is born. Yahweh will allow the Israelites to sacrifice a calf, sheep, or goat to Yahweh on the altar on the eighth day after it is born. But Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to kill a calf, sheep, or goat on the same day that the Israelites kill one of the animal's parents. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am surprised that Yahweh cares about the mother animals and young animals too; or
- I wonder why Yahweh asks us to do this; or
- Yahweh is very specific about the animals that we can sacrifice to Yahweh; or
- I am glad Yahweh tells me what Yahweh wants me to do when I sacrifice an animal.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh says to sacrifice in such a way that Yahweh will accept the sacrifice. If the Israelites follow the commands Yahweh already gave, and if the Israelites eat all the meat from the thanksgiving offering on the same day that the Israelites make the offering, then Yahweh will accept the sacrifice on the Israelites' behalf. Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to keep any of the meat from the thanksgiving offering until the morning. Yahweh says again that he is Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want the Israelites to enjoy the meat from their thanksgiving sacrifices; or
- I need the Israelites to treat the meat from the thanksgiving sacrifice as special, so the Israelites cannot just keep the meat as long as the Israelites want.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh says to obey the commandments Yahweh gave the Israelites and to do what Yahweh told the Israelites to do in the commandments. Yahweh says again that he is Yahweh. Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to profane Yahweh's reputation as completely good and powerful, so that all the Israelites will acknowledge that Yahweh is completely good and powerful. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- When people know how powerful and good I am, people will know why it is important to do what I tell the people to do; or
- I really want the Israelites to realize how much I want the Israelites to do what I tell the Israelites to do; or
- I love the Israelites, and I want to help the Israelites do the right thing.

Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that Yahweh is holy and I can tell others about Yahweh; or
- I want other people to know how amazing Yahweh is; or
- I can show through my actions how holy Yahweh is.

Continue the drama. Yahweh says again that he is Yahweh, and that Yahweh makes the Israelites holy. Yahweh also reminds the Israelites that Yahweh brought the Israelites out of the land of Egypt so that Yahweh could be the Israelites' God. Yahweh says again that he is Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 22:26–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, **Yahweh** talks to Moses. Yahweh is the personal name that the one true God gave to the Israelites to call God. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

In this passage, Yahweh says that Yahweh will accept an animal as a **fire offering** when the animal is eight days old. Use the same word or phrase for fire offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on fire offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh talks about **killing** a baby animal. Use the same word or phrase for killing an animal as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh requires that the Israelites eat the meat from a **thanksgiving sacrifice** on the day the Israelites make the offering. A thanksgiving sacrifice, or offering, is a special type of freewill offering that people offered when people wanted to thank Yahweh for doing something for those people. Use the same word or phrase for thanksgiving sacrifice as you used in previous passages. For more information on **sacrifices** and **freewill offerings**, refer to the Master Glossary.

Leviticus 22:26–33

Yahweh tells the Israelites to obey Yahweh's **commands**. Yahweh's commands are all the instructions that Yahweh has given his people. Use the same word or phrase for commands as you used in previous passages. For more information on commands, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh does not want the Israelites to **profane** Yahweh's name. When someone profanes something, that person mistreats something holy and makes that thing not seem holy anymore. Use the same word or phrase for profane as you used in previous passages. For more information on profane, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh's name is **holy**, and Yahweh makes the Israelites holy. When the Bible says that Yahweh is holy, it means that Yahweh is completely good, completely pure, completely powerful, and completely majestic. When Yahweh says that a specific group of people is holy, it means that the people are dedicated to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for holy as you used in previous passages. For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that Yahweh is the Israelites' **God**. In the Bible, God refers to God who created everything. God is the most powerful spiritual being. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 22:26–33

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (848 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.0 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.0 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 23:1–8

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 23:1–8 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:1–8 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

At this time, the Israelite people are still camped near Mount Sinai. The Israelites had recently completed building the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh is now giving Moses many instructions on how the Israelite people should live in a holy way. In this passage, Yahweh gives Moses instructions about the festivals that the Israelite people should celebrate. Yahweh tells Moses to give these instructions to the Israelite people.

Yahweh uses a second name for these special festivals. Yahweh calls these festivals “holy assemblies.” An assembly is a group of people whom someone calls to meet together for a special reason. An assembly can also refer to a community reading. In this case, the Israelite people gather together to hear someone read from the part of the Bible that the Israelites had at this time: probably the books of Genesis, Exodus, and Leviticus, and eventually Numbers and Deuteronomy. These books tell the history of the Israelite people and tell the Israelites how to follow Yahweh’s laws.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Why do you think it is important for people to gather and listen to the Bible together? Pause this audio here.

First, Yahweh reminds Moses about how to celebrate the Sabbath. Every seventh day should be a day of rest for the Israelite people. This is the Sabbath, the last day of the week. The Sabbath reminds the Israelite people that Yahweh created the world in six days and rested on the seventh day. Sabbath is a day to trust Yahweh and a chance to be together as a family and community to worship Yahweh. Yahweh commands the Israelite people not to do any work or business on this day. The Sabbath is the regular day of sacred assembly. This means that the Israelite people come together to worship Yahweh on that day. You heard in an earlier passage that Yahweh gave the Israelite people strict instructions to celebrate the Sabbath rest and not to ignore it. Yahweh even commanded the community to punish people who did not obey this rule.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what days are holy days or days that are important in your religion? How do people act on these holy days? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh gives instructions for the Israelite people to celebrate the Passover and the Festival of Unleavened Bread. The instructions for the first Passover are in the book of Exodus. The Israelite people celebrate the Passover on the fourteenth day of the first month of their calendar. This date can be anytime between what we today call late March and late April.

To celebrate the Passover, the Israelite people must hold a special ceremony and not do work. It is a time when the people remember the first Passover. At the first Passover, when the people were still slaves in Egypt, each household brought a young sheep or a young goat into the house on the 10th day of the month. The people kept the animal in the house until sunset on the 14th day. Then, at sunset, the people sacrificed or killed the young sheep or young lamb. The people put the animal’s blood over their doors and on their doorposts, so Yahweh would

remember the people and see that the Israelites obeyed Yahweh. Yahweh protected the people who obeyed Yahweh, and Yahweh did not kill the firstborn son in the houses with blood over the doors. The Israelite people ate the roasted meat of the animal with bitter herbs and unleavened bread. Unleavened bread is bread that has no yeast in it. The bitter herbs remind the people of their slavery. The unleavened bread is a reminder to make a meal and eat it quickly, because the people would not be slaves much longer.

Stop here and look at a picture of unleavened bread together as a group. Pause this audio here.

To remember that Yahweh saved the Israelite people from slavery, the Israelites now celebrate Passover every year. The people also consider the Passover festival to be a time when Yahweh cleanses the people spiritually and gives the people new strength.

Beginning on the 15th day of the seventh month, the day after Passover, the Israelite people celebrate the Festival of Unleavened Bread for the next seven days. During that week, the Israelites must not eat any bread with yeast. The Israelites can only eat the unleavened bread.

Stop here and look at a diagram of a calendar together as a group. See how the Sabbath is every seventh day, how Passover is on the 14th day of that month, and how the feast of Unleavened Bread starts on the 15th and continues through the next seven days. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your culture, what kinds of bread do you normally eat? If you do not normally eat bread, what is your main food that is not meat? What types of bread do people consider to be good or filling? How would you feel if you could not eat that good and filling food for a week? Pause this audio here.

The people also must give fire offerings to Yahweh every day. These are the offerings that the Israelites give to Yahweh by burning the food on the altar. We do not know everything that was in these food offerings, but it is likely that the Israelite people had to give at least grain and drink offerings. It is very possible that the Israelites also had to sacrifice a young sheep or a young goat, and it may have even included special offerings such as a firstfruits offering. People brought a firstfruits offering at the beginning of the harvest season as a gift to thank Yahweh for giving a harvest.

On the last day, one week after Passover, the Israelite people will have another special ceremony to worship Yahweh and remember what Yahweh has done. On this day, Yahweh instructs that the people should not work again, especially any form of hard work. This is another holy assembly, a special day for the Israelite people to come together to celebrate and worship Yahweh all together as a group.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your culture, how do people talk about different kinds of work? Describe the different kinds of work people in your community do, such as working in offices, in fields, building things, and teaching people.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh gives Moses instructions about the festivals that the Israelite people should celebrate. Yahweh tells Moses to give these instructions to the Israelite people.

In the second scene: Yahweh instructs Moses that every seventh day should be a day of rest for the Israelite people. This is the Sabbath, the last day of the week.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelite people should celebrate Passover at the right time. The Israelites must hold a special ceremony and do no work. For the next seven days, the Israelite people should celebrate the Festival of Unleavened Bread. During that time, the Israelites must eat bread without yeast and give food offerings to Yahweh.

In the fourth scene: On the last day, one week after Passover, the Israelite people must have another special ceremony and not work.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- And the Israelite people

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The Israelite people were still camping in the wilderness near Mount Sinai. The Israelites had recently finished building the Tent of Meeting, following Yahweh's instructions. Yahweh is giving Moses instructions that Moses then writes down and tells to the Israelite people.

In the first scene, Yahweh gives Moses instructions about the festivals that the Israelite people should celebrate. Yahweh tells Moses to give these instructions to the Israelite people.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you tell someone about what another person told you? Also, describe a situation where someone gave you instructions. Notice what language you use. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh emphasizes that Yahweh has "appointed," or chosen, these festivals for a special purpose. Therefore, Yahweh gives the Israelites special times and ways to celebrate the festivals. These special festivals happen on specific days of the year, so this makes a sort of religious calendar for the Israelite people to follow.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Talk about specific holidays or celebrations in your culture that happen on specific days, specific seasons, or specific times of year. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh uses a second name for these special festivals. Yahweh calls these "holy assemblies." An assembly is a group of people who someone calls to meet together for a special reason. Yahweh wants the Israelite people to come together as an entire nation to celebrate and worship Yahweh as a group.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what kind of events bring everyone together? What makes your people proud? What do you call these special events? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh instructs Moses that every seventh day should be a day of rest for the Israelite people. This is the Sabbath, the last day of the week. This means that the people should not do any work or business on this day. The Sabbath is the regular day of holy assembly. This means that the Israelite people should come together to worship Yahweh on that day. Earlier in Leviticus, Yahweh gave the Israelite people strict instructions to celebrate the Sabbath rest and not to ignore it.

In the third scene, Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelite people should celebrate Passover at the right time. The Israelite people celebrate the Passover after sunset on the 14th day of the first month of their calendar. This date can be anytime between late March and late April. To celebrate the Passover, the Israelite people must hold a special ceremony and do no work. It is a time when the people look back and remember the first Passover. Passover begins at twilight, which is in the evening, right after the sun goes down. For the Israelites, a new day began after the sun set in the evening.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do you talk about the time of day after the sun sets? How will you talk about the date and time that Passover begins? Pause this audio here.

For the next seven days after Passover, the Israelite people celebrate the Festival of Unleavened Bread. During that time, the Israelites must not eat bread with yeast. The Israelites also must give fire offerings to Yahweh every day. These are offerings that people give to Yahweh by burning at least some of the food on the altar. You may have heard that some translations call these "food offerings," while other translations call these "fire offerings."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do the translations you listen to describe these offerings? How will you continue to talk about these offerings in your translation? Pause this audio here.

We do not know everything that was included in these fire offerings, but it is likely that the Israelite people had to give at least grain and drink offerings. It is very possible that the Israelites also had to sacrifice a young sheep or a young goat, and it may have even included special offerings such as a firstfruits or harvest offering.

Stop here and discuss as a group: The Passover festival begins on the 14th day of the month, then the Festival of Unleavened Bread begins on the 15th day of the month and lasts for seven days. How will you talk about the days of these festivals in your language? Pause this audio here.

In the fourth scene, on the last day, one week after Passover, the Israelite people must have another special ceremony to worship Yahweh and remember what Yahweh has done. On this day, Yahweh again instructs that the people should not work, especially any form of hard work like work in the fields or work that requires a lot of physical strength. Some translations use a term like “regular” or “usual” work. This was another holy assembly, a special day for the Israelite people to come together to celebrate and worship Yahweh together as a group.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what are ways that people talk about different kinds of work? Discuss what word or phrase in your language works best for this type of work. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- And the Israelite people

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh gives Moses instructions about the festivals that the Israelite people should celebrate. Yahweh tells Moses to give these instructions to the Israelite people.

In the second scene, Yahweh instructs Moses that every seventh day should be a day of rest for the Israelite people. This is the Sabbath, the last day of the week. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite people, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am so glad we get a day of rest every week! or
- I have so much to do. How can I afford to take a day off? or
- Even Yahweh rested after Yahweh created the earth; or
- Yahweh wants us to be still and know that Yahweh is God; or
- The Sabbath will be the time of the week for the family to get together and worship Yahweh; or

- Can you explain what I can and cannot do? I am not sure what Yahweh thinks is work.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelite people should celebrate Passover at the right time. The Israelites must hold a special ceremony and do no work. For the next seven days, the Israelite people should celebrate the Festival of Unleavened Bread. During that time, the Israelites must eat bread without yeast and give food offerings to Yahweh.

In the fourth scene, on the last day, one week after Passover, the Israelite people must have another special ceremony and not work. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- This will be our time to remember when Yahweh saved us from slavery in Egypt; or
- Oh no, the people will grumble about eating unleavened bread for a whole week! or
- To see the Israelite people come together in one place to worship Yahweh is amazing.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, **Yahweh** gives Moses instructions about the festivals that the **Israelite** people should celebrate. Use the same words for Yahweh and Israelites as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and Israelites, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that these festivals are sacred or holy assemblies and appointed festivals. An assembly is a group of people whom someone calls to meet together for a special reason. This assembly is holy because Yahweh set it apart and dedicated this gathering to Yahweh. Yahweh has "appointed," or chosen, these festivals for a special purpose.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate **holy assemblies** and **appointed festivals**. Remember the things you discussed in previous steps. For more information on holy, look at the Master Glossary. If you have already translated these phrases in another book of the Bible, discuss whether you can use the same phrases here. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh instructs Moses that every seventh day should be a day of rest for the Israelite people. This is the **Sabbath**, the last day of the week. Use the same word for Sabbath as you used in previous passages. For more information on Sabbath, refer to the Master Glossary.

Use the same word for **Passover** as you used in previous passages. For more information on Passover, refer to the Master Glossary.

The festivals or sacred assemblies were special times of the year when the Israelite people were to stop regular activities and focus on religious celebrations or ceremonies. In this passage, Yahweh gives Moses instructions about the **Festival of Unleavened Bread**. Use the same phrase for the Festival of Unleavened Bread as you used in previous passages. For more information on the Festival of Unleavened Bread, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and look at a picture of unleavened bread together as a group. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh instructs Moses that the Israelites should give a **fire offering** to Yahweh on each of the seven days of the Festival of Unleavened Bread. Use the same word or phrase for fire offering as you have used previously, and refer to fire offering in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 23:1–8

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (845 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.1 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 23:9–14

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 23:9–14 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:9–14 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:9–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

At this time, the Israelite people are still camping near Mount Sinai. The Israelites have recently completed building the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh is giving Moses many instructions on how the Israelite people should live in a holy way. In this passage, Yahweh gives Moses instructions about the festivals that the Israelite people

should celebrate. Yahweh tells Moses to give these instructions to the Israelite people. Yahweh is preparing the Israelites for what Yahweh expects from the Israelites when the Israelites enter Canaan.

Yahweh gives Moses instructions about how the Israelite people should offer the harvest offering. When the people start to live in the land of Canaan, the people will begin to grow their own crops, including grain. When the grain is ready, the Israelite people will cut down the grain to harvest it. Then the people will gather the grain, put the grain into bundles, and tie up each bundle into a sheaf. A sheaf is a bundle of something. So Yahweh calls these bundles "sheaves of grain."

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of barley and sheaves of barley. Pause this audio here.

Usually, the first grain that is ready for harvest is barley. The barley harvest happens right around the same time as Passover and the Feast of Unleavened Bread. Because of this, Yahweh instructs the Israelite people to bring the firstfruits offering or harvest offering at about the same time as these festivals. It is possible that the offerings that Yahweh talks about in this passage are the ones that Yahweh instructed the people to give in the last passage. In that passage, Yahweh told the Israelite people to offer fire offerings to Yahweh every day during the Festival of Unleavened Bread.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what is the most important harvest? How do people celebrate that harvest? Pause this audio here.

For the harvest offering, an Israelite must get a sheaf of grain. Again, this grain was probably barley, but the important thing is that it is the first grain crop that the person harvests. The Israelite brings the sheaf of grain to a priest near the Tent of Meeting. The priest then takes the sheaf of grain and moves the sheaf in a special way in front of the altar. We do not know exactly how the priest moves the sheaf, but we know the priest moves it in a special, ceremonial way. The priest may hold the sheaf in his hands, then raise and lower his arms a few times. In this way, the priest offers the sheaf to Yahweh. This is an example of a wave offering, which you heard about in previous passages.

Yahweh instructs the Israelites to bring the sheaf of grain for the offering on the day after the Sabbath. We are not sure which Sabbath Yahweh means here, since it can mean two different things. First, it can mean the day after the regular Sabbath. This would mean that once the Festival of Unleavened Bread begins, the first Sabbath would mark what day this is. Whenever that first Sabbath happened, the next day would be the day when the Israelite people brought the harvest offering. The second option is that this Sabbath refers to the special Sabbath which marks the first day of the Festival of Unleavened Bread. In that case, the people would bring the harvest offering on the second day of the Festival of Unleavened Bread. If possible, it is best to translate this in a way that it could mean either Sabbath.

When the Israelite brings the harvest offering, the Israelite also must bring a burnt offering. For this offering, a person brings a young male sheep.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a young male sheep. Pause this audio here.

The Israelite person also needs to bring a grain or food offering to Yahweh. The Israelite must bring two-tenths of an ephah of flour for the grain offering. This is probably about 3 kilograms. This is twice the amount that Yahweh normally required for a grain offering. This flour was supposed to be the "finest" flour. This means that when a person grinds the grain, this is the grain that takes the longest time to grind. The Israelite people also consider the finest flour to be the best quality flour. To make the grain or food offering, the person mixes this flour with olive oil.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your culture and language, what do you call something that is the best of its kind? Discuss what makes something high quality. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also says that the grain offering is a pleasing aroma. Remember, we heard in an earlier passage that the priest takes a handful of the grain offering and burns it on the altar, so the "pleasing aroma" probably refers to the nice smell of the smoke when the priest burns the flour on the altar.

The Israelite person who offers the harvest offering, the burnt offering, and the grain offering must also give a drink offering. For the drink offering, the person offers one-quarter of a hin of wine. A hin may equal about 4 liters, so one-quarter of a hin is 1 liter.

Leviticus 23:9–14

This is an important offering for the Israelites, because the Israelites could not eat any of their new harvest that year until they had brought this offering to Yahweh. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that this is a statute that the Israelites should follow for all the generations in the future.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:9–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses instructions about how the Israelite people should offer the harvest offering. The people must offer a bundle of grain as a wave offering, a young male sheep as a burnt offering, flour and olive oil mixed together as a grain offering, and wine as a drink offering.

In the second scene: Yahweh instructs that the people should give these offerings every harvest before the people eat any of their own harvest.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- And a priest

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The Israelite people are still camping in the wilderness near Mount Sinai. The Israelites have recently finished building the Tent of Meeting as Yahweh instructed. Yahweh is giving Moses instructions, which Moses then writes down and tells the Israelite people.

In the first scene, Yahweh gives Moses instructions about how the Israelite people should offer the harvest offering. Yahweh is preparing the Israelites for how the Israelites should live and honor Yahweh when the Israelites arrive in Canaan, the land Yahweh will give to the Israelites. Yahweh tells Moses to give these instructions about the harvest offering to the Israelite people. Usually, the first grain that is ready for harvest is barley. When the grain is ready, the Israelite people cut it down and gather it into bundles and tie it up into a sheaf. A sheaf is a bundle of something. So Yahweh calls these bundles of grain sheaves. Yahweh instructs the Israelite people to offer a sheaf of barley as a wave offering.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of barley and sheaves of barley again as needed. Discuss what words you will use for "barley" and "sheaf." Pause this audio here.

The barley harvest happens around the same time as Passover and the Feast of Unleavened Bread. Because of this, the Israelite people must offer the firstfruits offering or harvest offering at or around the same time as these festivals. Some translations use the word "firstfruits" to talk about this offering, because the Israelite people offer the first and best of the crop to Yahweh for this offering. We will call this the harvest offering here, as a reminder that this is the offering that the Israelite people give at the beginning of harvest.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, what will you call this kind of offering? Pause this audio here.

For the harvest offering, an Israelite person gets a sheaf of grain and brings the sheaf to a priest near the Tent of Meeting. The priest takes the sheaf of grain and moves the sheaf in a special way in front of the altar. In this way, the priest offers the sheaf as a wave offering before Yahweh. "Before Yahweh" means "in the presence of Yahweh." The priest offers the sheaf "on behalf" of the Israelite person who brings the offering. This means that the priest offers the sacrifice, but Yahweh knows the offering is from the person who brought it.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how have you translated the phrase for "wave offering"? Does the name for this offering describe what kind of ceremonial movement the priest makes? How

are you going to describe the movement that the priest makes in this passage? How will you make it clear that the priest waves the offering in the presence of Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

The Israelite people bring the sheaf of grain for the wave offering on the day after the Sabbath. When an Israelite person brings the harvest offering, the Israelite must also bring a burnt offering. For this offering, a person brings a young male sheep. This sheep must be a year-old lamb that is physically perfect.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a young male sheep, which people also call a lamb. Pause this audio here.

The Israelite person must also bring a grain offering, which is two-tenths of an ephah of flour. This is probably about 3 kilograms. This flour must be the "finest" flour. This means that when a person grinds the grain, this is the grain that takes the longest to grind. The Israelite people also consider the finest flour to be the best quality flour. The person mixes this flour with olive oil. In this passage, Yahweh refers to this grain offering as a food offering or fire offering for Yahweh. Many of the other people groups who did not worship Yahweh believed that their gods and goddesses actually ate the food that people offered to their gods. However, Yahweh does not actually eat the food. These offerings of food were just a way to honor Yahweh. Some translations call this kind of offering "an offering by fire" because the priest will take a handful of the grain offering and burn it on the altar. This makes a nice smell, so Yahweh says this grain offering is a pleasing aroma.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Why do you think Yahweh calls the grain offering an offering by fire? How have you heard this part of the passage before? Pause this audio here.

The Israelite person who offers the harvest offering and the burnt offering and the grain offering must also give a drink offering. For the drink offering, the person offers one-quarter of a hin of wine. A quarter of a hin would be about a liter of wine. So in all, the Israelite person would bring the harvest wave offering, the burnt offering, the grain offering, and the drink offering.

In the second scene, Yahweh instructs Moses that the people should not eat any of the new harvest until the people make the harvest offering. Yahweh says this is a statute for all future generations, which means it is a rule that will always be there.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:9–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- And a priest

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Yahweh tells Moses instructions on how the Israelite people should offer the harvest offering. The Israelites must bring four offerings. The people must offer a bundle of grain as a wave offering and a young male sheep as a burnt offering. The Israelites must mix flour and olive oil together and give the mixture to Yahweh as a grain offering. The Israelites must also give wine as a drink offering. Yahweh instructs that the people should do this every harvest before the people eat any of their own harvest. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I feel excited when I hear Yahweh speak about the harvest we will one day have. Yahweh does everything Yahweh says he will do, so we will surely have good land where we can grow a good harvest! or
- It is strange to hear instructions about what to do when we have crops. We move from place to place and do not have time to grow crops. I will be so glad to live in one place and grow crops one day! I think it will be hard to give the first crops to Yahweh, because those first crops will be very special to me! or
- I am thankful for the way Yahweh provides food for us as we travel. I will also be thankful when Yahweh causes our crops to grow in the future!

Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy when the people remember to thank me for what I have given the Israelites; or
- When the people obey me, I know that the people trust me. I want the Israelites to give these offerings to honor me and to remember that I provide for the Israelites; or
- I hope that the people will not forget these instructions.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:9–14 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, **Yahweh** gives Moses instructions about offering the harvest offering, which people also call the **firstfruits offering**. The **Israelites** will give this offering each year when the Israelites enter the land that Yahweh will give to the Israelites. Use the same words for Yahweh, Israelites, and firstfruits offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, Israelites, and "firstfruits offering," refer to the Master Glossary.

The Israelites would bring a sheaf of grain for the harvest offering. A sheaf is a bundle of something.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of sheaves of barley again as needed. Discuss how you will talk about a **sheaf** here. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh instructs the **priest** on how to offer the Israelites' harvest offering. The priest will wave the offering in Yahweh's presence. This is an example of a **wave offering**. Use the same word for priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest and wave offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss how you will translate the way that the priests wave the offering here. You look back to Leviticus 7, where you chose a phrase for "wave offering." You can either just describe the action here or give the name of the offering here. Pause this audio here.

The priest will wave this offering on the **Sabbath**. Every seventh day is a day of rest for the Israelite people. This is the Sabbath, the last day of the week. Use the same word for Sabbath as you used in previous passages. For more information on Sabbath, refer to the Master Glossary.

When the Israelite offers the harvest offering, the Israelite also needs to offer a **burnt offering** of a **young male sheep**. Use the same phrases for burnt offering and young male sheep as you used in previous passages. For more information on burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a young male sheep again as needed. Pause this audio here.

The Israelite also needs to offer a **grain offering** with the harvest offering. Use the same phrase for grain offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on grain offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

The Israelite must bring two-tenths of an **ephah** of flour for the grain offering. An ephah is a unit of measurement. Two-tenths of an ephah may have been about 3 kilograms. Use the same word for ephah as you used in previous passages. For more information on ephah, refer to the Master Glossary.

In this passage, Yahweh calls the grain offering a food offering or an offering by fire. You will remember that these offerings of food were not food for Yahweh to eat, but rather a way to honor Yahweh. Some translations call this kind of offering "an offering by fire" because the priest burns part of the offering on the altar. The Israelite also offers a drink offering of wine. Use the same phrase for **fire offering** as you used in previous passages.

The Israelite must bring one-quarter of a **hin** of wine for the drink offering. A hin may equal about 4 liters, so one-quarter of a hin is 1 liter. Use the same word for hin as you used in previous passages, and refer to hin in the Master Glossary for more information.

For a drink offering, people brought a gift of wine, and the priest would pour the wine out over the altar to symbolically give it to Yahweh as an act of worship.

Stop here and discuss what word or phrase you will use for **drink offering**. For more information on drink offering, refer to the Master Glossary. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says this is a **statute** for all future **generations**. A statute is a rule that focuses specifically on the religious rules about how to celebrate festivals, perform religious rituals, and offer sacrifices of animals and grain. A generation is a group of people who are living at the same time and belong to about the same age group. Use the same words for statute and generations that you have used in previous passages. For more information on statute and generation, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 23:9–14

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (845 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.9 MB)

- Embodying the Text (1.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 23:15–22

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 23:15–22 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:15–22 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:15–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

At this time, the Israelite people are still camped near Mount Sinai. The Israelites had recently completed building the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh was giving Moses many instructions on how the Israelite people should live in a holy way. In this passage, Yahweh tells Moses about how the Israelite people should celebrate the harvest festival. In later years, the Israelite people will call this festival Pentecost. Pentecost will one day become an important day, not just for the Israelite people, but also for believers, as the day when the Holy Spirit first visited the people who followed Jesus.

For the first harvest offering in the last passage, Yahweh instructed each Israelite family to offer a sheaf of barley as a wave offering. In this passage, Yahweh tells the people what to do 50 days later. After 50 days, Yahweh wants the people to celebrate the harvest festival and to bring loaves of bread that the people made from the grain the Israelites had just harvested.

Stop here and look at a calendar that shows the day the Israelites would offer the sheaf of barley and, 50 days later, when the Israelites would celebrate the harvest festival. Pause this audio here.

Since this is the time of the wheat harvest, it is likely that most people bringing this offering would bring wheat for the end-of-harvest offering. The Israelite people are supposed to use two-tenths of an ephah of flour to make this bread. This is probably about 3 kilograms of flour. The people are supposed to make these loaves of bread with yeast. This is the only time of year when Yahweh commands the Israelite people to bring bread with yeast as an offering. The priest will take this grain offering and move it in a special way in front of the altar. In this way, the priest would offer the bread as a wave offering before Yahweh.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of wheat and of bread that people made with yeast. Discuss: In your culture, what is the main food you eat every day? How is this main food similar or different from the Israelites' bread? Pause this audio here.

The Israelite people also must sacrifice 10 animals for burnt offerings, along with grain and drink offerings; a sin or purification offering; and a fellowship offering. You will notice that Yahweh requires a lot of sacrifices for this festival! Since it was the time of harvest, it was the time of year when the people had a lot of food. The harvest festival was a time for the Israelite people to thank Yahweh for providing the Israelites with enough food and to trust Yahweh to provide for the Israelites in the future.

Leviticus 23:15–22

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, how do people celebrate the harvest? What do people look forward to with the harvest? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh instructs the people to sacrifice seven young male sheep, one young male bull, and two adult male sheep as burnt offerings.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of young male sheep, a young male bull, and an adult male sheep. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites also need to present grain offerings and drink offerings along with the burnt offerings. We know from the last passage that the Israelite person who offers these offerings is also supposed to give a drink offering. For the drink offering, the person is to offer one-quarter of a hin of wine. It is possible that this would be about 1 liter of wine.

The priests also must offer the offerings that the Israelites bring. These offerings are a young male goat as a sin or purification offering and two more young sheep as a fellowship offering.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of a young male goat and a young male sheep. Pause this audio here.

The priests must also offer the two young sheep that the Israelites bring for the fellowship offering as a wave offering for Yahweh. The priests are to do the wave offering of these two young male sheep along with the wave offering of the bread with yeast that the people had made for the end-of-harvest offering.

The Israelite people should not work on the day of the harvest festival. Instead, the Israelites should come together for a religious celebration. Yahweh calls this harvest festival a holy assembly.

Yahweh repeats instructions on how the Israelites should harvest. When the Israelite people harvest their crops, Yahweh wants the Israelites to leave some of the crops behind. The Israelites must not pick every single plant or take every single fruit or vegetable, but leave some, especially around the edges of the fields. Yahweh instructs the Israelites to do this so that the poor Israelite people and foreigners can have food to eat. Foreigners among the Israelites were any people who were not descendants of Israel.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, how do people take care of and accept people from other languages and cultures, or people who look different?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:15–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses when the Israelites must celebrate the next festival. This festival is the harvest festival, which the Israelite people will, in later years, call Pentecost. For the harvest festival, the Israelite people need to bring grain that the Israelites had just harvested to offer to Yahweh.

In the second scene: Yahweh gives details of what offerings each Israelites family should bring for the harvest festival. The Israelite people should not work on the day of the harvest festival. Instead, the Israelites should come together for a religious celebration.

In the third scene: Yahweh repeats instructions on how to harvest. When the Israelite people harvest their crops, Yahweh says to leave some of the crops behind, so that poor people and people who are not Israelites can have food to eat.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- An Israelite priest

- A poor person
- And a foreign person

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that Yahweh is giving Moses instructions that Moses then writes down and tells to the Israelite people. Remember that even though the storyteller does not mention Moses in this passage, we know from this chapter that Yahweh is telling Moses these instructions.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses how to count days to see when the next festival will be. Yahweh tells Moses to count seven weeks or 50 days after the first harvest offering.

Stop here and look at a calendar that shows the day the Israelites would offer the sheaf of barley and, 50 days later, when the Israelites would celebrate the harvest festival. How do you count days and weeks? As an activity, count the days and weeks until one of your holidays. Then discuss how you want to translate the way that Yahweh tells Moses to count the days until the harvest festival. Pause this audio here.

For the first harvest offering, in the last passage, the Israelite people were supposed to bring a sheaf of grain to the Tent of Meeting. When the grain was ready, the Israelite people would cut down the grain, gather the grain into bundles, and tie up the bundles. A sheaf is a bundle of something that a person ties up. In the previous passage, Yahweh instructed the Israelite people to offer a sheaf of barley as a wave offering. Now, for this harvest festival, the Israelite people need to bring grain that the Israelites had just harvested to offer to Yahweh. This harvest festival happened at the end of the wheat harvest, so it is likely that most people who bring this offering would bring wheat for the end-of-harvest offering.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of wheat and sheaves of grain. Discuss what you will call "wheat" and "sheaf." Pause this audio here.

Yahweh mentions the first harvest offering at the beginning of the passage. Be careful not to confuse the first harvest offering with the end-of-harvest festival, which people also called Pentecost.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, what will you call the harvest festival? How will you show the difference between the first harvest offering and the end-of-harvest offering? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells Moses to count seven weeks, or 50 days, after the first harvest offering to mark the day for the harvest festival. The Israelite people will one day call this festival "Pentecost."

In the second scene, Yahweh gives details of what offerings the Israelite people should bring for the end-of-harvest offering. For the harvest festival, Yahweh instructs Moses that the people should make two loaves of bread. The people are supposed to make these loaves of bread with yeast.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of bread that people made with yeast. Discuss what you will call "bread with yeast" in your language. If possible, discuss the process people would use to make this kind of bread in your language. Pause this audio here.

The Israelite people must use two-tenths of an ephah of flour to make this bread. This is probably about 3 kilograms. The people make this bread from the grain the people had just harvested. The flour for this bread must be the "finest" flour. This means that when a person grinds the grain, this is the grain that takes the longest to grind. The Israelite people also considered the finest flour to be the best quality flour.

The priest takes this grain offering of the two loaves of bread and moves the offering in a special way in front of the altar. In this way, the priest would offer the bread as a wave offering before Yahweh.

The Israelite people also must kill ten animals for burnt offerings: seven young male sheep, one young male bull, and two adult male sheep.

Stop here and look at pictures of these animals. If necessary, go back and review the process of offering the burnt offering in Leviticus chapter 1 as a reminder of how the priest would offer these sacrifices. Pause this audio here.

The priests must offer the grain offerings and drink offerings that the Israelites bring at the same time as they offer the animals. Yahweh calls this an offering by fire. Yahweh also calls the offerings a pleasing aroma. This

means that the offerings smell good to Yahweh. Remember, the priest takes a handful of the grain offering and burns it on the altar, so Yahweh also probably refers to the nice smell of the smoke when the priest burns the flour and the animals on the altar.

Stop here and, if necessary, go back to Leviticus chapter 2 and review the process for giving the grain offerings as a reminder of how the priest would offer these offerings. Pause this audio here.

The priests must offer the young male goat that the Israelites bring as a sin or purification offering and two more young sheep that the Israelites bring as a fellowship offering. The priests offer the two young sheep for the fellowship offering as a wave offering for Yahweh. The priests are to do the wave offering of the young male sheep along with the wave offering of the bread with yeast for the end-of-harvest offering. The priests will burn part of the fellowship offerings, then the priests may have some of the offering to eat.

Stop here and, if necessary, go back to Leviticus chapters 3 and 4 and review the process for giving the fellowship and purification offerings as a reminder of how the priest would offer these sacrifices. Pause this audio here.

The Israelite people should not work on the day of the harvest festival. Instead, the Israelites should come together for a religious celebration. Yahweh calls this harvest festival a holy assembly. The word for assembly means a request to meet together. Yahweh wants the Israelite people to come together as an entire nation to celebrate and worship Yahweh together. Just like Yahweh said for the harvest offering, Yahweh says this is a lasting statute, which means a rule that will never stop or go away, for every generation of Israelite people.

In the third scene, Yahweh repeats instructions from earlier about how to harvest. When the Israelite people harvest their crops, Yahweh commands the Israelites to leave some of the crops behind. The Israelite people must not pick every single plant or take every single fruit or vegetable. Instead, the Israelites need to leave some food and plants, especially around the edges of the fields. Yahweh instructs the Israelites to do this so that poor Israelite people and foreigners can have food to eat. A foreigner is any person who is not an Israelite, but lives among the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, what do you call a person from another culture, language, or tribe? Discuss how you will translate this word as it refers to people who are not Israelite. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh finishes this instruction by repeating something Yahweh has said before. Yahweh often says in Leviticus, “I am Yahweh, your God.” Yahweh wants the Israelite people to treat poor people and foreign people well because the way the Israelite people treat other people directly shows people who Yahweh is.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:15–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- An Israelite priest
- A poor person
- And a foreign person

Note that even though the narrator does not mention Moses in this passage, we know from this chapter that Yahweh was telling Moses these instructions.

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses how to count the days until the next festival. Yahweh tells Moses to count seven weeks or 50 days after the first harvest offering. This festival is the harvest festival, which the Israelite people will one day call Pentecost. For the harvest festival, the Israelite people need to bring grain that the Israelites just harvested to offer to Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy that we will celebrate harvest; or
- The Israelite people will learn to thank Yahweh at the beginning and the end of harvest. The Israelites will learn to see that every harvest is a gift from Yahweh; or
- I wonder how we will offer all of these offerings in a bad year.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh gives details of what offerings the Israelite people should bring for the harvest festival. The Israelites are to bring two loaves of bread that have yeast. The Israelites also must kill ten animals for burnt offerings: seven young male sheep, one young male bull, and two adult male sheep. The priests must offer grain offerings and drink offerings at the same time as the animals. The priests also must sacrifice a young male goat as a purification offering and two more young sheep as a fellowship offering. For this ceremony, the priests also offer wave offerings of some of these sacrifices. The Israelite people should not work on the day of the harvest festival. Instead, the Israelites should come together for a religious celebration. Pause the drama. Ask the person or people playing the Israelite people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person or people might answer things like:

- We are excited for a break from work; or
- I am thankful that Yahweh provided for us this year; or
- For the harvest festival, we must sacrifice a lot of animals; or
- Our religious ceremonies remind us of who Yahweh is and who we are.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh repeats instructions on how to harvest. When the Israelite people harvest their crops, Yahweh wants the Israelites to leave some of the crops behind, so that poor people and foreigners will have food to eat. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the poor person and the foreigner, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am thankful Yahweh remembered me; or
- I am amazed that Yahweh provides even for people like me; or
- I was hungry, but now I have plenty to eat.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:15–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh instructs Moses how to count the days until the next festival, the harvest feast of Pentecost, will happen. To calculate it, Moses must count seven weeks from the day after the **Sabbath**, which was the day the Israelite people gave the first harvest offering. Use the same word for Sabbath as you used in previous passages. For more information on Sabbath, refer to the Master Glossary.

Leviticus 23:15–22

Yahweh talks about many kinds of offerings in this passage. The priest is to give the harvest offering and the fellowship offering as a **wave offering**. Use the same phrase for wave offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on wave offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

For the Festival of Weeks, the priest offers another **offering** of new grain. Use the same phrase for offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

The Israelites should bring two loaves of bread that someone made with two-tenths of an **ephah** of fine flour. Use the same word or phrase for ephah as you have used previously, and refer to ephah in the Master Glossary for more information.

The two loaves of bread will be a wave offering of **firstfruits** to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for firstfruits as you have used earlier, and refer to firstfruits in the Master Glossary for more information.

The priests must also offer many **burnt offerings**. Use the same phrase for burnt offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on burnt offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

The priest must also give a **grain offering** and **drink offering**, which together Yahweh calls a food offering, or a **fire offering**. Use the same phrases for grain offering, drink offering, and fire offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on grain offering, drink offering, and fire offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Then the priest must offer a **sin or purification offering** and a **fellowship offering**. Use the same phrase for purification offering and fellowship offering as you used in previous passages. For more information on purification offering and fellowship offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

Use the same word or phrase for **Yahweh** as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

In this passage, the priest must sacrifice seven young **male sheep** for a burnt offering and two young sheep for a fellowship offering. Use the same word for young sheep as you used in previous passages.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a young male sheep. Pause this audio here.

The priest must also sacrifice one **young male bull** as part of the burnt offering. Use the same word for young male bull as you used in previous passages.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a young male bull. Pause this audio here.

For the burnt offering, the priest also must offer two **adult male sheep**. Use the same word for adult male sheep as you used in previous passages.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of an adult male sheep. Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the priest must also offer a **young male goat** as a purification offering. Use the same word for young male goat as you used in previous passages.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a young male goat. Pause this audio here.

These offerings are **holy** to Yahweh. Use the same word for holy as you used in previous passages. For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary.

Use the same word for **priest** as you used in previous passages. For more information on **priest**, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh calls this harvest festival a sacred or **holy assembly**. Use the same phrase for holy assembly as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh says this is a **statute** for all future **generations**. A statute is an instruction or rule, especially about the place of worship. A generation is a group of people who are living at the same time and belong to about the same age group. Use the same words for statute and generations that you have used in previous passages. For more information on statute and generation, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says to leave some of the crops in the fields for the poor people and for the **foreigners** who live with the Israelites. Use the same word for foreigner as you used in previous passages. For more information on foreigner, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says, “I am Yahweh, your **God**.” Use the same word for God as you used in previous passages. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 23:15–22

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (848 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 23:23–32

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 23:23–32 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:23–32 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.

4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:23–32 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh continues to tell Moses the instructions for the yearly holidays and festivals. This passage focuses specifically on two festivals that happened during the last part of the harvest season for grapes and olives.

So Yahweh told Moses what to tell the people of Israel about how to celebrate the festival of loud noises. People today often call this festival the "Festival of Trumpets," which means the New Year.

Yahweh said that the celebration would happen on the first day of the seventh month. This would have happened around a harvest season. This usually happens during September or October. On that day, the people of Israel needed to rest and not do their normal work. This probably meant that the Israelites could do some kinds of work, but not do their normal jobs of farming, cleaning, or other kinds of hard work.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What kinds of normal work do people do everyday? How do people describe that kind of work? Pause this audio here.

The festival of loud noises, or Festival of Trumpets, was a day to remember, either what Yahweh has done, or to ask Yahweh to continue to remember and help the Israelites. Yahweh also says that the Israelites should gather together with loud noises. Most people translate the words "loud noises" as "the loud sound of trumpet music." If it was a trumpet, no one knows what kind of trumpet. It was most likely a trumpet that people made from a ram's horn. This kind of trumpet is a ram's horn trumpet. It could also have been a silver trumpet.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a ram's horn trumpet and a silver trumpet. Pause this audio here.

So these words could mean that people were supposed to blow one of those two kinds of trumpets. However, these words could also mean that people were supposed to shout really loud. Elsewhere in the Bible, people use the words "loud noises" to talk about shouting to celebrate or to get people ready to go to war. Since this day was a holiday and a festival, it was some kind of loud noise that people made by shouting or blowing trumpets in order to celebrate the holiday.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What kinds of loud noises do you make to celebrate your holidays? Why do you make these noises? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also said that this day, when people gather together, was "holy." This means that the day was special to Yahweh and that the people needed to treat the day with respect. Yahweh did not allow the people to do any of their normal kinds of work. Instead, the people were supposed to offer different kinds of sacrifices as a fire offering. You will remember that the fire offerings are often the offerings that the priests burn with fire to smell good to Yahweh. Another book of the Bible explains that the types of fire offerings the people were supposed to offer included burnt offerings, grain offerings to celebrate Yahweh as king, purification offerings, and drink offerings.

After Yahweh explained what the people needed to do during the festival of loud noises, Yahweh told Moses to tell the people of Israel what to do on the Day of Atonement. You will remember that atonement is the way to restore someone's relationship with God. The people needed to celebrate the Day of Atonement nine days after the people celebrated the festival of loud noises. So the people celebrated the Day of Atonement on the tenth day of the seventh month during the harvest season.

Yahweh said that this day was also a holy day for people to gather together. Once again, Yahweh called this day holy to show that it was special to Yahweh and that the people needed to treat the day with respect. The people needed to respect the Day of Atonement by not eating and drinking and by offering a variety of sacrifices as a gift of fire to smell good to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When are some times in your culture when you would choose not to eat or drink? Why do you do this? What are some other ways that you show that a holiday is very important? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said that anyone who ate or drank on that day would be "cut off" from their people. No one knows exactly what these words "cut off" mean. It either meant that someone needed to kill the person who ate or drank something, or that that person who ate or drank something would not be one of Yahweh's people anymore.

The other way that people needed to respect the Day of Atonement was by not doing any work at all. This was because Yahweh chose the Day of Atonement to cleanse the people, the holy place, the bronze altar, and the priests from all the bad things that the people and priests did throughout the year. This day of cleansing also repaired the people's relationship with Yahweh, their God. The people needed to focus on Yahweh on this day, not on the work that the people needed to do.

Yahweh said that Yahweh would destroy anyone who worked on the Day of Atonement. This was a rule or statute that would last forever in each generation, no matter where the people of Israel lived. The Day of Atonement was a special day of rest when the people were supposed to deny themselves eating, drinking, and perhaps other things that were pleasurable.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:23–32 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh gave Moses instructions about what the people of Israel need to do for the festival of loud noises, or Festival of Trumpets.

In the second scene: Yahweh gave Moses further instructions about what the people of Israel need to do for the Day of Atonement.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- And the people of Israel

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the first scene, Yahweh talked to Moses and told Moses what to tell the people of Israel about how to celebrate the festival of loud noises. Yahweh did not actually call this festival "the festival of loud noises," or "the Festival of trumpets." Yahweh said it was a holy assembly, and a day of rest, that people remember because the people make a loud noise, or possibly trumpet blasts! This celebration would happen on the first day of the seventh month. This would have happened around one of the harvest seasons.

Stop here and discuss how people talk about times of the year. How do people talk about yearly festivals or holidays? How do people explain when those festivals or holidays are supposed to happen? Pause this audio here.

On that day, the people of Israel must rest and not do their normal work, just like the people do on the Sabbath rest days. This day was a day to remember. It is not clear what this "day to remember" is supposed to mean. Some people believe it was a day for the people of Israel to ask Yahweh to pay attention to the Israelites and continue to take care of the Israelites. However, it could also mean that the Israelites were supposed to pay attention to Yahweh and think about how Yahweh had been taking care of the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you call a holiday where you remember something important? How will you translate "day of remembrance" here? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also said that this “day to remember” is a day to remember with loud noises. Most people translate the words “loud noises” as “trumpets.”

Yahweh also said that this day of people gathering together is a “holy assembly,” where people gather together to worship Yahweh. This day was special to Yahweh, and the people needed to treat the day with respect. People must not do any of their normal work. Instead, the people were supposed to give an offering as a gift of fire to Yahweh. You will remember that the fire offerings, or food offerings, are often the offerings that the priests burn with fire to smell good to Yahweh. This kind of offering includes both burnt offerings and fellowship offerings. The people would have given these offerings at Yahweh’s Tent of Meeting.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the Tent of Meeting. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh told Moses to tell the people of Israel what to do on the Day of Atonement. You will remember that Yahweh had already talked about this festival, but this time Yahweh talked about two new pieces of information: the date and the punishments for people who disobey Yahweh. Yahweh repeated several times that the Israelites must not work on this festival day.

First, Yahweh explained when the people need to celebrate the Day of Atonement. Yahweh said the people must celebrate the Day of Atonement nine days after the people celebrate the festival of loud noises. So the people celebrated the Day of Atonement on the tenth day of the seventh month during the harvest season. For the people of Israel, the day began in the evening. So after the sun went down, it was a new day. That is why the Day of Atonement began in the evening when the ninth day ended, and it lasted until the next evening when the tenth day ended.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what marks the end of the old day and the beginning of the new day? How do you talk about something lasting a whole day? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh explained that the people need to deny themselves. Yahweh probably meant that the people must not eat or drink as a way to treat that day with respect. Some people think that this may mean that the people must not do anything that causes pleasure or makes people feel happy. Yahweh also said that the Israelites need to offer a variety of sacrifices as a fire offering to Yahweh.

Then Yahweh explained that the people must not do any work at all on the Day of Atonement since Yahweh chose the Day of Atonement to cleanse the people, the holy place, the bronze altar, and the priests from all the bad things that the people and priests did throughout the year. This day of cleansing also repaired the people’s relationship with Yahweh, their God.

In the most important piece of information, Yahweh emphasized how serious the rules were by repeating the instructions three times not to work and to deny themselves. Yahweh also showed how serious these instructions were by explaining the punishment for people who do not do what Yahweh said. If a person ate or drank on that day, then the community would “cut off” that person from their people. These words “cut off” either meant that someone needed to kill that person or that that person would no longer be one of Yahweh’s people anymore.

If someone worked on the Day of Atonement, then Yahweh would destroy the person who worked on that day because this was a day of Sabbath rest. This was a statute that would last forever in each generation, no matter where the people of Israel lived.

Stop and discuss among yourselves how best to show the way that Yahweh emphasizes these instructions for the Day of Atonement in your language. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:23–32 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- And the people of Israel

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh talked to Moses and told Moses what to tell the people of Israel about how to celebrate the Festival of Trumpets. Yahweh said, "This festival will be on the first day of the seventh month. On that day, the people of Israel need to rest and not do their normal work. It is a day for you to remember. It is a day for you to make loud noises. It is a day when you gather together in a holy gathering to worship me, so people need to treat this day with respect. Do not do any normal work. Instead, give a food offering, or a gift of fire to me." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad to take a break from work to celebrate; or
- I am worried about taking a break during harvest time.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh told Moses to tell the people of Israel what to do on the Day of Atonement. Yahweh said, "The Day of Atonement will be on the tenth day of the seventh month. It is a day when you gather together in a holy gathering to worship me, and so people need to treat this day with respect. Do not eat or drink anything. Instead, give a food offering, or a gift of fire to me. And do not do any work at all on this day, because this is the day to make atonement for everyone and restore your relationship with me, Yahweh, your God." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I want the people to understand how serious this atonement day is; or
- I want my people to focus on me, not on everything else; or
- I look forward to my people spending time with me.

Continue the drama. Yahweh said, "If you eat or drink on that day, then you will no longer be one of my people anymore. If you work on this day, I will destroy you." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people of Israel, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I need to make sure I obey the rules for this day; or
- I am afraid that I will do something wrong and die.

Continue the drama. Yahweh said, "Do not do any kind of work at all on this day. This is an ongoing statute that will last in each generation, no matter where you live. This is a special day of rest for you, where you are not supposed to eat or drink.

"This day will begin in the evening when the sun goes down on the ninth day. It will last until the evening when the sun goes down on the tenth day. This is the special time to rest."

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:23–32 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh gives instructions for the people of Israel about a festival that the **Israelites** will later call the **Festival of Trumpets**. Look up Yahweh, Festival of Trumpets, and Israelites in the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and Israelites as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh said, "This festival will be on the first day of the seventh month. On that day, the people of Israel need to have a day of rest or a **Sabbath** and not do their normal work." Look up Sabbath in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Sabbath as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh said, "This day is a day to remember." It is not clear what this "day to remember" is supposed to mean. Some people believe it was a day for the people of Israel to ask Yahweh to pay attention to the Israelites and continue to take care of the Israelites. However, it could also mean that the Israelites were supposed to pay attention to Yahweh and reflect on how Yahweh had been taking care of the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "**day to remember**." If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, decide if it is appropriate to use the same phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said this is a day of loud noises. The people would celebrate this festival with loud noises, which the people probably made with trumpets. So many people call this the "Festival of Trumpets." It is possible that the people also shouted.

Stop here as a group and look again at a picture of a shofar trumpet and a silver trumpet as needed. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **loud noises**. Discuss also how you will talk about the name of this festival. If you have already translated this phrase in another book of the Bible, decide if it is appropriate to use the same phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said to have a **holy assembly**, or a special gathering where people worship Yahweh, so people need to treat this gathering with respect. Look up holy in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for holy assembly as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh said, "Do not do any normal work. Instead, you all need to offer me gifts that the priest will burn in the fire." Remember that this is a way to talk about all the different kinds of offerings that the Israelites can give to Yahweh. When the people burn these offerings, the aroma is pleasing to Yahweh, so sometimes people call these "**food or fire offerings**." Use the same word or phrase for fire or food offering as you used in previous passages.

Then Yahweh told Moses to tell the people of Israel what to do on the **Day of Atonement**. Yahweh said, "The Day of Atonement will be on the tenth day of the seventh month. Have a holy assembly and gather together to worship me." Look up Day of Atonement in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for "Day of Atonement" as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh said, "You need to **fast** and offer a gift of fire to smell good to me." To fast means not to eat or drink. Some translations say "deny or afflict yourselves." Look up fast in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for fast as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh said, "And do not do any work at all on this day, because the purpose of the Day of Atonement is to cleanse, or **atone** for, you all in the presence of me, Yahweh your **God**." Look up atonement and God in the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for atone and God as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh said, "If you eat or drink on that day, then the community will **cut you off** from your people." This could either mean that someone would need to kill the person, or that the person would no longer be one of Yahweh's people, and the community would send this person away. Use the same word or phrase for cut off as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh said, "If you work on this day, I will destroy you." In this passage, this word "destroy" probably means that Yahweh would either kill that person or make it so that the person no longer belonged to Yahweh's people. Either way, it was a very serious punishment. The difference between this punishment and the punishment for eating or drinking is that Yahweh says Yahweh will personally punish the person who works on the Day of Atonement.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **destroy**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, decide if it is appropriate to use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said, “Do not do any kind of work at all on this day. This is an ongoing **statute** that will last forever in each **generation**, no matter where you live.” Look up statute and generation in the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for statute and generation as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh said, “It is a special **Sabbath**, or day of rest for you, where you must not eat or drink. This day will begin in the evening when the sun goes down on the ninth day. It will last until the evening when the sun goes down on the tenth day. This is the special day of rest.” Look up Sabbath in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Sabbath as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 23:23–32

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (843 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 23:33–44

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 23:33–44 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:33–44 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:33–44 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

At this time, the Israelite people were still camped near Mount Sinai. The Israelites had recently completed building the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh was giving Moses many instructions on how the Israelite people should live in a holy way. In this passage, Yahweh gives Moses instructions about the festivals that the Israelite people should celebrate. Yahweh tells Moses to give these instructions to the Israelite people.

Yahweh tells Moses to instruct the Israelite people how to celebrate the Festival of Tabernacles or Shelters. Here, a tabernacle is a shelter or a home that people live in for a short time. A person could make a shelter out of many different kinds of materials. Here are some of the kinds of temporary shelters that the Israelite people would have used.

First, there are tents. In ancient times, people often lived in tents. People wove goat hair into fabric to make these tents because goat hair would keep out water. Then the people used wooden poles to hold up the fabric. People made ropes from plant or animal parts and pegs from bone, wood, or metal. People tied the tent fabric down using these ropes and pegs. This created a covered space that people could eat, move, sit, and sleep inside. At the time when Yahweh gave these instructions, most Israelite people lived in tents like this.

There is another kind of shelter, which people often call a hut. People often made these huts out of wooden beams and strong grasses like reeds. People used things like ropes and mud to hold these shelters together. In ancient times, for this festival, it is probable that Israelite people lived in whatever kind of temporary shelters the Israelites could make.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of temporary shelters. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, talk about different kinds of temporary shelters. How would you build one if you needed to? Pause this audio here.

The Israelite people lived in temporary shelters for eight days during the Festival of Tabernacles. On the first and last day of the Festival of Tabernacles, the Israelite people gather the people together to have holy assemblies or worship celebrations. No one can work on those days.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, what celebrations or holidays do people celebrate by not working? Pause this audio here.

For every day of the festival, people are also supposed to give fire offerings to Yahweh. You will remember that in the original language, this is something like “fire offering” or “an offering that a person makes in the fire.” This can really refer to any of the offerings where a priest burns all or part of the offering on the altar.

When Yahweh gives more specific instructions about how the people should celebrate, Yahweh mentions that this festival should happen after the people have finished the harvest.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, what are the most important crop harvests? What are some things you do after you finish your harvests? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also tells Moses to tell the Israelite people to gather tree branches. While it is possible that the people used these tree branches when the people built the shelters, the people probably carried these tree branches while they walked all together and celebrated as a group. In a way, the Festival of Tabernacles may have led

to the celebration we see later in Jesus' time, Palm Sunday, when people waved palm branches and put the branches on the ground in front of Jesus. For this festival, Yahweh instructs the Israelite people to gather date palm branches, willow branches, and branches from other leafy trees. Yahweh says, "branches from a tree that loves water," so some scholars think this could mean willow branches or poplar trees. It is possible that when Yahweh said "leafy trees," Yahweh meant myrtle trees.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of these different kinds of trees. How are trees in your area similar to or different from these trees? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that all generations of the Israelite people should celebrate this festival by living in temporary shelters for a week. This festival is a reminder that the Israelite people lived in shelters when Yahweh brought the Israelites out of slavery in Egypt. Yahweh ends his instruction with an important statement: "I am Yahweh, your God." Yahweh says this statement often, and Yahweh is saying it again, probably for the same reason as Yahweh has before: to remind the Israelites that the Israelites must obey Yahweh because Yahweh is the Israelites' God. Then Moses tells the people about Yahweh's festivals.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, what do people say or think about future generations? Why do you think it was important that the future generations would live in temporary shelters like their ancestors?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:33–44 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses to instruct the Israelite people how to celebrate the Festival of Tabernacles or Shelters. The Israelite people are to celebrate this festival for eight days. On the first and last day of the festival, the Israelite people are to have holy assemblies or worship celebrations. No one can work on those days. On every day of the festival, the people are also supposed to give offerings to Yahweh.

In the second scene: Yahweh says that these are Yahweh's festivals. Yahweh reminds the people about the different kinds of offerings that the people are supposed to give Yahweh.

In the third scene: Yahweh gives more specific instructions about how the people should celebrate the Festival of Tabernacles. Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelites should gather tree branches and build temporary shelters for this festival. Every Israelite person is supposed to live in these temporary shelters for the seven days of the festival. Yahweh also says that all future generations of the Israelite people should do this. This celebration is a reminder that the Israelite people lived in shelters when Yahweh brought the Israelites out of slavery in Egypt. Yahweh says something very important at the end of this scene. Yahweh says, "I am Yahweh, your God."

In the fourth scene: Moses tells the Israelite people about Yahweh's festivals.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- And the Israelite people, including those who give the offerings

Although you might not wish to represent this group with a person, Yahweh also mentions another group of people in this passage: the future descendants of the Israelite people from every generation.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you talk about future generations? Pause this audio here.

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Leviticus 23:33–44

The Israelite people are still camping in the wilderness near Mount Sinai. The Israelites have recently finished building the Tent of Meeting as Yahweh instructed. Now, Yahweh is giving Moses instructions that Moses then writes down and tells to the Israelite people.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses to instruct the Israelite people how to observe or celebrate the Festival of Tabernacles. Remember that here, a tabernacle or a shelter is a temporary house in which people can live. A person could make a shelter out of many different kinds of materials. Translators have used many names for these temporary shelters: tabernacles, shelters, booths, huts. It is even possible that some people would live in tents during the festival, which is what the Israelites are living in as Yahweh gives these instructions. Remember that in step two, you already heard explanations about different kinds of temporary shelters that the Israelite people could make and live in. You can listen again to step two if needed.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of temporary shelters. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss if there is a word or phrase in your language that you could use for any kind of temporary shelters, and decide what you will call these temporary shelters. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites to celebrate this festival for eight days. The first and the last day of the festival are Sabbaths, or special days of worship and rest. The two Sabbaths are one week apart. Remember that the Israelite people began their days at sunset, the time when the sun goes down.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, how do you count days? What words do you use to talk about lengths of time? Pause this audio here.

On the first and last day of the festival, the Israelite people must have holy assemblies. When Yahweh tells the people to gather for an assembly, Yahweh is telling the people to all meet together for a special purpose. Yahweh wants the Israelite people to gather as an entire nation to celebrate and worship Yahweh all together as a group. These two special Sabbaths are the same as normal Sabbaths; people are not supposed to work. The people are not supposed to do hard work or physical labor. For every day of the festival, the people are also supposed to give fire offerings to Yahweh. Remember that fire offerings can really refer to any of the offerings where a priest burns all or a part of the offering on the altar.

In the second scene, Yahweh reminds the people again that these are Yahweh's appointed festivals. Something that Yahweh has appointed is something that Yahweh has chosen. It can also mean something that someone does at a special time or in a special way. In this case, it also might refer to the way that these special festivals happen on specific days of the year, which makes a sort of religious calendar for the Israelite people to follow.

Yahweh talks about four kinds of offerings in this passage: burnt offerings, grain offerings, sacrifices, and drink offerings. When Yahweh says "sacrifices" in this passage, Yahweh probably means fellowship or peace offerings.

Yahweh also mentions Yahweh's Sabbaths, which are the regular Sabbaths. The two Sabbaths that Yahweh mentions for the Festival of Tabernacles are special Sabbaths. This means that the people will celebrate the special Sabbaths as well as the other Sabbaths. Lastly, Yahweh mentions freewill offerings, which are offerings that Yahweh does not require the people to give. The Israelite people bring freewill offerings to Yahweh just because the people want to give these offerings.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, discuss something that you do or something that you give, just because you want to give it. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Yahweh gives more specific instructions about how the people should celebrate the Festival of Tabernacles or Shelters. Yahweh says that this festival should happen after the people have finished the harvest.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, talk about harvest time in your community. Pay attention to the words and phrases you use for things like crops, which are plants that people have harvested, and harvesting, which is the process where people gather and store these plants. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also tells Moses that the people should gather tree branches. The Israelite people should gather date palm branches, willow branches, and branches from other leafy trees.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of these different kinds of trees. Discuss what you would call these kinds of tree branches and these kinds of trees. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh instructs every Israelite person to build temporary shelters, probably for their families, and live in those shelters for the seven days of the festival. Yahweh instructs the people to celebrate together as a community.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: If someone is giving instructions that everyone in the community must follow, what language will that person use? Discuss how you want to translate the way Yahweh gives instructions here. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also says that all generations of the Israelite people should celebrate this festival. This celebration is a reminder that the Israelite people lived in shelters when Yahweh brought the people out of slavery in Egypt. Yahweh finishes his instructions with an important statement: "I am Yahweh, your God."

In the fourth scene, Moses tells the Israelite people about Yahweh's festivals.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:33–44 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- And the Israelite people, including those who give the offerings

Although you might not wish to represent this group with a person, Yahweh also mentions another group of people in this passage: the future descendants of the Israelite people from every generation.

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses to instruct the Israelite people how to celebrate the Festival of Tabernacles. The Israelite people must celebrate this festival for eight days. On the first and last day of the festival, the Israelite people must have holy worship celebrations. No one can work on those days. On every day of the festival, people are also supposed to give offerings to Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Yahweh deserves our attention in every season; or
- It is good for the people to come together to worship Yahweh. It will remind the people that we all serve Yahweh together as a community; or
- I think the people will like a break from work, but will the people complain about living in temporary shelters?

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh says that these are Yahweh's festivals. Yahweh reminds the people about the different kinds of offerings that the people are supposed to give Yahweh. Yahweh also mentions Sabbaths and freewill offerings in this scene. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am excited that the people will have so many chances to come together and be with me; or
- I hope the people remember these instructions; or
- It is hard for people to leave their work and rest, but I hope the people learn how to trust me by obeying my instructions.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh gives more specific instructions about how the people should celebrate the Festival of Tabernacles. Yahweh repeats most of the information from scene one. But Yahweh also tells Moses that the people should gather tree branches and build temporary shelters for this festival. Every Israelite person is supposed to live in these temporary shelters for the seven days of the festival. Yahweh says that all generations of the Israelite people should celebrate this festival. This celebration is a reminder that the Israelite people lived in shelters when Yahweh brought the Israelites out of slavery in Egypt. Yahweh finishes with an important statement: "I am Yahweh, your God." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Right now, we sleep in temporary shelters. Someday we will not sleep here, but in comfortable houses. Will we want to come sleep in temporary shelters again at that time? or
- This will remind us what Yahweh has saved us from; or
- Why do we have a special celebration that includes something uncomfortable?

Continue the drama. In the fourth scene, Moses tells the Israelite people about Yahweh's festivals.

For a possible additional exercise, you could have someone play the part of the future generations. You can also ask the future generations what they are feeling when they hear this story. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a descendant of the Israelite people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I cannot believe our ancestors lived like this all of the time; or
- I am excited. This celebration will be a good time to be together as a family and thank Yahweh for how Yahweh has taken care of us; or
- If we forget our past, we will not know why it is important to obey Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 23:33–44 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, **Yahweh** gives Moses instructions about how **the people of Israel** should celebrate the Festival of Tabernacles. For this festival, the people had to live in temporary shelters. Use the same words for Yahweh and the Israelites as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and **Israelites**, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what phrases you will use for **Festival of Tabernacles** and **shelters**. For more information on the Festival of Tabernacles and shelters, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh mentions many kinds of offerings in this passage, as a reminder of all the different offerings which Yahweh requires from the people. Use the same phrases for **burnt offering**, **grain offering**, **drink offering**, **fire offering**, **sacrifice**, and **freewill offering** as you used in previous passages. The Israelites are to bring these offerings in addition to any offerings they bring to fulfill a **vow** to Yahweh. For more information on any of these offerings, and on vow, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that these festivals are **holy assemblies** and **appointed festivals**. An assembly is a group of people that someone calls to meet together for a special reason. This assembly is holy because Yahweh set it apart and dedicated this gathering to Yahweh. Yahweh has "appointed," or chosen these festivals for a special purpose. Use the same words for holy assemblies and appointed festivals as you used in previous passages. For more information on **holy**, refer to the Master Glossary.

The people are supposed to celebrate these festivals as well as Yahweh's **Sabbath**. Use the same word for Sabbath as you used in previous passages. For more information on Sabbath, refer to the Master Glossary.

For the Festival of Tabernacles, the Israelite people took branches from **leafy trees**, including **palm trees** and **willow trees**, to build temporary dwellings or shelters for the people to live inside.

Stop here and look at pictures of the types of trees that the Israelite peoples would use to build these shelters. Discuss what you will call these trees and their branches in your language. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh calls these instructions a lasting **statute**, which means this is a rule that the people should follow every year, no matter what, for every **generation**. Use the same words for statute and generation as you used in previous passages. For more information on statute and generation, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 23:33–44

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (848 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.5 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 24:1–9

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 24:1–9 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 24:1–9 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 24:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

At this time, the Israelite people are still camping near Mount Sinai. The Israelites had recently completed building the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh has been giving Moses many instructions on how the Israelite people should live in a holy way. In this passage, Yahweh gives Moses instructions about how the priests should do certain rituals in the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh tells Moses to give these instructions to the Israelite people in a way that shows the Israelites that these rules are very important for the Israelites to follow.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, what are some of the religious rituals that people do? What are the rules for these rituals? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh commands the Israelite people to bring a certain kind of good olive oil. To make this good olive oil, people would first collect the olives by "beating" or hitting the olive trees with a stick or shaking the branches to make the olives fall off the tree. Then the people would crush the olives, either using their feet or by using a large stone and wood mill called an olive press.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of an olive press. Pause this audio here.

Then the people put the crushed olives into an olive press that would squeeze the oil out of the olives. People called oil "beaten" oil. The first oil that came out in this process would be the most clear and of the highest quality. This is the oil that Yahweh requires the Israelite people to give to the Israelite priests for priests to use in the Tent of Meeting.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of olive oil. Pause this audio here.

This oil would go in the lamps. Ancient people made regular oil lamps out of clay. These lamps looked like little bowls that could hold oil and often had a special place to put the wick. The wick is the part of the lamp that people light on fire. People would make wicks from plants. The people would fill a lamp with olive oil, light the wick on fire, and the wick would use the oil to keep the fire burning. But the lamps that the priests used in the Tent of Meeting were very special. The Israelite people had made a lampstand from pure gold as Yahweh had instructed. The people made seven lamps and a beautiful gold stand to hold all of the lamps. This gold lampstand with its seven lamps has been an important symbol of God's light and presence with the Israelites throughout history.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of regular oil lamps and the gold lampstand with its lamps. Pause this audio here.

The priests must make sure that these lamps stay lit with fire all throughout the night until morning, without the fires going out. Yahweh says that special lamps should be in the Tent of Meeting, in the Holy Place near the "curtain of the testimony." The curtain of the testimony is the beautiful curtain that hung between the Most Holy Place, where the ark of the covenant was, and the Holy Place, where the priests would perform certain important rituals. The word "testimony" is a reminder that the main reason why this curtain is there is to make a divide between Yahweh's presence on the ark of the covenant and the place where the priests serve Yahweh and worship. The priests stand just in front of the curtain of the testimony when the priests present certain offerings before Yahweh.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the curtain of the testimony that separates the Most Holy Place from the Holy Place. Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 24:1–9

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Why do you think it was important to keep the lamps burning? What are some religious rituals that your people make sure to always do? Why do people do this? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also wants the priests to set out special offerings of bread on a gold table in the Tent of Meeting. Some translations call this bread "showbread" or "bread of the presence." People called it this because the bread was to always be in the presence of Yahweh, in the Holy Place. There were 12 loaves of bread to represent the 12 tribes of Israel. It was a special bread that was only for Yahweh and the priests. We do not know who made this bread. Yahweh says to make the bread from the finest or best-quality flour. The person should make 12 loaves of this bread of the presence as cakes, which here means in round, flat shapes.

The person must use two-tenths of an ephah of flour, which is probably about 3 kilograms of flour. That is a lot of flour for each loaf! We are not sure how big these loaves would be. Some people think that these loaves must be very big. Other people think that maybe the loaves were small but very heavy. Maybe the people made the loaves in a special way, or maybe the measurements mean something different here. We do not know exactly what the answer is. But we do know that the priests put the bread in two piles, six cakes in each pile, on the gold table in the Holy Place.

People sometimes call this special gold table in the Tent of Meeting the table of the bread of the presence. Israelite craftsmen made the table from acacia wood and covered the table all over with gold. Like the ark of the covenant, the table had rings and poles so that people could carry the table from place to place as the Israelite people moved around the wilderness.

Stop here as a group and look at a map of the Tent of Meeting. Find the location of the table of the bread of the presence. Also, look at a picture of the gold table of the bread of the presence and the bread on the table. Pause this audio here.

The priests also must put frankincense on top of the two piles of special bread. Frankincense is a mixture of sap and gum that people can collect from a certain kind of tree. The tree sap hardens into little pieces of resin, but it looks like little white rocks. Frankincense smells very good, and the Israelites would often burn the frankincense to make a good smell. The priests probably take the frankincense and put it in two gold bowls. The priest put these gold bowls on top of or beside the two piles of bread. Every Sabbath, the priests have to take this frankincense and burn it on the altar of incense. The frankincense is Yahweh's portion of the bread of the presence. This is one of the offerings that the Israelites called the food offering or fire offering.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of frankincense and the altar of incense. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what smells do people really like? If possible, try to think of something that people burn to make a nice smell. Pause this audio here.

The priests should do this every Sabbath without stopping. It is an "everlasting covenant," or an agreement that does not stop. Aaron and Aaron's male descendants can eat this special bread, but these men must eat the bread in the sanctuary, or holy place, because it is holy bread.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 24:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh gives Moses instructions about how to do important jobs that Yahweh requires Israelite priests to do in the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh tells Moses to tell these important instructions to the Israelite people.

In the second scene: Yahweh wants the Israelite people to bring olive oil to the Israelite priests. The priests will use this oil to keep the fire lit in the lamps in the special gold lampstand. Yahweh's rule is that the fire of these lamps should burn every night, always.

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In the third scene: Yahweh also wants the priests to set out special bread on a gold table in the Tent of Meeting. The priests should put the bread in two piles, six loaves in each pile. The priests also put frankincense on top of the bread. The priests should offer this frankincense as an offering every Sabbath. The priests must do this ritual without stopping. Aaron and Aaron's male descendants can eat this bread, but these men must eat the bread in a holy place because it is holy bread.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Israelite people
- Aaron
- And Aaron's male descendants

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

The Israelite people are still camping in the wilderness near Mount Sinai. The Israelites had recently finished building the Tent of Meeting as Yahweh had instructed. Yahweh is giving Moses instructions about how the Israelite people are to live and worship Yahweh, including special instructions for how the priests should perform holy rituals.

In the first scene, Yahweh gives Moses instructions about how to do important jobs that Yahweh requires the Israelite priests to do in the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh tells Moses to tell these important instructions to the Israelite people.

Stop here and discuss how you pass information from person to person in your language. Talk about how you want to translate something that Yahweh told to Moses, and that Yahweh wanted Moses to tell to the people. Pause this audio here.

Here, Yahweh says to Moses that Moses needs to command the Israelite people to do this. When someone commands something, they tell someone something in an important way. This means that Yahweh is about to tell Moses some very important rules, and that the Israelites need to pay attention and follow these rules carefully.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, how do you tell someone that it is really important for that person to do something or to follow a certain rule or instruction? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh commands the Israelite people to bring olive oil to the Israelite priests. This oil is supposed to be the olive oil with the best quality. Good-quality olive oil can be a deep yellow color or a deep green color, and it has a smooth texture. A person could describe this good quality by saying that the oil is pure or clear. This olive oil is clear in the sense that it does not have any impurities in it. This olive oil is so clear that you can see through it like clean water.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, how do you talk about something that is the best quality? Pick something, if possible oil, and talk about what you think makes it good or not good. Notice the words you use. Pause this audio here.

The priests must make sure that these lamps stay lit with fire all throughout the night until morning, without the fires going out. The priests must do this every single night, always, no matter what. However, the lamps are only lit from evening until morning, so this does not mean without stopping. Try to find a word that explains this idea of keeping the fires going all night without going out, and of doing this repeatedly. But try to stay away from words that might make people think that the priests must keep the lamps lit during the day.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, talk about how you might keep a fire going. Notice the words you use. Also, talk about how you discuss something that must happen constantly for a time, and must happen every day, over and over. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that special lamps should be in the Tent of Meeting, in the Holy Place. These lamps should be in front of the "curtain of the testimony." This curtain is the beautiful curtain that hung between the Most Holy Place, where the ark of the covenant was, and the Holy Place, where the priests performed certain important rituals. The word "testimony" is a reminder that the main reason why this curtain was there was to make a

divide between Yahweh's presence on the ark of the covenant and the place where the priests served Yahweh and worshipped.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the curtain of the sanctuary. Pause this audio here.

Ancient people would make regular oil lamps out of clay and wicks out of plants. The people would fill the lamps with olive oil, light the wick, and the wick would use the oil to keep the fire burning. But the lamps that the priests use in the Tent of Meeting are very special. The Israelite people made the lamps from pure gold. The Israelites made seven lamps and a beautiful gold stand to hold all of the lamps.

Stop here as a group and look again at pictures of regular oil lamps and the special gold lamps and lampstand in the Tent of Meeting as needed. In your language, describe how the lamps work. You may wish to discuss what special words to use for lamps and lampstand. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Yahweh says the priests must set out special offerings of bread on a gold table in the Tent of Meeting. Sometimes translators call this bread "showbread" or "bread of the presence." It means it is the bread that the priests display near Yahweh's presence. People called it this because the bread was to always be in the presence of Yahweh, in the Holy Place. Sometimes it helps to have a special word or phrase for this bread, since it was a special bread that was only for Yahweh and the priests.

Stop here and discuss: What will you call this bread in your language? In your translation of this phrase, how can you show that this bread is holy and that this bread was close to Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh instructs that the person who makes the bread should make the bread out of the finest flour, which is the best quality flour. The person must use two-tenths of an ephah of flour, which is probably about 3 kilograms. Yahweh says the person must make these loaves as cakes, which here means in round, flat shapes.

Stop here and discuss: What word can you use in your language to describe this bread as round and flat? Pause this audio here.

The person should make 12 of these loaves. The priests would put the loaves on the special gold table that people sometimes called the table of the bread of the presence. The table was a special gold table. The table was 88 centimeters long, 45 centimeters wide, and 67 centimeters tall. The priests must put the bread on the table in two piles, six loaves in each pile.

Stop here as a group and look at a map of the Tent of Meeting. Find the location of the table of the bread of the presence. Also, look at a picture of the gold table of the bread of the presence and the bread on top. Pause this audio here.

The priests must also put frankincense on top of the two piles of special bread. Frankincense is a mixture of sap and gum that people could collect from a certain kind of tree. The tree sap hardens into little pieces of resin, but it looks like little white rocks. Frankincense smells very good, and the Israelites often burned the frankincense to make a good smell. The priests should take frankincense and put it in two gold bowls. The priests put these gold bowls on top of the two piles of bread. Every Sabbath, the priests must take this frankincense and burn it on the altar of incense. The frankincense is Yahweh's portion of the bread of the presence. This is one of the offerings that the Israelites called the food offering or fire offering.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of frankincense and the altar of incense. Also, look at a map of the Tent of Meeting as a group. Find the location of the altar of incense. Pause this audio here.

The priests must do this every Sabbath without stopping. It is an "everlasting covenant," or an agreement that does not stop. Aaron and his sons, or male descendants, can eat this bread, but these men must eat the bread in a holy place because it is holy bread. This holy place is probably anywhere in the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 24:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Leviticus 24:1–9

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Israelite people
- Aaron
- And Aaron's male descendants

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh gives Moses instructions about how to do important jobs that Yahweh requires the Israelite priests to do in the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh tells Moses to tell these important instructions to the Israelite people. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- It is good that Yahweh gives us specific instructions for all the rituals in the Tent of Meeting; or
- I must remember all of these things so that I can explain the instructions well to the Israelite people; or
- I wonder if the people will be happy about these instructions or if the people will be angry again.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh says that the Israelite people must bring olive oil to the Israelite priests. The priests will use this oil to keep the fire lit in the lamps in the special gold lampstand. Yahweh's rule is that the fire from these lamps should burn every night, always. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy to give a special offering to Yahweh; or
- Yahweh gets the best of our olive oil, just like Yahweh gets the best of our flocks and the best of our flour. Yahweh must be very important! or
- Why are the priests the only ones who can go into the Tent of Meeting? Yahweh's lamp is lit all night long, but we cannot see the lamp.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh says that the priests must set out special bread on a gold table in the Tent of Meeting. The priests should put the bread in two piles, with six loaves in each pile. The priests also must put frankincense on top of the bread. The priests should offer this frankincense as a part of the offering every Sabbath. The priests must do this ritual without stopping. Aaron and Aaron's male descendants can eat this bread, but these men must eat the bread in a holy place because it is holy bread. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Aaron and his male descendants, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- It is a great honor that we can eat Yahweh's special bread offering; or
- There are 12 special bread loaves, just like there are 12 tribes of Israel; or
- I always look forward to this offering on the Sabbath because the frankincense fills the whole Tent of Meeting with such a nice smell.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 24:1–9 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh gives Moses instructions for the **people of Israel**. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh and the people of Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and **Israelite**, refer to the Master Glossary.

In the Tent of Meeting, the Israelite priests must always have the special oil lamps burning with fire. These oil lamps were on a special gold lampstand that holds seven lamps. For more information on oil lamps, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of olive oil, everyday oil lamps, and the Tent of Meeting lampstand. If you have not done so for another book, discuss what words or phrases you will use for "**oil lamp**" and "**special gold lampstand**." Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh talks about the curtain of the testimony. This is the curtain that divides the Holy Place from the Most Holy Place inside the Tent of Meeting. The priests who served in the Tent of Meeting could not see the ark of the testimony because of this curtain.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of the curtain of the **testimony**. If you call this the curtain of the testimony, refer to the Master Glossary for more information about testimony. Pause this audio here.

In the **Tent of Meeting**, there was a gold table where the priests would put the special offering of bread. In other books of the Bible, people call this the table of the bread of the presence. Use the same word for "Tent of Meeting" as you used in previous passages. For more information on the Tent of Meeting, refer to **tabernacle** in the Master Glossary.

Stop here as a group and look at a map of the Tent of Meeting. Find the location of the gold table of the **bread of the presence**. Also, look at a picture of the gold table and the bread of the presence. If you choose to call this bread the "bread of the presence," refer to the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

People should make each loaf of bread with two-tenths of an **ephah** of the finest flour. This was probably about 3 kilograms of flour. If you use an ephah in your translation, use the same word or phrase for ephah as you have used previously, and remember that ephah is in the Master Glossary.

Yahweh calls these instructions a lasting **statute**, which means this is a rule that the people should follow every year, no matter what, for every **generation**. Use the same words for statute and generation as you used in previous passages. For more information on statute and generation, refer to the Master Glossary.

The priests put gold bowls of **frankincense** on top of the bread of the presence as a **memorial portion** and a **fire offering**. You will remember that some people think that the memorial portion was a physical way for people to remember the covenant between Yahweh and Yahweh's people. Other people think it was supposed to call Yahweh's attention to the reason the person was offering the gift. Use the same words or phrases for "memorial portion" and "fire offering" as you have used previously. For more information, refer to "memorial portion" and "fire offering" in the Master Glossary.

Every week, the priests would take the **frankincense** and burn the frankincense on the **altar** of incense. Use the same words for frankincense and altar as you used in previous passages. For more information about altar, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of frankincense and the altar of incense. Pause this audio here.

The priest must put the bread on the table every **Sabbath** as a lasting **covenant**. Use the same words for Sabbath and covenant as you used in previous passages. For more information on Sabbath and covenant, refer to the Master Glossary.

Aaron and Aaron's descendants can eat their **holy** portion of the bread in the **sanctuary** or holy place. This is not just the Holy Place in the Tent of Meeting, but includes the courtyard of the Tent of Meeting as well. Use

the same word or phrase for holy and sanctuary as you used in previous passages. For more information on holy and sanctuary, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 24:1–9

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (846 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.9 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 24:10–23

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 24:10–23 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 24:10–23 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 24:10–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this passage, the storyteller of Leviticus tells a story that introduces the laws Yahweh gave about how to punish someone who hurt or killed a person or animal. In this story, a man whose mother was an Israelite and whose father was an Egyptian came into the camp where the Israelites were. This man was not a full Israelite because his father was an Egyptian.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you determine who is part of your culture and who is not? Do you have different rules for people in your culture and for people who are not? Pause this audio here.

This man, whose mother was an Israelite, got into a fight with an Israelite. In this fight, the two people probably used their hands and their feet to hit each other.

While the two people were fighting, the man whose mother was an Israelite used Yahweh's name in a curse. When a person cursed in cultures around Israel, that person asked a god or a spirit to do something harmful to someone else. This man might have asked Yahweh to do something harmful to the person the man was fighting. Or the man might have asked another god to do something harmful to Yahweh. Either way, when the man made this curse, the man deeply insulted and dishonored Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people curse other people? Who or what do people expect to harm the person they curse? What would happen if someone spoke disrespectfully about gods or spirits? Pause this audio here.

When the man misused Yahweh's name in the curse, the people who heard the man brought the man to Moses. The mother of the man who cursed had the name "Shelomith." Shelomith's father's name was Dibri. Shelomith belonged to the tribe of Dan, which means Shelomith was one of Dan's descendants. The people put this man who cursed in a place where the man could not escape, and then the people waited for Yahweh to tell the people what to do.

Yahweh told Moses that Yahweh wanted the Israelites to take the man who blasphemed Yahweh's name outside the camp. Then everyone who heard the man blaspheme Yahweh's name needed to lay their hands on the man's head. The people probably needed to lay their hands on the man's head to show that these people were not murdering the man when these people killed the man. The people also might have laid their hands on the man's head because this man made the people impure when the people heard the man blaspheme Yahweh's name. The people wanted to show that the people were transferring their impurity onto the man before the people killed the man. After the people who heard the man blaspheme Yahweh's name put their hands on his head, all the Israelites needed to throw stones at the man until the man died.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people do when someone misuses the name of a powerful person, or a spirit or god? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh told Moses to talk to the Israelites. Yahweh wanted the Israelites to know that anyone who curses Yahweh has sinned. The Israelites needed to execute anyone who misused Yahweh's name. All the Israelites together needed to throw stones at a person who misused Yahweh's name until that person died. If someone misused Yahweh's name, the Israelites needed to kill that person, whether the person was an Israelite or a foreigner. Sometimes, people had different rules for someone who was a citizen and someone who was a foreigner, so Yahweh wanted the Israelites to know that Yahweh expected the people to obey this law no matter who misused Yahweh's name.

Then Yahweh talked about other reasons that the Israelites might execute someone. If someone killed an animal, that person needed to give the owner another animal as a replacement. Yahweh was talking about when a person killed an animal that belonged to someone else; Yahweh was not talking about when people kill a wild animal. Yahweh expected the Israelites to give a life when the Israelites took a life. The Israelites could give a life by replacing an animal if someone killed an animal. But the Israelites had to give a life by killing a person if that person killed another person.

Yahweh said the Israelites must punish a person by injuring that person in the same way that the person injured other people. The Israelites needed to punish someone who fractured a victim's bone by fracturing the person's bones. The Israelites needed to remove someone's eye if that person removed someone else's eye, and the Israelites needed to remove someone's tooth if that person removed someone else's tooth. Yahweh said again that a person who kills an animal needs to replace the animal, and Yahweh said again that the Israelites needed to execute someone who kills a person.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people punish someone who injures someone else? How do people punish someone who killed an animal? How do people punish someone who killed a person? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh said that Yahweh expected both Israelites and foreigners to obey the laws that Yahweh is telling the people. The people needed to obey because Yahweh is their God.

After Yahweh told Moses all this, Moses told the Israelites what Yahweh said. Then the Israelites took the man who blasphemed Yahweh's name out of the camp and threw stones at that man until he died. The Israelites did exactly what Yahweh commanded Moses to tell the Israelites to do.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 24:10–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: A half-Israelite man blasphemes Yahweh's name.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites to kill the man.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells Moses to tell the Israelites what to do when someone blasphemes Yahweh's name, kills a person or an animal, or injures a person.

In the fourth scene: The Israelites kill the man who blasphemed Yahweh's name.

The characters in this passage are:

- A man whose mother was an Israelite and whose father was an Egyptian
- An Israelite man, who fights with the first man
- The Israelites
- Moses
- Yahweh
- And foreigners

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Remember that in previous passages, Yahweh told Moses about holidays and festivals, as well as how to make the oil and bread for the tabernacle. Also, remember that in previous passages, Yahweh was telling Moses the rules that Yahweh expects the Israelites to obey, but the storyteller has not told many stories about what people do.

In this passage, the storyteller of Leviticus tells a story. The storyteller of Leviticus may tell this story to show why Yahweh gave the laws about how to punish someone who hurt or killed an animal or human. This story shows one reason to execute someone, and reminds the Israelites that Yahweh is the one who gives the laws.

In the first scene, a man whose mother was an Israelite and whose father was an Egyptian enters the Israelites' camp and fights an Israelite. This might mean that the man comes out of the tent the man is living in and goes near other people in the camp. Or it might mean that the man lives outside the camp where the Israelites live, but then the man enters the camp.

Stop here and discuss as a group: How will you say that the man went among the Israelites in the camp? Pause this audio here.

The storyteller says that the man whose mother was an Israelite blasphemes, or speaks evil, about "the Name." While the storyteller does not say whose name this is, the Israelites would know that this is Yahweh's name. Sometimes, in order to show deep respect to Yahweh, the Israelites just say "the Name," instead of "Yahweh." To show that the Israelites really do not want to blaspheme Yahweh, the Israelites would not even say Yahweh's name as the Israelites talked about the way that people curse.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people show that they deeply respect someone? What would be disrespectful ways or times to mention someone's name? What would be the best way to translate when the storyteller of Leviticus says that the half-Israelite blasphemed the name? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, when the man blasphemes Yahweh's name, the people who hear the man take the man to Moses. The storyteller now explains that the man's mother's name was Shelomith. Shelomith is the daughter of a man whose name is Dibri. Shelomith is one of Dan's descendants. You will remember that Dan is one of the sons of Jacob, and the ancestor of one of the 12 tribes of Israel. The storyteller probably tells us who the man's ancestors are when the Israelites bring the man to Moses, because Moses probably asks the man for that information when Moses asks the man about what happened. The people who heard the man blaspheme Yahweh want Moses to ask Yahweh what Yahweh wants the people to do with this man. The Israelites probably do not know what to do with the man. The man's father is an Egyptian, so this man is not fully a part of the Israelite people group. The Israelites probably are not sure if their rules are the same for this man. Then the storyteller tells us that the Israelites put the man somewhere that the man cannot escape.

The people probably tell Moses what happened, and then Moses speaks to Yahweh. The storyteller does not tell us that part of the story, but just begins to tell us what Yahweh says. The people who first heard this story would probably assume that the people talked to Moses and that Moses then talked to Yahweh. Yahweh tells Moses that Yahweh wants the Israelites to take the man who blasphemed Yahweh's name outside the camp. The people who heard the man blaspheme Yahweh's name need to put their hand on the man's head, and then all the Israelites need to stone the man. When Yahweh says all the Israelites need to stone the man, Yahweh probably does not mean that each individual Israelite needs to throw stones at the man. The Israelites must gather together as a group, or an assembly, to throw stones until the man is dead, even if not everyone throws a stone.

In the second scene, after Yahweh tells Moses what to do in this situation, Yahweh then tells Moses what to do in other times when people curse Yahweh. Yahweh tells the Israelites that anyone who blasphemes Yahweh will lift up, or carry, their sin. When Yahweh says the person will carry their sin, Yahweh is using special language to mean that the person will be guilty and that someone must punish the person. Yahweh is talking as if that person's sin is a physical object that the person holds in their hand, and because the person is holding the sin, someone needs to punish that person.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate when Yahweh says that an Israelite who curses Yahweh will carry their sin? Pause this audio here.

The Israelites need to execute anyone who blasphemes Yahweh's name. All the Israelites need to throw stones at a person who blasphemes Yahweh's name until the person dies. The Israelites need to execute both Israelites and foreigners who blaspheme Yahweh's name.

Then Yahweh tells the Israelites to execute anyone who kills a human. Yahweh also says that anyone who kills an animal needs to pay money to the person who owned the animal. Yahweh says, "life for life." When Yahweh says life for life, Yahweh is using special language to mean that a person must experience the same harmful thing that the person did to someone else. If the person caused someone to lose an animal, the person also needs to lose an animal. If the person caused someone else to die, that person must also die.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people make sure a punishment is fair? If someone does something bad, the same thing must happen to that person? How would you talk about that in your language? What is the best way to say "life for life"? Remember that Yahweh will use similar special language in the next part of the passage. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites need to punish anyone who injures someone else by injuring that person in the same way. Yahweh says, "fracture for fracture." This is special language Yahweh uses to mean that if a certain person fractures someone's bone, the Israelites need to fracture the same bone in the attacker's body. Yahweh also says "eye for eye" and "tooth for tooth." Both of these are special language that Yahweh uses to mean that if someone attacks a person and removes that person's eye or tooth, the Israelites need to remove that attacker's eye or tooth. The attacker needs to suffer from the same injury that the attacker caused to someone else. Yahweh probably means that the Israelites need to punish the attacker by giving the attacker the exact same injury the attacker gave someone else. Yahweh might mean that the Israelites need to punish an attacker in a way that is as bad as what the attacker did to another person.

Yahweh says that the person who kills an animal needs to replace the animal with a similar animal. The Israelites need to execute a person who kills a human. Yahweh probably mentions these ordinances about when a person kills an animal or a human again because Yahweh wants the Israelites to know how much Yahweh wants the Israelites to obey these rules.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time someone repeated a rule to let people know how important it was. How did that person repeat the rule? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites that the Israelites need to follow these ordinances for both foreigners and Israelites. The Israelites need to follow these ordinances because Yahweh is their God. Yahweh wants the Israelites to clearly understand that Yahweh takes care of the Israelites and is leading the Israelites so that the Israelites will do what Yahweh tells the Israelites to do.

In the third scene, Moses tells the Israelites what Yahweh told Moses to say. The Israelites take the person who blasphemed Yahweh's name outside the camp, and the Israelites throw stones at the man until the man dies. The storyteller of Leviticus says that the Israelites do what Yahweh commanded Moses. The storyteller says that Yahweh commanded Moses because Yahweh gave the rules to Moses, but Yahweh wanted all the Israelites to do what Yahweh commanded. When the storyteller says that the Israelites did what Yahweh told Moses to tell them to do, the storyteller confirms that people who read or heard this story later should act as the Israelites acted in this story, because the Israelites acted in a right way.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a person or group of people that you want other people to act like. How do you let other people know that people should act like the person or people in the story? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 24:10–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- A man whose mother was an Israelite and whose father was an Egyptian
- An Israelite man, who fights with the first man
- The Israelites
- Moses
- Yahweh
- And foreigners

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Leviticus 24:10–23

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, a man whose mother was an Israelite and whose father was an Egyptian went into the Israelite camp where Israelites were. The man and another Israelite started fighting each other. The man whose mother was an Israelite blasphemed Yahweh’s name by using Yahweh’s name in a curse.

In the second scene, the people who heard the man took the man to Moses. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a man whose mother was an Israelite and whose father was an Egyptian, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I was so angry when I fought with that other Israelite! or
- I should have respected Yahweh even though I am not a full Israelite; or
- I am so afraid that Yahweh will make the Israelites kill me.

Continue the drama. This man’s mother was named Shelomith, and her father was named Dibri. Dibri was one of Dan’s descendants. The Israelites put the man in a place where the man could not escape until Yahweh clearly told the Israelites what Yahweh wanted the Israelites to do with the man. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- This man is only half-Israelite; what are we supposed to do with this man? Does this man follow our same laws? or
- I am mad at this man because this man disrespected Yahweh; or
- I am surprised that this man would say something like that! We have seen how powerful Yahweh is. I know Yahweh heard this man and will be angry with this man!

Continue the drama. Yahweh told Moses to take the man outside the Israelite camp. Everyone who heard the man blaspheme Yahweh’s name needed to put their hands on the man’s head. Then all the Israelites needed to throw stones at the man until the man died.

In the second scene, Yahweh told Moses to tell the Israelites to execute anyone who blasphemes Yahweh’s name. All the Israelites need to throw stones at the person who blasphemes Yahweh’s name together. The Israelites need to execute any person who blasphemes Yahweh’s name, whether that person is a foreigner or an Israelite. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am angry that this man would insult me; or
- I am glad that my people want to know what the right thing to do is; or
- My name and my reputation are very important; or
- Even people who are not Israelites need to respect me; or
- I want people to realize how holy I am.

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh said that the Israelites need to execute anyone who kills a human. Yahweh also said that anyone who kills an animal needs to replace the animal with a similar animal, and give a life for a life.

Then Yahweh says that if anyone injures another person, the Israelites need to give that person the same injury that person gave. The Israelites need to fracture the same bone that a person fractures, remove the same eye that a person removes, and remove the same tooth that a person removes. In the same way any person injures someone else, the Israelites need to injure that person. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that Yahweh requires the Israelites to properly punish anyone who hurts me; or
- I wish that I could punish someone who hurt me more; or

Leviticus 24:10–23

- I am glad that if I hurt someone, other people will not hurt me worse than I hurt someone.

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh said that a person who kills an animal needs to repay the person who owned the animal, and that the Israelites need to kill a person who kills a human. The Israelites need to apply these ordinances equally to the Israelites and the foreigners who live with the Israelites because Yahweh is their God.

In the third scene, Moses told the Israelites what Yahweh told Moses to say. So the Israelites took the man who blasphemed Yahweh's name outside the Israelite camp and threw stones at the man until the man died. The Israelites did exactly what Yahweh commanded Moses to tell the Israelites to do.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 24:10–23 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, a man whose mother was an **Israelite** and whose father was an Egyptian gave a **curse**. When someone curses, that person asks a god or spirit to harm another person or even a god. Use the same words or phrases for Israelites and for curse as you used in previous passages. For more information on Israelites and curse, refer to the Master Glossary.

The man who was a half-Israelite blasphemed God. To blaspheme someone means to speak evil about a person, and to insult someone. A person who curses God, insults God, dishonors God, or makes God seem less powerful or important is blaspheming God. The punishment for blasphemy was death.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "blaspheme." Use the same word or phrase for **blasphemy** as you used in previous books of the Bible. For more information on blasphemy, refer to the Master Glossary. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites wanted to know what **Yahweh** wanted the Israelites to do. Yahweh is the personal name that the one true God gave to the Israelites to call God. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh will not allow anyone to curse **God**. In the Bible, God refers to God who created everything. God is Yahweh, and he is the most powerful spiritual being. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary.

If someone curses Yahweh, that person will carry their **sin**, or be guilty for what they have done wrong. Any time that a person breaks one of God's laws, that person sins. Use the same word or phrase for sin as you used in previous passages. For more information on sin, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that the entire **assembly**, or large group of Israelites, should throw stones at the person until he dies. Use the same word or phrase for assembly as you have used previously.

Yahweh said that even **foreigners** who cursed Yahweh needed to die. When someone is a foreigner, that person is living in a country that the person is not from. Use the same word or phrase for foreigner as you used in previous passages. For more information on foreigner, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh requires the Israelites to punish someone who hurts their **neighbor**. "Neighbor" can mean people in your community or with whom you come into contact. In the Old Testament, neighbors often referred to people groups who lived in the same land area or region. Use the same word or phrase for neighbor as you used in previous passages. For more information on neighbor, refer to the Master Glossary.

The people need to apply Yahweh's decision, or **ordinances**, to both Israelites and foreigners. An ordinance is a decision that a leader makes about what people should do in a specific situation. Use the same word or phrase for ordinance as you used in previous passages. For more information on ordinance, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 24:10–23

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (852 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 25:1–7

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 25:1–7 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:1–7 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh is giving Moses instructions to prepare the Israelite people for when the Israelites move into Canaan, the land that Yahweh has promised to the Israelites. Moses and the Israelite people are still camped near Mount

Leviticus 25:1–7

Sinai at this time. Moses goes up on this mountain to talk with Yahweh. Mount Sinai is part of a very rocky mountain range in the wilderness.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of Mount Sinai. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells Moses that these instructions are for when the Israelite people come into the land. This land is Canaan, the land that Yahweh had promised to give the Israelites' ancestors: Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. Many of the instructions in this part of Leviticus are instructions for the people to follow later when the Israelites live in the land of Canaan. So it will be many years after the people hear these instructions before the people can follow these instructions.

Yahweh says that when the Israelite people come into the land, the Israelites need to give the land a Sabbath or rest every seven years. In the Bible, the number seven often represents things that are holy or important to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, what traditions do people keep that happen at certain times or after a certain number of years? What numbers are the most important or have special meaning in your culture? Pause this audio here.

The idea of Sabbath is different in this passage than in previous passages. The word for Sabbath means seven in the original language, and the Israelites would think of the Sabbath as referring to the seventh day of the week, or Saturday. This is the holy day of the week for the Israelite people. Yahweh requires that on this holy day, the Israelites must do two things: the Israelites must worship Yahweh and the Israelites must rest from any hard work. The Israelite people would have already been familiar with the Sabbath as a day on which the Israelites worshipped and rested. So the word Sabbath has this idea of seven, but also a meaning of rest. Both of these meanings are important and would be familiar to the Israelite people listening to this instruction.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, what is the most important thing that people do on holy days? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that for six years, the Israelite people may plant their fields, take care of their vineyards, and harvest their crops. The word that Yahweh uses here for "fields" can be any kind of land on which a person can grow crops. It includes fields where Israelite people can grow grains such as wheat and barley.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of grain fields and crops. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, what kind of grain or food is most common? What words would you use for these kinds of grains, or for grains in general, in your language? Pause this audio here.

But the word "fields" can also include any kind of orchard. The Israelites eventually would grow pomegranate bushes, olive trees, fig trees, and date palm trees for their fruit as well.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of pomegranates, olives, dates, and figs, and their trees. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss: In your culture, which fruit trees or plants are the most important? Pause this audio here.

During the six years, the people are also supposed to take care of their vineyards. People must cut off old, dead leaves from grapevines to help the plant grow and produce new fruit.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of a vineyard and grapes. Tell a story about a time when you saw a plant that had too many dead leaves or too many branches so that the plant could not grow food. How could someone help that plant be ready to grow food again? Pause this audio here.

After six years of planting and taking care of their fields or vineyards, the Israelites must spend the next year, the seventh year, not harvesting or taking care of the land.

Instead, the people are supposed to eat what the people can find and take what the people need from whatever is growing whenever the people need it. Even without the Israelite people actively working the land, the plants will still produce things to eat. The trees, such as the fig trees and the date palm trees, will still produce their fruit. The uncut vineyards will still produce some grapes, but not as many. And seeds that fell into the ground the year before will cause plants like barley and wheat to grow, too.

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This is the rule, not just for the Israelite people, but for all the people from other people groups who live with the Israelite people, as well as the Israelite people's livestock. Livestock means every kind of animal that the people raise for meat and milk, such as cattle, sheep, and goats.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses at Mount Sinai to give these instructions to the Israelite people about how to treat the land the Israelites will one day live in.

In the second scene: Yahweh says that for six years, the Israelite people may plant their fields, take care of their vineyards, and harvest their crops.

In the third scene: Yahweh says that in the seventh year, the Israelite people must not plant their fields or take care of their vineyards or harvest their fields like the Israelites normally do. Instead, all of the people and the animals are to eat what they can find and take what they need.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Israelite people
- Male and female servants
- Hired workers
- And temporary residents

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh is giving Moses instructions to prepare the Israelite people for when the Israelites move into the land that Yahweh has promised to the Israelites. Moses and the Israelite people are still camped near Mount Sinai at this point. Moses goes up on this mountain to talk with Yahweh.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of Mount Sinai. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells Moses that these instructions are for when the Israelite people come into the land. Many of the instructions in this part of Leviticus are instructions for the people to follow later. From the time the Israelites heard these instructions, it would be many years before the people could follow these instructions.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, how would you give someone instructions for something to do later? Pause this audio here.

It is also important to know that Yahweh gives these instructions for all of the Israelites to follow. Sometimes it sounds like these instructions were for one person. But these instructions were for everyone. So, translate in a way that makes it clear to your listeners that these instructions were for every person.

In the second scene, Yahweh says that for six years the Israelite people may sow seeds in their fields, take care of their vineyards, and harvest their crops. The word "sow" refers to the way that people scatter seeds on the ground so that the seeds can grow into plants. The Israelite people would plant crops such as wheat and barley, pomegranates, figs, and dates.

Stop here as a group and look at pictures of grain fields and crops. How do you plant seeds in your culture? Discuss how you want to translate the way that Yahweh says the Israelites can sow their seeds. Pause this audio here.

The Israelite people can also grow and tend vineyards, where people grow grapes. The Israelite people can cut off or prune the old growth on the vines so that the new vines can grow.

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Stop here as a group and look at pictures of a vineyard and grapes. How do you talk about the way that people cut off parts of a plant to help the plant grow new branches or more fruit? Discuss how you will translate the way that people prune or cut off old growth here. Pause this audio here.

The Israelite people can also harvest their crops, which is when the people gather all the crops and store the crops to eat throughout the year.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, what words do you use to talk about the way people harvest and gather the food that has grown on the plants? Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Yahweh talks about what the Israelites must do in the seventh year. The Israelite people must not plant their fields, or take care of their vineyards, or organize any harvesting. Yahweh calls this "giving the land a Sabbath." The idea of Sabbath has a few different meanings. It means "seven." It is also the name of the seventh day of the week, Saturday. Remember, Yahweh instructed the Israelite people to set aside the Sabbath as a holy day to worship Yahweh and rest from work, so the Israelites probably thought about rest when the Israelites thought about the Sabbath. When you translate this word, remember that this word refers to the number seven and is connected to the idea of rest from work. In the original language, Yahweh says the land must rest. But really, it is the people who are resting from their regular work in the fields. The Israelite people are not supposed to do this only once, but instead, the Israelites are supposed to do this every seven years.

Stop here and discuss: In your language, what do you think is the best way to translate the Sabbath rest for the land, or for the people in the land? Pause this audio here.

Instead, during this seventh year, the people can eat what the people can find and take what the people need from whatever is growing whenever they need it. Even without the Israelite people actively working the land, the plants will still grow things to eat. The trees, such as the fig trees and the date palm trees, will still produce their fruit. The uncut vineyards will still produce grapes. And seeds that fell into the ground the year before will cause plants like barley and wheat to grow, too.

This is the rule, not just for the Israelite people, but for all the people who will live with the Israelite people. This includes three groups of people besides the Israelites: the people who live in the household, such as male and female slaves, the other workers that the Israelite people hire, and any foreigner who lives among the Israelites. It is even the rule for the Israelite people's livestock. Livestock refers to every kind of animal that the people keep, such as cattle, sheep, and goats. Even wild animals will eat in this way.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- Israelite people
- Male and female servants
- Hired workers
- And temporary residents or people from other people groups

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

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The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Yahweh tells Moses at Mount Sinai to give these instructions to the Israelite people. Yahweh says that for six years the Israelite people may plant their fields, take care of their vineyards, and harvest their crops. But during the seventh year, the Israelite people must not plant their fields or take care of their vineyards or organize any harvest. Instead, all of the people and the animals are to eat what they can find and take what they need from whatever grows. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- How can we go a whole year without growing food? or
- Yahweh provided food for us in the wilderness. Yahweh will provide for us again; or
- I am worried that my family will go hungry.

Ask the person playing the servants, hired workers, and the people from other people groups, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- Our gods would never tell us to take such a rest for a whole year; or
- Who is this Yahweh, who provides even for people who do not work? or
- Perhaps the Israelite people will not work, but we will keep growing food. Otherwise, we will all go hungry.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:1–7 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh speaks to Moses at **Mount Sinai**, a mountain in the wilderness. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and Mount Sinai as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of Mount Sinai. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh gives Moses instructions for the **people of Israel**. Use the same word or phrase for people of Israel as you used in previous passages. For more information on **Israelites**, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says the land should have a **Sabbath** rest. Normally, the word Sabbath means the last day of the week or the day that the Israelite people would rest for a whole day. In this passage, Yahweh commands the people to allow the land to have a Sabbath or rest for a whole year. Use the same word for Sabbath as you used in previous passages. For more information on Sabbath, refer to the Master Glossary.

During the Sabbath rest for the year, the Israelites must not plant or take care of their **vineyards** and **fields** where they grow crops. The Israelites must not harvest **grapes** as the Israelites normally do. Use the same words for vineyards, grapes, and fields as you used in previous passages. For more information on vineyards, refer to the Master Glossary.

This rule is for the Israelites, for the Israelites' male and female **slaves** and **hired workers**, and for **foreigners**. Slaves are people who work for someone else without pay, usually for a long time. Hired workers are people that someone would hire and pay, usually to do a job for a short time. Foreigners are people who live in a different country from the country in which that person was born. Use the same words for male and female slaves, hired workers, and foreigners that you have used in previous passages. For more information on slaves and foreigners, refer to the Master Glossary.

This rule is for the Israelites' **livestock** and for **wild animals**. Remember that in this situation, livestock refers to cattle, sheep, and goats—all the kinds of animals that Israelites kept to work for them, and for food and milk.

Wild animals are animals that people in the household did not keep. Use the same words or phrases for livestock and wild animals as you have used previously.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 25:1–7

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (838 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.4 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (1.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.7 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 25:8–22

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 25:8–22 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:8–22 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Leviticus 25:8–22

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:8–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh is giving Moses instructions to prepare the Israelites for when the Israelites move into the land that Yahweh has promised to the Israelites. In the last passage, Yahweh said that the Israelite people will need to give the land a Sabbath or rest every seven years. For six years, the Israelite people can plant their fields, take care of their vineyards, and harvest their crops. But in the seventh year, the Israelite people are not supposed to plant their fields or take care of their vineyards or organize a harvest. Instead, all of the people and the animals are to eat what they can find and take what they need from whatever grows on its own. This is the Sabbath year.

In this passage, Yahweh talks about a special Sabbath year. After the seventh Sabbath year, which would happen on the 49th year, the next year is also to be a Sabbath year. This year, the 50th year after seven Sabbath years, is a very special Sabbath year which Yahweh calls the Year of Jubilee. For two years, the seventh Sabbath year and the Year of Jubilee, the Israelites must not plant or harvest crops as the Israelites normally do. Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelite people must count the Sabbath years well to determine when the year of Jubilee will be.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people keep track of time and important events? Pause this audio here.

The Year of Jubilee is important for many reasons. The Year of Jubilee is a year when people return to the land that Yahweh had given to the people. Families come back together. People release other people from slavery. We know from another passage that people are supposed to forgive all debts. People are supposed to forgive others in every part of life. It gives hope to the person who feels despair because the person owes money or works as a slave. It is a once-in-a-lifetime chance to restart life as a person free from being a slave and free from owing money. It is also a time that causes people to be more equal. Even though some people naturally become richer or poorer through the years, the Year of Jubilee is meant to be something that stops people from hurting each other in an effort to get wealthy. No matter how much land a person can buy, during the Year of Jubilee, that person has to return any additional land that the person bought or rented.

The Year of Jubilee also sets a spiritual example. The Year of Jubilee teaches the Israelite people that Yahweh cares about these things. Yahweh created a way for people to no longer have debt and for people who were servants to be free. Yahweh is the God of people who have made many mistakes and the people who thought that other people ignored or forgot about them. The Year of Jubilee is meant to be a year of celebration and rest, a way to completely restart the community to the way the community should be.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In what ways do you think the Year of Jubilee was helpful to the Israelites? How would something like this be helpful, or not, in your culture? Pause this audio here.

The people will announce the Year of Jubilee on the Day of Atonement, which is the tenth day of the seventh month. The religious new year always started in the seventh month of the calendar year. The Israelite people had two new years: the calendar new year that helped the Israelites keep track of the days and times, and the religious new year, a time of year for the people to renew their relationship with God. The year of Jubilee starts on the Day of Atonement, which is the tenth day of the religious new year. You will remember that the Day of Atonement was a festival in which the high priest offered sacrifices to atone for the people and restore the people's relationship with Yahweh. To announce the start of the Year of Jubilee, people are supposed to play musical instruments all over the land. To make these instruments, people would take ram horns and take out the inner bone and bone marrow. Then someone would heat up the horn to shape it and cut off the tip of the horn to make a mouthpiece.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a ram's horn instrument. Pause this audio here.

Ancient Israelite people used these ram horns to communicate important messages to large groups of people. People would also use these instruments to make loud, joyful noises of celebration. People would even use these instruments to scare their enemies when people went to war. When the Israelite people heard the sound of the ram's horn, it was like a cry of victory, and it reminded the Israelites that Yahweh cared about them and gave them freedom. The name Jubilee comes from the people using the ram's horns to announce the beginning of the celebration.

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Stop here and discuss as a group: In your culture, what sounds, instruments, or songs do people use to celebrate special events? Pause this audio here.

The year of Jubilee also follows the same rules as other Sabbath years. The Israelite people must not plant their fields or take care of their vineyards or organize a harvest. In the previous passage, Yahweh called this giving the land a Sabbath. This is actually a good way to take care of the land so that the land will continue to be good for farming. But really, it is the people who are resting from their regular work in the fields. Instead, the people are to eat what people can find and take what people need from whatever grows on its own. Even without the Israelite people actively working the land, the plants will still produce things to eat. The people can take whatever the people need to eat, but the people should not store or gather the crops in the way people do in other years.

Yahweh instructs Moses that the people should change the prices for fields based on how soon or how long it is until the next Year of Jubilee. Yahweh says that when it is many years until the Year of Jubilee, the Israelites can increase the price of the land. But every year that passes, the Israelites must decrease the price as the Year of Jubilee becomes closer.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Imagine you are selling land to your brother. If it has been 10 years since the last Jubilee, how many years are left to harvest crops until the next Year of Jubilee? What if it has been 30 years since the last Jubilee? Will you sell the land to your brother for more or less? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelite people not to do wrong to each other. This means that the Israelite people should not cheat, trick, or gain something from another person's troubles.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your language, describe a situation where someone tricked or cheated someone else. In your culture, how do people feel about people cheating in business? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh says to fear Yahweh. The reason the Israelite people should not cheat each other is that Yahweh knows when the people cheat, even if the people try to hide it. Yahweh also punishes people who do wrong. After Yahweh says these two commands, Yahweh makes one of the most important statements in Leviticus: "I am Yahweh, your God." The people should not cheat each other out of respect and honor for Yahweh. Yahweh promises that if the people obey, then the land will grow lots of food. And Yahweh promises that Yahweh will provide for the people throughout the two Sabbath years.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:8–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh instructs Moses on how the Israelite people should celebrate a very special year, the year of Jubilee. The Israelite people are supposed to celebrate this special year of celebration once every 50 years. The Year of Jubilee begins on the Day of Atonement, when the people are supposed to play ram's horn instruments everywhere. Then every Israelite is supposed to go back to live with their own family on their family's own land. This is another Sabbath year, so the people are supposed to follow the same rules about not growing, harvesting, or storing food in the normal way.

In the second scene: Yahweh instructs Moses that when people buy or sell fields, the people should change the prices for fields based on how soon or how long it is until the next Year of Jubilee. Since in the Year of Jubilee all the land went back to the original owners, any land that the Israelites buy or sell is just for rent until the next Jubilee.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells Moses to warn the Israelite people to follow Yahweh's rules and instructions. If the Israelite people obey Yahweh, the Israelites will safely live in the land. Then Yahweh addresses a worry or concern that the Israelite people will probably have. What will the Israelites eat during the Sabbath years if the

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Israelites do not plant or harvest? Yahweh says that before every Sabbath year, Yahweh will give the Israelites so much food that the Israelites will have plenty to eat and still have more left over for the next year.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- A person selling their land
- And a person buying land

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh is giving Moses instructions to prepare the Israelite people for when the Israelites move into the land that Yahweh has promised to the Israelites. Moses and the Israelite people are still camping near Mount Sinai at this point. Notice that even though Yahweh does not mention Moses in this passage, we know from the rest of the chapter that Yahweh is giving these instructions to Moses, and that Moses will give the same instructions to the Israelite people.

In the first scene, Yahweh instructs Moses on how the Israelite people should celebrate a very special year, the Year of Jubilee. The Israelite people are supposed to celebrate this special year once every 50 years. Yahweh says to count seven Sabbath years. The word "count" means to keep track of something, to calculate something, or to keep a record to remember something. Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelite people must count the Sabbath years to know when the Year of Jubilee will be.

In the previous passage, Yahweh told Moses that every seven years should be a year of Sabbath for the people and the land. This means that a Sabbath year will happen seven times in a period of 49 years. After the seventh Sabbath year finishes, or the 49th year finishes, Yahweh tells the people to have a very special celebration in the 50th year. This celebration is the Year of Jubilee.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Find a way, whether drawing on paper or in the dirt, or using rocks, to make seven groups of seven. If possible, have one special item in each group to represent the Sabbath year. Then add one more item to represent the Year of Jubilee. As you make these groups of seven as a group, talk about the words for these groupings and numbers in your language. Pause this audio here.

The Year of Jubilee begins on the Day of Atonement, when the people are supposed to play musical instruments or rams' horns "throughout all the land" or everywhere in the lands that the Israelite people own. The people are supposed to play these musical instruments to show that the Year of Jubilee has begun.

Stop here as a group and look again at a picture of a ram's horn instrument as needed. Pause this audio here.

Ancient Israelite people used these horns to communicate important messages to large groups of people. People would also use these instruments to make loud, joyful noises of celebration. The word "Jubilee" refers to this celebration, especially to the loud, musical noises and sounds that told the people that it was time to celebrate. Yahweh commands the Israelites to consecrate the 50th year, or make the 50th year holy. In other words, the Israelites should make the 50th year special. Yahweh commands the Israelites to do this.

Stop here and discuss how you would give a command in your language. How do you show that someone must follow your instructions? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says to proclaim liberty throughout the land to all the people. Yahweh wants the people to cry out in a loud voice that people can be free. The idea of being free here is like an animal in a trap that has broken free from the trap.

Stop here as a group and discuss what you will use for the phrase "proclaim liberty." Pause this audio here.

Then every Israelite is supposed to go back to live with their own family on their family's own land. This does not mean that the people will just visit their families. In the land of Israel, although people could buy each other's land, it was never a final sale. It was really more like renting. In the year of Jubilee, each portion of land will go back to the original owners. In the same way, if someone sold another person as a slave, in the year of Jubilee, the master will set the slave free and send the slave back to their family to live with their family again.

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The Year of Jubilee is to be another Sabbath year, so the people are supposed to follow the same rules about not growing food or harvesting or storing food in the normal way. Remember the way you translated the instructions in the previous passage to decide how to translate them again here.

In the second scene, Yahweh instructs Moses that the people should change the prices when people sell a field based on how soon or how long it is until the next Year of Jubilee. This is a rule both for the people who are trying to sell land and for the people trying to buy land. Yahweh tells the people not to do wrong to each other. This means that the Israelite people should not cheat, trick, or gain something from another person's troubles. Yahweh repeats this command in this passage a second time, so also think about how you could repeat it in your language.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your language, how would you tell someone not to cheat another person? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh gives another command after Yahweh commands the Israelites not to cheat others: fear Yahweh. The reason the Israelite people should not cheat each other is that Yahweh knows when the Israelites cheat, even if the Israelites try to hide it. Yahweh also punishes people who do wrong. After these two commands comes one of the important statements in Leviticus: "I am Yahweh, your God." The people should not cheat each other because they respect and honor Yahweh.

In the third scene, Yahweh tells Moses to warn the Israelite people to follow Yahweh's rules and instructions. These are Yahweh's "statutes" and "ordinances." If the Israelite people follow Yahweh's rules, the Israelite people will live in a safe and secure way. This means that the Israelites will live without danger or threat from enemies or lack of food. The people will live without worry.

In this passage, Yahweh says something about "the land yielding its fruit." The word "land" here can refer to soil, fields, or gardens. "Yielding its fruit" refers to a good harvest of food. Yahweh says if the Israelite people obey, the Israelites will have plenty of food, that the Israelites will have full bellies, or the Israelites will have enough food to be satisfied.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your language, how do you talk about the way that people have all the food people need? Discuss how you will translate the way that Yahweh says that the Israelites will eat their fill. Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh addresses a concern that the Israelite people will probably have. What will the Israelites eat during the Sabbath years if the Israelites do not plant or harvest? Yahweh says that before every Sabbath year, Yahweh will give the Israelites an extra harvest and so much food for the Israelites to store. Yahweh promises that the people will have enough food for the Sabbath year and still have food left over.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:8–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- A person selling their land
- And a person buying land

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

Leviticus 25:8–22

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh instructs Moses on how the Israelite people should celebrate a very special year, the Year of Jubilee. The Israelite people are supposed to celebrate this special year once every 50 years. The Year of Jubilee begins on the Day of Atonement, when the people are supposed to play ram's horn instruments everywhere. Then every Israelite is supposed to go back to live with their own family on their family's own land. This is another Sabbath year, so the people are supposed to follow the same rules about not growing food, harvesting, or storing food in the normal way. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- That will be a very special year to look forward to; or
- A year when debts go away, and families come together, will bring hope to many people; or
- I cannot imagine what that celebration will be like.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh instructs Moses that the people should change the prices for fields based on how soon or how long it is until the next Year of Jubilee. Since in the Year of Jubilee all the land goes back to the original owners, any land that the Israelites buy or sell is really just land for rent until the next Jubilee. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- When I see people acting in ways that are kind and just, that makes me happy; or
- I am angry when rich people steal from poor people; or
- I want the people to know that I am the God who cancels debts and frees slaves and servants.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh tells Moses to warn the Israelite people to follow Yahweh's rules and instructions. If the Israelite people obey Yahweh, the Israelites will safely live in the land. Then Yahweh addresses a worry or concern that the Israelite people will probably have. What will the Israelites eat during the Sabbath years if the Israelites do not plant or harvest? Yahweh says that before every Sabbath year, Yahweh will give the Israelites so much food that the Israelites will have plenty to eat and still have more left over for the next year. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad Yahweh promised this because I think some people will worry about having enough food; or
- If the Israelite people obey Yahweh, the Israelites will have lives of blessing; or
- I want to worship Yahweh. I am amazed at how Yahweh provides for us.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:8–22 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh says to count off seven Sabbath years. Normally, the word **Sabbath** means the last day of the week or the day that the Israelite people would rest for a whole day. In this passage, the Sabbath year refers to the year of rest for the land and the people when the people do not plant and harvest in the seventh year. After the seventh Sabbath year, which will happen on the 49th year, the next year, or the 50th year, is also to be a Sabbath year. This is a very special Sabbath year, which Yahweh calls the Year of Jubilee. Use the same word for Sabbath

as you used in previous passages. For more information on Sabbath and the Year of Jubilee, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for the **Year of Jubilee**. Refer to "Year of Jubilee" in the Master Glossary for more information. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh instructs the people to play musical instruments or ram's **horns** everywhere on the **Day of Atonement** of the 50th year to show that it is a Year of Jubilee. Use the same phrase for "Day of Atonement" as you used in previous passages. For more information on Day of Atonement, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word for "ram's horn instrument" as you used in previous passages. For more information on horn, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a ram's horn instrument. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says to **consecrate** the Year of Jubilee. To consecrate something means to set the thing apart for special service to God. The thing now belongs to God and is holy. Use the same word for consecrate as you used in previous passages. For more information on consecrate, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that each person should return to their own clan. Clans are a group of relatives that includes a few different households or families. A tribe is several clans together.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **clan**. Pause this audio here.

The Israelites must not harvest grapes from the grape vines as the Israelites normally do. People grow grape vines in a **vineyard**. Use the same words for grape and grapevines as you used in previous passages. For more information, refer to vineyard in the Master Glossary.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of grape vines as needed. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the Year of Jubilee will be **holy**. Any place, person, or object Yahweh has dedicated to God is holy. That means that Yahweh has set the object apart for God's special purposes. Use the same word for holy as you used in previous passages. For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says not to take advantage of each other, but instead to "**fear your God**." When someone fears God, that person has a great reverence, honor, and respect for God. That person believes that everything that God has said is true. As a result, that person obeys God because that person knows that God's commandments are good, and that God will punish the person if they disobey God. Use the same phrase for "fear your God" as you used in previous passages. For more information on "fear of God," refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says, "I am **Yahweh**, your **God**," to remind the Israelites why the Israelites should obey Yahweh's commands. Use the same words for Yahweh and God as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh warns the Israelites to obey Yahweh's **statutes** and **ordinances**. Use the same words or phrases for statutes and ordinances you used in previous passages. For more information on these two terms, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh assures the Israelites that Yahweh will give the Israelites great **blessings** so the Israelites will have enough food to eat during the Sabbath years. When Yahweh blesses a person, Yahweh is doing, or promising to do, something good for that person. Yahweh is promising to give the Israelites good things, specifically food, for the Sabbath years. Use the same word for blessing as you used in previous passages. For more information on blessing, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 25:8–22

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (839 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.7 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.5 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.5 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.8 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 25:23–34

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 25:23–34 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:23–34 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:23–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh is giving Moses instructions to prepare the Israelite people for when the Israelites move into the land that Yahweh has promised to the Israelites. In this passage, Moses and the Israelite people are still camping near Mount Sinai. Yahweh gives rules about how people could “buy” or rent land.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what are common ways that people rent or sell to each other? Try to talk about specific examples and notice what kind of words you use to talk about it. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the Israelites must not permanently sell land. The reason that the Israelite people only rent the land is because the land does not really belong to the Israelites, but to Yahweh. Because of this, Yahweh says the Israelite people are like "foreigners" in the land. That means the Israelites are like people groups from other places who come to visit as guests. Just as Yahweh instructed the Israelite people to be kind to the foreigners who live with the Israelites, the Israelite people should also be kind to each other, when one of the Israelites becomes poor and needs to sell land for a time.

In order to understand these instructions, we must talk about why land ownership was so important for the Israelite people. When Yahweh promised the land to the Israelites' ancestors Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, these men did not own much land. These men spent much of their lives traveling from place to place, even though these men believed the promise that one day Yahweh would give their family a place to settle. When the Israelite people were slaves, the Israelites had no land of their own, and yet Yahweh promised the Israelites a place where the Israelites would belong.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How important is it for people to have a place to belong and settle? Talk about the things in your culture that make people feel like they belong. Pause this audio here.

Eventually, Yahweh will give specific regions of land to each of the tribes of Israel. The only tribe that will not get a region of land is the Levite tribe, who instead will get towns in each territory, so that the priestly tribe will live throughout the land of Israel. Each family from each tribe will receive an area that will be for the family to live in forever. Yahweh's promise was finally becoming real after many years, so it was very important.

But the reality is, as soon as people enter the land, some will be prosperous and have plenty of everything and continue to increase wealth. Other people will have troubles and lose money. The Year of Jubilee, in many ways, is a way to make people more equal again. In many ways, the Year of Jubilee would correct much of this divide of wealth and fortune.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do you think the Year of Jubilee teaches us about Yahweh? What do you think Yahweh thinks about these things? How do you think people who follow Yahweh should think about these things? Pause this audio here.

In the same way, it was extremely important for people to try to keep land in the family if at all possible. This is why, in this passage, Yahweh talks to the Israelites about the "redeemer." If a person becomes poor and needs to sell their land, if possible, that person's closest relative is supposed to come and buy the land. This person is the redeemer. This is extremely important because it keeps the land within the same family. Notice the language in the passage: the person sells their land because that person is so poor. The Israelite person in a normal situation would not think of selling their land, because their land was the blessing from Yahweh. But extreme circumstances might cause someone to sell their land. This is why Yahweh makes the kinsmen-redeemer rule, so that the Israelite people will take care of their extended families and do everything possible to take care of each other.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how is your land and the land of your family important? What kinds of things do you do to keep the land? What happens if you lose the land? Pause this audio here.

We know from another passage that the kinsmen-redeemer should also redeem a person who became a servant, marry a widow, or even avenge the wrongful death of a relative.

If the person does not have any relatives who can help the person redeem his land, the person can sell their land. Then the person can work until the person makes enough money to buy their own land back. The Israelite people are not supposed to keep a person like this from buying back their family's land. It is more important for each person to have their land than for one person to keep buying more land for himself.

Yahweh also gave rules about selling houses. If a person sells a house in a city, the person only has one year to redeem or buy back the land before the ownership changes to the new owner forever. A city is a group of houses that has a large stone wall around it to protect the people from attackers. However, if a person sells a house in a village, which is a smaller group of houses without a wall, then the person can redeem the land and the land will go back to the original owners in the year of Jubilee.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of what an ancient Israelite city and an ancient Israelite town might have looked like. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh gives an exception to this rule for the Levite tribe—the tribe of Israelites that descended from Jacob's son Levi. The Levite tribe was the tribe that Moses and Aaron came from. Aaron's direct descendants were the priests. The other descendants of Levi worked in the tabernacle and later, the temple. Remember, Yahweh did not give the Levite tribe a large territory of land like the other tribes. Instead, Yahweh gave the Levite tribe cities in each of the territories. The Levite tribe is always allowed to redeem their own land. Not only that, but the Levites are the only tribe that Yahweh does not permit to sell their land. The Levite people can sell their houses, but the Levites cannot sell the pasture land that came with the Levite cities. This is because these pasture lands are the only lands for the whole Levite tribe, so it is important that the Levites not lose these fields.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:23–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh gives rules about how people could "buy" or rent land. If a person becomes poor and needs to sell their land, if possible, that person's closest relative is supposed to come and buy the land. Yahweh calls this person the redeemer. Even if someone has to sell the land outside the family, the person can make money and buy the land back. But no matter what happens, the person will be able to claim the land that they sold in the Year of Jubilee.

In the second scene: Yahweh gives the rules about selling houses. If the house is in a city, the person can sell the house, but the sale will be final. The person will have one year to redeem the house and rebuy it. After that, the house will permanently belong to the person who bought it and their descendants. However, if the house is in a town without walls, the person who sold the house can redeem the house. Also, in the year of Jubilee, the original owner of the house will get the house back from the person who bought it.

In the third scene: Yahweh gives rules about how the Levite people redeem their property. The Levite people can always redeem their houses. In the year of Jubilee, the Levite people are supposed to get back any houses that the Levites sold. The Levite people also are not supposed to sell their land.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- A poor Israelite person selling their land
- A kinsmen-redeemer
- A person selling a house in a city
- A person selling a house in a village
- And a Levite person who wants to buy back their house

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh is giving Moses instructions to prepare the Israelite people for when the Israelites move into the land that Yahweh has promised to the Israelites. Moses and the Israelite people are still camped near Mount Sinai. Notice that even though Yahweh does not mention Moses in this passage, we know from the previous passages that Yahweh is giving these instructions to Moses, and that Moses will give the same instructions to the Israelite people.

In the first scene, Yahweh gives rules about how people can "buy" or rent land. Yahweh says that the Israelites must not sell the land permanently. The reason that the Israelite people only rent the land is that the land does not really belong to the Israelites, but to Yahweh. Translate in a way that shows that Yahweh owns the land.

In some languages, it may be easier to talk about the Israelite people's ways of buying land as "renting" land, since the land must go back to the original owners eventually.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about the words in your language that refer to things such as buying, lending, or renting. Pause this audio here.

One important concept in this passage is the idea of whether or not a sale is permanent or forever.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Reflect on the words you just talked about for buying and renting. In your language, how would you show the difference between a sale that will eventually go back to the original owner in the Year of Jubilee and a sale that will remain, even during the Year of Jubilee? Pause this audio here.

All of the Israelite people are to obey the rule of redemption. This redemption rule is to be a rule in all the land that Yahweh will give to the Israelite people. Here is a description of the rule of redemption: If a person becomes poor and needs to sell their land, if possible, one of that person's closest relatives is supposed to come and buy the land. Yahweh calls this person the redeemer. Try to translate this name in a way that shows that this person should be a close relative of the original owner and that it is this person's responsibility to buy the land if possible to keep it in the family.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Think about the words you just talked about for buying and renting. In your language, how would you show the difference between a sale that would eventually go away in the Year of Jubilee and a sale that would remain, even during the Year of Jubilee? Pause this audio here.

Even if the person has to sell the land outside the family, the person who sold the land can make enough money and buy the land back. The original language says something like, "if the person's hand gets enough wealth so that the person is able to redeem it." This means that the person becomes rich or that the person has enough money.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In your language, how would you talk about someone having enough money to buy something expensive? Pause this audio here.

The rule is that the person who bought the land has to allow the original landowner to buy back the land if the original landowner can. In order to determine the price of the land, the buyer and the seller are to calculate the cost of the land by how many years it will be until the next Year of Jubilee. If it is a long time until the next Year of Jubilee, the price will be more. If there is less time until the next Year of Jubilee, the price will be less. The person selling the land back must not make the price too high just because the original landowner might be eager to pay extra just to get their own land back.

Even if the original owner never has enough money to buy the land back, the original landowner will be able to reclaim the land that person sold in the Year of Jubilee.

In the second scene, Yahweh gives the rules about selling houses. If the house is in a city, the person can sell the house, but the sale will be final after one year. The person will have one year to redeem the house and rebuy it. After that, the house will permanently belong to the person who bought it and to their descendants, even in the Year of Jubilee. This is the only case where the sale will be permanent. An ancient Israelite city would have a big rock wall around the house to protect the people who lived there from any warring people groups who might be traveling through the area.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of what an ancient Israelite city might have looked like. Pause this audio here.

However, if the house is in a village, the person who sells the house can redeem the house. A town is a place where people live close together, but there is no wall to protect the people from invaders. In the Year of Jubilee, the original owner of the house can get the house back from the person who bought it.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of what an ancient Israelite town might have looked like. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Yahweh gives rules about how the Levite people redeem their property. The Levite people are the people from the tribe of Levi, or the descendants of Levi, the son of Jacob. Aaron, a Levite, is the ancestor

of all the priests. But the people who are part of the Levite tribe who are not descended from Aaron still help in the Tent of Meeting and with religious activities.

Stop here and discuss as a group: What will you call the Levite people? If you have already translated their name in another book, you should translate the same way here. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will not give the Levite people land like Yahweh will give the other tribes. Instead, Yahweh gives the Levites cities in all of the territories. Because of this, the Levite people can always redeem their houses. In the Year of Jubilee, the Levite people are supposed to get back any houses the Levites sold. But the Levite people are not supposed to sell the land that surrounds the Levite cities. This land is pasture land, where the Levites kept their animals. It is the Levites' only land, and it is important to keep this land in the tribe.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text
Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:23–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- A poor Israelite person selling their land
- A kinsmen-redeemer
- A person selling a house in a city
- A person selling a house in a village
- And a Levite person who wants to buy back their house

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh gave rules about how people could "buy" or rent land. If a person became poor and needed to sell their land, if possible, that person's closest relative was supposed to come and buy the land. Yahweh called this person the redeemer. Even if the person had to sell the land outside the family, the person could make money and buy the land back. But no matter what happened, the person would be able to claim the land that the person sold in the Year of Jubilee. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the poor person selling their land, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so sad that I am losing my land; or
- I have hope that my family will get the land back in the Year of Jubilee; or
- I am so grateful to my relatives for keeping the land in the family.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh gave the rules about selling houses. If the house were in a city, the person could sell the house, but the sale would be final. The person would have one year to redeem

the house and re-buy it. After that, the house would permanently belong to the person who bought it and their descendants. However, if the house was in a village, the person who sold the house could redeem the house. Also, in the Year of Jubilee, the original owner of the house would get the house back from the person who bought it. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the people selling their houses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I will work hard to redeem my house; or
- I worry for my future; or
- I pray that Yahweh will provide for me.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh gave rules about how the Levite people redeem their property. The Levite people could always redeem their houses. In the year of Jubilee, the Levite people were supposed to get back any houses the Levites had sold. The Levite people also were not supposed to sell their land. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- It is good that the people of my tribe can always redeem their houses, since Yahweh did not give my tribe land like other tribes; or
- The priestly cities will be a special symbol to the Israelite people that we are Yahweh's chosen people; or
- The Israelite people might live in the land, but the land belongs to Yahweh.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:23–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh says that the **Israelite** people are **foreigners** because the land belongs to Yahweh, not to the Israelites. Yahweh calls the Israelites two words for foreigners: foreigners and **strangers**. A stranger is a general word for someone who is not from your people group. Together, these two words mean anyone who does not belong to the Israelite people group. Use the same words or phrases for foreigner, stranger, and Israelite as you used in previous passages. For more information on foreigner and Israelite, refer to the Master Glossary.

If an Israelite person becomes so poor that the person needs to sell their land, a close relative is supposed to come buy the land. This keeps the land with the family. Yahweh calls this relative who buys the land a "redeemer." Similarly, if the person is able to make money to buy the land back themselves, people are supposed to allow this person to **redeem** the land. Yahweh calls this "redemption." For more information on redeem, refer to the Master Glossary.

The land will go back to the original family in the **Year of Jubilee**. Use the same word for Year of Jubilee as you used in the previous passage. For more information on the Year of Jubilee, refer to the Master Glossary.

In this passage, Yahweh talks about houses that people sell in cities and villages. People built cities to be able to house a lot of people, and cities had tall and wide stone walls to protect the people who lived in the city. If another people group attacked the area, the people in the surrounding villages could come and be safe in the cities. But the villages were just groups of houses without walls.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of what an ancient Israelite city and an ancient Israelite village might have looked like. Discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **cities** and **villages** in your language. Pause this audio here.

If a person sold their house in the city, that person had a year to buy the house back. If the person did not, the house would belong to the buyer and the buyer's **descendants**. Use the same word or phrase for descendants, and refer to descendants in the Master Glossary for more information.

The Levites were the people who were from the tribe of Levi, who became the tribe from which the priests and religious workers came.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **Levites**. Look up Levites in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used before. Pause this audio here.

The Levites must not sell their pastureland. Pastureland is big fields with lots of grasses and food for animals like cattle and horses to eat. This is where people keep their animals.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **pastureland**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used before.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 25:23–34

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (843 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 25:35–46

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 25:35–46 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:35–46 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.

5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:35–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh is giving Moses instructions to prepare the Israelite people for when the Israelites move into the land that Yahweh has promised to the Israelites. Moses and the Israelite people are still camped near Mount Sinai. In this passage, Yahweh gives rules about how the Israelite people should take care of their poor people and guidelines for slavery.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people say or think about owning slaves? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh commands the Israelite people to help Israelites who become poor. This means the other Israelites should provide and care for the poor Israelites. One reason the Israelites must help poor Israelites is that the Israelite people all know that Yahweh cares for poor people. The command to fear Yahweh is a reminder that Yahweh notices and remembers how people act, especially how people treat other people who need help. Yahweh also reminds the Israelites that Yahweh showed compassion to the Israelites and rescued the Israelites when the Israelites were poor and struggling in Egypt.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people think and say about poor people? Pause this audio here.

Another reason why the Israelite people must help the poor Israelite is so that the poor Israelite can keep living in the land with the other Israelites. It is very important for the Israelite people to stay in the land for many reasons. The land is the inheritance that people pass on through family generations for the tribes of Israel, a place where each family has its own place and a chance to grow together. Living in the land shows the people that Yahweh keeps Yahweh's promises. As long as the Israelite people are living in the land, this shows the Israelites are obeying Yahweh.

If a poor Israelite has to leave the land, the poor Israelite might end up forgetting about Yahweh. Instead, the poor Israelite may begin to serve idols or the false gods of other people, perhaps of their new masters. If an Israelite is in another land, the Israelite also will not be able to participate in the worship services and festivals of the Israelite people. This is why it is important for the Israelites to stay in the land that Yahweh gives to the Israelites.

Yahweh says in this passage that the Israelite people must care for poor Israelites as the people would care for a foreigner or a person from another people group. This is very interesting! In the ancient world, people usually liked people from their own people group and did not like people from groups that were different from them. Yahweh gave many instructions to the Israelite people to be kind to people who were different from the Israelites. So when Yahweh needs to tell the Israelites to treat poor Israelites kindly, Yahweh says, "treat the poor Israelites like you would treat a foreigner."

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people think and say about people from other people groups, tribes, or countries? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh gives the Israelites specific rules for how the Israelites should treat poor people. The Israelites should not profit from a poor Israelite's need. The Israelites also must not lend money to the poor Israelite and then expect to get more back. People call this "interest." For example, a rich person might lend a poor person some money or resources. But the rich person tells the poor person that the poor person must pay back that money, plus more. It is like the rich person asks the poor person to pay an extra fee to use the money. Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to do this to each other.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Make a demonstration of what "interest" could look like. It might look like this: a poor person asks a rich person for a coat. The rich person gives the coat to the poor person, but the rich person tells the poor person that the poor person must give the rich person two coats when the poor person comes back. Or it might look like this: one person gives another person a rock. Decide as a group what the rock

represents. It could represent cattle, or money, or a certain kind of crop. The rich person gives the poor person one rock. But the poor person must give the rich person many rocks. The longer it takes the poor person to pay the rich person, the more rocks the rich person can require from the poor person. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also gives rules about slavery. Slavery is a difficult topic, and there are some people who ask why it is in the Bible at all. Slavery was very common in ancient times, and the Bible did not ignore that it was a part of many people's lives. In fact, the theme of slavery is extremely important in the Bible. The Israelite people were slaves in Egypt until Yahweh freed the Israelites. Yahweh tells the Israelites that the Israelites should be Yahweh's servants, but not slaves to false gods or idols. We will start by talking about what slavery was like in ancient times.

The word in the original language for "slave" means "someone who is underneath another person's power." People use this word in different ways. It might mean a soldier who follows the orders of their commander. It could mean the royal advisors who served a king. It also meant slaves who had a master.

In cases of this kind of "slave," the master paid a one-time price and then got free labor from the slave. When a master bought a slave, the slave was a part of the household. The master promised to take care of and protect the slaves. Many times, the slave worshipped the same gods as their master, and the master would treat the slave as part of the family.

In this passage, a person became a slave because the person had no food or no way to provide for themselves or their families. This was a very common reason why a person might become a slave. Sometimes a person might also become a slave when that person could not repay a debt. The person sold themselves to repay the debt. The person exchanged their labor as a slave for what the person borrowed or for food. The slaves usually did not earn any money for their work.

Some masters were cruel to their slaves, and some masters were kind. In the Bible, Yahweh often commanded masters to be kind to their slaves. The Israelite masters must remember that the masters themselves were all descendants of the Israelite slaves who suffered in Egypt. Sometimes the masters were so kind that the slaves chose to stay with their masters.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Remember that Yahweh reminds the Israelites that the Israelites are Yahweh's servants. What do you think about using slavery as an example of serving Yahweh? What do you like about it? What do you not like about it? Pause this audio here.

If an Israelite has to sell himself as a slave, another Israelite person can buy the first Israelite. Again, it was better that another Israelite person buy the first Israelite than for a person from another people group to buy the first Israelite. Yahweh instructs Israelites who buy other Israelites as slaves to treat the Israelite slaves like hired workers, not like slaves. This means the Israelite person must not treat the Israelite slave the same as the other slaves, but as a hired worker. A hired worker had more honor and more freedom than a slave. Since a hired worker received a wage, the hired worker could choose to leave his employer for another employer if the worker felt his job or wages were unfair. Yahweh may mean that all Israelite people working as slaves should receive a wage, but we are not sure.

During the Year of Jubilee, the Israelites must release all their Israelite slaves. This was not just true for the first slave who sold himself, but also for the slaves' family members. Even though the Israelite people could own slaves from other people groups, the Israelites had to treat their Israelite slaves with a higher level of respect and honor.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:35–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

Leviticus 25:35–46

In the first scene: Yahweh gives the Israelite people instructions on how to treat other Israelite people who become poor. The Israelites must not profit from the poor Israelites or lend to the poor Israelites while expecting more back. If the poor Israelite sells themself to another Israelite, the Israelite master must not treat the poor Israelite as a slave, but like a hired servant or worker. Twice, Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh is their God and that Yahweh brought the Israelites out of slavery. Because of this, the Israelites must treat each other well.

In the second scene: Yahweh does allow the Israelite people to own slaves who were from other people groups. However, Yahweh does not allow the Israelite people to own other Israelites in the same way that the Israelites owned slaves from other countries.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- A foreigner or stranger
- A poor Israelite person working as a slave
- And slaves from other people groups

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh is giving Moses instructions to prepare the Israelite people for when the Israelites move into the land that Yahweh has promised to the Israelites. Moses and the Israelite people are still camped near Mount Sinai. We know from previous passages that Yahweh is giving these instructions to Moses, and that Moses will give the same instructions to the Israelite people.

In the first scene, Yahweh gives the Israelite people instructions on how to treat other Israelite people who become poor and cannot support themselves. To say that someone cannot support themselves is to say that the person cannot provide for themselves or cannot feed themselves.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how would you say that a person does not have enough or is so poor that that person cannot eat? Pause this audio here.

The Israelite people are to strengthen and help poor Israelites, which means to provide and care for the poor Israelites. The Israelite people are to care for the poor Israelites in the same way that the Israelites would care for a foreigner or a stranger.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how do you talk about doing something in the same way as you would do something else? Try to find an example and notice the language you use. Pause this audio here.

The Israelite people must help the poor Israelites so that the poor Israelites can keep living in the land with the other Israelites. It is very important for the Israelite people to stay in the land for many reasons. The land is the inheritance passed on through family generations for the tribes of Israel, a place where each family has its own place and chance to grow together. When the people live in the land, this shows the people that Yahweh keeps Yahweh's promises.

The Israelite people are not to profit from the poor Israelite or to lend money to the poor Israelite and then expect to get more back. Sometimes a person would give a poor person something, but wanted the poor person to give much more back to repay what the poor person borrowed. Yahweh does not allow the Israelites to do this to each other.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will translate that the Israelites should not lend money to each other and expect to get interest. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also commands that the Israelite people must not profit from a poor person when the poor person has a need. Why? The reason is that the Israelite people should fear, or respect, Yahweh, because the people know that Yahweh judges people who treat others unfairly.

Then Yahweh repeats the instructions: The Israelite people must not profit from the poor Israelites or lend money to the poor Israelites and expect to get even more back. Yahweh also commands that the Israelite people must not profit from feeding a poor Israelite. Why? Because Yahweh is the Israelites' God, and Yahweh brought the Israelites out of slavery in Egypt. Yahweh will give the Israelites the land of Canaan and promises to be their God. Yahweh will make a similar statement later, so you may want to think about how to structure your translation to emphasize these important statements.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Discuss how you want to translate the way that Yahweh reminds the Israelites of what Yahweh has done for the Israelites to show why the Israelites should obey Yahweh's commands. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that even if a poor Israelite person has nothing and needs to sell himself, the Israelite who buys the poor Israelite must not treat the poor Israelite like an ordinary slave. In ancient times, it was a common practice for people to sell themself to another person. The master would pay one price and then would get free labor from the slave. In return, the slave was a part of the household, and the master would provide food and a place to live. This kind of labor was different from a hired worker, who a master paid for their work.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your language, how would you show the difference between a person who was a slave and a person who was a paid worker? Pause this audio here.

But Yahweh says that the Israelite people must not treat the poor Israelites like the Israelites treated other slaves. Instead, the Israelites must treat the Israelite slave as the Israelites would treat hired workers or foreigners in the land. The Israelites must give the Israelite slave dignity and choice. A hired worker could always find work in another place if the wages did not suit the worker. The poor Israelite will work for their master until the Year of Jubilee. Then the poor Israelite, along with their family, can go back to their own land and be free again.

Here, Yahweh says again that this rule is this way because the Israelite people are Yahweh's servants. This word is actually the same word as "slaves," so it is clear that Yahweh is making a comparison to show how the Israelites must be kind to slaves because the Israelite people are Yahweh's slaves. Yahweh brought the Israelites out of slavery in Egypt, so it would not be right for the Israelite people to mistreat or turn their fellow Israelites into slaves in a bad way. Yahweh tells the Israelites not to rule over their Israelite slaves in a cruel or fierce way, because Yahweh was kind to their ancestors when Yahweh brought the Israelites out of Egypt. Yahweh requires the people Yahweh has shown mercy to show mercy to others. Because of this, the Israelites are to treat each other well.

Stop here and discuss as a group: In this passage, it is important to show the connection between the rules about slaves and how Yahweh freed the Israelite people from slavery. Talk about how to make these connections clear in your language. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and tell a story about a time when a leader ruled in a cruel way. How did this leader act? How would you feel if one of your people treated you in that same way? Discuss how you want to translate the way that Yahweh tells the Israelites not to rule over an Israelite slave in a cruel way, but to fear God instead. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh does allow the Israelite people to own slaves who are from other people groups. These might be both men and women from other lands. Or it may be people from other people groups who live in the land with the Israelite people. Because these slaves were not Israelites, the Israelites did not have to release these slaves in the year of Jubilee. If an Israelite person had slaves from other people groups and then the Israelite died, that Israelite person's children and relatives could become the new masters of those slaves. However, Yahweh did not allow the Israelite people to treat each other in the same way. The Israelites must release any Israelite slaves in the Year of Jubilee. Yahweh has told the Israelites to treat an Israelite slave like a hired worker, even if the Israelite slave sold themselves as a slave. Here, Yahweh says that the Israelites should not rule over the Israelite slaves in a cruel way.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:35–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- A foreigner or stranger
- A poor Israelite person working as a slave
- And slaves from other people groups

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh gives the Israelite people instructions on how to treat other Israelite people who become poor. The Israelites must not profit from the poor Israelite. The Israelites must not lend money to a poor person and then expect to get even more money back. The Israelites must not treat their Israelite slaves like ordinary slaves, but like hired workers. Twice, Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh is their God and that Yahweh brought the Israelites out of slavery. Because of this, the Israelites are to treat each other well. Yahweh says, "Do not rule over the Israelite slaves ruthlessly, but fear your God." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- These people know how bad slavery is. I do not want the Israelites to become so greedy that the Israelites forget and choose to make each other slaves again; or
- I saved these people from slavery. What good does that do if the Israelites just became slaves again? or
- The people will learn that I am the God who is different from the idols. I know when people are cruel and unjust, and I will repay those people for their actions.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh says that the Israelite people can own slaves who were from other people groups. These might be people, men and women, from other lands. Or it may be people from other people groups who live in the land with the Israelite people. Because these slaves were not Israelites, the Israelites did not have to free these slaves in the Year of Jubilee. Yahweh says, "Do not rule over the Israelite slaves ruthlessly, but fear your God." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the poor Israelite person, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I have hope that my family will be free someday in the Year of Jubilee; or
- I worry about how we will keep our dignity when we are only slaves; or
- I am grateful that Yahweh sees the way that people treat us, both good and bad.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:35–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Leviticus 25:35–46

At the beginning of this passage, **Yahweh** talks about how the **Israelites** should treat their "brother" or "fellow Israelite." Yahweh often talked about fellow Israelites as "brothers." Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh and Israelite people as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and Israelite, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says to treat the poor Israelites as you would treat a **foreigner** or a **stranger**. A foreigner is a person who is from a different people group and who lives in another land or territory. A stranger is a general word for someone who is not from your people group. Together, these two words mean anyone who does not belong to the Israelite people group. Use the same word or phrase for foreigner as you used in previous passages. For more information on foreigner, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says not to lend money to a poor Israelite and expect to receive even more money back. Instead, the Israelites must "fear their God." When a person fears God, the person has deep respect for God and so obeys God's rules because the person knows that God can punish that person. Use the same word or phrase for **fear of God** as you used in previous passages. For more information on fear of God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh is the Israelite's **God**. Use the same word for God as you used in previous passages. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh brought the Israelites out of the land of Egypt to give the Israelites the land of **Canaan**. Use the same word or phrase for Canaan as you used in previous passages. For more information on Canaan, refer to the Master Glossary.

The Israelites must free any Israelite slaves during the **Year of Jubilee**. Use the same word or phrase for the Year of Jubilee as you used in previous passages. For more information on the Year of Jubilee, refer to the Master Glossary.

When the Israelite slave becomes free, the Israelite can return to their own **clan**. Use the same word or phrase for clan as you used in previous passages.

In this passage, Yahweh gives the Israelite people rules about how to treat other Israelite people and how to treat **slaves**. Yahweh says the Israelite people should treat slaves well because the Israelites are **servants** of Yahweh. In the original language, people used the same word for servant and slave, and used the word to mean different things in different contexts. Yahweh also talks about both male and female slaves. You may need a separate word for female slaves. Use the same words or phrases for slaves and servants as you used in previous passages. For more information on slave and servant, refer to the Master Glossary.

The Israelites can have male and female slaves from other **nations**. A nation is a group of people who belong together, who live in the same country, and who have the same ruler. Use the same word or phrase for nation as you used in previous passages. For more information on nation, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 25:35–46

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (848 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.3 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.1 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 25:47–55

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 25:47–55 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:47–55 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:47–55 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh was giving Moses instructions to prepare the Israelite people for when the Israelites would move into the land that Yahweh had promised to give the Israelites. Moses and the Israelite people were still camped near Mount Sinai during this time. In this passage, Yahweh gave guidelines to the Israelite people about slavery and redemption.

Slavery is a difficult topic, and there are some people who ask why it is in the Bible at all. Slavery was very common in ancient times, and the Bible did not ignore that it was a part of many people's lives. The Israelite people were slaves in Egypt until Yahweh freed the Israelites. Yahweh told the Israelites that the Israelites should be Yahweh's servants, but not slaves to false gods or idols. Let us remind you what slavery was like in ancient times.

You will remember that the word in the original language for "slave" means "someone who is underneath another person's power." People used this word in many contexts. It might mean a soldier who follows their commander's orders. It could be the royal advisors who served a king. It also meant slaves who had a master.

In cases of this kind of "slave," the master would pay a one-time price and then would get free labor from the slave. In return, the slave was a part of the household. The master would provide food and a place to live. Many

Leviticus 25:47–55

times, the slave would worship the same gods as their master, and the master sometimes treated the slave as part of the family.

In this passage, a person became a slave because the person had no food or no way to provide for themselves or their families. This was a very common reason why a person might become a slave. Sometimes a person might also become a slave when that person could not repay a debt. The person sold themselves to get enough money to repay the debt. The person exchanged their labor as a slave for what the person borrowed or for food. The slaves usually did not earn any money for their work.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people treat poor people? What do people say or think about poor people? In what ways do people in your culture take care of poor people? Pause this audio here.

If an Israelite person had to sell themself as a slave, another Israelite person could buy that first Israelite person. Again, it was better that another Israelite person bought the first Israelite than for a person from another people group to buy the first Israelite. But if this was not possible, it was possible for a person from another people group who lived in the land of Israel to buy an Israelite person. This was better than the Israelite person having to live outside the land of Israel, where the Israelite would lose connection to their people and, more importantly, to Yahweh.

Yahweh instructed Israelites who bought other Israelites as slaves to treat the Israelite slaves like hired workers, not like slaves. A hired worker had more honor and more freedom than a slave. Yahweh may have implied that all Israelite people working as slaves should receive a wage. Yahweh did clearly say that the Israelites must release any Israelite slaves in the Year of Jubilee.

Another rule was that even though an Israelite person might be a slave to a foreigner, the Israelite slave still had the rule of redemption or the rule of the kinsmen-redeemer. If an Israelite person became poor and sold themselves into slavery, if possible, the person's closest relative was supposed to come and buy that person back. Yahweh called this close relative a "redeemer." Notice the language in the passage: the person became a slave because that person was so poor. An Israelite person in a normal situation would not think of becoming a slave. A person may feel like they have no choice but to sell themself into slavery because that person was in such bad circumstances. This is why Yahweh made the redeemer rule, so that the Israelite people would take care of their relatives and do everything possible to take care of each other.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what should people do to take care of their family? Who has to take care of whom and in what ways? Pause this audio here.

We know from other passages that the relative redeemer should also redeem a person who sold their land, should marry a widow, or should even avenge the wrongful death of a relative.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:47–55 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has one scene.

In the scene: Yahweh says a rich foreigner who lives in the land of Israel can buy a poor Israelite person. But a relative can redeem the Israelite slave, or the Israelite slave can even pay for their freedom on their own. The rich foreigner and the poor Israelite are supposed to decide the price based on how many more years there are until the Year of Jubilee. The master who is a foreigner is supposed to treat the Israelite slave not like an ordinary slave, but like a hired worker. Even if no one redeems the Israelite slave, the master must free the slave and their family in the Year of Jubilee. The reason is that Yahweh brought the Israelite people out of slavery in the land of Egypt.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh

Leviticus 25:47–55

- Moses
- A rich foreigner
- A poor Israelite person
- A relative of the Israelite slave
- And children of an Israelite slave

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh is giving Moses instructions to prepare the Israelite people for when the Israelites move into the land that Yahweh has promised to the Israelites. Moses and the Israelite people are still camped near Mount Sinai. Notice that even though the storyteller does not mention Moses in this passage, we know from the rest of the chapter that Yahweh is giving these instructions to Moses, and that Moses will give the same instructions to the Israelite people.

In the scene, Yahweh describes a situation that may happen. It is possible that one of the people from another people group may live in the land of the Israelite people and become rich. This is a contrast—the opposite of the poor Israelite in this passage and the last passage. To be rich or wealthy means that the person has more than enough for himself and his household.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you decide if a person is rich or wealthy? As you talk about this, talk about a person who has a lot of wealth or resources. Pause this audio here.

If a poor Israelite person becomes poor and cannot provide for themselves or their household, Yahweh does allow the poor Israelite to sell themself to a person from another people group who lives in the land. While Yahweh does not say the foreigner is in Israel, we know the foreigner is someone who lives in Israel because Yahweh calls this person a foreigner, or someone who is not an Israelite but lives with the Israelites. Since the person is still in the land of Israel, the foreigner is still under the law, which allows for a close relative of the person to redeem the person.

All of the Israelite people must obey the rule of redemption. Here is a description of the rule of redemption: If a person becomes poor, that person can sell their land. If a person loses their land, that person loses their ability to make money. If a person cannot provide enough, that person can even sell themselves into slavery so that the person can get food and a place to live. The rule of redemption is that, if possible, one of the person's closest relatives is supposed to come and pay the price so that the person can be free again. The closest relative can be a brother, an uncle, a cousin, or another relative who is a "blood relative." A "blood relative" is a relative who is not connected through marriage. Yahweh calls the relative who pays the price the "kinsman," or relative redeemer.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture and language, how do you show the difference between a "blood" relative and a relative through marriage? Pause this audio here.

An Israelite slave can even buy their own freedom if the Israelite slave is able to prosper, or to get enough money or resources to do so. If a person prospers, that person succeeds or is able to get something valuable.

The rich foreigner and the Israelite slave are supposed to decide the price based on how many more years there are until the Year of Jubilee. The Israelite slave will have to pay the wage of a hired worker for however many years are left until the Year of Jubilee. The master, who is a foreigner, is supposed to treat the Israelite slave as a hired worker. This may mean that the foreigner should pay their Israelite slave, or that the foreigner should treat the Israelite slave like the master treats hired workers. Yahweh says to "make sure" that the rich foreigner does not rule over the Israelite slave in a cruel or unjust way. This means that the other Israelite people should watch how the foreigner treats Israelite slaves, to make sure that a foreign master treats Israelite slaves fairly.

Stop here and, if needed, review how you translated the way that someone rules over someone else in a cruel way in the last passage. Pause this audio here.

Even if no one redeems the Israelite slave, the foreign master must free the slave and the slave's family in the Year of Jubilee.

Yahweh says the reason why the masters must do this is that the Israelite people are Yahweh's servants or slaves. Yahweh brought the Israelite people out of slavery in the land of Egypt.

Leviticus 25:47–55

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:47–55 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has one scene.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- A rich foreigner
- A poor Israelite person
- A relative of the Israelite slave
- And children of an Israelite slave

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

A rich foreigner who lives in the land of Israel can buy a poor Israelite person. But a relative can redeem the Israelite slave, or the Israelite slave can even pay for their freedom on their own. The rich foreigner and the poor Israelite are supposed to decide the price based on how many more years there are until the Year of Jubilee. The foreign master is supposed to treat the Israelite slave as the master would treat a hired worker. Even if no one redeems the Israelite slave, the master must free the slave and their family in the Year of Jubilee. The reason is that Yahweh brought the Israelite people out of slavery in the land of Egypt. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite slave, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am relieved that Yahweh protects me even with a foreign master; or
- It is good that my master will release my children along with me in the Year of Jubilee; or
- I am grateful that my relative was able to redeem me.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 25:47–55 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh talks about how a **foreigner** should treat an **Israelite** slave. Yahweh again says "your brother Israelite" or "fellow Israelite." "Your brother" was a way that Yahweh talked about fellow Israelites. A foreigner is a person who is from a different people group who lives in another land or territory. Use the same words or phrases for foreigner and for Israelite as you used in previous passages. For more information on foreigner and Israelite, refer to the Master Glossary.

If an Israelite person becomes so poor that the person needs to sell themselves into slavery, a close relative from the person's **clan** could come and buy the person back. Yahweh calls this relative a "redeemer." Similarly, if

Leviticus 25:47–55

the person is able to make money to buy back their freedom, that person may **redeem** themselves. Yahweh calls this redemption. For more information on redeem, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for redeem, redeemer, and clan as you used in previous passages.

The Israelite slaves will become free again during the **Year of Jubilee**. Use the same word for Year of Jubilee as you used in the previous passage. For more information on the Year of Jubilee, refer to the Master Glossary.

The foreign master must treat the slaves as the master would treat a **hired worker**. Use the same word for a hired worker as you used in the previous passage.

In this passage, Yahweh gives the Israelite people rules about how to treat **slaves**. Yahweh says the Israelite people should treat slaves well because the Israelites are **servants** of Yahweh. In the original language, people used the same word for servant and slave, and used the word to mean different things in different contexts. Use the same words or phrases for slaves and servants as you used in previous passages. For more information on slave and servant, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says, "I am **Yahweh** your **God**." Use the same words for Yahweh and God as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and God, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 25:47–55

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (839 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.6 MB)
- Embodying the Text (1.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 26:1–5

Leviticus 26:1–5

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 26:1–5 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:1–5 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous passage, Yahweh spoke to Moses from Mount Sinai and told Moses instructions about how Israelites should respond when an Israelite has to sell land or sell themselves into slavery because of poverty.

Until this time, Yahweh has been telling Moses what Yahweh expects from the Israelite people. Yahweh has chosen the Israelites to be Yahweh's people, and Yahweh is going with the Israelites to the land Yahweh promised to give the Israelites. But Yahweh has expectations for how the Israelites will behave and interact with Yahweh. Now, in this passage and the following ones, Yahweh explains to Moses what will happen to the Israelites if the Israelites follow Yahweh's instructions. Yahweh also explains what will happen if the Israelites do not follow Yahweh's instructions.

In this passage, Yahweh first tells Moses a summary of what Yahweh requires the Israelites to do and not do. The Israelites must not make idols or false gods to worship. The Israelites must not make images to worship, meaning that the Israelites must not create anything in the shape of a person, animal, or object to worship. The Israelites must not set up a pillar to worship, which seems like a common thing that people in neighboring cultures did to worship their gods. Finally, the Israelites must not make any kind of carved stone to bow down to in worship. In the original language, a carved stone may mean some kind of stone that is so amazing that it makes people want to look at it. However, it probably means a stone that someone has carved to look like something the person wants to worship. Yahweh describes all these different things because Yahweh wants to emphasize that the Israelites must not worship any god besides Yahweh. Yahweh also wants to emphasize that the Israelites should not make any kind of object to help the Israelites worship other gods.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What kinds of idols, objects, statues, pictures, or tools do people in your culture use to worship their gods? If people in your culture do not use any items to worship, how do people worship? Pause this audio here.

The Israelites must also observe Yahweh's Sabbaths. This means that the Israelites must observe the Sabbath day of rest every week. The Israelites must also observe the Sabbath year every seven years, where the Israelites let the land rest. The Israelites must also respect Yahweh's sanctuary, or holy place. The sanctuary refers to all of Yahweh's tabernacle or Tent of Meeting. The Israelites must treat the tabernacle and all the area around the tabernacle with respect. Yahweh finishes his summary of instructions by telling Moses to remind the people that Yahweh is Yahweh, the Israelites' God. In other words, the Israelites should not worship other gods, and the Israelites should follow Yahweh's instructions because Yahweh chose the Israelites to be Yahweh's people, so Yahweh is the Israelites' God.

After this summary, Yahweh explains to Moses what will happen to the Israelites if the Israelites obey Yahweh's instructions. If the Israelites obey what Yahweh has said, Yahweh will give the rain the Israelites need at the right time. The Israelites would need good rain to help their crops grow. The seasonal rain will come when the

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Israelites expect the rain to come. Yahweh will cause the ground to grow crops, and Yahweh will cause the trees to grow fruit. Yahweh means that when the Israelites work in their farms, the farms will grow many crops, and the fruit orchards will grow a lot of fruit. The Israelites' harvests will not fail. The Israelites will be busy with the grain harvest until the grape harvest starts, and the Israelites will harvest the grapes until the Israelites start planting the next grain harvest. The Israelites would harvest grain in the spring and harvest grapes in the late summer and autumn. Yahweh specifically says that the Israelites will thresh the harvest until the grape harvest starts. Threshing is when you separate stalks of grain from the kernels of grain that grow on the stalk by beating the stalk until the grain falls out. People in Israel did this by beating the stalk of grain with a sharp rock or a stick, or by stomping on the grain or having animals stomp on the grain.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of grain. Notice the stalk or stem and the kernel or edible piece. Pause this audio here.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of someone threshing grain. Pause this audio here.

When Yahweh says the Israelites will be threshing the grain harvest until the grape harvest starts, Yahweh does not mean that the Israelites will only be threshing during that time. Instead, Yahweh means that the grain harvest will be very big and healthy. The Israelites will pick the grain and prepare the grain for people to eat by threshing it, and this will take all the time before the grape harvest. Then, the Israelites will harvest grapes until it is time to start planting the next grain harvest. Again, this means that the grape harvest will be very big and healthy. The Israelites will need all the time before planting season to harvest the grapes. The Israelites made their main food, bread, from grain, and the Israelites made their main drink, wine, from grapes. The Israelites will not have to worry about their food or drink because if the Israelites follow Yahweh's instructions, the Israelites' harvests will be so successful that there will be no part of the year when nothing is growing.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your community, what time of year do people harvest crops? Which types of crops do people harvest at which times of year? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh finishes this passage by telling Moses that if the Israelites obey Yahweh's instructions, the Israelites will eat all the food the Israelites want, and the Israelites will live in safety in their land.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses a summary of how Yahweh expects the Israelites to behave regarding idols and Sabbaths.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Moses what will happen to the Israelite people if the Israelites obey Yahweh's instructions.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- And the Israelite people

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this passage, Yahweh continues to give Moses instructions for the Israelite people from Mount Sinai. Yahweh has just given Moses instructions about what the Israelites should do in Sabbath years, the Years of Jubilee, and when Israelite people have to sell land or sell themselves into slavery because of poverty.

Now, the storyteller begins a new section of the book. At the time the storyteller wrote this book, it was very common for people who wrote sets of laws and instructions to include a section at the end where the storyteller explained consequences. The storyteller would explain what good things would happen to people who obey the

instructions and what bad things would happen to people who do not obey the instructions. The book of Leviticus has a section like this, too. This passage starts the section of the book where Yahweh explains what will happen when the Israelite people obey Yahweh's instructions and what will happen when the Israelites do not obey Yahweh's instructions.

In the first scene of this passage, Yahweh starts by summarizing Yahweh's instructions. These are not the only instructions the Israelites must follow if the Israelites want the good things Yahweh is about to describe. Instead, Yahweh is repeating some of the main points of the instructions that Yahweh has given to the Israelites in the previous parts of the book of Leviticus. In this passage, Yahweh specifically mentions that the Israelites must not worship idols or false gods, and the Israelites must not use anything to worship other gods. Yahweh lists four things that people make or use to symbolize other gods or that people use in order to worship other gods. Bible scholars do not all agree on what these things are, but firstly, Yahweh probably says that the Israelites should not make worthless things that people use to worship other gods. Secondly, the Israelites should not make images or statues that represent other gods. Thirdly, the Israelites should not set up stones or pillars as a way to worship other gods. And fourthly, the Israelites should not carve stone into anything that the Israelites want to worship. Yahweh lists all these things to emphasize that the Israelites must not make or use anything to worship false gods.

Stop here and discuss these questions as a group: Think about which words or phrases you will use to talk about these four things that people use to symbolize or worship other gods. Remember that these four things are: worthless things that people use to worship God; an image of something that people make from metal, clay, wood, or stone; a tall stone; and a carved stone. In your language, is it best to list these four things separately or to talk about some or all of these things together? If you include these four things in a list, will people think that the Israelites could create or use anything else to worship false gods? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh gives these instructions because Yahweh is the Israelites' God. Then Yahweh says that the Israelites must follow Yahweh's Sabbaths, so the Israelites must rest on the day of rest each week and let the land rest every seven years. The Israelites must also respect Yahweh's sanctuary, which is Yahweh's holy tabernacle or Tent of Meeting, and the surrounding courtyard. Yahweh gave the exact same instruction about the Sabbaths and Yahweh's sanctuary earlier in Leviticus 19:30.

Stop here and discuss as a group: If you have translated Leviticus 19:30, you can go back and listen to your translation. How did you translate the same instruction in that passage? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene of this passage, Yahweh starts telling Moses about what will happen to the Israelites if they follow and obey Yahweh's statutes and commands. Yahweh says that the Israelites must follow or walk in Yahweh's statutes and commands. When someone walks in certain commands, it means the person listens to the commands and then does what the commands say. When the Israelites obey Yahweh's commands, Yahweh will bless the Israelites' harvests. Yahweh will send rain in the season when the Israelites expect rain, the ground will successfully grow crops, and the trees will successfully grow fruit. In fact, the harvests will be so big and healthy that the Israelites will be busy with the grain harvest until the time when the grape harvest starts. During the grain harvest, the Israelites will pick the grain and also prepare the grain for eating by threshing the grain. By the time the Israelites are done with that, the grape harvest will start. Then, the Israelites will be busy with the grape harvest until the Israelites start to plant the next grain harvest. In other words, the Israelites will have food all year because something will always be growing. Yahweh emphasizes this by telling Moses that the Israelites will eat all the food the Israelites want. Finally, Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelites will live safely in their land.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: Imagine that you are explaining to someone all the things that will happen if that person obeys a certain rule or law. You can use a community rule or a government law. How do you let that person know that all of these things will only happen if that person obeys the law, and these things will not happen if that person does not obey the law? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Leviticus 26:1–5

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- And the Israelite people

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

For the first scene, have the person playing Yahweh tell the person playing Moses the following instructions. Then have the person playing the Israelite people act out how the Israelites follow Yahweh’s instructions.

First, Yahweh tells Moses a summary of what the Israelites should do to follow Yahweh’s instructions. The Israelites should not worship other gods or use any objects, statues, pillars, stones, or anything else to worship other gods. The Israelites must follow Yahweh’s instructions about the Sabbaths. The Israelites must also respect Yahweh’s sanctuary, which was the tabernacle or Tent of Meeting. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite people, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am confident that I can follow these instructions; or
- I am nervous that I will not be able to follow all Yahweh’s instructions; or
- I am happy that Yahweh is my God, so I am excited to follow these instructions.

Continue the drama. Then in the second scene, Yahweh tells Moses what will happen to the Israelites if the Israelites follow Yahweh’s instructions. If the Israelites follow all Yahweh’s instructions, Yahweh will give the Israelites rain at the right times, and the ground will successfully grow crops, and the trees will successfully grow fruit. Also, if the Israelites follow all Yahweh’s instructions, the Israelites will be busy picking and threshing the grain harvest to prepare the harvest for eating all the way until the time when the grape harvest starts. Then the Israelites will be busy harvesting grapes until the time when the Israelites plant the next grain harvest. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite people, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I am content because Yahweh has provided so much food; or
- I am trusting Yahweh because Yahweh said Yahweh would give us successful harvests; or
- I am proud that my people followed Yahweh’s instructions, and so Yahweh is blessing us.

Continue the drama. Finally, Yahweh promises Moses that if the Israelites follow all Yahweh’s statutes and commands, then the Israelites will eat all the food they want, and the Israelites will live safely in their land. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I love my people, so I am happy to make good things happen for my people; or
- I am happy my people followed my instructions; or
- I am glad to see my people enjoying what I give to my people.

Leviticus 26:1–5

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:1–5 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, **Yahweh** first tells Moses a summary of Yahweh's instructions for the **Israelite** people. For more information on Yahweh and Israelite, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words for Yahweh and Israelite as you used in previous passages.

The Israelite people must not make **idols** to worship. For more information on idols, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for idols as you used in previous passages.

The Israelites also must not use any objects, statues, pillars, stones, or anything to worship other gods. People made images or statues to represent other gods. People set up stones or pillars as a way to worship other gods. People carved stone into anything that the people wanted to worship. The point of listing all of these different things is to say that the Israelites should not worship any god besides Yahweh, and the Israelites should not make any kind of object to help them **worship** or **bow down to** other gods. For more information about worship, refer to bow down in the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for worship or bow down as you used in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss what words or phrases you will use for **images** or **statues**, **pillars**, and **sacred stones**. If you have translated these words in other books of the Bible, discuss whether you can use the same words here. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says, "I am Yahweh, your **God**." For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word for God as you used in previous passages.

The Israelites must also observe Yahweh's **Sabbaths**. This means that the Israelites must celebrate the Sabbath day of rest every week and the Israelites must observe the Sabbath year every seven years, when the Israelites let the land rest. For more information about Sabbath, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Sabbath as you used in previous passages.

The Israelites must also treat Yahweh's **sanctuary** or holy place with respect. In this passage, the sanctuary is the tabernacle or the Tent of Meeting. For more information about the tabernacle and the sanctuary, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for sanctuary as you used in previous passages. Yahweh also tells Moses to remind the people that Yahweh is Yahweh, the Israelites' God.

After this, Yahweh explains to Moses what will happen to the Israelites if the Israelites follow Yahweh's instructions. Here, Yahweh calls the instructions Yahweh's **statutes** and **commands**. For more information on statutes and commandments, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for statutes or commands as you used in previous passages.

If the Israelites follow Yahweh's statutes and commandments, Yahweh will give the rain the Israelites need at the right time. Yahweh will cause the ground to grow crops, and Yahweh will cause the trees to grow fruit. The Israelites will be busy threshing the grain harvest until the grape harvest starts, and the Israelites will harvest the grapes until the Israelites start planting the grain harvest the next year.

Stop here as a group and look again at a picture of someone threshing grain as needed. What words or phrases will you use for threshing grain? Pause this audio here.

The **grain harvest** and the **grape harvest** will be so big and healthy that the Israelites will have food growing all year. Use the same words or phrases to talk about the harvest and grapes as you have used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 26:1–5

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (837 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 26:6–13

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 26:6–13 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:6–13 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:6–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last few sections of Leviticus, Yahweh gave Moses instructions for all the Israelites about how to live life the way Yahweh wanted. In the passage just before this, Yahweh told Moses a summary of Yahweh's instructions for how the Israelite people should live. Then Yahweh started to tell Moses what would happen to the Israelites

Leviticus 26:6–13

if the Israelites obeyed Yahweh's instructions. If the Israelites follow Yahweh's instructions, then the Israelites will have healthy crops and all the food the Israelites need.

In this passage, Yahweh continues to tell Moses what will happen to the Israelite people if the Israelites follow Yahweh's instructions. It is important to notice that even though Yahweh does not mention in this passage that these good things will only happen if the Israelites obey Yahweh's instructions, this passage and the previous passage are closely related. In the previous passage, Yahweh said that if the Israelites obey Yahweh's commands, then Yahweh will cause good things to happen to the Israelites. In this passage, Yahweh talks about more of the good things that will happen to the Israelites if the Israelites obey Yahweh's commands.

So Yahweh will give the Israelites peace in the land only if the Israelites follow Yahweh's instructions. The word from the original language for peace means a lot more than just not having war in your land. It also means that people will live in harmony with others, with nature, and with God, and that the people will have what people need to be truly well.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What are some things that people in your culture need to experience for your community to be truly well and peaceful? Pause this audio here.

The Israelite people will experience this good and peaceful life in the land of Canaan that God is leading the Israelites to. The Israelites will settle in Canaan after Moses dies, and the Israelites will call the land Israel. As part of this peaceful life in Canaan, Yahweh says that the Israelite people will lie down and nothing will make the people afraid. Yahweh means that the Israelites will be able to lie down and go to sleep easily because the Israelites will not need to be afraid of anything. Yahweh also tells Moses that Yahweh will remove wild animals from the land. Yahweh is not talking about harmless animals that are not on farms or that do not belong to people. Instead, Yahweh is talking about dangerous wild animals that might harm people. Yahweh also says that the sword will not go through the land. The sword represents war in general. Enemies will not attack and fight wars with the Israelites in the Israelites' land if the Israelites obey Yahweh's instructions.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What kinds of dangerous animals are in your area? Pause this audio here.

But Yahweh says the Israelites will be successful when the Israelites go to war and attack their enemies. The Israelites will chase their enemies, which means that the Israelites will win battles and then chase away their enemies. When the Israelites do this, their enemies will die by the sword in front of the Israelites. This is just a way to say that the Israelites will use swords and likely other weapons to kill their enemies in war. Swords were the main weapon in the Israelites' culture, and swords often represent weapons in general. Sometimes, only the Israelite leaders would have swords, but since swords represent all kinds of weapons, Yahweh is just saying that Israelite warriors will kill their enemies. The Israelites will be successful against armies that are much bigger than the Israelites' army. Yahweh says that 5 Israelites will chase 100 enemy soldiers, and 100 Israelites will chase 10,000 enemy soldiers, so clearly the Israelites will be much stronger than their enemies. And then Yahweh says again that the Israelites will kill their enemies.

If the Israelites obey Yahweh's instructions, Yahweh next says that Yahweh will turn towards the Israelites. This is special language that means that Yahweh will pay attention to the Israelites and be kind to the Israelites. Then Yahweh gives the Israelites the same blessing that Yahweh gave all humans after Yahweh created people. Yahweh will make the Israelites fruitful and multiply the Israelites, which means that the Israelites will have children, so there will be more and more Israelite people. Yahweh then says that Yahweh will fulfill Yahweh's covenant with the Israelites. Yahweh will do what Yahweh agreed to do in the covenant or binding agreement Yahweh made with the Israelites. Now, Yahweh is still in the process of making a binding agreement with the people of Israel at Mount Sinai, so Yahweh is probably not talking about that covenant. Instead, Yahweh is probably talking about the covenant Yahweh made with the Israelites' ancestor Abraham. Yahweh promised Abraham in Genesis 17 that Abraham would have many descendants and that Yahweh would keep confirming this agreement with Abraham's descendants, the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think of three situations where people in your culture might make a covenant, a binding agreement, or a special promise with each other. When would someone renew or confirm a covenant, binding agreement, or special promise that the person made in the past? Pause this audio here.

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Next, Yahweh promises that if the Israelites obey Yahweh's instructions, the Israelites will be able to grow so much food that the Israelites will be able to live on that food for a long time. In fact, the Israelites will have to get rid of some of the food from last year's harvest so that the people can make room for all the food from this year's harvest! This does not mean that the Israelites will waste a lot of food. It just means that the Israelites will never have to go without food because the Israelites will always have enough.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How would you or other people in your culture talk about a peaceful land where everything is good? What kinds of things would happen there? What kinds of things would not happen there? Pause this audio here.

Next, Yahweh makes the most important promise of all to the Israelites. If the Israelites obey Yahweh's instructions, Yahweh will live with the Israelites in Yahweh's tabernacle, the Tent of Meeting, and Yahweh will not reject the Israelites. Yahweh says that Yahweh will walk with the Israelite people. Now, Yahweh does not mean that Yahweh will literally walk with the Israelites as a physical person. Yahweh is using special language to say that Yahweh will live with and be present with the Israelite people. Yahweh says that Yahweh will be with the Israelites in multiple ways to emphasize that Yahweh will always accept the Israelites and be with the Israelites. Yahweh then tells the Israelites that Yahweh will be their God and the Israelites will be Yahweh's people.

To reassure the Israelites that Yahweh will certainly do all of these wonderful things, Yahweh reminds the Israelites who Yahweh is and what Yahweh has done before. Yahweh says that he is Yahweh, their God, and that Yahweh rescued the Israelites from Egypt so that the Israelites would not be slaves anymore. Next, Yahweh says that Yahweh broke the bars of the Israelites' yoke so that the Israelites could stand up straight. A yoke is a wooden bar or beam that you put across the backs of two farm animals so that the animals can pull the same load together. People could attach the yoke to a cart to carry things or to several kinds of farm tools.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of animals wearing a yoke. Now look at a picture of a person wearing a yoke. Pause this audio here.

In the culture of the people who wrote the Bible, people sometimes put a yoke on people who were slaves to humiliate the slaves. Because slaves sometimes used yokes to carry heavy objects, people sometimes talk about yokes to represent slavery. Yahweh also talks about the way that people without heavy loads can stand up straight to represent the Israelites being free people. When Yahweh freed the Israelite people from slavery so the Israelites could live as free people, it was like Yahweh took a heavy load off the Israelites' backs so the Israelites could stand up straight again.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:6–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh continues to tell Moses what will happen to the Israelites if the people obey Yahweh. The Israelites will have peace in their land and be successful in war.

In the second scene: Yahweh says that Yahweh will also bless the Israelites with children and with the food that the Israelites need.

In the third scene: Yahweh says that Yahweh himself will also come live with the Israelites and be their God.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- And enemy soldiers

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

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Yahweh is still talking to Moses from Mount Sinai and giving Moses instructions about how the Israelite people should live. In the passage before this, Yahweh explained that if the Israelites obey Yahweh's instructions, then all the good things that Yahweh says in this passage will happen to the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: Imagine that you tell your child to do something, and you explain all the things that will happen if your child obeys your instructions. How do you let your child know that all of these things will only happen if your child obeys your instructions, but these things will not happen if your child disobeys your instructions? Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh continues to talk about the good things that will happen if the Israelites obey Yahweh's instructions. In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses that the Israelites will experience peace and wellness in the land Yahweh is leading the Israelites to. The Israelites will not fear anybody or anything. Yahweh says that the Israelites will lie down to sleep because the Israelites will not be afraid.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: What are some ways you can describe someone who is not afraid? How does that person feel? What does that person do? Pause this audio here.

The Israelites will not have dangerous animals or war in their land. And when the Israelites go to war, the Israelites will be very successful even when their enemies have much bigger armies. Just a few Israelite soldiers will be able to chase off many enemy soldiers, and the Israelites will be able to kill the enemy soldiers. Yahweh uses special language to talk about this. Yahweh says that the sword will not pass through the Israelites' land, and later, Yahweh says that the enemy soldiers will fall by the sword. Swords represent weapons and war in general, so Yahweh is saying that there will not be war in the Israelites' land and that the Israelites will kill their enemies with weapons.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: How do you want to translate the special language about swords? As you think through this, consider these questions: How do people in your community talk about war in general? How do people in your community talk about weapons in general? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh promises that Yahweh will pay attention to the Israelite people and be kind to the Israelites. Yahweh promises to make the Israelites fruitful and cause the Israelites to multiply. This is the same blessing that Yahweh gave after Yahweh created people, and it is special language that means that the Israelites will be able to have children so that their community will grow larger.

Stop here and do this exercise as a group: If you have translated Genesis 1:28, then listen to your translation of this blessing. If you have not translated Genesis 1:28, listen to the blessing in the easiest-to-understand translation. Now decide how you will translate this blessing in this passage. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will make the Israelites' crops so successful that the Israelites will be able to store food to eat for a long time, but the Israelites will not have to use all the food because there will be so much food in the new harvest.

In the third scene, Yahweh tells Moses about the most important good things that will happen if the Israelite people obey Yahweh's instructions. Yahweh will live with the Israelites in the Tent of Meeting, which people also called the tabernacle. Yahweh will accept the Israelites and care for the Israelites. Yahweh will walk with the Israelites, meaning that Yahweh will be present with the Israelites. Yahweh and the Israelite people will belong to each other. Yahweh will be the Israelites' God, and the Israelites will be Yahweh's people.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: How would people in your community talk about the way a god is present with people? Yahweh says that Yahweh will be with the Israelites just like you would be with someone who walks with you. Discuss how you want to translate the way Yahweh says this. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh reminds the Israelite people of how Yahweh rescued the Israelites to show that Yahweh actually can do all the good things Yahweh promises. Yahweh also wants to remind the Israelites that Yahweh has already chosen the Israelites to be Yahweh's special people. Earlier, Yahweh rescued the Israelites from being slaves in Egypt. When Yahweh freed the Israelites from slavery, it was like Yahweh took a heavy wooden beam off the Israelites' backs so the Israelites could stand up straight.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How do people in your community talk about slavery? What kinds of words do people use to represent slavery? How do people describe someone who is free and not a slave?

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Discuss how you want to translate how Yahweh talks about the Israelites being slaves and then free people. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text
Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:6–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- And enemy soldiers

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

For the first scene, have the person playing Yahweh tell the person playing Moses that things will happen to the Israelites if the Israelites obey Yahweh's instructions.

Say that the Israelites will experience peace and wellness in the land that Yahweh is leading the Israelites to. The Israelites will not have to be afraid of anybody or anything. The Israelites will not have dangerous animals or war in their land. And when the Israelites go to war, the Israelites will be very successful, even when their enemies have much bigger armies. Just a few Israelite soldiers will be able to chase off many enemy soldiers, and the Israelites will be able to kill those enemy soldiers. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am feeling relieved that nothing and no one will attack us when we get to our new land; or
- I am excited that we will be able to fight our enemies and win; or
- I am impressed that we will not have to deal with dangerous animals in our land.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, have the person playing Yahweh tell the person playing Moses that Yahweh promises to pay attention to the Israelite people and be kind to the Israelites. Yahweh will make the Israelites able to have children so that their community will grow larger. Yahweh will make their crops so successful that the Israelites will be able to store food to eat for a long time. However, the Israelites will not have to use that food because there will be so much food in the new harvest. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so glad that Yahweh is going to take care of the people I have been leading; or
- I am amazed that Yahweh will give us so much when we get to the land Yahweh is taking us to; or
- I wonder if the people will actually follow Yahweh's instructions. The people have complained a lot so far.

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Continue the drama. In the third scene, have the person playing Yahweh tell the person playing Moses about the most important good things that will happen if the Israelite people obey Yahweh's instructions. Yahweh will live with the Israelites in the Tent of Meeting, which people call the tabernacle, and Yahweh will accept the Israelites and care for the Israelites. Yahweh will walk with the Israelites, meaning that Yahweh will be present with the Israelites. Yahweh and the Israelite people will belong to each other. Yahweh will be the Israelites' God, and the Israelites will be Yahweh's people. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am happy to be close to my people because I love my people; or
- I love my people so much that I am willing to live with them even though the people sin sometimes; or
- I want my people to follow my instructions so that our relationship can be good.

Continue the drama. Then have the person playing Yahweh remind Moses and the Israelite people of what Yahweh did for the Israelites before. Have the person playing Yahweh say that Yahweh rescued the Israelites from being slaves in Egypt. When Yahweh freed the Israelites from slavery to be free people, it was like Yahweh took a heavy wooden beam off the Israelites' backs so they could stand up straight. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am feeling confident that Yahweh will do these good things for us because Yahweh took care of us before; or
- I am feeling relieved because I remember how it felt when Yahweh rescued us from being slaves; or
- I can trust Yahweh because Yahweh took care of us before.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:6–13 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In the previous passage and in this passage, **Yahweh** tells Moses what will happen to the **Israelite** people if the Israelites follow Yahweh's instructions. For more information on Yahweh and Israelite, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and Israelite as you used in previous passages.

If the Israelite people follow Yahweh's instructions, Yahweh will give the Israelites peace in their land.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **peace**. Look up peace in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the people of Israel will kill their enemies with **swords**. A sword is a weapon that people make with metal. A sword is long and sharp, and people hold onto a sword using a handle. Use the same word or phrase for swords as you have used in previous books of the Bible.

Stop here and look at a picture of a sword. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh next says that Yahweh will pay attention to the Israelite people and be kind to the Israelites. Yahweh will make the Israelites able to have children, so there will be more Israelite people. Yahweh will fulfill his **covenant** or binding agreement with the Israelites. This covenant is probably talking about the Israelites being able to have many children and become more numerous, since that was the covenant Yahweh made with their ancestor Abraham in the story of Genesis. For more information on covenant, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for covenant as you used in previous passages.

The Israelites will be able to grow so much food that the Israelites will be able to live on that food for a long time. The Israelites will have to get rid of some of the food from last year's harvest to make room for all the food from this year's harvest. Yahweh will live with the people in his **tabernacle**, the Tent of Meeting. Yahweh says that Yahweh will put the place that Yahweh lives in the middle of the Israelites. This emphasizes that Yahweh is choosing to live among the Israelites. The place where Yahweh lives is the tabernacle, the Tent of Meeting. For more information on tabernacle, refer to the Master Glossary. You may use your word or phrase for tabernacle here, or you may simply say "the place where Yahweh lives." If you use your word for tabernacle, use the same word or phrase for tabernacle as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh will walk with the people. Yahweh will be the Israelites' **God**, and the Israelites will be Yahweh's people. They will belong to each other. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh also says that he is Yahweh their God and that Yahweh rescued the Israelites from Egypt so that the Israelites would not be **slaves** anymore. For more information on slave, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for slave as you used in previous passages.

Next, Yahweh says that he broke the bars of the Israelites' yoke so that the Israelites could stand up straight. Remember that what Yahweh says about the yoke is special language. The yoke symbolizes slavery, and standing up straight symbolizes freedom. When Yahweh freed the Israelite people from slavery so the Israelites could live as free people, it was like Yahweh took a heavy beam off their backs so the Israelites could stand up straight again.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **yoke**. Look up yoke in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 26:6–13

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (848 KB)
- Setting the Stage (5.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.9 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.5 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 26:10–46

Leviticus 26:10–46

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 26:40–46 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:40–46 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:40–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Over the last few passages, Yahweh has explained what will happen to the Israelites if the Israelites disobey Yahweh and do not return to obeying Yahweh after Yahweh punishes the Israelites. Now, Yahweh gives the Israelite people hope. Even after all these horrible punishments, Yahweh will still accept the Israelites back if the Israelites turn back to Yahweh.

Yahweh will remember the covenant Yahweh made with the Israelites' ancestors if the Israelites admit their iniquity and their ancestors' iniquities, or sins through the years. The Israelites must admit how the Israelites and their ancestors disobeyed Yahweh. When the Israelites betrayed and opposed Yahweh, it caused Yahweh to oppose the Israelites and send the Israelites to live in their enemies' land. But if the Israelites admit that the Israelites betrayed and opposed Yahweh, Yahweh will remember his covenant with the Israelites' ancestors.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time when your community agreed together and admitted that they or their ancestors acted in a bad way. How did the community do this? How did the community show the people were sorry? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that Yahweh will remember Yahweh's covenant with the Israelites' ancestors when the Israelites humble their uncircumcised hearts. Now, no one can actually circumcise a heart, since circumcision is when someone cuts the foreskin off a penis. The Israelites circumcised their boys and men as a way to obey Yahweh and show that the Israelites were Yahweh's people. People started to call things "uncircumcised" as a way to talk about things or people that did not specially belong to Yahweh. Uncircumcised things were things that were wrong or ritually dirty. In this case, when Yahweh says that the Israelites' hearts are uncircumcised, Yahweh means that the Israelite people are stubbornly opposed to Yahweh instead of dedicating themselves to Yahweh. So if the Israelites stop stubbornly opposing Yahweh and humble themselves, Yahweh will remember his covenant with the Israelites' ancestors. Yahweh also says that Yahweh will remember his covenant with the Israelites' ancestors when the Israelites pay for their iniquity, when Yahweh punishes the Israelites.

And when the Israelites do all these things to turn back to Yahweh, Yahweh will remember his covenants with Jacob, Isaac, and Abraham. Yahweh will never forget the agreement Yahweh made with those men. In the story of Genesis, Yahweh promised Abraham that Abraham would have many descendants and Yahweh would give those descendants the land that would become Israel. Then, Yahweh made the same promise to Abraham's son, Isaac, and Isaac's son, Jacob. So when the Israelite people turn back to Yahweh, Yahweh will continue to keep Yahweh's covenant with the Israelites' ancestors and give the Israelites their land.

Yahweh also says that Yahweh will not forget the land. When Yahweh punishes the Israelites, the Israelites will leave the land so the land can rest and experience the Sabbath years of rest Yahweh planned for the land.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how long can agreements last? What kinds of covenants or agreements can people make with one another that they will still keep with their children or their other descendants? Pause this audio here.

The Israelites will have to make amends for rejecting and hating Yahweh's instructions and commandments. Even though the Israelites have rejected and hated Yahweh, Yahweh promises that Yahweh will not completely reject or hate the Israelites. Even though the Israelites will have to go to their enemies' land, Yahweh will not completely destroy the Israelites or break his covenant with the people. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh is the Israelites' God, so the Israelites and Yahweh belong to each other.

Yahweh ends by saying that Yahweh will not forget the covenant Yahweh made with the Israelites' ancestors. This time, Yahweh is not just talking about Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, though. Yahweh says that Yahweh will not forget the covenant Yahweh has made with the Israelites whom Yahweh rescued from slavery in Egypt. People from other nations saw what Yahweh did, and Yahweh rescued the Israelites so that Yahweh would be the Israelites' God and the Israelites would belong to Yahweh. While Yahweh is currently talking to the Israelites whom Yahweh rescued from Egypt, Yahweh's instructions will also be for the Israelites' descendants. If, in the future, the Israelites' descendants admit their sin and guilt, Yahweh will keep the agreement that Yahweh made with those descendants' ancestors. The ancestors are the Israelites that Yahweh is talking to now. Yahweh then reminds the Israelites that he is Yahweh, which is the name Yahweh used to introduce himself to Moses when Moses chose to obey Yahweh as Yahweh rescued the Israelites.

Finally, the storyteller of Leviticus says that these are the statutes, ordinances, and laws that Yahweh included in the agreement between himself and the Israelite people. Some people think that the storyteller is talking about everything that has happened in the whole story of Leviticus up until now. However, it is more likely that the storyteller is talking about all the instructions that Yahweh told the Israelites, starting in Leviticus chapter 17 and ending in Leviticus chapter 25. Yahweh gives these instructions to Moses on Mount Sinai. Then, Moses will tell these instructions to the Israelites.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:40–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh explains that if the Israelites admit their iniquity, Yahweh will keep his covenant with the Israelites' ancestors.

In the second scene: Yahweh explains why the Israelites will not stay in their land, even though Yahweh promised the land to the Israelites' ancestors.

In the third scene: Yahweh explains that Yahweh will not forget his agreement with the Israelite people.

In the fourth scene: This is the end of the large section of Leviticus where Yahweh is telling the Israelite people how to live a holy life and obey Yahweh.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses, who is probably the storyteller of Leviticus
- The Israelite people
- The Israelites' ancestors, including Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob
- And people from other nations

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh is still talking to Moses on Mount Sinai, and Yahweh has been telling Moses what will happen to the Israelites when Yahweh finally punishes the Israelites severely. Part of this is that Yahweh will force the Israelites

out of their land to live as exiles in their enemies' lands. The Israelites will have horrible lives in the enemies' lands.

Now, in the first scene of this passage, Yahweh explains how Yahweh will react if the Israelites confess their sin and finish paying the price for their sin by experiencing punishment from Yahweh. First, the Israelites must admit that they and their ancestors sinned. The Israelites must admit that the Israelites and their ancestors betrayed Yahweh and walked in opposition to Yahweh. When Yahweh says that the Israelites walked in opposition to Yahweh, Yahweh uses special language that means that the Israelites lived their lives in such a way that the Israelites opposed Yahweh.

Stop here and remember as a group how, in previous passages, you translated the idea of "walking" as a way to talk about how people obeyed or followed Yahweh. Pause this audio here.

Because the Israelites opposed Yahweh, Yahweh opposed the Israelites and removed the Israelites from their land. Yahweh sent the Israelites to live in their enemies' land. The Israelites must be humble and dedicate themselves to Yahweh again. Yahweh says that the Israelites must humble their uncircumcised hearts. People circumcised Israelite boys and men to show that those boys and men obeyed Yahweh. When people talked about uncircumcised things, people meant that those things were wrong or ritually dirty. The heart represents a person's thoughts and emotions. If the heart is ritually dirty, it means that the person no longer wants to follow Yahweh. Here, Yahweh says that the Israelites' hearts are ritually dirty, so the Israelites need to dedicate themselves to Yahweh again.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: How will you translate the idea of uncircumcised hearts? Pause this audio here.

The Israelites must pay for not obeying Yahweh's instructions, which made the Israelites guilty. Yahweh must punish the Israelites so that the Israelites pay the price for what the Israelites did to become guilty.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: How will you translate the idea of paying for iniquity? In this context, iniquity refers to the wrong things people did that made the people guilty. When the Israelites pay for their guilty actions, the Israelites have to submit to Yahweh's punishment. How can you talk about this in your language? Pause this audio here.

If the Israelites pay for the wrong things the Israelites have done, then Yahweh will fulfill his covenant or keep his agreement that Yahweh made with the Israelites' ancestors, including Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. Yahweh talks about the covenant with Abraham, the covenant with Isaac, and the covenant with Jacob, but Yahweh does not mean there are three covenants. Yahweh made one covenant with Abraham, and Yahweh kept the same agreement with Isaac and Jacob. In the original language, when Yahweh says that Yahweh will remember his covenant, Yahweh does not mean that Yahweh ever forgot the covenant. Yahweh just wants to emphasize that Yahweh will never forget it. So Yahweh will never forget the agreement Yahweh made with the Israelites' ancestors, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.

Yahweh will also remember his agreement with the Israelites' ancestors about the land. Much earlier, Yahweh had promised the Israelites' ancestors that they would have many descendants and that those descendants would live in the land of Israel. So Yahweh probably means that Yahweh will then bring the Israelites back to their land and cause the Israelites to have many descendants again.

In the second scene, Yahweh then explains why the Israelites would not stay in their land as Yahweh had promised to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. Yahweh would cause the Israelites to leave because the land needs rest, and the Israelites need to pay for their guilt. The Israelites will spend many years in the land of their enemies. While the Israelites are there, the Israelites will pay for the way the Israelites rejected and hated Yahweh's instructions and commandments. At the same time, while the Israelites are in other countries, the land of Israel will be empty. The land will finally experience the Sabbath years of rest that the Israelites did not give the land. You will remember that Yahweh says the land will enjoy its rest at this time.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: How will you talk about the land enjoying rest in your translation? How can you talk about land doing something that normally only a person would do? If you cannot do this in your language, how can you talk about Yahweh giving the land time to rest? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: Start telling a story about your family, with you as the main character. At some point, pause the story and explain something that your parents or grandparents did that affects your story. Pay attention to how you talk about things that happened before the story. Pause this audio here.

In the third scene, Yahweh emphasizes that although Yahweh will punish the Israelites because of their sin, Yahweh will not break his covenant. Even while the Israelites are in enemy lands because the Israelites hated and rejected Yahweh, Yahweh will not hate the Israelites or reject the Israelites so completely that Yahweh destroys all the Israelites. Yahweh does not want to break Yahweh's agreement with the Israelites. Yahweh is still the Israelites' God, even when the Israelites have rejected Yahweh and Yahweh is punishing the Israelites. Because Yahweh cares about the Israelites, Yahweh will remember the covenant that Yahweh is currently making with the Israelite people who are with Moses at Mount Sinai. These are the people that Yahweh rescued from slavery in Egypt. Yahweh rescued the Israelites so that Yahweh could be the Israelites' God, and Yahweh rescued the Israelites to show the other nations how powerful Yahweh is.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: Imagine you are telling a story from your life about something that happened to you while you were away from home. At the same time, something happened to your family at home. How would you talk about what happened to you? How would you talk about what happened to your family? Pay attention to how you talk about things that happen at different places at the same time. Pause this audio here.

The fourth scene is what the storyteller of Leviticus says at the end of a long section. Since chapter 17 of Leviticus, Yahweh has been telling Moses what the Israelites should do to obey Yahweh and live holy lives. Now, the storyteller lets us listeners know that this section is over. The storyteller says that all these passages that have come before this are the statutes and ordinances and instructions or laws that Yahweh gave Moses when Yahweh met with Moses on Mount Sinai to make a covenant or agreement with the people of Israel.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: When you explain something like an agreement or some long instructions to a group of people, how do you show that you have finished? How would you remind the people of the main point of everything you have said? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:40–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses, who is probably the storyteller of Leviticus
- The Israelite people
- Their ancestors, including Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob
- And people from other nations

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Before this passage, Yahweh made a covenant with the Israelites' ancestors, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. Yahweh has punished the Israelite people by forcing the Israelites to leave their land.

Then, in the first scene of this passage, have the person playing Yahweh explain to the person playing Moses how Yahweh will react if the Israelites confess their sins. First, Yahweh says the Israelites should admit that the Israelites and their ancestors have sinned, betrayed Yahweh, and opposed Yahweh, so have the person playing the Israelites do that. Then Yahweh explains that because the Israelites disobeyed Yahweh, Yahweh opposed the Israelites and removed the Israelites from their land to send the Israelites to live in their enemies' land. Yahweh also explains that the Israelites must be humble and dedicate themselves to Yahweh again, and the Israelites must pay for not obeying Yahweh's instructions, which made the Israelites guilty. Then Yahweh says that when the Israelites do these things, Yahweh will respond and remember Yahweh's covenant or keep his agreement that Yahweh made with the Israelites' ancestors, including Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. Have the person playing Yahweh act out bringing the person playing the Israelites back to their land. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am so sorry that we disobeyed Yahweh! or
- Wow, Yahweh is very good! We do not deserve for Yahweh to still keep his covenant with us, but Yahweh will still do it! or
- I just want to go back to my land. I am sorry for everything that I and my ancestors did that caused us to have to leave our land.

Continue the drama. For the second scene of this passage, have the person playing Yahweh tell the person playing Moses that Yahweh will not forget the land. While the Israelites are outside the land of Israel, the land will be empty and will experience the Sabbath years of rest that the Israelites did not give the land. At the same time the Israelites will have to make amends for the wrong things the Israelites did because the Israelites rejected and hated Yahweh's instructions and commandments.

For the third scene, have the person playing Yahweh explain the following things to the person playing Moses. Yahweh says that even though the Israelites will be living in their enemies' land, and even though the Israelites have rejected and hated Yahweh's commands, Yahweh will not hate the Israelites or reject the Israelites so completely that Yahweh destroys all of the Israelites or breaks his agreement with the Israelites. Yahweh says that Yahweh is still the Israelites' God and Yahweh will remember the covenant that Yahweh made with the Israelites' ancestors. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am sad that my people rejected and hated my commands. I only want what is best for my people! or
- I love my people so much that I will not reject them even though my people rejected me; or
- I remember the covenant that I made with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, and I am committed to keeping this covenant even when it is hard.

Continue the drama. Because this happens in the future, the ancestors that Yahweh talks about are the people of Israel that are with Moses at Mount Sinai. Have the person playing Moses remind the person playing the Israelite people that Yahweh rescued the Israelites from slavery in Egypt. Have the person playing Moses remind the Israelites that people from all the other nations saw what Yahweh did. Yahweh rescued the Israelites so that Yahweh could be the Israelites' God and the Israelites could be Yahweh's people.

The fourth scene is how the storyteller summarizes this section of Leviticus. Have the person playing the storyteller say that all these things in the previous passages of Leviticus are Yahweh's statutes and ordinances and instructions or laws. Yahweh gave all these instructions to Moses when Yahweh met with Moses on Mount Sinai. At that time, Yahweh made a covenant or agreement with the people of Israel. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad that Yahweh made a covenant with us. That is a great honor; or
- I am nervous about these instructions. These instructions are very important, and it seems hard to obey all the instructions; or
- I am so glad that Yahweh gives us clear instructions so we do not have to wonder what Yahweh wants.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:40–46 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Before this passage, **Yahweh** explained many things that will happen to the **Israelite** people if the Israelites disobey Yahweh and do not return to obeying Yahweh after Yahweh punishes the Israelites. For more information on Yahweh and Israelites, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and Israelites as you used in previous passages.

Now Yahweh says that if the Israelite people admit their **iniquities** and their ancestors' iniquities, Yahweh will fulfill his **covenant** or binding agreement with their ancestors. You will remember that iniquity is the wrong things someone does over time that makes that person guilty. For more information on iniquity and covenant, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for iniquity and covenant as you used in previous passages.

But if the Israelite people admit that they betrayed and opposed Yahweh, which caused Yahweh to oppose the Israelites and send the Israelites to live in their enemies' land, Yahweh will fulfill his covenant with the Israelites' ancestors, **Abraham**, Isaac, and Jacob. For more information about Abraham, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same name for Abraham as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh says that Yahweh will remember his covenant with the Israelites' ancestors when the Israelites humble their uncircumcised hearts. In this passage, uncircumcised is a symbolic word that means that the people have not dedicated themselves to Yahweh. No one has actually circumcised the people's hearts. In the original language, the words for circumcised and uncircumcised are different words, but the ideas are similar. The circumcision Yahweh is talking about here is symbolic, and when Yahweh talks about the Israelites' hearts, Yahweh means the parts of the Israelites where the people make decisions. When Yahweh talks about uncircumcised hearts, Yahweh means that the Israelite people have not dedicated themselves to Yahweh, so the Israelites need to humble themselves and return to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words you will use for **circumcision** and **heart**. For more information on circumcision and heart, refer to the Master Glossary. Consider whether you should use a similar word or phrase for circumcision as you used in previous passages. Consider whether you should use the same word or phrase for heart as you used in previous passages. Pause this audio here.

When the Israelites do these things to turn back to Yahweh, Yahweh will remember or fulfill his covenant with Jacob, Isaac, and Abraham. Remember that in the original language, to say that Yahweh will remember his covenant does not mean that Yahweh at one time forgot the covenant. It means that Yahweh will fulfill the covenant and never forget it. Yahweh also says that Yahweh will remember the land. When Yahweh punishes the Israelites, the Israelites will leave the land so it can rest and experience the **Sabbath** years of rest Yahweh planned for the land. Remember that this is not just talking about the weekly Sabbath day of rest, but about the Sabbath year of rest that happened every seven years. For more information on Sabbath, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase as you used for the Sabbath year of rest in previous passages.

Yahweh promises that even when the Israelite people are in their enemies' land, Yahweh will not reject the Israelites so much that Yahweh completely destroys the Israelites or that Yahweh breaks his covenant with the Israelites. Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh is the Israelites' **God**. For more information on God, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for God as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh ends by saying that Yahweh will not forget the covenant Yahweh made with the Israelites' ancestors. Yahweh does this so that people from other **nations** would see Yahweh rescue the Israelites. For more information on nations, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for nation as you used in previous passages.

At the end of the passage, the storyteller says that everything that came before was the **statutes** and **ordinances** and instructions or **laws** that Yahweh included in the agreement between Yahweh and the Israelite people. For more information about statute, ordinance, or law, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for statute, ordinance, and law as you used in previous passages. However, notice that these are not talking

about three separate things. This is a way to talk about all of the things Yahweh has told the people of Israel to do to obey Yahweh. If having three different words for this in your language communicates that these are separate things, consider translating these ideas as one more general word or phrase that would include things like instructions, ordinances, and statutes. Yahweh told all these instructions to Moses on Mount Sinai.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 26:10–46

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (848 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.6 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.4 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.8 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.3 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 26:14–20

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 26:14–20 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:14–20 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.

5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:14–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

You remember in the previous passage how Yahweh said that if the Israelites follow Yahweh's instructions, Yahweh promised to give the Israelites rain and food. Yahweh promised to keep the Israelites safe from war and from wild animals. Yahweh promised to give the Israelites lots of children and victory over their enemies. And Yahweh promised that Yahweh himself would live with the Israelites. This passage talks about what will happen to the Israelites if the Israelites do not follow Yahweh's instructions.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about a time that your parents punished you for not following their instructions. If you are a parent, talk about what happens when your child does not listen to what you tell your child to do. What do you do? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites in this passage that if the Israelites do not listen to Yahweh's instructions and do the things Yahweh told the Israelites to do, then the Israelites are breaking Yahweh's covenant or special promise with the Israelites. This means that the Israelites are breaking their promise to Yahweh. Yahweh tells the Israelites that Yahweh will send the Israelites severe sickness and diseases that lead to death if the Israelites do not listen. Yahweh also says that the Israelites' enemies will eat the Israelites' crops and food before the Israelites get a chance to harvest. Yahweh will also send enemies to conquer the Israelites' land and rule the Israelites, and the Israelites will be afraid.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Talk about what happens in your culture when someone breaks a legal agreement or covenant with an important person. Think about a time when someone has broken a promise to you. How did you feel? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh continues his warning to the Israelites and tells the Israelites that if the Israelites still do not listen to Yahweh after Yahweh sends disease and war, then Yahweh will allow certain things to happen or give certain punishments so that the Israelites will obey. Yahweh does this much like a parent gives their children consequences when their children do not obey the parents. In fact, Yahweh says Yahweh will continue to discipline the Israelites over and over again as much as the Israelites need! The original language uses the special phrase "seven times" to describe this.

Stop here and discuss as a group: What did your parents do when you disobeyed your parents as a child? When your parents did those things, did you obey them? Why did your parents do this? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites that Yahweh will set his face against the Israelites. In the cultures around the Israelites, when a god turned his face towards people, it meant the god was giving people blessings. The god would help the people. However, if a god turned his face away from the people, it meant the god was acting against those people. That god did not help the people and would also oppose or curse the people.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: What happens in your culture when someone important turns their face away from someone, or rejects and curses that person? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says Yahweh will help the Israelites become humble and weak by making the sky like iron and the earth like bronze. Iron and bronze are hard metals. Iron and bronze are impossible to break. This means Yahweh will stop the rain from coming and the ground from growing food.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of iron and bronze. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says the Israelites feel proud of their ability to take care of themselves by growing their own food. Yahweh says Yahweh will stop the ground's ability to grow food. This will make the Israelites remember the Israelites are not the ones who make the food grow. The Israelites will work in vain, or work and get no use out of it. Yahweh's purpose in doing this is to cause the Israelites to listen to Yahweh again and remember that Yahweh is the one who really makes the food grow for the Israelites.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:14–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites what will happen if the Israelites do not follow Yahweh's instructions. Yahweh says Yahweh will send diseases and war.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites what will happen if the Israelites still do not follow Yahweh's instructions even after the deadly diseases and war. Yahweh says Yahweh will stop the sky from raining and the ground from growing food. Yahweh says he will give the Israelites as many punishments as the Israelites need to help the Israelites obey Yahweh again.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelites
- And the enemies of the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In scene one, Yahweh uses special words to show that Yahweh is giving the Israelites a warning. Yahweh is still speaking to Moses, and Yahweh expects that Moses will give Yahweh's instructions to the Israelites. Yahweh tells Moses that if the Israelites do not listen to Yahweh's instructions and if the Israelites do not do all the things Yahweh told the Israelites to do, then Yahweh will send the Israelites deadly diseases and war. Yahweh makes a direct contrast in this passage with the good things that Yahweh has just told the Israelites that Yahweh will do for them. But if the Israelites do not obey Yahweh, then the opposite things will happen to the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Think about how a parent might warn a child about what will happen if the child does not obey the parent. What words or tones of voice does the parent use? Have one participant act as a parent and another participant act as a child. Have the participant who acts as the parent give a warning to the child. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh uses similar words to say the same thing three times. Yahweh says, "If you do not listen and obey my commands, I will punish you." And Yahweh says, "If you reject my statutes, I will punish you." Yahweh then says, "If your soul hates my ordinances, or instructions, so much that you do not do what I said and break this covenant with me, I will punish you." In this culture, people often repeat ideas to show that something is important. Yahweh wants the Israelites to know how important this information is. Yahweh wants the Israelites to know how important it is that the Israelites should not disobey Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group: What ways do people in your language say something is really important? Imagine that you want someone to know a piece of information really well. How would you say that information to that person? Pause this audio here.

When Yahweh is warning the Israelites, Yahweh uses the phrase "if your soul hates my ordinances." In the original language, this is a way to use emotional language to communicate the strength of the warning. "Soul" is a part of a person, but here soul refers to the whole person, just with more emphasis. The soul is the innermost part of a person. Yahweh uses the word "hate" to show that someone very strongly dislikes something. Hate is the opposite of love. In this culture, "hate" is both a strong negative emotion and what someone does when that person rejects something.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you can show the emotional strength of the original language here. What parts of the body do you use in your language to talk about the deepest part of a human? What words do you use in your language to talk about rejection and strong negative emotions? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says Yahweh will punish the Israelites if the Israelites do not follow Yahweh's instructions. Yahweh will send horrible diseases and fever that will kill the people. In the original language, Yahweh talks about the fever that wastes eyes and drains away life. The Israelites used eyes to talk about the whole person. Some people think this phrase is talking about physical and emotional suffering. Other people think that this sickness causes death. Either way, it is a horrible fever that causes a lot of suffering.

Stop here and discuss as a group what phrase you will use for the fever that puts an end to eyes and drains away life. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says the Israelites will plant seeds in the ground, but the Israelites' enemies will eat the food that grows from the Israelites' work. Yahweh tells the Israelites that Yahweh will set his face against the Israelites. In the cultures around the Israelites, when a god turned his face towards people, it meant the god was giving people blessings. The god would help the people. However, if a god turned his face away from the people, it meant the god was acting against the people. The god was not helping the people, and the god was opposing or cursing the people. Yahweh also says that the Israelites' enemies, those who hate the Israelites, will take over and rule the Israelites' land and people. Yahweh says the Israelites will be so scared that the Israelites will run away even when nobody is coming after the Israelites. Yahweh will give the Israelites all of these punishments if the Israelites do not listen to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will talk about Yahweh setting his face against his people. Remember that Yahweh is rejecting and cursing the people when Yahweh turns his face away from the people. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh is saying that Yahweh will punish the Israelites if the Israelites do not listen to Yahweh. However, in scene two, Yahweh gives the Israelites a chance to change how the Israelites are acting and to listen to Yahweh again. Yahweh makes it clear that the whole purpose of the punishment is to help Yahweh's people begin to follow Yahweh again.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: How would you translate in your language the idea that Yahweh is punishing the people so that the people will want to obey Yahweh again? Pause the audio here.

Scene two begins with Yahweh hoping the people will obey Yahweh again. But if the people choose not to obey Yahweh after these punishments, Yahweh will continue to correct the people with more punishments. Yahweh says that Yahweh will discipline the Israelites as much as Yahweh needs to because the people have rejected Yahweh and not followed Yahweh's instructions. The original language uses the number seven to refer to this. Seven is the number of completeness. Yahweh will completely correct the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: What numbers have special meaning in your language? What does the number seven represent? How will you translate the idea that Yahweh will punish the Israelites seven times more, which means to completely punish or correct the Israelites? Pause the audio here.

Yahweh then continues and says Yahweh will break the Israelites' pride. This is special language that means Yahweh will humble the Israelites in a forceful way. The Israelites were proud when the Israelites thought they could grow all of their own food and not need Yahweh's help. Yahweh will remind the Israelites that Yahweh is the one who grows the people's food.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: What kinds of things are people in your culture proud of? How do people in your culture think about or talk about growing food? Have you ever been proud to grow your own food? Pause the audio here.

When Yahweh says that Yahweh will break the pride of the Israelites' strength, Yahweh is using a harsh way to say how this humbling will happen. When someone breaks a dish, the edges are all jagged, and the dish does not work as a dish anymore. The original language uses the phrase "break the pride of their strength" to talk about Yahweh humbling Yahweh's people. It is also communicating the harsh way Yahweh will humble Yahweh's people.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for "break the pride of their strength." It is most likely that you will need to use different words than the original language has. Try to think of ways you could say both what Yahweh is doing and how Yahweh is doing it. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says Yahweh will make the sky like iron and the land like bronze. Iron and bronze are hard metals. Nothing can break these metals. This is special language that means that Yahweh is going to stop the rain from coming down from the sky and stop the ground from growing food. Yahweh says this is how Yahweh is going to break the Israelite's pride, or humble the Israelites. Yahweh will cause no fruit to grow on trees or vegetables to grow in the ground. Then the Israelites cannot say they are proud of growing food.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: What hard things in your culture do people talk about as the most hard thing? Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss as a group what special language you can use to talk about the sky being like iron and land being like bronze. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:14–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelites
- And the enemies of the Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Have the person playing Yahweh tell Moses these things: "This is very important. Remember this. In the future, if you decide to not follow the instructions I have given you, I will punish you with deadly diseases. In the future, if you choose to not follow these instructions, I will punish you with war. In the future, if your soul hates what I have told you to do, I will correct you with famine. You break our covenant when you do not follow these instructions." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am feeling so much care in my heart for the Israelites; or
- I am feeling concerned for the future of the Israelites; or
- I love the Israelites.

Continue the drama. Have the person playing Yahweh continue to talk to Moses. Have the people playing the Israelites act out the different punishments. Yahweh says, "In the future, if you do not obey my instructions, I will send you horrible diseases that will kill you. I will punish you. I will let your enemies win wars against you. I will let the people who hate you rule your land and you. I will let you plant food, but not eat it. In fact, I will give your food to your enemies, and your enemies will eat the food. I will make you so scared in your land that you

will run away even when nobody is running after you." Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking when you hear Yahweh tell you this?" The people might answer things like:

- We are feeling scared of what will happen to us if we do not obey Yahweh; or
- We are feeling strong feelings of agreement with Yahweh; or
- We are feeling like it is so important to listen to Yahweh.

Continue the drama. Yahweh continues to say, "In the future, if all of those things happen, you can choose to obey me again, and I will stop the punishment. But if you keep disobeying my instructions, even after I sent you all those horrible punishments, I will keep correcting you. I will correct you as much as I need to until you listen to me. I will humble you. I will take your pride and break it. You are so proud of growing your own food. I will stop food from growing and rain from falling from the sky. I will make the sky as hard as iron and the ground as hard as bronze. You will not be able to grow food anymore." Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking when you say this to the Israelites?" The person might answer things like:

- I am feeling sad that I have to say this; or
- I am feeling concerned for my people; or
- I love the Israelites so much and hope the Israelites will listen to Yahweh's warning.

Continue the drama. Have the people playing the Israelites act like they feel humble.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:14–20 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh says that if the Israelites will not obey Yahweh's commands, statutes, or ordinances, then Yahweh will punish the Israelites. In this passage, Yahweh wants the Israelites to know how serious and important this is. Yahweh uses three similar words that Yahweh repeats one after the other to create this importance. These words are commands, statutes, and ordinances. All of these words are referring to Yahweh's instructions that Yahweh gave the Israelites in previous passages.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **commands**, **statutes**, and **ordinances**, and remember that these are similar words. Your language may not have three different words for these three similar types of instructions. Look up commandments, statutes, and ordinances in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated these words in this book, you may use the same words here. If your language creates emphasis through repetition, it may also be impactful in this passage to use the same word three times in a row here. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh warns the Israelites about what will happen if "your soul hates my ordinances." In the original language, this is a way to use emotional language to show how strongly Yahweh warns the Israelites. "Soul" is a part of a person, but here it refers to the whole person, just in a more emphasized way. The soul is the innermost, deepest part of a person. The word "hate" shows strong negative emotion. Hate is the opposite of love. In the original language, "hate" means both a strong negative emotion and shows when someone rejects someone or something else.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you can show the emotional strength of the original language here. Look up **soul** in the Master Glossary for more information. It might not be the best option here to use the same words you normally use to translate these terms. You could also say something like "you choose to reject my instructions." Discuss and decide if you need to pick different words or a different phrase. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh tells the Israelites that if the Israelites do not listen and obey Yahweh's instructions, then the Israelites are breaking Yahweh's **covenant** with the Israelites. A covenant is a promise or agreement between two people or groups of people. This covenant is legally binding, and both groups have to keep their promises. If one group breaks the covenant, there are serious consequences. For more information on the covenant, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for covenant as you used in previous passages.

When Yahweh tells the Israelites what will happen in the future if the Israelites do not obey, Yahweh says that Yahweh will send the wasting disease. This is a disease that makes a person so sick that the person either dies or their body becomes very weak.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **wasting disease**. If you have already translated this phrase in Deuteronomy 28:22, use the same wording here. Pause this audio here.

When Yahweh tells the Israelites what will happen in the future if the Israelites do not obey, Yahweh says Yahweh will send the "fever that wastes eyes and drains away life." The Israelites used eyes to talk about the whole person. Some people think this phrase is talking about physical and emotional suffering. Other people think that this sickness causes death. Either way, it is a horrible fever that causes a lot of suffering.

Stop here and discuss as a group what phrase you will use for the **fever that puts an end to eyes and drains away life**. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that the Israelites will plant **seeds**, but the seeds will not grow plants. Use the same word for seeds that you have used previously, and refer to seed in the Master Glossary for more information.

When Yahweh continues to tell the Israelites what will happen in the future if the Israelites do not obey, even if Yahweh sends war and famine and disease, Yahweh says Yahweh will discipline or punish the Israelites seven times for their sin. The Hebrew word for discipline here means correction or teaching. People use this word in other parts of the Bible to describe how a parent punishes a child. The goal of this punishment is instruction or teaching. This word for sin is also the word that people used to describe when someone purposefully hurts someone else that person is close to.

Stop here and discuss as a group what words or phrases you will use for **discipline** and **sin**. Look up sin in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated sin in this book, use the same word here. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that Yahweh will break the pride of their **strength**. The words "their strength" refer to the following sentences, where Yahweh explains that the Israelites take pride in their ability to grow their own food. When Yahweh uses the word "strength" to refer to the Israelites' ability to grow food, Yahweh shows two things at once. First, Yahweh shows that the Israelites believed that they could grow food on their own without help. And second, Yahweh shows that the Israelites put their trust in their own abilities rather than in Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group how you will say that Yahweh will break the pride of the Israelites' strength. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says he will make the Israelite's "sky like iron" and "land like bronze." Yahweh is comparing the sky to iron and the land to bronze. Both bronze and iron are very strong metals that people cannot break. Yahweh is saying he will make the sky not produce rain and make the ground not produce food. Yahweh uses iron and bronze as symbols of what Yahweh means. This helps the Israelites understand through special language what Yahweh is going to do.

Stop here and discuss as a group what special language you can use for the **sky like iron** and **land like bronze**. Look at pictures of iron and bronze again as a group as needed. Look up bronze in the Master Glossary for more information.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 26:14–20

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (842 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.8 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (6.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (4.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 26:21–26

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 26:21–26 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:21–26 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:21–26 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

You remember in the previous section how Yahweh told the Israelites two things that would happen if the Israelites did not obey Yahweh's instructions. Yahweh said he would send war and disease first. Then the Israelites would have a chance to turn back to Yahweh and follow Yahweh's instructions. But if the Israelites did not, Yahweh told the Israelites that the second thing Yahweh would do to the Israelites was to punish the Israelites as much as was needed until Yahweh humbled the Israelites. Yahweh would even make the sky like iron and the ground like bronze, so that the Israelites could not grow food and be proud of their own strength. This passage continues with the third and fourth things Yahweh says he will do to the Israelites if the Israelites keep disobeying Yahweh even after Yahweh punishes the Israelites the first two times.

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Yahweh tells the Israelites that if the Israelites still do not listen to Yahweh's instructions even after Yahweh punishes the Israelites the first two times, then the Israelites are actively opposing Yahweh. Yahweh says that Yahweh will give the Israelites even more punishments. Yahweh will continue to send punishments, or terrible things. Yahweh says Yahweh will send the Israelites wild animals to kill all of the Israelites' children and farm animals. This will make the Israelites' roads empty, so there will be no people on the roads. This is the third punishment.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about a time when wild animals caused people to die. Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh will give the Israelites another chance to change how the Israelites are living their lives and obey Yahweh's instructions. However, Yahweh says that if the Israelites do not accept Yahweh's discipline and change how they are acting, Yahweh will give the Israelites a fourth punishment. Yahweh says if the Israelites are still acting this way after the first three punishments, then the Israelites are actively fighting Yahweh. And Yahweh says that he himself will actively fight against the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about a group of people who are actively fighting against another group of people. What happens? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says Yahweh will fight the Israelites himself. Yahweh says he will strike the Israelites as many times as necessary because the Israelites have broken their agreement with Yahweh. The Israelites have betrayed Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about a time a person close to you betrayed you. Tell another story about a time when someone broke a strong agreement. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says he will get revenge on the Israelites when Yahweh sends a plague and enemy armies against the Israelites. Yahweh says that because of this war, food will be so small that 10 women will bake bread in 1 oven. Normally, each family would have an oven to cook all their food in and would use the oven throughout the day. But during this time, 10 women will be able to share 1 oven, because the people will have so little food to cook. This means that 10 people will have to share 1 person's food. Everyone will always be hungry.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:21–26 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites the third thing that will happen if the Israelites continue to disobey Yahweh's instructions. Yahweh will send wild animals to kill the Israelites' children and animals.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites the fourth thing that will happen to the Israelites if the Israelites continue to disobey Yahweh even after the first three punishments. Yahweh himself will fight the Israelites and send enemies of war who will take over the Israelites' land.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- And the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this passage, Yahweh is still telling Moses how Yahweh will punish the Israelites if the Israelites do not follow Yahweh's instructions. Remember that these things have not happened yet to the Israelites.

In scene one, Yahweh says that after the first two punishments, if the Israelites continue to disobey Yahweh, then the Israelites are "walking in hostility with" or actively opposing Yahweh. "Walk in hostility with" is special language Yahweh uses to talk about a relationship. This is important. Yahweh created people to walk with

Yahweh. Yahweh wants to walk with people. In other words, Yahweh wants to have a close relationship with people. Yahweh wants to live with people. Yahweh has made a special agreement with the Israelites, so Yahweh can walk with the Israelites. But in this warning, Yahweh says if the Israelites walk in hostility with Yahweh, then Yahweh will punish the Israelites like a parent punishes a child so the Israelites might change their minds and walk with Yahweh again.

Stop here and discuss as a group: What ways do people talk about close relationships in your language? Tell a story about a close relationship with one person who chose to hurt the other person. Pay attention to the language you use to talk about the close relationship before one person betrays the other person. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says if the Israelites actively oppose Yahweh after the first two punishments, Yahweh will punish the Israelites seven times for their sins and their betrayal. Yahweh will punish the Israelites by sending a plague, which in this passage means that Yahweh will judge or punish the Israelites with suffering that causes death and pain. The word “plague” means a judgment or punishment that causes death and pain.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about a god that gives people punishments that cause death and pain. Pause this audio here.

People in the original language use the number “seven” to represent completeness or perfection. Yahweh will send a plague up to seven times. This means the plague will be the most horrible it can be.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Discuss how you might translate the ideas of plagues or punishments and the number seven that shows completeness in this passage. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will send the Israelites a plague as the third punishment. Yahweh says this plague will cause death and pain. Yahweh will send wild animals to the Israelites. The wild animals will kill the Israelites’ children. Yahweh says that Yahweh will make the people “childless,” and the parents will feel pain because the parents have lost their children.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Imagine a parent loses their children. How might that parent feel? How would you talk about that feeling? Pause this audio here.

The wild animals will kill the children. The wild animals will also kill the farm animals. This plague will result in fewer people. Yahweh says that the roads will be empty. This is special language that shows that the wild animals will kill many people.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Imagine a village or town in your area that is full of people. Now imagine this same village or town with no people at all. How would you talk about this? Pause this audio here.

The second scene begins similarly to the first scene. Yahweh tells the Israelites that if the Israelites do not accept correction from Yahweh from the first three punishments, then Yahweh himself will fight against the Israelites with hostility or opposition.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about a child who does not accept when their parents continue to discipline the child. Pay attention to the language you use to talk about the children who do not accept correction and the parents who keep disciplining the children. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh himself will strike the Israelites with a sword seven times because of the Israelites’ sins. Seven times is special language that means as much as necessary. When Yahweh says he will strike with a sword, Yahweh means that Yahweh will send other people to kill the Israelites in war.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Discuss how your language might translate “seven times” in this passage. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says he will strike the Israelites as much as is necessary. Yahweh says Yahweh will bring with him a sword. In the original language, Yahweh describes this sword as a sword that “wants revenge for the covenant.” You remember in the earlier passages that the Israelites made a covenant, or special promise, with Yahweh. In this passage, Yahweh is saying that Yahweh is going to fight the Israelites if the Israelites keep breaking this covenant. Yahweh will fight the Israelites with this sword that Yahweh calls “a sword that wants revenge for their betrayal.” The sword is special language. People use swords to kill people. In this passage, Yahweh sends

other people to start a war against the Israelites because the Israelites betrayed Yahweh. Yahweh will use a sword that will get revenge for the way the Israelites betrayed Yahweh. Yahweh will not literally use a sword, but will send other people with swords and weapons to attack the Israelites, because of how the Israelites broke Yahweh's covenant.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Discuss how you might translate the phrase "sword that wants revenge for the covenant" in this passage. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh says that this war will cause the Israelites to all be together in the cities, or towns. Yahweh will then send a plague in the middle of the Israelites. Many people think this plague is a terrible sickness that will weaken the Israelites to the point that the enemy can come in and capture the Israelites. Yahweh will use the war to cut off the food supply for the Israelites. The original language uses the word "bread" to talk about food in general. After the war makes it hard for people to get bread to eat, 10 women will bake bread in 1 oven because the women will not have much grain to make into bread, and it will not be enough food for everyone. The Israelites will eat but will still be hungry.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Tell a story about a time when war was happening, and the people did not have enough food. Pause this audio here.

The women will pass out the bread "by weight." In other words, the Israelites will have so little food that the Israelites will have to carefully split up the food and weigh it on a scale to give each person the same amount.

Stop here and discuss as a group: Imagine having so little food that you have to carefully split the food up, weigh it on a scale, and pass it out. Discuss how you might translate the phrase "pass out your bread by weight" in this passage. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:21–26 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- And the Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Have the person playing Yahweh turn to the person playing Moses. Have the person playing Moses turn to the people playing the Israelites and say these things: "If you keep walking with me in hostility or opposition even after the first two punishments, I will send you a plague that will be as bad as it can be. If you continue to ignore me, if you do not want to listen to me, I will send you this plague. This plague is for your sins. This plague will be

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wild animals. I will send you wild animals. The wild animals will kill your children. The wild animals will kill your animals. The wild animals will make you have fewer people and will make your roads empty. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am feeling so sad in my heart for the Israelites; or
- I am feeling frustrated that the Israelites are not coming back to me; or
- I wish the Israelites would listen to me.

Continue the drama. Have the people playing the Israelites act out grieving because they lost children. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am feeling so sad that my children and farm animals died; or
- I am feeling angry at Yahweh for punishing us.

Continue the drama. The person playing Yahweh says to Moses, "Continue to say these things to the Israelites:

'And after that, if you still do not listen to me, if you do not accept my correction from the first three punishments, then I will oppose you. I, Yahweh, will fight against you. I will strike you as much as is necessary for your sins. I will bring with me a sword that represents revenge for you breaking my covenant. This means I will send you war. I will send you war that will make you gather in your cities and towns. I will send a plague in the middle of you. I will send your enemies to fight you, and they will win. I will use the war to cut off your food. Then, after I cut off your food, it will be so bad that you will have 10 women baking bread in 1 oven. And when the women are dividing up the food, the women will split the food up by weighing it on a scale. People will pass the food out, but it will not be enough. You, the Israelites, will eat the food, and you will not be full. You will still be hungry.'" Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking when you say this?" The person might answer things like:

- I am feeling sad that I have to say this; or
- I am feeling concerned for my people; or
- I love the Israelites so much and hope the people will listen to my warning.

Continue the drama. Have the people playing the Israelites fall down to represent being hungry and dying from war. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking when you hear this?" The person might answer things like:

- I imagine that this would feel horrible; or
- I do not want to disobey Yahweh; or
- I do not want this to happen.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:21–26 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

Yahweh says that if the Israelites keep disobeying Yahweh's instructions and refuse to obey Yahweh even after Yahweh has sent two punishments, then the Israelites are walking with Yahweh in hostility. Hostility is when a person is actively working against or fighting another person.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **hostility**. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will send a plague on the Israelites. A plague is something really bad that causes pain and death.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **plague**. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will send a plague because the Israelites have **sinned**, or betrayed Yahweh. For more information on sin, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for sin as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh will bring a sword that wants revenge for Yahweh's covenant with the Israelites. When you get revenge, you hurt a person because that person hurt you.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **revenge**. Pause this audio here.

A **covenant** is a promise or agreement between two people or groups of people. This agreement or covenant is legally binding, and the people must not break it. If one group breaks the covenant, that person will experience serious consequences. For more information on the covenant, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for covenant as you used in previous passages.

The war Yahweh sends to the Israelites will make it so that the Israelites have no food to eat. Moses says 10 women will bake **bread** in 1 **oven**. Bread is a food that people make from grain. People sometimes use the word bread to represent food. An oven is the hot place people use to cook bread. Use the same word for bread and oven as you have used in previous passages.

Stop here as a group and together look at a picture of bread and ovens as needed.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 26:21–26

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (849 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.2 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.9 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 26:27–33

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 26:27–33 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:27–33 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:27–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last few passages, Yahweh has explained what will happen to the Israelite people if the Israelites obey Yahweh's commands and instructions and what will happen to the Israelite people if the Israelites do not obey Yahweh's commands and instructions.

In the previous two passages, Yahweh has talked about many things Yahweh will do to punish the people of Israel if the Israelites continue to disobey Yahweh's instructions. When Yahweh punishes the Israelites, the Israelites are supposed to turn back to Yahweh and start following Yahweh's instructions again. But if the Israelites do not obey Yahweh, Yahweh will keep punishing the Israelites. Each time Yahweh gives the Israelites another chance to obey Yahweh and the Israelites still refuse to turn back to Yahweh, Yahweh will give a worse punishment. Yahweh has described four punishments that Yahweh will give the Israelite people if the Israelites ignore Yahweh and continue to sin. Now, in this passage, Yahweh gives a fifth warning. In the future, if the Israelites do not pay attention to Yahweh's first four punishments, then Yahweh will punish the Israelites again.

Yahweh says that if the Israelites keep disobeying and opposing Yahweh even after the earlier punishments, Yahweh will be angry with the Israelites, and Yahweh will oppose the Israelites. Yahweh also says that at that time, Yahweh will punish the Israelites seven times worse than Yahweh has before that time. Since the number seven represents things that are finished and complete to the people of Israel, this means that Yahweh will punish the Israelites completely. It shows that the punishment will be very serious.

One of the punishments is that the people will be so hungry that the Israelites will eat the flesh of their children. Israelite people did not even eat animal blood, so the Israelites considered eating any human to be a horrible thing to do. But if the Israelites keep opposing Yahweh, the Israelites will be so hungry that the Israelites will do terrible things that the people never thought they would do.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Can you think of a true story from your culture or another culture you have heard of where people ate other people? What happened to cause the people to do that? How is that similar to or different from what will happen to the Israelite people? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh also says that Yahweh will destroy the high places where the people worship false gods. These high places were usually on top of hills, but not always. The high places would have altars and some kind of statue or object that people used to worship other gods.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What kinds of places can people go to in your culture to worship a god or spirit? Where do people in your culture make these places of worship? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will destroy the altars where the Israelites offered incense to other gods. Yahweh will stack up the people's dead bodies on the dead bodies of the people's idols. This probably does not mean that Yahweh will literally stack bodies on top of the bodies of dead false gods. Instead, it means that Yahweh will kill so many Israelite people who worshiped false idols that someone could pile up their dead bodies. It is also a way for Yahweh to remind the Israelite people that these idols that people worship instead of Yahweh are not even alive, so the idols are no different from a dead body. Yahweh also says that Yahweh will hate the Israelite people and the Israelites will disgust Yahweh. This means Yahweh will no longer help or protect the Israelites like Yahweh did before. Yahweh will not be happy with the Israelites anymore.

Yahweh will also destroy the Israelites' cities and sanctuaries, or holy places. The holy places probably include the places where the Israelites worship false gods as well as the temple where the Israelites worship Yahweh. Yahweh will not accept the Israelites' offerings anymore either. Before, the smell of the offerings that the Israelite people sacrificed to Yahweh would make Yahweh happy, but now these offerings will not please Yahweh. Yahweh will ruin the Israelite people's land, and Yahweh will destroy the land completely. The enemies who take the Israelites' land over and move into the land will see what Yahweh did to the Israelites and their land, and it will surprise the enemies.

Finally, Yahweh says that Yahweh will scatter the Israelites among other nations. This means that Yahweh will cause the Israelites' enemies to force the Israelites to go far away from the Israelites' land. The Israelites will have to live in other countries. Yahweh will cause the Israelites' enemies to chase and attack the Israelites, so the Israelites will live in fear. Yahweh will destroy the Israelites' land and their cities.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:27–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells Moses that if the Israelites still do not obey Yahweh after all the ways Yahweh has punished the Israelites, then Yahweh will punish the Israelites even more strongly than before.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells Moses what will happen to the Israelite people when Yahweh punishes the Israelites.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- And enemies of the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In this passage, Yahweh continues to give Moses instructions from Mount Sinai. Yahweh has told Moses what will happen to the Israelite people if the Israelites obey Yahweh. Yahweh has also just told Moses several things that will happen to the Israelites if the Israelites do not obey Yahweh. Yahweh has previously talked about four types of bad things that will happen to the Israelites if the Israelites keep disobeying Yahweh. Now, Yahweh talks about a fifth type of bad things that will happen to the Israelites if the Israelites do not turn back to Yahweh after the other four punishments. Remember that these things have not happened yet to the Israelites.

In the first scene of this passage, Yahweh describes the things that must happen before Yahweh punishes the Israelites the fifth time. The Israelites must first experience the first four punishments that Yahweh just told Moses about. The Israelites also must continue to not listen to Yahweh. The Israelites also must continue to oppose Yahweh. Yahweh will only punish the Israelites if the Israelites continue to oppose Yahweh, just as in the previous two passages. Each time, Yahweh says that Yahweh will only punish the Israelites again if the Israelites do not learn from the previous punishment. But if the Israelites still do not obey and still oppose Yahweh after Yahweh punishes the Israelites four times, then Yahweh will be very angry. Yahweh will punish the Israelites with an even more serious punishment than Yahweh did before.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: When you have asked someone to do something, and that person still has not done what you asked, even though a long time has passed, how do you say that the person still has not obeyed? How do you say that the person has not obeyed if you have reminded the person many times what you asked that person to do? Pause this audio here.

In the second scene of this passage, Yahweh explains to Moses what those punishments will be. Yahweh will cause the Israelite people to be so hungry that the Israelites will eat their own children to try to survive. Yahweh

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will destroy the altars and everything else on the high places where people worship false gods. Yahweh will kill many Israelite people who worship these false gods who are not even alive. When Yahweh talks about killing the Israelite people who worship false gods, Yahweh says that he will pile the dead bodies of the Israelites on top of the dead bodies of the people's idols. Yahweh compares the bodies of the people Yahweh will kill to the idols, which were never alive.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you talk about dead bodies? How do you talk about things that were never alive? Discuss how you want to translate Yahweh's words. Can you use the same word or phrase to talk about people's dead bodies and idols that are not alive? Will it be clearer to use different words or phrases to talk about people's dead bodies and idols' bodies? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh even says he will hate the Israelite people. Yahweh then says Yahweh will destroy the Israelites' cities and sanctuaries or holy places, and that Yahweh will not accept the Israelite people's sacrifices anymore. Yahweh talks about this by saying that Yahweh will not smell the Israelites' pleasing aromas anymore. When the Israelites make sacrifices and give offerings to Yahweh, the smell from the sacrifices and offerings makes Yahweh happy. But now Yahweh says that Yahweh will not smell these things anymore. The sacrifices and offerings will not make Yahweh happy, because the Israelite people do not obey Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: Decide how you will talk about how Yahweh will not accept the Israelites' sacrifices and offerings anymore in your translation. How will you talk about the pleasing aromas? Do you also need to explain that the aromas are from the sacrifices and offerings? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will destroy the land by causing the land to be empty and without people. This will greatly surprise the enemies who take over the Israelites' land. When Yahweh says this, Yahweh emphasizes that Yahweh is the one who will do this.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: Think about something you have done recently. If you want to emphasize that you were the one who did that thing, and nobody else was the one who did it, how do you talk about that? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh then says that Yahweh will force the Israelite people away from their land to go live in many other countries, and that Yahweh will cause the Israelites to experience war. When Yahweh talks about this, Yahweh uses special language. Yahweh says that Yahweh will take out his sword and chase the Israelites. Swords represent war in general, so Yahweh will cause war, which will harm the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: How will you translate this special language? How do people in your culture talk about war in general? How would people talk about God causing war? Pause this audio here.

Finally, Yahweh reminds the Israelites that Yahweh will destroy the Israelites' land and cities, so that their cities are just ruins or piles of rubble where people cannot live.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:27–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- And enemies of the Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

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This passage talks about some very horrible punishments that Yahweh may punish the Israelites with in the future. As you act out this passage, remember that in the story of Leviticus, these punishments have not happened yet. You may not be able to fully act out everything that happens in this passage without doing something offensive, so make sure that everyone in your group is comfortable with how you act out this passage. You may need to talk about how you would act out certain actions instead of actually acting them out.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

For the first scene, have the person playing Yahweh talk to the person playing Moses. Have Yahweh say that Yahweh wants the Israelites to listen to Yahweh and to stop opposing Yahweh. Yahweh wants the Israelites to obey Yahweh after Yahweh punishes the Israelites with all the punishments Yahweh talked about in the previous two passages. If the Israelites do not obey Yahweh after all these punishments, Yahweh will be angry with the Israelites. And this time, Yahweh will punish the Israelites very seriously, with a very complete set of punishments. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Moses, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am afraid of the punishments Yahweh says he will do to the Israelite people; or
- I have been frustrated that the Israelite people have disobeyed Yahweh so much in the past. I know the Israelites will disobey Yahweh again, because the Israelites do not trust Yahweh as they should; or
- I am sad that the Israelite people may someday suffer like this because the Israelites disobey Yahweh.

Continue the drama. For the second scene, have the people playing Yahweh, the Israelite people, and the enemies of the Israelites act out or discuss what Yahweh says Yahweh will do to the Israelite people when Yahweh punishes the Israelites. When Yahweh punishes the Israelites, the Israelite people will starve so badly that the Israelites will eat their own children. Yahweh will destroy the altars and everything else the Israelites use to worship false gods on the places of worship on hilltops. Yahweh will kill many Israelite people who worship these false gods because these false gods are not even alive. Yahweh will hate the Israelite people. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelite people, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I hope that we will turn back to Yahweh before Yahweh punishes us in this way; or
- I wonder if Yahweh will really punish us as badly as Yahweh says; or
- These punishments sound so bad! We really need to obey Yahweh so this does not happen!

Continue the drama. Yahweh will destroy Israelite cities and sanctuaries or holy places. When Israelite people try to make sacrifices to Yahweh, Yahweh will not accept those sacrifices. Yahweh will destroy the Israelite people's land so completely that it will horrify the enemies who come and take over the Israelites' land. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the enemies of the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- What the Israelites are going through is so awful that even I am sad for the Israelites, even though we are enemies; or
- I am happy to see the Israelites suffer, but I am surprised how badly the Israelites are suffering; or
- I am afraid of the Israelite's God, who is making the Israelites suffer so much.

Continue the drama. Lastly, Yahweh will force the Israelite people to leave their land to go live in many other countries, and Yahweh will cause the Israelites to be at war with their enemies. Through this, Yahweh will totally destroy the Israelite people's land and cities.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:27–33 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In the previous two passages, **Yahweh** has talked about four ways Yahweh will punish the **Israelite** people if the Israelites continue to disobey Yahweh's instructions. For more information on Yahweh and Israelite, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and Israelite as you used in previous passages.

If the Israelite people still do not turn back to Yahweh, Yahweh will keep punishing the Israelites. In this passage, Yahweh talks about the fifth group of things Yahweh will do to punish the people of Israel if the Israelites continue to disobey Yahweh.

Yahweh says that if the Israelite people keep **sinning** and opposing Yahweh even after the previous punishments, Yahweh will be angry with the Israelites, and Yahweh will oppose the Israelites with great anger. For more information on **sin**, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for sin as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh will punish the Israelites very seriously and completely. Yahweh will make the Israelite people so hungry that the Israelites will eat their own children to try and survive. Yahweh will destroy the high places on the mountains and hills where people worship false gods. High places were shrines that the people made, often on hills and mountains. People would usually put something like a sacred stone, pillar, tree, or a statue that people made to represent a false god. People would also put an altar there and use it to offer sacrifices to false gods.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **high place**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will destroy the **altars** where the Israelite people offer incense to false gods. For more information about altars, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for altar as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh will also kill so many people for worshiping other gods that it is like Yahweh will stack people's dead bodies on the dead bodies of their **idols**, the objects people use to worship false gods. For more information about idol, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for idol as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh will take out his **sword** to chase the Israelites. Use the same word or phrase for sword as you used in previous passages.

Yahweh also will hate the Israelite people, which means that Yahweh will no longer help or protect the Israelites like Yahweh did before. Yahweh will destroy the Israelites' **cities** and their **sanctuaries** or holy places. You will remember that this word for cities means any larger settlement that people put walls around to protect it. Use the same word for city and sanctuary as you used in previous passages. For more information about sanctuary, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh will not accept the Israelites' offerings anymore. Yahweh will ruin the Israelite people's land and destroy it so completely that it will horrify the enemies who take over and move into the land. Finally, Yahweh will force the Israelite people out of their land to go live in other **nations**, and Yahweh will make the Israelites experience war as Yahweh destroys the Israelites'land and cities. For more information about nations, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for nations as you used in previous passages.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 26:27–33

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (852 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.2 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 26:34–39

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 26:34–39 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:34–39 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:34–39 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the previous few passages, Yahweh has explained what Yahweh will do to the Israelites if the Israelites do not obey Yahweh's instructions. In the previous passage, Yahweh explained what would happen to the Israelites if the Israelites continue to disobey Yahweh. Yahweh said that Yahweh will destroy the Israelites' land and cities and force the Israelites out of their land to go live in other countries. Now in this passage, Yahweh tells the Israelites what will happen to their land and to the Israelites who survive Yahweh's earlier punishments.

When Yahweh forces the Israelite people out of their land and into their enemies' lands, the land of Israel will be empty. The land will have no people to farm the land or live on the land. During that time, the land will rest and experience the years of Sabbath rest it should have had before. Remember that in Leviticus 25:4, Yahweh told Moses that every seven years, the Israelite people were supposed to let the land rest for a year instead of farming on the land. But if the Israelites do not let the land rest for the Sabbath year, Yahweh will punish the Israelites. When Yahweh finally punishes the Israelites completely, Yahweh will remove the people from the land so that the land can finally catch up on its rest.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: How long do farmers in your culture farm in the same place without taking a break? Do farmers change the fields they plant in or plant different crops in different years? If yes, why do you think farmers do that? If not, why do you think farmers do not do that? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh talks about what will happen to the Israelites who survive the destruction of their cities and land. Yahweh will send these survivors away from their land into other countries. When the Israelite survivors are in the lands of their enemies, Yahweh will make the Israelites survivors so afraid that they will run away when they hear the sound of a leaf blowing in the wind. This just means that the Israelites will be so afraid that even small and safe things like the sound of moving leaves will make the Israelites run away. The Israelites will run from these small things just like the Israelites would run from someone who chases the Israelites with a sword to kill the Israelites. Even though no one is actually chasing the Israelites, the Israelites will die anyway. In fact, the Israelites will be so afraid that the Israelites will run into each other and trip over each other, even though the Israelites are not running from anyone. All of this is probably special language that shows how afraid the Israelite people will be. The Israelites may or may not literally run when the Israelites are afraid and trip over each other. The point of this special language is that the Israelites will panic and try to get away from enemies who do not even exist. Also, the Israelites will hurt each other as the Israelites panic and try to escape death. Since the Israelites will be running even when the Israelites do not have real enemies, the Israelites definitely will not be able to defend themselves against real enemies, who will defeat the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Think of a time when you were so scared that you were afraid of things that were not even dangerous. If you cannot think of a personal story, think of a time when someone in your community was so scared that the person was afraid of things that were not even dangerous. How do you talk about someone who is very afraid like this? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh then says that the Israelite people will die in foreign countries, and the Israelites' enemies' land will eat the Israelites. Yahweh may mean that the Israelites will just die in foreign countries. On the other hand, Yahweh may mean that the Israelites will not only die in foreign countries, but people will bury the Israelites' bodies there too.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What do people in your community do with their dead people? What do people do to take care of the dead bodies, and where do people put the dead bodies? Now imagine that one of the people in your community died in a foreign country. What do you think would happen to their body? How would people in your community feel about that? Pause this audio here.

Finally, Yahweh says that the lives of the Israelites who survive all of this will become worse and worse as the Israelites live in their enemies' lands. This will make the Israelites feel like the Israelites are decaying.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:34–39 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh talks about what will happen to the land of Israel while the Israelite people are living in their enemies' lands.

In the second scene: Yahweh talks about what will happen to the Israelite people while the Israelite people are living in their enemies' lands.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- And the enemies of the Israelite people.

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

Yahweh is still talking to Moses on Mount Sinai, and Yahweh has been telling Moses what will happen to the Israelites if the Israelites disobey Yahweh and do not pay attention to Yahweh's punishments. Yahweh will force the Israelites out of their land to live as exiles in their enemies' lands. Remember that the things Yahweh describes in this passage have not happened to the Israelites yet. These are things that will happen if the Israelites disobey Yahweh.

Now, in the first scene of this passage, Yahweh tells Moses what will happen to the land of Israel if Yahweh forces the Israelites to leave. There will be no one to farm the land or live in the land, so the land will rest during that time. The Israelites should let the land rest for a year every seven years, just like Yahweh told the Israelites to do in Yahweh's instructions about the Sabbath year. But if the Israelites do not let the land rest, Yahweh will remove the Israelites from their land so the land can finally rest. In this passage, Yahweh talks about the land as if it were a person who can rest. Yahweh also says in several ways that the land will rest and experience its Sabbath while the Israelites are in their enemies' lands. Yahweh talks about the land's Sabbath in several ways to emphasize that it is important for the Israelites to obey Yahweh's instructions. The Israelites need to take care of the land by following Yahweh's instructions about the Sabbath year. Otherwise, Yahweh will have to take care of the land by punishing the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: Think of a story in your culture where a place, object, animal, or something else that is not human does something that usually only a human would do. Why do you think the storyteller talks about this thing like it is a person? Pause this audio here.

Then, in the second scene of the passage, Yahweh tells Moses about what will happen to the surviving Israelites. These are the Israelite people who are still alive after people destroy the Israelites' cities and their land. Yahweh will send these surviving Israelites away from their land to live in their enemies' lands. Yahweh will make the Israelites so afraid that the Israelites will panic because of small and unimportant things and try to get away from enemies who do not even exist. Yahweh says that the Israelites will run away like they are running away from someone attacking the Israelites with a sword. The sword represents weapons in general, and you can translate this the same way you translated it in previous passages. The Israelites will stumble over each other like people who are panicking as they run away from a dangerous thing.

The Israelites will also be so afraid that the Israelites will not be able to stand up in front of real enemies. This is special language that means that the Israelites will not be able to defend themselves against their enemies, who will defeat the Israelites. In the foreign countries that the Israelites will have to live in, the Israelite people will die in foreign countries, and people will bury the Israelites there. The Israelites who do not die yet will have worse and worse lives in their enemies' lands, so the Israelites will feel like they are decaying. This will happen because of the Israelites' iniquity. In other words, the Israelites have continued to disobey Yahweh, and now the Israelites are guilty. The Israelites' ancestors were also guilty because the ancestors disobeyed Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this as a group: How will you talk about the land in this passage? At the beginning, Yahweh talks about the Israelites' land resting. Now Yahweh talks about the enemy land devouring or eating the Israelites, which symbolizes people burying the Israelites in the enemy land. Is there a way in your language to talk about land doing human things? How else can you emphasize in your translation that Yahweh cares about the land as well as about people? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:34–39 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelite people
- And the enemies of the Israelite people.

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

Before this story, Yahweh told Moses some things that are important to this story. Before you act out this story, have the person playing Yahweh tell the person playing Moses that when the Israelite people keep refusing to obey Yahweh, even after Yahweh punishes the Israelites, then Yahweh will force the Israelites out of their land to go live in their enemies' land. Also, have the person playing Yahweh tell the person playing Moses that every seven years, the Israelites are supposed to let their land rest for one year during the Sabbath year of rest. But Yahweh describes what will happen if the Israelites do not obey. You can choose an area to represent the land of Israel, and have the people playing the Israelites act out farming and working in that land during the Sabbath year instead of letting the land rest. To represent the Israelites not obeying, you may choose an area to represent other lands. Have the person playing Yahweh tell the person playing the enemies to force the people playing the Israelites to leave the land of Israel and go to the other lands. Now, have the person playing the enemies act out how the enemies force the people playing the Israelites out of the Israelites' land.

Now, for the first scene of this passage, have the person playing Yahweh tell the person playing Moses what will happen to the land of Israel while the Israelite people are in other lands. No one will farm the land or live in the land, so the land will rest. Have the people playing the Israelites stay away from the area that represents the land of Israel so the land can rest. Pause the drama. Ask the people playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I regret not obeying Yahweh about letting the land rest; or
- I am sad that it was bad for the land for my people to live there; or
- I miss my land and want to go back.

Continue the drama. Then, for the second scene in this passage, have the person playing Yahweh tell the person playing Moses what Yahweh will do to the Israelite people. Have the people playing the Israelites act out what will happen to the Israelites. Yahweh will make the Israelites so afraid that the Israelites will panic over small things like quiet noises and run away, even though no enemies are chasing the Israelites. The Israelites will also hurt each other as they try to run away from their enemies, so have the people playing the Israelites pretend to run into each other and fall over. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am upset that I need to punish the Israelites, but I want the Israelites to turn back to me; or
- I am sad that my people are so afraid; or
- I am willing to punish my people because I know that I will bring the Israelites back into a relationship with me.

Leviticus 26:34–39

Continue the drama. The Israelites will not be able to defend themselves against their enemies, so have the person playing the enemies pretend to fight the people playing the Israelites, and have the enemies win. The Israelite people will die in foreign countries, and people will bury the Israelites there, so have one of the people playing the Israelites pretend to die, and have the other person playing the Israelites act out burying the dead person. The people who do not die yet will have worse and worse lives in their enemies' lands, so have the remaining Israelites act out being sad in the enemies' lands. All this will happen because of the Israelites' and their ancestors' guilt. Have the people playing the Israelites act out how they realize that they are guilty because the Israelites have disobeyed Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the remaining Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am upset that Yahweh is letting our enemies defeat us; or
- I am grieving for my fellow Israelites who are dying in our enemies' lands. We cannot bury these people with honor in our ancestors' graves; or
- I am sad because my life here in my enemies' land is terrible. Our enemies are cruel to us, and I miss my home.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 26:34–39 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In the last few passages, **Yahweh** has explained how Yahweh will punish the **Israelite** people if the Israelites keep disobeying Yahweh after Yahweh punishes the Israelites. For more information on Yahweh or Israelites, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and Israelite as you used in previous passages.

One of the punishments is that Yahweh will force the Israelites out of their land and into their enemies' lands. Then the land of **Israel** will be empty, and there will be no people to farm the land or live in the land. For more information on Israel, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for Israel as you used in previous passages.

During that time, the land will rest and experience the years of **Sabbath** rest it should have had before. So when Yahweh removes the people from the land, the land can finally catch up on its rest. For more information about Sabbath, refer to the Master Glossary. For more information on the Sabbath year, you may also refer to Leviticus 25:4. Use the same word or phrase for Sabbath as you used in previous passages.

Then Yahweh talks about the Israelite people who survive when Yahweh punishes the Israelites. When the Israelites are in the lands of their enemies, Yahweh will make the Israelites so afraid that the Israelites will run away from even small things as if those things were trying to kill the Israelites. Yahweh says he will do this by bringing despair to the Israelites' **hearts**, which will make the Israelites afraid. For more information on heart, refer to the Master Glossary. You may use the same word or phrase for heart as you used in previous passages. Or, if there is a more natural way to talk about Yahweh making the Israelites very afraid that does not use the word or phrase for heart, you may use that word or phrase.

The Israelites will stumble over each other like people who are running away from a **sword**. If you use the word for sword in your translation to represent war or danger, use the same word for sword as you have used in previous passages.

The Israelite people will die in foreign countries among people from non-Israelite **nations**. People will bury the Israelites there, where the Israelites' enemies live. For more information on nations, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for nations as you used in previous passages.

And lastly, for the Israelite people who survive all of this, their lives will become worse and worse as the Israelites live in their enemies' lands, so the Israelites will feel like they are decaying. This will happen because of the **iniquity** of both the Israelites and the Israelites' ancestors. For more information on iniquity, refer to the Master Glossary. Use the same word or phrase for iniquity as you used in the previous passage.

Speaking the Word
Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 26:34–39

Audio Content
- Hear and Heart (844 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (3.1 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 27:1–8

Hear and Heart
In this step, hear Leviticus 27:1–8 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:1–8 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage
Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this passage, Yahweh tells Moses to talk to the Israelites about vows. Remember that a person who makes a vow asks God to do something for that person and offers to do something in return. Sometimes people would offer to dedicate or give a person to Yahweh as part of their vow. A person may give themselves or another person in their household, such as a family member or a slave. The dedicated person would perhaps help the priests or Levites with jobs other than the ones that only priests or Levites can do.

Yahweh tells Moses how the Israelites can redeem or set free a dedicated person when the Israelites pay certain amounts of money. Then the dedicated person will no longer have to serve, while the person who made the vow still keeps the vow. It is also possible that Yahweh might mean that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to give a person to Yahweh. Instead, when someone promises to give Yahweh a person in a vow, Yahweh wants the Israelites to pay a certain amount of money instead.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, when people desperately need something, how do those people ask gods or spirits for help? When are some times when people may promise to do something in exchange for help? Pause this audio here.

Stop here again and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, would a person ever dedicate themselves to God or a god or spirit? If people do this, is there ever a way to redeem that person or end the service in an honorable way? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh then tells the Israelites what the value for each person is, based on that person's age and whether they are a male or a female. A person needs to pay 50 shekels to pay for a male who is between 20 and 60 years old. A shekel was a unit of measurement that people used as money. A shekel was often a piece of silver that weighed a certain amount. Sometimes a shekel was in the form of a coin. Scholars do not know how much a shekel was worth. People may have earned about a shekel for two weeks of work. In that case, a person would earn 50 shekels in 100 weeks, or nearly 2 years. Sometimes, people used different weights for shekels, so the priests in the temple had a specific weight the priests used for shekels. Yahweh specifies that the shekels a person needs to use to pay for any human needed to weigh as much as priests in the holy place decided a shekel should weigh.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a shekel. Pause this audio here.

A person needs to pay 30 shekels to pay for a female who is between 20 and 60 years old. Yahweh probably tells the Israelites to pay less money for women because if the Israelites buy a woman as a slave, the Israelites pay less money. Yahweh does not think women are less valuable than men.

A person needs to pay 20 shekels to pay for a male who is between 5 and 20 years old. A person needs to pay 10 shekels to pay for a female who is between 5 and 20 years old. A person needs to pay 5 shekels to pay for a male who is between 1 month and 5 years old. A person needs to pay 3 shekels to pay for a female who is between 1 month and 5 years old. A person needs to pay 15 shekels to pay for a male who is older than 60 years old. A person needs to pay 10 shekels to pay for a female who is older than 60 years old. Yahweh probably had people pay less money for people who were older or younger because if the Israelites bought someone of that age as a slave, the Israelites would pay less money. Yahweh does not think old or young people are less valuable.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what are some situations when a person would pay a worker a different amount for a job based on the worker's age or if they are male or female? Pause this audio here.

If a person who makes the vow cannot afford to pay the price for someone that they gave in a vow, then that person needs to bring the person that they gave in a vow to a priest. The priest will examine the person that someone gave in a vow and decide how much the person who made the vow needs to pay for the second person based on how much the first person can afford.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has two scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites how much money to pay for someone whom a person vowed to give to Yahweh.

In the second scene: Yahweh explains that if someone cannot afford to pay to get someone back, the priests can decide a lower price.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelites
- A person making a vow
- A man between 20 and 60 years old
- A woman between 20 and 60 years old
- A boy or a man between 5 and 20 years old
- A girl or a woman between 5 and 20 years old
- A boy between 1 month and 5 years old
- A girl between 1 month and 5 years old
- A man older than 60 years old
- A woman older than 60 years old
- A person who cannot afford to buy back someone the person vowed to give to Yahweh
- And a priest

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In previous passages, Yahweh told Moses what the Israelites need to do so that the Israelites can prosper, and what Yahweh will do to the Israelites if the Israelites do not obey Yahweh. In this passage and the next few passages, Yahweh will talk about people or things that people might give to Yahweh.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses to tell the Israelites how much money to give to Yahweh to redeem, or buy back, someone that a person vowed to give to Yahweh. The person who vowed to give someone to Yahweh will probably have to take the money to the priests at the tabernacle and give the money to the priest. Yahweh starts with people between 20 and 60 years old, because the Israelites considered that age range the most standard age range people talked about. Then Yahweh tells the Israelites what the Israelites need to pay for people who are younger than 20 who someone gave in a vow. Finally, Yahweh tells the Israelites what to pay for people who are older than 60.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do you group people by age? What is the best way for your language to order these groups of people? Pause this audio here.

A person needs to pay 50 shekels to pay for a male who is between 20 and 60 years old. A person needs to pay 30 shekels to pay for a female who is between 20 and 60 years old. A person needs to pay 20 shekels to pay for a male who is between 5 and 20 years old. A person needs to pay 10 shekels to pay for a female who is between 5 and 20 years old. A person needs to pay 5 shekels to pay for a male who is between 1 month and 5 years old. A person needs to pay 3 shekels to pay for a female who is between 1 month and 5 years old. A person needs to pay 15 shekels to pay for a male who is older than 60 years old. A person needs to pay 10 shekels to pay for a female who is older than 60 years old. Remember that a person may have earned about a shekel every two weeks for a regular job. This was a lot of money for someone to pay.

Stop here and do this activity as a group: Gather at least 50 small items or units of money. Practice this passage by giving the right amount of items for each age range and gender that Yahweh talks about. Pause this audio here.

In the second scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites what to do if the Israelites cannot afford to pay the amount of money Yahweh says to pay to buy back a person that an Israelite has vowed to dedicate to Yahweh. The Israelite who made the vow must take the person they want to give for the vow to a priest. The priest will then decide

how much the Israelite needs to pay for the person the Israelite vowed to give to Yahweh, based on what the Israelite can afford.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has two scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- Moses
- The Israelites
- A person who makes a vow
- A man between 20 and 60 years old
- A woman between 20 and 60 years old
- A boy or a man between 5 and 20 years old
- A girl or a woman between 5 and 20 years old
- A boy between 1 month and 5 years old
- A girl between 1 month and 5 years old
- A man older than 60 years old
- A woman older than 60 years old
- A person who cannot afford to buy back someone the person vowed to give to Yahweh
- And a priest

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells Moses to tell the Israelites how much money an Israelite needs to pay to buy back a person whom that Israelite gave to Yahweh in a vow. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a person who makes a vow, “What are you feeling or thinking?” The person might answer things like:

- I was so grateful to Yahweh that I vowed to give my child to Yahweh; or
- I really needed Yahweh’s help, so I vowed to give my child to Yahweh; or
- I am glad I can buy back the person I vowed to give to Yahweh; or
- It is going to be really hard to afford to pay for the person I vowed to give to Yahweh; or
- I know that I cannot really give someone to Yahweh, so I will pay this money instead.

Continue the drama. A person needs to pay 50 shekels to pay for a male who is between 20 and 60 years old. A person needs to pay 30 shekels to pay for a female who is between 20 and 60 years old. A person needs to pay 20 shekels to pay for a male who is between 5 and 20 years old. A person needs to pay 10 shekels to pay for a female who is between 5 and 20 years old. A person needs to pay 5 shekels to pay for a male who is between 1 month and 5 years old. A person needs to pay 3 shekels to pay for a female who is between 1 month and 5 years

old. A person needs to pay 15 shekels to pay for a male who is older than 60 years old. A person needs to pay 10 shekels to pay for a female who is older than 60 years old.

In the second scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites what to do if an Israelite cannot afford to pay the amount of money Yahweh tells the Israelites to pay. The person who made the vow must take the person they wanted to give for the vow to a priest. The priest will then decide how much the person needs to pay for the person they vowed to give to Yahweh. The priest decides based on what the first person can afford. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a person who cannot afford to pay for someone that they vowed to give to Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am glad I can pay for the person I vowed to give to Yahweh; or
- I am poor, so I can only pay a little bit of money; or
- Yahweh is so kind to make this easier on me.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:1–8 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, **Yahweh** talks to Moses. Yahweh is the personal name that the one true God gave to the **Israelites** to call God. Use the same words or phrases for Yahweh and Israelites as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh and Israelites, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh talks about when someone makes a **vow** to give Yahweh a person. A vow is a promise someone makes to someone, or so that the other person will do something for that person. Use the same word or phrase for vow as you used in previous passages. For more information on vow, refer to the Master Glossary.

A person has to pay using **shekels**. A shekel is a weight that people use to measure silver or gold. People used silver to pay for things, and people weighed the silver that people used to pay for things in shekels. Use the same word or phrase for shekel as you used in previous passages. For more information on shekel, refer to the Master Glossary.

The shekels need to weigh what the priests in the **holy place**, or sanctuary, say the shekels should weigh. The holy place was the place where people went when people wanted to make a sacrifice to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for holy place as you used in previous passages. For more information on holy place, refer to the Master Glossary.

If someone who vows to give a person to Yahweh cannot afford to buy the person back, the first person can take the person that he vowed to give to Yahweh to a **priest**. Priests were responsible for offering sacrifices to Yahweh on behalf of the people, and the priests also taught the people how to worship Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 27:1–8

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (842 KB)
- Setting the Stage (2.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (2.7 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.7 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (1.4 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 27:9–15

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 27:9–15 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:9–15 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:9–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In the last passage, Yahweh told the Israelites what to do when the Israelites vowed to give Yahweh a person. In this passage, Yahweh tells the Israelites what to do when the Israelites vow to give an animal or a house to Yahweh.

First, Yahweh talks about an animal that Yahweh will allow the Israelites to sacrifice to Yahweh. Yahweh allows the Israelites to sacrifice cattle, goats, sheep, and doves to Yahweh. Yahweh says that when the Israelites vow to give the animal, the animal becomes holy. Yahweh will not allow any of the Israelites to give Yahweh another animal instead of the one the Israelite vowed to give. The Israelites cannot exchange another animal of the same kind as they promised or another animal of a different kind. The Israelites cannot give an animal that is better or worse than the animal the Israelites promised to give. When Yahweh talks about an animal being worse or better, Yahweh is probably talking about how healthy or big the animal is. Bigger and healthier animals are more valuable than smaller and less healthy animals.

Leviticus 27:9–15

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what makes one animal more valuable than another animal? Pause this audio here.

If an Israelite gives Yahweh a different animal instead of the animal the Israelite vowed to give to Yahweh, then the different animal the Israelite gives to Yahweh becomes holy, or dedicated to Yahweh. But the animal that the Israelite first promised to give is also holy. So the Israelite will still need to give the original animal that the Israelite promised to give, even though the Israelite gave a substitute.

If an Israelite makes a vow to give an animal to Yahweh that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to sacrifice to Yahweh, then the Israelite will take the animal to a priest. The priest will look at the animal and decide how much money the animal is worth. Yahweh probably says that whatever the priest decides the value of the animal is, even if the animal is worth a lot or not worth very much, that will be the value of the animal. Yahweh will not allow the Israelite to try to get another priest or someone else to decide how valuable the animal is, even if the Israelite does not like what the priest decides. Yahweh also might mean that the priest will consider both the good qualities and the bad qualities of the animal, and that whatever the priest decides will be the animal's value. If the Israelite wants to buy the animal back from Yahweh, the Israelite needs to pay the animal's value and pay an additional 20 percent, or one-fifth, of the animal's value. Then the Israelite will own the animal again.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people dedicate animals to gods or to a specific purpose? Why do people dedicate these animals? What kinds of animals do people give? How or when can people redeem, or buy back, the animal? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh says that if someone consecrates a house, or makes a house holy by dedicating it to Yahweh, a priest will look at the house and decide how much the house is worth. When someone dedicates a house to Yahweh, the house becomes the property of the priests. Yahweh is probably talking about houses that people own inside large towns or cities. In the next passage, Yahweh will talk about houses that are part of the land that Israelites will receive when Yahweh divides up the land that Yahweh is promising to give the Israelites. The priests might sell the house for money, or a priest might start living in the house.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of an ancient Israelite house in Jerusalem. Pause this audio here.

Yahweh probably says that whatever the priest decides the value of the house is, even if the house is worth a lot or not worth very much, that will be the house's value. Yahweh will not allow the Israelite to try to get another priest or someone else to decide how valuable the house is, even if the Israelite does not like what the priest decides. Yahweh also might mean that the priest will consider both the good qualities and the bad qualities of the house, and that whatever the priest decides will be the value of the house.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, when someone gives away a house, how do people decide how valuable the house is? Pause this audio here.

If the Israelite wants to buy the house back from Yahweh, the Israelite needs to pay the value of the house and pay an additional 20 percent, or one-fifth, of the house's value. Then the Israelite will own the house again.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people dedicate houses to gods or to a specific purpose? Why do people dedicate these houses? What kinds of houses do people give? How or when can people redeem, or buy back, the house?

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:9–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh talks about what to do when an Israelite vows to give Yahweh an animal that Yahweh accepts as an offering.

In the second scene: Yahweh talks about what to do when an Israelite vows to give Yahweh an animal that Yahweh does not accept as an offering.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites what to do with a house that an Israelite vows to give to Yahweh.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Yahweh
- The Israelites
- And a priest

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the previous passage, Yahweh told the Israelites what to do when an Israelite vowed to give a person to Yahweh. In this passage, Yahweh tells the Israelites what to do when an Israelite vows to give an animal or a house to Yahweh. As Yahweh continues to describe people giving an animal as a vow, Yahweh does not use the word for "vow." Moses and the Israelites know what Yahweh is talking about. However, you may need to continue to make it clear that Yahweh is talking about vows in this section. You will remember that Yahweh is talking about vows that the Israelites or people who live with the Israelites give because the people want to; Yahweh is not talking about required offerings or anything else that Yahweh requires the Israelites to do.

In the first scene, Yahweh talks about what to do when an Israelite vows to give an animal to Yahweh. First, Yahweh talks about animals that Yahweh accepts as offerings. Yahweh says that when someone vows to give Yahweh one of these animals, the animal becomes holy, or dedicated to Yahweh. Yahweh will not allow any of the Israelites to give an animal that is different from the animal that the Israelite promised to give to Yahweh. The Israelite cannot exchange the animal for a better or a worse animal. The animal that an Israelite vows to give is holy. If an Israelite tries to give a different animal, that second animal becomes holy too. That means the Israelite still needs to give Yahweh the first animal that the Israelite vowed to give to Yahweh, and the Israelite cannot take back the second animal the Israelite gave to Yahweh instead.

In the second scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites what to do when an Israelite vows to give Yahweh an animal that is unclean or ritually dirty. This is an animal that an Israelite cannot offer to Yahweh as a sacrifice in worship. Sometimes, when Yahweh talks about an animal that is ritually dirty, Yahweh means an animal that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to eat. Here, Yahweh is probably talking about all animals that Yahweh will not allow an Israelite to sacrifice to Yahweh, even if an Israelite can eat the animal.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to explain that this is a ritually dirty animal that people cannot sacrifice to Yahweh? Pause this audio here.

The person who vowed to give Yahweh a ritually dirty animal must bring the animal to a priest. The priest will look at the animal and decide how much the animal is worth. Yahweh probably means that whatever the priest decides the animal's value is, even if the animal is worth a lot or not worth very much, that will be the animal's value. Yahweh will not allow the Israelite to try to get another priest or someone else to decide how valuable the animal is, even if the Israelite does not like what the priest decides. Yahweh also might mean that the priest will consider both the good qualities and the bad qualities of the animal, and that whatever the priest decides will be the animal's value.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate that, whether good or bad, what the priest decides the animal is worth is what the animal is worth? Pause this audio here.

If the Israelite wants to buy back the ritually dirty animal that the Israelite vowed to give to Yahweh, the Israelite needs to pay the value of the animal and an additional one-fifth, or 20 percent, of the animal's value. The Israelite will give that money to a priest. In previous parts of Leviticus, Yahweh told the Israelites to pay for any holy things the Israelites took accidentally by paying those things' value and an additional one-fifth, or 20 percent of the value. In this situation, Yahweh expects the Israelites to redeem, or pay for, animals the Israelites vowed to give to Yahweh in a similar way.

In the third scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites what to do if the Israelites vow to give a house to Yahweh. Yahweh calls this making the house holy, or dedicating the house to Yahweh. The house would probably be a house in a

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large town or city, not a house in a field. Whatever the priest decides the house is worth will be what the house is worth. Yahweh probably means that whatever the priest decides the value of the house is, even if the house is worth a lot or not worth very much, that will be the value of the house. Yahweh will not allow the Israelite to try to get another priest or someone else to decide how valuable the house is, even if the Israelite does not like what the priest decides. Yahweh also might mean that the priest will consider both the good qualities and the bad qualities of the house, and that whatever the priest decides will be the value of the house.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate that, whether good or bad, what the priest decides the house is worth is what the house is worth? Pause this audio here.

If the person who dedicated the house to Yahweh wants to buy the house back, that person needs to pay the value of the house and an additional one-fifth, or 20 percent, of the house's value. That person will give that money to a priest. Then the person will own the house again.

Stop here and remember together how you translated the idea of adding an additional 20 percent to the value of something in Leviticus 5:16. Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:9–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- Yahweh
- The Israelites
- And a priest

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites that if a person vows to give Yahweh an animal that Yahweh accepts as a sacrifice, the animal will become holy, or dedicated to Yahweh. The person cannot give another animal instead of the animal that the person vowed to give to Yahweh. The Israelite cannot give an animal that is the same, different, better, or worse than the animal the Israelite vowed to give to Yahweh. If the Israelite gives Yahweh another animal instead of the animal the Israelite vowed to give to Yahweh, the animal the Israelite gives to Yahweh and the animal the Israelite vowed to give to Yahweh will both be holy, or dedicated to Yahweh. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing the Israelites, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I am frustrated because I tried not to give Yahweh the animal that I promised I would, and now I have to give two animals to Yahweh; or

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- Yahweh is very serious about us doing what we vowed to do, so I should think very carefully before I make a vow!

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites that if the Israelites vow to give a ritually dirty animal, then the Israelites need to bring the animal to a priest. The priest will look at the animal and decide how much the animal is worth. Good or bad, whatever the priest decides the animal is worth is what the animal will be worth. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing a priest, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I need to do a good job figuring out how much this animal is worth; or
- Yahweh trusts me to figure out how much this animal is worth.

Continue the drama. If the Israelite wants to buy the animal back from Yahweh, the Israelite needs to pay the value of the animal and pay an additional one-fifth, or 20 percent, of the animal's value.

In the third scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites that if an Israelite consecrates a house to Yahweh, a priest will look at the house and figure out how much the house is worth. Good or bad, whatever the priest decides the house is worth is what the house will be worth. If the Israelite who dedicated the house to Yahweh wants to buy the house back from Yahweh, the Israelite needs to pay the value of the house and pay an additional one-fifth, or 20 percent, of the value of the house. Then the Israelite will own the house again. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I love it when people dedicate things because of how grateful those people are and how much they trust me; or
- I am very serious about when people vow to give me things; or
- I want people to realize how important I am, so I want the people to take vows seriously.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:9–15 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh tells the Israelites what to do when the Israelites **vow** to give animals and houses to Yahweh. When a person makes a vow, that person promises to do something for Yahweh. Yahweh does not use the word vow because Yahweh expects the Israelites to know that Yahweh is still talking about vows like Yahweh was in the last passage. Many translations of this passage do use the word vow here. If the addition of the word vow would be useful for clarity in your translation, use it. Use the same word or phrase for vow as you used in previous passages. For more information on vow, refer to the Master Glossary.

People can give Yahweh animals that Yahweh will allow the people to offer. When a person offers something, that person gives it to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for **offering** as you used in previous passages. For more information on offering, refer to the Master Glossary.

The Israelites give the animals to **Yahweh**. Yahweh is the personal name that the one true God gave the Israelites to call God. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

The animal that the person vowed to give to Yahweh becomes **holy**. Any place, person, or object that is dedicated to God is holy. That means that the object or person is set apart for God's special purposes. That object or thing is no longer "common" or "ordinary." People can no longer use that holy thing for common or ordinary purposes. Use the same word or phrase for holy as you used in previous passages. For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary.

If a person vows to give something to Yahweh, a **priest** looks at that thing. Priests were responsible for offering sacrifices to Yahweh on behalf of the people. The priests also took care of the tabernacle and taught people how to worship Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh also talks about when an Israelite sacrifices an animal that is **unclean** or **ritually dirty**. If Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to eat an animal, that animal is ritually dirty. Sometimes, if Yahweh will not accept an

animal as an offering, people call that animal ritually dirty. For more information on **clean and unclean**, refer to the Master Glossary.

An Israelite might want to **redeem**, or pay for, an animal that is ritually dirty. When someone redeems a person, animal, or thing, the person pays money to the person who owns that person, animal, or thing so that the second person will give up the person, animal, or thing. Use the same word or phrase for redeem as you used in previous passages. For more information on redeem, refer to the Master Glossary.

A person can also **consecrate** a house. If a person consecrates something, the thing becomes holy. Use the same word or phrase for consecrate as you used in previous passages. For more information on consecrate, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 27:9–15

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (843 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.2 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (2.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (2.2 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 27:16–25

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 27:16–25 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:16–25 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

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Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.
6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:16–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

Yahweh has been telling the Israelites what to do when the Israelites vow to give things to Yahweh. Yahweh also calls this consecrating, or making something holy.

In this passage, Yahweh talks about what the Israelites need to do when the Israelites consecrate land that the Israelites inherited. This would be land that is supposed to stay with the same family forever, as people gave it to their children or closest relatives. When a person consecrated this land, the person probably continued to work the land, and the person gave the grain that the land produced to the priests.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people decide who owns what land? Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people inherit or receive land from their relatives who die? How important is the land? How important is it to keep the land in the family? Pause this audio here.

If an Israelite consecrates any of the land the Israelite inherited, a priest needs to decide how valuable the land is. Yahweh says that the priest will decide the value of the land based on the opening of its seed. Yahweh probably means that the priest needs to determine how valuable the land is based on how much seed someone needs to use to sow the whole field. Yahweh might also mean that the priest needs to determine how valuable the land is based on how much seed the land produces. To the Israelites, land was primarily valuable based on how many crops a person could grow on it.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what do people mostly use land for? Pause this audio here.

Also, stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people decide how valuable a specific section of land is? Pause this audio here.

The land will be worth 50 shekels of silver for every homer of barley seed that a person can sow on the land at a time. A shekel was a weight that the Israelites used. The Israelites mostly used the weight to measure silver. Since people used silver as money, people based how valuable something was on how many shekels of silver people would pay for that thing. A shekel weighed around 11.4 grams, so 50 shekels was about 575 grams of silver.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a shekel of silver. Pause this audio here.

A homer is a measurement of how much space something took up, and Israelites used it to measure grain. Scholars disagree on how much grain a homer measured. A homer was the amount that a donkey could carry. Some scholars think that a homer of barley weighed 220 kilograms, while others think that a homer weighed 400 kilograms. If a homer weighed 300 kilograms, then the value of the field was about 1 gram of silver for every 52 grams of barley seed that a person needed to use to sow the field. This was probably a reasonable price for a field, though it might be a low price for a field. Barley seed was the cheapest crop that a person could grow in Israel, and both people and animals ate this crop.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of barley seed. Pause this audio here.

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If an Israelite consecrates the field on the Year of Jubilee, then the value of the field will be 50 shekels for every homer of barley, as Yahweh said earlier. But if the person consecrates the field after the Year of Jubilee, then the priests will decide how much less the field is worth based on the number of years until the next Year of Jubilee, and the priest will reduce the value of the field by that much. You will remember that in the Year of Jubilee, any land that an Israelite sold to someone else or consecrated to Yahweh returns back to the people or the families that sold the land, so the value goes down because the field will produce fewer crops before the land returns to its original owner. Since the price of the field was 50 shekels per homer of barley seed and there are 50 years between each Year of Jubilee, the priest probably reduced the value of the field by 1 shekel per homer of barley seed for each year after the Year of Jubilee.

If the person who consecrated the field wants to redeem the field, or buy the field back, then that person needs to pay the value of the field and an additional one-fifth, or 20 percent of the value of the field. Then the person will own the field again. If the person does not buy back the field before the Year of Jubilee, then that person will not ever be able to buy back the field after the Year of Jubilee. That person will also not be able to buy back the field if that person sells the field to someone else. Because a person probably still worked the land that they dedicated to the priests, the person might sell the land to someone else so that another person would work the land. When the Year of Jubilee happens, Yahweh will totally dedicate the field to himself, and the field will belong to the priests. No normal Israelite will ever be able to use the land again.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, what things do people completely devote to a god or spirit or person? How do people treat those things that people devoted? Pause this audio here.

Sometimes people bought land that their family did not own before. If someone consecrates a field to Yahweh that the person bought, then a priest will figure out how much the field is worth based on how many years remain until the Year of Jubilee. The person who dedicates the field will have to pay how much the field is worth on the day that the priest decides how much the field is worth. The money that the person pays will be holy money devoted to Yahweh. Then, when the Year of Jubilee happens, the person who originally owned the field and sold it to the person who dedicated it to Yahweh will own the field again, since it is their property.

Then, Yahweh gives the standard of payment, or the standard value of the shekel. Yahweh gives this important information to explain how much money people need to pay for things that people have dedicated to Yahweh. Yahweh says that whenever a priest determines the value of something, the priests will measure the value in shekels that weighed as much as the priests in the holy place decided a shekel should weigh. Yahweh also says that a shekel will weigh the same amount as 20 gerahs. A gerah was another measurement of weight. The only thing we know about a gerah is that it weighed one-twentieth, or 5 percent, of a shekel's weight, which means it probably weighed a little more than half a gram.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:16–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has three scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites what to do when the Israelites dedicate land they inherited to Yahweh.

In the second scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites what to do when the Israelites dedicate land they bought to Yahweh.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites how to measure the value of things they dedicate to Yahweh.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- A landowner who consecrates inherited land to Yahweh and redeems that land
- A landowner who consecrates inherited land to Yahweh but does not redeem that land

- Yahweh
- A priest
- A landowner who sells land that the landowner had already consecrated to Yahweh
- A person who buys land that the landowner had already consecrated to Yahweh
- A person who buys land and then consecrates that land
- And the original owner of the land that someone bought and then consecrated

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In previous passages, Yahweh has told the Israelites what to do when the Israelites vow to give a person or an animal to Yahweh, and what to do when the Israelites consecrate a house to Yahweh. In this passage, Yahweh tells the Israelites what to do when the Israelites consecrate land to Yahweh, whether the Israelites bought that land or inherited that land. Remember that the Israelites are at a place called Mount Sinai in a wilderness area without any cities or villages nearby. Yahweh has promised to give the Israelites the land of Canaan, and when Yahweh does give the Israelites the land of Canaan, Yahweh will give each family a specific part of the land that will belong to that family forever. The children in each new generation will inherit the land. Even if a person who inherits land sells that land to someone else, that person will only have control of the land until the Year of Jubilee. Inherited land is any land that a person owns because Yahweh has given that land to their family.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate the idea of land that people inherit? Pause this audio here.

When a person dedicates, or consecrates, a field they inherited to Yahweh, the person probably continues to grow crops on the field, and the person just gives the crops they grow to Yahweh by giving the crops to the priests. When a person consecrates land that they inherited to Yahweh, or dedicates that land to Yahweh, a priest will look at the land and determine how valuable it is. The priest will decide the value of the land based on the opening of its seed. Yahweh probably means that the priest needs to determine how valuable the land is based on how much seed the owner needs to use to sow the whole field at one time. Yahweh might also mean that the priest needs to determine how valuable the land is based on how much seed the land produces.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way for you to translate that the value of the land is based on the opening of its seed? Pause this audio here.

The land will be worth 50 shekels of silver for every homer of barley seed. This is probably a very low cost for the land, because Yahweh wants the Israelites to be able to redeem, or buy back, the land. Because Yahweh decides that the land will go back to the families Yahweh gave the land to every Year of Jubilee, Yahweh bases the value of the land on how much a person can grow on the land before the Year of Jubilee. So if the person dedicates the land to Yahweh on the Year of Jubilee, then the field will be the full price Yahweh just said: 50 shekels of silver for every homer of barley seed that a person needs to use to sow the field at one time. But if the person dedicates the land to Yahweh after the Year of Jubilee, then the priest needs to lower the value of the land based on how many years are left until the next Year of Jubilee, and the value of the land will be reduced by what the priest decides. The priest will probably reduce the price by 1 shekel per homer of barley that a person needs to use to sow the field at one time. If the person who dedicated the land wants to redeem the land, or buy it back from Yahweh, that person needs to pay the priests the value of the land and an additional one-fifth, or 20 percent, of the value of the land. Then the person who dedicated the land to Yahweh will own the land again.

Stop here and remind each other as a group how you will translate an additional one-fifth, or 20 percent, of the value of something. Pause this audio here.

But if the person does not buy back the land before the next Year of Jubilee, then that person and their family will not be able to buy back the land ever again. If the person sells the land that they dedicated to Yahweh to someone else, then the person and their family will not be able to buy back the land ever again. Instead, when the Year of Jubilee happens, the field will become completely devoted to Yahweh, and no person except the priests will be able to own it again. When Yahweh completely devotes the field to himself, the situation is similar to when a field is holy. But when Yahweh completely devotes something to himself, Yahweh expects most people to never use the thing again in any way. In most situations where Yahweh completely devotes something to himself, Yahweh makes the Israelites destroy the thing Yahweh has completely devoted to himself. In this case, when Yahweh completely devotes a field to himself, the priests will own that field forever.

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In the second scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites that if someone dedicates a field that they bought to Yahweh, then a priest will decide how much the field is worth. The priest will decide how many years are left before the Year of Jubilee happens, and will use that to determine the field's value. Then the person who dedicated the field to Yahweh will pay the value of the field on the same day that the priest decides how valuable the field is. The money the person pays will be holy to Yahweh. A person who buys and then dedicates a piece of land to Yahweh may not want to redeem the land as quickly as the person who inherits land and then dedicates it to Yahweh. A person who inherits land must redeem the land, or else that person risks losing the land forever. A person who buys land will lose that land anyway at the Year of Jubilee, so that person may not feel that they need to hurry to redeem the land. So Yahweh tells that person to pay to redeem the field the same day the person dedicates it.

When the Year of Jubilee does happen, the field that the person bought and then dedicated to Yahweh will become the property of the original owner or the original owner's family, because it is the land Yahweh gave the original owner's family.

In the third scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites that every time the Israelites determine the value of something that the Israelites are going to dedicate to Yahweh, the Israelites need to measure that thing in shekels that weigh as much as the priests in the sanctuary say the shekels should weigh. Yahweh also says that 20 gerahs weigh as much as a shekel. The Bible only mentions a gerah when it says that a shekel is 20 gerahs. Since a shekel is a relatively small amount, a gerah is probably the smallest measurement of weight that the Israelites used.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate "gerah"? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:16–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has three scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Moses
- A landowner who consecrates inherited land to Yahweh and redeems that land
- A landowner who consecrates inherited land to Yahweh but does not redeem that land
- Yahweh
- A priest
- A landowner who sells land that the landowner had already consecrated to Yahweh
- A person who buys land that the landowner had already consecrated to Yahweh
- A person who buys land and then consecrates that land
- And the original owner of the land that someone bought and then consecrated

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

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In the first scene, Yahweh gives the Israelites an example situation. In this example situation, an Israelite consecrates, or makes holy, the land the Israelite inherited to Yahweh. When the Israelite consecrates the land they inherited, a priest will decide how valuable the land is. The priest will decide the value of the field based on how many barley seeds you need to use to sow it at one time. A field is worth 50 shekels of silver for every homer of barley seed a person needs to use to sow the field at one time. If an Israelite consecrates a field on the Year of Jubilee, then the field will be worth what Yahweh just said it was worth. But if the Israelite consecrates the field after the Year of Jubilee, then the priest will decide what the price will be. The priest will decide the value of the field based on the number of years that remain until the Year of Jubilee, and the priest will reduce the price by the appropriate amount. If the Israelite wants to redeem the field, then the Israelite needs to pay for the value of the field they consecrated and an additional one-fifth, or 20 percent, of the value of the field. Then the Israelite will own the field again.

If the person does not redeem the field or the person sells it to someone else, then no one will be able to redeem the field. On the Year of Jubilee, the field will become completely devoted to Yahweh, and only the priests will ever be able to own that field. Pause the drama. Ask the landowner who consecrates inherited land to Yahweh but does not redeem it, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I really appreciate how Yahweh takes care of me, so I dedicated a field to Yahweh; or
- I really wanted more money after I dedicated my land to Yahweh, so I sold the land to someone else. Now I will never get my land back; or
- I forgot to redeem my land, and now I will never own that land again; or
- I am so upset because my family will never own this land again; or
- The land was very cheap to buy back, but I did not do it; or
- Yahweh really cares that people are responsible with the things that people dedicate to Yahweh.

Continue the drama. In the second scene, Yahweh gives another situation. In this situation, an Israelite dedicates a field that they bought to Yahweh, a field that the Israelite did not inherit. In this situation, a priest will figure out how valuable the field is. The priest will figure out the value of the field based on how many years until the Year of Jubilee happens. The person who dedicates the field to Yahweh will have to pay the value of the field on the day that the priest decides the value of the field. The money the person pays for the field will be holy to Yahweh. On the Year of Jubilee, the person who originally owned the field will own the field again. This person, who originally owned the field, owned the field before the other Israelite bought the field and then dedicated the field to Yahweh. The original owner will own the field again because it is the land Yahweh gave the original owner. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I really want families to continue to be able to use the land that I will give them; or
- I love it when people dedicate things to me to show how much the people love and trust me; or
- I want people to be able to dedicate their fields to me without worrying about losing their fields forever.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh talks about when people determine the value of something that people give to Yahweh. Yahweh requires people to measure the value of something that people give to Yahweh in shekels. These shekels need to weigh what the priests in the sanctuary decide a shekel should weigh. One shekel is worth twenty gerahs.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:16–25 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh talks about when people **consecrate** something to Yahweh. When someone consecrates something, that person dedicates that thing, or makes that thing holy, to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for consecrate as you used in previous passages. For more information on consecrate, refer to the Master Glossary.

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The Israelites consecrate things to **Yahweh**. Yahweh is the personal name that the one true God gave to the Israelites to call God. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh says that a field will be worth 50 **shekels** of silver for every homer of barley that a person can plant in it at one time. A shekel is a unit of measurement that equals 11.4 grams. People used shekels as money. Use the same word or phrase for shekel as you used in previous passages. For more information on shekel, refer to the Master Glossary.

Stop here as a group and look at a picture of a shekel again. Pause this audio here.

A homer was a unit of volume, or how much space something was, that equaled what a donkey could carry. A homer might have been about 150 liters. A homer of barley might have weighed around 300 kilograms, but scholars have a lot of different ideas about how big a homer of barley is.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **homer**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

Barley is a plant that the Israelites grew. Barley produces seeds. The Israelites would sometimes eat the seeds. The Israelites would mostly grind the seeds into a powder and mix the powder with water and oil, or just water, or just oil. The mixture would become a dough, and the Israelites cooked that dough over a fire to make bread. Then the Israelites ate the bread. Barley fields produced more seeds than other plants. But when people made bread from barley, the bread was worse than when people made bread from other plants.

Stop here and look again at the photo of barley seeds. Discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **barley**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

A **priest** decides how much a field is worth. The priests were the people who taught the Israelites how to worship Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for priest as you used in previous passages. For more information on priest, refer to the Master Glossary.

The priest will decide the value of the field based on how many years until the **Year of Jubilee**. Every 50 years, Yahweh expected the Israelites to have a year-long holiday. During this holiday, any inherited land that someone had sold becomes their land again. Use the same word or phrase for Year of Jubilee as you used in previous passages. For more information on Year of Jubilee, refer to the Master Glossary.

A person who consecrates a field can **redeem** that field, or buy the field back from Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for redeem as you used in previous passages. For more information on redeem, refer to the Master Glossary.

The money, or shekels, a person uses to pay for a field that they dedicated to Yahweh is **holy**. Any place, person, or object that is dedicated to God is holy. That means that the object or person is set apart for God's special purposes. That person or object is no longer "common" or "ordinary," and people can no longer use them for common or ordinary purposes. Use the same word or phrase for holy as you used in previous passages. For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary.

If a person sells a field that they dedicated to Yahweh, then Yahweh will completely devote the field to himself. When Yahweh completely devotes something to himself, Yahweh does not allow any common person to use it. If Yahweh completely devotes a person, animal, or object to himself, Yahweh makes the Israelites kill the person or animal or destroy the object. If Yahweh completely devotes a field to himself, the priests use that field.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **completely devoted**. If you have already translated this idea in another book of the Bible, use the same word or phrase that you have used there. Pause this audio here.

The shekels need to weigh as much as the priests in the **sanctuary** decide the shekels should weigh. The sanctuary was the holy place that the people went to when the people wanted to make sacrifices to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for sanctuary as you used in previous passages. For more information on sanctuary, refer to the Master Glossary.

A shekel is as much as 20 gerahs. A gerah was a unit of weight, and it probably weighed about half a gram.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **gerah**. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, use the same word that you have used there.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 27:16–25

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (847 KB)
- Setting the Stage (4.3 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (5.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.6 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.6 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)

Leviticus 27:26–34

Hear and Heart

In this step, hear Leviticus 27:26–34 and put it in your hearts.

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:26–34 three times, in three different translations, if possible.

Pause this audio here.

Now, as a group, discuss the following questions:

1. What do you like in this passage? Pause this audio here.
2. What do you not like or not understand in this passage? Pause this audio here.
3. What does this passage tell us about God? Pause this audio here.
4. What does this passage tell us about people? Pause this audio here.
5. How does this passage affect our daily lives? Pause this audio here.

6. Who do you know who needs to hear this passage?

Setting the Stage

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:26–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In previous passages, Yahweh has been talking about things that people vowed to give to Yahweh. In this passage, Yahweh talks about things that already belong to Yahweh.

First, Yahweh says that the first time an animal gives birth, an Israelite cannot dedicate that baby animal to Yahweh, because that baby animal already belongs to Yahweh. Yahweh had said earlier that the first time any animal gives birth, that animal's baby belongs to Yahweh. Whether the baby animal is an ox, a goat, or a sheep, that baby animal already belongs to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people treat the firstborn animal? Pause this audio here.

If the animal is an unclean or ritually dirty animal, then Yahweh will allow the person who owns the animal to buy it back from Yahweh. When Yahweh says the animal is ritually dirty, Yahweh probably means it is an animal that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to sacrifice, not just an animal the Israelites must not eat. Again, the priests determine how much the animal is worth. If a person wants to redeem the animal, that person needs to pay that amount as well as an additional one-fifth, or 20 percent, of that amount. If the person does not redeem the animal, then the priests will sell the animal for the original amount.

Then Yahweh says that if a person owns something and that person completely devotes that thing to Yahweh, then the person cannot sell the thing and the person cannot buy the thing back. If a person completely devotes a human, animal, or inherited land to Yahweh, then no one can take it back. Anything that a person completely devotes to Yahweh becomes one of the most holy or most dedicated things to Yahweh. However, if any human being becomes completely devoted to destruction, no one can buy that person or save that person; the Israelites need to execute that person. Sometimes Yahweh completely devotes a person to himself, because that person has murdered someone or is a prisoner of war. For example, Yahweh later completely devotes the city of Jericho to himself after the Israelites start to conquer the land that Yahweh is giving to the Israelites. Yahweh tells the Israelites to kill every person and animal in Jericho and destroy every object.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people completely devote things to a god or some special purpose? What sorts of things do people completely devote? Pause this audio here.

Then Yahweh says that all the tithes from what the land produces are holy to Yahweh. When the Israelites produced food, Yahweh expected the Israelites to give one tenth, or 10 percent, of the food to Yahweh, which Yahweh called a tithe. This reminds the Israelites that Yahweh owns everything in the land that Yahweh gave to the Israelites. The Israelites give one-tenth of their grain or fruit to the priests and the Levites, or the Israelites give it to poor people and widows and orphans and foreigners. All the tithe from the crops that grow up from the ground and all the fruit that the trees produce are holy to Yahweh. If anyone wants to buy their tithes back from Yahweh, then that person needs to pay the value of the tithe and an additional one-fifth, or 20 percent, of the value of the tithe.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people give to support priests or poor people? What sorts of things do people give? Pause this audio here.

When someone tithes a herd of cattle or a flock of sheep or a flock of goats, the animals the person tithes are holy to Yahweh. Yahweh says that the Israelites must give to Yahweh every tenth animal that passes under the shepherd's staff. People who owned herds or flocks would probably count their animals with their shepherd's staff. A shepherd's staff is a long stick that the shepherds would use to help themselves walk and to fight wild animals. The shepherd would probably hold their staff over the animals as they walked and count each one as the animals passed under the staff. Yahweh tells the Israelites to set aside every tenth animal when the Israelites count the animals like this, so that the Israelites can tithe these animals to Yahweh.

Stop here as a group and look at the picture of a shepherd's staff. Pause this audio here.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: In your culture, how do people count the animals that those people own? How do people direct or herd their animals? Are there any tools that people use that are similar to a staff? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh required the person who owns the herd or the flock to give Yahweh every tenth animal that the person counted when the person counted their animals, so the person could tithe the animals. You will remember that cattle were the animals in a herd, and sheep and goats were the animals in a flock. Yahweh did not expect the person who owned the herd or flock to give Yahweh every tenth animal every time the person counted their animals. Yahweh only expected the person who owned the herd or flock to give Yahweh every tenth animal that they counted occasionally. People do not know how often the Israelites counted their animals. The Israelites may not choose which animals, whether the best or the worst animals, from the flock. Yahweh also will not allow the Israelites to give Yahweh another animal instead of the animal the Israelites were supposed to tithe. If someone gives Yahweh another animal instead of the animal the person was supposed to give Yahweh, then both of the animals will be holy, or dedicated to Yahweh. Yahweh will not allow the person to buy back either of the animals from Yahweh.

Finally, the storyteller of Leviticus says that these are all the commandments that Yahweh gave Moses on Mount Sinai for the Israelites.

Defining the Scenes

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:26–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will define the scenes, characters, and setting of this passage. Then the group will visualize this passage.

This passage has four scenes.

In the first scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites that the Israelites cannot consecrate, or dedicate, a firstborn animal to Yahweh.

In the second scene: Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to redeem anything that is completely devoted to Yahweh.

In the third scene: Yahweh tells the Israelites about both crop and animal tithes and how to redeem their crop tithes.

In the fourth scene: The storyteller sums up both this passage and the book of Leviticus.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- A person completely devoted to Yahweh
- Moses
- And the Israelites

As a group, pay attention to these parts of the passage's setting:

In the previous scenes, Yahweh has told the Israelites what to do when the Israelites vow to give Yahweh something, such as a person, an animal, or a house. Yahweh also calls this "consecrating" the thing, or making it holy to Yahweh. In this passage, Yahweh talks about some of the things that already belong to Yahweh.

In the first scene, Yahweh explains that the firstborn animals already belong to Yahweh, so the Israelites cannot choose those animals to dedicate to Yahweh. When an animal that an Israelite owns gives birth to her first baby, the Israelite must give the baby to Yahweh. All the firstborn cattle, sheep, and goats belong to Yahweh. If the animal is ritually dirty, then the Israelites can buy it back. When Yahweh says the animal is ritually dirty, Yahweh probably means that Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to sacrifice the animal, not that it is one of the animals that the Israelites cannot eat. Again, the priests determine the value of the animal or how much the animal is worth. If a person wants to redeem the animal, that person needs to pay that amount as well as an additional

one-fifth, or 20 percent, of that amount. If the person does not redeem the animal, then the priests will sell the animal for the original amount.

In the second scene, Yahweh will not allow a person to sell or redeem anything that the person has completely devoted to Yahweh. No one can sell or redeem any human or animal or inherited property that someone has completely devoted to Yahweh. The things that a person completely devotes to Yahweh become the things that are most holy, most special to Yahweh. Most of the time, when something gets completely devoted to Yahweh, Yahweh tells the Israelites to destroy it in some way. Yahweh does not require the Israelites to destroy inherited land; instead, the priests own any land that is completely devoted to Yahweh, and no one else may use that land. If a person becomes completely devoted to Yahweh, then Yahweh will require the Israelites to kill that person. Some translations call this “devoted to destruction.”

In the third scene, Yahweh tells the Israelites how to redeem the crops that they tithe to Yahweh. When people tithe something to Yahweh, the people give one-tenth of that thing. So if a person has 100 sheep, the person will give 10 of the sheep to Yahweh. Yahweh has already told the Israelites to tithe to Yahweh earlier, in the book of Exodus. First, Yahweh tells the Israelites that everything the Israelites tithe, one-tenth of all the crops and all the fruit that the Israelites will produce in the land that Yahweh will give to them, is holy to Yahweh. When Yahweh talks about the crops and the fruit from the trees, Yahweh is using special language to talk about every plant that the Israelites grow. Crops and fruit trees were the most common plants the Israelites grew, so when Yahweh talked about these things, the Israelites would know Yahweh was talking about all the plants the Israelites grew in the land.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to translate when Yahweh says that the Israelites will tithe from the crops and the fruit of the trees? Pause this audio here.

If anyone wants to redeem the tithe of their crops, the person needs to buy the crops back from Yahweh by paying the value of the crops and an additional 20 percent, or one-fifth, of the value of the crops.

Then, Yahweh tells the Israelites that all the tithes from their herds and flocks will be holy to Yahweh. In other words, the Israelites cannot redeem the animals that the Israelites tithe to Yahweh. Yahweh says also that the tithes are every tenth animal that passes under the shepherd’s staff. When the Israelites counted their animals, the Israelites probably made the animals walk one at a time under their staff so the Israelites could count the animals.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: What is the best way to talk about the animals walking under a shepherd’s staff so the shepherd can count the animals? How would you talk about the way that you count animals? Pause this audio here.

Yahweh will not allow the Israelites who tithe their animals to try to decide if the animals the Israelites are giving to Yahweh are good or bad. Yahweh also will not allow the Israelites to try to give Yahweh another animal instead of every tenth animal that walks under the shepherd’s staff. If an Israelite gives Yahweh another animal instead of one of the animals that the Israelites are supposed to tithe to Yahweh, then both the animals will be holy to Yahweh. Yahweh will not allow the person to redeem, or buy back, either of the animals.

In the fourth scene, the storyteller of Leviticus sums up the book of Leviticus. The storyteller says that these are the commands, or commandments, that Yahweh gave to Moses on Mount Sinai, so that Moses could give those laws to the Israelites.

Stop here and discuss this question as a group: Tell a story about a time someone gave a lot of rules to a group. How did that person finish giving the rules? Pause this audio here.

Now, the group should storyboard, draw, or use objects to visualize the passage and the action in it.

Embodying the Text

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:26–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will dramatize the passage.

This passage has four scenes.

The characters in this passage are:

- Yahweh
- A person completely devoted to Yahweh
- Moses
- And the Israelites

As a group, act out the passage twice. You should act out the passage in your own language.

First, act out the passage without stopping. Pay attention to the dialogue, flow, plotline, and chronology of the passage. Make sure you do not skip acting out the difficult or important parts of the passage. Help each other remember every part of the passage.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage.

The group should act out this passage a second time. At certain points in the drama, pause the drama and ask the person playing the character, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person playing the character should answer what they would be feeling or thinking if they were that character. Then continue the drama.

Pause this audio here and act out the passage a second time.

The following is an example of the drama and possible responses.

In the first scene, Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to consecrate any firstborn animal to Yahweh because Yahweh already owns all firstborn animals, whether they are cattle, sheep, or goats. Yahweh says again that all firstborn animals are Yahweh's. If the firstborn animal is a ritually dirty animal, then Yahweh will allow the Israelite who originally owned the animal to buy the animal back. That Israelite must pay the value of the animal and an additional 20 percent, or one-fifth, of the value of the animal. If the Israelite who originally owned the animal does not buy back the animal, then the priests will sell the animal for the value the priests decided the animal is worth.

In the second scene, Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to sell or redeem any of the animals, humans, or inherited property that someone completely devoted to Yahweh. The people and animals and inherited property that someone completely devotes to Yahweh are very holy. If Yahweh completely devotes a human to Yahweh, Yahweh will not allow anyone to ransom that human, or pay to save that human. Yahweh will require the Israelites to execute that human. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing Yahweh, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- The Israelites need to understand how much I want the people to execute a bad person sometimes; or
- The Israelites will realize how holy I am when the Israelites treat the things that are completely devoted to me the right way; or
- I do not want the Israelites to try to take things that I own from me.

Continue the drama. In the third scene, Yahweh says that one tenth, or 10 percent, of all the crops the Israelites produce in their land will belong to Yahweh. The crops include both the plants that the Israelites grow from the ground and harvest, and the plants that produce fruit that the Israelites pick. All these crops are holy to Yahweh. If an Israelite wants to buy back any of the tithes of the crops, the Israelite needs to pay Yahweh the value of the tithe and an additional 20 percent, or one-fifth, of the value of the crops. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing an Israelite, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I love Yahweh, and I am glad to give Yahweh one-tenth of the crops that Yahweh causes to grow; or
- I am glad Yahweh will let me buy back the crops that I want to keep; or
- Yahweh really wants us to respect the part of our crops that we tithe to Yahweh.

Continue the drama. Then Yahweh says that all the tithes of the herds and the flocks that the Israelites own will be holy to Yahweh. The tithes of the animals will be every tenth animal that walks under the shepherd's staff as the people count the animals. The Israelites can not choose the best or the worst animals from the flock to tithe. Yahweh will also not allow the Israelites to give Yahweh another animal instead of any of the animals that the Israelites decided to give Yahweh as a tithe. An Israelite might try to give Yahweh another animal instead of the animal the Israelite had originally decided to give Yahweh as a tithe. If so, the animal the Israelite gives, as well as the animal that the Israelite had originally decided to give as a tithe, will be holy. That Israelite cannot

buy back either animal. Pause the drama. Ask the person playing an Israelite, "What are you feeling or thinking?" The person might answer things like:

- I wanted to give Yahweh a worse animal than the one I originally decided to tithe to Yahweh; or
- I should not have tried to cheat Yahweh; or
- I feel sad because now I have to give two animals to Yahweh instead of one.

Continue the drama. In the fourth scene, the storyteller of Leviticus says that these are the commandments that Yahweh gave to Moses on Mount Sinai so that Moses could give the commandments to the Israelites.

Filling the Gaps

Listen to an audio version of Leviticus 27:26–34 in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this step, the group will discuss key terms and words in this passage.

In this passage, Yahweh tells the Israelites that firstborn animals belong to **Yahweh**. Yahweh is the personal name that the one true God gave to the Israelites to call God. Use the same word or phrase for Yahweh as you used in previous passages. For more information on Yahweh, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to **consecrate** the firstborn animals, or make the animals holy to Yahweh, because the animals already belong to Yahweh. When someone makes something holy, the person dedicates that thing to Yahweh so that Yahweh, instead of that person, can use that thing. Use the same word or phrase for consecrate as you used in previous passages. For more information on consecrate, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh mentions **cattle** and **sheep**. Remember that cattle refers to both male and female cows. Use the same words or phrases for cattle and sheep as you have used previously.

Firstborn unclean animals also belong to Yahweh. Unclean animals are ritually dirty, and Yahweh will not allow the Israelites to sacrifice these animals to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for unclean as you used in previous passages. For more information on unclean, refer to **clean and unclean** in the Master Glossary.

An Israelite can **ransom** a ritually dirty animal that the Israelite owned and dedicated to Yahweh. When someone ransoms an animal or a person, that person pays for that person or animal to go free. In this context, the ideas of ransom and redeem are very similar. Ransom is more focused on getting the person or animal back to their original owner or family. Redeem is more focused on paying a price to free a person or animal. Use the same word or phrase for ransom as you used in previous passages. For more information on ransom, refer to the Master Glossary.

Yahweh also says that the Israelites can **redeem** a ritually dirty animal that someone dedicates to Yahweh. When someone redeems a person or animal that the person had owned, the person pays money to buy back the person or animal. Use the same word or phrase for redeem as you used in previous passages. For more information on redeem, refer to the Master Glossary.

Sometimes someone will **completely devote** a person, animal, object, or piece of land to Yahweh. When someone completely devotes something to Yahweh, Yahweh does not allow any common person to use that thing. If someone completely devotes a person or animal or object to Yahweh, Yahweh makes the Israelites kill the person or animal or destroy the object. If Yahweh completely devotes a field to himself, the priests use that field. Yahweh will not allow anyone to redeem or ransom a person, animal, object, or piece of land that someone has completely devoted to Yahweh. Use the same word or phrase for completely devote as you used in previous passages.

People, animals, objects, and land that someone completely devotes to Yahweh are very **holy** to Yahweh. When something is holy, that thing is devoted to Yahweh, and Yahweh will not allow anyone to use it for common things. Use the same word or phrase for holy as you used in previous passages. For more information on holy, refer to the Master Glossary.

Animals of the Israelites' **herds** and **flocks** walk under the shepherds' staff so that people can count the animals. The animals in herds are cattle, and the animals in flocks are sheep and goats. Use the same words or phrases for herds and flocks as you have used in previous passages.

The tithes are also holy to Yahweh. When people give tithes, people give one-tenth of the things they grow or make to Yahweh.

Stop here and discuss as a group what word or phrase you will use for **tithe**. Look up tithe in the Master Glossary for more information. If you have already translated this word in another book of the Bible, decide if the same word is appropriate to use here. Pause this audio here.

These are the **commandments** that Yahweh gave Moses on Mount Sinai so that Moses could give them to the Israelites. A commandment is a law, a rule, or an instruction. Use the same word or phrase for commandment as you used in previous passages. For more information on commandment, refer to the Master Glossary.

Speaking the Word

Listen to an audio version of the passage in the easiest-to-understand translation.

Pause this audio here.

In this session, retell the passage, as a group, in your own language.

First, the whole group should practice telling the passage in your own language. Remember to include the things you decided in previous steps, like chronology, words, phrases, emotions, or anything else you discussed.

One group member should tell a few sentences of the passage and pause. Another group member should tell the next part of the passage and pause. Do this until the group has retold the whole passage. The group members can correct each other in this step.

Pause this audio here.

Next, each member of the group should tell the whole passage without interruption at least one time. A group member can use random objects, motions, or their storyboard to help them remember the passage.

Pause this audio here.

Next, the group can decide whose version of the passage you like the most. You may decide that you liked the way one group member told one scene but you liked the way a different group member told another scene.

Pause this audio here.

Finally, the group can put together a final version of the passage that everyone agrees on. Each group member should practice telling this final version of the passage.

Leviticus 27:26–34

Audio Content

- Hear and Heart (847 KB)
- Setting the Stage (3.9 MB)
- Defining the Scenes (4.0 MB)
- Embodying the Text (3.4 MB)
- Filling the Gaps (3.0 MB)
- Speaking the Word (1.1 MB)